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Wednesday, July 7, 2004



Traditions Wars:
a pathway to peace

NA Fellowship Work in Progress

Tradition Wars: a pathway to peace
Fellowship Work in Progress - Not for Use in Meetings

Cover Art

The Phoenix is a legendary bird whose tears have the power to heal. The Phoenix can resurrect itself from its own ashes. When addicts get clean and stay clean, they begin to resurrect themselves from the ashes made of their lives. The twelve primary feathers represent the NA Twelve Steps of recovery. We look at the past with shame, the present with guilt and the future with fear. Recovery changes all that!

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Victor Hugo Sewell, Jr.

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Tradition Wars: a pathway to peace
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Dedication:

To all that we lost during these times of spiritual conflict. If you are alive, clean and have no hatred in your heart, you are victorious not only over your disease but also our historical episodes.

Begun in February as the Victors of the Traditions Wars, *in April we moved to change the name of our new book effort to* The Traditions War: a pathway to peace. *The phrase was part of a sentence spoken by a member sharing in the Smyrna NA Foundation Group. We had not thought of what happened as a war before, but it was. People were hurt, some died, the conflict was real. That seems to cover the action, the fire fights, the victims, casualties, victors and all levels of conflict from cold-warism to outright attacks. We do not mean this as a literary spin on real war. We mean this as the Japanese say, "business is war." Our conflict has been very real and our members seriously injured by deliberate actions, justified by confused members who had no better guidance to go on. We love our members better. We don't hate them better, control them better or punish them better. Our purpose is to bring the conflicts out into the open first and then to recommend alternative ways to deal with situations that have the kind of give and take we need in a spiritual Fellowship like ours. You know, where everybody and their friends are right about just about everything. To get everyone on the same page, we need some more pages.*

P R E F A C E

If you have been a member of NA since the late 1980's, and have gratitude in your heart and hatred towards none, you are victorious over not only your disease but also our historical episodes. Naturally, as a Fellowship, we expand for a while numerically and conceptually – then we contract. Our numbers follow this increase and decrease of conceptual breadth and depth. The *Tradition Wars* is the name we are giving to the conflict between those who think NA is set up like a business and those who feel NA is a spiritual Fellowship. Many of us believe the spiritual dominates the mental plane by including so great a number of factors that go well beyond our field of perception.

This is why we 'turn it over to God.' You can sense things of the world with sight, hearing, tasting, smelling and touching. Things of the spirit are perceived in another manner on a different, wordless, level. There are other good members who have trouble relating to the spiritual and are more comfortable with the material or mental idea of a Fellowship of clean addicts who follow a path of action that while confusing seems to have good results, especially as to staying clean. Many times in this work we will refer to WSO or the business-like members. This is inevitable in dealing with issues and the written word. What we don't mean is that we hate the members or fail to see and value their viewpoint. It is upsetting and troublesome to many people to have to deal with the spiritual because it seems so intangible and unresolved to a person focused on things of the world. The Tradition Wars have had to do with the violation of our Second, Third, Sixth, Seventh and Eighth and Ninth Traditions. Of course, any violation involves them all ultimately but for purposes of our considerations, we will deal with these first, through time and referencing published minutes, reports and correspondence along with eyewitness accounts.

We are fortunate to have talented, grateful members who are motivated to work on this book in harmony and with the goal of inclusion of various viewpoints. As someone pointed out recently, we don't think there are serous casualties on our side alone. Having many written materials should hasten the work and allow us to reflect on the entries. Many reports and documents have flooded the NA landscape and there are too many to present them all. We will attempt with the help of an all loving, all-powerful creator to present samples representing experience and viewpoints from all sides. Of course, we know this is a difficult thing. Recovery has accustomed us to miraculous. It is no secret in life that when you are exerting your full effort on behalf of someone in dire need, you are able to step beyond your

normal boundaries. Someone on the sidelines would not see or understand that prayer gives people extraordinary energy and the ability to do what is not normally possible. It is a mistake to think they are doing it 'on their own.'

Since we don't want money or personal credit for our work, it is obvious that others figure we are nuts. It is just that it isn't fair to take something where God does all the work. Giving all credit to our Loving God is no exercise in deception. It is the simple truth. It is important that those who would work with us understand.. Love is the flow of spiritual energy between people who care about one another and are open to that caring. As NA has grown, there has been a hope among many of us that the deep, abiding love would eventually be acknowledged. It certainly took a lot of love to keep things going. Policies were pushed aside when they seemed inconvenient. Members were wasted where they fell out of favor with the business ''leaders'' who began to take over world services. We see a far reaching self-fulfilling prophecy downgrade membership in NA to prevent their having a say in what happens in NA. The original, attractive NA enhanced members and expected great things of them. This was uplifting and surprisingly many members were able to rise to this level of expectation.

"As I watched in the late 1980's the results of WSO's secret publication of the 4th Edition Basic Text from my front row seat on the Board of Trustees, I was appalled that my Fellow trustees were not upset. Some trustees seemed to be in on the unauthorized changes. Unauthorized means the motion that called for the light edit specifically removed the word 'grammar' lest it be interpreted to allow for editing beyond spelling, tense, gender and verb agreement. [Look this up and quote exactly! - Ed] This created a system of ongoing tension between those who knew what happened and those who did not. Obviously, much was being done outside the approved service structure, leaving out the members who were following the rules and giving ascension to those willing to break them. The level of damage was so great to our spirit that the perpetrators could not be easily chastised or removed from office. It was a fundamental breakdown of our system. Even to speak or write about it today gets one tar brushed for being in the know. While all this was going on, I prayed there would be a time of reckoning, so the membership would understand that they have to take interest in what goes on at world level and let their will be known! Otherwise, you can just wait for the next big surprise to be thrown at us.

"I have three obligations here. First to my own spiritual integrity, second to my friends who died during these times or lost their spirit and third to you - who would know the truth and pitch in to help us continue and expand our recovery process in Narcotics Anonymous. Even now in these quiet days, I wonder if they are up to something? Are there new betrayals in the works? Or have they settled down to do their jobs in perfect trust and faith to the NA Fellowship. Since the new WSO is styled as a business corporation with little required reporting, no outside audit done in years and delegates who vote how they 'feel' that day, and not representatives who vote the conscience of their region, you can bet there are some nasty surprises ahead. There is a tragic side to human nature that just wants to tear down something beautiful. Like despoilers attacking a religious shrine, it is almost as if they hate the serenity and peace of others and so attack their symbols. The work of years can be torn down in a day. If there is nothing untoward going on, well I am concerned for nothing. If there is, my apprehension only lowers the impact of betrayal. It doesn't prevent it. The point is, I should not have to worry about being betrayed in NA. Nor should anyone else. We can surrender and play by the rules. It gets so twisted that to be forthright and correct is to be deemed dumb and out of it. A world of recovering addicts has had its hands tied for about twelve or thirteen years now. It was in trouble before that. But like the complex inter-workings of an automobile, all the parts have to be in place and in working order for the machine to run. A new Fellowship has grown up wherein members are left out of processes, allowing themselves to be diverted by the carefully presented policy motions that have as their main effect neutralizing and immobilizing the creativity and curiosity of the Fellowship. What makes it all funny and allows us to escape the mess is that by distancing itself from us the supporters, world services if finally setting us free to begin again advancing the processes they seek to control! Discipline is creative - control is deadening." – Bo S.

To prevent this unfair diversion of Fellowship attention and money, we have to develop a firm understanding of the 12 Traditions of NA. Some things are not ok here. We need to praise our steadfast members who do the daily miracles by setting up the meetings and conducting the services of groups, areas and regions. We have to continue the study we began when we got clean as we continue to pass on what we have learned thus far. This chain of learning and encouraging others must not be broken. It is not spiritual or OK to say God will take care of it. Do we need a rash

of new funerals to remind us what happens when we don't do God's Will? People in a valley dying of small pox better get serious about vaccination if they want to live. God inspires and gives gifted people the ability to develop the vaccine, it is up to the doctors and nurses to get it out to the people who need it in time. While many carry into recovery notions that wrongdoers need to be punished, that won't work very well in NA. If someone makes a mistake, deliberately or by accident, chances are they didn't really understand that their actions would result in the death of some of our members. While we pay a terrible price to learn these lessons, we don't have to pay additional pain and agony by punishing the 'culprits.' We don't have to vent the anger we feel towards ourselves for not maintaining the learning days and discussions that should prepare our members to lead recovery meetings.

It takes work and study to learn the importance of really sitting down and explaining membership to someone new. The Twelfth Step is the key Step to NA peace and unity. NA is a self-correcting program. We also warn our members that sometime, somewhere, somehow, we will be thrown off balance and it will make using drugs seem like a good idea. With our disease that is absolutely certain to happen. It may be a business thing, a love affair, a service committee deal. Whatever it is, your package is on its way. Will you have the spiritual force and energy to ward off the obsession and compulsion or will you star in one of the early death scenarios that remind the rest of us to do our duty? Dot Tally of the Pittsburgh Fellowship once said, "Addicts have three requirements to live: food, shelter and someone to blame it on." All us addicts are like this to some degree. Learning to take personal responsibility is the same as saying we find ways to take actions to bring about the good things we want and minimize the things we don't want. Spread out over a Fellowship wide scale, it takes a lot of gratitude and devotion to do what we do. In our NA Society, we each play a vital role, sometimes only known to us. As we share and transmit what we have witnessed and what works for us, room is made for us to learn and experience new things.

I want members of NA to know the miracles we have enjoyed. If some of our members have climbed to the tops of mountains in our name, every NA member should know about it and feel good. How we solve our problems and get help has to be learned because it is not in our nature to do these things well. Usually an addict will be real good at two or three things at the expense of everything else. We have a lot to share and be grateful for in NA. I know I am not alone in this desire and my knowledge of the miracles we have seen. It should be noted that there are many types of corporations and industries that are creative and make themselves attractive by engaging and involving their members, stockholders or employees in their processes. Corporate does not have to be cold and exclusive. Many flourish by establishing and maintaining an air of openness and fair play. When things go wrong, they make an openhanded evaluation and renew their commitment to quality service or whatever their business is. One of the irritating aspects of the past twenty years is the many times we have been betrayed by orators who cover corporate mismanagement and tampering with Fellowship practices under the guise of 'good business.' Terms like streamlining and cost efficiency are used to describe curtailing services that members want and need. Duplication of services is a term used to eliminate vital checks and balances. In NA, it is never 'good business' to leave the Fellowship feeling left out.

In Loving Service,
Bo S.

I N T R O D U C T I O N

Deceased members full names will appear in this material to prevent confusion.

The Tradition Wars: a pathway to peace

The purpose of this book is to open an avenue for all who have been burned by the lack of participation in our 12 Traditions. We have seen members utilizing power in NA service to bolster their views, increase their power base, or simply to get rid of those who oppose their way of carrying the message. These abuses can be found on any and all levels of NA service. Sadly, they often lead not to disagreements and arguments, but to the very lives of NA members who leave the fellowship, use and possibly die.

Narcotics Anonymous service brings together an odd lot of people who's ideas vary as widely as the forms of drugs we used. Many have a natural talent for structured service, analytical, cold, calculating, often times shrewd and cunning. Many of their talents came from life on the streets were it was kill or be killed. Survival of the fittest was the name of the game and often those that gravitate to the top of the food chain in NA service have honed those skills to an art form.

On the other side are those who believe in self-less service. Who have been taught to give freely expecting nothing in return. They learn that giving this way has it's own reward, a deep sense of self worth and gratitude that is worth much more than gold or fame and titles. NA service often pits these two forces against each other, often with disastrous results not only for the individuals but for the fellowship as a whole.

The Basic Text reminds us that honest sharing is the antidote to our diseased thinking. The truth will set you free, but first it will piss you off! Some will be thrilled and thankful that the truth is being told, others may feel threatened, while others will shout loudly, how dare you? We who write this book say back to them.. How dare you??? Sadly, some day down the road, we are all going to have a Judge Judy moment. Probably when large sums of money have been diverted for personal gain, someone will say something like; "So, where were the checks and balances? You dissolved the Board of Trustees, what were you thinking????" The fact that members lives were saved by Narcotics Anonymous and they can cold bloodedly manipulate the system to create a closed none fellowship participatory system to suite their private needs is beyond belief. It stagers the imagination that members who's lives were useless and pathetic, were loved back to health and sanity, and their response is to highjack the service structure and ostracize a loving God as expressed through NA individual group conscience is unfathomable!

No one of us is completely without sin when it comes to tradition wars. Many of us who cry the injustice of structured service, have been party to our own use of traditions as weapons in the war to purify NA. How many members have we sent back out because they did not share our vision of NA unity. We berated them for being sober and not clean, for sharing about Alcoholics Anonymous in "our" NA meetings, like we could truly own something that was God given.

Early NA is littered with the bodies of addicts who never got clean because the fellowships had not yet written the traditions. Before the Traditions were put into written form, the principles still existed, so we can call them ‘spiritual violations. These ‘spiritual violations’ were very injurious to the Fellowship. Individual egos ran the show right into the ground, over and over and over again. The first attempts at NA in NYC at the end of 1949 beginning 1950 was riddled with tradition violations. Of course, they were doing the very best they could with what they had and sadly to say in 1950, they didn't have much. Caring individuals, like Father Dan Eagan and Salvation Army Major General Dorothy Berry helped the fledgling group by creating a board of trustees for NA. Sadly they would not let any addicts serve on this board. The group extended itself to all manner of aid to it's members; housing, food, job assistance. In it's waning years, the leader, a woman named Ray Lopez, had gotten a job working for the Narcotics Division of the city of New York. Half her office was New York Narcotics the other half was NA. You can just

imagine the problems that ensued.

As with most early fellowships, the death of the stronger member oft times meant the death of the fellowship, as in direct contradiction of the 12 traditions, one member and not the fellowship, was doing most of the work. They were not "we" fellowships, but ones with small power centers at the top. This is how NA in California failed in it's first attempt. As most of us know, toward the beginning of the 1960's, the last NA meeting in the world had died. It was quickly picked back up by founding members, including Jimmy K. He was always adamant that NA was a "we fellowship" and not an "I" fellowship. He always said; "there are no big shots here in NA – one shot and we're all shot."

Jimmy K maybe the most visible casualty of the Tradition Wars. Sadly, his name is still used today to justify ongoing hostility and resentments. You have to wonder what Jimmy would think about that. He was a loving man who had many people speaking in his ears toward the end of his life and the end of his career in service to the fellowship as business manager of WSO. Often times Powerful Men will be used by those around them to further their goals. The fellowship begged and pleaded with Jimmy to come to the World Service Conference to give a report, while others played on his feelings of betrayal and fostered their beliefs that the literature committee was out to get him. This was far from the truth. The leaders in the literature for the most part owed their lives to Jimmy, as he sponsored several of them. One member was his protege and probably one of his best friends. Sadly those in the circle around Jimmy painted pictures of betrayal about Greg Pierce that just were not true. Greg shared about the pain of going to his sponsors house and having the door slammed in his face. Why? Because he fought to get a book written by addicts for addicts. So too Greg Pierce, the man who wrote our 12 Tradition chapter of the Basic Text, the NA Tree, our first service structure, The Triangle of Self Obsession, Living The Program, an Approach to The 4th Step in Narcotics Anonymous, had been kicked to the curb for standing up for NA and our need for a book on recovery.

The largest element of NA that was disenfranchised by the tradition wars were the die hard dedicated members of the World Literature Committee. These members gave their 'all' for over 2 years to see that a Basic Text of Recovery from the disease of addiction in Narcotics Anonymous became a reality. Many lost family, jobs, and gave countless years of selfless service so that addicts could recover and would not have to die from this wretched disease we are all afflicted with. As changes were made to the Basic Text without true fellowship approval, a little piece of them died. They had sweated over every single word in our book and to see a small handful of insiders would make change after change, hire professional writers to edit something they saw as near perfect and all with the flick of the wrist, or the strike of some keys on a word processor, did in years of diligent tireless selfless service. Many have left NA and sadly will never come back. We owe them our very lives, and this is how we repay them, by labeling them vocal minority, trouble-makers and malcontents, who have nothing better to do than tear down NA.

This book is about any violation of traditions that led to or could lead to the death of even one suffering addict. As our literature states, "that (no) addict seeking recovery need ever die!". The text also lets us know that "we are as sick as our secrets". For these reasons we write and ask all to participate in the writing of the Tradition Wars, this is your book as well as ours. Please go to the NA-HISTORY.ORG web site and input your views and your memories on these our growing years. If you don't write it, it will never be heard! This is your chance to have your say and make a difference for the health and well being of NA for years to come.

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To move forward with this work, we will create an original document and let NA members from all over the world input ideas, suggestions, writings, critiques and do this as a joint effort. The way copyright law reads, contributing authors derive their work from originating author. This keeps the technicalities simple and opens the door to participation to any member, just as setting up a meeting place does for a recovery meeting. The www.nawol.org Quest Forum and the information on the www.na-history.org will contribute directly to the material along with any minutes, committee reports and correspondence we can find. Further, we will include eye witness accounts cited with first name and last initial. Special thanks to Grover N. and Ron R. whose courage and vigor have inspired this work. We will add to this list of thanks as we progress. Gratitude to David A. of the Smyrna NA Foundation Group for originating the title in one of his incredible, colorful phrases.

In Loving Service,
Bo S.

Dear Fellow Members,

Our editorial policy should be to present viewpoints and factual documents not otherwise available to help NA members think for themselves. I don't think we ever need to deal in radical rantings, but we should give ourselves the liberty to inform the general membership what has been going on the last ten or fifteen years. Many members haven't been clean that long - so they don't realize they used to have representatives that carried their vote. We are willing to take some time to avoid witch hunts and kangaroo courts. There has been enough of that.

We pray as we undertake this effort for God's divine hand to strengthen and guide us so that our efforts will heal and strengthen our Fellowship.

I went to a convention this past weekend, there was a NA history workshop that I missed so I asked some friends who did the workshop in the hopes that I might come away with a contact that I could get some material from.

When I found out who did the workshop I walked up to the lady who had 25 years clean and told her that we were doing a NA history web page, her reply was ""who is we?"" when I mentioned some of the names involved with the NA history web site she instantly said ""I am not interested"" and turned her back on me.

I was so deflated I did what I know how to do call a trusted addict and talk about it. I got some good feedback and went on and enjoyed the rest of the time I spent at the convention. I did buy the tape from that history workshop along with 5 others I like the 6 for 5 tape deals if your gonna spend 5 bucks per tape may as well get a free one, anyway I listened to a few tapes I really wanted to here Bob B. was great it took until today for me to get to the history workshop tape and after listening to this lady it made me think of the Tradition Wars topic what I came away with from listening to this lady was this. Yes there were casualties some people died and some of those that survived are still hurting and yet others worked the hell out of this program and got on with their lives.

This lady made me realize that there were casualties on both sides of this thing, and just like we feel strongly about those we lost, there were people lost and hurt on their side also. So maybe just maybe when we start this project about the Victors of the Traditions Wars that we tell about whom got hurt on both sides.

This is just this old addict trying to spark up some thoughts, ideas, and possibly get another part of our history told in a fashion that will bring about true understanding and maybe some healing.

While listening to this tape as she spoke or starting to speak about certain things you could hear the pain she was reliving, that was the initial spark that prompted me to write this. I guess the thing we call empathy does work when you practice the spiritual principles of our God given program.

ILS
Ronald R.

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Chapter One

Early History of NA

There is an early mention of a 12 Step program for addicts similar to Alcoholics Anonymous in the Summer School for Alcohol and Drugs at Yale in 1948. The question was put to a speaker name William W. We can easily suppose this is Bill Wilson, though investigation may show another person. It is still an early mention and while William's response is evasive, it doesn't deny the question.

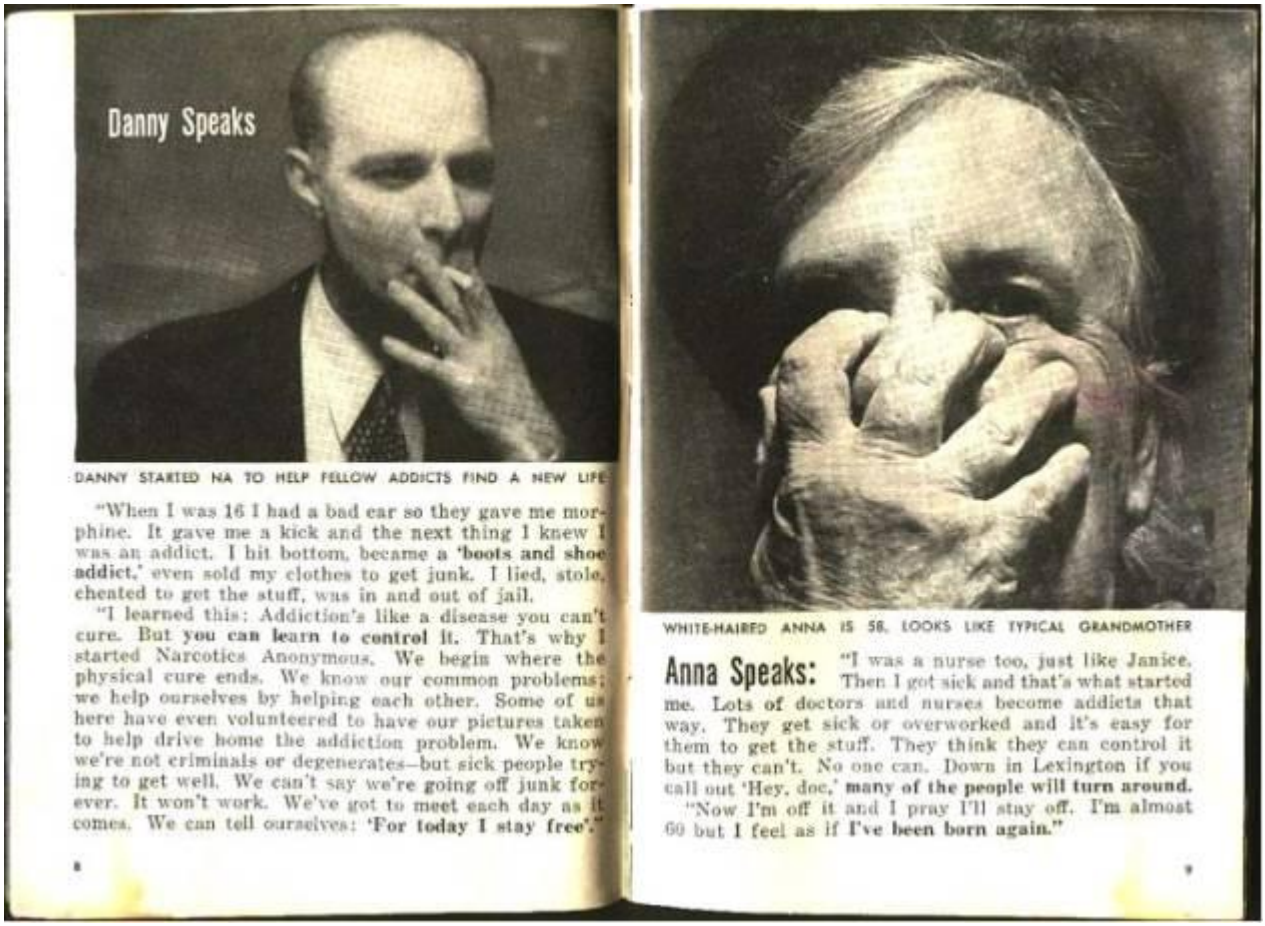
A person subject to chronic relapse named Daniel Carlson went to Lexington, Kentucky to cut his dope habit one more time and got clean. It may have been a miracle or simply the accumulation of efforts by different people over time. Another man left Montgomery, Alabama and went up to Lexington with the 12 Steps of AA under his arm. His name was Houston Sewell. He helped start the Narco group. There was a newsletter circulated in the Fed system – *the Key*. Meetings also took place in Angola, the big state prison in Louisiana and in Dallas Texas. While many addicts used the system to lower their habits to more manageable levels, it is obvious that our roots trace back to these early efforts.

In New York, where Danny lived when he wasn't in Lexington, a up and coming lady in the Salvation Army named Dorothy Berry rose in rank to Brigadier General. Her work earns her mention in our early history. She encouraged and provided meeting space for NA meetings in their facilities. Father Dan Egan also worked, primarily among prostitutes and addicts and also earns mention. An NA member in South Florida in 1982 is quoted as giving an NA member named Charlie McGee credit for coming up with our name, Narcotics Anonymous. Time will tell us more as our work deepens what is known of our history. One thing, regardless of details, we are grateful to them all for what they did led to our recovery today.

West Coast: Sun Valley beginnings, minutes of meeting in July, 1953 show that by October, there was no one left holding their original positions. Remember, the group wanted to be AA/NA and when it came down that AA would not violate their Traditions, it probably offended the original group members. Some members must have met because the legend credits NA as beginning on the West Coast in 1953. We have no idea what the meetings were like but like their counterparts back East, they must have lacked a key ingredient. One member expresses the idea that they started "groups" rather than taking the role of starting a Fellowship. That is why there was no literature. The Little White Booklet was like a small sailboat on the sea of addiction in the fifties, sixties and the early seventies.

The Twelve Traditions were approved by the Fellowship of AA at the St. Louis General Service Conference in 1955. This singular point well illustrates just how new the organizational aspects of 12 Step Fellowships were evolving. When I got clean, I was told that efforts to begin NA in the forties died out because they did not follow the Twelve Traditions. While it is true that the principles that lie within the framework of the Traditions were violated and problems thus generated did stop the meetings in several instances, they could not violate something not yet known or approved.

One of our earliest members was Daniel Carlson, a hopeless relapser who came back to Lexington to clean up one more time. This time he made it. His is the primary name associated with NA beginnings in the Eastern United States. Along with Brg General Dorothy Berry of the Salvation Army who was a great friend to NA in the early times.



Danny Speaks

DANNY STARTED NA TO HELP FELLOW ADDICTS FIND A NEW LIFE

"When I was 16 I had a bad ear so they gave me morphine. It gave me a kick and the next thing I knew I was an addict. I hit bottom, became a **'boots and shoe addict,'** even sold my clothes to get junk. I lied, stole, cheated to get the stuff, was in and out of jail.

"I learned this: Addiction's like a disease you can't cure. But **you can learn to control it.** That's why I started Narcotics Anonymous. We begin where the physical cure ends. We know our common problems; we help ourselves by helping each other. Some of us here have even volunteered to have our pictures taken to help drive home the addiction problem. We know we're not criminals or degenerates—but sick people trying to get well. We can't say we're going off junk forever. It won't work. We've got to meet each day as it comes. We can tell ourselves: **'For today I stay free'."**

WHITE-HAIRED ANNA IS 58. LOOKS LIKE TYPICAL GRANDMOTHER

Anna Speaks: "I was a nurse too, just like Janice. Then I got sick and that's what started me. Lots of doctors and nurses become addicts that way. They get sick or overworked and it's easy for them to get the stuff. They think they can control it but they can't. No one can. Down in Lexington if you call out 'Hey, doc,' **many of the people will turn around.**

"Now I'm off it and I pray I'll stay off. I'm almost 60 but I feel as if **I've been born again."**

There are many articles in the Saturday Evening Post and other top magazines to illustrate the efforts of many to get NA going in places like Cleveland, Ohio, and distant places like Los Angeles. On the West Coast, a small group came together and started what they say is a new brand of Narcotics Anonymous in Sun Valley, California. While all this is questionable as to originality, there is no doubt that the continuity of meetings and the eventual development of NA into a world wide Fellowship centered around the West Coast efforts to start a Fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous. It also needs to be stressed that while headquarters and some co-ordination came from California, it is the people of NA that brought about the serious changes in the 1970's. Greg Pierce knew something about organization and came to NA in a business suit. Although a junkie and heroin addict, Greg had a deep love of people and a flare for the fantastic. So much so that he bet his life on a program that did not in some regards yet exist. He and others did much of the ground work that helped make the Jimmy K WSO a reality and workable office. Jimmy on the other hand was a great symbolic leader, loving NA and enjoying the life of service that having the Office in his home afforded him.

Jimmy K's 20th Anniversary Talk (excerpted)

clean date: Feb 2, 1950, died July 9, 1985

20th ANNIVERSARY DINNER ISLANDER RESTAURANT
LOS ANGELES AUGUST 18, 1973
CHAIRMAN BOB B. (excerpts)

Introduction by Bob B.

The 20th Anniversary is, I think, a good occasion for me in terms of, I was not around for the 20 years because I was still playing crazy. But about 15 years ago, when I did come around I met some people that something happened in the process. And it wasn't to happen for another three years before I was to get clean at the insistence of the state. And then to find out that I could cone out after a couple of years and to stay clean over a period of over ten ears. It wouldn't have been possible if there wasn't people like the people in this room that kind of insisted, kind of pushed, kind of bad rapped me, they kind of held me up. They gave me all the things that were necessary, the things that I needed. And at the same time, one person that I became very close to, at that time, stayed in close touch with me over the years, giving me some confidence in terms that I could do it if would only try. And we've been through many trials of error in my growing up. And at the same time, we've shared a lot of heartaches and pleasures also. I'm going to let him tell you his own story in terms of what happened.

At this time, I've been going through papers our offices and things have been in trunks of cars and back of garages in cardboard boxes, in old filing cases, and what have you. And many of these things that we keep as momentous as to times gone by. And one of these momentous that I've kept over a period of years is an original set of By Laws that were adopted in 1953. (The text of these By Laws can be found beginning on page 2 of this work.) August the 17th, which was yesterday today is like a year (20 years) and one day. This set of guides that were set down in order to determine, to run, or to govern NA as a whole some particular guides. There have been many, many additions and changes since then. But at this time I thought it would be appropriate that I put these here By Laws in some kind of archives for safe keeping. And who better is there to give this to and put it in safe keeping, but the person who helped put it together, kind of shepherded it around, kept us all tied in some manner together. And I put them in a binder so that he can probably put them away with the rest of his treasures as a remembrance of say oh, that's where it started and this is how it is today. And I would like to, at this time, to introduce and present this here set of By Laws as a token of safe keeping and a token of whatever I can't don't even know the words to express it to Jimmy K., one of the founders of NA; and one of the people who has been a mainstay; and one that keeps it together and has kept it together through many of the years that it has been around. So, this is the By Laws, an original set, and I'm going to give these here to Jimmy. And at this time Jimmy probably can give a little more background and highlight as to where it came from, what happened, and what's happening right now. I'm gonna turn it over to Jimmy K.

Jimmy K.
My name's Jimmy Kinnon, I'm an addict and an alcoholic. (Text of Jimmy's talk is complete.) I've been on the verge of tears for about one hour here and that almost did it. But I'm not ashamed of tears anymore, providing they're the kind that are said for something that's worthwhile. That just about wiped by, brain clean, I can't even remember what I was going to say now. However; in our fellowship, at any time, our main purpose has to be always foremost in our lives; whether we're socializing with each other in our individual homes, or whether we're at a gathering of this kind, particularly this kind. What I have to remember, personally, that I'm here, and possibly all of you are here because of people who'll never be here. The newcomer is the life blood of this organization, always has been, always will be.

Bob pointed out a few people who are here tonight and some people who couldn't make it tonight. Those people we call "Trusted Servants" of Narcotics Anonymous. Mostly, anyone who takes a position or any kind of leader (whether it's Chairman of a Group, Representative of a Group, GSO Representative, Trustee, or anything else regarding this organization) just lets himself in for a lot of work, a lot of criticism, and a lot of those things that go on. But you see, we have to grow, and our shoulders get broad enough to carry these things because the life that is given to us makes

everything worthwhile. If it wasn't meaningful and worthwhile, I wouldn't be here tonight. If this program didn't lift me higher carry me further and make me feel better than anything else ever did in my life, I wouldn't be here. That's for damn sure?

I sit up here in this chair, I've always admired these chars but never thought I'd sit in one. I say "Yea Gods?" shades of Peter Lorie, you know, where's the fat man? But, first things first they tell us. You know, this is a part of a dream come true; and a dream envisions great changes but progress demands many small actions. A dream doesn't come true because of one group of people, or one man, or two men, or three men. It comes true because a lot of people work at it, because a lot of people put effort into it, because a lot of people buy the idea and carry it forward. That's one of the reasons we're here.

Most of you have noticed that there are a few pictures over there on that easel. These are some of the pictures of the beginnings. we started long before NA was a reality, even in name. we grew out of a need and we found those of us who were members had come into AA and found we could recover. In AA we found out that many addicts were still going down the road of degradation and death. And we thought it was right that we should try to do something. But, you know, we're funny people, the more we try to do things together, the more we fight each other and the more we tear each other apart, tear down the very thing we try to build. And that's been the history, up until a few short years ago, of Narcotics Anonymous. We tore down as fast as we built. That's the kind of people we are and we must recognize that to recover. All of us must know the nature of the illness, the nature of the illness, the nature of the addict, and the nature of recovery. All these things are necessary to grow, and to live, and to change. And we started from resentments - resentments made us grow.

Before NA there was HFD, Habit Forming Drug Groups. These were hidden, these were one or two or three people meeting in apartments, here and there. Nobody knew where they were, they demanded certain things, and were dominated by one or two persons. You know, you and I don't go for authority. We don't like authority. A few of the people I met down an skid row years ago from East LA formed another group known as Addicts Anonymous. They infringed on the AA name and they died very quickly because they too were dominated by one man. So, we found out very early, and our experience has taught us that we can have no bosses, no big shots in Narcotics Anonymous.

For awhile after we formed A lot of things happened that I'm not going into tonight but due to some things that happened and due to the nature of the addict, the nature of our illness, some people were put ii a position where they became the leaders again, the Great White Father You know, we can't have a Great White Father or a Bib Momma, you know, it doesn't work in this organization. And NA died once more, and the friends of ours in AA helped to pick us up and said "Don't let it bother you". These were the real friends we had in the beginning; members of AA who believed in us, members of AA had themselves a dual problem at that time and recognized that they came and helped us get started again. But again and again this happened in this organization. One person would try to dominate the whole movement. And every time it happened we began to die. Because the Traditions go down the drain when we try this. And one of the first things that we said when we met as a group in that house, #1 up there, where we formed those By Laws that Bob was talking about; where we sat together trying to iron out some things we wanted to do. We came down to very simple ideas. Number one, that we believed that this program of 12 Steps would work for addicts as well as for alcoholics. Two, that the Traditions must be followed if we were to grow, and grow as a fellowship that could stand on its own feet aside from and away from AA. We could take our own place as a fellowship, and not be dominated by or affiliated with anything or anybody else. And we said we would keep a place open for at least two years, and if in two years one or two addicts showed that this program could work for them, we would have felt that it had been worthwhile.

That fundamentally, was what we started with. But we argued about it for about six weeks before we put those By Laws on paper, and then we didn't want the By Laws. The sooner I figured we could get rid of the By Laws, the better off weld be. Because the policies of the Traditions are enough to guide us in what we have to do. The Traditions will save us from ourselves. And this is what is so necessary for a fellowship like ours. This is life, the other way is death as we know it. But how hard and how difficult it is not to go back. How difficult?

The first big order of business we had when we got together was the name. I was the first Chairman of what we then called ah - nothing. AANA, that's what it was called and I said "You simply can't do that ". You made me your chairman, we're gonna have to find another name, we can' t call Ourselves AANA or NAAA. And the committee who voted me the Chairman immediately vetoed what I said . Right , that's a good way to start. They vetoed everything I said the first night, so I thought I was off to a pretty good start. I wasn't going to get away with any horse shit from these people. They were going to find out what was right to do . And so the first order of business was to contact Anonymous to find out if we could use their name.; and found out that you couldn't do it. So I got the satisfaction, at least, of being right on the first thing that they vetoed. That made me feel a little better, you know, because I got news for you, I get my own way most of the time. I know you recognize that because so do you. That's the kind of people we are. But we had a lot of trouble when we got together; because I'm just like you are and you're just like I am. You're going to have to show me that what you say is going to work or I ain't going to go along. And thank God we are like that. I think that is what makes this program work eventually.

It was very hard to find a place to meet; after we got together and agreed what we were going to do. You couldn't find a hall to meet in. Nobody would allow us in. They didn't trust us in any way, shape or form. And it's pretty sad when you go from one place to another after you've got something real good going and nobody will let you use their hall. You know? Eventually, we did find a Salvation Army hall and they allowed us to use it for five dollars a month. You know, that's pretty good, but there were no facilities there. There was one little with a hand basin and a bowl in there, and that was it. There was no kitchen, so we had to go out and buy a little electric stove and some coffee pots, some cups which I still have at home. I found them just this week. I've had them all these years. We used to give them to each other because this week you might meet at my place, which is the second picture up there, and next week we might meet at your place. So you took the cups with you so everybody would have a cup to get their coffee in. You know, not many of us had more than a couple of cups in our houses then. In fact, not many of us were working. But that's the way it was. I still have those things.

"I got news for you, the Sunland Lumber Company is now defunct, but we're still living. The Salvation Army hall is still there - there are 2 pictures if it up on the top line - it is now a Spanish church. Some of the other pictures up there are where we had some of our "Rabbit Meetings". We called them "Rabbit Meetings" then because we never knew where we were going to meet. If there were 5 or 6 of us at a meeting tonight we decided then whose apartment or whose house we'd have the meeting in next week. And you would take the cups and sugar bowls and the format with you, you know, and then we'd meet at your place next week.

It wasn't that we who were getting into the program then were so afraid of the law but the newcomers were scared to death. I made a sign and we put it outside of the front door of the church there (about twice the size of this - three times the size of that) that said NA Meeting tonight at 8:30. And then we opened the door for business and we'd get about a dozen alcoholics in there who came to help us. And then a car would pull down around the comer slowly and they'd look at the sign and then they'd split. Nobody trusted nobody - you know they thought it was staked out. They wouldn't believe us when we told them there was no surveillance. And we weren't just too sure in the beginning ourselves."

"Because as a group we decided we were going to get right with the law at least and we went down to the Narcotics Division. And we told them, we didn't ask them, we told them we were going to have a meeting of addicts. And they raised their eyebrows a little bit when we first mentioned it. But there were 5 of us down there. A Miller, I forget if he was a Lieutenant or a Captain then, he listened and he said: "It's about time something like this happened, I've been trying to help addicts for years and with no success; I can't help anybody". And so he called in a lieutenant to listen in on our conversation and see what he thought. And he was a hard-nosed, old style, hope-to-die cop who knew for sure (who knew for sure) that none of us could recover, you know. And he listened and Miller was saying: "I like that idea", "I'll go along with that idea", "I buy what you have to say", "I'll do everything I can to help you". All the way down the line he was all for us. He kept his word, by the way. And he said to this lieutenant "what do you think?" (lieutenant): "Ain't gonna work, once a Junkie always a Junkie, you know that, God Damit. There's never any of them gonna get any better. I don't care what you say, I don't care what these people say, it ain't gonna work." So he looked back at us and I didn't know what the Hell to say, you know I'm only one of the group. I looked at Doris and she

didn't know what to say. And Frank didn't know what to say. And old Pat, who was sitting back there with his mouth shut all this time and never opened his mouth says: "Lieutenant, my name is so-and-so, I was born and raised in such-and-such a place, I got arrested the first time for such-and-such a thing, and I was sentenced such-and -such a time for so many years; and starting there I want you to go back and check my record all the way through. I've been in every God Damned Federal Pen., except Danamora, in the country. I'm the last of the Petermen, and I haven't had a bit of Junk for 18 years. I haven't been in Jail for 18 years; and this program works for me. Now you look it up and prove it to yourself because I was never out of jail from the time I was a kid until the time I found this program." And the guy didn't know what to say. Pat said: "Now I mean it, check it out."

Whether the guy ever checked it out, I don't know; but I know that the police department and the Narcotics Division kept their word to us. And they never staked us out , they never busted us in any way, shape, or form - never rousted us coming or going to meetings. And so, we in turn kept our word, we policed ourselves and we followed the Traditions as best we knew how. And this is what has made us basically begin to grow in the past 12 years."

Early Problems

When the July planning sessions resulted in the October meeting, almost everyone on the list of signees from what are reputed to be the original minutes of NA has backed off.

Over the years, perhaps for excellent reasons, Jimmy Kinnon and Sy Melas had disagreements. Sy was fond of citing the way things were done on the East Coast and Jimmy was quick to point out the 12 Traditions said this and that. Once a check came to the NA address for a $100 honorarium for Sy speaking at a hospital. Things like that created some of the early problems through the 1950's. Please bear in mind that the 12 Traditions of AA were not adopted at the General Service Conference until 1955, so they were new.

Meetings stopped for several months in 1959. It was no ones fault; everyone thought someone else was covering the meeting. The members weren't going bowling or fishing, they were likely off to a convention or going to other meetings. Responsibility just hadn't become an item on our NA agenda. What changed things was the NA Tree and the commitments made by members of the Board of Trustees. Notably, Jack Waley made a joke at one of the early anniversaries by telling the group they had better be committed to NA, otherwise they were being ripped off for the price of the rubber chicken at the World Convention. Jack was probably the first NA to make a point of being loyal to NA. If he sponsored you and you got loaded, he would tell you, "Bring me a year. You let me down, let yourself down too." He deserves a permanent place in our Fellowships memory. [look for more material on tape from 20th anniversary tape.]

Narcotics Anonymous was built by spirited, loving, grateful addicts who got caught up in the dream of a world wide fellowship of clean addicts working the 12 Steps of NA and helping others. That dream still exists. It must be understood that the vision comes before the reality here. The dreamers have to see it as possible and work against all opposition to bring it into reality. The opposition may ridicule, sabotage and show contempt for them in the beginning. But thank God, they made it and what we share is their dream of our recovery come true.

Steeped in selflessness, they sought no position at WSO. This was one factor that helped create the separation between volunteers and paid staff. The very experienced and informed NA members would always speak up when something inappropriate of violation of our structure came up. This may have helped create the idea that they were just radical and liked to complain. The growth of a gap between these experienced and informed members widened until Bob Stone saw them only as 'vocal' and in the 'minority.' I would suppose every organization has its followers

who apply themselves more than the average member and are vocal about it. Actually, they thought they were not being vocal enough and experienced confusion and embarrassment when rebuffed by WSO personnel - Bob Stone or anyone else employed there. Their first thought was that they had it wrong and rechecked the written, approved structure and other facts. When they found themselves correct, they would really become vocal, minority or not. And when they were treated like traitors and malcontents, it was like plunging a dagger into their heart. Not usually over the issue but in the face of betrayal by a service arm and not being supported by their Fellow members. Now, here is a virus that can poison an entire Fellowship, given time.

Bob Stone spoke while explaining the 4th Edition debacle at the WSC about the blindness that affects people at WSO. That because of who was voicing concern, he would pay attention or ignore. This labeling led to tagging members as "good" and "bad." That no one in a position to help saw this is a real shame. Many good members went down over this. They got loaded, lost their dreams and died. Many, many others are still in meetings today still dazed and confused about what happened and what went wrong. This is what we mean when we call them wounded. They deserve to have their dreams back. They earned them!

Chapter Two

How NA Service Took on Its Form

It took us a long time to realize that some of these early meetings had nothing to do with founding a fellowship. They were courageous efforts to create someplace where addicting seeking 12 Step recovery could go. It was later that our efforts to create the things it takes to make a Fellowship, things like the WSO, the Basic Text and the many members who people our service structure world-wide. When things went wrong, we left a trail of broken-hearted NA lovers. It is hard for us to buy into a dream and that is all NA was back then.

Greg P. got clean in 1970 with around twenty known NA meetings in the world. Greg went to all of them in Southern Cal. He had a business suit and a job that left him with time on his hands in an office. His recovery story went in the Little White Book as "I was Different." He became ardently involved from the beginning. Jimmy K was his sponsor and during some periods of illness, Jimmy was cared for at Greg's home in North Hollywood, California. Greg often made thoughtful statements. NA came into existence by members making a commitment to NA as their recovery program. Greg commented, "It takes a certain brand of insanity to bet your life on something that doesn't exist."

With his special gifts, Greg thrived on the atmosphere at WSO and when he was two years clean, he began work on a service structure. He was on the Board of Trustees (WSB) and it galled him that we had no structure. He consulted not only the AA service structure but also the Magna Carta and other documents and wrote a simple structure that won the support of the Board of Trustees in 1975. This manual was called the NA Tree. So in 1976, the 1st World Service Conference (WSC) was held (what city?) with little done due to the youth of the Fellowship at the time. There were around 200 meetings in the world. Over a two year period between 1973 and 1975, he wrote the seminal service structure that began it all for expansion of the NA dream into a positive reality. The structure called for meetings of group representatives at area meetings. Also, area reps would go to a regional committee which in its turn would send representatives to a world service conference. The world service office would provide primary services all years long under the direction of the Board of Trustees. The NA Tree is included in its entirety in the appendix of this book.

Vigorous efforts in Lexington and other cities cannot be denied. It may not have been time for NA back then. The total fear and negative characterization of addicts shifted a great deal in the 1960's and 1970's. While some say Daniel Carlson had the idea that some famous person would get clean in NA and herald in a new period of growth and recognition, that never happened. There has to have been some commitment and service for NA to even exist back then. The idea of addicts sharing and caring for one another along with surrender, faith and inventory has to have been potent weapons for recovery. We have no writings from back then, so let's wait until some show up and avoid the errors of speculation. The spiritual factor seems to be as long as addicts gather for purposes of recovery, recovery takes place. The act of coming together with recovery in mind seems to generate the elements needed out of thin air, if necessary. For that day, and any other days the actions are repeated, the recovery will likely take place. This we know from our own experience. Recovery since 1970 is pretty well known with several living witnesses. [get exerpts from the Key to present samples of the language and feeling of recovery coming out of Lexington in Kentucky, Angola in Louisiana and possibly another Federal facility in Texas. -]

In July of 1953, Jimmy Kinnon along with others got together in Los Angeles to form a self-help group for addicts. The original name proposed by the group was AA/NA. Jimmy noted that AA would not let them use their name. The AA General Service Office in New York was contacted to get permission to use the name. Permission was denied and the group became Narcotics Anonymous. They also very generously encouraged us to adapt the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions to our needs. Jimmy is described as showing up for meetings with only one or two addicts present for long periods of time. While one or both could be nodding out from their fix, he kept coming back. Through the fifties, sixties and especially the seventies, he was constantly involved in some way.

Tradition Wars: a pathway to peace
Fellowship Work in Progress - Not for Use in Meetings

In the 1970's, a office was established with the general support of the Parent Service Board, the fore runner of the NA World Service Board of Trustees (WSB). We had no written service structure but we had the building blocks. We have tapes of the 20th and 21st Anniversary of NA with Jimmy Kinnon speaking. He is vibrant and forceful in his spirit and delivery and no other man or woman speaks with his authority and commitment to NA.

His kitchen table was the site of many, many late night discussions and brain storming sessions. The Office became the NA World Service Office (WSO).

The NA World Convention also started in 1971 and during the time it was an annual event, you could tell the Convention by the year.

In 1977 another attempt was made during the WCNA in San Francisco. Only one RSR showed up, the one from Southern California. The RSR from the only other existing region in Northern California couldn't come and again little was accomplished. By 1978, Greg was Chairman of the Board of Trustees and he went into the WSC with a list of enabling motions that transformed the WSC from an idea in the NA Tree to a reality. Members from Northern and Southern California were there along with members from Georgia [list other states here]. Excitement built as more and more members picked up on the air of joy and freedom permeated the small, growing Fellowship.

The World Convention had moved from San Francisco in 1977 to Houston, Texas in 1978. Three hundred addicts showed up, about a hundred from California. Californian members made a stupendous effort to carry the message to members from the Mid-West and the East Coast. East Coast included the deep South. While the community in Houston worked heroically to put on the convention, growth was slow in Texas, but a solid Fellowship took root and many of the same members are clean today!

In 1979, a large group of fifty or so members showed up from around the country for the WSC in Southern California. These members represented, usually by state, the new areas where NA was growing. They were full of questions, ideas and energy to help.

The 1979 World Convention was held in Atlanta, Georgia. Members came from Tennessee, Ohio, Florida, the Carolinas, Alabama, Louisiana, Kentucky, Pennsylvania - just everywhere! Bo S. and Pat L. were co-chairs of the Convention Committee. Bo called out West asking for guidelines and help with the job of chairing NA's biggest convention. There was none to be had from WSO, the WSB or the past conventions in Houston 1978 and San Francisco in 1977. So, flyers were printed, arrangements made with the Sheraton Biltmore on West Peachtree and the convention attracted members from all over the Eastern states with a over a hundred from the West Coast. It was becoming evident that ingenuity and tact were required to do NA service because there simply were no resources to guide our people. "Keep it Simple - Make it Fun" was a slogan on many NA Flyers along with "No Addict Turned Away." Being a young Fellowship, everyone knew one another, usually from the beginning of their recovery. It made us close and we had the bonds of our pain and desire for recovery. The learning experiences getting clean and learning the NA way of life gave us an unusual degree of unity.

Chapter Three

The Book

Every addict who came to NA prior to 1982 dreamed of a book for Narcotics Anonymous. Although our beginnings went well back into the forties, we were a long time learning the lesson of commitment. Jealousy, inter-personal rivalry and fear of setting oneself above his fellows undercut and prolonged our struggle for freedom. Growing up in the long shadow of Alcoholics Anonymous, there were plenty of members who quickly started in with the "who do you think you are, Bill Wilson?" jokes to warn off any who thought to take the dangerous road of commitment to NA recovery writing. Therefore, we had to wait until the late 1970's for a situation to occur where all members and service elements combined in their desire for a book for NA. Upon this stage several members approached with caution.

World services was honestly baffled by the lack of writing by NA members. The saying, "Addicts in recovery cannot write." became the euphemism for this confusion. Nobody questioned the saying, well, almost nobody. Everyone repeated it throughout the NA world. And so, blind leading the blind, nobody wrote anything, just like they were told. The advent of having a World Service Conference allowed members concerned about literature for our Fellowship to come together in a non-confrontational, supportive environment where members were praised for their efforts and encouraged to do more. A series of literature conferences were held beginning with Wichita, Kansas in the fall of 1979, Lincoln, Nebraska in 1980, Memphis, Tennessee in the winter of 1981, Santa Monica, California in the spring of 1981, Niles, Ohio in the summer of 1981, Miami in the fall of 1981 and Philadelphia in the winter of 1982. A special Regional Service Conference held in Memphis, Tennessee mailed out the Basic Text material to all the known groups in the world and it was approved by the Fellowship at WSC 1982.

World Service Office became a hub of activity in trying to get the newly approved book typeset and printed. A plan to sell the first 2500 copies in a numbered special edition for $25 each allowed the Fellowship to launch the self-publication of our book by the World Service Office. There were seeds of destruction set in this because the World Service Office quickly came to see itself as a publisher, not a primary service center. This is a major departure from our written, approved service structure at the time and members were very slow to pick up on the exact nature of the conflicts which followed. WSO was never meant to be a seat of power. As our Traditions clearly state, God as you understand him is our Ultimate Authority and our our service boards and committees are DIRECTLY responsible to the Fellowship. This is very different from interactive boards and committees responsible mainly to each other. This layering can allow attention and priority to drift into preserving and expanding bureaucratic elements at the expense of the surrendered and trusting Fellowship. With the new payrolls at WSO, the potential for conflict of interest became greater. By careful shifts in the service structure, the control center of the Fellowship could be gently moved to the corporation that ran WSO. The WSC could be maintained to co-sign corporate decisions.

The purpose of raising all this money was to be self-supporting and not farming out to meet our publishing needs. It was also understood that once the book was well established, the price would be rolled back to $4 or $5 to make it more affordable to all members. The idea of creating a wide margin between the cost and selling price to fund world services was not considered by the Fellowship.

Another 5,000 books were printed to be sold at $8.00 a copy. This all brought in over $100,000 and our book quickly became universally available. Trouble cropped up from a few trusted servants and one new employee falling into a trap that they only partially understood. Concern over a few lines in the book as approved by the Fellowship were challenged by Jimmy K., who had long been our primary trusted servant. While the lines were consistent with our spoken recovery, they were thought to be problematic in possible outcomes. Changing them became a much greater and actual problem than any projections would have predicted.

The Fellowship had placed its ego and personal preferences on hold in favor of our primary group purpose and to have a few individuals take it on themselves to change anything triggered widespread anger and confusion. It is possible that the members who were involved with this were never completely aware of the exact nature of the

outrage and upset over the book changes. Chuck Skinner, BOT Chair who signed off on the changes, said, "You'd have thought we killed somebody." If they had voiced their concerns in any way prior to the approval, consideration and allowance of change could have been completely smooth and uneventful. Since all the material involved Chapter Six on our Twelve Traditions and was written by Greg Pierce, long time member of the Board of Trustee, the material was not considered controversial or problematic. Further, since the entire World Service Board of Trustees had the material for about six months prior to approval, and three more literature conferences had been held, it violated the Fellowships sense of fairplay for these last minute concerns to justify changes without group conscience. Some members from that time looked at it like a dog marks its territory with its scent.

Two key points were involved with the changes. The first is that the miracle of NA depends on daily decisions and moments of contact between two or more addicts who decide to not use for one more day. The simple phrase, "all else is not NA" had long been established to affirm this point and particularly to define that recovery is not a result of coercion from any force outside the individuals themselves. To delete this went against the very statement best affirming recovery is an individual working the 1st Step on a daily basis. The second involved members setting themselves in positions of arbitrary power over other members. Since recovery is a matter of individual volition, the notion that some can 'control' the many is sort of ridiculous. And to allow it at the onset of the publication of our Basic Text is very telling about why it took us so long to have a book. Power really does reside in a spiritual force greater than us all, and people who thought this way wrote the book. No changes had been made to the original document as Greg wrote it either by the Board of Trustees or the World Lit Committee. To set themselves in opposition to a line like "service boards and committees do not have the power to rule, censor, dictate or decide" was a slap in the face of the Fellowship and a poor representation of the vast majority of surrendered trusted servants seeking only to serve, not to rule. Together, there couldn't have been a worst choice of two key principles to change.

So, we have two things here: the fact of any changes at all was one and the content of the changes the other. These changes set in place antagonism and distrust between the service structure, particularly the WSO, and the Fellowship.

Early attempts were made to write some recovery material for NA. Greg Pierce and Bob B. speak of boxes kept in automobile trunks with input in them. The material never surfaced during the entire writing of the Basic Text. What seemed to concern members most was that they would be ridiculed for trying to write recovery material by the many AA members cruising through all the NA meetings. Some smoked marijuana and sold it to NA members. Their belief that AA and only AA would work stifled NA growth. In any debate, AA was taken seriously and NA was considered dishonorable and almost like a pretender to real recovery. It was gauling to those member who felt devoted to NA. There grew a determination to go to just NA meetings and doing the things required for recovery in terms of the new, young Fellowship.

One way to look at it is to think of the 12 Steps of Alcoholics Anonymous as a recipe for a cake. AA baked their cake long ago, establishing a system of devoted members that endures and renews itself as time goes by. We are doing the same thing in Narcotics Anonymous. We gratefully accepted the recipe and baked our own cake. We even put in some ingedients that may not be the same in AA. After all, we are not only dealing with many different drugs of choice, we have a deck stacked against us when we start recovery. Old friends, even families, will try to put us back into the place where we seem to belong - loaded. Breaking our of this mold means some real changes have to take place. There is a terrific load of brainwashing and media advertisement and entertainment that make it seem taking something would make our day go better, or get us the girl or guy! Baking our own cake, we began to stand on our own feet and stand for something good.

WSO Timeline of Important Dates and Events

January 1972 the first GENERAL SERVICE OFFICE of N.A. was opened at 2335 Crenshaw Blvd in L.A. with Jimmy K. as office manager. The Service office relocated to Highland Ave. in Hollywood.

Later, the name was changed to The World Service Office of Narcotics Anonymous.

November 1974: Following moves to 1346 Highland Ave., Los Angeles; a room in the Suicide Prevention Center, Los Angeles. The General Service Office was opened at 101 Santa Fe St. in L.A. This was much like a regional office of today. November 15, 1975: Following the move to Sun Valley, it was discovered that several boxes of records and other historical data had been lost. 1976: WSO moves to above a bail bond office on Van Nuys Blvd. and then to JK`s home. 1976 WSO incorporated.

The Wyandotte St. Address would be after it was in Jimmy K's home.

It is interesting to note that several addresses appear in printed materials for the WSO.
In the case of the IP, Who, What, How and Why...
1st printing had Why are we here, and po box 622, Sun Valley Address.
2nd printing had why are we here replaced with 12 traditions. Still had Sun Valley Address.
3rd printing had 12 traditions, 16155 Wyandotte St. Address.
4th printing had 12 traditions, po box 9999 Van Nuys, Address.
In 1986, the First printing of this run had the section entitled Why are We Here back in.

The people who wrote the Basic Text experienced something that had never happened before. They met NA's who set high standards for themselves, met and exceeded those standards. It became socially acceptable to keep your service commitment in NA. We began to expand and develop for the first time the problems that come with being a really large organization. Sometimes persons not accustomed to being taken seriously were quoted making offhand statements and inaccurate rumors were generated. We had to learn to pace ourselves. Communications over such a broad range of newly formed meetings was difficult at best, impossible at worst. Policy issues were presented and voted on before the Fellowship understood the ramifications. Changes in our Service Structure from year to year became a confusing, changeable series of rules, utilized when perceived useful, circumvented when bothersome or inconvenient. These people got a real education in NA Steps, Traditions and policies. Policy means the plan of action agreed to by an organization or group. Policies set in place carefully can give members a sure way to go if they are well made and adhered to consistently. They started first hundreds, then thousands of meetings.

Before the Basic Text little meetings would spring up in towns and cities all across America. They would perhaps survive and start other meetings for a year or two. Relapse of key members would usually throw the other members into confusion and NA would die out for a time. Then the cycle would repeat itself. With the Basic Text the same thing happened except the other members who did not get loaded just continued to meet and start new meetings. Often the original members would be able to make it back into recovery because now they had a circle of recovering addicts to support them.

From the beginning all sorts of addicts were included in the recovery meetings and it followed that all members were welcome in the effort for the Basic Text. Young and old, rich and poor, educated and drop-outs were all welcome.

The World Lit Committee was actually the WSC Sub-Committee for Literature. It was also called the Lit Committee or World Lit. Affectionate abbreviations were common because so many people were involved with the Committee. The first active Lit Committee of the WSC was in 1978. Many of the active committee members were revisionists to the existing literature and turned in a lengthy re-write of the Alcoholics Anonymous Basic Text with drugs substituted for alcohol. Of course, we looked at alcohol as just another drug, a molecule or two away from ether, the kind they use in hospitals to knock people out. Still, it was hard work and their intentions were good.

The second year for World Lit was 1979. The Committee asked the WSC to set a site for it to hold a Conference in the fall of the year. The idea was that if the WSC set the site, they would also attend the Conference. The WSC chose Wichita, Kansas where the Leer Jet Company had it main offices. It was in the middle of the continent and it would be as easy to attend from the West Coast as the East Coast. It was held in a community center in a shopping center

and about twenty-five members attended. They worked up ideas for a handbook to guide the Committee's efforts. By the next WSC, a thousand little Handbooks for NA Literature Committee's was presented and approved.

The next year for World Lit was 1980. A second Conference was planned in the mid-west, this time in Lincoln, Nebraska, 200 miles north from Wichita, the site of the next NA World Convention. This time, two members of the Board of Trustee, Bob B. and Greg P. were on hand and Greg's notion to expand the Little White Booklet into a topic outline was adopted. Members were urged to pray for their Higher Power to remove their self-will and ego sufficiently to allow them to do the work. With this suspension of normal limitations, people's abilities came out in all sorts of useful ways. The pace quickened and a tremendous amount of work was done in a few days. 800 pages of input was copied, clipped into key ideas and pasted onto typewriter paper with space in between for connective sentences to be hand written into the spaces. Typists helped flow the material into coherent sentences and readings began the arduous task of working the ideas into a flowing form eventually tagged 'we form.'

Since the WSC was in the Spring and there was no Conference planned during the winter, some of the WLC members began to talk about doing another Conference in January or February to take the material further, while the people were hot on the trial of the Basic Text. One member from Memphis, Tennessee, Joseph P. was so flamboyant and persuasive that Memphis was chosen and plans were made.

The Memphis Literature Conference was a nine day Lit Conference beginning on a weekend, running the following week and then going through the second weekend. Like the experience in Lincoln, the Committee really started to roll after the first day or two. Tuesday things began to happen. We had an unused college dorm on Memphis State University. We had a cafeteria located next to us in the same building, and rooms upstairs. It was very comfortable. We had a bank of IBM Selectric typewriters and two heavy duty photocopiers. A black board at the end of the room had a chalk drawing of a work plan and the whole board was completed by the second weekend. Over a hundred members showed up and worked around twenty hours a day. Do your math and you will realize the NA members put in over 15,000 hours that week, working on their book. The shock waves of jubilation went out all over the NA world.

The Fellowship was astonished and full of gratitude and joy. We could not forsee that the people in California and at the World level especially, would view our progress with concern and alarm because they basically did not know or trust us fully. Their idea was to take the work to 'professionals' to have it cleaned up.

The following is taken from the Grey Form, so-called for its grey covered, GBC bound, review form sent out in Spring 1981:

FORWARD

(from the Grey Review Form of the Basic Text)

"The full fruit of a labor of love lives in the harvest, and that always comes in its right season..."

The material for this book was drawn from the personal experiences of recovering addicts within the Fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous. The text is based on an outline derived from the pamphlet (our "white book"), "Narcotics Anonymous." The first eight chapters are based on the topic headings in the it white book" and carry the same title. We have included a ninth chapter, 'Just for Today,' and a tenth chapter, 'More Will Be Revealed.' The remainder of the text was comprised of personal stories and appendices.

Following is a brief history of the book:

Narcotics Anonymous was formed in July 1953 with the first meeting held in Southern California. The Fellowship grew erratically, but quickly spread to various parts of the United States. From the beginning while membership was still very small and the need was seen for a "book on recovery" to help strengthen the Fellowship. The pamphlet, "Narcotics Anonymous," was published in 1962.

However, the Fellowship still had little structure and the 1960's were a period of struggle. Membership grew rapidly for a time, and then began to decline. The need for more specific direction was readily apparent. N.A. demonstrated its maturity in 1972 when a World Service Office was opened in Los Angeles. The W.S.O. has brought the needed unity and sense of purpose to the Fellowship.

The opening of W.S.O. brought stability to the growth of the Fellowship. Today, there are many thousand recovering addicts in hundreds of meetings all across the United States and in many foreign countries. Today, the World Service office truly serves a worldwide Fellowship.

Narcotics Anonymous has long recognized the need for a complete text on addiction - a book about addicts, by addicts and for addicts, which would serve us much like the A.A. "Big Book" has served that Fellowship.

This effort was strengthened shortly after the formation of W.S.O. with the publication of The N.A. Tree, a pamphlet on service work. This pamphlet the original "service manual" of the Fellowship. It has been followed by subsequent and more comprehensive volumes, and now the N.A. Service manual.

The manual outlined a service structure which included a World Service Conference. The W.S.C., in turn, included a Literature committee . With the encouragement of W.S.O., several members of the Board of Trustees and the Conference, work began. As the cry for literature, particularly a comprehensive text, became more widespread, the W.S.C. Literature committee developed. In October, 1979, the first, World Literature Conference was held at Wichita, Kansas, followed by conferences at Lincoln, Nebraska and Memphis, Tennessee.

The W.S.C. Literature Committee, working in conference and as individuals, have collected hundreds of pages of material from members and groups throughout the Fellowship. This material has been laboriously catalogued, edited, rewritten, assembled, dismembered and reassembled. Dozens of area and regional representatives working with the Committee have dedicated weeks and thousands of man-hours to produce the work here presented. But more importantly, those members have conscientiously sought to insure a "group-conscious" text.

In keeping with the spirit of anonymity, we, the Literature Committee feel it appropriate to express our special gratitude and appreciation to the Fellowship as a whole, especially the many c)f you who contributed material for inclusion in the book. We feel that this book is a synthesis of the collective Group Conscience of the entire Fellowship and that every single idea submitted is included in the work, in some form or another.

This volume is intended as a textbook for every addict seeking recovery. As addicts, we know the pain of addiction, but we also know the joy of recovery we have found in the Fellowship and on the program of Narcotics Anonymous. We believe the time has come to share our recovery in written form with all who desire what we have found.

Appropriately, this book is devoted to informing every addict: JUST FOR TODAY, YOU NEVER HAVE TO USE AGAIN.

Therefore,

"With gratitude in our cleanliness, we dedicate our N.A.book to the loving service of our Higher Power that through the development of conscious contact with God, no addict seeking recovery need die without having had a chance to find a better way of life."

We remain trusted servants.

In gratitude and loving service,

WORLD LITERATURE CONFERENCE-III

WORLD SERVICE CONFERENCE-LITERATURE COMMITTEE,

NARCOTICS ANONYMOUS At Memphis, Tennessee February 8, 1981

INTRODUCTION

(from the Grey Form)

This book is the shared common and personal experience of the Fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous. We welcome you to read this text, trusting that you will choose to share with us the new life we have found. We have by no means found a "cure" for addiction. We offer only a proven plan for daily recovery.

In N.A., we follow a program adapted from Alcoholics Anonymous. In the last forty-five years, more than one million people have recovered in A.A., most of them just as hopelessly addicted to alcohol as we were to drugs. We are grateful to the A.A. fellowship for showing us the way to a new life.

The Twelve Steps of Narcotics Anonymous, as adapted from A.A., are the basis of our recovery program. We have only broadened the perspective of addiction. We follow the same path with a single exception; our identification as addicts is all-inclusive in respect to any mood-changing, mind- altering substance. "Alcoholism" did not cover the total spectrum as comprehensively as does addiction. We believe that we have been guided by a Greater Consciousness as a Fellowship, and are grateful for the Direction that has enabled us to build upon an already-proven program of recovery.

We have come to Narcotics Anonymous by various means and believe that as our common denominator is that we failed to come to terms with our addictions, however varied. Because of the degree and variety of addictions found within our Fellowship, we have approached the solution contained within this book in general terms. We pray that we have been searching and thorough, so that every addict who reads this volume will find the hope we have found.

Based on our collective experience, we believe that every addict, including the "potential" addict, suffers from an incur- able disease of body, mind and spirit. We were in the grip of a hopeless dilemma. The solution of which is spiritual in nature. Therefore, this book will deal in great part with spiritual matters.

We are not a religious organization. our program is a set of spiritual principles through which we are recovering from a seemingly hopeless state of mind and body. Throughout the compiling of this work, the prevailing theme has been the conscious prayer and meditation:

"GOD, grant us knowledge that we may write according to Your Divine precepts; instill in us a sense of Your purpose, make us servants of Your will and grant us a bond of selflessness that this may truly be Your work, not ours, in order that no addict, anywhere, need die from the horrors of addiction."

Everything that occurs in. the course of N.A. service must be motivated by the desire to more successfully carry the message of recovery to the addict who still suffers. It was for this reason that we began this work. We must always remember that as individual members, groups, and service committees, we are not, and should never be, in competition with each other. We work separately and together to help the newcomer and for our common good. We have learned, painfully, that internal strife cripples our Fellowship; it prevents us from providing the services necessary for growth.

It is our hope that this book will help the suffering addict find the solution we have found. our purpose is to remain clean, just for today, and to carry the message of recovery..

Thank you,

WORLD LITERATURE CONFERENCE III

WORLD SERVICE CONFERENCE - LITERATURE COMMITTEE, NARCOTICS ANONYMOUS

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One story from old California recovery is where two old-timers drove two hundred miles each way on Friday night for two years. They finally found someone to take the H&I commitment and they failed to show up the first Friday they were supposed. The H&I meeting at that institution was cancelled. This is what Californians were conditioned to expect from newcomers. When the members working on the Basic Text came out with material like the extract above, the Californians went into shock. It was far, far easier to believe the members working on the Basic Text were flawed newcomers, lucky in writing but yet to experience the 'big let down' of the reality of NA recovery they had found. It looked so different to us, it took years to puzzle together.

The Memphis Grey Form succeeded in waking up the Fellowship to the reality how much a book can help a spiritual fellowship unify and effectively carry its message. Many members got clean and many meetings were started by the members who wrote the Basic Text. It is estimated that over 1200 members participated directly in the writing, with many more reading, discussing and participating in the approval of the book over a period of years.

When the Book came out in 1983, the cash flow at WSO rose to unprecedented levels. 2500 numbered copies were sold for $25 each to raise money within NA to publish our newly written and approved Basic Text. With a book to sell and all the other items carried by WSO such as booklets and pamphlets, the Office flourished. Bob Stone, who had served as parliamentarian for our World Service Conference (WSC) for several years, was hired to manage the WSO. Care was taken to inform Jimmy K in a thoughtful and timely manner by a close and trusted friend. Instead of telling Jimmy, the friend thought he would take it badly. So, Jimmy came to help out as manager of WSO one day and found the door locked. Unfortunately, it seemed to Jimmy that he was being fired rather than relieved of a burdensome responsibility, ill befitting an older gentleman with health problems. This was the beginning of controversy between NA members and the WSO staff. Word went out that Jimmy had been locked out of the Office. That the new manager, appalled by the number of keys floating around, had the locks changed and Jimmy had not yet been by to pick up his key. Indeed, he did not know that Bob Stone had been installed as WSO manager. All this made for difficulty and there are still those who feel Jimmy was somehow wronged, even though all NA member acknowledge his years of service and the crucial roles he was fortunate to play at different points in our history from the inception of NA in California, the growth through the years, the telephone at Jimmy's house and the WSO located all during the 1970's at Jimmy home. Perhaps the negative side of addicts took these simple elements and created the myth of Jimmy getting fired by an ungrateful Fellowship. Of course, Jimmy still came by the WSC every year to autograph books. Jimmy Kinnon was one of the first tragedies of the Traditions Wars.

The vote was a central theme in the new service structure because in a very real sense, the Fellowship controlled World Services. After all, the Fellowship, not the WSO or any other service organization had just written the NA Basic Text, *Narcotics Anonymous*. Members did not have to be told this, they knew from their own recent experience. They had been included in the process and even those who had not been able to attend a single World Lit Conference felt they were involved and played an important part in the process of writing and approving the Basic Text. The legalities of a corporation follow a logic of their own. Basically, a corporation has to stand on its own to the extent that it can make decisions and commitments irregardless of all other individuals and corporations. That's what you want with a corporation. A distinct legal entity that is accountable, definable and responsible on its own. Any other way, the corporation would be a subsidiary of another corporate entity - one that was a stand alone entity. Because of this legality, as soon as the Office was formed, the notion that it could sue a member was brought up. It was presented and believed that the WSO, not the Fellowship, owned and controlled the Basic Text as well as all other intellectual properties, literature and so forth. This was certain to breed problems and animosity began almost right away.

Chapter Four

Money, Property and Prestige

Rage, jealousy, territoriality reside in the back portion of the human brain, the medula oblongata. Crocodiles and alligators have well developed medula oblongata. Sensitivity and spirituality involve more advanced portions of the brain and rise above our basic animal instincts. Something snaps occasionally in our members an irrational side seems to take over without notice. It is similar to a lynch mob that gets going over some tragic event like a rape or a murder of a child and becomes obsessed with finding someone who will fill the opening at the end of their rope. It is not for naught that our Traditions warn us to avoid money, property and prestige. These three relate to greed, lust and pride and we are sick in the areas of sex, security and society. We will most of us sell out for more money than we can use, more power than we can handle and the advantage over our Fellows. Many spiritual paths warn against getting involved with upsetting worldly concerns when we are seeking spiritual growth. There is a natural conflict between things of the world and things of the spirit. It is not perhaps a matter of good and bad, it may only be the difference between the way we need air to breathe or food to eat and our need for peace in our hearts and clarity in our thinking.

There are three planes of existence that need to have our attention to understand these things: the physical, the mental and the spiritual. Physical recovery is not using. Mental recovery is not allowing diseased habits and attitudes to control our lives. Spiritual recovery is the freedom to grow and aspire to greater things. In early recovery, we learn the mind can produce pain if it will get drugs in return. So, we learn to tolerate a degree of pain to maintain our recovery, if necessary. So also, we learn there can be unaccountable conflicts between the mental and the spiritual. The mental judges all by its own standards and declares illegal and off limits anything not covered in those standards. The spiritual knows no boundaries and is beyond the limitations of both the physical universe and the limitations of individual cognition. Conflicts are bound to occur and should not necessarily be regarded as accidents. The world of the spirit is veiled in ways that divert and deflect those unprepared for the awesome and wonder vistas of spiritual perception. In particular, those who have not yet achieved comfort in being surrendered experience pain and anxiety when confronted by spiritual reality. They retreat into their ignorance and may become dangerous if pressed too deeply into a psychological corner. All roads lead to betterment and increase in health, it is only our disease that holds us back. As with all things, the spiritual path is to wait and let things unfold agreeably rather than force and beat into submission those flowers not yet ready to bloom. The illusions of money, property and prestige allow people to attempt to substitute these things for contact with a higher power. Those who understand this will back off and allow those who do not to grow. It does not need to be a mystery or a subject of fear and superstition. That only gives power to the disease and we have enough of that.

As the WSO grew from a handful of employees in the 1970's to over forty in the early 1908's. When the cash flow broke the million dollar mark in 1984 pr 19985, the questions became, "Who's book is it any way?" Naturally, the people who get it printed, type set and distribute the book assume it is their charge, and by extension, their property. Well, that's not the way the law reads. WSO did not pay anyone for writing the Basic Text. They didn't even pay expenses. The WSC gave some reimbursement after several hundreds of dollars of printing and postage had been paid out over a year's time out of a members pocket, insisting on seeing the receipts first. We felt the thrill of getting the book done in 1982 and then the absurdity of being accused of making typographical errors in the hardback copies WSO had typeset and printed. As if t they would copy our exact wording and spelling, even including errors person , spelling and tense. Fortunately our background included enough adversity and unfairness to not let this rough treatment upset our spiritual equilibrium. After all, the WSO was made up of business types and clerks. They couldn't be expected to appreciate the miracle at hand. Antipathy between office staff, paid workers, and the Fellowship volunteers, unpaid trusted servants began. Since they were never brought together on any occasion, the gulf grew deep and wide.

The changes growing out of these differences showed up in quietly removing the office of WSC secretary from the World Service Conference. Since WSO did most of the printing and mailing, everyone was for letting the WSO do

that. Then the Treasurer of the WSC seemed redundant and so the WSO did that too. Then the Secretary of the World Service Board was dropped in favor of letting the WSO do that job. Also, the Board didn't need a Treasurer. After a few years, it was obvious the WSO could really do everything and why not? They were at the center of the NA world and knew better than anyone what was going on and best for the Fellowship. By seeing their distribution of minutes and reports as an expensive and largely unnecessary task, they began to style the material in a petulant and unfriendly manner. By the late 1980's it was becoming hard to read the Conference reports, minutes and get anything sensible out of them. They still exist and samples will be included in this material. A former member of the WS Board of Trustees shares, "I recall reading one report in the early 1990's that took two pages and stated that the Committee met and considered three options and dropped one because it was just like the second option and discounted the third option as unworkable. What stood out to me was there were no nouns. The report never even hinted what options had been considered, how the first and second were similar or identical and what the third one was and how it was not a practical consideration. Even the first option was never described even in the most general terms. It was what college students are taught to label 'gobbledygook.' Members stopped reading and responding to the obscure and unfriendly reports that even college level students found dense and hard to read."

The riff deepened with the strains showing up in motions affecting the Temporary Working Guide to our Service Structure. The acronym TWGSS, pronounced 'twigs', was used to refer to the Temporary Guide. Some members thought it through and said, "The NA Tree has been reduced to Twigs."

Surely, it is fair to say that some of the 'powerful' personalities wound up working at WSO. They stressed professional credentials and worked hard to get and hold their positions. This business of 'seeking a job' at WSO was not regarded as the most spiritual way to serve NA by the Representatives sent in from the Fellowship. The unspoken objection was 'conflict of interest' that would place the spiritual objectives of the NA Fellowship at odds with the balance sheet of WSO. The Office stance was finally best defined by the notion that it took about eighteen months to get something brought up at a WSC through a Conference Agenda Report (CAR), addressed at the Conference, sent out for a year's group conscience and take a vote at the following WSC. No more brief way to take a group conscience back to groups for a vote was ever mentioned that I recall. Surely there was a way.

The members stance was hindered by several things. First off, most Representatives had never been to Southern California, Hollywood, Disneyland or any of the other sights to see out there. They were often a bit awed and over whelmed. They wanted to be liked. Second, the demands were great and the training was brief. Much depended on luck and having key individuals present to look out for Fellowship interests. The notion that the Fellowship had to be protected from encroachment by its own WSO was not pleasant and it was hard to shift gears. Kind of like having a pet baby tiger that is outgrowing its play pen. You don't want to shoot it but it can get tense.

Chapter Five

The Growth through Our Book

"There is nothing stronger than the heart of a volunteer."

As they worked on writing the Basic Text, NA members from all over the country became ever more informed about NA recovery, Steps and Traditions. Indeed, they became the most informed members in our history. Even members who were unable to attend one of the seven Literature Conferences became informed. The reading and discussions allowed members to share, ask questions, correct mis-impressions and get our NA message straight out of a book. There were other results that stemmed from their involvement in the writing of the Basic Text. They stayed clean. And they became super-informed members who knew first hand almost anything a person could know about their Fellowship. This information empowered them to go forth and carry our message to the world. Meetings started and recovery took root in places all over the United States, Europe and even faraway India, where the heroin traffic resulting from the Afgan War was wreaking havoc where drugs had been mostly a religious observance and not a health problem. Heroin addicts sprouted up everywhere and NA was quick to follow. There were NA meetings in Russia, Japan and Australia. As a direct result of the members writing the basic message of recovery down on paper in a form that most members could agree on, NA became a world-wide fellowship.

Following our Twelve Traditions and our general impulse to include rather than exclude, we developed our service structure using a volunteer system that endures to this day. No one was trained, well almost no one. And the services were heroic. A fledling Public Information committee in South Florida pasted up thousands of stickers saying "Drug Problem? – Call NA at this phone number." They did this on a Friday night and Monday morning the telephone company called them and told them they were having a problem with the stickers, not the drugs, and would we please remove them from many of the twenty-five thousand pay phones all over Dade County! Members in Cleveland, Ohio put up billboards. Flyers went up in clinics and laundromats. These service volunteers have never been properly applauded for their heroic efforts which continue to this day.

As the business operations in California continued to grow, they forgot that the membership wrote the book. As days went by, more and more memory was being lost. New employees were concerned with day to day activities and when they heard about this happening or a persons name, it was from a co-worker or their boss. A Corporate mind set began to set in and replace the intuitive, loving, caring spirit of service. As weeks became months and months passed into years, the Fellowship continued to grow and know about its history and what had taken place – there were numerous witnesses and participants who loved to talk. There were writings. But over time, there was one view coming out of the Office and another out in the Fellowship.

This corporate mind set grew as the WSO spread its influence into the burgeoning Fellowship. There is an inevitable air of being 'in the know' when you're involved with a primary service center. Unfortunately, our primary service center was being revamped into our primary business office. WSO began to style itself as a publishing company and expenditures directed towards the creation of new books and publications we justified by the return potential rather than the good they did for people. Try not to allow your mind to slip into the 'good and bad' mode. These things were bound to happen and would have happened in one form or another under any conceivable administration. Call it growth changes or learning curve if that helps you understand. We are not blame assessors. At best we describe what happened so you - the members - can be better informed and make better choices relating to our future as a spiritual Fellowship and enjoy more peace of mind as you go about your recovery and service.

As the Fellowship grew in hundreds of thousands of new members, naturally WSO grew more and more perplexed about our policies and nervous about eventualities like the members voting to do things that would limit or damage WSO's ability to function. We all know what one crazy addict can do, how about two hundred and fifty thousand voting members with less than a year clean? Who knows what "if... then..." propositions flourished among WSO personnel during these years. I imagine that if you were part of that group and came up with one more terrible senario, it got repeated and encouraged others to think of something even more hideous and implausible. There was a

line altered during the WSO's edit of the Basic Text. The original said, "The mind will of course wander." This is taken form old spiritual writings and alludes to the simple task of learning to drag the mind back to the place you have chosen for it. It was altered to read, "The mind will wander off course." Does this constitute an improvement to your mind? I heard that whoever came up with the alteration was praised and that the brilliant edit was whispered up and down the halls of WSO the rest of that day. So much for blaming the 4th Edition debacle on the Literature Committee.

Some thoughts on the

History of the Purist Movement

in NA by a founding member.

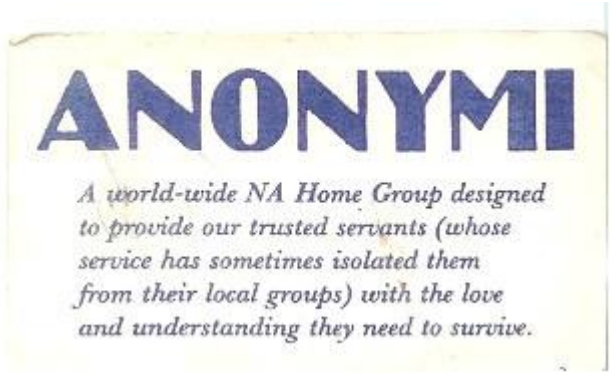
The Purist Movement official got it's name from a small news letter written by a guy named Jimmy D from New Jersey. He took the logo from my t-shirt, which was a bid shirt for WCNA 15 for Virginia.. "BRING THE WORLD TO THE BEACH!", we lost to DC of course, who's slogan was about unifying the divide between inner city blacks and the suburban whites. The t-shirt was black with a bright blue outline of the globe.

But the story starts long before that. In the early days of the Literature movement to write a book by addicts for addicts, there was a member named Jim M from Ohio who showed up at one of the first Lit conferences. Jim was a very intelligent guy and one of the first things he noticed was that hardly a single person attending identified themselves the same way. Hi my names Sue and I'm a dope fiend, my name's Bob and I'm a drunk and a junky, my name's Bill and I'm a drug addict.. and so on. Jim was the guy who questioned folks about getting the words right. Meaning, that we needed to come up with a language that fit all addicts no matter what their drug of choice might be. This is probably were the original seeds of the purist movement were first formulated and they didn't even know that was what they were doing. It just made sense that using the term clean, would cover any substance, where sober only spoke of alcohol, or that calling ourselves addicts would strengthen our unity, rather than dividing us by our drugs, which we were no longer doing... ie: drunk and junky, boozer and user, slimy dope fiend. The term addict fit everyone equally weather your drug of choice was alcohol or heroin, or marijuana. It also leveled the playing field with no group of users being any better or worse than another.

The members of these literature conferences were becoming enlightened as to this new vision and another one that was talked about outside the working sessions. That one was about only attending NA for your recovery. Back then and even into the early 1980's, that was a very foreign idea. We had all gotten clean in AA meetings and had started a small handful of meeting in our areas or towns. Hardly enough to recover in, but a place were we could go once a week or so and feel free to talk about our drug usage. Our foundation and our recovery was in AA and we felt safe in their years of experience. NA was that other meeting that we could go to once a week and talk about drugs. Recovery in NA was just a dream for most of us. Yea, man, that would be cool to have NA every night.. some day.. .

Something that the key players in the Lit movement understood was that you had to bet your life on NA or no one else would! They began to become adament about this stand and would leave these Lit conferences and NA conventions where they met up with each other to get pumped up.. then would go back to their small NA communities and with excitement they had gained by being around other like minded folks, would push the new message of one disease and one program to all the poor unsuspecting drunks and junkies back home. The results were mixed of course. One member said to my wife, well if it was so good back there in Georgia, why don't you go the hell back there! Many were intimidated and saw this new movement as a clear loss of power, as they had been ruling the roost for many years now. NA was more like counseling sessions with powerful personalities at the helm. I know, I was one just like that.

Back then, they came up with the name S.W.A.T which stood for Service Workers Attack Team! This was really the first organized, named purist group. They even made up t-shirts for you collector types. In discussions with the spiritual leader of the literature movement, Greg Pierce (deceased), several of the members he sponsored wanted to come up with a name and purpose other than SWAT. The discussion came around to a simple card and a simple name and a simple purpose. Greg said to me; "You don't wanna know what it started as.. smile!" I guess he toned it down a bit. It was called Anonymi, and it was simply a printed blue calling card that said: (I apologize, I can't find mine so I will do as best I can, and hope someone will edit it correctly) "A worldwide NA home group who's trusted servants gather to gain the love and support they need to continue carrying the message in their home groups and areas. It's primary purpose is to disband."



Think about that, an NA home group who's primary purpose it to "DISBAND". The idea was that by getting this new information and becoming enlightened to a new view of NA, you would go back home and often times be met with scorn or worse by some members. You would met up with other Anonymi members at NA conventions and re-charge your batteries to go back into the fray. I was given my card by my sponsor Joe P from Memphis, Tennessee who was one of the 4 key players in the literature movement. Greg referred to Joseph as the "Sgt Bilko" of NA. Joseph wasn't a writer per se, but he could get stuff. Joseph would show up at a lit conference with dozens of copying machines and Greg would say: "Joseph were did you get these? Wow!" And Joseph would say; "Don't ask!". Joseph was treasurer for World Lit as the Basic Text was being written and without his tireless and self less service, this project would have probably taken many years, instead of the 2 that it did take to write. We as a fellowship owe him a huge debt of gratitude. His efforts to put together the lit conference at Memphis State University and his tireless efforts to stay on the job even after the week long conference, assured us that the Grey review form of the text went out to all the addicts that they had addresses for.

The idea of an NA home group who's primary purpose was to disband, stood on the foundation that some day NA would be a strong vibrant fellowship. That most all addicts would identify themselves as that. Folks would get and stay clean in NA and have no need to go to another fellowship for support. That us isolated members who were out their fighting for these things, would not be out their but simply a part of a world wide Narcotics Anonymous clean whole fellowship. Today that dream is a reality for those of us who not so long ago could only hope and pray for... snif snif.

So the purist movement was actually made up mostly of sons and daughters of Anonymi and SWAT. With a few original members in the mix. The seeds of the movement were firmly planted at a late night rap session in Washington, DC prior to WCNA 14 Miracles Happen in Chicago Sept, 1984. It was during this year that DC had a fund raiser for their bid committee. The cool thing about NA was that all the opposing bid committees showed up to support them, Virginia, Pennsylvania etc. They were so moved by this, as their turn out from the local fellowship was a bit weak and our coming to support them made the event a success.

Tradition Wars: a pathway to peace

Fellowship Work in Progress - Not for Use in Meetings

Late night Saturday, a bunch of us Anonymi/Convention/Service friends were gathered in a room at Georgetown University were the event was being held. We jokingly began talking about the do's and don'ts of being a purist. The word had been floating around for a few months by now. It came out of an article that the guy Jim M from Ohio had written for an early NA way magazine entitled "The unfolding of the fellowship". It asked "what about those folks that only go to NA meetings for their recovery and identify themselves simply as addicts.. are these folks radicals? No they are merely purists".

In our late night talk session, we came up with 24 do's and don'ts to be a purist. Some was for fun, some we truly believed in our hearts was the right thing and the only true future for NA. We had made our stand in Narcotics Anonymous and we were fearful that it might not become what we needed it to be to recover. We could no longer feel comfortable in meetings that were filled with confusing languages of recovery and mixed messages and quotes from AA literature... of course we could, we all had for the most part gotten clean in AA, but you know how the old saying goes" "there's nothing worse than a convert!" For it's usually the converts that are the loudest and strongest on a cause. We had for the most part, all been clean and sober just a few months or years ago.

We had made our stand, we had bet our lives on NA and we were damned determined to see this work. Sadly we were a bit too determined and very forceful in our approach to NA language and the use of it in our NA meetings. We often would confront poor newcomers in the middle of the meeting, "it's clean, not sober!" Our text is basic, it's not big!.. Sober stands for short of being entirely ready! If you call your self and addict and an alcoholic, then put $2.00 in the basic as you are treating two diseases! And so on...

A friend of mine in England put it so well. He said: "We are the children of Alcoholics Anonymous. When I was a kid and I got to 16 years old, you couldn't tell me anything, I knew the right way, you were wrong.. and I was angry. As I grew up, I got married and now I am an adult with my own family and I have a much different relationship with my parents, we are more like equals." Narcotics Anonymous had to go through it's growing up phase. It had to break the apron strings to AA and stand on it's own two feet. Sadly we did it with the hostility of a teenager, rather than the maturity that we do today. Today it's so simple just to read an identity statement at the beginning of the meeting and let folks know what we do here in NA and ask them for the cooperation in this simple yet important matter. But that was then and this is now.

Jimmy D was at that meeting that night and felt inspired to go home and create. He came up with a simple purple bandana and a folded up little newsletter called the Purist News volume 1, number 1. Jimmy says he had the bandana at Chicago. I know that the Newsletter was distributed at the 6th East Coast Convention held at Towson State University, Towson, Maryland in June of 1985, just prior to the World which was being held right next door in DC in September, 1985. Jimmy gave me a copy of the Purist News and like the rest of the gang, I went home and copied it like mad! It became our manifesto. It was the first thing in written form that spelled out what it was we that had become imbedded in our heats and minds for a long time now.

I took a big stack with me to the 2nd European Service Conference in England a few months latter. The host committee had a meeting on the pamphlet that I had put out on the table with convention flyers. They asked me if I would come speak to them about it, but I declined.. I was a bit of a chicken.. brack! They voted that it was neat stuff but not appropriate on the table at the convention. They were right but I had gotten the word out, any way I could... tee hee. A few months latter, as I sat in a World International Committee meeting in California at the WSC, I was invited into a room for discussion. There was a long table of 14 World Level big shots and Bob Stone the then Manager of the World Service Office. Bob and I were on good speaking terms, having crossed paths at several events and our interactions were always pleasant and friendly. Bob started talking in a round about manner about how being at the central site of NA, he had to deal with all manner of things that come up, and then he whips out a copy of the purist news and forcefully tells me this showed up on the tables at a meeting in Denmark or Holland.. I thought to myself, cool! Bob wanted to know all about this movement and how organized it was etc... I withered under Bob's attack... man, Bob, it's just a cool pamphlet that a bunch of us made copies and passed out. I put some out at ECCNA in London and it must have made it's way to that group. Sorry. It was interesting that they needed 14 people to confront one member on this daring issue.. not! The reality was that they were trying to put a

finger on a feeling and they couldn't. For it wasn't in a piece of paper, it wasn't in a few members who were vocal.. it was an idea who's time had come and their was no way for a small handful at the center of power to stop it from happening. It's time had come, and some of us were just a few steps ahead. Not that they disagreed with what we were doing, most every trusted servant at the World Level were pure NA members by now. Okay a few old timer Californians were still going to always be clean and sober. They just differed in how it could come to pass.

They got their chance to heal this area of our fellowship and did a stellar job. George H and Lea G of Florida along with others at the center of power spear headed a movement to re-write the little white book and take out the denial an endorsements of the outside enterprise AA, which we had been reading in meetings every night. The White book used to state" We are deeply grateful to the AA fellowship for pointing the way for us to a new way of life". This is a great truth and it was moved to the front of our Basic Text but it was in-appropriate to be read in a meeting each night, along with a tradition that tells us not to endorse finance or lend the NA name to outside enterprises. The task was given to the Board of Trustees to come up with a new version and they did an excellent job. The gave us the readings we have today, and explained why each change was necessary. It was overwhelmingly approved at the conference that year. This solidified us as a one disease, one program fellowship. Thanks Guys!

The Purist movement begins to splinter. During the next few short years, the folks at NA Central started utilizing the funds that were being generated by the growing sales of literature to an ever growing NA fellowship. They traveled a lot to carry the message around the world. The group of folks I was in, which Bob Stone fondly referred to in his book as "The Vocal Minority" was becoming more and more ostracized from power in NA and more and more angered by what they saw as an inner circle of addicts with NA credit cards using fellowship funds for personal enrichment.

It's an interesting thought that we were labeled the vocal minority, when in fact we were in touch with a vast group of members across the entire fellowship. So we were hardly a minority. Our voices, loud yes, were being stiffled at the World Level by a centralization of power in the hands of a smaller and smaller few. These were the ones who had their hands on all the methods of communication to the fellowship, they seemed to answer only to themselves.. so in reality, it was more likely that they were the true vocal minority.. ya think?

It came to a head in a discussion at my kitchen table with my NA mentor, Larry North (deceased). Larry was a fisty old Irishman who brought the message of NA to me in 1982 when we were first starting our little NA meeting in the mountains of Virginia. Larry had some 9 years back then and was involved in the literature movement, the area, the region and the world. We lovingly called him the old man. He knew everything there was to know about service and the traditions, he was the king of tradition troopers. He also loved newcomers like nobody's business. He took you under his wing and showed you all the ropes and then some. Larry took me everywhere, we were like 2 peas in a pod for many, many, many years.

Larry was an accountant by trade and a damn good one. He handled accounting for large companies and could run numbers on an adding machine like nothing you have ever seen. As we sat in my kitchen one evening, Larry said; "The ultimate authority is not a loving God... the ultimate authority is the purse strings.. it's the money!" He was referring to dealing with what he saw as the abuses of World NA. We control them by the fund flow from the sales of literature. How do we do that, I asked? Simple, you see it only cost about 2.00 to make a Basic Text, and the rest of the money goes to feed the WSO. We can make a Basic Text in paperback that can be copied on a copying machine for about a buck or less. We give them away free or at very little cost. In this way we kill two birds with one stone. The first being that the Basic Text should be a lot less expensive so it can be freely given to newcomers, and the 2nd is that for everyone of those text that we give free, that is a lot less money in the hands of the World Gang! And so arose the idea for a baby blue bootleg copy of the Basic Text.

The idea was to put items back into the Basic Text that had been taken out without group conscience of the fellowship, and to distribute them at cost or free. Most importantly of these edited items was 2 sentences that had been taken out of the text before it even had come to print. Upon reviewing the material in the approval form of the

Basic Text, then manager of WSO, Jimmy Kinnon (our founder), had taken exception to 2 lines in the traditions. He believed that they were in violation/conflict with the traditions and wanted to remove them. He knew that if he sent them back to the fellowship for discussion it would be another year before our book was published. He chose a second course of action and had a group conscience of The Board of Trustees Chair, the Office Board Chair, the Conference Chair and they all agreed to allow him to take out the following lines and print the Basic Text as amended.... in the 2nd and 4th traditions.... it was written "what about our service boards, our committees, are these things NA. No, they are not NA, they are services that a group may or may not choose to utilize. And another line stated: "a service committee cannot decide, rule, dictate or censor". Well this service body decided, ruled and dictated to censor those 2 lines. Of course at the time, the literature folks were furious. The fellowship had studied every word and prayed over their decisions to vote on the book as it was. This flagrant violation of group conscience was wholly unacceptable to them. This one action created a rift in the fellowship that is still not completely healed to this day.

Some members in Miami, who more than likely took their cue from Larry North, printed up the first copies of the Baby Blue and began distributing them in large numbers. In the North, my friend Greatful Dave took the ball and ran hard and long with it as well. Copies started showing up in all manner of colors. The Georgia Peach, The Resentment Red from England, Pink, Beige and several variations of blue. There is even a site on the internet that shows all known copies. http://www.syix.com/mleahey/Babyblue/

This is were the movement starts to splinter. This is were I took my ball and went home. I had been actively working steps for a while now and had given up my need to fight. I didn't have it in my heart to do something that would damage NA as a whole, even if I disagreed in my heart with what folks were doing. I had learned that those extra dollars from the sale of NA literature do a lot more than just provide travel and lodging for World Level Trusted servants. The money goes to translate the literature into foreign languages, to help our World PI efforts, our World H and I efforts, to make NA available anywhere on the planet. I knew there was no way to take money out of one part of NA without hurting addicts in some other part of NA. Dave grabbed me outside a workshop in Memphis on the Basic Text issue and said come on, we need you in here. You got me started on this thing. I said; Dave I'm sorry I'm just not there anymore. I tried to point out to him that the very people he was antagonizing over this issue were the folks he would need to be their for him when his AIDS got worse. He told me he had been prayed over and that he hadn't felt ill since. That was the last time I saw my friend Dave.

He had decided to force the issue to court. This was his plan all along. It was a loose, loose situation for the World Service Office in that they would never come out a winner by taking a concerned NA member to court over the literature. It was actually a pretty brilliant idea. It all came to a head in a court room in Pennsylvania and a very wise Judge. The Judge first looked at them and said what are you guys doing here? I spent every day dealing with addicts that don't have the answer and you guys do! He motioned, after much back and forth, that if Dave would agree to stop printing and selling Baby Blues, that the World Service Office would put a motion into the conference agenda to have a worldwide vote of every individual NA home group as to which Basic Text they wanted. By now there had been 5 printings with the 4th edition being an editors nightmare and having lost pages due to inaccurate transcribers at WSO and not doing sufficient final proof reading. The 5th Edition apparently still hadn't corrected all the missed sections. The Office managed to stall and delay, and Grateful Dave's Aids finally progressed and he passed away. Along with him went the court case. There are those who still talk about taking up arms and getting the case re-examined. It is easy to say with forebearance that all members involved did what they did with the good of NA in their hearts. Nevertheless, we have to learn from our mistakes and one of the key problems has been conflict of interest. No one should be voting or in a position to control the outcomes of important Fellowship decisions who is on the payroll of WSO or any of its subsidiaries.

I had moved around a few times and about a year ago, I was driving back to my home in Montgomery, Alabama. We had an NA club house with meetings twice a day. All the members only went to NA and all identified themselves as addicts. I was coming down the highway from Birmingham and it dawned on me that I couldn't remember the name of that group, what was it anonysomething... that we had all belonged to back then.. oh yes, ANONYMI.

Apparently it had disbanded, as it was no longer needed.

In loving service,

Anonymi

peace

Chapter Six

History Movement Starts in Alabama

Madison History Conference

Planners: Bill B. Ed C. and others from N. A. Area were main plannners. Mainly to start Bill B. Ed C and myself. made the first three and then formed committee.

I have stated from the start and before that the transcripts should be in. Or published as a separate piece. Bo you and I can to the thought for the book on my drive home from Decatur via cell phone. I thank we talked from Florence to Little Rock and beyond.

We were later gifted with the title, but the book was born through that conversation.

I have gotten a little frustrated with the work due to the fact that I feel I feel I am repeating myself and repeating again. So I have felt discouraged. I have to work while inspired, to force it is not working.

There is confusion between Madison and Montgomery. I think some tapes were mislabeled.

Madison Was first, Bo, Joseph, Greg, Grateful, Ed were all there and panel speakers with Tully giving a great opening.

Montgomery, was Father Dan, Betty K, Bill Beck, Cindy D.

Donnie J. Was the chair and I was the Regional History Chair. Donnie had a full committee of great spirited members. My camera was not working for this one. I think I have three pics. Others have some.

This all started with my trip to see Ed C. We met in his home and talked, prayed and Then a trip to see Bill B in Decatur. Upon Bill's yeah vote we started. We went to a Convention in Ga. where we share our vision with Billy A. and others. Billy went home and put together Allen Town and held it prior to Madison. I feel and have always felt this was to upstage the event. I took one member and went to Allentown it was held at a beautiful College. It was small. Greg P and Grateful were there as well as Fawn.

I felt some pain from the upstaging but wrote it off to a start at least. Madison was held and went over great. I have, and have posted pics of the event. People were walking the floors in tears of gratitude and no one I talked to wanted it to end. Bill was the Chair and I took the co chair seat. Wanting to keep my ego out of it.

Montgomery was set at the next committee meeting and we had a ton of willing members. The Committee went to Regional Committee just before Madison Bill Served his term with much shit coming from a chosen few at the region. I took up the gauntlet. Montgomery we allowed Billy A to tape and video tape the speakers. There were interviews behind closed doors and the committee was shut out. We passed it off to anonymity and accepted it besides we would see the tapes and glean the information from them. The whole purpose anyway. We never got a copy of the video tapes. We asked repeatedly for them. TO this day we have not seen the tapes. Father Dan is now gone and Betty is much older. Who knows what golden nuggets they shared. We don't!

Now you combine all this shit, the shit from the Region or I should say one member of the Region and a couple from Florida. Bill B becoming dishearten, The letter from WSO about the Blue books. The lies from all about our intent. It makes me want to scream still. Fuck surrender people just need to grow the fuck up. Ok that is my short serenity prayer, now I feel better.

Florida has now produced a History book, the WSO now has a history display in the lobby I am told. You hardly have a convention that there is not a history workshop, and we still don't have a fourth step as a fellowship done. It is easy to rewrite history. It is easy to dress it up and make it pretty. But people died behind the shit that went down and the fellowship of NA changed forever. So lets tell the truth backed up with the documentation. That was the intent from the beginning. Not to shade for political correctness, or to save someone's feelings. Searching and fearless. Black and white.

\- Grover N. June 28, 2004

Tradition Wars: a pathway to peace
Fellowship Work in Progress - Not for Use in Meetings

I. The inception

In order to share how the committee started you need to understand the why.

When I got clean treatment centers were flooding the rooms of NA. "People did not recover in NA alone" was the message; you had to go to AA in order to have long-term recovery. Going to AA meetings I heard them defend their message. Neal H. took me to many different meetings in NA, in many different towns, and I meet many new people that were recovering in NA alone. We always made at least one H&I meeting during the week. 90 in 90 was the official creed. Early on he directed me to a member that was doing H&I in a local prison. That meeting became my regular Tuesday night meeting for 5 years. Through active service, workshops and learning days I was able to meet BO S., Greg P. Motorcycle Ed, Bill B., Tully A., Susie S. Mike, Billy R., Rick A. These people helped to shape my understanding of service. I learned that people did recover in NA and that NA had a different message. I HEARD IT. WOW!!!!!!!!! What an awakening.... I heard Larry North share at a spiritual NA gathering at Cheeha State Park in Northeastern Alabama as the 3rd paragraph of *We Do Recover* was read. A love affair was born. A love affair with this fellowship, and our message began. I wanted to share that. Members brought back the 3rd paragraph as an opening reading to our group and we began to read it at every meeting.

In area service we understood that we did not know everything, so we asked some of the people mentioned above, and others to come share in workshops about our message and how to carry that message. We are not addicted to crosses, poly's, anda's or anything else. I wondered how I would be received, if I said hello, I am Grover, and I am a welder.... We learned and grew, our area grew and so did our service committee meetings.

We heard about inclusive service, leading by example, how our book was written, and some of our pamphlets. We heard that addicts could somehow no longer write, the book was a fluke. Many other things were being done and said in that time period that threatened what we saw as a Spiritually based service structure and were in conflict with our Traditions. We took a stand. Anytime someone stands for something you will have opposition. We saw many members standing for Spiritually based service and our Traditions as a guide while others wanted to streamline the process and turn writing over to the professionals. To some of us the very thing that helped us to fell and be a part of, was sighted for dismantle and termination.

II. The Committee forms

If we are hurting what does our sponsor tell us? Write! History cannot be written from one person's point of view, or it is distorted, and perverted... Orson Wells 1984 gave us an inside view of this. Only those that fear the light, cling to the darkness.... Our disease does not want us to recover. I believe it is the same with the fellowship at large. An addict went to Motorcycle Ed's home and asked, " what we could do to bring healing, if a Fourth Step heals, could we not do a Fourth Step in the form of history and heal?" Ed, and the member prayed in that room, and felt if addicts can recover through a historical look at their life then maybe the fellowship could find unity after a historical look at itself. After much prayer and thought, this was taken through the service structure and approved. Bill B. was given the intent and was asked if he would chair the committee for NA History. He accepted. I was voted in as Co-Chair. That trip to Ed's house gave us our start. Bill saying yes sealed the deal. We were on.

The intent of the committee was to gather facts. Interview people, gather documents and make it available for all members. We knew that many people see one wreck from many different points of view. So to be honest, fair, searching, and fearless all avenue's had to be researched. The Basic Text project gave us a perfect tried and proven method of how to do this. There were many facts to consider, we were an aging fellowship, and many had passed, I feared many more would before it is done. Time was important. Below is a picture of first History Committee. Left to right is, member, Richard and wife from Guntersville Al., member, member, Bill B. Decatur Al., Grover N. Athens Al. These members worked hard, worked together, raised money and hosted the first Conference in Madison Al.

III. The First Celebration Set

The committee was formed and sponsored by two primary Areas the North Alabama and N.E. Alabama Areas of NA. Officers voted in and minutes kept. The first task was to agree on what we wanted to achieve. We envisioned bringing members together to share archives and to get on tape members that were there and had first hand knowledge of how things were done and got done. We felt celebrating our Fellowships Birthday would be the best way to bring members together. A conference held with its focus on our history. We decided on the date that we understood at that point to be the starting of NA. August 17th 1953. We sat a number of goals. We held several fundraisers/speaker meetings. Artwork was submitted, tee shirts made and site agreed on. Madison Alabama. The committee was adopted as a regional committee that same year.

We set out to contact Greg P., Bo S., Joseph P., and Jim M. These people that had first hand knowledge of our service structure and how the book was written. Our Registration packet was give special consideration. We wanted to give a piece of our History to those attending. So we used a copy of the first white book and changed the color of the cover as to not offend anyone. As anyone knows that has helped to organize and host a major event in NA it took a lot of hours and hard work to keep our areas informed and to be fully self supporting. We did not want to take money away from our PI and H&I efforts at the area or region.

IV. Members Gather

About 200 members showed up from all over the country. There was an archive room set up. Greg and other members brought lots of memorabilia, and archived literature no one had seen before. Copiers were also set up for archives to be gathered and shared.

There were more archive tables as well as copiers and computer tables set up in this room in order to facilitate the work.

Tully A. opened the Celebration with "I'm Tully and I'm an addict! Hi Family, I'd like to welcome everyone to the Celebration of NA History, it's this Region's first and hopefully we will have many, many, many more. Before we get started I would like to read the purpose: "The Alabama N.W. Florida Region of Narcotics Anonymous has formed a Committee whose purpose is to host a Celebration of NA History. Our intent is to bring our archives and fellowship together for a weekend of learning and sharing and at a point in the near future to have our legacy in written form through the Spirit of a loving God."

V. Speaker Transcripts from the Convention

NA HISTORY CONVENTION

MADISON, ALABAMA
AUGUST 1990

Madison History Conference Opening 1990

The Northwest Florida-Alabama Region History Committee
Planners: Tully, Donnie and Roxanne, Dickie, Grover N,

Madison Workshop
History of NA Conference
Friday Opening Meeting

Tully - Frank - Frieda - Victor - Guy - Kevin - Pat - Chris - Pete - Little Eric

Hello, I am Tully, I am an addict, hi Tully, hey family. I would like to welcome everyone to the celebration, the NA celebration of NA History. It is this regions first and hopefully we will have many, many more. Keep coming back Dickie. Before we get started, I would like to read the purpose the **History Committee purpose**. The Northwest Florida-Alabama Region has formed a committee whose purpose is **to host a celebration of NA History**. Our intent is to **bring our archives and fellowship together for a weekend of learning and sharing** at a point in the near future recent history to have our legacy in written form through the spirit of a loving God. The **purpose of this weekend is to celebrate recovery not to sabotage to reputation of Narcotics Anonymous**. We hope all addicts receive the best message possible while attending our conference. We also hope to make the message obvious to anyone who comes in contact with our fellowship. As a member attending, this conference **if you see someone acting inappropriately please be responsible**, and that is me too. Take time to do something about it. Notify conference committee members at the registration area. Before I go on any, further this meeting is being taped if you did not know. To the press, our public relations policy is based on attraction rather than promotion. We need always maintain personal anonymity at the level of press, radio and films. If any members of the press are present, please contact someone in the registration area for information. We ask that **no pictures be taken during the meetings**. If you wish to take pictures, please ask before you click your camera thank you. If you guys will please help me to open with a moment of silence followed by the we version of the serenity prayer. God grant us the serenity to accept the things we cannot change, courage to change the things we can and the wisdom to know the difference, amen.

Tommy G reads, Who Is
Bob B of Huntsville reads: What is an NA Program
Shalah reads: How
Cat C. reads: 12 Traditions
Susie B. of Birmingham reads: We do recover (third paragraph)

I am Tully and still an addict, hi Tully, hey family. Gosh when we first started out reading there was only about half of us here so we have filled up during our readings. Welcome glad to have you here. Tonight we are having a party in participation and the topic is "What were my feelings when I first saw the book"?

I got clean in 1982, the first part of '82 and we did not have a hard back Basic Text. My first meeting all I had was a little White Book with phone numbers in it. To me that was my book. Then I came across a little sleeky approval

form, best seven dollars I ever spent. I do not know about y'all but I took that book with me everywhere, to work, especially to meetings and I am the type of person that has to highlight things because I like to go back and let that magnify in my crazy mind. I do not know where my original approval form is today; I just hope somewhere it is doing somebody some good. I held onto that little book because it was talking about me and I never truly knew what a hug was until I read that book. I guess it was just the best hug I had ever had in my life, because that book was filled with warmth, understanding and unconditional love. I do not know how y'all were brought up but I was brought up within service and there was no way around it. Either you were in service or you were in service, so I chose to be in service, and I am proud of it, proud of it. I am grateful today; I was very excited that we were finally going to have a book. Many of us back then knew that we were having a controversy whether to have the book out or not but by the grace of God, we did. That book talked about me, talked about me. It was like how do y'all know how I feel inside without me sharing in meetings? I felt blessed with that book. I was so proud of it, I am still proud of it. Today I carry a paperback with me, but I guess my precious present to me is my little sleeky, because that was my best friend. I read it, reread it, read it, and reread it. I guess my favorite chapter is Chapter 10, "More will be revealed". I do not want to stay up here and talk to long so I am going to open the floor up and the topic is "What were our feelings when we first saw the book". I am not going to ask that you show hands, just come on up and share if you wish. Love you all and glad to have you here. (Applause)

Hi my name is Frank and I am an addict, hi Frank. You know I guess when we all come into the fellowship, depending on what edition we are on, what book you know that is the one we latch onto. For me it was the Third Edition Revised. Like you mentioned when I first read that book or heard the readings in the meetings, I thought that someone had been following me around all my life with a pencil and a pad and writing down everything that I did. You know it was through that and through the people that I have met in the fellowship that you know I am not a generic freak and I am not no different. You know I have blessed with a person a former sponsor of mine that I got to travel pretty much all over the east coast with. The things that I have learned from listening to you all in different places was that we all share the same feelings and we all share the same experiences and I hope we share what we talk about in the steps especially the commitment we talk about in the third step. You know there have been times especially early on. To tell you exactly why I got clean nothing would work no more. About 8 months before I got clean the only string with sanity the only things that meant anything to me passed away, my grandmother and from that point on the disease of addiction in whatever I did nothing worked anymore. I was always one who strove for attention and when I came to my first Narcotics Anonymous meeting, I found that. You know and I could not be with addicts all the time and I mean there were times when I had to go home and go to sleep or when I use to go to work, I would bring the White Book with me and read it. When things would get carried away, I would go into the bathroom or something and start reading. My favorite chapter is "Just for Today". That was one of the things I read everyday and "Who is an Addict", step one, two and three and traditions one, two and three. I got into that daily ritual. You know I do not want to separate one edition from another. You know that words are there. Some words have changed a little bit here and there but they are all very special. I have a disease that wants to separate them and I am not into that. I know better but every once in awhile I get caught up in some of the things that go on around here. You know I am trying not to do that today. I am trying to accept the book for what it is.

The reason I came here was last year, I think in the early part of the year there was an event in Northern New Jersey. After the event, a group of us went out to dinner and there were a few people there that had a lot to do with the first book being written. I felt a certain energy as they were talking about it a little bit and I knew these people would be here this weekend that is why I am here. The people that I know that were involved, there is one man that is very special to me you know and I reach out. I come from Connecticut but I have no problem having to call Georgia or having to call Pennsylvania or to do whatever it takes to do. You know surrendering to the words within that book that mean a lot to me. You know it is my whole life. My existence would not be possible today without that book. I am grateful to be here and I love you all, thank you. (Applause)

Hi I am Frieda, I am an addict, hi Frieda. I am grateful to be here tonight clean and see all of y'all. The book for me is such a comfort because I am not always willing to call somebody and I am not always willing to go to a meeting and I do not always follow the suggestions that are offered to me. I want to still hold onto my way a lot of the time, hide, and get better before I come around. I know that does not work but I try to keep doing it, but thank God the

Basic Text has a message for me that I can always receive a blessing from if I put out some effort to read it. Sometimes I hear things from other addicts that I choose to close my mind to but there are things in the Basic Text that I can read for the tenth time and get hope from what I am seeing in that book and use it. So for me the blessing of our literature is that I do not just have one chance to hear about it. I do not have just one chance to meet that person that is carrying that message, but I can keep it with me and always turn to it. I do not ever have to be with out it. I love you all and glad to be here, thank you. (Applause)

My name is Victor and I am an addict, hi Victor. I am very happy to be here. I had the book for a year and I did not read it because I was afraid of the book. It was given to me by the person that brought me to the rooms and they said read this. I got scared I did not want to look in that book you know and just put it up on the shelf for a year and a month, I finally finished reading it, and I identified a lot with what it had to say. My favorite chapter is "We do recover" and it helped me. I just was not ready to read I do not know but it is one of the few books that I have ever finished reading in my life. I have only maybe read five books and that is the one that made the difference you know. It has helped me a lot and I am really happy to be here. I identify with a lot of the stories and like I said they gave it to me, someone just gave it to me the person who brought me into the rooms. In Miami where I am from I went and did my recovery in Spanish, they do not have a Spanish text, and I am trying to get involved in that. You know I am not going to the translation committee because I am slacking off but I am trying to help in other ways to get a book out for people who need it in Spanish. I think that is important for my recovery to help to pass the message in Spanish because that is how I received it. I feel really happy to be here and I am trying little by little to be more and more apart of this great organization that saved my life. Because I would not be here if it were not for NA, you know and there is so much to give back and I am just trying to do my best, thank you. (Applause)

I am an addict and my name is Gayla, hi Gayla. I came around in May of '84, went to meetings every night, and got clean in October, we had a White Book, and that was all we had. That is all we knew about. We did not know they had IP's and all of that and we found an address. My sponsor and I found an address and we knew there were a lot of people that were staying clean with us and we were afraid that with nothing to hold onto besides just each other and going to meetings that we were going to loose a couple. We ordered a box of whatever it is they had out there you know we did not know. We found out they were eight dollars and we ordered as many as we had money for and there was a big box that came, and they came and went because my sponsor and I gave them away. You know it has just been two years ago that I got myself another Second Edition and that was given to me by somebody that knew we had given some away like that. I do not know I think there were twenty or twenty-five in there.

When I first came around and the White Book was the only thing we had around I was a real dope fiend man I stole a book you know. (Laughter) Then I was in a meeting and I heard them say that they didn't have anymore so I felt really bad then and went and made copies and took the original back in and I snuck it in so that nobody would know that I stole it. It is in my fourth step and it is no big deal now. I love you guys. (Applause)

I am Terry and I am an addict, hi Terry. When I came in in '82 we had this book here, it use to be called the hip pocket program. It fits real good and this book is real special to me too. That was my Bible, I worked off shore, and I do not recommend you do what I did. I went through treatment and I spent seven weeks in treatment and being that I worked out in the gulf the time you spent in you had to spend out so seven weeks out in the gulf you can go kind of crazy. They did not have any telephones and you could not walk to meetings because you were about a hundred miles off shore. This was my Bible and a lot of people did not want to be around me because I was crazy. Anybody that I could grab and sit and ;listen to me for five minutes and I did not care if they understood me or not I shared with them what I was going through. A lot of them did not come back you know because they did not want to hear what I had to say but it helped me.

When we got our first Basic Text, the Red Book I sat down and I cried because you know that is real special. You know that was our first one to me. You know we had the Grey Book but I did not have a copy of that. I have had a copy of just about every other one and being the good dope fiend that I am I gave it away. I was told the only way I can keep what I have is by giving it away. I gave all of my books away but I did not give away my Red Book. You know a lot of addict's work a long time on those books, spent a lot of man-hours a lot of sleepless nights. You know I

have been involved in service since I got clean you know it never killed me to sit in a committee meeting and argue with some other people that did not agree with me, it still don't but it is ok. Narcotics Anonymous is my life and that is it. I ain't got no other I am not willing to go out and use again because I do not know if I have another recovery in me and I am not willing to take that chance. I have been going through a lot of pain lately and a few weeks ago, I wanted to use real bad. I was told that if you stay around long enough in the program somebody else will go out and use for you and that happened and the girl came back, shared about it, and said that it just gets worse. My desire to use went away but this was my Bible for a long time until a book came out, thank you. (Applause)

Madison History Conference #3
Friday Night Opening (continued)

Speaker: Guy
Everybody my name is Guy and I am an addict, hi Guy. I have often thought that I was real fortunate in recovery in the respect that kind of the path that I ended up following led me to a lot of different people that were involved with the writing of the text. So I cannot share exactly in like the same type of joy and jubilation of having been apart of the actual process. Most certainly as one of the things that to say maybe around a hundred times I have pondered since I have been clean now, "damn if you would have just gotten clean a little bit longer you could have done that". I heard a long time ago that you do not leave empty-handed and there are still lots of opportunities for me to be involved today in many different things.

What I can share with you is my first experience of seeing the book. It was not that big a deal to me. You see the reason I bought a book was not because I wanted to read the thing. It was because I wanted to fit in. Everybody that I knew in the meetings had a book you know. The disease wanted me to feel in the worst way that I fit in and I figured what the hell the eight or nine dollars was a lot cheaper than the dope I was spending so I would invest. You know maybe the other thing that before I realized that the help of the book through a sponsor that I got a little bit later down the road that there were actually words in this thing that were meant to be read. It became much more valuable in the sense that what it became for me was a telephone book.

That Third Edition Basic Text and I have a lot of different versions. I do not have them all but I have a few and that one is like "my book". The reason it is like that is because the wear and tear on that one is all my wear and tear. That is the one that has been to all the meetings. That is the one that you can hardly read the NA logo on anymore on the front of it. That is the one with the binding all torn and it is the one with phone numbers filling every blank page of the Basic Text. What makes it so special to me looking at it today is that one thing that I have learned through that whole process is that we are very transient people in recovery, even clean you know. Almost none of the numbers are the same anymore, everybody has moved around. One of the like most significant things for me in there is every now and then as I go looking for somebody's number as I go flipping through the pages for phone numbers, there are two of them that I always have to stop at and kind of look at and it is not my sponsor's phone number. It is not real good friends; it is addicts that chose to go out and get loaded that are dead now. They are people that NA introduced me to that were apart of my life. That is the reality of the disease and that is real good for me, it kind of like kicks me in the ass every time I stop and look at it. Yep the disease is real it ain't bullshit. It is there and it could have been you.

I can get a little bit grateful you know. Hell I was asking Ed you know I read the newsletters and stuff like that and what was it about six months ago we just went over our millionth Basic Text sold, half a year ago, somewhere around there. I mean the only thought I can think after that is that a few years down the road is "Look out McDonalds". Thanks. (Applause)

Speaker: Kevin
Hi everybody I am Kevin and I am an addict, hi Kevin. I wish I could say also that I was one of those people that could share these long stories about how it happened. I am grateful for those people because if it were not for that Basic Text from that person who answered my phone call gave me and I opened it up and saw that there was a whole bunch of writing in it and I did not understand it because he scratched all the women's phone number. There was a

whole bunch of lines and highlight is like I heard somebody say earlier in there and I did not understand it. I heard him say later that those were things that stood out for him and maybe you will read it and find something that stood out for you and you can do the same thing, so I did that.

Also, when I first got clean, I think it was about two days after I had got clean this book came into my life. He told me to get phone numbers before I left meetings or he would not give me a ride home and I believed him. So I to used it for a telephone directory and I remember I had lived with the people I used with for the first week of my recovery and it was a real uncomfortable situation when I found myself walking around the dope table and saying that I could handle it once again. I found myself locking myself in my room with the telephone in one hand and the Basic Text next to me. It was really ironic because I looked at the list of the people and there was only one person I felt comfortable talking to and it was the guy that gave me the book but I figured I used him enough and I needed to call somebody else. I called this gentleman by the name of Sam and Sam asked me and one of my favorite chapters in the Basic Text is "What can I do" because what can I do has some things in there that I can do. He told me first to pat myself on the back because I did what I needed to do and then read the book and then call him back and I told him that I felt a lot better. You know there are a lot of things I can do.

A lot of the things have come from the people who came before me have made it possible for me. I am not going to knock; I am here to learn what it took to make this thing happen. I really appreciate the turn out and all the people sharing their experience with the little White Book. Even though that was the only thing that I carried around with me to work and I us to run center lines down the middle of highways and I use to talk to God and tell him to kill me, to take my life from me. You know I was one of those people who wished a heart attack type of deal. The insanity that the second step talks about and I found myself running center lines down roads and my party chief and the chairman would walk down marking center lines and I would have the thing out reading a fuckin story. Excuse my language, I apologize.

That is what got me through, that is what got me through, rubbing key tags, reading the text and reading this little book here and it was a nasty little thing. I still got it with all my other nasty key tags in a little box you know. I sat here since everybody, since three people shared I am like ok I will go now, and somebody would get up so I waited and it kept going and going and I was like I can't top that. Somebody said I do not have to be like that I just have to identify with what goes on in the Basic Text. I appreciate all the hard from everybody that put something into it and make it happen for me, thanks. (Applause)

Speaker: Pat
I am Pat I am an addict, hi Pat. Hi family, I am grateful to be clean tonight. For a long time whenever I told my story, I remember the first time I ever told my story it was at my home group and when I got to the point where I shared about the person who shared Narcotics Anonymous with me the message as I know it today. I could not get past that point. That knot would get right here you know and I would say how he gave me the White Book and I would have to just stand there and wait because God forbid that I cry you know. You know I would have to wait until it went away, but I can remember that just as clear if it was yesterday.

My first NA Meeting and I knew when I walked in that room I knew I was where I was supposed to be. They did not have any of the White Books at the meeting so he carried me upstairs to his office and gave me a White Book. I told him that I had tried to quit using but that I did not know how. So he gave me a little White Book and I carried it home and started reading it and I could identify in that book. You know I read it and read it and read it. My ex-husband was in treatment and when I would go and see him I would get every piece of NA literature they had and read it and take it home and read it. You know it was like I was a sponge, I could not get enough. You know I did not know that there was recovery. I thought that addicts just died or kept on using. It was like the guy who gave me the little White Book said, there is a way out you do not have to die today.

I am real grateful for the people that were here before me and allowed their Higher Power to work through them to bring Narcotics Anonymous to whatever it was when I got here. My first little White Book, my first NA Basic Text you know I did not know if it was approved or unapproved, you know it did not matter to me you knows I was just

grateful. I never even knew that there was not a book you know. I was just grateful that there was something that I could identify with and knew that I could stay clean if I did what that little White Book told me. I knew that I would stay clean. There was that little glimmer of hope and the faith that I had that if I would just read my book that I would stay clean and do what it said. I remember a lot of times and I still do this today. I think well, I will open my book to a certain place, and I know that God has got a message there for me. You know and I will just do that, open it to a certain place and there is usually a message there for me. I remember when I first got clean my concentration was real bad and I would read my book and I would not know what it said. I knew if I would just open that book and read it c and it didn't matter if I didn't remember what it said I knew that I was doing what I was suppose to be doing.

They told me the same thing about working the steps or die. Told me to get involved that service work would keep me clean. You know and I have tried to do that. I have tried to give away what has been given to me so freely. You know I am just real grateful for this program and for the people that were here before me and the positive role models that was here to teach me how to live. Love y'all. (Applause)

Speaker: Chris
I am Chris and I am an addict, hi Chris. I will make this short. The first time I saw that book I was in treatment and they gave us a bunch of books. We had step studies on another book and that was the one we had to do our homework on in treatment was that other book. I read that one you know and did the best I could with it. They made us read all these other books but they never said nothing about this book. So I figured that that was the one I wanted to read. They did not say shit about this book and are giving me all kinds of homework on feelings and but they ain't saying nothing about this book you know so I started reading it. They had taken us out to NA Meetings and I remember when I first opened that book and started reading I was like hey I have heard this before. That is when it hit me that the readings that they were reading in those meetings you know. These damn things are chapters you know, there is more to it than what they are reading in the meetings.

That is when I started to get some hope because I was one of those who went to treatment and did not want to go. You know I did not have any problem that shit is illegal but there was no problem you know. That book showed me that there was a problem. I stayed around and I thought I could bullshit my way around the treatment center. You know they would see that I was all right or they could send me with the crazies like the rest of us. I kept reading that book like I said and I saw some hope. It was like when I said before it was like I thought somebody had been following me around you know cause all the stuff like that I thought I was going through that nobody else had ever been through. Well somebody else has been through it and it amazed me you know. You know I was still real sick and I thought well this is why they do not want me to read this because they do not want me to know that I am not crazy you know that I am just sick. You know they wanted me to be another kind of person and all this stuff. You gave me a lot of hope and I am real glad to be here and am real glad to see some of the people that wrote this book. You know it is nice to know that they are still around. It is nice to know that I did not get here before the people that I owed so much to and at least get to meet them. I love you all. (Applause)

Speaker; Pete
My name is Pete and I am an addict, hi Pete. First time I saw the book I was in a meeting and they told me that I needed one of them. First thing I asked of course was how much was it. They told me eight dollars and I said well I do not have it and somebody gave me one and that was real neat. Today I have been able to give a few away myself and that is how it works. You know history has always been written by the winners quote and the winners destroyed what was written before. We have an opportunity to go to the source and I have gotten a lot of phone calls in the past week, he said she said they said, dada, dada, dada. I said well it sounds like rumors to me. Well what are you going to do about it and I said well what do you want me to do about it. I don't know get a butterfly net and catch them, you know I don't know. Here I know we have an opportunity to go to the source. You know most histories are not able to be written by going to the source. You know we have a source and that is really neat. You know that is what recovery is about, sharing experience, strength and hope. You know we have a rare opportunity to go to the source. Where it goes and what we do with it we will find out. You know more will be revealed. Thank you I am glad to be here. (Applause)

Speaker: Little Eric
Hi everybody I am Little Eric and I am an addict, Hi Eric. I am grateful to be here and I just wanted to share my story of the Basic Text is when I was in treatment. I read that line that said, "We have found from our group experience that those people who keep coming to meetings regularly stay clean". You know and I looked up at my counselor and she said ok now define regular. The only thing that I could think of was my grandmother. When she said she was regular that meant everyday. (Laughter) I swear to God. So I told myself that if I would just go to these meetings on a regular basis that I could stay clean because it said so. I really believed it and the process that my mind went through was that these people that had been, you know I was a newcomer a couple weeks clean. These people that had been around for years and years and years found out of habit from going to these meetings over and over and over and they noticed this trend that people who came regularly stayed clean. I grabbed onto that and that one sentence gave me a lot of hope in the beginning. That is my little story, thanks. (Applause)

Speaker: Tully
I am Tully and I am still an addict, hi Tully. Thanks everybody for coming up and sharing and thanks to those who did not come up and share for sticking it out with us. I realize it has been a long meeting but it has been well worthwhile. Let us have Shorty come up tonight and give out our chips.

Saturday Speakers continued the Madison History Conference

My name is Greg, and I'm an addict. Somehow I ended up on some kind of literature committee in 1971. A variety of things had happened. We used to have a taped meeting for the purpose of developing literature. Every Saturday we would go down to this guy's house and run the tape recorders and have a meeting. I don't know what happened to any of that stuff. To my knowledge none of it ever became literature. But it was real interesting, and there was interest there. I guess that was how I really got involved. I've got a letter I wrote in 72 asking for input for a text. Part of the problem, for me, was that there was always so much to do and so few to do it. In the seventies you didn't stay involved in any one thing very long because you were always fighting fires. There was no service structure; there was no working service boards and committee's. Well, there was one. There wasn't any 'anybody' taking care of your service needs. If there was need, you went and did it.

If there wasn't a group somewhere in some part of town, you went over to that part town and started a group. And then you went there every week for a year. If there was a need for H&I work, you didn't wait for some committee to tell you how to do it, you went and did it and tried to follow the traditions to the best of your ability. If there was a P1 need, for instance, this was in California, if the LA County Sheriff's Department wanted an orientation on NA, you didn't go to a P1 committee because there weren't any. A member who had been around some time grabbed a couple of white books and went and did it.

That's really the way it was, there weren't to many bodies going around, I think there were maybe half a dozen live wires. I guess I got involved in the Basic Text before there was really much effort going. I've heard Bo talk about our first meeting, and I know that during the seventies we were always on the lookout for another live wire. If any body showed any interest they got encouraged, they got put on a committee, they got asked to participate but very little was forthcoming. There was some writing prior and some work done prior to the effort towards the Basic Text. Maybe he'll talk about that in another section. But that's how I got here. I felt like I was here before we started. I got involved the same way the rest of us get involved.

Hi, I'm Jim and I am an addict. I got a letter in the mail, I think that was the first thing, maybe it wasn't, but it sounds dramatic so maybe I'll share it that way. The letter said "you are the book". It went on to talk about how "you are the only Basic Text that anybody will read. And unless you write it down and share it, we're not going to have one." I think that was what got me started writing it down. That's probably the most important part of my being a part of. This service effort was actually sitting down with that most intimidating of things, a blank sheet of paper and a pencil.

When I was about 3 months clean, but claimed I had a year and 3 months, I went to my first convention. Which was a world convention because that was the only kind of conventions there were at the time. It was in Atlanta, I left about ten times, because there wasn't a single NA speaker. Not that the people didn't do what they thought was right and shared what they thought was kind of like recovery with everybody. It had a lot of spirit, a lot of caring love, a lot of love caring concern, they just weren't NA speakers. They didn't find their recovery here and didn't perceive themselves as being powerless over addiction. I'm very

judgmental, the more you hear me talk, the more you will understand that. I make a decision right up about a speaker and even more so then.

At any rate, we couldn't get literature in our group at home and I wanted to go see why, and fix it. I figured I couldn't just by jumping up and down and screaming. I heard about Wichita, I heard about there being a thing for the book, a movement to write the book, but probably the most important thing was that I went to a club house outside of Atlanta after the convention and heard an NA speaker, and sat in on this service committee meeting. I sat up next to this cuddly, pudgy fellow in overalls who put his arm around me and took me off to the side afterwards and said "do you need a Tree?" This guy hunted in his house and brought it out after a long time and I got involved, and I got cared for. I think that's what I'm trying to say here with a lot of words. I got loved and cared for, I got an arm put around me with a lot of love, care and concern and the feeling of "we want you involved, we will include you whenever you are here, we will spend whatever time it takes to explain these concepts to you and what you have to say is important, it doesn't matter who you are or were you've been." That's the feeling I got and the spirit I caught and the service that I found in the Lit committee and in world service in 1979- 1980. That's what kept me coming and got me involved and that's what more than even recovery that inclusiveness, teaching about surrender is what's made me who I am today.

Here I am, out of order again, my name is Bo, and I'm an addict. Well I feel like I got started on this last night, I don't want to be as dumb as I am, and repeat everything, but maybe that's what I need to do. Maybe, from a slightly different angle. For one thing I'm real glad that Ed and Jim and Greg and I can be here, and I still hope our other buddy Joe, will drag in from Memphis, we may try to keep it light but actually we're sort of like revolutionaries and the war's are real and the wound's are real and we have casualties so if Joe can't make it, pray for him. Battles are played out in these halls and we do the best we can to care and share and occasionally we get a chance to really do something in service. I guess my personal starting place was like every other starting place in my life, I was there, wherever it was, I was there very much before it happened, but wherever it was, I was never around when it was happening. I was always hearing about it, reading about it, doing some dope; I kept missing it, whatever it was. I wasn't even sure it was real or really happened.

Obviously there was a lot of stuff around so you figured it came from some place but you know, like how to actually be there. I was always to young or to old or to fat or to skinny or to smart or too dumb or too early or too late or just out of sync actually. Of course part of the time in active addiction I may not have been out of sync except I put myself out of sync with what I put in, and missed chances that way. The last thing I expected when I read the lines in a book called the *Beat's* that Synnanon grew out of some meetings in a building where NA meetings were held in Santa Monica that I would ever get involved much with NA, because I was just a sixteen year old beatnik reading a book finding out how to be weird.

Truncating the whole deal a little bit, in 1971 or so, I called information in Atlanta to find out if there was a meeting of Narcotics Anonymous in Atlanta, because all that back ground behavior up to that point it seemed like I ought to be contacting Narcotics Anonymous. At that point I had just spent two years on the strip down at Atlanta; I was on the 6 o'clock and 11 o'clock news whenever I wanted to be. The mayor came to Human Improvement Project, Inc. on 10th street in Atlanta frequently. We used to figure out ways to force him to come down, and if he didn't come down we'd go down there like one time Mohamed All donated fifty thousand dollars to fight addiction in Atlanta. And so this rough looking hippy with blond hair like this leans over this desk and says " how about some of that fifty thousand dollars Mayor Massell." and Sam leaned back, you know and people were dying down there, and we interacted with federal, state and local efforts, churches, do goobers, medical societies. There were Jesuits down there. There were federal people down there. A lot of people good willed down there. A lot of people came down there looking for there kids. A lot of times we would develop relationships with families slash kids. A lot of weird stuff happened.

Towards the end I had to strap on a loaded six gun every time the sun went down because it was that rough down there. Just to feel okay, like I could walk to the store and back. The reason I'm stressing all this is because two year experience like that, working at night and day, eating, sleeping, breathing it, reading magazines, hearing whatever people brought, all convinced me that there was absolutely no hope anywhere on the entire planet for addicts seeking recovery. There was no hope at all, there was none; there was nothing you could do. You were trapped, it was over, there was no way out, there was no such thing as living clean. It was like you had slid into a pit, I guess you got them around here, these creatures that live in the sand and make a living off of killing ants. The way they do it is they make a little suck hole for themselves and the ant comes in if it ever crosses within that circle that's like a fallen cone then the Ant Lion, I think is the name of it, kicks up sand so that the ant even though it struggles, it thinks it's going get out, and gets to the edge. It really doesn't, it really just keeps falling to the lower and lower circle to the bottom so the Ant Lion can bite it and suck it's juice out and all that. Kind of like ground spiders, in a way.

Being an addict was sort of like that. Once you were over the edge a little to far, you might see the edge again, you might think you were actually going to get out, but something would always happen right before you did, and you would be at a lower level

to lower level. I'm sure everybody in this room knows how ridiculously I'm glossing over actual horror and feeling that goes with discovering that you are that kind of addict. And something's got you and you can't see the motherfucker but you know it's there because it's doing it to you. Sometimes were struggling to be nice, sometimes were struggling to do better, and sometimes were struggling to be a good person, to do the right thing, but as soon we get to the close to the edge like we're going to be on our way with our lives something has got us, something kicks in our face and we fall down, and all we know is we are trapped and can't get out of it until the last moment. Then we know something's got us but we don't have time to talk about it much.

We're clean addicts who figured out something had them$_4$ and if there going to do any talking, they better talk quick, mostly because allot of us have seen our friends die, you know, using, car accident, choke on your own puke, OD, shot, stabbed, you know, there is just a lot of ways.

This one young lady shared with me and God I hope she's here, I hope she hears this and I hope she don't get pissed at me talking about, but it's just so fucking typical, and this woman was shooting dope with her girlfriend and the girlfriend had the dope and she had wanted the dope, so they got off, and her girlfriend went into a heavy nod, so she took the rest of the dope and shot it and split before her girlfriend had come out of the nod because she didn't want to get yelled at for stealing the rest of the dope and doing it, and left the woman there passed out on the couch with her two or three year old daughter and found out later her girlfriend had died and the baby had been left with her dead Mom on the couch for three days, and didn't feel to hot about herself, you know, or maybe, you know, there was something wrong about the way she was living.

It didn't have anything to do with the cops, the establishment or all the TV ideas about what drug addiction does to you. Coming from that background, and the thing we had been doing on the strip had sort of died out, which was great. Now, I tried to call Narcotics Anonymous. We held like six meetings and had a copy of, a green colored copy of the white book but had no idea about anonymous principles or real steps or traditions. The people who were good enough to provide the green covered booklet were alcoholics and I couldn't relate to that. I thanked them a lot, you know, and after a while we stopped the meeting, you know it's kind of like trying to learn the song, we couldn't quite catch the tune.

So, three years later is my clean date, and I've been going to meetings ever since. Since June 10, 1974. Yeah, I think I went through a stage, you know. There was, let's see, I got clean in 74, and there wasn't even the Grey Form until 80 or so, that means I was, staying clean on the little white booklet for maybe, six years.

I understand how a lot of people feel real strongly about some of the lines in Recovery and Relapse, some of the lines in We Do Recover, some of the basic stuff about the Steps. I think I read a couple of the stories in the back of the basic text a couple of times. The thing that kept me going was the sincere newcomers, the idea of recovery, all those discussions, all the phone calls, eventually all the meetings.

When NA started clicking and growing, there were meetings in nearby states and other parts of the country and communicating with them, those are the things that really fired my recovery. In a sense, more because being in a situation that God set up for me, we had more, like, terrifically sincere newcomers. The questions they asked kept me moving, and jumping, and calling, and writing, trying to get their answers. You couldn't do something as simple as go to a book and flip it open to a section you read, this is even with other material from Alcoholics Anonymous or from other sources, you know, we were doing the best we could back then. The answers just really weren't there. There were breakdowns, I mean I was going into NA meetings and there would be NA newcomers there, sometimes quite upset, sometimes real pissed off about the notion of having to substitute drug for alcohol, and problems other than drugs, which was a famous piece. I said, hey, look, I know some thing about that program and that guy did not ever mean to piss somebody like you off or make you uncomfortable or kill your chances of recovery. So I believe if that guy were here today, he would tell you to do what I'm going to tell you to do, and that's tear that damn pamphlet in half and throw it in the trash. The guy was sort of trapped a moment before I said that, but the idea that he could do that, and plus he had my support and encouragement and permission, he was suddenly free. That guy is still clean today, right?

But, you know, a lot of people didn't have somebody there to say no, get clean, that's the main thing, don't pay attention to that paper, it'll upset you. It was that kind of fertile land or something, you know, so much shit there - any seed that dropped there is bound to grow. I had pressure put on me like that, I hit the NA trail. It's always sickening how I read occasionally how phrases like this get turned around.

I headed out to the greater NA, I had to discover the greater NA. I heard that line like, abused by someone who quoted is an instance of, like, better NA was where they were at, or something weird like that. Okay, I mean I don't know what that is, sometimes I think it's like everybody is born in recovery somewhere and they got themselves and their locale, and their circle of friends, and somehow the old human habit of, anybody that's close, anybody that knows their name, anybody in my circle of friends it's okay, but those other people, you know, they're out to get you. I mean, even within the fellowship, it's sort of like

we're all ape men or something, and we got to live by the law of the fang. If you're not careful, then somebody will come in and burn your village.

It's real weird, it's real weird, I think something that changed my recovery experience early on was, for being a hippy all those years, and all the other stuff, was just the idea that if the most dangerous thing to do, short of actually using was to wish harm to another member, and it's been extremely to walk the mile of walks and not wish harm to other members, with the road filled with thieves and assholes and son-of-a-bitches along the way, but I've never wished them harm, I've tried to rationalize it and play down the bad part of it and accentuate the good part of it. But, I was used to overriding it you know, you don't have a choice of drugs like LSD without expressing the positive and emphasizing a lot of inter-direction and being objective.

I still bear marks from that, you know, maybe they'll continue to rub out of my personality. But the main thing is when people like got clean there was no Basic Text, like what Greg said. I saw a copy of a letter sent out from the office in 1972, maybe that was it, or there was another one, there was a mock letter saying that an effort for writing the Basic Text was under way, don't miss out, send you story in today. Nobody went for it, nobody sent in their story.

When I'd been in contact Jimmy Kinnon, and several other people, maybe, but mainly Jimmy, and I wasn't satisfied with my answers. I mean I actually reached the point where, together with another member, I'd sit down and write the letters saying like, where, if there is a group conscious, where is it, where does it live, what is it's name, does it have a phone number, does it have a mailing address? I was just short of being insulting, like, what in hell is going on? Because I was getting dodges on the telephone. I kept asking, and re-asking the same kinds of questions over about eight pages, and guess what, I got back a post card. A nice post card. It said, okay kid, things are fine, keep the faith baby, like, you know, I think sometimes people in World Service just think they are dealing with little children, and with my back ground and all, you know, somehow I just happened to be on this Delta flying west for the World convention you know, coincidentally of course.

You know, they were like knocked back that somebody was there from the east coast, me and Tommy B., that we actually flew in for the world convention. They kept expecting that we flew in to visit family or out there on business or why are you here? For the convention? They would yell out across the room, "Hey, there is somebody here for the convention all the way from Georgia!" And the next thing, was, there I am at the World Convention, at the Jack Tar, in San Francisco, walking around, just enormous numbers of possibly clean addicts who still looked pretty weird and a little bit street-hard, but nevertheless I had every reason to suppose they were clean, whatever stage of recovery they might be in. And there wasn't much on the program that year about the Basic Text of Narcotics Anonymous. And there wasn't much in the little display room about where the early meetings were held, who was working on our little book, and I literally went through about a dozen people saying things like, nice weather, it's really pretty out here, who's working on our book?

You know, it's like, I had to begin with a couple of lame lead sentences and then I'd immediately get to that other sentence, and then it was simple navigation, you know, they'd say like, go over there, and I'd go over there, and they'd say go over there, and I'd go over there. And I kept zinging back, homing in on the registration desk. They could have just told me at the gate. That's where I wound up. And within about five minutes I met Jack Whaley, Jimmy Kinnon and Greg Pierce, Bob Barrett and Chuck Skinner and all these guys hanging around this desk. That was in a way, a big way, effectively world services. I didn't meet any Magdalenos that time, and there were other people around, as far as the people who were active at that point and I can still recall the names that played a significant major roll, like Jimmy really did do some early work, Jimmy really did pick up the fire, and carry the banner after the early efforts of NA on the east died out, and did manage to be there and sit there with that one shuddering newcomer and not give up. And off, on, maybe, maybe he did it because he is a great man, maybe it was an ego trip. It don't much matter how he did it, and that does count for something here as elsewhere and there had been early efforts in literature, the White Book and so on. It just seemed like they all took for ever. A lot of time passed before progress started happening, so anyway, I'm asking these people, "Who's working our book?" When I'm still getting zinged but the space across which I'm getting zinged is getting shorter and then I meet ole Greg, and I mean that was the weirdest thing, because now I'm meeting an NA old-timer who is young, a young NA old timer who is also the chairman of the Board of Trustee's. And like on the outside I'm going, yup, yup, and on the inside I'm going, oh goody! You know? I wasn't being very indirect, I mean I was asking pretty straight forward questions for me, not very objective at all. I'm making jokes, I get criticized for being objective and indirect and all that, and really I got knocked back for asking so hard that I guess I still am in difficult situations where I'm trying to be nice and then I wind up being criticized for being indirect and objective when really it my only way of handling very difficult situations, so I'll stop laughing at them and wasting all this time and get back to this story, and I do love them, but it's hard, but…

So me and Greg is talking and the funniest thing happens is that I stopped zinging because he had to go do something so I tagged along and I had to do something and was amazed to find him tagging along? Wait a minute, he's supposed to be real busy and say yeah, check with me later, go see so and so. Suddenly, I ain't zinging - plus we're talking about mutual interests and so like I

was, whatever it was, check on my luggage or something like that I hadn't really had to do it. And when it got done, I went wherever he was going and we wound up going around the building and somehow we weren't too good at catching on that day but the inevitable happened. We went up to his room and he pulled out some cases with some documents in it and started going through paperwork like we were going through till five-thirty last night, and see? Once an addict, always an addict, right? Love that paper work. I liked it because I thought it was cool stuff but I also thought about members back home because see, they're had no way of going to San Francisco themselves and this was the way to take home something and give pieces of it away and let them know that it was really happening and because without the evidence in those days, I mean a photo copy was a valuable instrument because it was a way to let the people back home get encouragement and hope and it's really happening and here look at this and look at that and let them know the whole goddamn thing was real because back then, you know, you'd hear things about the sister fellowship thinking it's bigger than we are and better off and more meetings and all that, I mean it was hell back then and we needed the evidence bad, they did know for real that our program worked, that our Traditions meant something that the Twelve Steps were valid principles of recovery as practiced by NA members in NA meetings. I mean all that of, by, for, NA stuff, a lot of that has become reality in the last ten or fifteen years. It didn't come easy, it took low blows, you know, within the fellowship and from external forces, and I guess what's happening is like it's easier to come out front and just talk about this because now, you're all Narcotics Anonymous. Okay?

The days in which we got clean ten percent of the room might be real NA members so we had to watch our step, think about that, I mean it was fucked! and it was hard to do something about it, and there was no way to judge them, there was no way even if I got to talk to you or you or you or spend time with you I couldn't really tell because you'd lie to me, you probably wouldn't even half know. You might act and talk and express things to where you're not and then ten years later here you still are and then there are a lot of people that seem like they're NA members but they wouldn't do nothing for the fellowship they were supposed to love and care about so much. Let somebody else do it was their philosophy, you know one of the best tributes to the disease of addiction something like eight or nine years ago and this is the first time I had a place where I could pass on that material by request because of people asking for it so it might have been never, but it wasn't it was today, thank you.

I'm an addict from Memphis, my name is Joseph. Hi ya'll, I don't really know what's going on, I always walk in on Bo it seems like and I can never figure out what's going on but, of course my mind picked up on the sons a bitches, and thieves and assholes that are around the program, that's certainly true.

I sometimes get caught up in the negative and isn't and who's not doing what and first one thing then the other but I take it that from what Ed told me that we were kinda sharing about how some of us got involved in how the book was born and got evolved that and to add to what Bo said, and what Jim said, is I got clean in June of 79. I got clean over the phone, there was no Narcotics Anonymous in Memphis and I found the number of the World Service Office in the public library there, it was in Sun Valley, so I called collect and talked to Jimmy Kinnon, one of the co-founders and called collect every day for a while and he sent literature and said start meetings and don't do any dope and try to care about yourself and everybody else and give hugs unconditionally and that was in June of 79. And then he sent a flyer about the World Convention that was coming up in Atlanta that year. He said somehow you got to get down there and meet some of these other folks, that he wouldn't be there but Bo would be there and Greg and Chuck Skinner and so like, Bo, when he went to San Francisco a couple of years before that, I walked in and it looked - whatever the term used - looked pretty street rough. People were all around that hotel in Atlanta and they were hugging and laying on the floor and it was pretty, that's the first clean addicts I'd been around and I wasn't sure these people were clean, so I spent a lot of my time up in the room pacing around.

At that time I used nicotine, so I inhaled a few packs of nicotine and just wondered what the hell was going on, somebody'd hug you and they wouldn't let go of you and I'd go back up to my room and freakout. I didn't know what I'd gotten myself into, but I roamed around and found Bo and found Greg and sit back and listened, I asked about the same questions and they asked my how long I'd been clean about 3 or 4 years? I didn't say anything I just said yeah, of course it had only been a couple months at that time but I didn't want to feel not a part of or that these guys wouldn't talk to me and wouldn't share with me, I just kinda went along with it.

Down there I'd heard about the book being talked about and that these fellows were working on it and that was where I wanted to get involved because there was no literature, just these five pamphlets and the little white book that was in the starter kit at that time in 79. I still today don't do very well transferring my thoughts in to paper but I knew I could help out and be a part of somehow by just being there and I was told about the first World Literature Conference that was coming up a few months later that was coming up in Kansas? Up in Kansas. I'd arranged for Bo to come through Memphis to pick me up and go up there, I didn't' know what it was going to be about and on the way talked about a lot of things and we talked about we were going to write this we book and we got up there and I like to fool with the copy machine and go out and get people food and clean up ashtrays and things like that. That's the kind of role that I could do in my diseased mind and my emotional debilitating self and they kept talking about for days about this we book we were going to write and all this information that Greg had and other

people had getting piles, and the copy machine was running and I couldn't figure out how they were going to get all this material in a small book and it went on and on and on and what I finally figured out after that convention was that the We book, is that, we, together, and not small, but I never asked.

That's where I was, but about this clean time and about this we book we were going to have and how small it was going to be so I just kind of hung around and did what I could and volunteered and at the end of that World Literature Conference, the first one, they were going to set up a time to have the next one and of course me being the assertive self good controlling addict that I was, I wanted to volunteer Memphis and so I did of course I was the only clean member in Memphis. But things worked out, we had that Literature Conference at the, the Grey Book came out of, is that correct Bo? If I remember way back then, what's that, eleven years? Yeah, a year and a half after Wichita, and ended up being about a eight or ten day conference and then people left and people like Jim and others came back and Bo stayed on and we finally, I think Bo's got all the tapes of that whole, we taped the whole conference that year and all the group conscious and like he says he wanted to know what the address was of the group conscious was and what the phone was and at that conference we really started to develop what, in our mind, what was spiritually attuned to what we thought group conscious was is writing in committee and writing in groups and letting everybody who wanted to be a part of and not limiting anyone's participating for any reason and it seemed to work, I think that Grey book came out it was, we mailed it, I think we printed twelve hundred of them and we didn't have that many addresses of groups and areas and individual members around the country. I think we had a total of about seven hundred addresses of addicts or groups or churches that NA used to be at all around the world. How many? 663? Okay. Close, and we mailed them out and got a lot of them back and Jim took a lot of pictures of that Conference I don't know if he's got a set of them but I brought a set of them with me. It's pretty interesting seeing all these addicts sitting around and laying around.

There also a few in the pictures that aren't with us today, Roger T, who has since died of AIDS, was a big help. He typed about ten days straight without rest, he could type about hundred and forty words a minute accurately and he was a member of the other fellowship. He just happened to be at the State University where we had the Conference and wandered into it and became addicted to NA and recovery and writing the book and his thing was typing and so he played a big part in this book being written and developed. And there were others, Gina H from Nashville, who is not here today that's since died of AIDS also. She was one of the early members of NA in Tennessee. I think with fourteen years clean she died, and one of the phrases that made it through all the processes of the book that I really liked, was part of her words, was everything is subject to revision especially what we know of the truth and that continues to be the true for me of what changes of what I think today or what I thought three months ago or three years ago and about myself about life about recovery about other addicts about the world and how I used and live the steps in my life today and try to apply the principles on a moment to moment basis, and like Bo said, I too have a difficult time today, seems like more difficult today than the past in dealing with personalities within the fellowship, particularly when it comes to our literature and the Basic Text as it is today and the other literature that's coming out and such as that is what's going on. So I've been involved and all my recovery has been in Narcotics Anonymous since June of 79 and I've started meetings and I've shared and do what the next thing is to do. I guess that's all I have to put it in a little nut shell. Thanks a lot.

Hi, family. I'm Motorcycle Ed, and I'm an addict. You know that one of the things that Joe has opened up the door is the different talents, it was so amazing to just show up at one of the conferences, my self worth was at the level that what basically I could do was tote tables and give back rubs and I believe at the second one they, that I showed up at the real treat for me was getting to do what all the other people had got to do in kindergarten that I didn't get to do cause I didn't get to go to kindergarten was little bitty scissors cut up little pieces of paper and get to paste stick them on the back and paste it on another piece of paper and the kid in me just went berserk, you know, hot diggedy doggy dam! Twelve hours of this, you know, it's like somebody'd walk up and start rubbing your back and all this and one of the things that did happen in Memphis was, how long was the conversation with the phone call? Two calls totaling over nine hours and a little gal sitting there and they take turns typing, you know, one person would hold the phone to their ear and they would type and another person would rub their back so they wouldn't cramp up and just over and over and over times again the selflessness.

People said how did you learn to give like you give and it was through the conferences and watching time after time after time and you know, just stepping out thinking you know, well, I really don't have the money to go, but I'm fucking going anyway and called the boss up and said I got to have two weeks off next week and if you want to fire me you can. And the boss saying, okay, you can go, come back when you get back in town, come back to work. Alright, and leave running and you know the encompassing the coming to believe process you know where the phrase of this is one family goes to the bone. You break the bread and you cry and you suffer and you sit and wonder why and how and as Bo mentioned why did they say that or you know, why did they do that and you know, don't they love NA and yes, maybe they do and you try to be open minded and all that stuff because really I got tired of being run out of the institutions because I didn't have the proper credentials. It was like well, we'll go get some tell me I can't get it, you're in trouble.

I got tired of seeing people dying for lack of hope, you know come in and try it and we offer them a white book and this was there more? Well, if you got time to listen we can talk to you and then the joy of getting the chance to, yeah there's a little bit more over here and pull out a book and give it to them and watch the life come back and to some people that's not valuable but to me it is. We're going go on a little bit more about the conferences and maybe share some overcoming, I know we got this, if you haven't gotten in the room at one thirty maybe after this you can go there and look at some of the stuff and it will tie it too, there is some of it laying up here and you know because it is hard to conceive sometimes why do I get tears in my eyes when I see this flyer? Five years worth, that's why and the other people this flyer said yeah, okay big deal, so they didn't know how to do it artistically then. Which ever one of the gentlemen wanted to go next?

My name is Greg and I'm an addict, and I don't know. I look around and we're all a little teary eyed, maybe that's from a lack of sleep - we've been there before. For me, part of what was such a big impact for me, you know, this is the first time we all sat down together in years. This is certainly the first time the four of us, the five of us have ever done this and that's amazing because you see we were really part of each others lives for a long time and I think that some of that stuff is the stuff that never gets talked about, that it wasn't just work, it was sharing each others lives. We used to ride busses across the country.

Joseph visited me in Oregon on a Greyhound, twice from Memphis. I visited Joseph in Memphis on a Greyhound then swung up and rode from Memphis to Pittsburg and Jim picked me up and went to the farm and went to Warren for the Lit Conference and then, Oh, we went, drove across Pennsylvania to New Jersey so I could talk at the East Coast then we came back and went to Warren for the Lit Conference and somewhere in the middle of that we went up to start the Ohio region, I mean we lived with each other this was not just about getting together to put together a book.

One of the things, an awareness that I've come about really in the last month or two, one of the things that is very real, the process is part of the magic. The only way we could learn about recovery, particularly the folks who are here, was through involvement in service. There wasn't any place to go. There weren't any old-timers. Particularly in the east. And the way you learned about living clean was by getting involved in service and traveling from Ohio to Georgia on a wing and a prayer and putting up with some crazy - I mean we put them in the back of the truck that didn't run and drove them to the airport.

I remember, you know, or traveling to here or there or wherever and showing up and becoming part of the process and the process and the process was about stretching the limits of knowledge of recovery. I really believe when people started discussing the Basic Text, it's obsolete because the awareness is grown and the awareness grew. A lot of, I believe the way NA is perceived today grows right out of the process of the Basic Text and discussions, it's obsolete now, the awareness of recovery and the fellowship in NA has moved past the Basic Text. It's one of the reasons we originally talked about, never wanting anything that became a, you know, "This is the Bible!" sort of thing. We wanted something that would be reviewed every five years and updated as our understanding and awareness recovery grew.

I think the actual process started, in this attempt, in San Francisco, the things that led up to that, the writing letters, the looking to people, encouraging people the phone calls and everything else, those were all setting the stage. I really believe the actual process started in San Francisco in 1777 at the 7th World Convention. And it grew from there. I want to read a letter that I think is real indicative of, that Bo sent me. In December of 1977, this follows when we first met at the World Convention in San Francisco, Bo came down with me and spent a few days at the house, several of you have done that. I visited the fellowship in Marietta. I'd been in a situation where I was in Washington, you see, I used to do triangle flights. I started traveling in NA in 1976 wherever there was some groups and when I did some business, what I'd do - I don't think you can do it any more - they used to be able to tack on another leg for like 30 or 40 dollars. So if I was doing business or something from LA to Washington, what I would maybe, in fact this is a real trip that happened. Instead of flying, I had business in well, Bethesda actually, just outside of Washington. What I did was fly from LA to Washington, go to an NA meeting, meet an NA member, have them drive me to Washington, take care of my business, run around Pennsylvania for a couple of days, end up back in Philadelphia and then fly to Atlanta and then back to LA.

Or another trip was, there was one I was setting up a plant in Toronto and I flew from LA, there was a stop, there was a change of planes in Chicago so I stayed overnight and went to a meeting in Chicago in 77, had pizza and went on to Toronto and on the way back I worked it out where I could stop in Wichita and visit with some of those folks on my way back to LA and that was the way I traveled. I'd almost built that in and for very little money you could add a leg to a flight and I was traveling and so on one of those trips, coincidentally, Bo chuckles about it and says, "Coincidentally two months later Greg dropped in on my local meeting." and you know, but that's the way. I mean, that was not anything bizarre. That's a description of the nature of the relationship. We participated in each others lives to a much greater degree than we have since, you know, we were part of each other, and I was struck to, on how well we complimented each other because we all got different strengths.

I could not have done what Joseph or Bo or Jim did. Bo could not have done what Joseph or I or Jim did, Joseph could not have done what Bo or I or Jim did, Jim could not have done what Bo or I or Joseph did we each had our own strengths, and that's something really. We haven't, I don't think we ever really looked at, but it's true, it's really true. I don't really know what they really are, but they were very real.

Anyway after that trip, and when I'd dropped in and I don't know, sometime in 77, here's the letter, and I think the letter really speaks to some of the spirit of the Basic Text of the process. I also think NA grew as much from the process as it did from the product see, because an example of that, now Jim mentioned coming down to Atlanta in 1977, and then he went back, there really wasn't any NA, he started an NA meeting. In 1980 there was like one or two meetings. In 1981 there were one hundred meetings in Ohio. You know, that's the sort of things that happened and that was because the process and because of the awareness. The moving to a higher level of conscious because of awareness that took place in the process.

Dear Greg, Well we all wear glasses now, do you wear glasses? Did any of us wear glasses before? My first pair of glasses! I don't think any of us wore glasses, that was like one of those weird a, yeah, nun of us needed to we all have to now. I don't know. That was one of those weird things, well I can remember at Warren, the 4th the 5th, whatever, World Lit Conference, the 5th, one of the things that struck me was the percentage of people with light colored eyes, I don't know why that struck me, but there was something there. Anyway

> Dear Greg,
>
> Guess who bought a typewriter? I hope you have a nice Christmas, this is December 16th 1977, please say hi to Lois and the baby, hope to see you next year, I've gotten off to a rolling start with the writing. I've started umpteen pamphlets and a few notes for the NA book. My friends here know of my efforts and I hope to get a few of them together real soon for input and discussion. Hopefully this will take place here and elsewhere. Thank God it's begun. At this point I feel we have to involve as many as possible to make sure we cover all points of view. Involving people might struggle the effort and controversy but I really trust the spirit and believe we'd be poor servants if we leave them out.
>
> Somehow if we could get our best minds working on this in harmony I just know it would strengthen the gut of the program. In my thinking it has occurred to me what we're up against, is NA a cure for addiction, how to help doctors treat or react to addiction.
>
> We would hate to see any valid point of view left out, also I would hate to see any great length of time elapse without some progress. Please write to me, my friend.
>
> Your friend,
>
> Bo

I didn't get to attend the first World Lit Conference in 79, that and I'm sure Bo will talk more about that, or somebody, that was about planning the plan. We always planed from a, you always plan the work and work the plan process. That was a rule of thumb. You plan the work and then you work the plan and you review the plan, you probably do it over 2 or 3 times. You plan the work and work the plan and Wichita was about developing the Literature process, writing the directions, stuff that had never been tried before, I can remember a lot of phone calls and a lot of letters.

We were going now what the hell should we do next? We checked things out with each other we were in real close communication. I think it really began for me in Wichita, in Lincoln, after the 10th World Convention in Wichita. Kermit brought a mug from that convention; he's sitting in the room over there. The following week was the second World Lit Conference just a state away. We didn't think nothing about it 'S just a state away from the 10th World Convention was the second World Lit Conference and that's where the work on the book began.

There'd been writing before that, there'd been input put in, there'd been a number of people who sent stuff in. There was old stuff drug out of boxes and closets and other people's closets. From World Service office and wherever. There was these stacks of paper and I didn't know what to do with it. Some of the things that happened at that Lit Conference, we talked about what had happened before that, the history up till then and that would be a very interesting thing. That tape exists.

We made a decision and one of the basic premises we worked on the text from was that all the significant points that needed to be included in the Basic Text, were included in an outline called the White Booklet. The White Booklet would serve as the outline for the Basic Text. We actually wrote a different outline, and we cut up material.

Ed was talking about the 12 hour sessions with the scissors. What he didn't tell you was when you get done with the twelve hours of scissors you go somewhere and crash for an hour or two and you come back and do it again. You sit in a session with everybody involved doing all these different tasks and you read and people cry and you can feel something happening, you can feel the process, you can participate in the process.

I want to read a little bit of that first cut and paste. I don't know how much but it started out

> As addicts we have a common bond, we have all felt pain, we felt the numbness, gnawing inadequacy, aching loneliness, separateness from our fellows and feelings of uselessness and self pity.
>
> We've surly had enough of self-destruction.
>
> Somehow in a moment of clarity we were able to look at the whole scene and all its insanity. We stopped fighting and something inside of us said no more.
>
> We lacked real information on what addiction is, what recovery could mean to us. We were in a poor position to judge whether or not we were addicts, each of us faced a dilemma.
>
> We remember going through a lot of pain and despair before considering the possibility the possible connection between drugs and misery.
>
> Eventually drugs ceased to make us feel good.
>
> We tottered on the brink of self-destruction.
>
> All our attempts to stay clean failed.
>
> In our isolation we had lost the things in our lives that were most important to us. We lost all hope and freedom.
>
> We were sick and tired of being sick and tired.
>
> From the start, the theme of NA meetings was recovery.
>
> We all knew how to use drugs.
>
> We knew the effect they had on us.
>
> The primary thing we were interested in was how to stay clean, how to cope with life without drugs. How to handle unpleasant feelings and emotions, in other words, how to recover.
>
> This is why we suggest attending meetings, the same way we used drugs, as often as possible.
>
> Going to NA meetings provides a period of time where we could talk to other addicts about the nature of our addiction, the addict and recovery. We learn we're not alone.
>
> Few of us set out to become addicts, it seems that we were born that way or at some point in our using crossed an invisible line in to addiction expressing itself in our obsessions, compulsions and preoccupations.
>
> Our addiction overrides reason, experience and perception.
>
> We can see a little of our self in every addict.
>
> Addicts are scared; they feel they must be something they are not. They can't stand the future, they can't stand the past and they can't stand still.

> It is the addict's nature to perceive and precipitate crisis, adopt a style of living from crisis to crisis.
>
> Many of us are dependant upon people to carry us emotionally through life, we are often disappointed and hurt when such contacts have other interests, friends and loved ones.
>
> Addiction is a disease not a moral issue.
>
> The addict reacts to drugs in a distorted behavior and compulsively seeks more.
>
> The addict is past the point of no return and must have help in order to gain a normal life without drugs.

I can remember the first time I heard that read, which was at the close at the Lincoln Lit Conference and there were fifty people there crying because, you see, this was real. This had some cohesiveness. This was the beginings for a book, you could touch it, you could hear it, you could see it, you could read it, it was real. Before that it may have been just stacks of paper, bits and pieces that didn't make any sense. Maybe the biggest thing that happened for me in Lincoln was that I began to believe that it could work. I think I'll cut it off there and let other people share about those first couple Lit Conferences. The one after Lincoln was Memphis and maybe this go round should be through Memphis.

Hi, I'm Jim and I'm an addict. Maybe it should be through Memphis, What I feel like is that Memphis is where I really got started, where I really got involved that first time. When I come to some thing like this I've a tendency to stand up here and do my best to put me back there and say well how did you feel? Okay? Probably less so now then five, six years ago. How I would have felt back there is hey, lets get at it.

I want to hear about this history right now, all of it. So put it down, so tell me point by point what happened. Let's not any more of this cosmic bullshit, let's hear it. I think we learned about three things in our literature committee experience as a fellowship, if we communicate and are inclusive, if we let everybody know what's going on and we're willing to take everybody in, something really special can happen, and that was what happened, I'd seen that and wouldn't go, but then somebody came out with one that was good enough for me, these guys finally stumbled along and came up with one good enough for my standards. They discovered that there was something called an offset press machine and then could I get on a plane? I'd read this and hammered everyone around me to do it and hadn't done it myself and on the plane down there, I did it: wrote my story. That was the first time I wrote anything. I was harangued, I was challenged into participating, I wasn't kept away, I wasn't excluded, I was included, that's really important. I had something to offer.

I think spirit of recovery picks the very sickest, the most objectionable of us to share some of the deepest parts of the message, to teach the rest of us about anonymity so if we need the message we ignore the messenger, we don't consider the vehicle, but what's being carried in it and I'm pretty objectionable. I'm pretty pedantic, I'm pretty hard, it's hard to hear what I have to say because of who I am. Because of how I act. Anyway I think that we learn about anonymity, not let that get in our way. I think we learn that if the spiritual purpose of a project is right the talent and the money is always going to be there. Always. If we do something for NA, and our purpose is right, everything that we need is going to be there. What we did was acceptable to the fellowship, it got approved by the fellowship because we were inclusive we practiced functional anonymity and the fellowship did it, we didn't do it, we're nothing, we don't mean a dam thing. The fellowship wrote the book. We didn't write the book and don't every accuse me of being part of writing any book because I didn't you did. The third thing is that the biggest part of that which is what happened among us was much more than the sum of our talents. You couldn't take our credentials, everybody that ever participated in it and add those up and say that this could have been the result of that, it couldn't have been possible. There was something more that happened. Now I'll get cosmic.

I sat down after 18 hours of no sleep, sitting in a group and I saw my hand move without any effort of my own. I even questioned that. Something happens. Memphis, I went down and Bo taught me how to work with him for about three days ahead of that and we delivered an order so we could get there and learn how to work together. It was great, he never got paid for it because he let us work on it. It was shit, Bo was done. But we went to Memphis and sat down and we had our first group conscience. I read this. I didn't know about five other people in the world who could read. It says addict in here. It doesn't say drug addict or alcoholic. It says recovery in here. We went around the room and introduced ourselves and everybody was different. I got angry and slammed my fist on the table - wanted to anyway.

Somebody had to be the son of a bitch to talk about getting the words right and because of my background and a lot of real sick shit about me I took that role, it was extremely important to me that the words were as very precise as they could be. It's a good

thing that there was somebody there like that. For the very first time in the world mankind addressed recovery from addiction. In the written form starting in Memphis.

Mankind addressed the topic of recovery from addiction for the very first time ever. No matter what else had been written with modifiers on it. I thought that was kind of important because I couldn't, when you said you were a drug addict I couldn't hear you. When you said you were an alcoholic I couldn't hear you. When you said you were powerless over a chemical I couldn't hear you. Because I knew that you didn't know. When you called recovery sobriety, and used the terms interchangeably I couldn't hear you because I knew you didn't know. I knew you didn't understand, I knew you couldn't understand. Its not that I rejected you, I didn't reject you, your recovery was just fine whatever you had was just fine it just wasn't recovery.

VI. Archive Search and Define Goals

The archive room was a bustle of activity and was left open for all waking hours. The podium was an open microphone on a subject line. There were several members that hardly ever left the archive room. The copiers were kept humming and many thousands of copies made. This was the place of many deep discussions of times past and things yet to come. Many hugs and tears were traded. This was a place for both the newcomer and the old timer alike. Planes were made for the next event as well as work to be done in the mean time.

In the course of this weekend a hotline call was taken at a members home while returning to get supplies. The person was picked up and taken to the hotel and stayed the weekend. A couple of years later when seen he was still clean.

Many members found it hard to leave. Two ladies from Michigan come to mind. They cried rivers of tears, they were two of the last to leave they just did not want to go home which was the case for most of us.

VII. The Trouble Starts

While the intent was read and many came in an attitude of service and giving some came to decent. For short time the microphone was used to discredit some and the effort. This in no means rained on any ones parade and did not dampen one spirit. It seemed as to be like water on a ducks back. It was there and then it was gone. Yet, looking back it is the first seed of disunity for the committee and its efforts. It would prove to grow and flourish.

A full set of the tapes from this event can be heard or down loaded at www.na-history.org

Chapter Seven

ALLENTOWN HISTORY CONFERENCE

Audio and video tapes along with minutes. Held at Lehigh University in Eastern Pennsylvania. Organized by Billy A.: included Grateful Dave, Bill B., Betty Kinnon, Jim M., Danny W., Bo S. Grover N. and many others.

Lehigh U. had been the site of many large NA functions. We had an excellent meeting room and everyone was comfortable. The universite setting proved to be a quiet and condusive place for the history effort. Hundreds of members showed up from all over the Northern states. The spirit and energy was good and members felt free to share the truth of their experience. Unfortunately, much of this sharing was done on audio and video tapes and the video tapes got lost. The audio tapes are being duplicated by several members in different areas so that we will have copies all over.

[NOTE: In addition to our need to be clear and unambigious about names we have moved forward so rapidly that we will have a review form soon and so we put in only the last initial of living members. - Ed]

History Literature Addathon 1990
Allentown, Pa
Tape One
Opening

Hello Family, my name is Grateful , and I am an addict. Hi Family. Tonight I am (Hold it down John). Tonight I am going to try to stimulate some questions in your minds so that you can ask some of the people that are going to be here a little bit later, to further elaborate on them. I have been called many things; one is an NA Historian and a policy expert. I have done a lot of research that has contributed to some of our longer-term members talks on the history of this fellowship.

I am going to go before pre 50's and just to say that the book of Organizations List of 1942 of Lexington, Ky. The formation of an organization called Narcotics Anonymous, and it does not bear any resemblance to the fellowship that started in Southern California.

There were a number of attempts to do something called Narcotics Anonymous in various forms, in Cleveland, in NYC, in Lexington and all of those efforts failed. There was a group that met in the Lexington Federal Detox down there and that is the earliest knowledge that anybody has as to the use of the name of Narcotics Anonymous. It was basically a group therapy session for ex dope fiends. They had put out this thing called The Key, which was a magazine, a little newsletter and when you go to look at the minutes of the formation of Narcotics Anonymous, which are here. You will see that it says our purpose has been taken from The Key and for a long time that was hidden because of the general obscurity of our documents of our formation. There was a group that operated in New York that was basically sponsored or helped along by the Salvation Army. They operated there from the mid 1940"s until 1952. At the beginning the formation of Narcotics Anonymous and the San Fernando Valley, California was that they contacted this New York organization and the New York organization said " Hey man, we' re doing our own thing and don't want any part of what it is you're doing". So the Narcotics Anonymous that we are all members of evolved independently of that.

When several members and friends of mine were out in California went back to talk to some of the people that were around 20-25 years ago. The story that we were told about the formation of Narcotics Anonymous is, is really interesting. There are several versions of how we got started, but the one that is most number if older members out there was that the H&I coordinator for AA in So. California besieged by a prison warden in So. California and asked

"What can you do for these drug addicts"? The person said, "Well there is nothing we can do, you know there different and they don't recover". Well thanks to the persistence of this warden, he made the H&I coordinator promise that he would look into trying to do something. So what occurred out of that was he knew of a member that was involved and that was a member of Alcoholics Anonymous, who was involved with a program called " Habit forming Drugs" which was trying to help addicts , you know like the ones on the streets. To help them to get clean generally and run them into the AA Meetings. So what happened at the time was this member was kind of hand picked by the H&I coordinator from the AA Fellowship and other members whom this gentleman had knowledge of were picked to form or to try and form something that was independent of Alcoholics Anonymous that would help the addict. That became know as the AA / NA Group. Well that immediately caused some controversy, and this founding one of our founding members Jimmy K. who is now deceased. His wife is still living so I won't , well you'll probably hear all that Jimmy Kinnon as we have some tapes and videos and things like that of talks that Jimmy has given. Some of them the formation of our service structures, how that was formed and the discussions, and we will be looking at many things. Anyway, they called it AA / NA and this guy says we cannot use the AA name. Well of course, an uninformed group conscience then voted it down.

They wanted to keep the affiliation with the organization of Alcoholics Anonymous, so this member Jimmy Kinnon wrote them a letter and said, "Look we want to use, and these people want to use the AA name and attach it to NA and call it AA / NA. It was a letter written from the general service offices in New York stating without and gray areas that they would not allow Narcotics Anonymous to use the AA name. So this gentleman was vindicated and the first meeting to form the fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous, by all the available documents, occurred on August 17, 1953 and the first Recovery Meeting was October 5, 1953. There are copies of the flyer for the first meeting here somewhere. This is not all in order anymore and a copy of the first White Book is here as well. I have all the original literature and stuff at home, but did not realize and I would have had to load up the whole car with stuff to bring it up here. . Here is the sign in sheet for the first Recovery Meeting. There were 17 members who signed in, there may have been more in attendance and here is the flyer "Starting Monday Night October 5, and each Monday hereafter at 8:30. So that is a little bit of interesting stuff about our history. A lot of the meetings at that time, there was like you know people were going to different peoples houses, they carried their coffee cups around with them and they called them "Rabbit Meetings". That was because at the time addicts were being hassled a lot by the local constabulary, so they had to hide. Addicts were scared to come to the meetings because they felt that the meetings were staked out and they might get busted. That happened in New York. They tried to start NA related, to the So. California fellowship in New York. However, the Rockefeller Laws got them, so it was not until 1982 that the first meeting of Narcotics Anonymous was really allowed to exist freely in New York City. New York City today has at last count 1002 meetings a week, and they account for 1/20th of the total population of Narcotics Anonymous. So it has come along way, the power and the message of Narcotics Anonymous is what is most interesting to most of us I suppose. In 1953 to 1956 there was probably at the most 6 meetings that were going at any one time, and in 1959 for a period of about 5 months there were no regular NA Meetings held anywhere in the world. What happened was according to Jimmy Kinnon , one of his tapes was that Narcotics Anonymous had become affiliated with a treatment center and had become a "one man rule".

They were not following the Traditions and so Jimmy K and a few other people decided that they were going to start it back up and get together and carry on and Jimmy K was the only contact knows around the country for Narcotics Anonymous for almost 32 years. He answered the phone and used all his money to Xerox literature talked to people on the phone night and day. He never wanted to be a Bill Wilson or a founder. He believed that he was just an instrument being used as apart of an idea in his service was service to God, and was service to the principles and it didn't matter to him . There were many stories of Jimmy K and a newcomer and a coffee pot for years. He would always go and find somebody and bring them into a meeting for years, and it was not until about 1956 that the first Narcotics Anonymous literature was printed. That was odd, odd reading version of what we call today the White Book. It is very different and unfortunately, I do not have it with me. It is interesting that the printing was done and then Narcotics Anonymous died.

So they started back up in 1959 and then they published another White Book without stories. The Board of Trustees was established in about 1965, and nobody knows for sure why except that it was felt that they needed a larger base

from which to make their decisions, and by then the number of meetings had increased by that time to about eight or 9 meetings. In 1966, there were approximately 10 meetings they started. The two family members of the Magdalino family were feuding over wanting to retain the AA literature in the NA Meetings. There was a big resentment that occurred, interesting how growth correlates with conflict and resentments. They took and went up to San Francisco and started some NA Meetings up there, then there was another split, and the San Diego Meetings got started.

Tomorrow late, there will be a guy here who was around for the formation of the fellowship in San Diego who has about 30 years clean. Therefore, we are going on and we are up to about 1970, but in 1968 let me say that there was the "Voice of NA" newsletter printed and basically that was just to tell stories, share on events and it was published locally. I have copies of that at home and I am sorry I am just not real prepared. I do have copies of every World Service Conference, the minutes and fellowship reports, all the reports and literature up until 1985; I have the rest at home. I just brought this here with me because it is history and most of us know what happened from '85 on, professional contracts and junk like that.

At any rate, they decided to o-pen an office so the general service organization, they called the GSO and that was basically, what they had been doing the same old thing for years and years. Jimmy K had been answering the phones, putting out literature, detoxing members and new people from "Cry Help" and other detox and treatment facilities from around the valley, to help out and put things together.

So in 1970 we are up to about 20 meetings a week. Now, where were you in 1970? I know where I was, I was full blown on the streets of Haight Ashbury. So it is interesting that in 1970 that we only had about 20 meetings in the whole world. I guess this is significant because as we start to come up over the next 15 years we will see some interesting things that historically may just be a historical event, maybe no spiritual significance to it, but just the beginning of literature. Well along about 1970 or 1971 there started to be what they called a Trustee Literature Committee, where they started to write which was really a very small venture. They started to write literature with the folks who hung around the office. The office was run out of Jimmy K's. house for years and years right up until 1982, late '82. It was operated out of this mans house. We need to know, we need to know that there was somebody who had the commitment and dedication to Narcotics Anonymous. To sit there for 30 years when nothing was happening. I mean you know we find it hard to sit still for 30 minutes, we find it hard to to stay committed for 30 days. So I think we are looking at what commitment means. Yes, it is a Just for Today program for the rest of our lives.

The choice is ours, it has always been ours. So along about this time choices are starting to be made, somebody comes up with a bright idea like let us have a World Convention, so they had a World Convention in LaMarada, California in 1970 and that is at the 20th anniversary or there about…..NoNoNo, yeah we are getting close. The reason I say we are getting close is because we have tapes. We have tapes from the 20th and the 23rd anniversaries of Narcotics Anonymous in which some of the founding members speak and hopefully they will be available for you to either listen to or purchase at some point during the course of this Addathon weekend.

So they had a World Convention, I am sure it was very well attended, like maybe from what I understand. There were about 150 people there at the first World Convention and at the third there were about 300 people tops. Therefore, we are looking at Southern California and Northern California fellowships with no meetings outside of the state of California at this time, and that was that. I mean everyone knew one another; it would be like going to a convention in my home region in West Virginia. You know there are 250 or 300 people and you get to hug everybody. Therefore, everybody knew one another and generally, everyone was participating in each other's recovery.

So between 1971 and 1975 they formed the 1st. Area Service Committee. They opened a World Service Office on Crenshaw Blvd. that did not last to long. From what I understand, it was just opened for a little while and then it reverted back to Jimmy K's. house again. So we are talking 1972, there are probably 70 to 80 meetings in the world, and most of those meetings being in Southern California still. Along about 1972- 1973 somebody in Georgia got hold of a White Book and started some meetings down there. This began the fellowship on the East Coast. Same way it happened in Philadelphia. Philadelphia and Atlanta are the oldest East Coast NA fellowships; with interestingly

enough I think Spartanburg, South Carolina and Keyport, Pennsylvania. Some other very non descript, oddball off the way places out of the way places got a White Book and started a meeting. Addicts were really hungry for something. AA at the time was not in competition with Narcotics Anonymous. They just said "You don't share that shit in here boy" or girl and if you want to talk about that, you gotta go, and it is still that way today. In my home state in a lot to the rural places you do not go to an AA meeting, because they tell you "You don't belong here". Today there is an alternative, and some good people guide you to that alternative, which is Narcotics Anonymous. However, at the time addicts were kind of floundering around in a sea of nothing. It is as if you do not belong here, well then where do I belong. Well they say addicts do not get better, you are supposed to die, and that was the climate.
Therefore, we have had a struggle, and we have had to really fight for the existence of Narcotics Anonymous all throughout our history. That fight and that struggle are still occurring today in the emerging fellowships around the world. You look in reports from Columbia, Brazil and places like that. Wow, we think about 20,000 meetings and ¾ million addicts in the fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous today. You spread that out on a planet of 6 billion people and you get an idea of the work there is to do. There is not anywhere on the face of this earth that the disease of addiction does not exist. Therefore, we really have a lot of work to do in quote, unquote evangelizing the world of Narcotics Anonymous. Therefore, that is why we need members to be connected today.

What was true 30 years ago will be true 30 years from now. We are just part of a legacy, of a wave, we are pawns and God is revealing himself through the principles and through
the power and majesty of our 12 Steps and 12 Traditions. In 1975 a member who had almost three years clean or 4 years clean at the time got together with Jimmy K and said " Well why don't we have a service structure"? So they started out talking about it and went through all the AA service structure stuff like that and came up with this document here called the NA Tree. This was our first service structure and it is really quite simple, it was quite efficient and quite effective, maybe we need to return to something that simple, it was based on the 12 Steps and 12 Traditions.

The difference between our fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous and our evolution as a fellowship is in terms of our service structure. Now I want to make a statement here, that if you look at our Steps and Traditions, all of our steps and all of our traditions are about service. If you look in the front of the Basic Text, you will see what they call a service symbol and it talks about service. When we serve and attract more members, we attract the base of the pyramid, the more we attract the higher the sides, the higher the point of freedom, the higher we are able to go in our own personal recovery.

So our fellowship was found and based upon the 12 Traditions and Principles, our Steps and Traditions are all principles, our Steps and Traditions , out Traditions, our Steps, they all point in one direction, and that's selfless service. That is reasons for serving other than for self. So our service structure and our fellowship are based on Principles of service.

Conversely, AA was founded as a marketing tool for the publication written by its two founding members that was called the AA Big Book. They started out and their entire organization and service structure was written differently and founded differently. Their fellowship grew as a result of marketing the Big Book. I mean if we are talking about history, we have to talk about history. There were parallel, their gross and things like that, which were going on, but its interesting to see at what point we begin the separation. That was Gods way of possibly making our message of recovery available to more people.

The Traditions were not written for 20 years. They were a fellowship for 20 years without the Traditions. The 12 Concepts of Service were written 12 to 14 years later. So their entire fellowship and their entire structure evolved from a different spirit, a different place, a different growth. I am not making a value judgment, certainly what they do works fine for them. One of the exciting things that come from being a member of Narcotics Anonymous is the creative spirit of God that has always been involved in our development.

We said necessarily that we need to be different, because we need to have a different identification. So people with multiple substance abuse problems and that are all it was at the time, it was not like the disease of addiction and the

philosophy of the disease concept that is growing in acceptance of Narcotics Anonymous. It was more or less, as if you know it says in order to do H&I work in Narcotics Anonymous you had to be an alcoholic, a barbiturate addict or a narcotic addict. I mean that is right here. That was the requirement for being able to serve in the fellowship in the beginning. So it is interesting how the refinement of our message is beginning to exhibit itself.

We are finally gathering in numbers larger than ten at a time through the World Service Conference. That first World Service Conference, all the documents and information from that first World Service Conference is right here. That was bigger than the second one because they had the 2nd and 3rd ones in conjunction with the World Convention. They decided that was a mistake that everyone wanted to party, so the World Service Conference got off to a rather shaky start.

In 1977-78, there was a person on the East Coast who will be here probably in the next forty or fifty minutes that was scratching his head saying, "How come we don't have a book"? And "Why can't we have a book"? You know why do we have to keep scratching out the word alcohol in this Large Book (laughter). It is the puzzlement, you know a real puzzlement but the popular school of thought at the time is that addicts could not write. You know, I mean, addicts could not write. Addicts, using addicts, wrote some of our greatest literature. You look at Hemingway and Poe; I mean the list is endless. So the idea that clean addicts could not write is a little bit far fetched.

So at any rate we are getting to the point when there is a stirring in the breast of Narcotics Anonymous, a yearning for an identity. Now that we are seeing that, we cannot mature in the shadows of another fellowship. That we must begin to risk, we must begin to stand on the principles that we have been taught and that we have been listening to in our meetings. Okay and you can imagine the fear, the excitement, and the controversy from the very beginning of Narcotics Anonymous, and controversy is where we grow.
The first step is controversy in me when I walked in here and you told me that I was powerless over a disease called addiction. That I have to change my whole fucking life. I will tell you that all I thought was conflict (laughter). At my first NA Meeting, there was a fight in the parking lot over the AA Big Book and the Hazelton literature not being in Narcotics Anonymous. I said "What's this about" and they explained it to me and I said "Alright, Yeah". So that is how I came to Narcotics Anonymous, in the midst of conflict. Therefore, along about 1976, the conflict began this conflict between the past and growth, the past and the future and it ripped the fellowship apart. Because 99% of the people that were clean at that particular point in the history of Narcotics Anonymous got clean somewhere besides Narcotics Anonymous.

There were not enough meetings for them to do 90 in 90 in Narcotics Anonymous, even to the point of having to drive seventy-five miles one-way two nights a week to get my 90 in 90.

Today recovery is so convenient, we say, "Oh well there is not a meeting in our neighborhood" (laughter) or "Oh well, it's where I use to cop, you know people, places and things". However, it is down in them ghettos in them war zones that the 12th Step is all about. That is where it is about, it is about going out where no one wants to go, and doing the work. That is what Narcotics Anonymous has always been and not anything else is the spirit of Narcotics Anonymous.

It's convenience, being comfortable, that bothers me. When I begin to get comfortable and people begin to tell me how comfortable, I am and boy, I feel great. When I hear it out in meetings, well I have been sitting around long enough in meetings to know that the people who are comfortable are out the door soon. Because if I am growing, there is always some internal conflict going, because I have to continue to step beyond the limitations of my present reality that is always a source of conflict. We are the creators in the group conscience; we are the creators of our own destiny.

If we rely on the past and are afraid of the future, then we will never grow as a fellowship. We have begun to reach that point in Narcotics Anonymous today. Where our growth in the United States has stabilized, whether people are saying we don't need to do all the work or we don't need to be involved in service, you know after all I have a home group and group conscience.

Our attitudes, our viewpoints have shrunk somewhat. When I got clean every single addict that walked through the door was a precious commodity. Every single addict that walks in the door today is still a precious commodity in the sight of God. So this is the spirit, this is the spirit that spelled our growth, the spirit that made people stand up and get punched in a meeting saying" We need our own literature, we need our own book".

So I want to tell a little bit, but I do not want to take the story away from the guy who is going to be here to tell it. He went to California with three years clean and said, "Hey, Who's working on the book, Oh Luke what are you doing about the book"? There was a guy there with a bunch of years clean and said "What are you gonna do about the book, what are you gonna do"? One of these days, one of these days, one of you are going to write. So nothing was happening so he hooked up with this other guy and they sat and talked about the book. The next year they came back to the World Convention and this guy that had said "What about the book, what about the book" says "I got 160 pages" and the guy said "I got to go take a shower", so he said "Well I'll go with you"…So essentially some little three year clean newcomer high on swamp gas from Georgia was basically responsible for a movement that changed the face of the history of Narcotics Anonymous.

Now, everybody was participating in one way or another in that movement, but pointing fingers and saying "You guys are out of your minds…you'll never succeed, you are destined to fail, this is self will". Se it is the same old song, it is the same old story that has been used capriciously for years. But the text got written. You know how it got written? People had to hitch hike, they had to sell their cars, and they sold their blood to rent the typewriters, to buy the paper, to rent the facility. This was what was going on. Addicts died, addicts left NA saying, "Oh you guys don't like AA no more, and there is so much controversy, I'm going back to AA". Hey, you know that is just the way the cookie crumbles, you know what I mean. Some people were willing to stand on what they believed. Rightly or Wrongly you know and I respect people who stand on what they believe and are not blown by the winds of people pleasing and " If I get someone to like me I'll get a position" and all that.

I am trying to stimulate, so when these people share over the course of this weekend you will ask some probing questions. You will try to pull (grunting) pull that little extra effort out of yourself and out of the people who are standing at the podium and talking to you.

The 1st World Literature Conference was held in 1979 in Wichita, Kansas, right after the World Convention, and lit. People jumped in the car to get over there. I mean it was really a special time in Narcotics Anonymous.

I got clean about two months after the Basic Text was published, and the spirit of the fellowship at that time and the feeling that was involved in our services and the excitement that was spread far and wide, right across the face of Narcotics Anonymous brings goose bumps and rushes to me today.

So we are looking at the 1st World Literature Conference, we are looking at about 450 meetings in the whole world. Now it is interesting how the growth begins to accelerate at this point. When they got the Grey Book, I do not know if you have ever seen it, but it is like a big old book with numbers down the side and got some funny language in it and stuff like that. But it was the 1st Basic Text. By the time that was approved by review and input happened in Memphis... That Memphis copy was printed and developed and brought to the fellowship, there was 1100 meetings, from 400 in two years to 1100. Okay, we are going to watch, were going to watch this wild explosion of growth in Narcotics Anonymous, because hey maybe because we were starting to stand for something. Maybe we were beginning to breathe excitement and enthusiasm, maybe there were even more people who said" I ain't going back there, I don't have to; I can recover in Narcotics Anonymous... Look we have a book" and we have been working on this book. Boy, it was exciting.

So in, 1982 they had done all their work on the review and input, and they came out with this little tiny book about this thick, called the approved copy of the Basic Text. That was the first 10 chapters of the Basic Text, no stories, stories were put together later in the publication that was sent around. But in 1982 at the World Service Conference, they approved the, the approval copy of the Basic Text without stories. The stories were circulated after the 1982

World Service Conference and came in, they did not get a chance to go through the group conscience process but they were included in the publication of the Red Book, which was the Special edition. Interestingly enough in the Grey Book there was some language about the Traditions that was included and in the approval copy, that same language was included. That is what the group voted on and Wow interestingly enough when the Red Book came out their were stories but the language was gone. So that is why we had three editions of the Basic Text in a year. Three editions, the approval copy, the Red Book and the First edition. Before the conf3erence in 1983, they started to print the 2nd. Edition. The first printing of the 2nd Edition was done. At the World service Conference in '83, the fellowship showed out in mass. Why did you take that stuff out of the book? The fellowship went, and the conference went (Deliberate stuttering) (Laughter).

So they said let's put it back in. So the 2nd printing of the 2nd Edition, ok they had paste over, they pasted the original Tradition language back in, in the 4th and 9th Traditions. In the 3rd printing of the 2nd Edition all without paste over. Well guess what, in the year 1983 we had four printings of the Basic Text. We had the 2nd Edition 1, 2, 3, then we had the 3rd and interestingly enough that "weird language was gone again. I mean you know at some point to go hmmmm, why bother. So you know they printed the 3rd Edition for the remainder of the conference. Here then in 1984 the 3rd Edition Revised changes were brought to the World Service Conference in form of a proposal be the Trustees to change the stories in the little White Book and to change the language in the little White Book. Okay so that went up for a year to the fellowship, all the groups in Narcotics Anonymous voted on these changes to the White Book. A motion was made {hey its here, its you know what I am telling you is all here}. OK in 1982, they were saying that Phil Perez who was the office Board of Directors chair at the time said, "Gee, there was a printing error". We have heard that one before. You know between the approval copy and the Red Book and then there is other letters in there from the chairman of the World Service Branches. But the problem, the problem we found ourselves in today with literature is literature is money. The World Service Office did not have any money until we had a book, until we had a book. We did not have any meetings, if we did not have any meetings, people did not get clean. So we got a book. Now so from the book, from '83 we got today there was 1,100 meetings, today we got maybe 22,000 worldwide. We have grown folks and with growth come growing pains. If you can remember how when you were growing up the knee hurt, or the elbow or something like that you know. We have to look at our fellowship kind of like a growing body. You know part of it grows faster than other parts, just like us, our own personal recovery. In our own personal journey of growing up to be adults. There are growing pains along the way; one thing grows a little faster. My gosh, you have to have a party to introduce your pants to your ankles about once a year. So I mean we must understand that with all of the growth that we are coming to, were going to have some problems. There is absolutely nothing wrong with the program of Narcotics Anonymous, I want to make that abundantly clear. Now the program of Narcotics Anonymous is the 12 Steps and 12 Traditions that is what the program is. The fellowship is a bunch of people you know and service outside of the group is service outside the group.

I think what the people in World Services were so hot about then or hot about today is because today the 4th and 9th Traditions made it very clear that our service boards, committees, offices, conventions, and fundraisers were not Narcotics Anonymous. There were other people that disagreed with that, but the Group Conscience said it was.

So here, we are today all these years later with the 5th Edition of the basic Text, and now current philosophy has it that the 4th Edition was approved, fellowship approved. No, the 4th Edition was not, it was never approved. The World Service Conference said no we do not want the 4th Edition. Not only did they say we do not want the 4th Edition, but they did not approve the 5th Edition either.

So we are talking about a rather checkered history, were talking about a lot of manipulation, were talking about a lot of control, and were talking about a lot of things that occurred in the course of our development that goes on underneath, away in the shadows. That you the general member, the person that goes to meetings do not get a chance to see, a chance to know, why. Ok that is the purpose of what we are doing here tonight, is for the fellowship to know. That is the reason for the history of Narcotics Anonymous, is for the fellowship to know. See because its not reality to say that everything that happens in Narcotics Anonymous is spiritual or hunkey doorey. You know it is just not real.

As an addict I am most comfortable with the truth, you know you take my dope and shoot ya(laughter). You tell me the truth and I can deal, but if you flim flam something up and make it real pretty and it's more half-truth and innuendo I am not going to be able to deal with it responsibly.

So part of the problem has been we have no accurate history. The good the bad and the ugly. If you were wrong, it is highly unlikely that you are going to a forum such as this and admit that you are wrong. But until this occurs, until the truth is told for everybody there we're never going to know the good things we did, the mistakes we've made , the paths we have walked down and ended up in blind alleys. The World Service Office has been offered all of the archives from the beginning, but they said if you give them to us, they are ours and we will do with them what ever we choose. Cannot do that with our literature you know. So I got right here like back in 1979 when people were begging for a literature to be written.

Here it is 1990, we are just getting started, and it is going to be great. We can sit around the table and listen to all of these old timers point fingers at one another and transcribe it all down, and put it out, and it will be beautiful. Because we will learn from that, and old-timers quote, unquote will grow from that, There are people that were invited to this function that are not showing up here, not showing up because they like to do their deeds in the dark. They don't want the truth told because it will make then look bad. But I have to deal with the truth in my life you know. Yeah that is right old Grateful Dave went and slapped somebody at the area service, boy he's real spiritual (laughter). You know I got to learn what I got to learn, and I got to go through what I got to go through, and we got to go through what we got to go through, you know. I have been coming here to this area for five and a half years. I've been sitting on the porch down the street and I've been talking about Narcotics Anonymous. I have been involved with World Service and service to this fellowship since my second day clean. Second day I was in a group conscience meeting and fifth day clean I was in a regional formation meeting and my fortieth day clean I was in a World P.I Workshop. My seventieth day clean I was in a penthouse with Trustees and the World Convention Group. What is this all about, tell me this, tell me that. So service in Narcotics Anonymous is what it is, because without service we have no spirit. We have no soul, and with no soul we ain't going to grow, and people are going to come through our meetings and go "This is a phoney baloney bunch". You know talking a bunch of good sounding bullshit, giving each other thumbs up and saying, "yeah you sound good, right on man". So we got to get down in the trenches and do some work, we got to try to quit trying to make everything so pretty. We got the truth, the truth is not always pretty but the truth will set us free.

There is a lovely lady that just walked in that is going to do the next section. She use to work at World Service Offices, she knows a lot of the old people. She has lived in California and as God has graced us with her presence here tonight. I have come to know this lady and I know she loves Narcotics Anonymous and I know she is dedicated. I know she is here because she wants the truth to be told.

So I have given you some things to think about and some questions maybe to ask over the course of this weekend and to ask yourself as well as the people who participate here. . But it all begins and ends in the Home Group and we are at the midnight hour and I have talked a lot. I could talk a lot more (laughter) and not repeat myself. Well I do not think that would be real fair. I will say you know it is one thing to listen to people who sound good you know and I know how to sound good, but what I am interested in seeing in my life is people that live good. People whose mouth lines up with their feet. If they tell you they are going to do something, you see them doing it. You know it is great to sit on the sidelines and point fingers but it is useless. Controversy is apart of life, a division of cells, the formation of the universe, conflict, conflagration. So I am looking forward to a weekend that will stimulate my desire to know. I have never been one that shrank from conflict, hopefully our fellowship will not and we will do the job, telling our history. The truth, the whole truth and nothing but the truth because you cannot edit history and you cannot change history. We only hear one thing in our NA Media, what the NA Media wants us to hear….Good Night (Applause)

Questions and Answers:
Please, please, we got time for a few questions. You will have to come to the microphone. We will not entertain any questions that are not addressed in line at the microphone. That will be rigor of the course over the entire weekend. I would like to say that I became a repository for information like a computer chip with about three years clean. I knew

everything and could repeat it. You know but what I learned today was just stuff that I learned and stuff I can repeat. But I have done research on it. So kind of like with the Steps, the steps became something that came alive to me when I quit trying to sound good with them and tried to learn to live them. So let us have our future in Narcotics Anonymous. Are there any questions to the microphone?

Q: Hi, my name is Greg. (Hi, Greg) I found it interesting you were talking about the qualifications of service. Is there any history as to the efforts of the name change? To be changed when the progress became all in the addiction and the disease of addiction. As opposed to just narcotics in NA.

A: Yeah, several attempts have been made to alter the name of the Fellowship. But the name of the fellowship has so much history that there has not been any real serious or what you would say successful attempts to change the name. There have been splintered groups called Drugs Anonymous, Pills Anonymous in New York but they were not necessarily a splintered group of Narcotics Anonymous. They existed before the fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous was able to be in public in New York. As soon as Narcotics Anonymous came busting in the World Convention there these other groups began to decline in membership and respect. Basically because they were so similar in their substance specific or symptomatic approach to recovery. Where Narcotics Anonymous approach top recovery is a holistic approach deals with the whole person rather than the symtomology and that makes our fellowship an evolving message unique today. It was not that way when we started out, it was very drug oriented. Did I get it all? There were addicts anonymous that was started a few times. It started out in Philadelphia with some disgruntled Narcotics Anonymous members. I know there have been other attempts as there was an addict in California, a couple of other attempts you know.

The question was, was there any attempts to form another fellowship. To change the name of Narcotics Anonymous to be more consistent with the approach to recovery. To be from the disease of addiction. In the past, there were some attempts to do that but there were not for that particular reason. Maybe in the future there will be other attempts that will be done for that reason. To more accurately reflect the exact principles in our steps and traditions. I do not know if I will be supportive of that, you know. I know too much about this fellowship and the evolution of this fellowship is exciting enough.

Q. I am an addict named Lawrence (Hi Lawrence)…My question was that in your research have you run into or run across with any meetings or something's that going sort of along as a meeting. As in (ANDA) meetings? It is kind of like an AA / NA meeting. Have you run across an of that in your research.

A. (laughter) As a matter of fact I have. Recently yet if you go in the northeast corridor in the large metropolitan areas you will find that (ANDA) is for the most part in these large metropolitan areas, except for a few of the old groups are very much (ANDA) what we can call (ANDA) fellowships. And an also (laughter) in California and in some places in the northeast corridor and around in the larger metropolitan areas, Minnesota for example Narcotics Anonymous is an (ANDA) fellowship. That I think well points up rather clearly the phenomena of the message of the recovery in Narcotics Anonymous being more or less a southeastern, Southeastern United States and Midwestern effort. I think partially evolved because we were sent White Books and there was not a 25-year sober guy hanging and saying "Well look this is really the way it is kid". We had to figure out what recovery from addiction was and what the desire to stop using meant. Because we were rejected by Alcoholics Anonymous, but there are rows of competition between the fellowship on the East Coast. That said hey there ain't no recovery over there, you got to come over here. We got into it too, we got into it too now, were not little" well you cannot go over there, sober hmm hmm hmm(laughter), and in California they just don't have a clue(laughter) you know and they go wherever they go and it don't matter…Really.

But it is interesting that the 1st purist movement in the fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous started in southern California in the Los Angeles area. There were members whom our next speaker knows that were completely, what we would call today, pure NA members. They talked clean, they only went to NA Meetings, and that is really marvelous. You know we have a heritage of purism in this fellowship.

Q: Who gets the money (laughter)? What are their names and who determines that our money is used to build buildings instead of putting out more books and who determines the cost of our books and our literature?

A: (laughter) Well lets see they have not changed the price of the Basic Text since 1983, so that particular price was set along time ago. Obviously, you and I up until the present have not been able to determine the price of our literature or where the money goes. (sigh) ( ) how to explain this in the short form. Most addicts see World Service as being one entity and their not. We have the World Service Office, which is a corporation that is producers and holders of a fiduciary relationship for our copyrights, which means that they are held in trust. They are the ones that print, publish and distribute our literature. Well that has not always been the case. Before areas, regions and groups printed, developed, and distributed literature and that similar to a grass roots type of thing that is going on today. The money goes to the corporation. Whether the corporation is using that money in a what that we as a fellowship feels is responsible or not is a matter for great study and debate and for conscience both individual and group. But knowledge is the forunner of making a decision. The volunteer service structure has a gross income last year of $280.000.00 , the corporation had an income of 5 million that is basically generated from the sale of our literature in which 43% of all total volume of the sales is sold to outside enterprises. Outside of the fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous, Hazelden and Comcare purchase their literature at $5.23 for a Basic Text where as the New York Regional Service Office pays forty cents more. So our office is selling the literature 40% to 43% of its funds to outside vendors cheaper than it is selling to the fellowship.

It costs about a quarter of a cent to produce to produce the Triangle of Self Obsession, and it costs you about 13 cents. It costs half a cent to produce a key tag and about 26 cents to produce a tape, twenty cents for a medallion $1.47 for a Basic Text. You get the idea that is where the money goes. We have expanded the World Service Office in the past two years from 18 paid employees in 1987 to a current staff of 48 fulltime employees. Everywhere they go, they go on airplanes, they have credit cards, expense accounts and maybe that is something we want to do and maybe its not. Because our 9th Tradition says that, we may create service boards and committees directly responsible. The flip side we may not create them or we may UN create them or we may modify the relationship of special workers to the service structure. But until you know, know what I mean. It's the getting bad dope when you were first getting high you know, you thought it was great until you got some good and then you didn't want anything else. It is like so really the fellowship owns everything. You everybody in this room own the copyrights, they are yours, they are ours, every staple every chair you know. So it is up to us to know what to do with it (Audience laughter) no simple answer to it, no short answers to any of these questions.

Q; How would you suggest that the fellowship at large organize to demand and accounting for monies and direct impact on some changes. That us the fellowship at large would want concerning the areas of copyright, new material, impact of the material, selection of officers and find out what the basic requirement to be a member of this committee is?

A; Well, there is a number of things we can do. Since 1982, we have been going to the World Service Conference as a block asking for dialogue, and accountability. There has not been the accountability or allowance of any substantial or significant dialogue as to the pertinent issues that you raise, the questions you asked.

This World Conference was the worst in memory, I mean depending on where you sit. I mean if you sit on the World Board Committee they got everything they wanted. If you look at the fellowship the news, line the NA Way I mean you know you can see. How the truth and the RSR and people who were at the World Service Conference how the truth has been manipulated to make people who want to engage with such discussion as you put forth in the question appear to be zealots, hitlers out to destroy the fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous. With no reason to you know, I mean that is what our NA media has been used for. It has been to isolate us from one another. The world Service Conference in here they told us that they said the regions on the east Coast made 150 motions; well we made less than thirty. The actual truth so the point is they aint listening. They want no dialogue, what can we do?

It is called Grass Roots you know, go to your Home Group, discuss these things, make a decision on what it is you would like to do you know. I mean we can try to continue to try to work Quote, unquote within the structure, which I

support entirely. But there are other things that we can do that are not necessary entirely within the structure, as we know it. As it exists that, we can do. I see some of that in your bag; you know I mean you want cheaper literature and cheap Basic Text, "Print um that's all".

Send a message that we do not like it, they aint going to listen to nothing but the pocketbook. I'll tell you that they have spent 15 thousand dollars of your money sending legal cease and desist orders around the fellowship in the past thirty days, federal expressing apologies because at $14.00 a pop because of that so you know the hand is on the nuts, if you want to put your hand on and squeeze a little bit maybe we can change something.

Q: Hi I'm an addict, my name is Arlene.(Hi Arlene).. I am confused you said that the 4th and 5th Edition are not WS approved. Am I correct ,ok. What is , why do we use it or I mean is that why we use it. I mean is that why we use it because they didn't approve it and its what we want?

A: That's a good question, why do we use literature that was not approved by the entire fellowship. I don't know, I mean that's a question to discuss in conscience. If you look and you research the history of the members of the WS Conference you will see that the 4th Edition, because that is why we have a 5th Edition, but they never voted to have another edition of the text. There was a discussion, which is in plain document for everybody to see that substantiates what I say. So what they have done is sold you a book that was professionally edited and made presentable, with a glossary put in tit so it would be palatable for treatment centers. If you take and compare the 4th Edition Revised with that edition, they take out some very controversial statements about recovery from the disease of addiction. And we need to have more money and more literature, and let us do it faster and better, I mean you are asking me, I am telling you, you know. That is a matter for you to go home and say, well look you know. Give us somebody who has the information I mean lots of people can talk, and lots of people talk real good, and are persuasive but if they cant back up what they are talking about don't listen to them.

(Audience) In the book here, it says that this is NA Conference literature, and it says NA in the NA Way are regular trademarks of the WSO. What is conference approved literature, I mean are all the pamphlets we have, are those all conference approved or WS approved? Some say this, some say that.

A: The WS Conference is a group of 75 votes that may or may not reflect the wishes of the fellowship. The fellowship is the Home Groups and the conference is the conference. We gave the conference approved logo stamps for all our literature from the very beginning when we got a conference. We had literature before see, so you know the question is whether conference approved is fellowship approved, or whether its conference approved, because there is a lot of things that happened on the floor of the WS Conference, that do not coincide with what you and I believe or do in our Home Group. We say that is Group Conscience and move that up. You know a lot of things happen, quick fixes, people think they know what is best for NA, on the floor of the WS Conference and they just act in a lot of people's views capriciously.

(Audience) I know when I read the Basic Text some of it is not very palatable to me. It is very hard for me to concentrate because I can not relate to a lot of it. You know this is my opinion, when you get into something like this I can relate to something more like this, you know rather than the technical jargon. Even though I am in the medical profession that does not matter, you know. Its still something that I want one on one and I guess that something that comes back to what can we do, you know. Thank you

Q: I want to thank you for the NA History. I heard the tape you did in Florida about the checkered past. Our Basic Text had a few other things , its always nice to learn a few things but you know like again maybe you can give me some history, maybe like why WSO , WSC, or what our service structure has done right, because all I am hearing is what they do wrong. Maybe you can shed some light on that.

A: Well our Service structure from the very beginning has been there basically to answer the telephone. Right now, that is what the WS Office does real well. They answer the telephone real well and they ship literature pretty well, most of the time. They disseminate information and they refer calls to PI and things like that. They do that stuff pretty

well, I guess it is the nature of the nature that we all have. It is like when things are working real well we don't want to fix it, you know. Its not the things that are being done you know that are correct, that need fixing, or maybe even so much discussion. There is a lot of good that has been done by the WS and it is still continuing to be done by the WS. It is not those things that need to be changed.

Tape Two
Allentown Addathon 1990
Fawn- speaker

(un- clear beginning) NA World Services work right away and I resigned in '82, after a series of things happened I just decided I didn't want to be apart of it anymore. So I not only resigned from service but I moved out of California (laughter) and I came out East and I've been very happy and stayed clean ever since. So I really am not, I have not stayed active with World Service since 1982. I hear stories, and I hear things and it has changed so much that it is overwhelming at times to get a clear understanding of what is going on anymore. It would be nice to see it all come together and make sense again. What I have done, or what I did a few months ago was I put together, as best I could a history of NA from Jimmy's notes and tapes. I was a very good friend of Jimmy's, I also spoke with his wife, a few of his other friends, and I put together a history. It is not complete but I think I would like to share it with you because I think it might give you a picture of what NA use to be like and you will see for yourself how much it is grown and how far we have come.

You know about a month ago I was asked to go up to Massachusetts to give a NA History, a big NA History function they had and it was really pretty funny. My girlfriend and I flew up there, the flight was about 45 minutes, and we drove around in this addict's car for about three and a half hours. He was trying to track down his ex-wife and his kids and at one point, we had three addicts in a car, three children and two cats, it was really wild. Because that night in a room about this big it was a history workshop on the region, the area up there and then the history of NA. I was the last, I had all of this wonderful information, I had all of these archival knick-knacks you know, and I invited people to come and look at them. The only question anybody has was "Who gets the credit for the first meeting in their area"? During the dance what happened was shuffling all my papers together and going back to my seat I dropped one of my, one of my original copies of the first white pamphlet on the floor and I did not know it. So in the middle of the dance, on a crowded dance floor some girl comes up to me and she goes Hey is this yours. So you know it was an experience for me you now but maybe people were not ready to hear it and I don't think it was just like being in the twilight zone.

It is good to be in a room where the people are familiar with some of the issues anyway. So what I will do is since I was not here in 1953, I mean I was born in 1954. I had to write this down so I want to be a thorough as I can with the information that I have. Betty, Jimmy's wife you know has invited me to come out and sort through file cabinets and file cabinets of stuff that she has this simmer. I hope to get out there and help her with it but, so you guys want to hear this, then when I get into NA I can sort of adlib it a little bit.

Prior to August of 1953 and before NA as we know it came into existence; there were organizations and groups throughout the United States who were trying to do something for drug addicts. Many of you might have heard about many of these groups. The programs in Louisville, KY and New York City were started by concerned citizens, prison officials, the Salvation Army volunteers, and even the D.A. Some of these groups adopted the 12 Steps of AA and some made variations to the 12 Steps and inserted new language of their own. However, these groups and organizations bare little resemblance to the structure and meaning of the Narcotics Anonymous we have all come to know. During the 50's in the southern California area groups known as HFD groups, habit-forming drugs were scattered throughout and there was a group that called themselves Addicts Anonymous. However, these groups eventually died out for many reasons. Two of the reasons in particular were that they did not abide by the 12 Traditions that AA were using, or they were considered to be run like a one man show.

The NA in New York City that started up in the 1950 has published a pamphlet for drug addicts entitled "Our Way of

Life and introduction to NA". This pamphlet was printed at the Rikers Island print shop and in this pamphlet; there is an excerpt that reads, "The National Advising Council on Narcotic Inc., a group of civic minded citizens sincerely interested in this problem, function as a Board of Directors for Narcotics Anonymous. The function of the board is to direct, guide and coordinates Narcotics Anonymous Groups. Obviously, this was not the birth of NA, as we know it. If you call the World Service Offices today and ask who Jimmy Kinnon was, you will be told he was a nice man who helped NA a lot. But the truth is our history begins with him.

For years he was the first and sometimes the only NA voice many addicts all of the world heard. He could touch people and give them hope like they have never had before. There was something very magical about the way Jimmy carried the message. When people got close to him, their natural inclination was to recover. Jimmy K was three years sober in Al-anon and very involved in what was known, or what is still known as the Radford Clubhouse of AA in Studio City, California. He was on their Board of Directors and was very involved I service work in AA. Jimmy by trade was a roofer and very often did roofing work for the clubhouse. Jimmy and other AA members would go down to skid row to 12 Step the alcoholics. When they were doing work with addicts, however they observed that addicts were not identifying with what they were talking about. Jimmy was quoted as saying that one kid in particular told him, I just cannot buy this stuff, I am not an alcoholic. Others felt the same way, the people Jimmy made friends with were addicts like himself. So many of his friends were dying. Jimmy and his fellow 12 Step callers knew the addict they were trying to help were not making it. He knew there must be a way of adapting the steps to other specific causes. He heard about a guy called Danny Carlson who ran a program, but the program wasn't the same. They were not anonymous and they admitted they had problems with hard-core drugs. He thought then that there should be meetings for addicts, because addicts were still dying despite AA's message for recovery. Jimmy learned that AA could not do all things for all people and that most importantly the 12 Traditions had to be adhered to.

A committee was formed in June or July of 1952. Jimmy and four other people met at a member's house and tossed the idea around. However, the committee eventually died out. In June or July of 1953, a committee formed and met every couple of weeks to try to formulate what they were going to do. There was a commitment to get something going; they decided that they wanted to follow a format like AA because AA was a winner. But it was not working for addicts.

Jimmy was elected chairman of the committee and they immediately vetoed, voted down two things he suggested. One being that the groups not use the AA name and two being to adapt AA Traditions. One of the first things to occur was naturally an argument. An argument over what were going to call ourselves. It was agreed that it would have to specify addiction and not one particular drug. Drugs Anonymous did not sound right cause who wanted a program called DA, yet Narcotics was more understood. We could not call ourselves Addicts Anonymous because that would infringe on the AA name. The committee wanted to call it AA / NA. Jimmy informed the group that they could not call themselves this because it infringed on the AA name. Yet the group decided that, that was what they wanted to be called. Jimmy knew that at least they were off to a good start performing in a group conscience like manner. Doris called AA Headquarters in New York and AA informed them that they could not call themselves AA / NA as it implied affiliation with AA.

Nar-anon was another suggestion but that was something dianetic, a sciencetology thing. Eventually the name Narcotics Anonymous was agreed upon. On August 17, 1953 the by laws were drawn up outlining what Narcotics Anonymous should be about. The first paragraph of those laws stated 1, This society or movement shall be know as Narcotics Anonymous and the name may be used by any group which follow the 12 Steps and 12 Traditions of Narcotics Anonymous.

The first meeting of Narcotics Anonymous was held at member's homes. One of the members Scott K. had a meeting at his house on N. Chandler Blvd. in North Hollywood, California. Eventually booklets that were printed up were kept in Scott's garage in back of his home. Some of you might have seen that floating around; I have a copy up here if you would like to see it. The first established NA Meeting was at a church at the corner of Cleburne St. and Kintara St. in Sun Valley, California. It was held every Monday night and was referred to as the dad's Club and run by the Salvation Army. A hand made sign with the letters NA was placed outside the church. Jimmy would stand outside by

the front door; cars would slowly creep by and then tear down the street. It was obvious that outsiders were not quite sure if the church was staked out. At that time Jimmy approached the police department and informed them that of their intentions to meet. Because back in those days it was a felony to just be an addict. Up until really pretty recently, I know in the 70's it was still a felony at that time. The police dept. assured Jimmy that there would be no surveillance at any of the NA Meetings.

A small electric stove was purchased to make coffee. Back then, nobody had any money and mugs were schlepped from meeting to meeting because there was no money to buy paper cups. Jimmy and another member would go to the jails and institutions to carry the message of Narcotics Anonymous. Later however that member thought it would be ok to charge people a fee for lecture services. Jimmy said that was unacceptable and could not be done. That member eventually went back to AA. Because NA was, so new many people were struggling for power and saw themselves as leaders.

The meeting moved to a location on Stagg Street, a lady named Doris was apart of our original committee and Frank and Doris had a machine shop inside of their home. Barbara, Tommy and Paul were also names of members of the original group. Doris typed the formation of the first meeting minutes. The meeting stayed at a church for about six months and then it was moved to a place known as Shyer Dryer in North Hollywood. This was in 1954-55 and 56. The building was originally the North Hollywood Lodge and Sanitarium and the owner Dr. Shyer. AA Meetings had been meeting there since 1951 or 52. Dr. Shyer gave permission for Narcotics Anonymous to hold a meeting there once a week. There was a small parking lot there but only five or six people could fit there comfortably at one time.

There was some conflict with the Traditions at that time and Jimmy did not attend any meetings there. Meetings were held there for quite some time, then Shiers Dryer was to undergo some remodeling and the meeting moved to another sanitarium, I guess those were the only places that wanted us, on Ventura Blvd. in Studio City. When the remodeling was completed at Shiers Dryer, the meetings moved back to that site.

By 1954, there were 12 to 15 people attending the meetings and by 1955, the number went up to 18 to 20. There was always talk of starting up more meetings. Most people went to one NA Meeting a week and then to AA and other therapeutic groups. Society in general did not really believe that addicts could stay drug free.

The word addict was no longer a dirty word anymore and more and more was being done in society to help addicts. 12 Step work was done in groups because people did not want to go alone on a 12 Step call because they thought they were going to use. Recovery was getting a little easier since more addicts were working. So by this time those were the only two NA Meetings in the world. Shiers Dryer and the sanitarium on Ventura Blvd.

In 1958 what was to be known as the mother group started at the Unity Church on Moorpark St. in Studio City, California. The group eventually known as the Architects of Adversity Group, a fifth and tenth step meeting. Another meeting sprung up at Magnolia Blvd. behind a store. There was a small apartment where a member named Bill W., no relation to Wilson lived. Eight members met there for a brief period of time where they would sit around on the bed or on the floor. By 1959 NA had folded, people had either died, gone back out or went back to AA; additionally groups were not abiding to the Traditions.

One night Jimmy Kinnon and Sylvia Wexworth were sitting at the kitchen table again and wondering what to do because no one was coming to the meetings. Jimmy and Sylvia were the only two left. In tears, Sylvia said what are we going to do. Jimmy looked at her and said I don't know what you are going to do but I am going to start over again and this time we are going to start living by the Traditions.

In the beginning of 1960 with about four members, NA started up again. In the mid 60's a meeting held at a duplex apartment that Jimmy's brother rented out in Studio City. Regular members of that group were Jimmy, Pepe, Scott, Doris and Danny. In 1961 Penny K. author of "I can't do anymore time" in our little White Book came into NA and eventually held a meeting in her home in North Hollywood. Jimmy's home was the first hotline to helping addicts in a small room, which was initially his roofing and painting office. In the mid 60's Jimmy put together NA's first

pamphlet. An eight-page pamphlet for distribution. Jimmy heard there was an NA Group in New York, this group was contacted but even though they called themselves Narcotics Anonymous, they were into a different sort of thing. Although they had the same name they did not fashion themselves after Narcotics Anonymous. They accepted donations and funds from the government and they openly admitted they were not like us. They informed the group in S.V. that they did not wish to join our club. They wanted to be a separate entity.

The first Board of Trustees was formed in 1968. Chuck S. was the first member of the board after Jimmy held the position since NA's beginning. The first World Service Office was set at a place called the Crenshaw House in Los Angeles. However, two organizations were now operating under one roof. The work was not getting done. The WSO was then moved to the Suicide Prevention Center, but two programs were getting mixed up and confusion arose. (laughter) The literature was not getting mailed out and there was theft. There was no consistency. The office then moved above a Bail Bonds office on Van Nuys Blvd. in the San Fernando Valley. In order to work in the office someone would have to run down every half hour and put money in the parking meters. The rent could not be met, and it was at this time that Jimmy K moved the WSO to his home in Sun Valley.

Up to that point the WSO consisted of one tiny box of records, one beat up couch and one filing cabinet, the borrowed desk had to be returned. He answered the phones day and night and took care of the mail. The few people who had volunteered were expected to work, I mean work. Everyone was motivated by him, the office acquired a used typewriter, used file cabinet and other outdated office equipment, like scales, staples etc. Jimmy and his wife Betty would go out to yard sales and go through trash dumpsters for things they could use at the office. Cardboard boxes were collected from behind stores to be used for shipping, paper bags were cut up and used to wrap literature and tapes. The percentage of the working volume at the office were newcomers, and every penny was put back into the office.

Now understanding that our organization started in 1953 it was sad to admit that in 1972 there were still just a few meetings around the world. That is not a lot of growth for any organization. For the first time, though there was some stability and consistency for NA through the WSO. In 1960, Jimmy K wrote, "Who is an Addict", and in 1960, Jimmy K wrote, "What is an NA Program". In 1960, Jimmy K. and Sylvia W. wrote, "Why are we here"? The second half of "How it Works" in our NA pamphlet beginning with, this sounds like a big order, was written by Jimmy K. In 1960 Jimmy K wrote "Recovery and Relapse", and in 1961 Jimmy K wrote "We do Recover". Jimmy K also wrote "Another Look", which was also revised by him in 1983. In 1962 Phil P wrote "One third of my Life" and in 1962 Penny K wrote "I can't do anymore Time". In 1962, Garrett wrote "Vicious Circle". In 1962, Bob B wrote "Something Meaningful". In 1976, Greg P wrote, "I was different". In 1976, Betty K wrote "Careful Mother". In 1976, Bill B wrote "Fat addict". Our prayer my gratitude speaks when I care and when I share the NA Way was written by Jimmy K.

Our symbol was designed by Greg P. and Jimmy K. There is a real touching story behind our NA Symbol. Jimmy K was in the hospital with TB and it was there in his hospital bed that he carved what is our symbol into a piece of leather. It had a gold background and it was carved very deep. It was a circle with a diamond in the center with NA inscribed in the middle. Prior to World Convention NA had what was known as anniversary dinners? A tape is available of the 20th anniversary dinner of NA, where Jimmy K and Jack Whaley who was then the chairman of the Board of Trustees spoke. Back then, everyone went to both fellowships, AA and NA. The significance of this tape however is a revolutionary idea that addicts could recover in NA. And the NA was separate from AA. At the 6th World Convention of NA held at Ventura California, the first World Conference was held. You know that may not be right, I guess it was 1976 so what year was the Ventura. Well something was held in conjunction with the World Convention.

That conference established an Ad- Hoc committee of elected representatives of the fellowship to review and revise the service structure that had been proposed for NA called the NA Tree. The NA Tree was NA's first service structure, which was devised by Greg. That ad-hoc committee presented the results of their labors to NA's first independent World Service Conference held Van Nuys California held in the spring of 1978. The conference accepted that work and the many other suggestions that come in and turned all over to the newly established World

Service Literature Committee for finalization. The service manual of NA was presented to the conference in the spring of 1979 for approval. I was 30 days clean in 1978 when I first met with Jimmy K. in his home. I was taken back by his strengths and devotion towards NA. I use to always say you may not become a spiritual giant in NA and you may never come out with more than five cents in your pocket, but you will learn how to think for yourself.

If you made a commitment to NA, you would learn how to stand up on your own two feet and think for yourself. Most of all Jimmy loved freedom and if you listen to tapes that he spoke on, he always talked about freedom in such an inspiring way.

As I said earlier, very early on in our history, people were vying for power, but nobody really wanted to work. Even in good old California where it all started, personalities shaped areas and regions. Southern California and Northern California could never agree on anything. The San Fernando Valley and the Bay Area, the Bay Area not being San Francisco but its like a beach community like Santa Monica or Manhattan Beach, all around inside of LA were always squabbling about one thing or another. Clicks would form, people who were still un-recovering, thinking they knew something.

In 1976 at the World Convention in San Francisco, California, a very funny thing happened. World Conventions were always held in California because where else were they going to be held? So every year it was the same thing, you know you would have Northern California getting up to the and back then they determined where the next World Convention was going to be. They would all sit in a room on Sunday in the big auditorium and vote by hand where it was going to be. So that is how you would know where it was going to be the next year. So Northern California and Southern California were the only two who would ever have a bid to propose to the convention floor. They would give their fancy smancy proposals. You know the Holiday Inn, filet mignon and all this, and then Southern California would get up with another fancy proposal. So this is the way it would go, then in 1976 out of the blue this young girl from Houston Texas gets up to the mic and says, Well I don't have a proposal but we really need Y'all in Texas. It was so weird man because you had like, what the chairman decided to do was , oh everyone from Northern California get over here on this side and everyone from Texas stand right in the middle.

So there are a lot of members who do not really give a shit you know where it was going to be. But they were moved by this girl from Texas, she had nothing but she thought from her heart you know. But northern and southern California you know God forbid if you take it out of California that's the end. So the room split up, Northern California was pretty matched 50/50 but there were ore people for Texas down the middle and then what happened next after that was hilarious. They started at one another right, come on what are you doing, we have to stay in California, come on Northern California would say yeah right well you comer over here, you know like they did not want to budge. Even this one dear friend of mine Danny who is this big biker with long hair a Chicano guy. He had a lot of time in the program. He stood up on a table saying Chicanos over here; you know it was like a madhouse. Because of their refusal to budge and come together, because one, some people were screaming lets just keep it in California, if we united we can stay in California. Well because of their refusal to compromise, Houston got it. You should have seen the stunned looks on everybody's faces, even mine I was like Oh my God. So anyway, it was a good thing though because wherever the World Convention went after that NA tripled. I mean the convention would bring, after the convention were over dozens hundreds of meetings would start up in cities. That is pretty much the way it happens when NA, a World Convention comes to a city. Maybe now I think what happens when a convention goes to a city is that there is a re-commitment or a desire to commit to Narcotics Anonymous. I have seen that happen.

So ,NA grew. Many people called Jimmy a rebel. He never had a problem with saying no, it's wrong or we can't do that, it isn't right. He never believed that any one person or group should run NA. He was not afraid to tell anyone who came along with some good smelling horseshit that, that was what it was. So needless to say, he made some enemies along the way.

While we were all squabbling about our major differences in the area level in the San Fernando Valley, Jimmy reached out to members all over the world. In Canada, Australia, Germany Guam, Great Britain Scotland and Ireland.

Jimmy whose son was stationed in Germany provided literature to the Army Bases there through his connection as an officer. He had literature sent to Viet Nam.

One of the most memorable moments when I worked at the World Service Office was the day that we got a letter from New York City from Terry. It was the happiest day because you know as many addicts as there are in New York City, it was one of the last cities to really get it together and happen, and that was in '81. He made contact in new areas starter kits were sent out from the WSO and he was there for people when they called and hoped to hear about NA as a program. How NA could help them or their area.

Like I said the WSO use to be in his house, a bunch of us would go over there on Tuesday and Thursday nights and those were some of the nicest nights in my recovery. I was very new in recovery but I felt such apart of and it was an atmosphere of love and respect because we were all working for nothing and we were all doing it because it made us feel good. Jimmy had a modest little home, he collected books, and he loved to read. There were knick-knacks everywhere because Jimmy and Betty collected them. He lived across the street from an airfield and despite the noise and pollution; beautiful flowers and birds were always in his yard. I think you are going to be shown a tape tomorrow and you will get an idea of what his house looked like. There was a filing cabinet a used typewriter were in the mudroom, the literature was stored in a backroom, the duping machine that we used to dup tapes for the NA tape library was kept in the living room. It was really hard getting an NA tape back in those days because everybody was identifying as addict alcoholics, getting sober you know. We were always sort of deleting the word, fixing it up a little because we wanted to get some good tapes out there to groups and areas outside of California that were really struggling to get started. But it was an atmosphere of being at ease and being yourself. It was really growth for me because like I said I was new and I have to be around people who had a lot of time and experience in the program. I just felt, I just felt like I had finally found some purpose and meaning in my life. I could talk until sunrise about this program. He loved to talk and in those days, Jimmy's door was always open to addicts. It was a safe place to go, you could always hear about recovery in Narcotics Anonymous and you always felt good when you left his house... I knew very early on in my recovery that I would never use again and because I grew to love and appreciate Jimmy Kinnon, I grew to love and care about NA. Because I first learned to love it.

One of the times that Jimmy was invited to share at a radio station, a call in program about NA. And typical practicing addict who knew nothing about recovery let alone NA would call in with stupid questions like can you mix green pills with black pills, or what is the most potent kind of pot out there. We were sitting at home going Oh shit man here is a time for NA to be talked about and get some of these addicts out there in . Because it was, a rock and roll radio station so we said hey let one of us call up and pretend were just a dope fiend or something, an addict who wants to know about NA. So Doug called up and he asked, well what is addiction? Jimmy really knew how to talk about addiction. Can you explain what it is he said, and dear Jimmy passing over this opportune time? He simply said, is this you Doug (laughter) you should know better you know. So that was the sort of guy that Jimmy was, he really did not you know, he was not he did not do things to try to impress people. You know he did things the very opposite of that.

In the late 70's Greg P. and Bo S. began the efforts of what would later be known as NA's Basic Text. Our Basic Text was written by addicts for addicts. This project took over six years to complete and our book finally became available for the fellowship conference approval in 1982. In 1980 there were whisperings going on about a new and better WSO. At one time, there was a worldwide paper strike and yet the fellowship clamored for their orders. While toilet paper in Japan was going for $10.00, addicts could not understand or conceive of the delays the office was experiencing. With very little funds to automate the office, working in the office was a night and day affair. As I stated before most of the people involved the actual work were newcomers, because the people with time were still going to AA or were busy doing other things. Yes, Jimmy was radical all right, it was the World Service Conference in 1980 that came out with the statement and motion that NA should cease and desist the selling and distributing or reading of AA literature at NA Meetings. So a trustee stood up and said, "Oh, I hoped it would not come to this." (laughter)

The first foreign translation in Spanish of the NA pamphlet was prepared for distribution by the office and presented

to the conference in 1981. The world directory typed by hand on an out dated and often broken typewriter was typed and copied in Jimmy's house. It was presented at the WSC for distribution to members. Around this time there developed a conflict between the World Service Literature Committee and the WSO over who was going to be in charge of production and distribution of the Basic Text that was in the making.

In the spring of 1981, just prior to the World Service Conference the WSO moved its headquarters to a new office on Vineland Avenue in Sun Valley in hopes of meeting the demands of the officers of the conference and Board of Trustees, to move the office out of Jimmy's house once and for all. The office was moved to its new location. It was one large room with a storefront. The trucks came to move the furniture and stuff out of Jimmy's house into our new office. Jimmy was still the manager of the office and was looking forward to working at a location outside of his home. I cannot help but wonder how he might have felt that day. With the bigger office, we all felt so grateful and proud to have acquired such a place to better facilitate the needs of the fellowship. However, the move the office made to its new location primarily to address the concerns of some of the officers of the World Service Conference and the entire Board of Trustees. They did not finally address their real intentions, which were to disband the WSO board, staff and Jimmy K as office manager.

Jimmy K died of lung cancer on July 9, 1985 a little while after he was locked out of the WSO. Upon arriving at work one day the locks had been changed, he went home and wept in Betty's arms. In all the moments I spent with Jimmy, he never told me what to do. I can remember when the controversy with the office started. I would get so upset and angry I would tear down Vineland Avenue toward Jimmy's house to get some answers I needed. When I would get there he would sit me down give me some coffee, give me a cookie and I would expect some profound thing, remedy, but he would pull out his poetry book and read me some peaceful poem and it would calm me down and you know I would be ok. I would start to relax, Jimmy was not a director, he was not into control, he was not all-powerful and he was not selfish. But Jimmy was not one to go along just to get along. Jimmy could vote with a blindfold on, standing up for what he believed was right and in NA"s best interest always. He was never an instrument of any one person's demise or misfortune in NA. He went by principle. I wish I could have had about 10 years when I met him so I could have asked him some real meaty questions about life and how it relates to the program for me today. But I think today he would be proud of me, I have a life and I will always be grateful to him for when I met him at the beginning of my recovery and that is what I have. Thanks. (Applause)

Does anyone have any questions? None?

Audience: Is that the non controversial things that went on or could we get you to expound a little bit about who did what to whom, when. I mean that was really what I thought maybe when we were here for and people like really poked me for stuff like names and stuff like that. Just tell the story hun. (UN clear speaking)

Fawn: He was not senile by any means. He had an excellent memory. I was often shocked at how he could recall because I use to work with him all the time and we would get letters in from (Poot Butt, South Dakota) or something and I would forget the name and what day it was sent. He would know it just like that, so he had a very keen and sharp mind, he was not senile. Like I said in the thing there was, when the Basic Text was being born I think there might have been visions of what that might bring to NA. Whether it be profits or an explosion of growth and perhaps people wanted to be in on that. Maybe seeing themselves as managers, leaders you know this is what I am trying to imagine you know I do not think that people, I have to believe that people do not intentionally go out to stick it up somebody's ass. But there was a time in my recovery that I really thought that. But the way it was gone about was disgraceful and dishonest. I sat there through three conferences you know and I felt like a witness to an atrocity. You know what I saw happening with a lot of new people in recovery with a couple of years clean being prompted with the motions to go up to the conference floor and make the motions that would get him out. The fellowship did not want Jimmy out, the Trustees wanted it.

When the book was finally getting ready, see the office had to make sure that how the book was getting distributed was being done in the channels that we had at that time, through the service structure. So it was a lot of confusion, you know the book whoever the people that were involved with the Basic Text it was their baby, just as the office

was our baby. You know it was very hard to let go of something. So I guess when it came time to producing and distributing the book or letting go of the book and letting the office do its job they were reluctant. Well one of the things that happened was the printers that we had used forever. We gave them the money to print the Basic Text and they went bankrupt. So that was a real blow and of course, it was some people did not accept that those things happened.

I remember one year at the conference I sat there in a circle with some other committee members, I was speaking on behalf of the WSO, and you know this one chairman said I just want to make sure that when this book comes that people are not living up in Beverly Hills and driving Mercedes. You know and he was implying that the WSO with the, he was assaulting the character of the people who worked in the office. I remember really being hurt and I just said that is an insult for you to be speaking that way. The thought really never occurred to me that anyone in NA could be like that could think that way. So it became like a battle and maybe it was also a battle between the East Coast and the West Coast or I do not know. I do know that like I said a lot of what I was seeing happening is that very early on in our history there were powerful personalities, maybe they were snubbed, maybe there was a fight and they carried resentment. Later on though people would sponsor people and you know how that goes, hey you know you are my sponsee and that person is a motherfucker and watch out for that asshole. So these resentments kind of kept growing and so they. I have a story of a member here who wrote it really good; maybe I will read it tomorrow. His version of what he saw happening and how a lot of it is tied into personality's right out of Southern California. A lot of people who went around talking about Jimmy never met him and in my personal experience, none of the Trustees had the balls to confront the man himself, and say hey here is my beef, can you just get out. Why are you there, but they always used their little stories, their pigeons with two years, one year, 6 months and that was how that worked.

Question: I am an addict named Lawrence. Hi Lawrence. And I appreciate your presentation and your effort. Sort of educators and gives us some information. But I have to say its so and I just have to say that I feel like this is trivializing Jimmy K. Because if we are to get to the bottom of our history I just feel that, you know we need to know exactly what happened you know what happened, who were the people who wanted Jimmy K removed? Look, if we are to put anything together you know as a history book or something like that you know it just seems to me that it would be advantageous for us to have you know why was the power play because obviously there was a power play involved. You know I appreciate your efforts and I do not mean to trivialize your efforts because I really appreciate it. It was informative but you know I just think that this is basically a story of Jimmy K and which is ok but I just think there is a whole lot more there and we are just not getting it. I just feel like half full you know and my other question is when New York approached or bid for the World Convention. Another question I have why was I mean what was actually the reason and the purpose for having the World Convention. I realize there was a purpose at the beginning and I am just wondering why it seems today that we have totally prostituted ourselves in terms of that, putting up flyers, I mean we are endorsing all this kinds of stuff and then we are saying it is all in the name of Narcotics Anonymous. I hope that you can respond on that.

Fawn: While I only have my opinion, I can offer here, but in answer to your second question, there are a lot of member who love conventions and look forward to going on a vacation where there are thousands and thousands of addicts from all over the world. It is exciting to a lot of people, most new people who go to World Conventions will most likely never use again, so I do not know. Some people like them, some people do not. There has always been a great turn out and it is about having fun. It is probably one of the few times when so many addicts can gather together and have fun rather than fighting and assaulting one another at a conference level. In answer to your first question, hey, I cannot distort the truth, history is history. It cannot be modified or changed; it was a very simple history of very early beginnings. Because Jimmy's name was so slandered, he was treated so disrespectfully and in such an uncaring way. I felt it necessary to give you a truer and more honest picture, which you will probably never hear to people. Because it is so important, you know who carried us for such a long time and who made it possible for us to grow. Jimmy never wanted to take credit for being the big beginner or anything that was not what it was about, but you knows I can read things; I can see what the truth is. I can come up here and look if you want to know who did what there all right here in the minutes. If you want to know who the entire Board of Trustees was looking in the 1979, 1980, 81, and even 82 minutes, the motions are in there. Some girl from I do not know made the motion. Finally,

someone had the guts to come flat out and say that we just fire him. It took that long you know I am not about sitting here and giving a bunch of names out when the people are not here. I was hoping I could come here today and see some of those people here, there not here. Because I would like to know, I am curious too. How can you the man who was responsible for ten years what happened? So, I have questions, some of the very people that were responsible for the removal of Jimmy and caused him so much pain walk around and glorify him today, which totally blows me away. Taking credit for loving and what a dear man he was , so that kind of shit disturbs me. I don't understand that one. I hope the slanders on the tape, well.

Question: I am a grateful recovering addict by name. Two things from what I understand when a nation of people a family a person cannot identify a trauma that is past with any subject to repeat it. This situation that happened with Jimmy K , okay in one respect we can say that the past , what I am concerned about is the people who we have today and the leaders we have today that pick innovators. The people who are producing literature for us now who have NA at heart, what is to prevent the situation from happening to them, now or next week or whenever. The second part of my question is, is there a group of people or a panel or a committee of whatever that coordinating the portion about history. Dave's portion about history and other peoples about the history of NA at this present time. At this particular meeting and coordinating that the adding to the artifacts, to present to a publisher or whatever. To print this history and what is being done to protect the artifacts, the pieces of history and documentation that Jimmy has. That his wife has, Betty K has in case something happens to her. Is there some sort of mechanism to protect that information or to distribute that information to coordinate all this in at least a raw form of the basic history, that we can look at or be printed or what.

Fawn: thanks a lot those are good questions. A few years ago, Lynn A. a dear friend of Betty's approached Bob Stone at the WSO and said look Betty has tons and tons of archival history. About Narcotics Anonymous that he saved as his personal memorabilia that she is ready to turn over to Narcotics Anonymous under one condition that it not be altered of changed the reason she said was this there was a time in our history where members of the conference wanted to change J's story which was another look . Jimmy always felt that another look was a part of history and it was not right to revise, delete, change, or fix up anybody's story. He revised it himself they were pretty, I think back then what they were hung up with was the word self-reliance because they were dirty words in Alcoholics Anonymous. So they could not understand that the man with his over twenty years of recovery found true self-reliance after having worked the steps. As you and I well know the only way that we find true self-reliance, we all were here that long. Having developed a relationship with our Higher Power and through reliance on a higher power we come upon self reliance, but they had to have that spelled out they thought you just can't say you're going to be self reliant. So she offered that was her condition and without any further I will get back to you or anything Bob Stone said. No, sorry but anything that you turn over to WSO becomes our property and we can do anything with it that we choose. So she politely said well FUCK YOU so that is the story there. I find it very hard to believe WSO, the way it is now would ever in a million years give credit where credit is due. I think NA the way it is now, the story we like to present to the fellowship, is the one we have now the " PO BUTT ". Hey in 1953 we all woke up, here was this big fat fellowship for us all, and that is the way it happened. It has to start somewhere and a lot of the people that are still involved with World Service. I don't know maybe they still have resentments for them. I know at the time the WSO was functioning there are some strong personalities on the staff. There were members of the literature committee that resented members of the WSO staff and hey I was a member of the WSO staff and I resented a lot of the members of the World Service Literature Committee. So there was that going on. Does that answer your question? Ok I forgot the other one ok, I know there have, are some.

History workshops being done, I know there's one in Alabama in August and allot of the people involved with the Basic Text, the original Basic text are going to be there and they are trying to start a compiling of this information. People who have the NA archives of information about anything about any history period in NA are being encouraged to come out and participate. Its going to be from what I understand a very big event. And a lot of participation. I know w there are some tapes floating around but you know I don't know if the WSO would publish something like that. I think it would have to be, because it is such a we organization. You know we put so much emphasis on the we they would have to I would think in going along with that, they would have to cut that part out. That's the way I see a conference approval, or an office approval , or a board approval, or whoever's running the boat

now would probably do it (unclear) not by the WSO and world service conference no (audience). Well that is a question that was asked of me at the C&P region and you know, do something go to some of the history workshops, get the things started. I don't know I mean I don't know, how things like this get started. Like how we started our Basic text you know an idea was planted and a bunch of people got in on it and it started to happen. You know I don't see the outcome of it happening anytime soon I think because it is going to take a lot of work.

Question: I am Mike, I am an addict. You know previously I have gotten involved with this service thing. I am kind of frustrated and I heard a lot. In the past few months, I have learned a lot and I do not know a whole lot about Jimmy K. Basically you know I feel like we should be working on today and today's service, how we can change Narcotics Anonymous today My question would be like what advise would you give the fellowship today on, to help the service structure. How we can get the fellowship back and hold onto it, and to not have all different Basic Texts floating around and have like some kind of service structure. A sturdy one, you know something better that what we have had in the past. There was nothing wrong with what we had in the past. But it is 1990, the fellowship changed for the better, its bigger, most addicts today are clean, there not clean and sober. When I came in I was clean and sober and today I am clean, I have been clean quite awhile. And the people with time, I talk to them you know to some of them it is like the big people up here in World Service. They kind of like put you down, push you away. Some of them like they don't want to tell you nothing and that are the impression I get. I don't know if its ego, pride, they want to make money, I don't know. You know but it kind of hurts because I am getting all this information. I am new in service and some of the issues bother me. Whoever started this fellowship you know I feel for them. I am glad Narcotics Anonymous is here and I don't have to go nowhere else today. You know and I wish the people up here in WSO would get honest, get real, and stop playing games you know and that is just the way I feel.

Audience: Part of what you said struck off a chord in me because Bo who is going to be here tomorrow has been; he says he has access to everything he needs for the history. He is perfectly capable of writing it. He wrote the story of the Basic Text and his problem has been that he has told many people including the WSO you know I cannot do this and work a job, but I need someone to enable me to get this book done. No one seemed interested, so what he has been doing is slowly by slowly. You know first he got the computer then he got a laser printer and the whole time he is, as I will just. Then he told me that he was going to have to become in a financial sufficient manner to where he would be able to sit down and do it himself if necessary. But it takes time and he needs help and that's part of why he offered to come here for this workshop, and he is going to Alabama as he feels that if more people become educated about the need for this you know nothing can be done alone. I am very interested in the history for a lot of my own personal reasons and I was speaking to a founder of another program who said that of the leadership is turned over to the fellowship before the fellowship is not mature enough the disease will rip it apart. I see that exactly happening when I look at the years and the short time with which it was taken away from Jimmy for whatever reasons. I called up Greg and asked what could have been done for that control to be kept among you longer and he said it would have been wrong for them to do that, they had to turn it over to do spiritually the right thing. But you know I tend to wonder if there could not have been someway for it to have been left in their control. I mean other than Bob Stone who is not an addict, who bottom line is the dollar you know I mean I've been there and his palm id hairy But I am saying during this time I want to know what could have been done to where it could have spiritually been. I want to know what could have possibly been done to spiritually turn that over like they had to do but not to someone like Bob Stone. That is what I would like to know so maybe when Sob Stone is out we do not get another one worse.

Fawn: I spoke with Stu Tordman a couple of weeks ago and I asked him about, I had a conversation with him about the recent firing of Bob Stone as the WSO manager at the WSO, and I said who is going to run it now? He said it is going to turn into a World Service Center as opposed to a board and it is going to be run by a, its going to answer more to the conference. It was evidently, this is what he told me ok, and he said that the time had come where it is not that they are displeased with what he was doing but they saw the need that the office had to be accountable to the conference. That it could not be run by an executive director anymore or someone who you know the way it was. The fellowship, what I see happening well you know I do not even know, you know it is like I was raised in NA. The pyramid looked like the member in big letters at the top, you know then the group, then the area and as it got smaller and then the region and at the very bottom the World Service Conference and the WSO, and all the sub committees that branched out. I see the pyramid totally turning around and I think what has happened is we see a system of

self-preservation happening. You know who was as far as the history of the Basic Text; I think Bo is very qualified to write about the history of the Basic Text. I do not know about the history of NA. I have read a little bit about that and I don't agree with especially about the New York stuff. I happen to know that is incorrect that is why I made so much references to the New York. Because as we know it did not start in New York and as far as I am concerned it is one more effort to take away the credit where the credit is due.

So there was something else I wanted to say, I think that, I do not know I don't go to the conferences anymore. From what I hear, it would totally blow me away. Some of the old timers that someone else was saying earlier that were there early on, yeah they are not involved anymore. People like me because personally I feel like I gave four years of my life to that and I am lucky I got away from it with my recovery, my sanity. It was very disturbing and until there is a totally overhaul of new people I will not attend. You know I was telling somebody the other day, yeah okay let us all go there to the conference, and say Ok everybody can vote. The Board of Trustees, the regional reps., the WSO manager, all these other friggin subcommittees, let them all vote. People who represent absolutely no one, but under one condition that everyone in office right now resign and then see if they would like to have this new idea of theirs go into motion. You know I don't know it has just gotten so, you know the other day I was sitting in a meeting, just a regular NA Meeting and I saw the Traditions up on the board and you know how sometimes you just start glancing at them. You know it just seems that what is going on is, if you really look at the Traditions in just a flat, just the way they are on paper. It seems like we have just gotten out of hand, it seems to me that we have gotten too organized. It seems to me that our service boards and committees are not directly responsible to us. You know it seems like we are just not following the Traditions. But there is so much fancy language to justify they are being followed that it overwhelms me. Just a simple person to, you know get in there and strategize it with these people. I think one of the reasons that the WSO lost out in '82 was because we were so busy sending orders out, stapling pamphlets that we didn't have time to sit around and play fuckin strategy. While these assholes sat around in corners talking about OK here is how were going to get the motherfuckers out, when this motion passes you do this, and if it does not pass here is the plan of action. That is how it went, I saw it happening and I think that if they don't get there way here, lets just let some time pass and we will bring it up again. There are so many different ways you know it so professional, it is like the only people who really understand at are those people who are still sitting on these boards and committees for ten or twelve years. You send a regional representative who is in service for one year out there and he is there overwhelmed, all he knows is his group conscience that is all he is carrying. The thousands of people he is representing and you hear all bullshit you don't know how to think. You don't want to be left out. So then a vote is called for , it is so easy to forget why you are there and so what do you do? You look around the room and there is Joe Blow Trustee, well he must know what is happening. I will just vote like him. You know so I don't really think when we talk about fellowship approval at the conference level, I don't know because the issues we are talking about at home, they are not of anything we are talking about at the conference. So I wonder where is all the group conscience shit they are talking about that is happening at the World coming from. Because I really believe, my personal opinion that if all regional representatives carried just exactly what our regions want and nothing else the conferences would go back to three days long. Because there will be no bullshitting and no more ego playing. You have to remember that a lot of people that are in service, these regional reps. They don't have a lot of time clean, some of them do and some of them don't, and not all of them have finished working the Steps. So you know they want to be heard, they want to raise their hand, they want to talk, you know that is normal. I think we all go through that. People tolerate us, maybe that is the feeling your friend there was talking about earlier, how it always seems that they look down to me. I guess after awhile they just get tired of hearing the same questions year after year. My feeling is the system of services should be on a rotating basis. And we should get more to the spirit of volunteerism, and rotations as opposed to preserving the powerful positions that can sway many of us when it comes to money, property and prestige. I know a lot of them go and pray, you know I know a lot of them go home and write inventory and share with the newcomer. But it is real easy to think that you are doing the right thing ands not even realize you are being motivated by perhaps something else. You know hanging on to your big fancy name or your big fancy payroll, your salary I mean or whatever you know.

Question: I am an addict named Mike. Hi, Mike. I was just wondering what year we started paying our Trusted servants you know to work in the office. What year did that take place? Was our fellowship aware of that, did they have any say in how much salary we would pay them, or was that approved by the WSO itself? And I just have one

more... Could you briefly tell me how that affected Narcotics Anonymous?

Fawn: I think it has made a lot of people resentful, you know I mean that is what I am seeing. I think that accountability for every service arm of Narcotics Anonymous is essential. Because we are all addicts and because it is important because we are a fellowship, to know where the money is going and how it is spent. I don't know who makes what or how much they make. I don't know if that information is even available to the fellowship is it. I did ask Stu when I talked to him, I said well I hear a lot of people are upset that so many people are flying around the world first class and to countries where NA has not even started, just to set up corporation rights. You know what the hell is going on. He said well Fawn you should know better than that. (laughter) He said that the laws are very different in other countries for example in Germany. When they were translating the literature, Germany has a problem with the word leaders and wanted to change that word, so there is a lot of stuff I guess that justifies you know sending people out to get this. I heard translations are very, very costly, although the Spanish translation of our little White Book cost nothing. We had it done by the foreign class, Spanish foreign class at the University of Southern California free when we told them what we wanted.

Question: I Al, I am an addict. You talked about the Basic Text, could you elaborate on the process they used to approve, the first Basic Text. (Answer unclear, microphone not at podium)

Question: Hi, I am addict Carl. A wonderful lady we both share in our lives Betty, she passed along phones numbers to get in contact with you and Doug in her hopes of organizing what she called a calamity for as long as I have known her. Maybe that is something on a personal level we can discuss later. I guess my major question is one of the things that are being hoisted out to the fellowship today in a new service structure and one of their comments transpired in 1979-1980 of the creation of the offices as a separate entity. Being in service from 1978 to 1982 are you privileged to information. What actually occurred from what was available in the Tree that put the office in the hands of the Board of Trustees? And what is now being explained as all of a sudden, it came out of the office into production as a separate entity and nobody noticed. How close is that to the truth? The office became its own separate entity outside the control of the Trustees in 79-80 that was said to have happened in the office.

Fawn: When the WSO staff, good question. When the WSO staff was working at the office at the time, there were a couple of Trustees who were also part of the staff. They stopped coming to work and they were later discovered to be the instigators of a lot of the dissention in terms of like, we got to get him out of there. You know and stuff like that. So the office had elections and voted in a new board, that is what happened. All the people that were voted out of the board were the workers. We decided the people best qualified to be participants at the WSO were the people, I mean to be on the board of the WSO were the people who were doing the damn work. Because everybody else had so many opinions you know you would always get these people coming over with their grandiose ideas and then they would split. You know they did not want to hang around and help with the work.

Question: What was changed in our literature, what changed in how we came into two basic structures? ( ) that was never brought before the conference, it was never discussed.

Fawn: The WSO quite simply, what they presented to the conference, was that the WSO was a separate entity in that the way that they explained it was no, ( ) Right and also because id NA was ever sued, NA the fellowship could not be sued, the WSO would be sued. So that way it protected, it was like the legal part of the fellowship. That is the only reason that was ever stated. It was not like something new that was invented. It was always known that the WSO is not Narcotics Anonymous. You know just like a dance is not, it wasn't a secret agenda or something to come out with.

Question: Can we get the NA history Book; can we get it printed without anything on the world level? Can we get it privately, like if that was successful could we get something else printed? What kind of plans are being taken to print the history?

Fawn: But there would probably be, would not there be problems with the infringement of the name Narcotics

Anonymous. So I mean if you wanted to do it through the structure.

Question: Can I ask you a question what is Narcotics Anonymous then, is not it the group. I mean isn't the group Narcotics Anonymous? So I mean how could the group infringe on what's rightfully theirs?

Answer: We have a service structure. If something stinks then the service structure should be changed. As a group of Narcotics Anonymous to change that by a group taking action and following through with it. I mean the group is autonomous and can take action within the group and start initiating those changes and doesn't have to wait for the conference to go do the ( )

Fawn: Things should go from the fellowship to the conference not the other way around. We should not be being told what is going to happen to us from the conference. We should be directing the conference what we want done. I was very shocked to hear, I was like the last one to know that there was a time in NA when all the World Service Committees were open to the fellowship. You know if you wanted to be on the Literature Committee, anybody could come. Now you have to be polled and voted in if you even want to be on it. I mean I hate the closing off that I see happening. The exclusion stuff that is going on. I know there use to be a time when there were no time requirements, I was 6 months clean and I was the conference secretary conference, I mean it has just gotten so to a point where I think it would turn a lot of people off to even bother tot try to get on some of these committees. Such a hassle and so hard to get your sign up on the list or get your name. I do not know how they do it now but I know it is not the way they use to do it. Because the Basic Text created by the fellowship, I don't see why that can't still be happening and I am shocked at this whole thing about the 12 principles of service. I think that's so horrible, because its not the NA I know. You know really blows me away, I don't know.

Tape 3
Allentown Addathon 1990
Letter from Doug F.(reading)

I am Eric; I would like to welcome everyone back. We are going to have a moment of silence followed by the Serenity Prayer. Then we are going to open the meeting up and talk about the issues. God, grant me the serenity to accept the things I cannot change, the courage to change the things I can, and the wisdom to know the difference, just for today.
I am going to turn the floor over to Lu and let him explain where we are at. This is Lu, exceptional reading skills (laughter). What I am going to be reading is a letter, inventory history that was written and sent on by somebody who could not be here today and hope you bear with me, because I am not the best reader. I am the one that got asked to do it and I have learned never to say no.

Letter from Doug F.
former volunteer at WSO

> I sometimes think especially today about the reasons why addicts are the way they are. The way they treat each other and the way they feel toward each other even clean. When I first came into the fellowship, I experienced a lot of alienation, especially from the dope fiends. It was as if they really didn't understand who I was or where I had been, and it seemed that if one didn't shoot heroin, go to jail, shoot heroin, go to jail, add infinitum, one just didn't belong. There just did not seem to be room for anyone else. I am beginning to understand why they thought the way they did and I began to understand myself. Whenever you go to a meeting that is comprised of a lot of different people, you get a lot of different ways of thinking and expressing different thoughts. That is why this fellowship has grown the way that it has. We are getting people in who because of the nature of the drugs are recovering from their addiction much faster. If the very essence of narcotics was to be explored they are vastly different than other drugs, and the organization that bears that name in all reality probably should have dedicated itself to the cause of narcotics addiction as opposed to drug addiction. I can see today that the addict of long ago would not have joined the organization

that you see today, but enough of them were here when the transition from narcotics addiction to addiction occurred that when created, did state that narcotics and sedation. I guess when Jimmy wrote it that seemed to suffice in the implication.

At any rate, the purpose of this paper is to explore the addict and the recovery setting and try to discover what is going on around Narcotics Anonymous. It is difficult because if you are an addict because it doesn't necessarily mean you understand addicts. I can only try to reconstruct things from what I have been able to gather from information that I have been given and what I see transpiring today. Not being clean in 1953, I have to reconstruct with some of the information that the foundry gave me. I have to say as acting sometimes biographer sometimes first person I will try to tie it together as best I can with the information that I have. In the final analysis you will have to be your own judge, I am all good conscience and with the guidance of my Higher Power, I will do my best to write the truth and hope that it will be received that way. I am motivated to write this because it is to me an inventory of sorts and I hope to be free of the information and make certain decisions for myself based on this. So in part, this is my personal experience I am sharing with you.

Narcotics Anonymous was the idea of a man by the name James P. Kinnon. I can use the full name now because he is no longer with us. He passed away July 9, 1985. NA started in homes in the San Fernando Valley that is California. These first meetings were called rabbit meetings because they were held in homes and jumped around a lot. Whoever had the meeting at their house next usually took the coffee pot and a box of green glass cups and saucers. This NA is not to be confused with the NA that had attempted to make a start a few years earlier in New York City as reported in the Salvation Army news article and is informed by a Jesuit priest speaker at the 13th world convention of NA held in New York. There is a tape circulating around the fellowship with this story entitled "Junkie Priest". If ever an organization would want to dedicate itself to any individuals, it should be those few suffering addicts who tried and failed in New York because of no support, only hope. It boggles the mind that in a spiritual organization people can fight, take sides, discredit each other and honestly think that what they do is infallible, even to the point of destroying another one reputations and good standing in the community NA. When we have more than just hope, what we have is reality.

At any rate, what happened were the original members got together and met at what was then called the Roads Moorpark meeting. Almost from the beginning, there were problems, one being that Sy Malias who was one of the first AA's to support NA was discovered soliciting money from the LA County General Hospital, and the hospital was ready to pay it for 12 step calls. Jimmy found out about this and put a stop to it informing the hospital that we do not charge, we give this away free. Obviously, those in this very small organization at that time had their own opinions. In the final summation, Jimmy proved right. At approximately the same time another segments of addicts in the name of Narcotics Anonymous offered our services in Northern California for the purpose personal gain in the field of drug rehabilitation, I believe it was in Berkeley. Jimmy K once again met with the people at the university and told them that we do not sell this thing we give it away. This put the damper on those members' activities and stopped them from as Jimmy put it cutting a big fat pig in the ass (laughter) these two single activities along with some differences in basic philosophy in the organization caused what I shall call the north south rift. The basic elements in philosophy were that a couple of members wanted to maintain the steps as the AA version and saw no reason to expand the literature. AA's Book and 12 in 12 would be enough. For many years' addicts coming into the program were told to just add the word drugs to wherever the word alcohol appeared and keep on stepping.

When Jimmy first wrote and compiled the stories for the first little White Book, prior to that we only had a little yellow book, which was informationally lacking. There were still those who were opposing him for even doing that, AA's literature was good enough. I guess if you only knew that it would be good enough I think, at this point we have to remember that the fellowship and information that they had was not being related to by the addict at large. This organization was not being started for those addicts to meet who were

making it in AA, but for those who were not. At any rate through dissention and discord, disharmony ensued and almost threatened to destroy any hope of NA ever developing the proper spirit to continue on. All the while Jimmy continued to have faith in his visions. He never gave up on the addict as so many others had done to us. When the fellowship was wanting and waning you could always find it in Jimmy's maple kitchen table. What he learned about recovery and relapse he learned first hand. When in a moment of jubilation he wrote, "We do Recover" he also experienced that. Although it was tough getting started in the early years consider he was only clean and sober three years he always had faith in his vision and his vision never failed him. As Jack Waley was to recall on tape years later, he would go down to Moorpark, see Jimmy K, a few loaded junkies, and he would go down there to carry his message. Jack died 18 years clean and sober, was a Trustee for many years and died playing handball of a heart attack.

Jimmy's vision came to him at a time when his life again became meaningless, when he began to question his own purpose for being as he was to relate years later a voice told me what I was to do. He never disclosed to anyone what that voice said, but those of us who were close to him never doubted it for a minute. His energy for service in this program was the kind of energy that could only come to one who was so inspired. Most of the text part of that pamphlet was written right down at the end of that table, as he was to recount to us in a meeting at Moorpark in which he was taking his 30-year cake. I can only guess at the feelings that must have come to him as he blew out his candles. He always opened with his pitch. ,my name is Jimmy and I'm an addict, I am here because of so many that came before me and cant be here. I do not think that he ever thought that it was he that doeth the work. Even in relating about writing the pamphlet he merely said that much that was written was written "down at the end of that table". He never claimed any credit for himself he was a humble man, but at the same time with a strong healthy pride and sense of being, he was a Scotsman. Those of us that were fortunate enough to know him got to know an enduring love and a sense of compassion never experienced before. His dedication to NA was unfaltering and his love for this program unending. Even in the course of my own service, there have been times out of disappointment, disillusionment and imagined betrayal that I just walked away. Jimmy never did, he held to the beacon light always helping others to the goal. In the course of my service for many years in the WSO both as a helper stuffing envelopes and eventual vice president of the corporation it was he that first asked me to be in service, it was He that first asked me to get involved. I have to say that in all honesty left to my own devices I would have called sobriety a new car and he taught me what we were about, service. That the more recovery you get the more you had be ready to give it away, because if you do not you will not keep it anyway.

As the disease would have it, NA went through more transitions with some of the members leaving with resentments. The overview would have it that personalities tried to win out over principles, that group split off trying to take the Moorpark meeting with it, and some of the members eventually moved back to Northern California to start the NA that they understood. Amazingly enough there are still people who claim that NA started in Northern California, and I was three years clean myself I heard a woman at the Santa Rosa convention in Northern California stand up in front of the fellowship, raise her arms and tell them that she founded Narcotics Anonymous. Jimmy was present at that function and never spoke to anyone about it; I guess he figured it was not worth going into. After all that was a person along with a few others who had almost destroyed NA's chances of ever getting started. If she now wanted to take credit for the whole deal that was fine with him. All that I really know is that from inception to this very day we are still dealing with persons, attitudes and opinions from this original group that could not accept Narcotics Anonymous coming into being in its own way without AA literature or guidance. Many years later as the regional chairperson I was confronted many times with this issue, particularly in different areas of southern California that would determine to keep the Big Book of AA in their meetings and read from it. They made no small thing of this. People came to the regional meetings and raged at me for demanding that they remove those books from the meetings. I put it to the vote and this region back me in my stand. I always wondered after I had been to one of those meetings and saw each member with a book or books how they in their deepest imaginations could have considered themselves and NA Meeting.

At any rate, I informed them that in order to be considered to be apart of this region that the books would have to go or they should just call themselves an AA meeting. Oddly enough, most of those individuals from that area are the same people who are now on the other side of the coin and projecting this new fanaticism that we are experiencing in NA. I guess if you are a fanatic, any cause will do. Jimmy use to say that being a fanatic was part of spiritual growth and that as soon as you really knew what you were being a fanatic about you stopped being a fanatic.(laughter) We usually keep repeating something until we really know, I guess some people never outgrow that insecurity. It boggles the mind and sometimes I use to think to myself I am really glad that I don't have to see all of this through Jimmy's eyes. At that time, he had about 25 years clean and I guess he had witnessed all of this, the resurgence the repetition of all the nonsense for many years. I think the only thing that he use to ask himself was when are they going to stop arguing and come into the office and do some work. We have always had talkers in NA but very few who just quietly did the work.

At that time in NA History there were no titles to get, only service to render, and most of it was done on the back porch of a mans home. The preceding three attempts at having the office in a rented place had failed through lack of service, lack of interest and lack of Narcotics Anonymous. The last was above a Bail Bondsman Office in Van Nuys California. When Jimmy took it back into his home again there were boxes of orders, opened envelopes, but no checks, apparently they used the money to pay the rent but never filled the orders and no literature, a sad state of affairs to say the least. This was between 75 and 76, prior to that the office was in a mans trunk, not exactly accessible to the fellowship. I don't remember how long it was in that state, Bob B would know it was his car. It was not easy for Jimmy to put it back together but it was easier in 65 ten years earlier. He sat at the Moorpark meeting with only one other member; Sylvia Wexler and she ask what he thought they should do. He looked at the little box of literature and said we will go on. This time at least there was a good start of a fellowship that extended itself to a few meetings in Phoenix, Arizona.

I remember when I first came into NA in 1972 at that time there were only four meetings in Southern California. I went to a meeting at that time in San Francisco and had to open it up because the secretary was not there. It was myself, another clean person, four loaded musicians and a girl who wasn't sure if she was an addict or not. This was the state of affairs when Jimmy took over. The addict with his traditional attitude of I have mine, the addicts did not care if NA ever got out of the San Fernando Valley. Of course, at that time most addicts were going to AA and if the truth were really told not a lot of really made it. The real break for NA came and for the addict to when a man by the name of Bill Beck founded two recovery houses. One in Pasadena called Impact and the other in Sun Valley called Cry Help. Enough addicts came out of these places with a good enough understanding of the program that they stayed clean and the fellowship was to finally have a group of members that got their sobriety via NA and members of NA. I was in that first group that stayed for 9 months, went back out into society and had found it unnecessary for fourteen years to take and mind altering chemicals. Jimmy use to drop by once a day and visit and once a week he conducted a step study. He was a very strong motivating force for all of us. I was especially impressed with 23 years clean.

A couple years later, I asked him to be my sponsor and his reply was I would rather be your friend. I always valued that friendship, through the years we exchanged a lot of things some of them I am sure I have yet to realize. Well anyway, an office had to be put together and somehow fill the orders that were past due. At that time, all he had was a Social Security check so he threw that in the pot and the literature was ordered. Eventually he caught up with it all and NA was now on its way again. His phone use to ring twenty-four hours a day people calling from all over the country. It was safe to say that every existing region had its very first contact with Jimmy K. He was more than just an office worker or contact for NA he was a friend. The personal touch that he gave people was probably a very strong inspiration for many. He use to tell me, if that phone would ever just stop ringing maybe I could just get organized and get something stuff done around here. He often did his work in early morning hours, because that was the only time that he could work undisturbed. During this time, he was also in pain. His legs bothered him constantly. He had emphysema and added heart circulation problem coupled with deteriorating discs in his back, causing him to loose quite a bit

of sleep. In that way, the office being in his home was a blessing. When he could not sleep he could always write a letter to some other part of the country and at least give someone else some hope. I noticed something about him that was followed through in my life; it seemed that whenever he needed that was when he gave the most, in giving he received so much.

I remember him telling me sometimes about himself, about a couple of years prior to our meeting when he had tuberculosis and was in the hospital and was losing his ability to speak. He told his Higher Power that if he would just give him his voice back that he would for the rest of his life talk about Narcotics Anonymous. He was true to his word. When he was in the hospital, he carved the first NA Symbol out into a piece of leather. He said to me that he rarely thought about anything else and getting to a meeting.

It was a little later that I finally got into service. It was great going over to Jimmy's house and mailing literature and reading some of the letters that came in from all over the country. For an organization that did not advertise, NA sure caught on like a house of fire. For a few years, I use to hope from New York because that was the last place I used before coming to California. The letters just kept coming and from them came a reaching out and an effort to addicts that had never been paralleled. One man with the help of a few addicts finally had the opportunity to realize his vision and dream. The lesson here I guess is to just plug along long enough and in Gods time all things come into being. I know that he desired nothing else in the world, he was not a man that was ever impressed by the material world he was a practical man who just believed in planning things out and getting the job done. He use to say to me if it ain't practical, it ain't spiritual, his feet firmly on the ground much like facing a bulldog. If you were not entirely straightforward with the man, he had little use for you. More than once I heard him say to members that were being elusive, when you are ready to come clean then I will talk to you. If it was not about the work, or service or the program, he had little use for the conversation. To my knowledge, he never as long as I knew him ever hurt another human being but I am sure along the way he did hurt a few feelings. He was a no nonsense kind of man and anyone that ever dealt with him personally would tell you that.

I think the most difficult time that we had in the WSO was when a person by the name of Bo S came to one of our conferences with a rough draft of what he called the Book. Everyone was so enamored at the possibility of NA finally getting a book that they were convinced by the way that he spoke that he was indeed the chosen person to do it and the conference did in fact institute a committee giving him full charge and their well wishes. When I first met this man, he claimed to have this mission for NA based on the fact that he had been the speed connection for all of Atlanta Georgia. This was the only way that he could make his amends. He showed me the rough draft that he had that was a Xerox copy with a big light block through the center of every page making it impossible to read. I thought at the time that he was either a hustler or a crazy person. Years later, I hold the opinion that he was both.

A year later he came back to the next conference with four file cabinets full of what a girl that was with him told me was the book. Based on her sincerity and my association with her, Shirley C from Atlanta, I agreed to work with the committee. Being a New York kid I was not easily convinced so I ask if they would mind if we in California Xeroxed what they had and jointly shared and edited the information. They agreed, that year I became part of the Literature Committee. I had the title of Literature Committee Chairperson. Bo and Shirley left after the conference and did not contact me for the rest of the year. We went to a place to Xerox all of this great stuff and I realized and I told them that the majority of what they had belonged to other people, articles, medical studies and psychologist opinions and papers and that this was not in anyway a making of a book. In fact I think that out of all that I reviewed there were but twenty some odd pages that were somewhat original and could be a start of a book. Bo was somewhat discouraged and assured me that this psychologist was a friend of his and that he could get his permission to use all the material. I told him that it was not applicable to our book that he would have to canvas the fellowship for original material and it was left at that.

About then many things started happening that made my tenure and everyone else is very difficult. I don't

know how to explain it or how it started I think that I probably don't know as much about it as I wish that I did and maybe in the future all the facts will be known, I can only write what I know. The year was 1980 and all hell broke loose. It was during my work as chairman of the Southern California RSC that many things started occurring. I had requested $1000.00 for the WSO so we could put first and last months rent on a building that we had located. The decision was made to move the office out of Jimmy's home because there were rumbling that the issue might be brought up at the next conference, which was only a few months away. There was talk that they might want to move it to Georgia. We calculated with so much hullabaloo going on about all the work that they were doing on the book that they probably could have requested anything and got it. At any rate, I requested the $1000.00 from the region. At that, time they had $7800.00 in various checking accounts for various committees, which they claimed, was prudent reserve but in spite of all that, the area reps from all areas voted yes. They were very enthusiastic about the idea.

Many members at the time were very concerned with the fellowship growing at the rate it was that we should have something more to show than Jimmy's back porch. As the chairman, I called the treasurer and requested the check. Simple procedure yes, complicated process. She said she would meet me the next evening at the dance with the check, she did not show up. I called her and she agreed to meet me again, I felt that I was being stalled. She met me, refused to write a check, and said that I should call the chairman of the Board of Trustees. He told me that I should wait until the next conference to move the office and that I had no right soliciting the money for my committee. I took this back to the regional committee and I debated the issue until we had won. The treasurer resigned and I fired off a letter to the Board of Trustees demanding to know why they were trying to control my committee. Much transpired and the details are to numerous to list here the crux of it went something like this, calls were made to every region were made from the Board of Trustees outside of Southern California asking them to freeze any money that they intended to send the WSO until after the conference. Literature orders dropped drastically and we were informed that somewhere pamphlets were being produced without our knowledge and distributed all over the mid to southern southeastern regions. I can only posit a theory that is that some of the money earmarked for the literature committee ended up in this undertaking. Well the office was moved and we received enough orders to keep on going. I have to add at this time that a lot of areas ordered large orders and never paid for them. We seem to be under fire and just could not figure out where it was coming from. A task the started out as love and service was ending up in a war. It became apparent after a short period what was going on. Again the events are so complex and too numerous to list here. The meetings of the 80- 81 conference bear most of it out on the surface. The rest does not leave much to his imagination.

Out of the last literature conferences that were held in Southern California came the joining together of two groups of people. One the new NA or greater NA as the would later blatantly refer to themselves and another group of people were the friends and sponsees of a few people who still had an axe to grind with Jimmy over issues that were now almost over two decades old. These same people who had been involved in the original NA rift between Northern and Southern California were now re-emerging in the form of people they sponsored; they rarely came out front but were always close by. I was to realize that in my short time around I too was to be considered their enemy. Wasn't it I who had made them take the AA books out of our NA Meetings? I guess when I threw in with Jimmy K that there was a lot that I was to understand for me personally. I was also among along with his friendship to inherit his enemies. He never made any bones about it, he told me everything. I went in with my eyes open, just took this warning about certain people as truth, and just did the best I could. I never realized how much power that hate and resentment have until this juncture in my life.

At this point and time the literature committee which had never really been very communicative with the office anywhere showed up at the next conference with a printed and copyrighted copy of what they called our book and requested that we print it immediately. I remember the chairman for the Board of Trustees came over to Jimmy's house and told him that he thought it was a beautiful piece of work and that we should publish it as is immediately. What they had was not the book and was they had and was to undergo many changes over a period of three years until it became somewhat readable, free of plagiarisms and

redundancies and at least qualifiable to be called our basic text. I can only surmise from the events that happened that somewhere a plan was devised to publish the book, move the conference, move the office and remove Jimmy from the new NA or greater NA as they referred to themselves. At that time, all indications pointed toward a split in the fellowship. If this group of individuals now united within and outside of the state did not get their way. Jimmy went to the lawyers and closed the corporation to keep it from being penetrated by these factions who were becoming more vocal and starting to surface everywhere especially at the conference.

I want to give a very special recognition to Bob B. of the Board of Trustees, one can duly note in the minutes along with Bill B. who constantly reminded these individuals one the conference floor that the WSO was a outside issue and a separate entity that had the same autonomy and right as any other committee represented there. It would take the faction another two years to figure out how to get around that. For the meantime we were able to hold the line and secure the home fronts so that Narcotics Anonymous would not be taken over by a group pf addicts who were proving to us that they were fast becoming self serving and treated the traditions like they were there for them and only them to interpret. If you voiced a different opinion, you were accused of disunity, stirring the pot if you will. It was not long before that the discrediting of the WSO began to occur. There were slurs about people not getting the literature ordered letters not answered and talk and accusations about the members in the office using the phones to propagandize. I wondered what kind of organization I was apart of and for that matter what country I was living in It was very clear that this coalition and that included many of the Board of Trustees there is still a few around today would do anything within its power to further its ends. The slurs were endless, I still hear them today. A girl from Florida recently asked me if I had burned all the records in the WSO. The rumors persist that I am just a guy from California who use to work in office and has resentment because he was thrown out. The tactics that these people used are abhorrent and as Jimmy use to say reprehensible. In May of ’81, he gave me his personal resignation to deliver to the conference and read. It was one of the saddest days of my life. I felt that if he was leaving the Board of Trustees who could you trust. I have in the course of service in NA had many points of disillusionment. This was one of the greatest," due to the unconscionable actions of some members of the Board of Trustees on a personal level and the mistrust, division and disunity engendered by the same within the fellowship I submit my resignation on this date, April 27, 1981". His resignation was then followed by Bill B. His statement in short reads, I hereby resign as a member of the Board of Trustees because I refuse to do business with deceit and dishonesty that more or less summed it up. The Chairman of the Board stated that he would gladly accept Bill’s resignation on whatever conditions he placed it. He was later to lull the conference to sleep by stating after re-nominating Jimmy back to the board that he was sure that Jimmy would come back to his senses and come back to the board. He further stated to quall any thoughts about the board that Jimmy was to NA as Bill W was to AA and that no one had gone out of their way to hurt him. All they wanted to do was steal his dream and take it to Atlanta. As Bo was once overheard saying by the secretary of the conference and myself , we didn’t want to hear about those people driving Cadillac’s out in California after this book is published. He further stated which I think is very solicitous of him that Jimmy is of his right mind and in good health that he had just met with him this morning and he was all right. The rumor was along with other slurs that he was senile and he could not listen to reason.

All that I can tell you about this part of service or the business of NA is that daily a devastating experience. As each day opened, there were more rumors and more innuendos. Jimmy took the position that we would answer none of it. Just keep our heads down and do the work. I do not think to this day that many people really know the whole truth that is besides the people who spread the lies to begin with. The lies that were spread not only hurt Jimmy and the people in the office but the addicts themselves, NA as a whole. I was the main speaker at the 12th World Convention in Milwaukee, Wisconsin. After I got off the podium a young girl fell at my feet crying, please let them print the book, why do not you let them print the book. She told me that her brother had OD’d a few weeks before and that if she had had the book she could have saved his life. I felt so sorry for her and in trying to comfort her; I forgot to ask her where she had gotten that information. It was very bizarre, a throng of people were standing in line to thank me and an accuser hangs on my legs crying like I was Napoleon responsible for the life and death of a civilization. A similar

experience happened to Jimmy K in New York after he appeared at the 13th World Convention. An accuser stopped him and asked him what the fuck he did with the money from the book Referring that the money raised by the fellowship for the book that was lost in a bankruptcy by the printing firm that we contracted to print it. It is not long before that these individuals some Board of Trustees and others put together an AdHoc committee through the conference in 1982 to as they put it; get to the bottom of things. If a frontal assault did not work, I guess they would go through the bottom. They gathered up a report of complaints at the time that they felt would be satisfactory to dismiss our board all in the name of unity and Sally E. was at the forefront of that movement. In the course of that conference, a select committee was appointed to deal with this issue behind closed doors. This was a last minute decision, which they came about through my informing them that I too had a report. Mine dealt with the breaking of Traditions by the Board of Trustees. Not just a few letters not getting mailed without going into the infinite of what went down in this committee of who said what to whom I will take special note that James D. Newly elected board member upon leaving after I was in the process of reading my report exclaiming I want to get out of here I think I am going to throw up. I am sure that the recounting of this story he will say that he had the flu that day. If you know anyone long enough probably, everyone changes their story. At any rate, the rest is history.

As far as me leaving the office, it was precipitated by the standing board and the newly elected board to the WSO. I came to work at the office one day and one of the volunteers came up to me and told me that there had been some changes. The WSO board had met and elected a new president, this being new to me I further inquired. It seemed that the board had an emergency meeting called by the president Phil P. and that he had resigned last night and had nominated a new president who was elected. The new president was Chuck G. This to me was the most vicious cut of all. I was the vice president of a non-profit organization duly elected to that board with a legal responsibility and was not even called to an emergency meeting or present at the election of a new president. To say that I felt slided is to understate it. I felt humiliated, deceived and betrayed. I called the lawyer for the corporation and asked him what recourse I had. This was an obvious error, like calling your wives lawyer during a divorce (laughter). He told me that he did not see any recourse that I had and said frankly to me that he had never encountered a situation like this before and agreed with me that it was a very unusual thing to happen for a non-profit organization. He could not figure what the gain was in the move; I was all too familiar with the move. I had seen it used before in the case of Bill B. It had cost him the two recovery houses he had founded, in both cases discrediting information was first circulated then the bounce. I think that this is called character assassination. A sad commentary on a great career that a man embarks upon only to be cheated out of it when he reached the goal. No unlike what happened to Jimmy. There are many in this fellowship that should be searching their conscience about what they said and did to these men. Many of the individuals involved were the same people in both cases.

I am not asking anyone to do that for me because what was done to me did not destroy my life livelihood or dreams, it only hurt my feelings. It made me grow up a little faster than I would have chosen to and prompted me to write these things. The thing that I have been taught and learned it well is to write. Jimmy had signed off the corporation a year prior to all the eventual power struggles. I guess he saw the writing on the wall. At the time of my resignation, Jimmy was working as the office manager having demoted himself from director and president of the corporation to office manager and was happy to just make sure that the day-to-day work went smoothly. By the next conference with no one there to really protest, they voted him out and elected a new office manager. I often wondered what the threat was with him just being there overseeing the work and sharing the legacy of his program with the newer members. He was a man who could accept change he would have been happy to do it. After all, wasn't the new office manager called the executive director? Would there have been enough room in this organization to let him just stay or come in a few days a week. What I guess I am really asking is don't these people have any respect. Was the hunger for power so great that all power even personal power of a single man had to go? Was the vendetta so deep that all that got in its way had to be vanquished? Was not there just a little room still left in anyone's heart for the founder of Narcotics Anonymous. Yes founder, conceiver, and worker among workers, first committed and last to leave.

Until recently, I always had those questions in my mind. Recently I had them all answered for me. First, they changed one word back to the way AA says it which was my first indication that the old guard was back. ”These” instead of “those”, those indicating the 11 steps that precede the 12th step, which is a result of those 11 steps, we had a spiritual awakening, which makes perfect sense to me. It also made perfect sense to the man who was inspired to make that change in 1953 along with adding ”We” before each step and changing alcohol to addiction. A few simple changes that significantly changed the lives of thousands of people now a worldwide endeavor. But now 35 years later we are told that steps the way they use to be were not good enough. I only wonder if these individuals get away with this, what will they do next. They send around the changes to meeting along with the message to stop using certain words that it is bad for newcomers and 20 newcomers disappear out of our Hollywood meetings, and the beat goes on. Where is it going to end? When I went to start petitions to stop the power madness by certain members of the fellowship who are not happy that they have all the positions of power in the organization. They get free plane trips all over the world, free hotel and meals, ambassadors to the unknown is what they should be calling themselves (laughter). Apparently, all the public adulation, all the freebies just are not enough. They now want to revise the literature and change the steps. Tell everyone how to talk and just generally run our lives, spiritual programs and control what we read protect us from words that might have something to do with sanity. What is all this bullshit about?

Now I know why they wanted for Jimmy to disappear, he was the only sane person left that they had to reckon with. He was the only one that would have told them they were crazy. I mean all right if we are all crazy because no one will know the difference. Now if we can just convince everyone else that we are sane and they are crazy then we will be all right. This is a group of lunatics. To change any part of this program or the steps is like going to Ford Motor Company and telling them to re-design their engine because it does not work. To get back to reality, pardon my trip, when all this stuff came down at the last conference I was about as confused and unknowledgeable as anyone else. It has taken me several weeks to just comprehend information that I have and to reconstruct with help of conference participants what went on at that great gathering where that group of addicts got together to one more time save all of our lives.

It seems that according a member from England, I could not find anyone far enough a way from the problem or without the usual religious fanatical Ferber to talk about it. They offered us the changes to vote on we voted against them, so they tried to find a more palatable way of coming at us with them so that they could get the desired yes vote. When they did not get the yes vote, they went into an ad-hoc committee to discuss them. After five days, they finally got their way and we went home. If you remove, the twelve votes that the Board of Trustees hold they seem to be voting in mass according to the minutes of the conference you would not have been able to get those changes through. I do not blame them for voting for change after all they did change the literature that they were asking everyone to cooperate with and vote on. They made those changes regardless of historical content or continuity or spirit of the literature that they violated. I feel like someone had torn up a Bible in front of me and I have to grin and bear it and work my perfect program. Well folks guess what I am not like a lot of you. I don’t have to look good all the time. As far as what you say about me, I don’t really care. When you discredit ten years of service and hard work in this organization by just summarizing my whole service career with “He is just a guy that we kicked out of the office and now he has resentment”, it really doesn’t matter. I saw how you treated my best friend and what you said about him and I would consider it an honor it you would treat me the same way. (laughter) I will promise you one thing though no matter what you say in your rebuttal, no matter how dishonest you become I will not lie about you the way you lied about me. I would not betray and desert you the way you did to me. I would not alienate you from your fellows and reject you as a human being because of what you think. I will not judge you in private and say other when I see your face. You can say whatever you want to at any meeting that I attend and I won’t pull you aside afterward and defile and violate your being by telling you the words that I don’t want to hear you say. Because I live in America and I am a member of Narcotics Anonymous and was told by an old man that I could be anything that I had to be until I discovered who I really was. I learned recovery the right way, the free way where conditions were non-existent. What I was offered when I got here was love and along with it a responsibility which was offered to me unconditionally and would always be

> available to those who came after me. I know that I could turn and walk away. God know what my involvement in the past has cost me but maybe today it might just be a little different. After all aren't I still an addict. Maybe this time it will be different and people will care when I tell them what I know and how I feel. Maybe a few addicts like myself will take courage and move ahead to our proper places as concerned members of Narcotics Anonymous who can accept that there is no such thing as a recovered addict. That there are no musts in NA does not exist anymore, that we have no leaders it has been eliminated. That this program is no longer a suggested program.
>
> That's it from Doug F.

At this time, I would like to ask Fawn if she would like to say anything about where she left things off last night or in reference to anything she did not finish saying or about this letter.

Fawn: Hi, I'm Fawn I'm an addict. Did anyone have any questions? I don't know I pretty much what I covered last night I finished. I think someone approached me this morning and asked me about what progress is being made in the way of putting some kind of text, a history text together. I have spoken to Betty quite frequently, Betty was Jimmy's wife and she's got lots and lots of file cabinets of archival history of Narcotics Anonymous, because Jimmy was a saver of a lot of stuff. Written correspondence, to and from individuals confirming that we were not apart of any that, we had no affiliation with the early NA in New York or Louisville Kentucky, Lexington I'm sorry. So anyway God knows what is there, it has been very hard to open up. She has moved a few times and she schleps all these file cabinets wherever she goes and she kept them closed for along time because it is painful for her to go through all this stuff. A few years ago, Lynn A. a friend of ours approached Bob Stone at the office and said that, that Betty was willing to turn all of these historical archives over to Narcotics Anonymous under one condition that they not be revised, edited, or changed in anyway because they represented NA, as we know it began. There was an immediate answer by Bob and he said No I can't give you that condition because as soon as you give us something the office can do with it what ever we want to do with it. So under those conditions she said forget it. So now needless to say because of the events that had happened she is not very trusting to a lot of the people who are over anxious to get something going because of what you just heard and stuff like that. She was very apprehensive about whom to trust with this project to because she knows she cannot do it alone. So a few of us have been working on that and we are scheduled to meet with her either this summer or in the fall and we are going to start trying to put this stuff into some kind of order , by months maybe by years first, so that NA can have some kind of historical thing to go with. As far as the outcome of the project how it will ever get, if it will ever be approved, as we know literature how it gets approved today through the conference. I don't know if it will ever happen that way and a lot of that should be understandable after the letter you just heard read here today, because a lot of our history affects those people who are still empowered. That is where the difficult part is going to come in because you know that's it. From what I understand this is all, she has all this historical stuff and something is, she is ready. I know that there are some history workshops going on, I know there is one in Alabama in August. They are real excited about it I know they are handing out some flyers about it , I don't know if you guys up here have received those fliers, if you haven't I guess I can send some to Dave or Billy, and you guys can pass them out. So there is, workshops starting to happen and right now, what I think is going on is people are talking about the history because maybe that is the beginning of anything. Just like with our Basic Text there was, as Bo will cover later, there was talking of the idea for us to be discussed and talked about and then it starts to become something. Oh, great.

Grateful Dave addict. Had a couple of questions. Hi Dave, hi family. It is like part of the problem today as Douglas said in his letters that currently people who are in positions of power are still running our World Services and flying around. Our World Service Board of Director chairperson and the chairperson of our World Service Board of Trustees were some of the people that Douglas was referring to in that letter that stole Cry Help and Impact from Bill Beck is not that correct. That is one question.

Fawn: You want to know if that is correct. Well put it this way, Bill Beck was the Executive Director, Jack was the Assistant Executive Director, and these treatment centers were run by dope fiends for dope fiends. It was not very

structured, they lived off donations from the community you know they would send vanloads of residents out to Safeway, and you know can you give us some bread to feed us. It was like a 6 to 9 month program and so it was not I do not know all the details, because I was a resident at that time at Cry Help and under the, when Bill Beck was the Executive Director. That is where I first heard it you know, I loved being there I learned a lot about myself and the program when I was there. I do not know what went down, I was not behind the board meeting, and all I do know is that Bill Beck took a typewriter home and a lot of times. Oh I know another issue that the board had of the treatment center was that, a lot of times we would do trading, like the printing company would give us paper if we sent a couple of the residents over there to collate. So it was like I think they charged them accused them of slave labor or something. No I do not recall when I was being a resident there of ever feeling like I was being used or mis abused or whatever.

The charge was ( ) misuse of federal funds for his own personal gain, and it was Jack Bernstein who was apart of that legal movement to get him. I just want people to know that we are being led by thieves, liars and punks. ( )

I have a , you know in that letter it talks about a north south rift, it refers to the north , south rift, just like today we seem to have an east west rift. Narcotics Anonymous, repetitive historical past that seems to be in that same direction today again. That north south rift, could you put more light on that.

Fawn: Well I know it had to do with, like the letter was talking about it had a lot to do with the AA terminology and literature being used in our NA meetings. You know back then you have to understand that most addicts were going to AA and NA. Na was not always as large so a lot of the people were going to both. A lot of the Trustees that are on the board today you know started out in AA. That is where NA was at back then. So there was a lot of resentment that was born when this movement started to happen about let NA stand up on its own two feet and be a fellowship onto its own and quit using AA's literature and stop all these Tradition violations and that did not sit to well with some of the old timers. There has always been that competitive thing; you know who can do it better, who has got it stronger, who got more you, know.

I am addict, Yeswau by name. Hi Yeswau. See if I can word this right. I am trying to think how to say this and put it on a respectable level, instead of a street level. Ok, we got these people, this Board of Directors who have their foundation in AA, this is what I am understanding and they cannot seem to detach from that and be NA people to help Narcotics Anonymous. I guess my question is, it does not help me for somebody to tell me the board, or the directors. I need James this, Andrew that, Andre this, Sandra this, whoever the names are. What their position is and how we can write letters to them and tell them and tell them what we do not like what they are doing or whatever. And how we as the fellowship can organize to out, to remove them and put people who are responsible in those positions to continue the primary purpose of Narcotics Anonymous.

Fawn: Well all the, the information is available to everybody. It is in your World Service Conference meeting minutes. If you just take a little time and do your homework, you can see the names yourself, who made the motions, Read who is making the motions that is very important. The history of the conferences is another very important thing to understand. Early on in our history, everybody could vote ok. It is pretty much the way you have it now the board, the different boards all had a vote. Now another thing that was also possible back then was that these World Service subcommittees, if you wanted to be a member, if any NA member wanted to be a member they could. They were not closed subcommittees, anybody who was anybody in NA all you had to do was say you wanted to be apart of it. So you would try your best to fly yourself out to when they met and all that. Another thing that was happening at the conference was that as long as you were a member of a subcommittee you could talk, you could not vote but you could speak. So this is how a lot of shit got stirred up at the conferences, you Had a lot of people talking and a lot of movements going on at the same time, I mean this is how I saw it okay. There was a lot of confusion, but if you go through you meeting minutes, when the meetings were written back then, because I was secretary for two conferences in a row, I did names, I do not believe in this other shit. I did not always reveal the last names but lease I put the first name and initial, who made the motion, some of the discussion and was it carried or was it failed. A lot of times, you can sort of get a feeling for whom, you can see the movement being forged, and what you can really see when you look all through this is how the shaping personalities have shaped our World Services that is what has happened. My

personal opinion is that because all these boards who have a vote and a voice at the conference. They represent nobody, nobody but themselves. How could they possibly feel and experience what a group conscience is a vote is alright not like an RSR could, so my feeling has always been if the RSR's are the only ones who can vote because they represent someone they don't even represent themselves technically, they represent their regions. If they would come to the World and that was all that was on the agenda, is what your region wants, there is no room for any of this other ego shit that going on. You know because these, too much is coming from the World down to my region and I know it is not coming from my region and going to the world. So that is kind of, I think how that was born was years ago in NA because of the I guess it is the overall mentality or the personality of the addict if somebody else will do it let them. The apathetic stuff you know with GSR's, ASR's and RSR's it was always like ok you are our GSR, or you're our ASR or you're our RSR, go vote how you feel best for us. We will give you that vote of confidence you know so that is where your problems happen see. If you think about it, most of your people who are involved with service work are new in recovery. I do not know if all of them have worked all the steps or familiarized themselves. That is a very dangerous thing to put upon anyone you know I am going to vote how I see fit and hope that it is Gods will. So what you see happening is, I think it is very natural when you are overwhelmed and new in a big group of people you want to be heard you want to let people know, Hey I am on the ball I know what's happening. So this is what happens because they can just arbitrarily just make a motion or when it has come from nowhere. So that is what I see as being the disease in our world services. That it has stopped being a group conscience endeavor. I mean regional reps may go there and vote certain ways but they are being manipulated and politicked when they get there because these issues were not talked about at home. I mean because I read these minutes and I never heard these issues in my area. My group never made a motion to do a lot of this stuff with the changing of our literature. So I think if we got back to the basics, open committees, a system of rotation more volunteerism and true group conscience, that we will heal our World Services. It starts with the group, it starts with you know how well are your business meetings going? Encourage the members to participate in the group conscience. Teach them the difference between a group conscience and a vote and expect more from our GSR's and ASR's and our RSR's and this stuff will not happen. We have laid it all; we know what a group conscience is.

Yeswau: I understand that Betty has this compilation of material and she wants to put it in the proper place, in proper hands. Is there a group of concerned NA members like yourself who understand the sophistication of all of this and acquiring a place to put all this stuff and somebody to go through this and put our history in a chronological reasonable, rational, readable order so that us as NA members can read this? I mean are you going to get it printed. In other words, what is being done starting with today about getting this material together?

Fawn: Around the world there is a young by the name of Lynn up in New York, there are some people in California. I know that Lynn is a writer a professional writer, and I am a professional typist so I do not know. I don't know what the final outcome will be, but I know that's what is going to be started this year is that we are all going to meet and we are put it in some form and try to get the ball rolling. Does that answer your question?

Hi, I am an addict named Jodi: Hi Jodi. Before I get to the question, I need to share something briefly. First, I wish to make a statement that I never used the chemical alcohol and I never went through any treatment center, rehab, nothing. I am a pure NA baby and very proud of it. Recovery from the disease not only being clean is possible in NA only and I have a right to this fellowship NA, pure unadulterated NA, and I have a right to that. So I had to leave California, I could not find NA. There are two people in this room that have taught me something, very much. One person taught me a lot about the principles, the steps, the traditions, the politics, and the importance that personal recovery depends on this. We cannot run from this, our personal recovery depends on NA unity. I see people throwing up their hands not wanting to be involved but personal recovery depends on it. Someone else has taught me that sometimes our disease can get so lost in the intellectualism behind this and get so caught up and focusing on the politics that we lose the personal side of this. How is it affecting us, how is it affecting the newcomers. I see people throughout not wanting to get involved in the controversy and not understanding how this relates to them. Well what does history has to do with me, what does history has to do with recovery, what does history. I was talking to someone this morning that really pointed up that I would like this addressed because I heard a newcomer say and I have had the same experience that they tried reading the 5th Edition and they were not getting it. It was like a textbook to them and they were not understanding it. As soon as they got a copy of this unapproved rebellious outlaw

3rd edition revised, it clicked and this is what we are talking about here. This does affect our recovery. It affects the recovery of the members. It affected my recovery I living out there being fed lies and dying from my disease and not knowing what is wrong until I got the truth. It does affect personal recovery. In that area where the denial is so thick there, are addicts with 8 and 10 years clean killing themselves and not knowing why, because of this propaganda. Now that I know that, they are not hearing the NA message and hearing this propaganda is a lot of why these people have been killing themselves clean. You know an avoidance of the personal side of this, like the two extremes, you know the head in the sand versus the head in the clouds. My question is, I would like to know from Doug and I would like to know from Bo and from Greg and from you and all these people I would like to know your opinion on how this affects each member, their recovery and how it has affected your personal life. Because you know I found out I was pregnant yesterday and my immediate response was you know I had a material comfort in California and I am not having that here. But I have found NA and I have found recovery and my immediate response was I am going to go back to California and do the financially responsible thing and I am also here on a mission not only for my personal recovery, but on a mission so to speak. And what I have heard here, what I have heard here from each one of you has made me realize that money doesn't solve everything, that we can be dead and rich from this disease. It has affected, this weekend has affected my personal life because I have decided to stay here. Someone said to me last night, my disease would love for me to go to California, it is true. So let us address how this is affecting the individual member and us that is kind of my question. Let us not get so caught up so in all these politics that we do not see that, cause it does. You know there are addicts out there dying because they do not hear the NA message, I know because I was almost one of them.

Fawn: Thanks for sharing. How has all of this affected me? It has made me angry, it has made me sad, it has made me feel powerless and ineffective like my hands are tied, there is nothing I can do so why do anything. That is pretty much the feeling. I remember when I had about four years clean and I quit. I was living out here and I called my girlfriend out on the west coast and I said, I can't believe what happened, I can't believe what happened, why did it happen it can not be Gods will. She said just remember every dog has its day. (Laughter) So I had to like that sounds good you know. I do not know I would like to see change come about in a peaceful way. I don't get off on fighting like I use to, when I was younger in my recovery I had a lot of anger so I could get in there and roll my sleeves up and really get off on all that. It disturbs the little peace I have in my life today to hear what I hear and still feel those old feelings familiar again. It inspires me to see members who have come after me who have made a commitment not only to Narcotics Anonymous but also to try and make NA better for the newcomer. And I know that the people who make that commitment it is kind of hard to walk around peacefully and talk about these issues. Because when you love NA, when people are messing with it or distorting it as how you know it is to be it makes you angry. It is our life. Every now and then every meeting I go to I go by the literature displayed at the tables and one time my friend Leah said, Fawn why do you always go by the tables to look at the literature and I say I just want to make sure they have not changed our name yet. (Laughter) So anyway, that is how it has affected me. I am resolved to a lot of the things but there is still some old pain that I have not come to terms with. I am still confused about the way some things happened. I don't really see anything, I don't know because when I share with newcomers, I don't share about these issues I just share about the program and they can't take that away from me. Maybe if our literature is changed enough maybe I could see how it would affect the newcomer. You know if we changed the, you know sometimes taking out one word or inserting a new word can change a whole meaning and spirit of a paragraph.

Audience: This will be a real simple one for you because I am just going to ask for a yes or no when I am done with it. I am going to ask if maybe I am correct to assume something. Because I am going to assume something right now, okay. Jodi was just asking a question there and you basically talked about how it affected you but basic effects of history. If we had, I would assume that if we had our history documented put down all the issues that we have gone through from 1953, the growing process, the conference actual growth from when it started the office when it started the decision making process, how it evolved and where it has taken us today. That if we had all that documented I would be almost to assume that we had something to look at and be able to better clarify and make decisions in the home group on the direction we are going as a fellowship. But also, that it will protect us from ourselves from making bad decisions, from allowing a power structure from to be created then. If we could have that documented and see how it grew and how what we look at and say it is a power structure. The letter talked about old guard, the old guard, as I know to care is more of an old AA philosophy. Which is introducing an AA service structure to us basically right

now. I a fellowship report to going to Columbia and really the World Service Office today endorsing them following the AA service structure. Helping to set that up overseas, same thing with the principles that there talking about with their concepts or whatever they want to call it today. But it is basically, you know the stuff we could see a lot better if we had our history documented. Would I be correct to assume that?

Fawn: I do not know. I do not know. I do not know if having all our history in black and white is, I cannot answer that. I mean how would I know.

Audience: Would you be able to see it if it was written, and say hold it. This has happened in the past, it did not work. It is documented here, it factual so why are we going in this direction again?

Fawn: Sounds good. (Audience) and I will tell you something else that really worked that was very effective. If you are really upset about what is going on at the World. On mass movements are very effective. I do not care, I mean one year at the conference there were people from all over Georgia who flew in, and hitch hiked, and showed up bare feet, barefooted. I mean they were there, Newcomers some with just 30 days you know they were committed to this effort. It was very impressive, so you know if we as a group band together impress upon the conference what our concerns are and demand that we get the answers that we are looking for. I have not lost hope in that process. I believe it can and should work. I am just as baffled by all of this as you are. I do not go to those conferences anymore. Until every one of them has resigned and I can be assured that none of their sponsees are, have taken their places I refuse to go. I have no interest; I think it should be on a rotation system. We need the freshness and the newness and giving everybody a chance.

I am Grateful Dave, I am an addict. Hi Dave. Hi Family. I am going to keep hitting this mic and you know I am going to ask questions but I am going to have to make them more like a statement because I am not getting direct answers. The purpose of our history at least in my viewpoint is for all of the people to sit down and say what they got to say and pull no punches and name names, everybody gets to say their thing, and it gets printed up. That is the history, and that is the discussion, everybody is perspective, right wrong or indifferent. Now I know a lot of stuff, I know a lot of stuff. I could stand up here all day with stuff that has been perpetrated on this fellowship in the name of the still suffering addict. The vile undertones, the manipulation, and the lies you know. Jimmy Kinnon walking to the door of the World Service office and having a box kicked out, thanks for thirty-two years of answering the phones. You know I know about what I said about, because the man who wrote that letter told me what happened. I know Stu Tordman and I know Jack Bernstein, I have been knowing them for years. They have been lying to us for years. They lied to you just recently on the telephone. So let us get real. Bob Stone was there and Bob Reymar was there. They just appeared, they just showed up one day at the World service Office and nobody knew who they were or where they came from. There was letters sent from the WSO all to the east coast and personal phone calls made by these people to make Jimmy look like a schmuck and get him kicked out. There was lies told and those people are still controlling the fellowship, the Chuck Skinners, the Chuck Gates the Reymars , the new generation the Houlihans and these people are perpetrating a hoax on us in the name of the addict who still suffers. So we got to have this truth told, and I come up to the microphone and people say Well God damn Dave you are angry. Well you are fucking right I am angry because I have been involved with these people for six years plus. And I know them, and he knows them and we know them and you guys do not know them and you cannot believe that this shit goes on in Narcotics Anonymous because you go to NA as such, which is the home group where everything is warm and fuzzy and everybody loves one another and everything is all fucking spiritual. Well let me tell you something that is not reality that is not reality. There are millions and millions of dollars that being played with that belongs to God. It does not belong to a corporation it does not belong to anybody. This message , our book belongs to God. Give it to them for 50 cents give it to them. Who needs a World Service Office to get bigger and bigger and bigger? They ain't doing nothing, but perpetrating a great big hoax on this fellowship in the name of the addict who still suffers. There are 70, 80, 100 people that go to a World Service Conference and do not do anything that we do in our home groups, and all it takes is one trip. Open your eyes, open your mouths tell the truth. Bo knows stuff, you know stuff , I know stuff, Forrest knows stuff, and Billy knows stuff. We know shit that would make you sick and make you crawl out the door, but we are still here clean carrying the message. And the truth is something that we desperately need. Now I am going to back off, but and I am again, and I am going to these question quote statements slash but we need direct answers.

But Sally Evans friend Jacqueline Lear gets hired before the World Service Conference for $100.000.00 dollars to write " It works , How and Why" and the literature committee comes up with a new idea oh boy we didn't approve anything professionally written before but now we've got this great new idea, lets hire professional writers . Only lets pay them, they are addicts so that we can control them. That is what you are going to be reading from now on. That is what that 4th and 5th Edition is they were never conference approved. It was dope fiended on the floor, when are going to wake up. That literature, a pamphlet, get a pamphlet, go to a printer a quarter of a cent quarter of a cent. Go to a copy machine you can have pamphlets in your home group for a penny.

Fawn: Dave, Dave, I am telling you the answer is you will take, (Grateful Dave saying, the answer is to do something different) You will take power away from these people who represent no one if you insist that regional reps vote their groups conscience. There is nothing else to discuss, there is no under handed, under the table motions. There is no getting wined and dined with dinners , promises being made that you will get this or that. I mean think about from the individual GSRs if, we did service more in line with that, we would not have this out of control nonsense that we see. Because you know you have to ask yourselves ok the conference keeps saying that it is fellowship approved because all the regional reps voted on it I cannot believe it, I mean I cannot believe that what is making a lot of regional reps from NA go, think, deciding these things. So I would assume that they are misinformed when they get there, do not know all the facts, and are being taken off to the side and told well this will be so good for NAs and this is why you should vote this way. It is like a political party. You know I am really getting, there are some other people here who can answer questions to. I do not want to be like the person who knows all the answers cause I really do not. Thanks Fawn….Applause

The first thing I need to say right now is that we are leaving the letter and basically we are going into the 1980 conferences from 1980 to now, a basic area where Fawn was not involved . She went to the point where she could answer the questions on up to her involvement, and to go any further with that there is basically being another section of this here later, and we go over the conference through the eighties after the Basic Text stuff and go through that process, literature process. We have people here like myself, Bo, Forrest that have been involved in World Service Conference for an extreme period of time during the eighties that can better facilitate them kind of questions. You know that is a real extreme period of emotional growth and maybe lack of growth at times that we have gone through. That is some of the stuff we are going to get into later on this agenda, and if anything any questions need to be ask in reference to the letter or that should be it and I think we have gone beyond that at this moment. I think Fawn did a really great job and I think she did a beautiful job for us last night. They are going to bring lunch in here and what we want to do next is go into the Basic Text stuff next, the literature process itself which I think that is really important. Because Fawn ( ) to some things that I believe made it possible for real early literature stuff, was committee stuff and that stuff will be shared in the openness of our literature process in the early days which I was introduced to. You know and that is going to be real valuable information and I think we owe Fawn another applause and thank her, cause I am in gratitude for her participation here. If you want to go have a cigarette quick, go have a cigarette and come back we will have lunch in this room. Applause…..

Tape Four
Allentown History Literature Addathon 1990
Speaker; Bo S

My name is Bo, I am an addict. Hi Bo. Hey everybody, well I am glad to be here, part of me does not want to be here, and I tried to say my prayers a while ago. What I am going to try to do is not play it smart and you know I really think the pickle we are in today is only going to be healed when a succession of members come out of the hole and speak the truth and then there will be some good in that and some harm in that . But at lease it will be real and a real we can live with and carry on. I am not afraid and I am not saying this with any sense of embarrassment or negative anticipation. You know we have grown a lot and exist as a fellowship under a set of pressures and financial concerns and legal considerations and interactive boards that may at times either forget that they are directly responsible or it is hard to see that they are responsible based on their actions.

Let us see I guess I served at world for about ten or eleven years. I was probably involved at world probably like twelve years, and for the past year and a half I have not held any elected position at Narcotics Anonymous and I sort of feel like and alumni or something, like I am still involved and still play a role just not in any official capacity, nor do I wish to. I feel like I am lucky to have escaped with my life, my clean time and my sense of humor and my faith and to have gotten to see the miracles that took place. Because I was very, very, very, very spoiled. All of us were. We were very fortunate. You know going back to what I originally said though just about winging it. See the chance is if I made a series of intended carefully prepared statements then it might come off better to you people but then I might miss out some ambient thought that God might put in my mind and then that might trigger some good thing in you and so I would rather go with the ambient thought. Of course, we can also cover some other more like technically correct ground. I am also glad this is something I have thought about the last few weeks coming up on this. I am glad that I do not hold any elected position, I am glad that I am not seeking any elected position. Because for years I mean I had to function under constraints, like one way I would phrase my membership on the Board of Trustees was I am required to do many things and there are certain things I cannot do. And functioning within those constraints I mean it is a lot of change from being a using addict to a clean addict. I got use to reading that much paper a month, I started losing my eyesight. I was out of town thirty out of fifty weekends I was at world services and what was killing me was I thought a lot of money was getting spent on me and it wasn't doing the people no good. It started tearing me up inside and making me feel guilty, so I am glad I am out. The other nice spin off is I can come and meet with members of the fellowship like we are doing today and share things in hopes that it will help others, we got a lot of help.

One thing and you know just kind of picking up on some of the things Fawn was sharing and some of the things Doug shared in his letter. We came in to the picture in the mid 70's, we were east coast, and there were no meetings in Narcotics Anonymous in Atlanta Georgia when I got clean. I tried to start Narcotics Anonymous in 1971; I had spent three more years out there. This buddy of mine had gotten in AA so at the end of one of my marriages, I went to see my buddy Jim and his wife Rachael and sure enough, they were there and then a month later they announced and started holding this NA Meeting. By then I didn't even want to go, but you know I guess I was just curious. Then I was back at that meeting every Friday night for five years, and I noticed there was something real special about that meeting out of all the other meetings I was going to. And I guess there was something special too about the way the AA's treated me because I didn't sit and say I was an alcoholic or anything I said my name is Bo and I am an acidhead , my name is Bo and I'm a speed freak. I would notice the people at the close of the meeting some of them would jump up with this one expression on the face and run towards me and others would jump and intercept them. I think the interceptors intercepted them because they knew I was not kidding that I was sincere. I guess that is why. Anyway, every time they had a NA meeting then I would stop going to AA meetings, then there were seven meetings a week in Atlanta, and I have not been back to AA for recovery for oh along time, ah 13 years. I celebrated my 16th year anniversary last Tuesday, thank you. But there are addicts in AA and those addicts in AA helped me, and the alcoholic addicts in AA the ones that were sincere understood and helped me.

You know when it came to the Basic Text they helped me, because this one guy says, well as long as you stick to what you actually experienced nobody in the world can say that you're wrong. The instant you drift off into theory or conjecture almost anybody can pick you apart. So when I got elected world lit chair and was able to spearhead the movement, I repeated that to people and in open committee I would say stay away from them good ideas and stuff keep it real addict clean recovery experience. So that was our constant yardstick and that's what we held up, that was the measure, any piece of input we would hold it up to that yardstick and if it didn't stack up in terms of addict experience it didn't get in the Basic Text. Even though it might sound neat as a pin, you know we did not want any cool lines that would kill. You know there were other small but good things, some of the good will was important. Anyway, well just I guess leaving that thing on AA for a moment. It is just real impressive to me considering the monstrous nature of our disease how much they were able to do before we finally started growing. How much good and how much love and how much gentleness and how much mutual respect of course they had to earn their stripes and it did not come easy and of course we are having to earn our stripes and it ain't coming easy. I mean, does that mean you want me to speak up, oh okay, just checking. Oh, I bought these picture books, kind of, like family albums but y'all can look at them, just do not steal no pictures please. But, anyway, I guess if you are going to hear about lit workers then it might do to see some. There are a lot of other shots in there but they were just a mess in the drawer so I stuck them in those books. Anyway I had had a little bit of college, I had born like, you know one of those families

you see on TV where one part of the family has millions and millions of dollars and then there is the poor relatives, well that was like me. But I knew some of my uncles and so forth and I knew that you know money never impressed me worth a damn not in and of itself. I was on this sort of like quest for answers; I mean I went to coffee houses, beatniks. I can remember the first time I heard the word hippie I use to have hair longer than anybody in this room and had a gold earrings, and then somebody said , no gypsies put it on the other ear, so I had the pierce the other ear to be cool. I am trying to get some of my background because it was of, and the beatniks put a lot of sort of like respect for like. Generic spirituality, I mean it would be Hinduism, the Zen Buddhism and the just Buddhism and then reading about Jack Karoacks on the road and then something about Catholicism or Judaism or Christianity or Muhammadism. I run into a fellow last year who gave me almost the whole Koran on cassette tapes in Arabic and English and listened to it all, he was a Saudi national. So and I am still that way so I was like hungry to know and this that and the other.

So the lie that went down in Sheriff Hongisto at the seventh World Convention in San Francisco said and he did the official welcome cause like in those days they would get some prestigious personality to do it and an official welcome to the city to the World Convention for Narcotics Anonymous. So Sheriff Hongisto says lies, he went into the power of lies, and he says they use to burn witches at the stake because they use to ride around on broomsticks and because they cause little babies to die and stuff like that and then they would burn them at the stake. He said you guys are today witches and you get burned at the stake everyday. It was impressive to me to hear the sheriff of San Francisco saying this. Then later that weekend you know I was from Georgia and in San Francisco and in those days in 1977 there were very few members from the east coast fellowship in San Francisco. So I would sort of try to play it cool and then they had been telling us and we had been repeating that addicts in recovery can't write and so we believed what we were told and kept repeating that. Until one day we started questioning it, like what do you mean by that they have not tried writing, they tried and cannot write well or they do not write much, or what do you mean exactly. Because you know when you think about there have always been addicts and some of the addicts were writers, musicians or painters and I had been a beat nick so I wanted to know what this was, you know the deep inner meaning of this phrase we had been repeating was. So finally I got the answer in San Francisco, it means that they have never tried at least not on any scale. Then there were these rumored pieces of input for the Basic Text there were supposed to exist, they may still exist but I have never found them.

I started asking people at the World Convention just in the hallways like who I can talk to find out who is working on our book so we can help them you know I am from Georgia dah dah da. Hey, here is a guy from Georgia you know and he wants to find out who is working on the book, so they would introduce me to one and then another you know. I was getting tired of asking my questions but I finally met the chairperson of the Board of Trustees (Laughter) and you bet your sweet ass that I held on. So that was Greg and the interesting thing happened was that he would go this way and I would got that way with him, but then lo and behold I could go this way and he would go that way with me, so somehow we were connected. So we went, we played this game around the hotel for the next four or five hours and finally we surrendered to the fact that we were really were going to talk about what was going with the Basic Text. So we went up to his room and he showed my about fifteen or twenty pages that were written by George S. on the steps and it was NA material and it was on the steps and it was written by an addict and it was fairly good stuff some of which is in the Basic Text today. You know and outside of this one guy the big trouble they had even sent out a mock letter from the WSO saying like there is a movement under way to write the NA Basic Text, and we already have plenty of input send us some more. It was like one of those add gimmicks you know (Laughter) send us some more, like do not miss your chance and they couldn't get nothing in there it was just pitiful. I am going to take my watch off so I don't get weak and worry about what time it is because that really shouldn't be important, we have waited to long enough to share. So anyway later he gets to talking and says well you could come down to Los Angeles with me and spend a couple days and I'll take you to one of the oldest NA Meetings in the world, you could go by the WSO, would you like that. I said no I had better get on home I got some work to do and so forth. So I gave in, come around, and was down there three or four days did get too go to all of those places and met Jimmy for the first time, which we had talked on the phone and written letters. Like one question from the hotel room was like who can help with the Basic Text, he said well any member, I said really, and he said really any member. I said that was pretty interesting considering nobody has and we talked some more and went on. Oh, I just remembered, see well I will get to this in a minute. But I had forgotten that I had written some stuff before I had ever gone out there because

of some of my weirdo background like I wasn't afraid, like I did a mock 4th Step even though it was stupid when I was just 6 months. I figured I would just write a mock 4th Step because like what is the harm, you know nobody is even going to know unless I tell them, it may be a good laugh later on you know good practice. God people were scared of that step in the old days. Anyway, I had gotten carried away and I had written like a chapter outline what the hell else maybe a few notes. Anyway, I showed that to Greg, but between San Francisco and leaving LA 3 or 4 days later, I said well I am going to write some stuff and send it in and I will try to get some other people to and you are in world services you route the stuff to whoever is working on it.

History update here, 1973 to 1975 the NA Tree was written.
In 1976, the first conference was attempted and I think there were a couple of people there.
In 1977, the second conference was attempted and one member showed up and this was at the World Convention in northern California in San Francisco. The one member that showed up for the World Service Conference was from southern California, the northern California RSR did not even show, that is how grim it was in those days, we were very small in those days.

So anyway, structurally for me as an average member to agree to write something and send it in there was really no other place to send it to. There was no executive community of the WSC exactly I don't think and there was only one RSR that showed up so there was hardly a functional lit committee to send it to so the board would have been the only place that anyone could have sent it to in those days. So anyway, I said you know hell I will write something and send it in and then it will probably be awful but it will encourage somebody else to write something. There were more dreamy times later on but that was like the beginning. So I got home and you know I had rigorously worked on my steps and I viewed all this stuff as like holy and just surrounded with the yellow light and stuff like that and I would sit down and try to pretend like it. Oh I know before I had gone out there I had wrote my story at a meeting on a Sunday on the Fourth of July and nobody showed up, so I made the coffee set out the literature, and then wrote my story and sent it to the WSO. So I would do that some more except we have a lot of topic discussion meetings in Georgia so I would just write like on a topic like resentments kill or spiritual principles or honesty or whatever. I would just hold forth a page or two or three and then that was it and I would go on to another topic and just kind of make get in a state of mind like I was at a meeting and I was sharing with other members which I was use to doing. Then I would just write on it, okay and what this did.

Oh and then I had thirty or forty pages and went to Zayre's and spent fifty dollars and bought myself a little plastic typewriter and type it up. So I wrote Greg this and sent him the typed copies, of course the letter line was a little like that but you could read them. I found it was different on the typewriter because my thoughts would come clearer and I mean along with addiction I probably dyslexic and other kind of crap that I refuse to even consider, you know I have got enough diseases. You know it was legible when it got out there and so a whole year went by and I sent him about sixty pages and I had about thirty or forty and it was time for the next World Convention. I hate to hog the show in what I am sharing right now but I mean there was nobody else writing at all anywhere. So a year later and I was trying and I was beginning to learn how to encourage other members within the structure and the spiritual boundaries. A year later, I flew down to New Orleans and met Greg there, we went out and made photocopies of some of this other stuff that I had written, and we talked about it. Then we flew over to Houston to the World Convention there. I will never forget about one night that the man who is now my sponsor was sharing on the history of Narcotics Anonymous from the podium and I was out in the back of the room. I do not know if I heard the whole thing or not but if any of y'all have heard Bob B. Houston that is the history I am talking about. One of the things he says, and about the Basic Text, who knows where the Basic Text is going to come from, maybe from one of you newcomers who is walking in the door today. Like I am in the back of the room right and you know what I had been doing for the last year. I knew a little bit about the impasse right then, the psychology was that you know the esteemed old timers in Narcotics Anonymous you know they are like self-effacing humble people and they are so spiritual and none of them wants to make the first move but eventually they will write our Basic Text. Because they are so, cool and we are so fucked up. (Laughter)

Now the flip side of the coin is World Services really was kind of noble and wise and cool by then and you know I perceived them as esteemed old timers and beloved old timers. People I could go to with hurting and really trust and

get good answers from Chuck Skinner from Jimmy Kinnon from Cliff Craft from Dennis McGophran from Bob Barrett. They were like friends and they were totally 100%. See they had gone through a period like we are going through for twenty years of no Basic Text. Took them a long time, just took a long time to get the little White Booklet took them a long time to get the office. So they was by then, they were grateful for whatever they got see, and they were together on their story and they were 100% sold on Narcotics Anonymous and its principles. They did not give us an ambiguous message I mean clean and sober was a prevalent phrase in those days but beyond that they were solid on NA and solid on membership and solid on building Narcotics Anonymous and that is what they transferred to people like me. So anyway I just bided my time because you know if you are on good spiritual ground the world will come to you, you do not have to go to it just wait for the right time to come. Sure enough, Bob was done with his history workshop, I just waited by the door and along come Bob, and I say can I see you for a minute. So he says, sure what's up, and he had already said on his sharing when somebody asks him about the book he says what have you done for the book. I said I want to talk to you about the book and he said what have you done to help about the book. I said I have 100 pages up in Greg's' room, you want tot see them, and he went like I got to get washed up first. I said can I wait with you and he got washed up and we went on up to Greg's room and he took a look at it. I do not think a dozen people in the world have read what was in, between the index finger and the thumb, but at least an addict wrote it. So the next thing that happened I think beside us all going home was I think a few months later Jimmy asked me to write a letter about the work that was going on with the Basic Text. So I did and it was mailed out from WSO with literature orders from the fellowship. I said why do you want me to write this letter and he said we just do that's all. I said I am not elected to do that and I don't think it would be proper and he says, it is ok you are on the WSO Lit Committee plus the Board of Trustees Lit Committee and I said am I really you know I didn't know that. He said never the less you are. Finally, I agreed to write the letter and I think, I did not plan this but I think I am going to read that. Oh God can I find it. Yep, found it.

> Dear Members;
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> Several NA members in groups around the country have begun the work that we hope will result in the creation of our definitive text. We need an original book combining the basics of our program with fifty to a hundred stories of recovery in Narcotic Anonymous. We need a book that tells in detail what we have learned over the years about the problems faced by newcomers (Would you read this for me, I get a little fucked up at times like this) and old timers alike. Of course, there is a wealth of resource material available from other programs but it will always be there and we really need some of our own. The articles relating the experience of recovery in general. How we successfully face our problems in everyday, living. And how we actually work, our steps will contribute directly to the development of our book. We have only to tell it like it is.
>
> If this sounds like a big deal, it is. Our newcomers and groups in isolated areas do not know what to do in many cases and too many have floundered and died out. If we can combine our love and strength in this effort, we can give them many of the answers we have found for ourselves and other groups. Many addicts are reluctant to write but in practically every area where there are NA meeting there are some who can help if encouraged to do so by fellow members. Without encouragement they often hold back from fear of ego or simply because they do not know the need. We want our book to be as complete as possible and truly representative of NA as a whole. This means that we need input from you and your help encouraging and supporting of others. Those who have already begun this work find that fear of self-drops quickly away. We have found that our Higher Power once more does for us what we cannot do for ourselves. We need only offer ourselves and we will be used in this service.
>
> We realize that some will be skeptical about this effort but were really not doing this for selfish reasons. People who could be helped are dieing everyday from our disease. A book telling the story the story of recovery in Narcotics Anonymous would make our program more available to them. A few of us cannot do it alone we need your help. Please send your stories, articles and other input to, World Service Office Literature Committee, 391 Cranville Street, Marietta, Georgia 30060. This way all input can be made available to the various members and groups working on this project. If you also wish to make your name

and address available to those working on the literature development, please notify us by mail. Rest assured that a working manuscript based on your experience and the experience of others who contribute will be circulated within the fellowship prior to publication.

Daniel McGee,
Atlanta Georgia
(taken from The Story of the Basic Text)

Ok, I am Daniel by the way. I get criticized sometimes for being like intellectual and dealing with things on a mental level or something. What really is, this is probably another disease right but I just get like overwhelmed by my feelings, so I have learned that in a crisis, if this building was to fall in I would figure out a remedy or way to get out with a maximum number of people alive. I am great in crisis, it will hit me four or five hours later you know but when it happens I am cool as a cucumber apparently. But there is a lot of stuff happening on the inside, but reading that stuff or thinking about how beautiful those days were is just like overwhelming because it was not a daydream it all happened and that is the way it was, we wanted it good and so it was good. Well anyway as a result of that letter things happened like, the members who received that in Australia started sending in input. We found out there were meetings I places like Barcelona and Calcutta and I don't think they ever sent any in I think Germany was always on the mail list, I can't remember them sending anything, I know Australia sent written material and a cassette tape or two. But they were not just welcome in a tokenistic manner I mean anything they sent in was taken seriously by us as if it was someone across the street or within the continental United States. The letters back were as friendly because I read some of that Dale Carnegie stuff and you know we get like one little piece of input from somebody, and we weren't given like a Joe college rah rah rah letter. It was just like as serious as we could put it and we really appreciate your input and please write some more, and thank you so much, and here is how it is going. Try to write deliberately, intentionally write a letter so good back to them that they would be embarrassed and send us more input (Laughter) and you know it worked they would . We just thanked them until they believed it you know and then they would send some more input. Because we had to keep the faith because we knew we were building basically a spiritual movement, and you know you just cannot break the faith, you just can't. You can do a lot of things but you cannot break the faith. So we won these peoples hearts so they would send workshop stuff and write input and I would be talking to them on the phone and I'd say well have you sent anything in yet and they'd say no but I am getting these other people to. I said they ain't going to send nothing in and they would say why and I said because you didn't.

They are not going to do it if you have not done it. They would go like, well ok then I will. You know the part is that we always want people to do what we ought to do, and then they will not do it so they are fucked up and of course, we are all right; you know it is a game that goes around. Once they had sent in their contribution then they were capable of getting others people to do it. They would say look I sent mine is so you can send yours in, or you think that you are better than me and then they would like I will send something then. You know we just continued this along with all the other things that we were doing. I chaired the World Convention in Atlanta in 1979. My second child was born two days after the World Convention, my wife dreams that year of going to the World Convention as chair with my wife pregnant out to here and getting called away. You just have to get someone else to chair the convention I got to go to the hospital.

Anyway, I am just saying it was like busy times but we kept putting out these letters and kept getting input and trying to respond promptly with good letters and getting more input. The west coast did not believe about the input they were not getting it I would say like 300 pages and that would not work so I would say 3 stories and 15 articles and that would not work. So I finally got down to pounds I said we now have 10 pounds (Laughter) and I do not think they bought it but they thought well like pounds what do you mean pounds. Finally, we had like 800 pages going into Lincoln, Nebraska. That letter went out In the spring and so I went to conference that year and I guess basically on the strength of recommendations of old timers that I had me. Like Fawn had saying, newcomers voted in those days, but well it was not just like oh you remember so in so nice that you are here you to have a vote. It was more as if if you were the one, if as if five members came from Texas 1 would vote, if one member came from Arizona, one would vote if one member came from New Jersey 1 would vote. One member came from New Jersey, voted, and

moved to LA without ever having gone home. Which was good because he had charges on him and if had gone home he would not have come back for a few years. So I got elected World Lit Chair and that was all like real heavy I can remember up to that point , world services was a miracle and oh those people at the office are so cool and oh those trustees are so cool and all these conference officers and stuff . I mean I was not ragged out on it but it was rather neat, it was neat to be in California. So like when you get elected to "Chair", I should take this microphone down and prance around a little bit. "Chair of the World Lit Committee" (Laughter) you know, good to meet you, yes you can touch me and I mean it is like "Hey hey hey hey hey(sounds like an Indian dance around the fire) "I mean like deep in the heart of your recovery you know there is a lie right.(still laughing)

Then I got to thinking about all those people dieing and shit like that and kind of brought me back down to earth and you know the long time we had gone we so many doing so little, so rarely. I kind of got back on track, me and Greg talked about like if we can just get some input coming in and then if we have a solid positive response. If we keep, faith with the people then there will be more input and then more response. Then we will have to get together somehow and have like a work session or something probably like a conference and then we will you know figure out a way to start putting it into a topic outline or book form or something , that was kind sort of like what the dream was. But as this stack of poundage grew from several ounces to several feet I mean yeah about it started becoming a lot more real to us you know this is not just a joke this is real stuff and it don't do away . It is there on Monday, and it is still there on Tuesday and it still may be there on Friday.

We had to like push ourselves into the future and say like what would we do if we had one of these big conference things, what could we do. We actually we talked about that the year I was elected I was learning some World service savvy and group conscience so I just put it on the group. I thought wherever y'all would like to have the World Lit Conference is where it will be. Y'all just make your bids or something because if you done the World Convention you do it right. So they went for it and picked the San Francisco or this place or Atlanta or Wichita and Wichita got it. Well I was happy as a duck, I didn't give a rats ass where it was you know as long as it was someplace that I could get to. Wichita was fine because that is between the east and the west coast so talk about neutral ground. People who had to fly or drive in, sort of fair Wichita are out there in the middle. We finally got there input was still coming in and letters and things were still going out. Our guidelines consisted I think of one sentence, WSC organizational chart, officers,(flip tape/ side two) we back on yet, to collect, compile and review material prior to presentation to the WSC or the fellowship for approval. One sentence, so what we wanted to talk about in Wichita was a plan of action. Okay we got some input, we got some people interested you know our little world service conference got subcommittee chairs, more RSRs this year than last year things are doing better. I think the entire gross sales of WSO in 1978-79 are less than $10,000.00 but we were growing.

So when we got to Wichita, I opened the conference with these words, so now what are we going to do. So we went around the room and you and you, you expressed your opinion of what would be good to do, and what we were capable of doing. Therefore, by time we had made the rounds we kind of formulated what we were going to take on and try to accomplish during this three-day conference, out on the Great Plains or wherever Wichita is. It sure felt funny being out there, it was sort of, like a shopping center and then a little place down the lower level and you could park your car and walk in and like the Chamber of Commerce had offices in there and community groups could rent them out. So there was not a lot of space but it was reasonably okay and we had some copy machines some good typewriters. (Audience: How were they acquired)? Well they were just there I mean they were there from the Chamber of Commerce, just like part of the deal. That is okay, ask me questions because we are a group, this is a spiritual service body.

So anyway what we settled on was discussing the different categories like what is NA literature, well it can be a book but it can also be pamphlets and IP's it can also be newsletters. Well how is the Literature Committee organized, how do you deal with the paperwork, how do you raise funds within traditions and service structure and all that. See this was absolutely not written down anywhere I mean there was not even another committee that had this stuff that we could follow suit, copy their stuff, and plug in our names. So each workshop discussed these things like from the bottom up and left residue of minutes and notes and stuff. Now I am not going to drag it out anymore in that but it was a good feeling there. The committees did their work well, the minutes of those committees were atrocious I think

one or two had a good set of minutes. I spent all my time buzzing around from committee to committee and occasionally we would come together and talk about everything and kind of report to one another and then go back in to our little workshops.

I remember a funny moment in the back when they were talking about the fund raising thing and the workers came up with the idea of actually putting it in there for fund raising purposes within our fellowship. How much is a human life worth, and that sort of struck me, I remember that striking me very hard at the moment. We go home and we had some paper, we had not looked at it very close yet, no, we left it there with Cliff H. So I am on the phone every few weeks Hey Cliff, how you doing, yeah the weathers fine how are the minutes coming Cliff. You know I had promised them you will be sent a copy of the minutes and da da da registration was like twelve dollars or something. The weeks were going by and I had not done it yet and it started eating away at me you know and I kept calling Cliff up being nice and like how's it coming Cliff , how is it coming Cliff you know a month or two goes by. Finally I just said Cliff just send me the minutes, I will get them typed here, you know it was horrible it was killing me. He really didn't want to do that and said No I can't do it, and I said just tell me why, it doesn't matter I am your buddy you can trust me just tell me why, and he said cause I will feel like a failure. I said oh come on you are a trusted servant what the hell, where we come from you come on. So he thought about it and like well okay, I will send them, and he did and I got three separate excellent typists secretary type people come to my place and take the minutes away and they were going to type them up and they did not do it. This is with the (Dum da dum dum) deadline approaching, you know the 90-day deadline back in those days for the WSC, had to be in the mail 90 days before the conference to count to even have a chance for approval. This was mainly just minutes right and the main thing were to get them out as soon after Wichita as we could. These people kept bringing me back these minutes un-typed and embarrassed and funny looking. So I am chair and am assiduously trying to be chair, not secretary I will not type them. Finally knuckles under and go and look in there and I find out why nobody has typed them. I mean as if one committee actually created a numeric code to where the minutes were a sequence of numbers relating to these topics. It was just like barbaric and it really did make since if you could dig it. The question was did you want to dig it that much or not?(Laughter) You know those secretaries must have felt awful sorry for us and then others were just sort of like rough but they were there and one or two of them were done very well. I was really felt like I was up a tree; I had some cassettes, still have some cassettes tapes from Wichita, Lincoln and Memphis. It is really your Basic Text being written on cassette tape and I tried when I was a trustee to get the WSO to consider making a two hour cassette out of it cause then you could hear your Basic Text being written and they wouldn't have nothing to do with it, but maybe someday. What I did was transpose it I tried to do it like minutes because that it like minutes right, you got like a header and then roman numeral and then "a and b" and it was okay on some sections but on other sections a lot of stuff was getting left out. So I just thought well I will just type it in roughly cause why the hell not you know nobody is watching me and we are so late anyway and in each section I will just put in everything I remembered that was brought up and discussed .

Well what happened then was I looked at it the next day and it was making since but it seemed kind of dumb to go back and try to put that into a topic outline form or minutes. God step in the form of a printer named Phil Page down there in Marietta and he says you can take that there to Marietta reprographics and they would probably typeset that for $25.00. I said are you kidding Phil why would they want to do that. He says I could print it into a booklet, I said well let me think about this, so I went home and called Greg and called this one and the other one. I do not know how we were doing with our local lit committees in those days, there probably were not that many. We kicked it all around, it was like this was a collection of all the thoughts and ideas that related to the NA Basic Text, plus newsletters, and IP's plus forming a committee even. Well this is much more than minutes, and it would still go out to people because it has the same contents as the minutes. We will just put another cover page on it and call it The Handbook for NA Lit Committees. How is that guys, everybody said yes so we did it. We got it typeset and print and I think we had to do the collating, folding and stapling ourselves, but that was okay I called a ton of people up and fifty or sixty people showed up and we worked all evening one night and just sent out hundreds of them, to anybody we had an address on. We were no longer worried about anything, after the idea of it becoming a handbook then approval became an issue. Then we realized it really did not have to be approved to be a handbook because we were just going to use it internally and then we were going to sell it for two dollars to be a fund raising item to but stamps and paper and stuff for world lit and make phone calls. It got approved at the conference and came out through WSO

so we did not get nothing but it was approved some how even though it did not go through the 90 day process. We would just keep a straight face when things like that happened and be grateful. You know at least the plan of action to get a Basic Text plus newsletters plus these other things. At least that was written and it was out there and at least it was doing some good. That is the story of that came about.

I did not think too much about who was going to be chairperson of the World Lit Committee the next year. Several people ran hard for it my name was put for nomination and I thought yeah that is good, and then I was elected. There had been some problems. Some IP's were suppose to have gone out that never went out and I classed that as just some unfortunate things that happened and it was just apart of our early history. It could have gone differently but if it had then some other things would not have been possible. Now I was World Lit chair and we had a conference and we were suppose to send out some IPs, but first two people interested literature from Marietta but first they had to be printed at WSO and it was only the final forms that could be printed because they were changed, minor word changes in conference. Well I had left those at Jimmy's house and he had taken some gold and jewels out of this box and showed them to me. Then he took me to the airport. I had started to get photocopies and I did not get photocopies so the only copy in the world was at his house. He had stuck it away in that little jewelry box for most of that year and had forgotten where it was. So for months I was calling him saying well "hey he" along with checking on the minutes after we had done Wichita you know how is them IPs coming, when we going to see them IPs. Well we never did see those IPs exactly and I have still never seen the originals. It is kind of interesting how God worked it because there kind of damned me for not sending out these IPs like that was one of your main things and you blew it, I went like yeah I did blow it you know but we will get them out next year as soon as WSO sends them to us. Of course, they never sent them to us so they never went out, but had they come to us we would have sent them out just as we sent out some other stuff ok.

So we planned another conference the conference again picked the site, the conference again voted on it. Again, I was well pleased with their choice, this time it was going to be in Lincoln, Nebraska right after the World Convention in Wichita. Now the World Conventions was following where the lit conferences were somewhat. So a lot of people showed up in Wichita for the World Convention and then they went to Lincoln the next week a bunch of them like 25 or 30 of them went to Lincoln the next week for the Lincoln Literature Conference and that was set to run like between Tuesday to the following Sunday. So we left the World Convention on Sunday went to Lincoln and the lit conference started on Tuesday to run to Sunday. Then we had had another year a lot of local lit committees had been formed and I was World Lit Chair so I found out I could get away with saying well I think any local lit should be a co-chair at World Lit and we should act accordingly. I didn't know that that would not be a good move, but what I didn't count is members in service don't take their service efforts seriously if they are not taken seriously, and by making them co-chairs of world lit and treating them like co-chairs they come alive and started becoming capable of miracles. The Basic Text is evidence. I had a checklist and I wrote a list of their names and phone numbers on my wall. Then the weeks of all of my term and if I had contact with them I put a check mark there and then I could check the list and had not heard from them that week I could call them up, so we would stay in at least weekly contact. It grew to about 12 or 15 people and they would be like the local lit chair for LA and the local lit chair for San Francisco, local lit chair for Philadelphia and so on. Then by staying in touch with them, oh and another thing we did was put out a monthly letter about the World Lit Committee and how it was doing and what was happening and you know like when we were having trouble getting the minutes I would say like well Cliff had not sent them, but he was going to. Then I would put in there, well he sent them but we cannot make them out and they ain't typed yet. Then that is the phone calls when we used to decide to make it a handbook instead of minutes because we had our own internal communications like that. Then I would call them, read the World Lit Letter to them, and say if you catch anything that should be in here you let me know and I will read slowly and you just stop me when you want to. Then I would read along and they would stop me and say well you did not mention so and so, so I would write down exactly what they said, the way said it and it would be in there in the next World Lit letter in their own words. When they would saw their own words in the lit letter, then they trusted me, because before it was like that stand off like you know sure I am going to give you the money and you are going to bring me back the dope, right Huh Huh Huh, and they would be real nice, but it was very superficial. What came across from my side was when I put their words into the letter they trusted me. You know it is these silly tests we run on each other, to see if we are for real, right.

You all want to take a break, I mean I have been talking for some time, well I just don't want, I mean I see people having to go to the bathroom or else they are disgusted or something so I mean I don't want anyone sitting here in agony like wondering when. You want to take like a 5-minute break or something. (Laughter).

It is inevitable that you know I have passed over some things and I am going to pass over some things, but I have already been told by a least one person that things are coming out that they have never heard before. So I am going to keep doing it this way if it is okay and maybe we can get to some questions and answers too. So we were at Lincoln, Nebraska. The year was lets 1980 yeah cause my first conference was 79 and that's when World Convention was in Atlanta so this was a year later so it had to be in 80 okay and it is in the file because it is after World Convention so that means it was in September. It is pretty high energy, because some of the people who were at Wichita are back for Lincoln. By now, there are some local lit committees who are now using the new approved *Handbook for NA Lit Committees*. The dream of the Basic Text of Narcotics Anonymous has taken on like a new real dimension you know where it was two dimensions before it is now it is growing into three dimensions. Plus they have had half a week at World Convention to like really get hot to do it. So we are up there in Lincoln and a couple of notable things happened ones not in the story of the Basic Text yet, because I may be a horror in ways but I am not a horror when it comes to the fellowship and do not like to put things in just for like their emotional appeal or something. Everybody tells me that we should put it in; that everybody tells me that we should put it in that the members in Lincoln, Nebraska gave blood to raise money to host their lit conference and that probably should be in there.

Another thing that touched me particularly was this one guy who looks kind of, like an out of work truck driver was really a cowboy from the north plat and had gotten strung out in World War 2 you know like in Europe. So he could not read or write so this girl sat down with him and took down his story. I thought it was really neat that we had such a group of people together to where we could include people like that. Then I remember also sitting because we would, if all you think that World Lit Committee was a committee then you are missing it. Because like a lot of things in the fellowship it was like tongue and cheek like how many people have a secretary in their home group that can take shorthand and how often does the chair necessarily chair a meeting the way a corporate board of directors chair, would chair their meeting. But we have to call it something so secretary stuck and chair stuck and so on you know and let the secretary take care of the fifty dollar cash flow. So we had this committee but in years since this time, I realized it was not really a committee. It was a spiritual service body collection of members absolutely dedicated to a goal of the Basic Text for their fellowship. These people had years to work at it, we had sometime to make our mistakes on a small scale. Like one time we mailed out a World Lit mailing with Narcotics Anonymous on the outside of the envelope and we didn't do it to be mean we were that dumb and also it had been donated printing and it was in a hurry to get the mailing out. Get it, and I mean every time we screw something up man we should get a subsidy or something from the phone company, because you can just imagine all the red lights going off (Laughter) yes we know about that, yes that is right, no it will not happen again. We did not have any approved guidelines and that is an example, but we knuckled under instantly, were true to our word, and never did it again. I guess that is the way you have to do it in service. I am just trying stress on you that the people who showed up in Lincoln were not like newcomers to World Lit anymore. Some had attended the World Service Conference in 79, the World Lit Conference in Wichita in 79 and they had been working in local lit committees for months, 6 months or a year maybe. They had written material and had written their story perhaps by this point. So by the time they got to Lincoln they was not going there on this big what if deal you know. Plus the committee by now had like 800 pages of input and like my good old buddy, Doug said in his letter, some of it was rather rough but we treasured all of it. It was certainly evidence that addicts in recovery could write and of course, that was the lie that was going down that we could not. It is funny like I have heard it said that America is unique out of all nations because you can go out on a street corner in America and take a dozen unemployed fools sitting around and say come on lets build a bridge, I will pay you. They will say oh ok, it does not matter what city, what corner what twelve guys, or gals even as long as you have the building materials and the money to pay them, they will build a bridge. One of them will know something about blueprints, one of them has laid brick before, and one of them knows how to work iron. Between them, because they are American they will figure out a damn way to build a bridge. Now it may not be the best bridge but you know it is just an attitude, I do not know why, the cultural diet, the TV, the magazines, the readings our conversations, our attitudes, our friends, our travels, the jobs that we work. So anyway, all these people that were attracted from our younger growing NA fellowship to literature and some of them had a while to think about it and kind of gear up and

learn to type or whatever. They showed up and again the question was well now we are here what do we going to do. So we went around the table we heard from everybody. See that was not just to hear from everybody that is important enough by itself, but that was something we did so that everybody there knew that they were welcome and appreciated and to deal them in made like a circle of us. In other words, it was not just a few important ones over here that has to talk and you guys keep your fucking mouth shut. It is like everybody was important and everybody had an equal say and an equal chance to say it. It did not matter if you had forty years clean time or four days. We literally had people in our lit conferences with one day clean. I remember this one little sixteen-year-old down in Memphis. She had to sit on like five or six phone books to get her ass up high enough to reach the typewriter keys. She could type like a madwoman and it was good typing to, but she was just small. So anyway, we Greg was there, Bob Barrett was there oh give you one other little idea about why this was not a quote, unquote real committee, that it was really a spiritual service body. This guy was sitting next to me, and you know I am there starting to get a little excited and she is like you could just tell that she was not real comfortable you know it didn't look like she needed to go to the bathroom so I said, have you ever said the lit prayer? She says what is that. I said well you know that is where you pray for God to remove your ego and give you the strength and guidance to do his footwork and all like that, have you. No are you suppose to, Ohhh to sit in this room you better because you be in here with your ego you might blow up, and she said my goodness what is happening to me. I said go out into the hall and take a few minutes, get with your God say that prayer and come back. Five minutes later here she is, you know World Lit Worker, throwing her hands up and attitude and doing all the stuff, you know just come alive. I guess everybody there did something like that you know to where their ego was no longer a question and they were comfortable with their qualifications for NA membership. Meaning you know they had made a mess of their lives and everything they had touched had gone wrong more or less and they had surrendered and had that spirit that unity.

I said in the break to somebody outside well we were so luck. We had the Basic Text for a project to write on, everybody supported it, and everybody was interested in seeing it for various reasons. It was just total absolute unity, the service branches, World Service Conference was for it, so was the World Service Board of Trustees so was WSO. Everybody helped us, everybody liked us, everybody loved us and that is how it went in the early days.

One idea had been proposed, Greg had mentioned it to me and he pitched the group with it and that was to make a topic outline based on the White Booklet because everybody knew that and most of the points were covered even if they were not elaborated on sufficiently. Then from that topic outline, we would plug in the input and then see if we could figure out a way to get it from raw input into something to where all of the material would be in say this chapter in a certain basic order. Then we would worry about getting it to read more smoothly and so on and covering the other points that came up. So that is what we started doing. Greg pulled out the chalk and the blackboard and just went to work. He had been working for a corporation making polyurethane, to keep his workers alive and awake they sent him to a lot of like corporate schools for this and that, and so he was use to doing it. He had a real good style of delivery and just like ok folks we going to do it now. You know okay here is the first chapter and hell you know nothing but believers in the room, chugga, chugga, chugga chug we wrote the topic outline, then the second chapter, then the third chapter. You know" Who's an Addict"," What is NA", what should be in there. So then this is the crux, we are fixing to cross over from the period of time during which we had no book until the baby when you could see its little head sticking out. Okay it was not to pretty but it was at least a baby and it was there you know like a lot of babies it had some promise and people would love it and bring it up.

So we took the pieces of paper and where an item of input seemed to belong in different places within this topic outline we had it typed and photocopies made so everybody had a copy of it. Then we would say well the item in the stack of photocopies I got, this belongs in Chapter One b-3 and write that on this little piece of paper and throw it in the basket then those are all sorted to where all the Chapter Ones are in one pile all the Chapter Twos are in another pile. This still seems incredible even to me and I am a believer and a witness that we were able to do it that way, took a break, went to lunch, came back. Then we took all the pile of paper for Chapter 1 according to this topic outline, because the important point to us, you know and do not miss this very very important point a lot of people unfortunately missed this very important point. Is every scrap of paper in that pile was potentially the key to somebody's life in recovery? So we took every scrap very seriously, nothing was wasted. So anyway, physically, socially, emotionally, and mentally, how do you get all this transposed? Well everybody would take a little stack and

we would go to the first item on the topic outline, everybody would just keep looking through their stack and we would keep going until everything was used right okay. So it did not matter where we started or where we finished because everything was going to be used somewhere. However, getting it started was just like getting to the top of this great big hill and then you ain't quite got enough energy just to flop over the top. It is like I was there you know and I would pray and all that and I was real jacked up you know and hoping we would get a book. I said come on who has got that first one, come on, you know plug it in man you looking at it, does it speak to you, let me hear you. Everybody was like is this it, no that's not it, no then somebody else would say I got one, read it out, and they'd read it out and hell the first one was pain is our common denominator, and everybody says YEAH (Laughter) and we was on to the next item you know. We would like paste that on the top of a blank sheet of paper, and the next one, and the next one, and the next one went through that chapter and all the other chapters. I mean this took a lot of faith, and days later, you know we had. Oh, man that was another thing, (time warp) spiritual service body. Usually a day has 24 hours in it sometimes you watch science fiction movies and Star Trek heroes want to get from one galaxy to another so they like go into what's called warp factors. Well man, we like, kind of started out kind of like we are doing here, but what if the next thing we were going to do is okay later tonight we are going to start working and we got the files. This day and age, we got the computers, the spell checkers and I mean after two or three days everybody knows what the goal is and everybody knows what the resources are and everybody has total information access, everybody knows what is going on. Any question is answered that fast by anybody else so none of that likes held to control you or hold you back. So everybody knows everything. You know the term a mile a minute, I mean some of our hours were like days we would get so much done. I mean it would leave you with like this awed sort of blasted feeling. Like you know every now and then it would kind of creep up on you, like give you the willies is this really happening, is this okay? God was using the group as an instrument, to answer all the prayers and we have to be there and it was just great to see God doing all this neat stuff and we were just sort of bewildered but you know we were just happy to do our part and stay in place. So then, we had the humorous job of taking this cut and pasted material without computers. We literally down to this office supply store and said we need some paste, no I think we will need a little more than that.(Laughter) We need some scissors and they would bring out these seven or eight dollar like shears you know. Do you have any thing a little cheaper and we get this little toy, children's steel, you know like ends blunted so you cannot stab your fellow students or even yourself. We cut and pasted all right. So anyway between input one and input two ,pain is our common denominator and the next sentence whatever it is okay we are going to keep the content meaning and all the wording possible but can we get thee two or three sentences to line up and kind of flow from one to the other. By now we have twenty or thirty people all honed in on this one topic brainstorming and they would suggest a couple of versions with increasing ability they would hit on a combination that would include all the thoughts words and ideas in those sentences or two but they would read better. Then this was all written in, the bridge sentences were sometimes written in, in pencil. All this rough cut and paste with marks went to typing and we gave the typist the liberty you know, help it make since Mary and she would and if you are uncomfortable about something either delete it out or ask somebody and that was a good way because everything was included. We would get like a rough typing of Chapter 1 and then a rough typing of Chapter 2 and chapter 3 and so on. Not all the chapters were done that way but enough of them did like chapter one did and maybe two, I don't know. Okay and it just it was like the time warp slowed down on Sunday and everybody sat at the table and we said look we were much more done than we thought we would. Look the Basic Text is becoming a reality here it is on the table in front of you. You all are going to take copies of it home. We had the copies and the typewriters this time and they took their minute's home with them, I think or else we got them out pretty quick. That conference or the next conference we stopped the business about we will send you the copies to you shortly. Our style of conference we would take the minutes as it was happening and as a page of minutes was taken it would go away to typing. Therefore, when you got back from lunch you would get your morning minutes in your hands. Then we had these cute people who would say no that is impossible you couldn't possibly do that at one of these, and we just did it. I think I tried to be nice to him and said well we know it's hard and probably won't be able to do it all through the conference but we are going to do it just for today you know we will do it just for this little part of it okay. That seemed to satisfy him but hell we was like ready to eat iron we did it every damn time and there was never any yelling or any pressure or any extra effort. I mean everybody knew and nobody would even think of being mean to somebody else. You know there was just that kind of spirit. So anyway, we knew we were not done. We had gotten a lot done but we weren't all done and we had discovered some of the potentials. Just you know we are going to have to have another conference. Oh, my God, we are going to wait until May and then they are going to schedule one in

September that is a year from now. A year is there anything good that we can be doing in the next year while we are waiting to finish what we are doing right now and in the middle of and feel like going on with. None of us could think of anything. So we did the old damn faith bit and planned another conference, another world Lit Conference before the World Service Conference. I hope they understand some of them didn't. So we went on, hugged and all that, took some pictures went on home.

The next conference site was Memphis, Tennessee and we still never did get the IPS we were suppose to mail out. But the policy item we were suppose to mail out our review pieces was in place, the committee was including raising all the money to mail them out. You have to understand how small these conference committees were in those days, none of them had any money. I would spend two or three hundred dollars out of my pocket and then wait a few months or six months to get it back. When I was in LA next and could physically show them my receipts. Therefore, mailing out much of anything was quite a problem. I am not saying that there were people in LA that were like holding the money strings. There was like no conference committee got any money because it just had not been done yet. It was just like all the damn bumps and grinds of getting something started, and there was no procedure for the Treasurer to reimburse chairs of WSC sub-committees even though they were supposes to do it. It was not clear when and how. So it kind of hamstrung us financially. So we planned Memphis, everybody got their minutes from Lincoln; they got the edits from Lincoln and any other photocopies they wanted. I don't think we charged them for photocopies in those days. We figured if they paid them, money to travel and get here whether it was across the country or across town and they paid their $12-$15 registration fees then part of the deal ought to be is they can make some copies on their photocopier, at their conference, since it was theirs. We felt like it would be irresponsible to deny members the right to use their stuff. Also they would have felt this wall go up between us and them and we didn't want any us and them so one way of keeping that down was to give things freely. Of course, we received freely too you know good thing we did. Therefore, we planned this lit conference, we know how many days we had at Lincoln, and we know it started Tuesday to go to Sunday. But it didn't start accelerating and go into like this acceleration thing until about Wednesday. Then we did two or three weeks work in two or three days. Even at that accelerated pace it might take more than three or four days. By the time, we got all finished with planning and talking and considering it turned into a nine-day literature conference, 24 hours a day. The site turned out to be Memphis State University. A hundred people showed up, 25 or so showed up for Lincoln, maybe it was 80 or 90 just under a hundred. They worked usually 18 or 20 hours a day. Now somebody do your math real quick, how many thousand did we put in that week? We didn't get there until Monday

Tape Five
Allentown History Literature Addathon 1990
Speaker; Bo S

I will be done with the sort of technical section in a minute, the techniques that we applied to create and employ the lit process of Narcotics Anonymous, which generated the Basic Text, and it has been a severe pain in my heart. To have to work for people at world level that do not know what you have heard me say this afternoon, and not knowing that they could apply their very own techniques. So anyway we continued this sort of, you have to have like a little discussion with the folks that are doing this kind of work. and say like, it's going to seem a little bit hokey but its going to be like one of those guys who sells things or something and calls and says, come on whose got the next line. You got to jazz it up, you kind of got to sit up straight and you know this line is so in so's. So we completed all ten chapters, and then we had all the roughs typed and then we got into editing.

One little committee of the World Lit Committee dealt with stories, that's why people like me didn't know whose name went with what story title, because for a certain period of time I think in 85 or so 86 WSO was mad at me because they thought I knew who wrote the stories that they were looking for. They were looking for the people that wrote these stories so that they could get a signed approval form and then include the stories in the Basic Text. Well I could not tell them, because to function as chair of this spiritual service body I had to not know whose name went with what title, because if there were even a hint that Bo was playing favorites the whole thing would have caved in. It was all a house built of faith. So outside of getting the pleasure and honor of going to the mailbox, pulling it out

and opening it and reading it for the first time then it went in the file and went to committee. They assigned the titles to them, I never knew. Maybe one or two cases like, I know my sponsors story pretty good," Found the only NA meeting in the world". But that was just like happenstance. But anyway, that was not considered like as important as the Basic Text itself. So that was begun in Memphis, but mainly then we had these roughs, okay now what are you going to do with the roughs? You are going to rewrite it, who is going to rewrite it, who wants to? We come together every six hours for a group conscience session and then all the workshops for chapters one, two, three, four, five tell all the other workshops how they are doing ask questions, share solutions they found and then you break up and go back into workshop. Then come together 4, 5 6 hours later, then break up and go into workshop, then come together. It went on all week and I swear to God boy about Tuesday afternoon, Wednesday morning we were flying again. I mean it came up that some members in Philadelphia had some input and some of the members in Memphis said we should have Federal Express send out that, it is only so and so dollars to send it out overnight. The group got so quiet and I will never forget it. It was like 8 or 9 men and women standing around me and everybody had their head down, and I was chair and I am trying to serve them, be their trusted servant, and I'm like I don't know what they are thinking, what do they got their head down for. So I ask one of them, I said what do you think folks, and they said, well 24 hours is a long time, couldn't we just take it out to the airport and put it on a plane like a real person, I said yes I think that could be arranged and that's what we did. So they run the material out, put it on the jet, and we run out to the airport in Memphis and picked it up and it was there in 4 or 5 hours, we did not have to wait 24 hours. And you know then the committee receiving it you know they just absorbing into the work. But we were running into certain troubles, because like reading even if there are 50 experienced lit workers present with hand held copies of the material being read in hand items come up that are hard to address. Because you get nitpicky, I mean should this be a gerund or a split infinitive, is it okay to use a split infinitive we used one a several pages ago? You just get in like this cerebral trance and it is like it is real hard to get folks you know working together and agreeing on things. So we made up another experimental way called the Memphis, what did we call that, Memphis flow reading, how does that grab you? That is where you get 50 or 100 members with hand held copies and readers take turns because the name of the game is to read it so damn fast that it short circuits your conscious mind. (Making blubble noises for description) I mean really I am not even going to do that; it is like burlesque right and it short circuits your conscious mind. And everybody in the room has to agree that it is okay and they give their full permission to have their conscious mind short-circuited as they sit in the chair and participate in this Memphis flow reading. We are just going to try it folks, if it does not work we will stop doing it, okay we will try. So I just read it, now you can read a whole chapter, see the trouble with these chapters is being what 10, 15 pages, 20 pages long is it may take you three or four hours for a little editing workshop to plow through a single chapter, or even four or five pages if they get bogged down. Where as with this flow reading you can jam through an entire chapter in about 5 or 10 minutes. But you are probably asking your self what if any good is it? (Laughter) Okay hope you are still with me, you mark because your eyes are having to move like this (Laughter) to follow the reader. If you spot something it makes you feel weird funny there might be an error here, you don't pencil in a little recommended thing you know in tiny little fine letters, you just make a mark on that part of the page. Okay now we have finished the flow reading okay, go get your coffee and we will be back in five minutes. Now we are back in five minutes, now we discuss marks, anybody got anything on page one, yes what is it, speak up they cannot hear you. Then we decide to do about their mark in paragraph two. Somebody else caught it over here, same damn thing. They spot a redundancy that was mentioned on page one and they caught it on page fifteen, because it happened within fifteen minutes so it felt funny to hear that again. That is a redundancy I think, so they marked it, checked it, later they had time to check later and they spotted the redundancy and edited it out. Okay other things, you cannot read material that has written a certain way this rapidly, the reader will trip up. That is one reason you can read the Basic Text that way, you probably never tried it or thought about it. You probably never tried it or thought about it, you may not have otherwise; we thought of this and talked about it openly. Like when you are laying there reading like in a chair or something like that, nobody is watching you, nobody is going to criticize, nobody give a fuck if you cheat and skip a page, they don't care. You are just reading it, and if you speed read or read a lot, you are just reading whole sentences like they were words after a while, just turn the page. Anybody knows what I am talking about, it is like another state of mind, that is real common but you do not do it in public so nobody talks about it. Well we figured it out, that people would probably be reading this book a lot and it might be good that it is written like that. Also, that it might be read in a lot of meetings and therefore it should read well and smoothly. So by just reading the fire out of it I mean if there was like some kind of phrase or poorly placed word or long and difficult word that didn't read well or that most people were not familiar with, you got to edge it

out, you know how it got detected I mean those Memphis flow readings. The other funny thing, (look at me looking) I have never gotten into, I have never gone this deep on this subject before with anybody, I do not think. But anyway, you all set the stage for it that made the difference. So we did not just one, Oh when we were doing the flow reading okay we can do editing and we could have fifteen tables in this room at four chairs each and you could not hear noticeably what is was being discussed at the next table, does everybody know what I am talking about? The next table aint hearing you, now if you yell or make something out of the way then people like look up but they got to do it right normally their brains are set to ignore what is happening at the next table. Where during a flow reading guess what, we are in here you know a series of people are taking turns reading until they run out of breath, somebody could walk by at the other end of this great hall and say (yelling) " hey is there any more coffee in there". And all 60 people in the hall would go like huh, (laughter) (bangs fist on the podium) I mean just stop and look over like hostile man like did you really just stick your finger in my eyeball? I mean you could feel it I mean it is visceral. You know these poor people just wanted some coffee, they didn't think that they were like really interrupting, intruding on our territory 75 feet away, but it was because we were in this other state of consciousness you see. That is another one that only, and some people could not stay in the room in a Memphis flow reading because the process and whatever it does to your brain they just were not ready for. (Laughter) They sit there for like two or three minutes, its like you see them breaking out into a sweat,(panting) I got to get out of here.(Laughter) we say yes go now , quickly please. You know but it was a real cool technique and it really it helped get the book. You know it is laughable in a way but it is like how else do you do you do that if you don't have millions of dollars to pay people or even if you do have millions of dollars to pay people. Why not do that with members and let them spot the errors and things they would like to see in their literature. So anyway, we got done and we so we had Memphis chapter one first edit, Memphis chapter one second edit. We got all of them done in Memphis. A continuation no, no not much was done with stories, stories were mainly just generally read and this group of stories could be printed for review form as is. So that was stacked in the file system somewhere. Okay and about remember Sunday to Sunday, or Sat is the week and then the following Sunday and about Thursday we knew we were going to get done. It was not done yet but you know, God willing the Mississippi River do not rise we were going to be done. What is going to happen next we going to wait a couple of months and then see if the conference wants to send it out. What do you mean the conference wants us to send out our own review materials, right? Well yeah but how are we going to get that money? Why should that be a problem we got plenty of support? So we finished it, we put out the word through this huge network of literature committees, which by now reached every tiny creek and hollow of the entire worldwide fellowship from Calcutta to Sydney. The fellowship coughed up about, at least twenty thousand dollars with in a couple of weeks. Much more money than anybody in NA had ever seen at one place at one time. The typist tried to type to retype it and kept coming across things, maybe some unauthorized changes were made, but eventually got a typing service to retype all the materials and put numbers out beside the lines, punch it, and gvc, bind it. A quarter of a million sheets of paper were used to print them. Simultaneously over in Marietta where I live this fellow Roger with a lot of our support spent about five or six hundred dollars in less than 30 days to locate every NA Meeting on the face of the planet and we would sit around and egg him on, he would run out of ideas. So if there wasn't a listed meeting in Dublin, we would call the hospital in Dublin and if they didn't know nothing then we would call someplace else and if we ran out of ideas we go on to Germany and come back to Dublin. But in the end we got meetings nobody even dreamed that there were, NA Meetings and they would get phone calls these weird ass phone calls from these crazy Americans. (Laughter)

So we located every meeting on the face of the planet, raised the money, had the material printed and we had been chastised for not sending out our review material and also it was in our guidelines to collect, compile and review material prior to consideration at the annual WSC. They probably did not think on which we were going to collect or on the scale on which we were going to compile these several hundred thousand man-hours gone by or the scale on which we would review. And since we had got the donations from the fellowship and we have enough Grey Forms printed and we had located every meeting in the world where they would get one. It was the conscience of the committee the spiritual service body to send a copy free to every meeting on the face of the planet, and that is what we done. And so you know in Atlanta we went out to the airport and here are these two or three boxes we was all like nervous as cats, couldn't wait to get our hands and knives on them. You know we dived in pulled it out, you know the first ones, did the same thing in LA and Philly and all over the place. They just drove around all night knocking on people's doors you know and finally the sleepy people would come to the door and say I think they live next door.

(Laughter) So we would run next door you know and give them their Grey form, took them by hospitals, took them by wherever addicts were. The woman Olivia in Dublin went down to the post office and got hers and it just floored her you know, this great big bulky package from the United States of America what could possibly be in it. You know she started crying and ran around Dublin and Ireland all the rest of the day showing it to people. So I am going to cut off here so that we can have time, there was other conferences like after Memphis and Santa Monica, there was additional edit of chapters and the committee got even better at doing it. By now there were people that had been working with it two or three years. Get the time sequence too, Wichita to Lincoln was a year, Lincoln to Memphis was 4 or 5 months, or two or three months, yeah. Memphis to Santa Monica was couple three months, Santa Monica to Warren, Ohio was three months I think, Warren , Ohio to Miami, Florida three months and then back to Memphis bought another three months and then the Philadelphia Lit Conference and then that's where the stories were all taken care of. The white form was sent out from Memphis the book was finished in Miami. That was the seven conferences though was Wichita, Lincoln, Memphis, Santa Monica, Warren, Miami and Philadelphia, and that completed it.

So help me God I don't know how this miracle happened but I am real glad and I am ( ) for everybody on all the committees and all those years. That the idea being able to turn around what the disease was doing to us and just going to keep doing unopposed forever. It made us in to sort of like spiritual warriors or something. And you know people died like we tried to get NA started back in the 40's, 50's and 60's then you know they even die in some places today but it aint as bad. And people have died that helped write your Basic Text. Roger is gone, Gina is gone, Tom the Red is dead, but at least they left with something, of all the addicts that did at least, they left with something. I mean Jimmy got to see his dream come true, things divide us like the more strong we got like bureaucratically and dealing with this paperwork and dealing with this communication system. Like without realizing that we had more friends and more support more money more connections, longer mail lists better equipment, quicker response time. We were just so tuned in to the fellowship it was like we would go to LA and instead of being like the old slow pokes from the east coast, we would go to LA and those fast people from Los Angeles and San Francisco would be sitting there watching us zip around the room. I mean just like how do they do this, you know some of the rumors and gossips in those days, who is behind them, the Ford Foundation giving them money? (Laughter)

I mean me losing my wife and my kids and my business; I am still paying off bills that come from those years. People still laugh at me and tell me that I am a bad example of recovery because I do not have more personal cash, but I may being here you will ever know. I have seen more miracles when I saw that thing you know Blade Runner and the guy was dying at the end and said I have seen the moons from Io. I have seen better than that right here through my recovery in Narcotics Anonymous. So what is this sign, Anonymi , well you know if we had gone through all of this without cracking some jokes and hamming it up a little bit it could have torn us up you know. So Anonymi was like what the Latin plural of anonymous and so we was constantly making up jokes. And one of the jokes which Anonymi actually was not some kind of a joke, it was the idea was that because of the kind of service we were doing and kind of strains that were on us. And the wavelength I guess we were on and the fact that we were servicing the needs of a worldwide fellowship and been doing it long enough that it was like our ordinary. I was like what are you doing today writing a letter to the entire NA fellowship what else (Laughter), do not we all. Then average members would go like you are doing what, you know we would have people outraged and mad at us. Well what kind of damn ego trip are you on? You know like somebody has got to do it, what something wrong with me, now don't answer that. You know some of the World Lit workers made up the joke or the notion or maybe they made up a chip that said Anonymi or at least one of those pins. They would have some little Anonymi meetings and share their feelings and what they are going through. Oh, I would talk about; I would run up to members in Atlanta after one of these conferences and say Oh the book is coming, of she is so great isn't it wonderful and they would go like and look at me like , you piece of shit. And I would go like what kind of reaction is that thanks a lot guys, so much for the home team. Then I would go and sit down at a table and start rattling on about the book and Id get up and leave and go like what?

In Atlanta Georgia where I lived, I lived like twenty miles out, and they called it Bo's damn book. (Laughter). Because from their perspective they did not know that we really were calling, writing, and seeing people all around the whole fellowship on a daily basis. So to them it seemed like Bo's damn book, it took them awhile to figure out no hell that is the whole damn fellowship, it can happen here. Then they took a more gentle view. Change, impact,

pressure, communication, spiritual restraint, check your facts don't go with the rumor, take it with a grain of salt give the other guy the benefit of the doubt. If you don't have a big bag of tools like that you aint going to make it. It is just like trying to do God's work with an ego, it is just like we took this little tape recorder and for some reason decided we wanted to get more music to where it would play louder like outside in the yard. So somebody said lets just switch over to 220 that will work, well no it won't it will just blow up the radio. And so for someone to do this kind of work with an ego, it is like you would blow up. It would be like a fuse, you try to put to much juice through to little a wire and it burns out to protect the equivalent maybe that is what are egos are fuses or something. But if you completely like brainwash out of yourself and just all of your thought system and action system the thought of ego and self and gain and what other people are going to think, we just had to completely forget about that stuff. Man, if we carried baggage like that with us, we would have never been able to walk the mile; it is hard enough doing what we did. A lot of times that got us in trouble, it made other people envious of us or they thought we were trying to take control or they thought we were upstaging them if you are familiar with movie terms. And we just like what are we going to break the conference just because upset in LA because we done the Basic Text, surely they are going to figure out that they are going to get the book next. You know they will accept it in time, you know funny rumors I mean I talked about the two fellowships and who here is not being NA transitional community that was going from AA/NA to just NA. People get start yelling politics and yelling other things. And I had people behind my back calling rumors to LA that were not even in Narcotics Anonymous. And LA believed what they heard on the telephone because what I was doing so upset these people that were not in NA that it was actually happening and that they would either tell them what a rotten guy I am or even embellish what a rotten guy I am. And in LA, they still believe what they were told ten years ago, what am I going to do go out there and shake them. I love them I am sorry it all happened. I wish to God I would have been able to find away to just stay in literature and not be WC administration and not be on the Board of Trustees for five years. Maybe I did some good but somebody would have to point it out to me. You know I got you know I have learned I have a lot of restraint and discipline but you know my love is always literature. The policy stuff I understand a lot of that stuff I was trustee liaison to finance anyway this is a history workshop, what do you do with old service workers. Well the people who wrote your Basic Text were very active. Typically, a Lit worker would show up in the beginning and say hey, there are four meetings in the state of Ohio and six months later, they would say well we got 20 meetings in Ohio now and a year later they say we got 50 meetings, it just wasn't uncommon. You know and I was chairing world lit and chaired the World Convention which was sort of a disaster but then four or five years later the WSC put me on the Ad-Hoc Committee to work on convention guidelines, so Bo got his revenge. This other upset chair from Milwaukee sent me notes and God came up with a plan and those guidelines were approved the convention guidelines for the whole fellowship. Me and Joseph, Joseph played a tremendous role in all this and he could not be here today, his car was broke or something like that. But you know things happen to us when people don't cherish or appreciate what we have been trying to do. , our hopes and dreams and a lot of people like Joseph and Jim Miller, a couple of others get something kind of torn out of them, and it is hard to go on like nothing had happened and pretend. Maybe working on history will set some of that to rest, because we have to take care of our own people cause if we don't care and take care of them nobody else will. You don't set them up on pedestals, your right that would kill them. But you do not kick them when they are down either and you can give them cheery little phone calls and show them you give a damn. You know like his mom died not long ago and like everybody in Narcotics Anonymous around the east knew about it, but he just went into a not communicating spell. So anyway what are we going to do next, you want me to just step down and we do the tape or questions…. Applause

Jodi: Thank you, thank you very much.
Bo: You are most welcome. Thank you.

Jodi: I kind of have two questions; one is when I lived in Van Nuys I remember speaking to one of the members of the present literature committee and being denied access to one of their meetings. Even if I said, I wouldn't say anything. And asking a lot of questions about all the controversy over the staff team approach and professional writers and in trying to, why do you feel the need to do this because some of our greatest writers have been addicts. And I get very upset at this concept that you put five addicts in a room and they can't even agree how to get out.

Bo: You mean some of our greatest writers just in the general population in history

Jodi: through out society and history.

Bo: Like, Hemingway was sort of an addict and had short choppy sentences.

Jodi: Right, the thing that we have talked about and maybe you could clarify it is that their concept is that our literature process did not work. bah, blah blah and I think I have heard you say in other times that it does they are just not doing it, and that is coming up with all these new fangled ideas

Bo: I just don't think they know what a spiritual process it is and how much a matter of the heart it is.

Jodi: That is the second part of the question this is not about words and paper and grammar, (Bo; It is not about things you can buy) that there is a lot of spirit that went into this book and I would like you to address some of that. You have talked on other occasions about the prayer that went into before each meeting and lets talk about this is more than English.

Bo: Well there was that thing that Greg wrote about you know divine precepts and all, God grant us the ability and whatever and that was read at later conferences and prayer was such a continuous part of what went on. It was like it was like eating a meal but you had been snacking all day so I mean like you have been praying all day so you make this special prayer now and then I mean yeah it is nice but I mean it took all them prayers. Prayer was the way we kept down the in fighting. You know that funny thing mentioned in the writing over there about when I got back from Lincoln and a lot of the files folders from the Lincoln Lit Conference were empty and it said chapter three and a little title for chapter three and had nothing absolutely in it. And deep down in my heart I knew that Joe had betrayed me and stolen that damn material, I could not figure out why. It just tore me out of the frame for about two or three days and you know I did not have any guiders or predecessors to tell me what to do I just could not figure out what to do. So finally I talked to Joe about it and he said Bo don't you remember we didn't get to those parts, I mean I just set up those folder but we never had any material to go in it. So we knew the love and the trust and we applied that, that way we learned those lessons. .Am I answering your question? (Sort of) Okay, cause you were asking about the prayers and the faith and all. I am just saying that while it was happening on one level like the physical plane it was also happening on the spiritual plane. (That is what I am trying to get at that it was not just English) And the two were just kind of jammed together somehow; sometimes it seems sort of float back and forth incredible things happen

Jodi: I mean obviously throughout your story you have talked about spiritual opposition the disease as well and maybe it is overtaken. (Bo; we knew the spiritual opposition would kill us if we let it). And maybe it has taken over our literature in a sense. Is it true that not only have you not been asked to help but also you have been blocked from our present literature process, you and the others that were apart of the original process.

Bo: Well yeah, I don't know whether they are figuring that one fellow should only do so much or they figure they got it knocked. But you know I am an NA member I help when asked; I mean I went to San Francisco to find out who was working on the book how can we help. And a man asked me to help, I said can I help and he said sure help. So I am use to do what I am told, I haven't been told to do nothing so I been like writing books and learning computers on the side and trying to pay my bills and such, take care of my two fine young sons. But, I guess maybe I have been blocked but who the hell knows Jodi? I mean it is like pulling teeth out, it is horrible.

Jodi: Well they say they cannot get it done but they have not consulted anyone to do it.

Bo: Well that does make you pause and wonder doesn't it. (Laughter)

Grateful Dave: Grateful Gave addict. Hi Dave. Isn't it great .I have a great deal of respect for the people who had enough courage and gumption to strike out in a different direction. No matter what the personal cost was to those individuals, there was a greater spiritual reward always reaped. Anybody that left NA over controversy did not really have a membership to begin with. The same is true today, controversy is vital, conflict is vital to growth, personal and otherwise. Knowing you as well as I do, I am sure you spent the past four hours telling us about the spiritual process

and probably a number of asides scratched your head and said I just don't know what happened then, and that's to be expected. I have some questions, maybe you have covered them maybe you haven't because I have spent seemingly months and months and months

Bo: Let me ask one real quick on what you said going on this intuitive process do you mean don't know what happened when it was happening or after it was over?

Grateful Dave: Probably a little bit of both

Bo: Well one thing that I think about after it was over is all those years and all the spiritual studies, I mean a lot of people do not believe that God is real so they are incapable of believing that God alone is real. So when you are around those people you have to make certain allowances. And very few people are willing to die for something good. So that is how you push past the normal boundaries.

Grateful Dave: Correct, it is like stepping off a cliff and saying well gosh, I am not sure if I am right, and I am not sure if I am wrong. But as long as I am paralyzed by fear I am not going to move anywhere, and I am going to be still suffering the same pain and have that lack of growth. I know that you believe this and I know that I believe it and I know that we believe basically the same things. I know our approaches are different. I love conflict, I love the truth I am Scotch-Irish. (Bo: If it is good for the addicts, I love it.) Well I hope that everything is guided by that basic spiritual premise. You know there are a number of things that have come to the attention of members of the fellowship, whether they are accurate or not are certainly a matter that is in question. Can you, maybe you went over this but were it true that the 4th and 9th Tradition language of the Basic Text was included in the approval form and also the review and input form? And we wont get into who, how, why, or what but capriciously it had disappeared between the approval copy and the printing of the special edition.

Bo: Well let me try to state it more clearly. The material was mostly written by Greg Pierce and edited by the lit committee to an extent in the Grey form this is 1980. And then sent to the Board of Trustees for the traditions check like all of the material sent to the Board of Trustees, they had it for a very long time. And while they were working on that, we worked on the rest of the Basic Text. We was all done it went out in the white form, that was out of Memphis after Miami. Then it was out for a good while, it got approved in 82 published in 83, so that means they probably had it more than a year, maybe a year and a half. Then what you are saying is after it got approved in 82, but nobody saw the printing until in 83 in May. Changes had been made in the document, and all these were lit workers compared the final approved form with what was actually in the printed version and they found a couple of discrepancies in the Traditions sections. What had happened was that the Board of Directors chair of the WSO, the Board of Trustees chair and the WSC chair had been advised that Jimmy Kinnon didn't like the line saying , the service boards and committees should never have the power to rule, censor dictate or decide, delete was one of them too. All else is not NA in the 4th Tradition, there were other less substantial changes, those however are very very crucial. Spiritual service bodies for instance that thinks their committees and start censoring, ruling, dictating and deciding loose faith with the people and the whole thing falls apart. Where is your volunteers where is your spirit coming from why does anyone want to come and work their ass off for that?

Grateful Dave: Is there a lesson that we might learn from World Services about the deletion of that language and where we might have evolved to because we didn't have that spiritual group conscience approved frame of reference to have to stand on foundationally in the truth.

Bo: Sometimes it is hard to appreciate a lesson when you are learning it. But it sure seemed to me at the time like the fellowship acted like a few members had some personal attachment to those lines and that the anonymous thing to do was to support WS move to delete those lines even though they were restored to the 2nd edition I think and then taken out again in the 3rd. But don't you see considered as if it were a personal antagonism between individuals and I don't think very many members voted on it stopped to consider whether they really thought areas and regions were Narcotics Anonymous in essential terms. Is the hotel the convention, yeah sure the convention takes place there but you could have the hotel and no convention, you could have the convention out in a big field. Everybody was there, it

was not raining, and everybody felt good.

Grateful Dave: Well the whole premise of that tradition was based on NA as such being the groups and it said that our service boards and committees exist to serve the fellowship, but they are not apart of Narcotics Anonymous, that was the 9th. We seem to have gotten ourselves into spiritual cross-purposes by placing an undo emphasis on untitled service. Wouldn't one by looking at the traditions, just the wording of the traditions alone get the idea that there is a requirement for membership on a service board or committee? So it violates our 3rd Tradition to be and also the 12th Tradition that anonymity does not apply once we take a service title, we set apart from. So, I mean duh, you know but it seems to me

Bo: I think there is even a simpler way and maybe more useful way to analyze it that may not occur to you is that when I got clean in 74, 75,76,78 and 79 when the service name was changed the service structure was one service structure it was one way.

Side two of tape

Bo: the old timers at the time was that all else was not NA, that line did not come from the new east coast, Midwest service workers, that was one of our axioms, that came from Jimmy Kinnon. That came from you know Chuck Skinner and whoever all else is not NA, that is what we were taught, that is what we learned that is what we wrote down, and plus Greg wrote that section so likely input that he derived from what they taught him. But see when it was changed authoritatively without checking with even the regions or even asking them with a decent phone call to let them know what was going on and printed, that is it, like it or lump it change the next conference. Then that was just like and insult to all the NA lovers who had just written their baby up from a dream to a reality. It was the insult that was tragic, but the biggest thing that you are saying Dave is that it was never considered on principle it was exclusively a personal, hot, political emotionally charged issue, as if it were like two eggs butting heads and the only question is who has the hardest head.

Grateful Dave: Well I have seen the letter that you speak of, there was an inner office memorandum, similar to the one I have over there that went about the hiring of the professional writer and it works. From the chairperson to the three branches of World Service

Bo: They all three put their names on it)

Grateful Dave: absolutely it was Sally and Raymar

Bo: I thought it was Chuck Skinner and Raymar and Bob Stone)

Grateful Dave: and Chuck Skinner was the office board chair, at the time.

Bo: I think it was Chuck Gates at that time; I have a picture of Bob Stones signature and seem like Chuck Skinner

Grateful Dave: Well Bob Stones signature is in the minutes of the 83 conference in explanation along with Phil Perez having said that oh there was an error between, there was a printers error, that was the official position at the time, that there was a printers error the inner office memorandum that went out to members of the WSC.

Bo: Well it was bad and everybody knows it happened and we need to work on a solution

Grateful Dave: Well the solution, the solution you know without knowing where we are today, see there are a couple of issues surrounding our message today, you know one is you know, one is the issue of the message and the integrity of the message and the preciousness of that spirit and the group conscience that burst that. And what is going on today in terms of you know every piece of literature that we have on out tables with five exceptions which were the pamphlets that were written prior to 76 have been written by the group conscience. All of our literature and

everything that we have gotten is a result of a process that we are being told today does not work and has, in effect, been thrown in the trash.

Bo: You have to be skilled to work it. I mean get real people I have shared the best that I can remember from back then to date. But I don't blame these professionals they have been to college for 5 or 10 years and been told this is how you write books. How they going to listen to a guy like me? I am just a schmuck.

Grateful Dave: I think that is a real good issue

Bo: Hey, they are paid to do it, I am broke.

Grateful Dave: I hear you. (Laughter). Fawn talked about a Scotch-Irishman that threw in his social security you know to do something worthwhile for Narcotics Anonymous. I happen to be Scotch-Irish and I have thrown in my social security check in to a book here okay, I threw my social security check in the pot and I don't pull any punches I aint no fuckin diplomat but I will tell you what . The approval copy of the Basic Text is the only book that was in total approved book by the fellowship and there were no stories in that. The stories were an after thought; they were never approved by the group.

Bo: No wait, they were, Philadelphia the white form was Miami sent out at Memphis and in three more months Philadelphia and then that form went out later because that wasn't ready in time for the first form.

Grateful Dave: Several groups in several areas in fact did vote on the approval of the stories because we have available across the street here the original book of 50 stories. Well we did not get them out in time or we don't know what to do with them, and why don't you guys check them out. But the date on that and the votes in looking through the minutes the stories were never approved, they showed up in the Red Book. It was a Literature Committee decision. Not bad or right or wrong but I need to make that point that they were never approved by the total group conscience. The changes in the 3rd Edition revised were done on the floor of the conference as an after thought to the changes that were approved in the white book by the trustee's recommendations of those changes, which was the only unanimous vote in the history of the World Service Conference. 72 to nothing the changes were approved on the floor of the World Service Conference to change the white book and as a motion after thought they said well lets make those changes in the white book consistent with the Basic text, so that is how we got the 3rd Edition Revised.

But in fact, in truth the only book that was ever approved by the groups was the approval copy of the Basic Text. That was published under C.A.R.E.N.A. and the signator for C.A.R.E.N.A. was James P. Kinnon, at the time, because I know its right there, I got that.

Bo: I think what you are saying is very important and these people are all ready supporting or probably would not be here. The dream that we had when the Basic Text was done was like the feeling was like whew, man great we finally are done and good for something. Now we can have conferences that are a little more comfortable and a little more convenient with a little more time in between it and can go a little bit slower and do a lot better. When we can go back through the Grey Form for all the good stuff that might have gotten passed over, we just never had a chance man, the money, the money people and the professionals and all that showed up. It is not like they took us away from it, because it was God's to us, it is like they reached for it and thought they took it and they have been trying to run with it ever since. But it is still in the same place it always was, they just do not know where to look for it, in the heart. Because I could correct literature today

Grateful Dave: Some of the assertions that are made in this open letter from the Trustees concerning the unauthorized printing of this unauthorized Basic Text and all this other happy horseshit. Would you say, you have seen this of course

Bo: Nope did not get a copy, but I have heard about that

Grateful Dave: Oh well then perhaps I would ask you to comment on the ethnicity of the statements that are made here.

Bo: Well I mean No just a second Dave, just starting with the basic idea that world sends out harsh letters directly to groups who may or may not know what is going on all by itself that is sowing seeds of controversy I mean that violates the tenth right there. I think you know direct responsibility we should have been more direct and if they had trouble with you or somebody else printing that book then they should have been more direct and more upfront and not tried to get people on the sides drawn in cause that's how newcomers get hurt.

Grateful Dave: So would you safely in you heart and soul and based upon the copious amounts of documentation that you have in your personal possession and we know that others have this same documentation say that the Basic Text belongs to the World Service Office, or that the Basic Text belongs to everyone sitting in this room?

Bo: We wrote it for the fellowship, not for any office that's why when the old office fell apart it was sad but you know I mean for the fellowship it is important not the office.

Grateful Dave: Do you think that we will have any resolutions of the current problems in the structure?

Bo: In other words, in finishing, that it should be held in trust like as agent for Narcotics Anonymous by the WSO and if the copyright forms do not read like that, then the fellowship owes it to itself to change it.

Grateful Dave: The trust relationship is, was vested in the WSO and is stated here in the minutes of the World Service Conference, was vested in the WSO to protect the copyright from unauthorized use from outside organizations such as an outside organization. Inside the fellowship, we were under the impression I assume at the time because we printed our own literature, we made our own literature, we duplicated our own literature, and we passed all that literature around. I got clean as a matter of fact there was a five page letter asking us to not to duplicate our literature that was sent out just before I got clean. And it surfaced in my area when I was a member in my area I made a motion at the area to stop buying key tags from Atlanta lit and to stop printing our own literature because if we were going to support NA, WSC, and WSO then we should go all the way with doing that. Well times have changed and things are different and today we have a moral situation that will require the same kind of the spark fire enthusiasm and commitment that produced our Basic Text to rectify it. Would not you say that that would be a safe thing to say?

Bo: I do not know how God is going to straighten this one out.

Grateful Dave: Do you think that God uses people?

Bo: Yeah

Grateful Dave: And if God aint using people to help straighten this out then maybe their not ( ) using God in their life. That a safe extrapolation.

Discussion in the audience….5 more minutes and we will have dinner. Thank you Dave.

Lawrence: I am an addict man and my name is Lawrence. My question is, I basically have three questions and I will try to keep them simple for you. My first question is when did we loose our common denominator in the Basic Text cause its not there no more.

Bo: Well I have heard that and I have heard people talk about it in this workshop.
But you know like my Basic Text with the special cover on it is not its not a 4th Edition and I still got Grey Forms, I mean changes like that I am counting on the fellowship to wake up and form itself accurately and address some of these things. I is just a big on and it takes time and I think five years ago a lot people couldn't envision it possible

what's happened since then. I think a lot of people, a lot of calm deliberate recovery types are on the case today so I see some remedy. Since I do not read the fourth and fifth edition then if I hear from somebody heard from a newcomer that just lacks some of the zip and zing I am not surprised, but other than that, I do not know what to think. I mean maybe it is so in just that one case and maybe it would be true 90 out of 100 people that read it. But really whom cares lets get back to sensibility, lets get back to an approved structure, lets get rid of the temporary working guide mentality. All that really means is that we follow the temporary working guide absolutely verbatim as written unless some powerful person wants to do it another way and then they do just as they damn well please. And the service world I existed in prior to 79, 80, and 81 was very stable and very cut and dry and we just did not have that kind of bullshit. I just wasn't allowed it would have been fantastic, of course we didn't have the World Service Conference either it was just coming into existence, but at the area regional level those guides worked good. Now we have had our period of explosive growth now let us put a lid on it, get back to the business serving the addicts sick in recovery, and forget all this squabbling. Because if you really could mathematically figure it our you would find that everybody was a little right and everybody was a little wrong the was a whole lot of in between.

Lawrence: My other two questions and I hope you could respond to them. My second question was the first copy of the Basic Text was sold for $35 dollars and I believe there was a purpose for selling those texts for $35 dollars> Was it because we needed to print more and sell them at that price in order to bring them down to the price we originally intended to keep them. The price affordable to you know again a common denominator addict that is coming into the rooms. My final question is, when did the service office stop serving the fellowship, when did it actually start?

Bo: Well first when the Basic Text was done and approved the plan was maybe several plans, there may have been several plans but the dominant plan that got approved was to have x number of Basic Texts printed with the Red Cover and sell for twenty-five dollars and maybe it was 2500 of them. Then like another 5000 of them printed to be sold for eight dollars a piece. Then do your math on it the income of that would pay for the whole first printing. So that was a way that we could finance with in the fellowship without having to borrow from a bank or outside source enough money to do the first printing, within traditions, with no outside support with in the fellowship. So people would hear that and send in fifty or a hundred bucks or two or three, it was twenty- five though. Then the balance was eight dollars each. I do not think that the WSO has ever stopped serving the needs of the fellowship entirely. I think there are many, many, very good, very loyal, dedicated, hard working, terrific individuals out there, and most of our problems and whether I am rationalizing because it is more personally comfortable or whether it is really true, most of our problems are like growing pains.

I mean if you took a damn hamburger company or a donut company and it grew from having one location to having five thousand locations in a year and a half you would have what is called "management problems." If you take a little baby fellowship like ours and just spring it up to life size in ten years, you have what is called "management problems." And, of course, our disease takes, you know, those expectable problems and like, "Oh God has let me down! Guess I have to go use some dope." (Laughter) I mean isn't that smart? I mean nobody can mess with your clean time but you, I mean you don't have a handle on everything, but least you got a handle on that.

So, anyway, I just look at, I never ignore entirely the 90 percent or more that are doing well at WSO and they are answering the phone calls, and staying at place out of love and they want things to get better and are glad there have been some recent changes. A lot of them may have just sort of given up hope but they did not quit, they kept trying. I am thinking of two or three specifics right now, just fine people working at WSO. And I stretch my neck out and let them put a sharp blade to it and I would never think they would cut me. Of course there are others who I would never extend that opportunity.

Lawrence: You were mentioning how we could stop the squabbling, and start to get back to the business at hand. Can you give us some concrete suggestions some ideas maybe some direction so I could take back to my home group.

Bo: Yeah but this is like sort of hopefully an educated guess, it is easier to start new big , desirable, clear goals that excite and energize the fellowship today than to deal with the matters of the past. That is why it is so hard to do the history, And what it is like there is this big fear if you go too far with the history work you get into personal issues,

and sooner or later, you pick up a clean time casualty or two. I mean like right in the middle of the history work xw something or other shoots himself right there on y in dot Van Nuys and we are all suppose to feel like hell. Well I am sorry people have been dying ever since I have been a grown person, a lot of them die young and horrible, and if anybody is stupid enough to have such a rotten spiritual condition, I just feel sorry for them. You know my little brother died when I was at the WSC and I stayed out there because I had other brothers and sisters who were not dead yet, and when the time came to put his ashes in the river I was lucky to be there. But people die everyday and I do not think people are going to die over history work that is pretty lame. But you know what I am saying is there are like these real curious fears try to get somebody who opposes history work to finger on what the obstacle is. You know well not right now, it will cost to much money or well form an Ad Hoc committee. I mean they have been putting it off for years, they being whoever is at the World service Conference because I have introduced motions about this every year and I couldn't say of it was the office that opposed it or the conference or the Board of Trustees. There may have been some support and some opposition from all three on a given year. But for some reason everybody acts like it is not cool for NA to have its own history. It is like we are suppose to be not real still. Like we are not real in the days before we had our book, and we loose that not quite real status if we have a history book. I mean what is everybody afraid of I mean you know I screwed some things up and mailed out some world lit mailing with a Narcotics Anonymous in the envelope isn't that awful, I mean really it was pretty bad we took it serious as hell at the time. But so what, it has been done along time if there was any harm done surely it is over by now. And other people did wrong things and things they would love to undo or take back. So what are you going to focus on that or the good stuff? I mean I see a young fellowship hungry for answers and I don't think the fellowship cares anything about who screwed up or who was successful or who do we got to( )talk to, you know your cool bro, you a drag jack. I mean when I am having trouble in my area I need to how I can adapt to a pattern that has worked for somebody else, how do I solve my problems at a group level? What were the dreams and values and intents of people who have played a historical role in NA? That is what newcomers ask me today that is what I think people want. They really don't think they want dirty laundry and I think, some people think that is all there is dirty laundry. You know there is a lot more than that.

Jodi: Hi, I am an addict named Jodi. Hi Jodi. It is kind of like the reason we do not have history you know the concept of spiritual anonymity and that our founders are suppose to remain anonymous and all that other bullshit, it is just rationalization. It is as if they expect it to be like adopted children who are not allowed to know their parents and expect us to grow up functional. You know it an unreal expectation especially the spiritual entity. You also brought up earlier you know that our steps talk about the addict who still suffers, addicts can be people with twenty years clean who still got through this, and sometimes it is overlooked. I appreciate you bringing that up. You said on different occasions that a lot of these problems started when we stopped writing our own original literature and maybe the squabbling would stop if we started working on something new and you discussed maybe working on the history and also a book on the spiritual experience. There are a lot of things unspoken especially from the older and even the newer members about these spiritual experiences, they are carrying them around thinking they are crazy, and we have talked about getting that together. What do you think about if we just stopped, it is like instead of focusing the disease, focusing on recovery what do you think if we started writing new literature, what do you think would happen?

Bo: Well, you know I have shared mainly as World Lit Chair and I want to step out of that role for a moment because I have also served as WC vice chair and on two Ad Hoc's, Board of Trustees and liaison to various WC subcommittees and worked three weeks night and day on the structure in Memphis. The first half of which is the approved current form. Just tons of stuff like that and as a service technician I am aware of the fact that under any version of our approved written service structure there has always been allowance made for individual initiative, for group initiate and area, regional or world. So that a piece of written material could originate from a member, from a group, from an area from a region or from a world level committee, now there is their theory. And in application, some pieces have originated from all those levels. Okay and then I think the last few years they have been having such a time of it that it is like the belief, fear, or something like that. No if we got literature from individuals or small groups the chance that it would be good enough to reach approval without extensive rewriting , restructuring, rephrasing, you know take out addiction put in drug addiction and just rubber stamping it making sure all the little terms are cool. It is just like exclude that no more members initiative. Still I think we are going to have members who

write books and I would love to see a hundred of them. I may not read all hundred books but I would cherish the choice. Meanwhile if World Lit wants to pursue its staff team approach and all that I think that it is just a real shame, a tragedy, and an abuse, but if that is what they want to do and you all are going to let them, get away with it then fine let them do it. But I still think loving individuals can do more than rich bureaucrats actually. Therefore, if they want to do that I am not mad at them and I hope they ain't mad if I do not do that and try to find some other positive thing to do. I am really tired of even following the plot I mean it is just lame. And I know the beauty in you all you can do it. So what is next you all want to go to dinner? Applause

Tape 6
Allentown History Literature Addathon 1990
Problems / Solutions

God, Grant us the serenity to accept the things we cannot change. The courage to change the things we can and the wisdom to know the difference.

Okay we are going to continue this workshop. What we want to focus on now is a, I believe Bo stopped off somewhere around 1982 and we are going to start with Dave sharing some things about 1982 on. Things that worked things that did not work and then we want to come up to the present and look at some questions you may have or some type of solution process we have or that we want to begin looking at. With that, what I want to do is we can get Dave up to the front up here and he is going to start off where Bo left off.

I have to finish taking my vitamins y'all, (anybody got a white chip) (Laughter). HaHa lithium is a salt, why do not we use it on steak. Well I am supposed to open this session here, Hello WSO. **My name is Grateful Dave and I am an addict.** Hi Dave, Hi Family. (Laughter) send one to Stu Tordman, will you. No, I can break my anonymity but they cannot.

The title of this session is problems and possible solutions and as you have kind of gotten the idea over the course of the weekend. I probably can recount verbatim the problems that have occurred over the past bunch of years, because I am sort of NA historian. I id not start out to be that way you know what I mean but God had other ideas. Because if it was left up to me I would go sit like a knot on a log in a group somewhere and drink coffee and go (noises). I do not know if you have seen this here. This is called an inventory input document. I put this together with a couple of people down in Philadelphia the well it was for a while it use to be the radical capital of the east coast this year but all our regional servants sold out and took positions you know. So basically this is a suggested format for groups, areas and regions to inventory World Service performance with recommendations for action. Now there is a lot of superfluous fluff in here, you know but maybe you want to attempt to get a copy. There was one of these sent to every region in the world, every RSR, every alternate, every conference participant, chair, board of director, trustee and vice chair, and an attempt to foster discussion at the World Service Conference. We have learned that the World Service Conference is not a place to discuss things. It is a place to beat up on each other for about fifteen hours a day once a year and ignore each other. So what I am going to do is kind of read through a summary of events that cause concern and then I am going to go into kind of like, this isn't all but kind of the high points. Take notes ask questions, if you have a problem that you want to talk about, come up and say what the problem is. If you have a solution that you want to talk about, come up and give us the solution. If you just want to come up and run your mouth then stay seated.

So, the summary of events that causes concern, the deletion of group conscience material from the Basic Text, fourth and 9th Tradition language 1982. Deleted language from Tradition 4, second paragraph third sentence use to read,"the answer is that these things

Are not NA" and also sentence #6 use to read "all else is not NA". Deleted language from Tradition 9 was in the last paragraph the deleted third sentence read, "None of them has the power to rule, censor, decide or dictate". Then there

was a phrase that was deleted that they exist to serve the fellowship but they are not apart of Narcotics Anonymous. These deletions dramatically affect the meaning of these traditions. Controversy over our World Service Office resulted in the firing of our office manager in 1983. That was Jimmy Kinnon and we have talked about that all day here.

WSC minutes 83, page 32 , We direct the policy subcommittee to rewrite the service structure for approval but everybody that I know that was at the conference says it was for review at the WSC. What we are talking about here is that we were given an inaccurate history or incomplete history of the history of the guide to service. How that got started there, select committee was appointed in 1983 at the World Service Conference to rewrite the blue and green service manual. Which the first fifteen pages of one was approved and the second fifteen pages of a other was approved the subsequent year and they compiled all this stuff with a bunch of input from other regions and policy committees and what have you. Two policy committees refused to deal with it so they created a select committee at the conference that is still working folks; they just changed the name to the Ad Hoc Committee on NA service. There whole idea is to go on, they never asked.

Okay the appointment of a select committee by the WSC chair in 1984 , this committee was only to review the 83 policy report which I just told you what it was, and to prepare it for fellowship review by November, '84, the select committee failed to meet the November '84 date and continues to work. Somewhere along the line, the select committee decides that it is suppose to totally rewrite our service structure all by itself. See WSC '84 minute's page 59, 14, 15 and 22. The WSO hires, unauthorized hiring of professional writers in 1985 and 1987. What happened was that the conference passed the motion in 1985 to have the Basic Text professionally edited for grammar, punctuation, syntax singular and plural verb tense and that kind of stuff but was not to change the concept of it. When they hired the writer to do that the writer didn't do that but in fact what the writer did at that time was become the author of a white copy of approval copy of "It Works, How and Why" which was then referred to as the 12 and 12.

But it was like, and I have the letters over here that were hired before the conference in '85 and the conference in '85 was where the motion was brought up and everybody was upset because they went and hired this professional writer without consulting the conference, with out consulting the fellowship. The unauthorized contracts for the step portion of, It Works, cost us $100.000.00 dollars. Nobody approved that but the WSO, Board of Directors and the Board of Trustees and the chairperson of the World Service Conference. Those people were at that time it was Sally Evans, George Houlihan. Then after the fellowship voted down the sober approval copy of "It Works, How and Why" was written by Jacqueline Lair who was 16 years sober in AA and was a friend of Sally Evans and that is how they got together for that contract and of course it is a documented fact right here, I got it. Problems, we are talking about problems. We are talking about our service structure doing things on self-will without consulting the fellowship first. Then and Bo remembers this when we were in Newark remember when they said, oh man that sixty thousand dollars we spent for the professional traditions is really unusable and Bo says, well we can't hide it from them they will find out about it anyway. Remember, yeah so we wasted $160.000.00 dollars without consulting the fellowship, and we spent another $200.000.00 dollars giving World Literature Committee money to do "It Works".

If you want to avoid guidelines in this fellowship, you create an Ad Hoc Committee. Ad Hoc Committees don't have to follow guidelines, so the World Literature Committee have become Ad Hocs of two people, okay that is what is was last year, that why they could. Then they went off and doing like all these back door things and telling us that our input is sixth grade and , blah, blah. Blah. Problems, problems, boy, oh boy, oh boy have we got problems.

The WSO was presented a gift of the World Convention Corporation after the Chicago Convention. The World Convention use to be under the auspices of the fellowship and forty percent of the money went to the World Service Conference to help support the volunteer service structure. In 1985 the DC Convention Committee kept $85.000.00 dollars in CD's. The WSO went down there with a special rescue committee John Curley, Dutch Hubber and some other people Tony Daddio went down there who were you know big wigs in NA at the time and rescued the money, and the WSO took the corporation at that point and made it a wholly owned subsidiary of the WSO. Removed the ability for the convention to be bid on need and be passed around and took the money from, the total money and kept that and put it right back in to the WSO and it has been that way ever since 1985. I do not go to World Conventions

any more because it was stolen. That is just an indication of some of the stuff that has been going on in the name of carrying the message to the addict that still suffers you know.

The 1985 and the ’87 guide to service was written by this select committee, without asking the fellowship for approval and the conference agenda to rewrite the service structure. I am trying to go over this quickly and it is hard to go over it quickly it really is. The Board of Trustees failure to respond to fellowship problems to fulfill their oversight functions and to report the true nature of office and conference activities to the fellowship at large. The Board of Trustees has gone from impotent to omnipotent in one fell swoop (Laughter). The creation of WSO dependent fellowship relations outside the borders of the US by the unauthorized use of office staff, WSO resources, materials and money. This is a part of an overall unapproved marketing and public relations merchandising effort undertaken by an Executive Director and the Board of Directors of the WSO. What I am talking about is going to Cairo when there is three meetings in a treatment center and needing an Arabic Basic Text and going to Brazil during carnival time and taking a guy from the Florida Region down there with him on a WSO ticket because he speaks Spanish and the Assistant Executive Director does not speak Spanish, but they speak Portuguese in Brazil.

So, (Laughter) we are what we are doing is getting the fast shuffle, the shuck and jive. We have been getting the shuck and jive for a long time okay. All right the joint administrative committee like who in the hell gave them the right to make motions? They took the right to make motions; they were never given the right to make motions. They were suppose to add motions, not create them they were suppose to add them to the conference agenda report when they came in from the regions. The JAC has become an unauthorized block between the regional structure and the committee structure of the fellowship. So the JAC ignores the conscience of the fellowship and held an unapproved expanded joint administrative committee meeting in July of ’89, then covers up by changing the name of to Expanded Ad Hoc Committee on NA Service. When confronted in St. Louis, Jack Bernstein went; well well well well, that was an expanded Ad Hoc Meeting. From a guide to service that we never asked for at a cost of $35.000.00 per meeting and they held two last year. The total ticket is mounting up you see. The freedom with the money that belongs to God see the money that comes from your basket in your home group and is generated in Narcotics Anonymous via anything doesn’t belong to us, does not belong to a corporation, it doesn’t belong to going for five dollar a pound coffee. What it belongs to is it belongs to carry the message to addict that still suffers? We have no moral right to capriciously use these funds and to spend them in ways that are not the most thrifty possible.

The Joint Administrative Committee chair, not the Ad hoc chair, chaired the meeting that was held there. So how could they call it an Ad Hoc committee if they would not allow the Ad Hoc committee chair to chair the expanded Ad Hoc Meeting? Oh boy, oh boy, have we got problems, and not enough time given to the fellowship to study changes in policy that affect our groups and services. JAC motion #6 at WSC ’89 keeps all service related material from fellowship eyes. This motion with JAC motion #3 and last years agenda, thank God it was tabled which means yes but you know next year said that coupled with the policy committee motion #6 in the ’88 conference agenda will assure that groups have no say in service manuals or WSC service committee guidelines.

The World Literature Committee is ignoring and changing its own policies and guidelines. The WSO is financing and using special workers in literature projects and service related projects in contradictions of Traditions 7, 8, and 9. This was before they were approved to be used, okay the Supreme Court decision, June 5, 1989 it affects the copyright ownership it is amazing. It is amazing how the staff writer approach became real popular right about the time that the Supreme Court was deciding this very important copyright issue. That decision is the (Community for Creative Non Violence vs. Reed) June 5, 1989 which specifically deals with the relationship of an employer and an employee and who owns materials made for hire. If WSO Inc. is allowed to have writers of literature or service materials as paid off the staff, our copyrights could be taken from fellowship control and the creation of a Canadian Service Conference without the specific knowledge or requests from home groups in Canada.

It was a meeting that occurred at 7:00 in the morning in one of the World Service Conferences by Bob Stone and several of the delegates from the Canadian Regions and they came up with this idea that they were going to start a Canadian World Service Conference. Of course this was the big thing, everybody, nobody disputed any of the documentation in this inventory input packet on the floor of the World Service Conference except this one. Well you

know some good detective work and you know so I had to say to people, maybe I was wrong on one but what about the rest of them. (Yeah, yeah that is true but well maybe that is true but we need to focus on today). Well you know how can you focus on today without taking an inventory, because you are all bogged down in the past if you don't focus on today. I got to get rid of the past to get to the present. This is one of the reasons why we are doing a history workshop. Okay.

So they used office staff to put all this together, board members, trustees, RSRs and members of committees traveled back and forth to Canada. You know it was suppose to be their model service structure placed on a guide to service. Did you ever wonder why Canada had their guide to services and the drafts for the guide to service than the American fellowship? This is a plan; there is a plan to do away with everything that we know about service in Narcotics Anonymous that was based on the 12 Traditions and the NA Tree that has been going on for a long time. Fawn talked about it the people who started it are still doing it, they just change places like chameleons you know. WSO and WSC seem to be creating an independent autonomous service office and service structure whose relationship to the fellowship and their desires are virtually non-existent. Did any of you want to have the trustees to have a blank check to write the Traditions? Did that come out of your regions (as if yeah we want the trustees to have a blank check) how about motion #3? Motion #3 was well if you guys do not like what we do then you can fix it next year, but the committees can write their on guidelines and just let us know. What are they doing? They are taking the control away from the ultimate authority which is a loving God expressing himself through our 9th Tradition. They are taking away that authority and that control. Making the WSC, which is actually the lowest element of the service structure. Because an educated home group member is the crown jewel of the service structure, that is where it all begins and ends with the member in the home group. There is no such thing as an area conscience. Areas do not have conscience, where does it say that in our Traditions. You know we look at our Traditions and it talks about groups, group conscience, but if you manage to fuck up and let that word slip out of your mouth at the World Conference you were booed off the floor. Spiritual principles got (Blahhhed) I mean if you were bumbling enough not to you know, talk their language. Group conscience does not exist folks in our World Services. It never did and it does not now. So when you get something coming down the pike and that has World Service Conference or Board of Trustees or this one or something that has some official looking stamp on a letterhead. Look for money, control, if you can see the issues that confront our fellowship in the context of those two things then they make perfect sense. (Well what is there to gain)?

A lot of addicts, for a lot of addict's power and prestige are much more seductive and much more meaningful to them than money. Man you take somebody who was crawling around on the floor for shit that sparkled with a straw in their nose you know a couple of years ago. Eating out of dumpsters and you say well gosh I am a worlds servant now, and I am chair of this and chair of that and boy I am the international coordinator for this. I mean what an ego gratifying thing that that might be, and to make that climb to that level of service when do you have time to work a job and the steps? Believe me I know, I tried it. I am glad I went crazy before I got a position on the world level and had to work the steps.

Okay voting by RSRs at WSC on motions that have never been reviewed by the entire fellowship via the conference agenda report and not asking that motions that will affect NA as a whole be tabled until the next WSC and published in the conference agenda report for the following year. Well for crying aloud, AA does that, AA do not vote on shit capriciously, of course they do not voting on nothing. Strike that from the history books (Laughter). The suspending of conference committee business, we were sent out a document called the 12 Principles of Service. It said in the 11th Principle it said that, under no circumstances should NA services be interrupted, okay. So even the people who were prostilitizing this guide to service and these documents and these principles had interrupted and cancelled the World Service Conference Committee business for the course of the year. Well we do not have enough money to fund the committees but we have enough money to spend $70.000.00 dollars to fly all these people to talk about a service structure that we never asked for. Yeah we got problems. Our 9th Tradition says that we may create service boards and committees directly responsible to those they serve, now what is the flip side of that. The flip side of that is that we may UN-create them. If a service board or committee does not directly, responsibly serve the needs of those that created it then it is dead wood, it is baggage, it is a drain and it is a problem. You know directly responsible does not mean (this fucking guy has to be responsible). That is a two way street too, we have a responsibility. We cannot

afford to advocate our responsibility under God to determine the direction of our fellowship or we will loose it. In my view, we lost it this World Service Conference and I never said that before. I always thought that there was a way to pull it back and maybe there is but the only thing they understand is hardball, reality, hit them where it hurts. Where does it hurt, if they cant fly around on their ego trip and stay in the fancy hotels no more the semi pro and professional NA member. Then maybe services wont be attractive we will get back to hitch hiking when we use to get things done for nothing, and when the addict was precious and the power was not the ultimate goal. Yeah sure, I bet you they go home and pray at night, I wonder what they pray to, I do not know, I do not know.

So anyway they suspended all these committee meetings, I got the reports right there. We are suspending the conference committee business as usual because we cannot afford to do that but we will be meeting in Albuquerque to discuss the principles of service and the guide to service, signed Tim Banner, Policy Chair. He was reading all this stuff that I sent out and he was going oh yeah all right, until he saw his name there and said oh gosh they are talking about me. But see what they have done for years is taken the champions the people who believed in something and who stood up on the floor at the conference and said hey look this is wrong and took moral stands. People use to say, No I don't want a position, no the conscience of my region says no this is wrong and I represent the conscience of my region. Now they tell you that you are a world servant and you do not represent the conscience of your region but that you really representing the best interest of NA as a whole. So what we have got is a lack of moral leadership in our fellowship, you know. They rub down the champions and say I know you had a motion to disband the JAC, but how about if elect you vice chair of policy Mitchell you know you can become the vice chair of policy, you just put that motion to disband the JAC in your back pocket and you can work from the inside. How about you Al Riser you know you came out here with a motion unanimous group conscience to return the Traditions to the fellowship. To return the Traditions to the fellowship, unanimous regional conscience. How would you like it if we let you have a position on the trustee traditions Ad Hoc Committee, would not you like that Al?

Well yeah, you can do so much good by representing your regions point of view from the inside, and zazoom, zazoom, zazoom our world history is littered with the wreckage. The reason we have regional policy in Philadelphia is because we had five RSRs in a row go out there and become world this and world that and we never saw them again. Conflict of interest. We do not have people in World Service working a program. Yeah they work service real good, they know how to survive. They know how to go out there year after year and end up going back on them plane trips. What are they doing? Are they leading us or are they selling us down the river? Do we need them, what do we need them for? To take $4000.00 dollars to travel in a year? That when they come back from the conference after being totally maligned and laughed at and ridiculed to save their position to tell us maybe we just need to work from within and let our voices be heard. Man we have been doing that since 1982. Mid Atlantic RSR, we will not buy the books unless you put the language that was deleted back in, what did they do for him. They made him policy chair and then trustee. Relax man relax, you work from within. All right I mean have we got problems, Is it evident. I mean these are recent, since '82 that is where Bo left off about '82 the approval of the text. Let me tell you.

I mean you have all heard me talk about today how the deletions and the additions and all this stuff. How many Basic Text we have had and all that and I just told you about the professional writers and the contracts that were done. The disunity and the controversy that it cost and you know and I have to pass the World Lit Chair here who has been there through it all, going (ummmhummm). If I run a foul of the truth please you know let me know.

Let us know if I am sitting up here blowing off bullshit. (Audience) (Dave, do us a favor, keep your personal opinion out of it, and just keep it to the facts.) Hey man, I am reading the facts right here. (You seem to be judgmental of some people here and I do not think that is right). Well you know sue me. You know I cannot be spiritual all the time. I am trying to be as spiritual as possible, because if I told you what I really wanted to do then you know, but never mind that.

The surprise of the fellowship to find out that the trustees had been allowed by the WSC to take over the writing of the traditions book, I mean that just appeared on the floor of the World Service Conference. I mean you know we have had a lot of problems in lit we had a World Literature Chairperson that took the literature files out of the WSO and blackmailed the WSO manager into giving her a paid position before she you know. I mean come on are we

going to stand up you know and tell the truth, so here we go. Then we had a World Literature Vice-chair that was caught by the office staff breaking in the files to get regional input out during "It Works, How and Why". He was taken on the floor of the Board of Trustees and reprimanded, did you ever hear about that stuff. Is this your fellowship, Narcotics Anonymous? Did you get a chance to talk about these things? Did anybody ever tell you the truth, or did they cover it up and make it look pretty. Isn't everything pretty and nice, Narcotics Anonymous, oh boy watch how it glitters and shines? Well there is nothing wrong with Narcotics Anonymous like I said yesterday and that is the 12 Steps and 12 Traditions, those are perfect, perfect. People are imperfect; our structure is imperfect, okay. So anyway, nobody asked for all this bullshit to go on man, excuse me.

The summary of events that cause concerns. Did anybody vote on having a $38.00 dollar Basic Text? Did you guys ask for one of them, having the WSO being able to adopt amend or repeal their by-laws, or to pay themselves anything that they want? Did you know that the WSO sells forty-five percent of all its literature to outside enterprises at a cheaper price then it will sell it to the fellowship? Did you know that five million dollars was the gross income of the World Service Office last year, and they stood up on the floor of the conference right before the conference they raised the shipping price and on the floor of the conference they said, well we are broke man we have to raise the price of literature. We cannot fund this stuff, if you want something to die, do not fund it. Good lesson being taught to us by the World Service Office. If you want something to die, do not fund it. If they ain't got money for plane tickets, they ain't going to fly. Do you know how much the volunteer service structure the world volunteer service structure gross income was, $280.000.00 dollars. Now we had an office that had a gross income of five million dollars that said well we are not part of you and we cannot give the money back to you legally. You cannot use it in your volunteer service structure. Then we have their travel budget was the same price as what our entire volunteer service structure had to do all their work with in the world. Something is wrong, take a snapshot and step back, wait a minute. I do not think Jimmy Kinnon had that in mind, or this guy had that in mind, you know. I think that some real sharpies like the former World Service Office Manager. He was a paid consultant. You know what a consultant is right; a consultant tells you how to get around the rules and to maximize your profits under the law. Bob Stone was a paid consultant for political candidates and also a consultant for non-profit corporations in California. He was brought in to help orchestrate the changeover from a zero money profit office into the multi million-dollar corporation with 48 employees that are over achievers that we have today.

The WSO has been subsidizing the formation of regional structures outside of the fellowship, paying lodging, paying travel, sending people over there. I mean I gave you a couple of examples. WSO has no financial guidelines what so ever. They have no accountability and have not given us a certified audit like they are suppose to under California Law. What we have had in our literature is like an attempt so that treatment centers will buy it, because that is where we are selling a major portion. Because a major portion of our income is going to be coming from the treatment community worldwide. When I first got clean thirty percent of the NA members that came around were, and I was on World PI back then in the early days so we had these figures available to us, but thirty percent of our members came through some kind of an institution that was just some kind of an institution. Approximately seventy percent of our members were walk ins, walk ins off the street. But that has turned around and those percentages are totally reversed today, so we need to look pretty for the outside enterprises. Our literature has to be slick, well written you know, and devoid of anything controversial, that may go against their treatment modality. At any rate, we spent a lot of money.

Now on the literature deal, there has been a lot of talk about how addicts cannot write and how the literature process has not worked. Well in 1984 in Santa Monica they put together, this little draft called "It Works, How and Why". Well they didn't have a title for it they called it the 12 and 12 and basically it was like because you know we had a Basic Text and now we need a 12 and 12. But back then, most of the people called the Basic Text the NA Big Book. Well interestingly enough the AA Big Book was called the basic text so it is a little schizophrenia (Laughter). You know my sponsor is giving me the 123 and 12 to work, so we needed a 12 and 12 and that was a legitimate thing so we got ourselves a 12 and 12 on input in California workshop, then it went to ( ) and here and there. I will there has not been a single piece of fellowship input in a book length project since that draft in 1984. Every piece of input that has been sent in by regions, areas, groups and members on "It Works, How and Why" has been put in who knows where file 13. We went out and worked in Chicago. We had 10 World Literature
Workshops, it was beautiful, we flew around, boy we had a dog and pony show and it was great. It was an attempt to

return to the old days because the fellowship had had it up to here. That project was deliberately sabotaged, that literature project. Our steps and Traditions books had cost us so far about $650.000.00 dollars total, if you throw in the $81.000.00 dollars that the World Literature Committee is going to get for a budget this year. What the hell are they going to do with it? I don't know what they are going to do with it because they got staff team writers that are going to be paid by the office to do all the work. What are they going to do, fly around? Or are they going to give us for those in treatment," "In Times of Illness" or In Times of Aids, or whatever you know more outside. You notice how we are catering to treatment centers now; it is like let us get it for those in treatment. Lets talk about behind the walls, well they missed a bet there they could have got really generic, how about for those who are unable to attend regular NA Meetings. Man they could have sold that everywhere. It is interesting how none of the steps and traditions work has any reference at all to the Basic Text. It is interesting how there is not a single line out of anything in the Basic Text (end of side one)

Make it a logical progression. I mean we see as a literature committee for years, and years and years the pain and the agony of trying to get our World Service to be responsible. I remember sitting in Charlotte as regional literature vice chair twenty regional literature chairs standing around two world pass world literature chairs that were not allowed to speak, in a world literature meeting. Well that was when I forced Jack Bernstein, me and a girl named Bonnie Harvey forced Jack Bernstein to tell us the truth after he had lied to us for a year and a half about the "It Works How and Why" project. You know we have not gotten any better; it is years and years and years. You know what we keep buying it, we keep going 'oh unity' and the world says. Then you hear someone in a home group say,"Well I called the world and the world said". Well the world what, the world who, where you know the world what, the World service Office. What is the WSO being involved in our conscience in the service related matters. That is directly against their personnel policies and it is on page 2 in the 5th paragraph right there. It says absolutely not, you are not supposed to have an opinion on service related matters. So you see they are operating in violation of the guidelines. Robin and I were having a lovely conversation over dinner about how this has been going on. You know we have people here that know the truth, that have been there. They can give us solutions, part of the solutions you know are being talked about here today. Here are some examples, Encourage by example, taken a group conscience inventory of our World Service structure and our own area, regional and group structures. Sponsor learning days; work with present groups in areas to improve practical application of the principle of group conscience. Form new groups in areas committed to the practical application of the principle of group conscience. Encourage letters, petitions and motions for action to support positions for change. I mean all of these things are kind of action oriented you know so we cannot change by everyone sitting on their ass warming a seat.

Build support for actions at the WSC '90. Well we went out there as a body, more organized and more unified than at any time in the history of the World Service Conference. We did everything that everyone asked us to, it was all turned around on us and if you look in the NA Way and you look in the fellowship reports, and you look at the lies being told about the people from the east coast. You know we are a bunch of wide-eyed radicals came there with no intention other than to destroy World Services. I mean that is what they are saying and it is just not true, just not true. You know we have a conscience in this part of the world because we wrote a Basic Text here. We have experience with anonymity and group conscience and direct responsibility. We wrote a book anonymously it came together. We understood that people with 20 years and twenty days had the same thing going for themselves. We have experience with that around here and that has woven its way into the fabric of what we do in our service structure. The rest of the fellowship does not have a clue folks. So maybe we need to form an east coast conference to protect and preserve these principles that we hold so near and dear and send our RSRs as usual to the World Service Conference but take care of our own business at home. I mean quit beating our heads against the brick wall of people who have not arrived yet, to understand the perfection and the purpose of the Traditions. We have experience with them. There are members here who wrote on Basic Text. There are members here that participated in the literature conferences. There are members here that were part of World Services when it was totally open. You can learn from us, or we can become part of the blob, we can just go, shit our service structure does not mean nothing, after all how did we get 20,000 meetings a week. Oh, we got it from some fundamentally unsound spiritual principles. That is what we are being asked to believe by this new guide to services and new service structure and principles and all this other kind of hogwash. It is like you know you guys got here and it was all wrong, how you did it that is what they are telling us.

Okay maybe we should all NA literature should be written by the processes that have been talked about today. Now we can do that, it is very easy. You pick up a pen and you start writing, and you know what you do, you get on the telephone and you say you know I just wrote something, how would like to see it. You got a fax machine, you got a computer modem (zipppppp, vrroomm, it is gone). We have computer programs and bright sharp people and fax machines and everything else, which needs a World Literature Committee. They have not written anything in six years anyway. You can write I can write, I wrote a hundred page step book. They took one look at it and said, well this came from you we are not going to use this. A big guy from Florida had just left you know he gave his regional input twice to Bob Stone. Bob Stone lost it, well gee you know we lost it. My region, the Philadelphia region went to the conference and the New Jersey region went to St. Louis looking for our input in World Lit in the master files you know(poof) disappeared was not even there. Hey, folks it is time to do something different.
We can eliminate committee and trustee votes at the WSC, that is no guarantee that it will solve the solution because there are regions that do not have a conscience, they do not know what it is. They got forty meetings in it and the state is 6,000 square miles

In addition, the meetings area hundred miles apart from one another and they are still going to AA, they have not even gotten a first step yet in those regions. So we are bucking up against something. We have to exhibit the leadership, we have to exhibit the leadership or be led. We can, you know we made motions, I mean here are 157 motions that were written, that were taken in to world committees to be discussed. They were not even discussed; they were laughed at and tossed over people's heads. They Did not discuss anything on the merits of anything. The WSC is not a place to discuss things. It is a place to run on self wills, it is a place to beat each other up. We could have eliminated the Board of Directors and directly elected the members during the conference. But when Bob Stone stood up on the floor of the conference and said you cannot do that it is illegal. Therefore, I went right to my little brief case and got the laws of the State of California and I said, oh, you are in for a fun conference Bob, here are the laws and I gave them to two lawyers. The two lawyers who were RSRs and a trustee, stood up on the floor of the conference, and said well there is nothing in the laws that say we cannot elect the directors right directly from the floor. (But maybe we want to think about that)

We got to rain in our WSO. We have to let the conference and the volunteer service structure administer the copyrights and the money. We do not want to give them to the BOT (Board of Trustees) because the BOT are now in a power hungry move to take over the control of the fellowship. The single board concept, the merger between the WSO Board of Directors and the WSO Board of Trustees is a sure lock on the road to the guide to service. So maybe we need to create an independent fiduciary relationship and responsibility ( ) conference. Maybe we need to sue for the return of our copyrights to their rightful owners which is you. (Dadada)

The most important thing is that we have never had a service structure. We have had a lot of descriptions and some nice ideas, we had an NA Tree, we had a blue manual and a green manual but we have never had a draft of a service structure. How do you use group conscience…Wow what does that mean. Well we inequitably apply that principle on the east coast pretty much. It is not the same in every region because nobody has ever put a draft together a service structure that even attempted to describe what group conscience is. Group conscience- group tally is a service structure that has yet to be written. All that means is that the decision of the group is a loving God and it should be passed through the service structure without interference to the WSC to implement the decisions of the group. It is a structure based on group tally, one group one vote, abstentions do not count. It takes six tenths of all registered groups to pass or fail anything. So if ten thousand groups vote, if six thousand groups vote yes, it is yes. Abstentions do not count; obviously, they do not have a conscience so they should not be voting.

Abstentions have never meant anything in terms of vote. If you look in Roberts Rules of Order, but we have four ways of voting on the WSC floor, abstentions have this. Abstentions folks mean absent you are absent. The only legitimate vote is the number of voting people voting, period end of story. In other words two-thirds of the yays or nays, abstentions are absent; they just are not there unless you have a roll call situation and blah blah blah blah blah. So we got, there is a lot of thins we can do, disband the Ad Hoc Committee on NA Service, we tried that you know. To have the fellowship team approach for our literature, to allow our fellowship literature committee where our areas and regions, groups and members can get together and write literature. To preserve literature written by the addict for

the addict, to hopefully retain the message and the inspiration and the spirit that was generated by that special process that occurred in the development of NA literature. To print and distribute literature for free allowing our 7th Tradition to support these activities. I mean you know you see this little free Basic Text lying running around, they are free in home group's man. They are on the table right out of the baskets. I mean you can do something, if we get enough people who want to do this as Home Groups who the hell they going to take to court, who they going to sue. They going to sue you, Narcotics Anonymous, they going to sue your home group, stand for something. You know the whole international issue, everybody is sawing and crying about the international issues and this and that. You know what the international issue is. That we have failed to put our money where our mouth is as a fellowship, that is what the international issue is. Four years ago, I proposed a translation plan for literature. That was thrown in the garbage, I re-proposed and it was thrown in the garbage again, it was thrown in the garbage again. I will tell you, if you try to control God in your own personal recovery, you know what the results are they are disastrous. So if you try to control God in the process of growth and development in our service structure then the results are disastrous. So here is a way to ease all the control out, it is like okay gee obviously we as a service body have been inept, at doing and translating your literature like it should have been done. Here take a book, take a pamphlet translate it, print it, end of the international issue. The other issue is international service. Now who the hell are we to be meddling in international service affairs? Let people according to the laws and needs of their own fellowship do their own service. I mean who the hell are we to dictate the American fellowship, boy are we the big wigs you know. But we are so busy getting new budgets and talking about new ways to avoid guidelines that we have ignored our primary purpose. There was not a word that I hear the entire week at the WSC did I not I not hear our primary purpose mentioned. Why are we doing this? There was never a moment of reflection there was never a moment of sober insight and thought about what is the reason that we are doing this. Yep there is a proper application of that word you know. It is all about budgets, it was all about power, it was all about control, and it was all about trustee and ad-men votes. We would not have gone in the directions we had gone if the regions had voted. Yes in some cases we would have but if, the regions had voted we would not have had the necessary two-thirds to pass a lot of the bullshit that passed. We have to fix it and if it is broke fix it.

If you cannot fix it then get rid of it and create something, you know gosh, there is a loving God that will lead us, guide us in our creative efforts as long as we do not throw blame, point fingers, manipulate, and control each other. If we just allow a loving, God to be there when we do something everything is going to work out all right. What happens is God goes out of the picture when we start pointing fingers and throwing blame and I seem to be pointing fingers and throwing blame up here. You know and yeah my personality enters into it, but I tell you what. What I am saying to you and what I am talking about here is all documented; it is all available for anybody. If you doubt me, come to my house. You got a question about anything that I have said take a note, write it down come and visit me, take my phone number call me. You will need to do that for the books anyway.

Therefore, we can provide all WSC minutes, BOT committees' office board minutes. I mean there was a motion passed in '84 to do that and the WSO has never done that. If you call the WSO you ask for the minutes of the trustee meeting and blah blah blah blah blah, or minutes of the WSC in '82 they tell you, well we do not have that stuff. Well you know their guidelines tell say that they are supposed to have that stuff there available to us. We are talking about, there is no real simple way, and there are so many problems and so many potential solutions. You know the solutions and the creativity that it will take to move us out of the abyss of where we are at the moment is going to come from you. It is going to come from your Home Group it is going to come from sitting in meetings like this and going, well you know that Dave is full of shit and I really would not want him running anything. If you don't want me running anything then you better get up and start running it yourself, and if you don't want them running things then you better get up and start running things yourself. I mean you are the hope, you are the future, every addict sitting here in this room and all the people that you sponsor, and your sponsors who have better things to do you know now that they got theirs. Who want to go out and do whatever they do, you know it is time man, carry the message. You know it is Carry, its work, Carry the message its work. Something worth having is worth working for. I do not know where the energy comes from, because if it was coming from me I would not be able to sustain the level of commitment. I would not be able to stand in front of people year after year after year and challenge them. The energy that you see is coming from personal recovery and the understanding in my relationship with a loving God. I am not out to people please, I am not out for you to love me, I am out to love myself and have a loving God think kindly of me when I die

and that may not be to far off. Only God knows that, because I got that Aids virus you know and almost died in October, but I know he is keeping me alive so I can come up here and talk to you all. He ain't keeping me alive for my stupid reasons, see what I mean. So you know why do I do this. Why in the world would I stand up here, make these fabulous kinds of claims and charges, and do this year after year after year after year.

I do not care if there is a trustee in the room, I do not care if Jesus Christ himself is in the room because I am telling the truth. Ahh the truth sets you free, first it will piss you off and if it does not piss, you off then you are probably comatose. Get yourself a copy of your inventory input documents.

You know what, if you did not see this in your home group then somebody along the line in your service structure is a "Censor". Censored your right to know, and you know we have such emotional connotations attached to that word. You know what I mean "Censored" but a censor is for me to determine that because this has WSC approved on it and this has from the inventory input committee. How do I know which one is bullshit or not? Huh, how do I know, if you do not get a chance to judge these things equally, you know all it is, is information does not make it right, does not make it wrong. You know I have resigned service positions because people wanted me to determine what was best for them to see and they hated to see me coming to area service, because I always had a stack of shit. You know I got this in the mail and I seen this and I pulled this out of the minutes and here is from the fellowship minutes in '84, because it pertains to this service thing we are doing today. And people are like get the fuck out of here (Laughter) and you know what they asked me to be a censor. I do not have any moral right to determine what it is as a servant that you should see or not see. I cannot make that moral determination so I resigned my service position and I brought the stuff anyway. You know what after the WSC they were having a meeting in my old area at the area service and you know what they were all upset because all the stuff that was passed at the WSC. They were" This sucks, how did they do this" Somebody said you know what Grateful Dave was telling us about this stuff two or three years ago and nobody wanted to listen to him then. So there was dead silence in the room for two minutes, you could hear a pin drop. I do not say that to pat myself on the back. I say that, that is your job as well as a member of Narcotics Anonymous to know where you are in reality. However, addicts like to duck reality, hey, man reality is reality. We got real problems and there are real solutions. So somebody says is it feasible that we can print our own literature? Yeah it is feasible, here it is. Yes we can do that, yeah we can, see. Is it feasible, obviously, it is. If you have a problem with that, that is all right because if you need more information rather than getting these scary letters from the BOT. The big chin goons they tell, Ahh they read it all, it is all lies, everything that is in there. I asked him to answer that question; there is not a grain of truth in them letters about what they are telling you about that Basic Text, not a single grain of truth in it. If you want more information, more information is available to you. If you need to be at the quarterly workshop tomorrow when we take a big tape of the WSO board of director chair saying," well you know you guys can print anything you want to in your home group". Won't that be nice we will play that in front of everybody that is permission to print? The Board of Director chair gave the groups permission to print. Now he may deny that in public but won't he be embarrassed when we crank that up full volume.

Won't that be an interesting thing, when one of the trustees says, I do not believe in you selling the book, I mean it is terrible you are using the book as a political football. When 500 books were sold out of his house in Georgia, hmmm. Stand for something or fall for anything, see what I mean. You cannot be a flip-flop, because nobody including yourself will ultimately respect you for being a flip-flop. Either you are an us, or you are a them, you either are part of the solution or you are the problem that is the bottom line man. I do not care how you slice it the only gray area in spiritual principles exists between your right ear and your left ear. (Laughter, Clapping)

You have your hand up. I am an addict, and what I want to know I mean and I know there is no simple solution to this because it is like the nature of addiction, not like a quick fix or easy solution. It is just ( ). You know because I have been bringing back a lot of materials and bringing stuff to my home group and show them. And those who read it you know like my home group is like wavering but they are like half way to approving the Basic Text over there. Yeah approving the Basic Text right (Laughter). I am catching flack and shit in other meetings because I am the only one with one of these and I am going to start giving them out. But the people are like jumping on me for bringing them into a meeting but they all want one and shit and they probably not going to want to pay for them but I will bring them back and give them one anyway. You know I just I am looking for some ground to stand on that is a little

bit simpler to explain because you just cant fucking understand all this stuff in one day. I cannot say anything in five minutes that is going to convince anybody and you know as if nobody wanted to come out. They all told me to come out and get information and bring it back to them you know, we talk about getting involved they will tell you about having a home group and a group conscience and all that . It is like on this one I am standing, I am not alone I got a couple of friends with me. I am not alone even in my area, but I am in the real significant minority so if got anything for me to go back with I would appreciate it.

Grateful Dave: I got one thing to say that you can go back with. God loves a servant you know. Just serve brother serve you know that is it. They cut off John the Baptist head you know but God loves a servant just keep on serving.

I am an addict named Bob, Hi Bob. This is a drop in the bucket sounds like with the things in question a lot of it is about besides the classical signs of an addict. The egotistical the power seeking, the conniving, the easiest way out, the quick fix. What I have heard mostly is the violations of the Traditions. What is truly being followed and if it is the Traditions and the spiritual principles I do not know if we can keep ourselves in check, somebody is running wild. I can also place blame on myself as an individual member.

I just came back from an area. Yes, you have a certain amount of people attending home group and a percentage of them attending group conscience, and a percentage of them holding positions and a percentage of that actually being gung ho toward the continuance of this fellowship. I am to blame; I take the blame for that because I am guilty of that too. I just came back from an area from which people are mislead and not informed. Where as for the last two months, I am not sure about the third, but for the last two months in area service committee meetings, we did not have enough GSRs to meet quorum for group motions. All we could do was for the meeting reports, secondary reports and go home after group hug. What is missing with this picture? People are not getting the right facts people are not getting the right idea about the fellowship and I am part of the blame because I am trying to be a responsible member of Narcotics Anonymous. Sure, it may sound like there are a lot of problems up at world level but begins down at the home group. Thanks for letting me share.

Thank you Bob. **I am an addict my name is Bill.** Hi Bill. You know solutions, I think that are more of a euphemism; I think that the need for solutions is the most important thing that an addict can seek. You know I came to Narcotics Anonymous in 1979 for a solution you know and that solution that I was given was a path of recovery to follow. I listened this weekend and what I heard was a lot of information that I have already had and a lot of information that I have not had. I am part of the history; everyone that is in this room is part of the history. History is a continuous thing; it grows daily. History is something that I study in college, do very well, and get A's in. Because history excites me and history itself is something that I look at in two different ways. You have to look at the whole picture you know it is like, I studied the French Revolution in this last semester, which led into Modern European History, and to remove Napoleon from the whole picture would have changed the whole history of the world, as we know it today. To try to remove a piece of our history and say it did not exist would be part of the problem and the solution is to get our history down. I think that is one of the main solutions I am looking at and what I am enthusiastic about is I am enthusiastic about going to Alabama, which I am going to. I am enthused about communication with some of the people I have met here this weekend, not met but some of the relationships that I have had with people that I have got to meet again. Some of the communications that I have had from participating and putting on this history workshop with Jimmy's wife. You know a three and a half hour conversation on the telephone. It took me back to the days when Jimmy was my link to Narcotics Anonymous. Jimmy was my link when I couldn't find no one else at three o'clock in the morning and I couldn't go to sleep because I was going through a two year withdrawal from meth and he was my conversation piece to get me through until I went to work. It took me back to that, talking to Betty. It took me back to that and the solution is living a principle first of all in ones own personal life, and becoming at peace with ones self-inside.

The solution is not in me trying to come to a point of, what's that word a comformitory. To conform to everything that you say this is what we do and you are out of unity if you don't fall in, it aint uniformity. That is not the solution; the solution is becoming an individual being able to make decisions. Being able to collect information before decisions are made on what we have to do. The solution is seeking all that information, seeking everything that comes

for us to make a decision upon and looking for all sides of an issue.

The literature is the main issue we have been bringing out here this week in the history and literature process. The reason the literature process is brought out is that a main stay of our history is around literature. The literature of what I was introduced to, the literature of the writing of the Basic Text. The little White Book that they called hip pocket of recovery when I first came in that was handed to me and it fit squarely in my back pocket. You know and I come to understand what the little white book is, what it was, was my Basic Text. Today it is, we give it usually to newcomers, and it is a little Basic Text. Because the Basic Text was built from that white book, as a model as a springboard and that is what I have to look at, when I am looking for solutions, what worked, what worked in the past is what I have to seek and what worked was an open communication. So that is something that we have to start establishing again, open communication across the board. What worked was telling people that they can seek there goals and rise above and accomplish things. I mean if you would have told me that we could not do this then I would probably not be here today. What I was introduced to was that I ran into a bunch of people that were writing a book. They gave me a Grey Book and they gave me a 4th Step inventory guide and someone said, "Work the steps or die motherfucker", factual words. I am not going to tell you hew said it any other way cause that is what the man told me. I took this Grey Book home, that Grey Book I did not look at the cover as review and input. I looked at that as Narcotics Anonymous and I went home. The history in this area is and I do not care what people have to say. What happened was I came to the home group this home group I walked in and I picked all the AA literature up and all the DNA literature and I dumped it in the garbage can and I slapped this book down on the table and I told them, here is our book. It didn't matter that it wasn't approved , it didn't matter, it was a piece of literature that spoke to addicts and that is because some people took what needed to be done and went with it and went around the country. They did not write it for us, but they encouraged us to get involved in the writing of it and it was open committee and that was something that worked. The problems to be what we call an international fellowship somehow confuse me because if you are over in France right now and I am in America I international to you. So I get confused to this separation. It is a worldwide fellowship and the way is teach them how to do it themselves not do it for them. What we have turned our World Services into, and I say what we turned our World Service into is a place to get it all done at. Some

[Is there a break in the tape or transcription here? - Ed]

How we need to come to a point where we can learn to reverse that process and go back to getting the addicts to do the work for there selves. It accomplishes the goals and teaching them instead of doing those things. How was it done before? What it does is create creativity. That is the basic thing. There are two different types of philosophy we are dealing with, one is business one is creativity. One is personal growth, one is profit, product. The fellowship makes a choice, it is a choice that is made, and I had to learn that as being an RSR for four years and being a World PI Vice-chair. The choice that was made is that there are regions that do not seek accountability of RSRs and do tell them that they can vote any way they want. Then there are RSRs that go there with specific, so what happens is you're going to follow your direction and you do a well job at it and then you are in a political system that I feel doesn't work. Buy why, what is the solution to getting it to work. One thing is I believe is electing trusted servants the minute the conference opens. If you elect them from the start you do not have to worry about when they get to the mic or not. Another thing I believe is in this is seeking a way to seek what the regions want. What do you actually want in the fellowship, that is what they ask when we are writing the book. Every home group got a Grey Book, every home group that was listed. Even dead people got them that were listed (Laughter). Let us get for real the seeker and tried to find whoever was out there to get them a book and get them involved. That is a solution; I am taking to my home group to get these tapes transcribed and that copy sent out to where ever we can get them sent out of what happened. Above board, above board communication and we start that at the home group level though. By protecting ourselves from ourselves, is a major thing we need to seek, I mean I can leave here go with going back to a home group, which this is my home group that is putting this function on. But I can go back to the home group that I belong to with information. What can we do, what can I do as a personal member of Narcotics Anonymous? I do not want a new fellowship; I want a fellowship that is above board open communication. I had a talk with the Board of Director chairperson and he asked me what do you guys want. I said a full accountability, full disclosure of the World Service Office, and we can ask for that. It is our choice to ask for that or not. It is our choice to say that is what we want. We only allow something to run amuck, or we allow to not run amuck. What I have come to believe is the more

open communication, the more workshops. Go to your, where ever you are from if you are not from here. Go to where ever you are from and ask your group to schedule a history workshop. You do not need your area to do it, a group can do it a group has that right to be autonomous and that is what a lot of us seem to forget. What can a group do? Narcotics Anonymous was not set up to be centralized.

I cannot blame the newcomer. Whom I can blame is myself, our other older members. I mean I can tell you I have got to the point where I have said I want to leave here; I do not want to come here. What good does that do if I share this in a meeting except dissention? That belongs with my sponsor, not using open Narcotics Anonymous meetings as open forums, but talking to my sponsor about those personal feelings in that area instead. Not making regular meetings battlegrounds, but making them recovery meetings. Talking about other issues like this in forums like this where they are meant to be. Talking about issues in-group conscience where they are meant to be. Making that there attractive for the newcomer to walk through the door instead, and make service attractive. Do not do service with a sad sack on your face. Do not do it like you are doing time, we are not in prison. Learn about the steps first, there was some talk about where we changed the 12th Step, understand that from "those" to 'these", understand that real well. I did not understand that when it happened because I thought words to until I got a dictionary. Those are past and these are present, those are the previous eleven and a half steps. These are the 12 Traditions that bind us, that hold us together. I did not understand that, because I was a person that had to get a dictionary because I was a person that did not understand the English language. I had to admit to that that was a character defect of mine that did not want to admit that I did not have knowledge. See if I did not have knowledge I thought I was stupid, so I had to do an inventory and realize I am not stupid, I need knowledge and I got a dictionary and started studying the English language. So what is the solution? If there is a problem, I am part of the problem. If there is a solution, I need to be part of the solution. What do I emphasize thought, am I going to make it look like doomsday, and all panic and go out and hang ourselves up, or can I say yes this exists over here just like we do in inventory, and that is what we do in inventories of groups. We have not learned how to do inventories in groups yet that I know of. We are just starting to write an inventory up in our area. We had no real inventory. We had some pieces of tradition inventory that we passed around, I think you remember that Bo. Whatever how many questions on the steps and how many questions on the traditions, you know but there is a basic form of an inventory that we utilize, but an actual form of what do we do, how do we take an inventory of a group. We got an inventory guide, how to take one for ourselves but what about a group, that is where it starts. Inventories that have been taken on a group level, how do we intermix together? That is where it starts. Am I willing to do the writing if I want it? Am I willing to do the participation, am I willing to do what it takes. See there are two different types of service, one is a participant service (you heard the word, one is getting involved) or one is let them do it for you and bitch. (Laughter) I mean that is the choice we have to make. Go to the home group and if they want you, if that is what they want. If you are sent here to get information, there is some information to take back.

I can tell you I had a conversation with Stu Tordman, our BOD chair and he said it was all right for our home group to print literature in our group, as long as we are not going in competition with this WSO corporate. I just had that conversation and he said that it was all right as long as you were not going to go and have it printed up for a cent and sell it for three cents when we are selling it for thirteen, to undercut us. He said if you are doing it for your home group, you have that right, autonomously for your home group. We do not have all that information. You have to make decisions sometimes like you are being shown this book. You need all the information if you are going to make that decision. I am not going to tell to make that in a home group decision until they collect all that information and they can make that decision within here first. I am in a home group that made that decision, it was a decision on collected information, it was a unanimous vote, and I will back the home group on whatever we do. As long as we are collecting information and following and seeking information, I mean that is what I do, that is what I have been taught. If you do not want skeletons in the closet then do not put them there, be above board and open. I mean the major problem it seems that we have in our history and our literature is we have skeletons all have the place and nobody wants to get them out. So what are we to get those skeletons out? One thing is try to get changes in where we don't have a structure that has service that has service where people are stuck there for ten or fifteen years. Get a revolving door, get and work towards a service center, not a service office. Service center implies something totally different from office. We do not realize that the tradition talks about a service center. A place to provide service from for us, stuff that we cannot do alone but combined we can do together. That is what a service center is and that is

what we need is a service center for that purpose. Do we need, and I am looking at it real questionable. Do we need a bunch of warehouses or do we need somebody negotiating with printing companies for us and getting us the price and letting the regions and areas purchase directly from those printing companies that are listed for the price instead. That would sure cut down on having to have five or six buildings in Van Nuys or having to look to purchase property. It could decentralize and bring it back down as close to the groups as the Tree was wrote for. Bring it back to the groups as close as possible. That is what I was brought into, that is a solution to seek those goals. That stuff you can carry back, ideas and concepts, I can tell you that the concepts or the principles, what eve they are calling it is what helped bring about this little book right now. The concept of if you do not like what we are doing stop the money. Oh well I am sorry, the only way you can stop the money is to stop buying literature. If you do not buy literature then we do not have literature, so what are you going to do, we have to print. You can stop all the money from going fund flow, the conference is already telling you they are complaining about not getting enough from that. However, the major money the basket money is not going through the fund flow system but is going directly from the group to the WSO in money for literature.

Look at you budgets; my home group just purchased $108.00 dollars worth of literature and gave the area $108.00 dollars this month. Another group though bought a hundred and some worth of literature and gave the area five something. If you look at the budget for our area this month you would see that we bought 60% literature and 40% of our money went into the service structure to provide our services here.

That tells me we have a problem, the problem is that and I am going to talk personally about another fellowship. Alcoholics Anonymous sells a Big Book to OA and OA buys it for $3.50. What is the difference, why do we have to pay $8.00 for a book? These questions need to be asked. I am tired of those things like that. I think that a lower cost book and putting more money into the fund flow and I think it would bring in line because then they would reverse the money going directly through literature to the WSO that profit wise the money would flow through the service structure. Where then the service center would have to become dependent on the conference to have to subsidize it instead. They would reverse that there, the process. It is called to reverse of process, but we need to seek a lower cost piece of literature. We need to seek getting the world fellowship where they have different languages to take them and tell them, take this literature and put it into your languages, you know best. There is, I mean English is basically a well-known language around the world. Many of your countries have to learn English. So there are some people in those countries that speak their own language plus English that could sit down and translate that book, without having to pay that big cost. I am not worried about dialect we have dialect in English. I mean I cannot understand some people from Mississippi, I cannot understand some people from England or Ireland. I will listen to them and they cannot understand me, so the dialect I do not think is that much of a problem. Let them put it in their language and get those good feelings that are a solution to me. Let them get those feelings of involvements instead. Not seeking for the Grand Gumba to say, hey, we will take care of you, do what we want, that is gangster style, just behave buddy, you know what I mean I will bust your kneecaps. I mean let us get for real.

Reverse our decision making process of our conventions. Our conventions are they are profiteering off Narcotics Anonymous. How much are your conventions making in your regions that some of you have come from. I mean I look at it; we will stamp NA on anything. I mean the most disgusting thing I saw one time was coming out of a city one time with NA nuts and bolts on girls under wears. Little skimpy ones, stamping NA on them, are profiteering. We spend how much energy in making money in them other ways? How much money is being ciphered off in those other ways? I mean you hear the rumors, you know the facts. I can tell you at the seventh east coast I know there was ten thousand dollars walked off with never accounted for. I can tell you that last years east coast walked off with some where around like twenty-five thousand, thirty or thirty-five thousand. I can tell you right now that the east coast this year has not paid some of their bills. I know one person that they fourteen grand to and did not pay them and the people are just walking around lobbying their heads acting like they don’t know what is going on. Money, property and prestige divert us from our primary purpose. What is our primary purpose that is a grass root effort we need to carry back? Grass root, that is our history what has built us to the point, was grass root effort, primary purpose and carrying the message.

Doing service not because I want to be somebody but because I wanted the next person that did not have it to have what I was given freely. When I walked in to the second east coast convention of Narcotics Anonymous, strapped down still in leather, hair down to my waist, by then I was 129 pounds at a year and a half clean. I had gained about 10 pounds but what happened there was a miracle I was introduced to what I call Narcotics Anonymous. That is when the man gave me the Grey Book and the fourth step inventory guide and that is when he gave me a spiritual connection and a communication network. Everything is missing today, that is the NA I know and the NA I want. That is the NA you hear being talked in history that is the NA you hear about Jimmy Kinnons phone ringing off the hook. That is the NA History you hear as Bo shared when he ran around the country from literature conference to literature conference when he talks about the history of the Basic Text of going to World convention wanting to know. That NA enthusiasm took those people from Georgia, which were barefoot, and everything at the World Service Conference to make a difference. There are solutions, there are solutions to setting up, you can create, dissolve and recreate and those are things we have to look at. What is going to work best for us? If it is setting up a service structure that is going to work for us then we need to start doing it. I have suggestions and have been going back to the NA Tree and looking at what worked there and start working from there, not this guide to service. I mean I just do not want to go through it, but something that was simple was the NA Tree. Start looking at what did work and look what needs to be expanded for worldwide fellowship today from that and keep it simple. That stuff we can start working on. We can take it to our home group and we can start getting copies of the old Tree somewhere. If anybody got it, get it copy it give it to them and start looking it over, inventorying it and getting a communication network finding groups that are willing to go through it together and supporting each other as a network. If your friend calls you up and says and why we had Anonymi at one time, a worldwide home group for those that was isolated because of their service. I carry a card today yet, I feel that way at times. Because you have a belief, follow the belief. Do not stop before the miracle happens, but follow it, that is a solution. Find the people, I do not believe in the old saying that if someone tells you that you are a horse, that you are a horse. I argue, you do not have to think about it and go to the second person and they say you are a horse you had better start believing and the third person. I do not believe in it, I can find three stupid fools to tell me I am a horse. (Laughter). I tell you I can find enough negative people to tell me it do not work this way, we went through that too many years. What was Narcotics Anonymous founded on? It was founded and went against the grain, and was told that it would not work and I can tell you those eleven years ago when we formed here and left Alcoholics Anonymous where I came from they said it would not work this way either. I was told the same thing that they were told in 1953, or any other time they started anywhere else. I was told make a commitment and I found those people that became my network. People like Bo; people like Greg people like Jimmy became my network, Joe Procter from Tennessee. They became my network of people to call on a regular basis and get support from, to know that NA worked.

They are the people who me I could write. Joe told me so many times, you could write Bill, you can write. I use to look at him and tell him you are nuts, you are crazy I never even got through the ninth grade. I failed spelling, I got straight A's in English from Kindergarten on, and they just pushed me through. I got a B+ in college English today. I went from 9th grade drop out to freshman in college in the last year, only because you told me it would work. You got me to believe in myself and that is what we need to do is help each other to believe in ourselves and when someone is beating on one of our brothers and telling him it doesn't work we need to support that brother or sister and help carry that message to them. That has to happen in a worldwide network. You can find too many people who tell us we cannot write literature anymore. They are going to tell us it is going to work best in a service center, or an office, or whatever, the fewer it works. I can tell you that I went on the World PI Committee when e was pen and I can tell you that the World PI Committee produces nothing today, it is in the service office, and World PI does nothing itself. I can tell you I wrote the guidelines for World PI, the PI Committee accepted them and then the chairperson turned around and had someone make a motion not to send them to the fellowship. Then the committee wrote it not to send them out and why, because they could amend them as they went along. They took real strict guidelines and made them into real wax guidelines to do whatever they want when they want. They will tell you that, just let me do what I know how to do best, I am a PI man, you don't know what it takes to do PI, but I do I am a specialist, just let me go but didn't you teach me not to listen to my own mind. Didn't you teach me to call up my sponsor before I think and get caught up in my own thoughts? I mean because my thoughts brought me here. Didn't

you teach me to protect myself from myself and not allow my ego to get out of line? It is not about not trusting me; it is about not trusting my disease and putting some blockades up for my disease. Therefore, my disease does not take off where I cannot see where the shutters are up. That is what it is about and that is why I need protection from myself. The greatest thing the Mid-Atlantic Region did for me was not allow me to have a vote of confidence on the WSC floor. The greatest thing that we can do is say hey we do not want anything amended, where are we going. Are we trying to get something done in our lifetime? Is anything going to come up that drastic really, or is it that I need my name attached to it. Do I need to boost my name, be some honcho? Take , put the roadblocks up so that the disease does not destroy our trusted servants. When you vote in the GSR, make sure it is the GSR for the job. Make sure it is the person that can do the job for you, not because they are your friend or because they look good or because you want to go to bed with her. You know I saw plenty of trusted servants come onto PI because somebody wanted to go to bed with them, pretty girls. So we need to learn to treat each other with respect, dignity compassion, carina what it meant "care". We need to learn to do that and how we do that is live the principles. How we do that is to take the message back and ask your groups to do these types of workshops and invite the people in to bring the information in. Start writing, communicating and working and if it is not working in the service structure we created and we cannot change the arena, dissolve it and recreate.

That is the message I have, that is the only that I have today. I am not going back to WSC. People did not understand that when I said when the fellowship does not want me they will send me home and I go home to the home group where I belong. I have a home group. It is not about being a world-trusted servant. It is about being a member. It is about participating and carrying the message, sponsoring people. They cant take the home group from me, but we can do a lot from there. That is the foundation of everything, that is a solution for me. I am willing to help and set up networks. I know that Bo knows how to do it, and it is time we start talking, getting addresses , phone numbers, communicating and finding out what each other is doing. I don't know if we have gone that far where it is more important to go out to a dance, or more important to hang out in discos or in the pool hall, or if you have had that spiritual awakening where you understand what we are here for. It has to be the living spirit, that is to become the spirit of NA. That is the solution, be that living spirit, do not falter because someone offers you something. If the gut is telling you it is wrong follow the gut. I do not care how many people are patting you on the back, follow the stomach, because that is usually our best barometer. I know it is mine, I know when I make a bad decision, I cant look at myself in the mirror, and I get this acid build up in my stomach. I mean I almost devoured my stomach when I was two years clean, but it happens when I am doing what I am not suppose to be doing. That is what I have. That is the solutions for me, so thank you for allowing me to come up and share. (Applause)

Tape 7
Allentown History Addathon 1990
Problems / Solutions
Speaker: Robin, Bill, Bo

I am an addict, my name is Robin. Hi Robin. I do not know the only thing that I keep thinking of that keeps coming to mind and Billy said it, is money, property and prestige. You know when I got involved in World Service I can remember getting a postcard from somebody that said I tried to call you and the line was temporarily disconnected, welcome to World Services. That is really what it was about you know World Service when I got involved was hard work and a lot of money out of pocket but the rewards were great. Today it is almost like join World Services see the world. (Laughter).

I really have a problem with that when we take good hard look at what we are doing. I can remember when I got involved it was with ***the NA Way***, you know and a lot of people were jumping out and saying talk about the history of the Way. What we were doing and what we were about at that time was providing some more stuff to read. It was taking more input from the fellowship and letting addicts read what recovery was about in other addict's lives. That what the magazine and the purpose of the magazine was and I got involved with it in the first year of its run and became of it in the second year, well I became co-chair.

All that bullshit was so much bullshit and was so tiring but anyway it was a lot of work. It was a fellowship voluntary production. I remember going to the conference after it was all over, after the year that I served was over. I remember being accused of wrongly spending money and it was bizarre. I do not remember how much over budget, I think there was like $1035.00 that we spent of the fellowships money and I was accused. I felt like I was being attacked verbally and we got twelve issues of the magazine out in a reasonable amount of time and that year at the conference the magazine was taken out of the fellowships hands and put into the WSO hands. An editor was hired for about $28,000.00 dollars.

I could not see the logic in that and I still fail to see the logic in that, in that whole process. That is why money, property and prestige, that is why I say that appears to be the root. That appears to be where we seem to falter. Going back to when Billy was talking about reverse the process, let the WSO be dependent on the fellowship for it's' survival instead of the opposite way around. The WSO was not meant to be and I do not believe it was ever meant to be the governing quote arm of the fellowship. I do not believe that was it's purpose.

I took myself out of World Services and went back to the level that would not give me stress and would not give me that type of pain, I guess. I started to get re-involved in my home group and re-involved in staying clean and the addicts who still suffer. Like a few other people had said I think that when we get, when money, property and prestige blinds us we forget about our primary purpose. You know I was sitting there and I ask Bo how much money was spent on the writing of the Basic Text. He said somewhere around $50.000.00 he thinks and it took a process of about five years. Okay, so for three years it took a total of around fifty-thousand close to it, and we had something in hand. I have been watching the service structure for the last seven years spending millions of dollars with nothing in hand with nothing in hand, and I wonder where we are going. I wonder what we have come to, and like everybody else, I believe that we need to go back to a grass root.

When I took a position on world level with a lot of other people in this room, the position was not one of glorification. I, like most people, spent hours and hours and hours alone working. My free time was not free time. My free time was given to the fellowship Narcotics Anonymous. Today I do not believe that taking a WSC - or any other world-level position - is that type of a position. I think mostly it is a glorification and very little of either. It is sad. I watch it and I don't know, I guess I backed out because I didn't know what to do and I felt that there was nothing more that I could do. I do not believe in the process as it stands today and I have not believed in it since I have seen it going in this direction for the last six years you know when I got out. That is all I have. (Applause) Thank you.

I am an addict and I am Bill. First of all, I need to make amends to you all and Dave because I shouted out something from the floor when he had it standing up here and for me that is inappropriate. What I have heard tonight isn't anything to different than I have heard before and have seen for the amount of time I have been around here, and that isn't really long. I have learned a lot through last night and today. Some additional information that gives me some tools that helps me sees things a little clearer. You know I have thought about this problem and thought about this and I saw it happening even with the three conference agenda reports. Back I saw this what was happening to the fellowship through the service structure, because I am one of those persons that believes that the nature or the type of message in the room is reflected from the kind of service structure that we have. Accountability is worthless without, responsibility is worthless accountability to us the fellowship. So you know I have seen this and I wondered like are we a dieing breed, are we freaks you know. I know everybody that is here understands that you have to be in recovery having to work the steps and live the principles and we also understand that there are spiritual rewards in self-sacrifice and that is part of what service is about for me. Like what are we going to do and I see a lot of people with time that have you know put some effort forth and had some kind of position in their group or at an area level or something and they have like 4 years or 8 years. And they go off and they are living this life and got all these things in life that are available to us when we do the next right thing. It does not matter what happens in the service structure, it just does not matter. Part of recovery is that it gives us the ability to participate in life, have, and do these things. So what is right and where is the balance, I believe that we do have to stand for something or we will fall for anything. I find myself having been a liberal being out there with my disease and it is sort of ironic now I find myself a conservative in the little interpretations of our Traditions. That is not necessarily today a very popular view you know and I see it in the rooms when people just come to get what they can get and they go out and do what they go

out and do what they can in life with what they take from the rooms and they are not too interested in giving. What is the answer, what is the answer for us? What are we suppose to do? Well I can continue to beat my head against the wall, and I can continue to battle that and I do not really want to live that way.

Or I could just like surrender. One way of surrender would be just like give up, okay I am beat, we might be right but I cannot do a damn thing about it. You know that is not what I am made of. I do not like that feeling inside of me when I am in confrontation of those that I care about and are suppose to care about me. However, what I have come to believe is that you know what we believe and we all here have in common besides addiction I believe is the spiritual principles that have been given to us. Through some effort and what is happening in my region at home is to form an Ad Hoc Committee to investigate starting a separate service conference. That is something, see everything I believe that all this that exists in NA in our service structure rather, cannot get them mixed up because a lot of people think that service is Narcotics Anonymous, and it is not. The only thing that is NA for me is a meeting okay and the service structure is an outside issue. A lot of people, now I have lost track.

I believe that I need to be true to my beliefs and that does not mean giving up so damn easy you know. It will always have to do with education because just as I carry what I was given what we give will be carried. So like that is real important to perpetuate that kind of education and that type of morality and values that comes from practicing those principles in our affairs. But that alone will not do it because we are in the minority so what are we going to do you know, we cannot blow these people away. Did God mean for there to be a place for people who cannot let go in the service structure. I do not have that answer but I do believe that there is a place for us. But before I give up before I let go and be one of those like one of those old farts in an AA meeting sitting in the back with a group of old fogies making cracks about somebody who uses some kind of new language. I am going to put my efforts in trying to educate those that will listen about what is suppose to be and what can be and to talk about the motion that is going back to my groups, to our groups and our regions. Nothing is impossible, if it is meant to be if y'all go back to your groups and make some kind of a motion that pertains to a separate service conference or something that will allow us to have a service structure, as we believe it should be and is meant to be it will happen. But if it is meant to be and we do not put forth that effort out of fear not being popular it will never come to be. Not everything for me in life that happens or exists is Gods' will. The truth does stand on its own for those who choose to recognize it. So I am tired so I am going to stop talking. (Applause) Thank you.

My name is Bo and I'm an addict. Hi Bo. You know the workshop today has stirred some ideas and stuff. There are a couple of sort of obvious choices, like one thing that Grateful cited me on the letters that I read. The thing that stood out on my first brief glance was that like one of them says, we are the office and we hold the copyrights in trust. Then the letter from the lawyers says, "Stop doing this shit right now or we will blow you away" and I really think that is sad for World Services to take two positions on the same issues in the same time frame. First of all because it makes them look ridiculous and then to offer offense to the most wonderful thing that we have to offer which is active involved members through those letters. It is just I guess more than anything a measure of just how insane it has gotten in world to day to even pull something like that and to not see how stupid it is and embarrassing. Because I mean neither letter reflects any spiritual sincerity, like the attitude of the servant. Like if you were some kind of flagrantly rich individual and you had gentle loving English butlers who says "but sir if I carry out your orders you know that bomb will really go off and we will both be dead" I mean there is just not any service in there. You know with our people we are like gypsies I always figured if you yell at us and treat us like fools and idiots, and then unfortunately we are use to handling that kind of crap. If you treat us real nice with dignity and love and respect hell, you got us by our heartstrings and we will follow you anywhere.

Side two of tape

food for thought and I am not going to try to promote them or read each one and then like oratize on each one. I will just try to read them sort of quickly. Take this tongue and cheek but I call this "Path of Personal Responsibility". One is we can create a new resource for Narcotics Anonymous just by changing our minds. One of the tricks that Joseph and I made up because we were really world level servants and we really did get a lot of opportunities to serve and often during those years 79, 80, 81 there would be potentially difficult problems just getting started but we would

know about them. They would be kind of isolated in just one area or region and our tactic was to include not exclude. So we would take radicals in instead of run them off. Of course, sometimes that would work to our embarrassment but never the less we were loving and just take the package deal right. We would come up with non-directive self-replicating solutions to some of the problems that by definitions on a single hearing somebody would go "Ah hah" and then could repeat it endlessly forever. It did not, it was not important where it came from, I mean like nobody knew we did it right. I guess the ones that didn't pan out just got repeated once or twice and then died out and then the good ones just sort of like went on and we didn't have that kind of problem in that time frame. So maybe this kind of stuff will be kind of like that, like non-directive, self-replicating solutions for current problems. So we can create a new resource by just changing your mind, changing your life we can create a whole bunch of esteemed old timers. We have enough members with long clean time who at a flip of a switch could become esteemed old timers who can kind of act out that role. I had a guy I sponsor visit me the other week and he was bitching about people putting him on a pedestal, this, and that and expecting a lot out of him. So finally he had brought it up about fifteen times so I could just sort of tell that he was having trouble dealing with it. I said well have you ever thought that they are asking you to do for them what was done for you. I mean you are there old man, I know you think you are a kid but you are not. (Laughter) Plus what you would be doing there would be giving, now sure you would have to show a little more dignity and restraint and clean up your act a little bit, but you can afford it you've had your kicks. Besides, it is not like martyrdom or something. Therefore, I at least have the impression that he will at least think about it, he definitely did not say no that is a good sign. I was smart enough to just say it and leave it, move on to the next item.

A lot of people you know or you can become an esteemed old timer just by thinking well that might be curious. You can become an esteemed old timer for even a couple of years and then go back to whatever without relapsing if you like. It is easy and we do have a lot of people with the time now. Another thing if you wanted to try that or even if you did not is you could contact old timers and express your gratitude. We have got a lot of really sad cases where people work their butts off and their stuck up in their job or relationships and dadada and they think they're alone and they don't come to things like this anymore and they are not shown appreciation. I wrote Chuck Skinner just a nice letter you know and didn't bring up any issues, and just told him I loved him and I was grateful and I respected him and how you doing right after the health. You know they are a little older and he told me about their recent ( ) adventures and at the end of the letter told me that the spirit just not as strong in me or something like that. I felt like he was coming clean about some thing. So I will probably write him again after awhile. I am not going to damn heavy it up to much. I really do, you know he has helped a lot. Everybody can do that because you all got your own little set of esteemed old timers, right somewhere. That helped you that loved you and took a little time with you. They probably not perfect you know they might be if they are still clean and feeling a little isolated you know you might brighten their day or something. I mean it is not exactly, they do not have to be senior citizens I mean (laughter)

Okay another thing and this is where my path approach and responsibility gets a little heavy and political. Stay tuned in to, just do that become esteemed old-timer show a little gratitude periodically to the old timers, which in turn will help you accept gratitude from others when being an old timer. Elected position or no just stay tune into the conscience of your home group at the group level. Write down what their feeling are, their aspirations are. In other words what they would like to see, not so much you but them. If you are not holding elective service position, not going to area region all the time just go out of your way and find out whom you are current ASR and RSR is and just call them and go see them. You have got every right to do that. If you are staying in touch with your groups level and enough people do that you are going to be factoring in a different sort of information than they might get just sort of flooding out from world who has the printing press right now. We use to have the printing press at the group level. While world is entitled and that is one way of interpreting what we are looking at right now. Let's just say that it is sort of entangled it is caught up in itself, not functioning to well, lot of problems and stuff. Just formulate regional initiatives; just get your region, another region. Get two or three regions, work out some thing cool to work on, history work, and work on something for policy, PI, or whatever. It can be a real goal or almost a humorous goal. Really in the current time frame and humorous might be fun, and submit it deadpan. Our region worked very hard and came up with this. I mean that would be an interesting repartee to some of these delicious letters and stuff. It would not take long to work up, like you did what, but just do it. Like I said earlier, we have got a lot more capacity today and you could bring together all the existing materials on PI and like examine basic questions. Like I had Bill

going into at the World Convention in DC a few years ago.

How many libraries are there in PA and how many of those libraries have NA Basic Text in them? How could we get Basic Text in all of them? Or just whatever, how many jails have got H&I meetings and how could we gets more; those are the real goals I think. If we had goals like that in World Services, we would not have any time for these bullshit problems. Anyway, while the world is entangled just opt for regional initiatives. If world settles down then go back to world and keep a few regional initiatives. Some people say that is structurally legal, but that ain't so. Invite those who have positive experience in service as if every area in the fellowship has got people who are not commonly known who worked very hard on the Basic Text. Or may have their story in the book or they may have done some other good work some time some place and they would make excellent speakers. Right now, I will guarantee you who get in to the big conventions speaking positions. It is a buddy system, and they ask for the tapes and all that and then they put the buddies in. They may even listen to the tapes but they still put the buddies in you know. I think a lot of times that happens. I mean see if I say I have not heard any good speakers that would be judgmental so instead I will say I have not shed a tear at a convention lately. I can remember sharing a tear at every convention; I would just be transfixed with something like a new idea or whatever. Personally, just by yourself pick out an objective that would help build NA and could make a commitment to it. As long as the fellowship says it wants it you know if the fellowship says, hey we do not care about that anymore, then you could drop it you aren't stuck. As long as you got some members like at group level yeah that would be nice that would be neat just work on it. It could be something small; it does not have to be big. Small things, a bunch of small things add up to be big good things. It could be a private thing, I mean it may even be anonymous, nobody else may even know you are working on it, how about that for underground service in recovery.

Personally, as an esteemed old timer, you can help keep the NA promise of recovery alive. That way as an esteemed old timer, it would no longer be your duty I mean we have got a heavy radical section. I mean like you could be on the sidelines kind of helping them not completely come unglued you know. Grateful will call me up sometimes and I can tell on the other end of the phone his head is turning like a helicopter and I am worried it is going to spin right on off. Then we will be talking, you know we have known each other long enough, and he kind of like calms down and well this, well that. I still say that Grateful has got a terrifically impressive track record at being right in advance. I think and I have thought this for some time that the only cure in the ongoing sense and is not a resource that we did not have in 1965, 75 or even 85. Just to have an on growing group of old timers who are committed to Narcotics Anonymous growth and continuance who hold no elective position at any level. To have their own files and maintain them and do their own studies, and keep track of who is being elected and what is happening. Are the people happy, if people ain't happy and you got clean time, you are committed, and showing up for stuff like this then it is on you? You can either use the powers and gifts God has given you to work towards solutions or you can just stay on the sideline and say ,"well ain't it sad about poor ole NA, oh it was just so sad, it caved in". Well it ain't going to cave in but if you want to be apart of it just get you another way of thinking and slide into it, like you slid into a new belief of God, you slid into surrender, your slid into turning your life and your will over.

Another thing that I heard today and this particularly concerns me because I can remember in the old days and I was spoiled so I am going to praise my original World Service experience. I was loved, I was talked to with respect, I was given the truth you know and I mean I was tested and you know how we are tested. There were no dirty jokes in world services; there was no ridicule of spiritual principles or people. I can remember two or three or four years ago at in conference that stood out in particular like the nominees had to get up to the microphone and along with their clean time and service experience they started citing where they worked and how much money they make. I know I have been coming out here four or five years what is this shit, what is that for you know like everyone was doing this one after another. I am so in so I have been clean so long I have served in this region that way; I make thirty- two thousand dollars a year. Where did that come from?

I also remember that every time at some point during the week the conference chair would authorize a negative sanction against a member of Narcotics Anonymous there in service. A negative sanction is where a group moves to embarrass somebody, or ridicule them or call them on the carpet. They never did that in the old days. They did Dave

one year, and then the next guy from Chesapeake-Potomac because he was dumb and he had left the damn $5000.00 check on the bureau, made it to the airport, and did not have time to go back. He came in, went straight to the conference treasurer, and says hey I am a dummy and left the check back there but I will send it to you. It has not been lost and you can count on five grand from the C&P. Well I mean four days later all that going to the conference chair and the treasurer and tell them what's going on and being assured well okay thank you for telling us and it is ok. Well man by Thursday of Friday it was like(wailing)"You know he didn't bring the check" and like this girl quivering you know the alternate first time at the WSC. I was trustee and hit that microphone and said, "What is this doing on the floor Mr. Chair, you know we don't do stuff like that here"? I was wrong, they went ahead and done it persecuted the shit out of this guy, hell you would have thought he was a damn mugger or bank robber you know killed children, raped fathers I mean, you know. He made a mistake and copped to it straight up. Anyway, my sponsor and I took him out and we ate ribs and laughed about it. He said in other words, I guess the conference needed a scapegoat, I said I do not know if they needed one, but they got one, and so we laughed. You cannot groom quality loving service workers that way; it was sort of, like that was just a shift you know. Who said it earlier, we created this shit we can UN-create it, you know somehow we allowed it to happen. In the old days, we did not have people with long clean time so we could not have a system of informed, involved network to esteemed old timers we can today. In the old days, we did not have any money, property or prestige so we could not have them all concentrated in the office. If you are into structural service and want to work a jigsaw puzzle then figure out how to spread the money, property and prestige around a little bit better where it is less concentrated just in the office and maybe that will give some relief. However, right now it is concentrated so everybody, a certain type of sick addict will suck up out there. And like Max said in the letter. He says, you know, you said Bo that some people are like so being seduced by money, property and prestige. Really, they get on this short tight skirt with a slit up the side before they leave for LA. They know where they are going. We need to just, that was the last thing. Whenever lets say we are going to have a conference this May, just keep track of anybody out there who ridicules spiritual principles who ridicules members especially from the microphone , especially anything that will show in minutes and get them removed, impeach them. Get signatures, we do not like it. NA saved my life, it is spiritual and we are not going to tolerate this. You have to be more careful about wrongdoing, like stealing money and stuff because that can be fabricated, so how do you check your facts out.

I am real glad that Bob Stones contract was not renewed. I do not know whether he was you know the best man for the job or not. Personally, I pray that he can come to terms with some of his (powered) sessions. But I am glad he is gone and I think there are a couple more that need to be gone because before that it was almost like these people with OUR millions of dollars. In addition, see we did not want royalties for the Basic Text, we did not want by lines for the Basic Text and we do not want them in the future. I speak for myself and others in this matter. We certainly do not want employees running down service workers or stomping on, what they regard as little guys. Because to us, people like me they ain't no little guys. Everybody is important and they should not be allowed to get away with that. You know I was talking to Forest earlier I said the fellowship has grown a lot but it has just got to mature like my kids getting bigger in his body and I hope he can get bigger in his mind at the same time. It is almost like try the next time you drive your car somewhere just like shut your eyes plug up your ears and see what happens. If you are not actively, if enough people are not actively engages in running world then world is going to do what it wants to just like that car and it is not the cars fault. If it is not told anything to do then it will start making up stuff or it will just keep going where it was going. The car cannot perceive the curve in the road. You know the same with world. Well I guess I have read my list and I will just shut up. This has been a real good mature workshop, we have covered a lot of ground, and I have not felt like anybody was prevented from sharing openly and honestly, whatever came to them. I hope this is setting like a new custom, because we need stuff like this. It freshens the air and takes the pressure off and then people are not running around that they heard there is trouble and they are scared you know. It kills the fear gets things out in the open it increases the faith and people relax and get common sense back. I am really glad you had it and thank y'all for having some of us in and I hope we can do it again too. Because y'all are real important to my life and me. I mean Dave, Bill, Bill, and the rest of you. When I first got clean and first got involved it was as if I rather hated to really get to know you well in a convention and then the disease side of me assumed I would never see you again in this lifetime. Then through service and recovery, oh man you get to know an incredible number of people. You might see them two or three times, you might know there face and name along time before you ever get to talk to them before you get to talk to them for along time. But I feel like I want to have a long talk with Carl and

Yeshua(right). I figured out it was like yes sir so you know somewhat different so. My wife's sponsor is up in Michigan right now and you are from Michigan we will see each other again and between now and then we can look forward to it. Thank you.

Tape 7
Allentown History Addathon 1990
Problems / Solutions
Speaker: Carl

I am an addict, my name is Carl. Hi Carl. One of the things that really attracted me to drive the seventeen hundred miles that it will take us to get here and back was solutions. I do not know how many, how many of you have been involved in work shopping a piece of literature in this fellowship. That is quite a few. I bet if I had asked earlier that it would have been a minority. So you got an idea and the warm and fuzzy at doing that and that inclusion you felt and being apart of and being heard and somebody actually understanding that you had some value in your life and that you got something to give away instead of continue to take.

A little of my background was looking for recovery in 68' and finding out since I was a convicted felon find out there was not any for me. Then finding it somewhere else in 72' and taking another 14 years almost to find out I belonged here. It was that hunger and thirst to find out why I had not found it because I felt good here I felt at home here. As I got more involved and did more things and tried to use the strengths that were given so freely to me I started seeing old timers feeling hurt and put off and set aside. When I went to conferences and quarterly workshops, saw the skirts, saw the chasing, and wondered where their spiritual principles were and if the was the epitome of service, if that was the height of service is that was where you could serve the best and do the most I did not want anything to do with it. That scared me a lot but I had those resources, I met those people, went to those places, and looked for that good old boy sitting back in the back of the meeting nodding his head and smiling. You can tell the serene ones around here and you can tell usually the service junkies have tired eyes and he is smiling when he identifies with what somebody else has to share. Our literature process is threatened. NA History something we are doing here is a ( ) item not to long ago. As a regional literature chair, I requested it and was told that it is in the office and the office was going to compile it. I was pissed and then I asked for all of the items that are available for development in this fellowship and was told we could not have them. How am I suppose to identify with the diversity in my region what they want to work on if I do not have the material to produce to give to them to understand what the might want to work on. I am in a new area, I mean this is backwoods, I mean a group conscience where I am living is 3 to 7 people in our area in any particular group. That is about what it was like when I came into the fellowship. Yeah with some learning experiences and finding solutions, this is the third area I have helped begin and helped grow. I told them third time is a charm does not isolate me because I learn from these old timers that is what happens. So when we just started to talk about it I said do not isolate me here is the service material read it, understand what you are talking about, information. Something we do not have much of in Narcotics Anonymous, we do not have a communication tool in this fellowship. We have a news line and it goes everywhere. Who writes it, what goes in it. If you read it long, enough you would know. (Laughter) Depends on how long it takes to set in.

Then we begin to dialogue a little bit in St. Louis. There were seventeen regional literature chairs in St Louis for the quarterly. The first hour and a half of dialogue with those regional chairs was a bitch session and I did not come 800 miles to do this. I have heard enough bitching where are the solutions. What are we going to do; we need some sort of tool of communication in this fellowship. Bill mentioned it I think a networking. I think a pyramidal sort of structure, I will call you, you call two people, those two people call two people and before long, you have the ability to communicate broadly in this fellowship. I think we need to identify those people who can write. I can remember just a few years ago when it was just enthusiasm and now I am meeting the people with doctorates and masters in English that has the talent, but I am hearing about their frustrations. You know a committee who took everything away from them for almost 9 months so they did not have anything to do and they want to quit. Seems like it would be simple to identify the people who could write, put a list of twenty topics together and send it out to as broad a distribution as you can get to every group that you can get an address for and ask them to read it in their group business meeting,

read it under group announcements. The fellowship would like to have your input on a topic. There are enough people who can determine whether you can write or not, that would not be hard to amass. We need those communication tools you know we are talking about assembling a history. Right, wrong, indifferent for approve you. Take a look-see what it looks like, see what you believe, you do not like it, check it out. If it irritates your ass and you know that it is different tell us more. I think we could do that in on a communication tool. However, we need to identify of where people stand. There is so much diversity, and so many different viewpoints and I firmly believe that none of the people that do the things we think are wrong do it intentionally. Lack of knowledge, lack of willingness and surrender is probably the two basics. The willingness to surrender comes hard for me, I want to keep fighting. That is probably why I stay in service. That is probably why in being a couple hundred miles away from my regional meeting I am still involved when I cannot afford it anymore.

Nevertheless, we need those solutions. We need to find those people who can write we need those communication tools and we need to quit bad mouthing service. We alienate a lot of old timers, I saw us getting stuck and wrapped up and when December showed up with the new proposed service guide I wonder why I want to stay around here fifteen years and be put off. It scared the shit out of me, and talking with those old timers it still scares the shit out of them. I met many old timers in another place at another time and they told me I did not have to change, I only had to stop. It did not do me a fucking bit of good. Today I have to change, I have to be adaptable, I have to learn, I have to communicate, I have to have the honesty, open-mindedness and willingness we talk about and I have to have service. They told me that is how it works and what can I do? It is mentioned probably ten different times because that is what they did to get recovery in Narcotics Anonymous. It is not mentioned in any other 12 Step programs that I know of. That is what works here and that is what works for addicts. I have begged people for service and I have corralled them into service, thrown them in the car, and taken them to service (Laughter) and it only works on that one on one. This whole program is about feelings to me man. I did not feel before I got here, and for something as powerful as this that reaches someone as stupid and as stubborn as I was and still am it has to come back to the primary purpose. What the hell are we here for; there were people here for me that gave me a chance to feel again. To feel okay about who I am and what I do and what I am like and what I think. Because they believe of the importance of carrying the message to the addict who still suffers. Not that it had to be hip slick and glossy, not that it had to keep from alienating treatment professionals so that we could more literature. None of that stuff mattered then, but here we are at a point where we are talking about adapting a system and the justification was to take a structure from another place that was to go from a dictatorship to a democracy and their justification is that this will take us from ( ) democracy to what, a dictatorship. Does Narcotics Anonymous need a seven million prudent reserve like the one somebody else has in using the Twelve Steps. You are going to have that ability when you get a meditation book and a step book. There will be that kind of money available, it ain't to far away. But there are a lot subtle rewards available for service in Narcotics Anonymous right now, there are charge cards and they will need office directors in Rio de Janeiro and Frankfurt and Paris, real nice rewards. Who will fill those positions, who will they go to? We have already made some of the mistakes of sending the wrong people to the wrong place. I believe we will come out on the other side just where we are suppose to be right where we are at now. We got here for a reason; we would not have attracted this number of people. We would not have had the quality of people that came to begin to do the dialogue. I remember when we first talked to Billy I said okay who are we going to get. Who is going to be willing to roll over and be honest and let us scratch their belly and let them feel apart of this again. Not many yet, but I think as the interest grows. I do not know what I feel about names in this anonymous program and I ain't out to get anybody, I am out to get better and to carry a message. What are the solutions it is getting involved and staying involved. The best rewards of this program many times for me have been through my service experiences. Dealing with you addicts has made life in general a piece of cake. I am amazed at how easy it is to deal with the public today. I am in a new town, I have a doctor that would give me anything I want, I have a pharmacist for a friend, and I can trust those friendships today because you gave that to me. Because I had to look in their hearts instead of their pocketbooks and what they have to offer me, you taught me that. Because sometimes you only alienated the shit out of me, but I had to look past that to your principles, sometimes I wonder where the principles go. I always hated principles because they put me in detentions and made me after school. (Laughter) Today it is different, today it is entirely different. Those are principles that I can live by, feel by, and grow by and I do not have to live in that base physical I don't have to be stuck in that crazy mental shit anymore. I try to maintain a spiritual condition because that sucker is finally awake. How are we going to wake up more, by talking more positively about what we do? Letting people know where we

came from, talking about those warm fuzzies. Letting people on the PI Committee know that they are not going to get any big strokes, but they are the basis for getting it out for more people to find. Recognizing that H&I have got a lot of hugs and a lot things to turn around and get out. Thanks, I needed that. There are some real nice fun things there. Policy hah that is going to be fun for the politician in all of us. There is a place for everybody in Narcotics Anonymous, because we have that diversity we have those needs, but for each and every one of us it is finding that so that we feel those warm fuzzy so you learn how to feel good about yourself. So you like who you are, I like being happy, that is new that is fresh everyday, But how because I have to keep it fresh I got to listen at that next meeting. My home group is based on the tenth step and we talk about how you applied the principles of this program, the Twelve Steps in your life in the last week. They get very honest; you do not hear a lot of bitching and moaning. You know just the basics of what we do can be kept so simple. You heard all the little suggestions going back to the home group it is where it is it is Narcotics Anonymous. What you going to do, you going to be a member or are you going to be a taker. You going to learn how to give or are you going to throw it away? There are solutions because the talents are here, calling a spade a spade will work I like your impeachment idea. It is a political structure, letting people know what other people are doing is not decent it is not controversy. Maybe it is just another honest basic attempt at being honest. I got to own my own shit today I do not got to own anybody else's. If I do not like your shit, I can give it back to you anytime I want. I am confident enough that I have mulled it over; looked at it and surrendered to it here it is it is all yours. Owning mine is a little more difficult, I need those informed people, I need those insightful people, I need those intelligent people, I need those feeling people to feed that back. If it just comes back to being a business here, I am gone. You know we discuss about changing the steps, let's get God out of here so we can be an international fellowship, wonderful. Some crazy things have come along what is the end result, they are huge. The estimated membership is equal to half of another fellowship and we have done it in less than ten years, something that took them 55 years. With the creation on new materials that is unknown, with our translations that is endless. Where are we going and what are we doing, hell if we know but it feels good and it is working and people are enjoying. But is it about fundraisers, is it about dances or is it about carrying a message. I hope we all realize it is about carrying a message. What is yours that is your own experience strength and hope to share? Hope everybody takes back what they have heard and thought about, come up with, mulled over, digested, throw it up, look over it tomorrow, and do some thing with it. Do not take it home and keep it. That is not what we do here we give it away. Give this away. I will copyright it and sell it. (Laughter). It is fun to ride the emotions in this fellowship, the joy of being apart of, The joy of being able to reach out to the next person you meet and give them something and low and behold just when you need it back, surprise you get it.

Transcriptions Allentown tape 8

Tape 8
Allentown History Addathon 1990
Problems / Solutions
Speaker: ( ), Lawrence,

Unknown Speaker:
I get pissed off at God but I ain't got pissed off at y'all yet.(Laughter) Sometimes I would think I was worthy, and I just want to say that I want to thank y'all because see I am one of the people that would have died in the last twenty-seven months if it wasn't for y'all. I do not know many some people forget about that. I realize that I am in a room full of saints and that is all that has been here, saints and angels, I am not. You know I fart, it stinks. Sometimes I don't brush my teeth you know sometimes instead of coming to the meeting for the message I look at somebody's dress tail. I did not do that this time. All I basically want to say is that I understand that when I show up I grow up. The last thing I want to say is the lies have to be covered up, but lies can run around naked. Thank You.

I am an addict, named Lawrence. Hi Lawrence. I do not know, I think this has been real gratifying for me to be apart of. You know it was very informative also. I wish some of the other people that were invited would have come,

but that is their loss. In terms of history, the dictionary definition is a collection of events, a collection of recorded events of significance that is it. Something that is not done anymore is that we do not input literature anymore. For me anything that is written is literature whether it be service guidelines you know the first H&I, which was the first project I was privileged to be part of, inputting the little blue book for H&I. I was also part of the early sickness of New York, New York region. You know the reality is that you can get o a meeting in New York and in any given moment, you will not find any literature on the table. This is probably because this has been the fastest growing region in the world and there is a lot of suffering addicts. Since it was made in '84 the former Board of Directors in New York and essentially what that was going to do was suppose create a better link between toe region and the world. What I experienced was just trying to move over and be nosey and be part of, you know try to just be there and be involved because that is what I was told to do. I felt like I really wasn't part of and you know I heard a tape of Jimmy K and he says that when individuals tend to dominate the spirit dies and that is what I experienced. I would say there were basically five people who dominated and there was not any spirit. There was a lot of growth and disease and a lot of money. There was a lot of prestige, and that is the reason Terry Ryan, you know Terry Ryan moved away from New York because of the disease. And for the purpose of opening a service office, it was all about prestige. Maybe an opinion, maybe an educated opinion too, that is what I feel. There was such an obsession to build a service structure, incorporate, and have a service office, where there were three lines on the help line. There was one phone; there were two phones, one collating, and one with a collating line and one without a collating line. But the obsession was to open a service office, an RSO. I could not understand that, I just could not understand that and it made me bitter. I really did not have much knowledge but I knew it was not right because it did not feel right. One thing I was always able to do is take an H&I commitment, go to a detox, share the message of recovery, and just hope that some of those people would come to meetings. There were also many things to do; there were just a lot of things to do. I got clean in an institution, and the way I got clean was that someone sent me a White Book. We actually someone sent the counselor the White Book and the counselor gave me the White Book. I wrote a letter and that letter was sent down to New York to the man who was chairing in the H&I committee, that was Terry Ryan. Terry wrote me a letter and sent me some literature. Then some other addicts wrote me and that is why I am here today. I am here today because like we are all here today, because of an intervention. There was an intervention and that intervention was for me to be a member of Narcotics Anonymous and stay alive and to carry whatever it is that I had, as people did for me. It is amazing but if we are trying to get skeletons out of the closet, we may as well right. Bo came up with the idea, he told his sponsee well why don't one of you guys try to see if one of your home groups will have a literature awareness addathon, or something with literature. We were coming back from a meeting with a member from another home group and they say, yeah yeah I will take it to my home group. Well they did not take it to their home group, but I brought it to my home group and we work-shopped it and that is history. It ain't my credit and I ain't trying to claim credit I am just trying to say it was so and it was good to be there and be a vehicle. We are talking about making a weekend thing out of this and I look forward to that. It is amazing that participation was great even without a dance; you know I mean there was a lot of people here, maybe they thought there were going to be a dance. Maybe someone told them a lie or something. That is the amazing part about it that people were interested.

My life basically still very fucked up and I am a whole lot harder on myself than other people are, people tell me. But I guess you know after having a shout out with my sponsor this morning. He reassured me that I was growing and I needed to hear that. The other divine intervention maybe I will become a father and that is scary, it is overwhelming and I have been on an elevator with it. I fell great then oh no, I feel great then oh no. If I was a woman I would have had a half dozen already. I mean I love dogs, I love animals I love kids I love things like that. I don't know I am not going to let my insecurities kick up because everyone left as soon as I started to share, but those who stayed I guess have some faith in me. You know the fact that the only person I have to rise above is my own, and that is what my personal program of recovery gives me. Just the fact that I could think of something like that, the possibility I could rise above my own personality and be a better person you know that is sort of like a miracle. Your presentation Bo was like right on, I was hoping that maybe you would share some of those spiritual experiences that you shared with Jodi that she shared with me too. I was hoping that maybe you would share them. You did share a lot of history, you know every time I think about the Memphis Conference where people had to go donate blood people bleed so that we could write this book. I know how much that means to you, it is overwhelming, and I am a book baby. If I had known, the Red Book would be an archive I would have kept it. I gave it to a newcomer; just give it away like that. I know wants the disease always wants; it just wants total disunity and wants us to tear each other apart. Sometimes I

think if controversy is really good and what kind of controversy is good? I do not think God wants us to live in conflict. I question that you know, myself. So much, stuff that I got out of this workshop. I guess as an addict that I could really see how I could focus in on the problems a whole lot easier than the solutions. But the solutions are really simple just be an involved member, participate in your home group and participate in service. That is being part of the solution and those are things I like to do. I have not slept all night, I did not want miss anything you know so I did not sleep. I will get to late tomorrow, but I did not sleep and I wish I had the day off tomorrow so I could go to the quarterly; I have never been to one, never experienced anything like that. I was going to go to Newark and was living there then. That is something that amazes me why I did not get to Newark I do not know and could have walked to the Holiday Inn and I did not make it. I guess I was not supposed to be there. I think of your idea of how many libraries there are in Pennsylvania you know,(don't put me on no time limit, you spoke for a thousand minutes , give me that crap I can stand on my two feet here). I mean it is a good idea of how many libraries there are in Pennsylvania send those books, send those free Basic Text to libraries, distribute them to the libraries you know. That will really make them think, Hi Lisa, okay I guess I have to speed it along. Anyway I am just glad to be apart of history and I know everyone else is glad to be part of history. That is it. Thank you for letting me share. (Applause)

Chapter Eight

Montgomery - Celebration 2

Planners: Donnie and Roxanne, Grover,

Participants: Father Dan Eagan, Betty K., Bill B., Cindy D., Grover N., Carl D.

Transcriptions of audio cassettes

Montgomery History Convention
Tape One

Opening Meeting
Speakers: Tom, Joe, Linda, Rachel

Speaker: Tom - I have seen it from both sides it continuously happens and it gets to the point where I have been interested enough. I was involved in service in Narcotics Anonymous since before I started counting my clean time and sometimes it gets to the point where I just see it as not having an end. For me to start getting sick and tired of things that are going on in this fellowship takes a lot. Because I owe this fellowship my life but after awhile I get, I understand opinion and I understand peoples interpretations, but when things go on, I ask six different people about the same thing, and I get six absolutely different answers something is wrong here. You know the things that have gone on in the past I have heard some of the things and for me to share and you know people will ask me questions that makes me feel good That somebody to come and say Tom what is going on? The hard thing for me is that sometimes I cannot answer them. I am the kind of person that if I do not have an answer for you, I do not make one up I go to somebody who I think may have the answer for me and then I get back to you. However, when I kind of run around and around and around and I never get an answer I start to look at it like this is futile. Is it really worth seeking these things out and spending a lot of my time, my energy and my money? I am another addict that really could not afford to be here, unmanageability yeah maybe my phone is being shut off while I am here because I chose to come here rather than do that. That was a choice I had in my recovery because I give a shit.

I could be at my states convention tonight but I chose not to be there because I want to know what is going on in this fellowship and whether or not the ties that bind us together are actually stronger than those that could tear us apart. I read something that came from the conference, I read a lot of things that came from the conference and I was real disenchanted, disillusioned, disappointed with a lot of the things that came out of there. There was a panel presentation called what are we here and I came back to my area and I read them the last four paragraphs and it talked about unity and it talked about us being able to disagree without being disagreeable and it talked about whether or not the dilemmas that we come across are insurmountable. I have engaged in a lot of philosophical discussions that there is no right or wrong answers to. Where my opinion has not been respected as I try to respect other peoples opinions. Icons in the fellowship, I do not know I have not been around long enough to have maybe fully appreciate some of the things that the past members or older members of this fellowship offered or what they went through. I would like to find out some of those things. I hope what I see over this weekend is not where we have the people who are kind on the edge and kind of like I do not know what is going on over in one group, and then everybody who is anybody "in this room" ends up at some other table. I see it happen in my region, I do not like it, and I really hope it does not happen here. Because I came out to rummage through peoples archives and to talk to members who have been around for a long time who were involved to get first hand knowledge from these people. I hope that if you are one of the people I am addressing that you take the time out, sit down, and answer some of these questions. I have been privileged to sit in on a number of discussions with a number of people over the last several years. I sit and I do not generally ask questions when it involves things that happened years ago etc. There is a reason for that because if you are sitting there having a discussion I am not going to take up all your time trying to get all the background information, but sooner or later I would like to know. I asked my sponsor this earlier and I did not understand it and I, maybe I am just naïve I have not been around the fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous long enough to of become hardened. However, through the 12 Steps as they are described in this book whatever edition it is that you keep

carrying, there is a way to let go of resentment of anger. It is in that book to be able to carry something around for five years or ten years. To have that be there for that long a time I do not understand. As far as me, I will be wandering around. I am here to help, I am here to serve the fellowship that I am a part of and to be apart of something that hopefully I will be able to look back upon and say yes I was there and I was apart of that and it turned into something good. I did not turn in to a mess like a lot of things I have seen in this fellowship and a lot of gatherings. In the event that I do make a mess, today I do try to clean it up. Thanks for letting me share. (Applause)

Hello I am an addict named Joe. Hi Joe. I am real glad to be here. I came all the way up here because I have some fears and I then I have some hopes. I have some fears that through my experience in the service structure that all that is done for me so far is kind of like eroding. From what I can see as Lawrence said, a couple of things that he said that as far as the group conscience that in some places it does not exist. You know I have become real familiar through my experience in service that past my region there is no group conscience the way I can see it, it stops there. We try our damndest in our region and in our area to really get as good a group conscience as possible. You know every question in my region we have to take back to the groups to get the conscience before we vote on it. That does not happen in every region. I was involved in the Spanish translation project from the beginning; in fact, about four years ago my area initiated the motion that kind of brought this thing all together. Then a few months ago, the WSO took it upon themselves to just disband the committee and turn the project over to a professional translator. That really hurt me deeply and scared the shit out of me to be real frank with you. I also realized that the service structure is not NA. That even if like tomorrow my area disbands, my region disbands the WSC disbands you know there is still recovery available to me in my home group. Never the less you know as if to me being able to serve through the service structure has really afforded me with a lot of good stuff. A lot of self esteem a lot of like chances to help other addicts and to use my God given gifts to help somebody else and to write literature and to take meetings to institutions. To really share myself as fully as possible and I see the process that I think should be like a real open process and everybody should be able to participate because it is part of our 12 Steps. I see it being closed more and more and more instead of being open. Instead of me being able to participate more you know as I go along in my recovery, and as I gain more recovery to be able to give more of that recovery I see the chances of being closed up and that scares me, because I really need that. Besides going to my meetings, to my home group and get it there this addict also needs a service structure where I can give it away. Besides on a one to one or in sponsorship, but I have a hope that God is in charge and that it says in the Traditions we keep what we have only with vigilance. Although my first instinct is to run away and not push it and not stand for something and not take the brunt of somebody else's difference of opinion like Carl was saying and realize I need to be vigilant. If I do not give it away, I do not keep it. I want us to keep what we have and to have more you know. So I need to stay involved and when I heard from Billy all the members that have been around for a long time with a lot of experience strength and hope way before who were here as this thing developed. I was very lucky, when I came in the doors it was all there for me you know. I already had like hundreds of meetings you know and I was able to get right into service and serve in many ways, it was all there for me. But I see the possibility that if we do not exert our vigilance that this process will be closed up you know. If the concepts come out and get passed, you know the regions will be disbanded and there will be no chances at a regional level. The Spanish translation thing I was so involved in it I read a book of a story written for the Basic Text, I really got excited, I met some of the people that were involved in that you know, and I was sorry that I did not get to participate. So when I found out there was a possibility that we were going to write another book and that I could be part of that process once more I will do it I am here and will go anywhere so that I can participate in that, because I believe that. The literature was written by addicts for addicts, I really like to understand how it happened that some corporation that is not Narcotics Anonymous now owns all of our literature. I mean how did that happen, I need to know. I need to know how that happened because I want to see if we can reverse that process and to keep it from happening again. If we do not understand our history, we are doomed to relive it again and there was a time that NA did not exist and addicts died and that could happen again I guess if we do not participate as much as we can. To be vigilant and to be of service and I need to serve. My life was meaningless before I got here and since I got here, my life has a lot of meaning because I can serve and that is very necessary for me today and I do not want to lose that. As a good addict I want more, I want to be able to do it much more and much better. I am real glad that I am here and I just want to get everything that I can from this experience. Thank you. (Applause)

My name is Linda I am an addict. Hi Linda. I am from California and the reason I initially came here was in

support of a friend, she did not want to fly alone but as it turned out we are both flying alone and we are both here. In preparing to come here, I was not really excited about it until probably about an hour before I was getting on the plane because my life is so full today because of Narcotics Anonymous. As I was watching the fireworks I said man this is way better than getting loaded you know and that is just a little part. Thinking about coming here oh gosh you know I got clean after Jimmy Kinnon died, passed away and I was never fortunate enough to meet him personally, but I seem to click with the family. I got to know Betty and then I adopted Jimmy's son as my father kind of informally you know so in that essence I have been able to listen to a lot about how this thing started and stuff . I found out the reason I am here after I showed up. I didn't sleep all night, The plane was booked, I can't sleep sitting up and the guy next to me took off his shoes and had stinky feet.(Laughter) I mean it was awful and then when I got on my second flight they were serving breakfast and you can't sleep when there is food you know. When I got here, I was delirious and then I kind of spent a little time at the airport. As long as I knew someone was coming to pick me up, I was fine. Then when I got here, they were just starting up and at this point now, I am very vulnerable and very scared. Because I am thinking that I am going to stay in the room with Betty and did they have it arranged and how is this set up you know I paid my money and I am sitting there all by myself without a soul around me just totally confused. I began to cry, I did not reach out I began to cry and this newcomer that I had met her name is Renee I had been talking to her and she came up and said Linda what's wrong? I told her I am about to cry I don't know what is going on, you know simple as registering and getting my room I wasn't able to do that. She said come on girl let's get you on up there, and she took me on up to the table and she got me signed up and I got my key and I got me suitcase and was on my way up to my room and I was okay. I said thank you so much for helping me and she said well that is what this program is all about. As I said, it did not dawn on me until after I was here why I was here and that is to carry the message to the newcomers to the people coming in that is what we are here for is to help one another. I too agree that since I have been in the program I have had a lot of backs turned on me because I was new or because I was individual because I had certain opinions, because I wore red shoes I don't know but many addicts do seem to turn other addicts away because of certain reasons. I remember when I was new I told myself I will never be like that. If there is an addict seeking recovery, just wants to talk, I am going to put off my life to listen, because that is what I needed when I got here. I want the newcomers what Jimmy Kinnon started here, the reason why he started Narcotics Anonymous is because addicts were dieing in AA, addicts were dieing in the street. I think you know today the meetings that I attend it are getting real repetitious, in the name of unity everybody are doing it the same way, and we are losing a lot of addicts. I am just really glad to be here. I am going to have a blast and get a good night sleep tonight, thanks for letting me share. (Applause)

Hi, I am an addict my name is Rachael. Hi Rachael. I am really glad to be here. I know why I am here, but I have not figured out why I am here yet. In the past three weeks or so, one by one my titled service commitments seem to be falling by the wayside. Last year I held a regional position and learned so very much, I grew a whole lot through it, and I swore as I made my final report to the region offside that I would never darken their doorstep again. So then I decided to run for ASR and at the last minute as things work out I was acting as temporary secretary for the area and at the very last minute before minutes and letters of willingness were to go out, and I mean literally at the last minute another letter cam in for ASR of willingness came in. I thought of shit I should have sent this out yesterday and I lost and I have never run for anything and lost before. I was confused and hurt for a little while not for to long I had to call my sponsor right away. Before I had found out that there was going to be someone running against me, there is another man in my home group, I am GSR of my home group and I had asked him if he would consider being GSR. He had never held an area position before and he said he would think about it. So after I lost I assumed, and people were saying well you know don't drop out of service this and that and the other thing and I said well you cannot get rid of me that easily. He asked me the next week, he knew that I had lost and he asked me if the GSR seat was still open. I was not even cold in my grave yet, people were ready to replace me, and I thought he has never been in this kind of service before and it might just be time that he gets involved at the area level. Therefore, what I saw happening here was the ASR did not happen and somebody else is willing to be the GSR now and it was time I did some service without a title again. I tell you last year when I was real involved in service without a title I wondered at times why I was doing it and when I thought it was over I wondered why I had done it. There was no title there was nobody to say "good job" no reports to hand in, it was just doing a never-ending job. I came to the conclusion very recently that there is something for me to do and I may just find it at Li-Hi and so I am here as an instrument. If it is nothing but to get in peoples way, change the tape and run a Dictaphone that will be it for the weekend but I am here

for a reason. I was sitting here listening to a little bit of history and I just kept thinking if this was person if this was someone I was sponsoring I would say get a clue and do a 4th Step. This program need to do, needs a 4th Step in a big way(clapping) but I don't sponsor this program so you don't have to worry about that. I know there have been times when I have become real cynical about service and it usually is when it gets up there in the big leagues and I get real down on it sometimes. I am not a cynical person by nature, a smart ass maybe but not cynical and every time I get like that my faith and my hope and my optimism is restored when I do service for my home group. When I see, the newcomer and we pass around the phone list, and when we do extra hugs at the end of the meeting. When the low fuel light comes on in my car and "no" to the newcomer that I do not need any money to get you home, I do not need any money to pick you up. It is time for me to give it back and every time I get down, I get picked back up in my group. The area that I come from I love with all my heart. I was, in NA I was born and raised in Kalamazoo NA and it was the most beautiful thing that ever happened to me and then I moved to Lansing and it was even more beautiful. I understand that times, they are a changing in Kalamazoo and it hurts to hear what is going on and I still try now I feel like Pollyanna what you seek you will find. I listen , I have many friends in Kalamazoo and I listen to the ones bitch, bitch, bitch and I am like you are the same people who bitch and you don't do anything but bitch. If they had an Ad Hoc bitch committee you would be top bitch,"bitch". (Laughter)(Applause) I think those things, I think those things but hey okay I could not afford to be here and people were shocked that I was not going to the convention to the dance well go on without me. I keep thinking that this reminds me this is NA summer camp here and you know the trees and the woods and I am thinking as I see all the trees this is like a retreat. My sponsor is here and my trusted friends are here, the fireworks were here and harmonica is here and I said screw Michelob it just does not get any better than this. I am just so grateful for all the people I have met in this program and I am grateful for the pain that I have been through in service, because I have learned. That I know today that I have buried many many resentments but at any time I can pick them back up and then there are people that love to get me geeked on that. They just drop the all the have to say is MRSCNA and I am like that and you know I let it go and everyday I let it just stay where it is. I am just so thrilled to be here and I look forward to meeting and talking with some more of you in greater length because I have so many questions, so many questions. Just one big question mark walking around so thanks for helping me stay clean. (Applause)

Tape 2
Montgomery History Convention 1991

Opening Meeting
Speaker: Bill, Bob, Bill B., Betty K., Grateful Dave, Lawrence, Frank, Carl

We will open this meeting with a moment of silence for the still suffering addict followed by the Serenity Prayer and for Marty.

God grant us the serenity to accept the things we cannot change. Courage to change the things we can and the wisdom to know the difference, amen.

I am an addict. My name is Bill, hi Bill.
Readings "Who is an Addict"- Vicki… "What is the NA Program"-Ron… "Why are we Here"-Rueben… "How it Works"-Pat &Marie "

Speaker: Bill – First, I want to welcome everybody and thank everybody for reading. This meeting is listed, as the opening meeting is the agenda and Alabama History Report. Agenda is what is in here basically and what we are here for this weekend. It is a History Conference and there is, the reason this conference is being put on is because of the lack of information that we have in Narcotics Anonymous. In our Basic Text and the approval process, it talked about that the book was not completed. That the book was supposed to continue to complete a history project and that was derailed somewhere. It was put under the carpet. I have to remember that because when the book was in the approval process we got a little flippy-floppy. We got a set of stories, it talked about the history of Narcotics Anonymous, and it talked about we had a job to complete with the Basic Text at that point and time. The job was not done and I was in

Ivy land, Pennsylvania when they were working on those stories and at that point, there was energy for writing the history. This conference requested the history from WSO and the WSO has not sent any of the collection of the history that it said it would send us. The reason we decided that we wanted to have a history conference , last spring, I mean last summer this group hosted a conference in a church basement and we had a few people come and go over some history and what we are seeking is to find out is the actual history of Narcotics Anonymous. Therefore, the agenda we scheduled was for the history from the 50's and 60's and what we are looking for is maybe some questions from the floor of what they are seeking. What people expect out of here, so we can get them type of questions answered by the people that have been brought in. We have members present there that have been involved in Narcotics Anonymous for a long time. They are going to be on panels and provide that information for us and we are going to be collecting that type of information. What else we will be doing is trying to collate and put together a history book of Narcotics Anonymous. You know which we feel is important and imperative that this project be complete. We feel that what will happen with our history is going to give us a lot of solutions for the problems that we are involved in today on our Narcotics Anonymous. This is one of the reasons this group chose to be involved in this project. We have chosen to be involved in it because of derailment of the history project and because there are a lot of people out there that are seeking where they came from and who started Narcotics Anonymous. There are a lot of rumors out there, there is some documentation. The little White Book starts that Narcotics Anonymous started in 1953, and then there is talk of a man called Jimmy Kinnon. If you call the WSO up it is almost like the mans name is defunct and that he never even existed almost. You ask WSO who started Narcotics Anonymous and they tell you God and they will not mention a lot about it. In our service structure and what we are looking for you know, it is as my home group has been involved in-group conscience. Where did group conscience come from? What does group conscience actually mean? What does it mean to the people that were actually involved in Narcotics Anonymous in the early days? What were their intents, what was their purpose? You know 1981 when I called the WSO up and a man named Jimmy Kinnon answered the telephone. Have we lost his spirit that is some of the stuff we will be going over here. In 1981 when I called the WSO up Jimmy Kinnon, I told him about that, we were starting a new area and that we did not have the money and needed literature and he sent our area a hundred dollars in literature. He said if you can repay it, you can and if you cannot do not worry about it. Those were the type of things I think we were interested in, you know what happened in the 50's and 60's in Narcotics Anonymous? Were there Tradition violations, how did they work through them situations? Those are things we were looking for as a group. Looking for you know it is like anything you grow up through and you go to school and you read history books about where we come from. You have some kind of foundation to go to; you have to see how the human race grew, what mistakes they made and how they were corrected. But Narcotics Anonymous, we have no basis to go from and that is disheartening. When I know we are history right now the people that are here are history.

We are looking at the 70's, many things we know about the 70's is a period of time when the WSO came into existence, what was the reason for it? We know that it was in a mans house for a while, we know that it was taken out of a house. We know there were other members that participated there. Who were they? How did they participate and what transpired. It is something, I have asked my sponsor many questions, certain areas are unanswered, and I wonder why. When I was on the World Service Conference floor and I talked to certain people and was told I should not even be talking to them I wondered why. These are the things that if we are about, if we are about theses principles that we talk about, these Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions. They are part of our history. Why did we adapt the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions from another fellowship called Alcoholics Anonymous to start with? Why did our service structure evolve? Why did the first thing called the NA Tree come into existence? Why has the service manual basically not adhered to? Is it because of principle violations and if so how do we heal from that? You know we had a Federal Court case last year. What is the reasoning for a Federal Court case against an NA member in Narcotics Anonymous? Why does our history have to have that involved with it? You know and those are the questions we look for, the home group wrote a letter in the area that we participated in sent a letter to WSC Narcotics Anonymous. It was sent to the BOT, BOD, World Service Inc. and all WSC sub-committees and to all Narcotics Anonymous as a whole, you know and it is a letter that went out but never a reply, and it had to do with principles, it had to do with questions of traditions. Our history has shown that there have been members ridiculed who have spoken out and why does that have to happen in a fellowship that is supposed to be spiritual. Those are the things that need to be healed in order for us to continue. What happened with the spirit of the of the older members of Narcotics Anonymous that one time worked together and today cannot even talk at times. I am not just talking about people

from the 50s', 60s' and 70s' but people who got involved in service in the 80s' and all of a sudden went into service as friends and n longer can fellowship or communicate and that is part of our history. Why is it just in my home group when newcomers come into it they are ridiculed by other groups for joining a home group that is part of our history, but it continues? These are the things I know that we were looking forward to working on. Why is it when we talk about writing a service book that it is not supported by our World Services that is suppose to be there to service I can tell you this conference was told that it has been cancelled, I have received the calls that this conference was cancelled. I know it came out of the WSO. Why does that have to happen? A friend of mine in California walked into the WSO, the flyers were removed from, and he had to go in and ask why and have them put back on in the WSO. What is the fear we have of having our history put together? Are we afraid of truth or is it that we have skeletons in our closets that we do not want to bring out in the light? Don't our principles teach us better? Don't our principles teach us if we are truly seeking the steps and participation of traditions do not they teach us better? What has been the history of the steps and traditions in our fellowship? What has happened to people that has worked with them? What has happened with the spirit of newcomers that use to be excited to get involved in this fellowship and are now today told you do not know enough stay away? Why did the committee's structure close down to get involved in our World Services? They are questions that are not even written about, but there is a reason why. What is the actual purpose of it? What is the constant conflict in our fellowship? That is what we are hoping to get some answers for here. We are also hoping to come out of this here with an actual working body to continue to work together to complete a history book. I think what I would like to do at this moment is we have, we have three members present that are going to be involved in the agenda okay. We have a man named Bill B, from San Diego. (Applause) We have Fawn who uses to be involved in the WSO who lives in Maryland. (Applause) We have Bob B who was involved in throughout the 60s', 70s' and 80s' that I know of from Los Angeles, California. (Applause) Betty K, I was looking for you from southern California.(Applause) What I also wanted to say was this was Jimmy Ks wife and hopefully this weekend we will hear about Jimmy K and get to know Jimmy K a lot more. I hope that the people who never have to meet him will be able to feel his spirit. (Applause) Then we have three other members who are coming who are not present at this moment yet, Bo S., Jim M. and Greg P. that have been involved in our service structure basically from the 70s' and in the 80s'. They were also involved in the Basic Text and NA Tree and the beginning of the NA Way magazine. What I would like maybe at this moment is to have, before members come up and maybe share about five minutes each on what they would like to come out of this history conference and what questions they have so we can just start and roll around. (Applause)

My name is Bob and I am an addict. Hi Bob. I look forward to this conference for a number of reasons. I think that very often we need a collection of information that Billy was talking about. However, at the same time we do not need a distortion of that information. There is much information that is available and sometime we must request it or go and get it or do whatever method we have to do about getting it. One of the basic reasons why the history has not been written, because it is incomplete. Different factions as I believe that they have more history than what they really have. There is a lot of information that is trying to be pieced together and slowly by pieces and bits, that information is being put together. I will share with you anything that I have there is some stuff that came out of the office that I will try of we have photo copies to make available to anyone here because it is not hidden out . It is not being hidden away but if it is incomplete there, is no need of giving it to somebody and say here it is. There have been some vain attempts to give out some misinformation, or be misguided information, where there are other documentations that refute that information. Therefore, we do not want to have controversies of let us say, by time you issue out one document somebody come in, throw another one in your face, and say what about this. That has been a continuation of that same issue has been going on for a number of years. Primarily, hopefully, collectively that people in this room that have these bits and pieces of information will share all of the information that they have so we can get a complete and correct copy of that information for everybody. I have never hid out any information from anyone. Whenever I go out to do history workshops I lay it in the table and let everybody see what I have. To access it to think what they may about it, it is what it is and that is usually what history is all about. It is what it is not what we think it is or pretends it to be or what we wish it could be it is what it is. It stands on its own merit. Each person sometimes has to come to their own conclusion about that without being led down whatever path they are being led down. There are no bones to be picked as far as I am concerned. I think that on of the biggest things that we find out is that we have a division or sense of thinking we have a division of trying to think that we have some "they" and "we" type of mentality. I do not see it as a they and we mentality because we are addicts that are recovering in some

state or condition that is going to need a lot of help along the way. It is a changing of attitudes, learning something about working together, learning something about accepting group conscience as we were talking about. It is very difficult very often when my idea is voted against and I have to accept what the group conscience is because I do not agree with it whole-heartedly, but it is usually acceptable, it is just an alternative to my thinking. Very often, I do not want to go and let you know that you have your rights in your opinion or your thinking and sometimes I have to give that up also. So I think it is one of those places we arrive at hopefully, with intentions of finding out information that we can pass on at another time and it be correct. Not something that somebody told you or what you thought you might have heard but what you have documentation and that is the way it is. I hope that is what it is all about and if I can be of any help in anyway, telephone or otherwise I will give you any materials I have, any research things that I am doing I will share them with you. That is all I can do right now so that is it thank you. (Applause)

My name is Bill Beck and I am an addict. hi Bill. You know like Bob said I feel that a lot of things can probably be resolved in a few meetings like this. I do not see the problem as great as it has been made out to be. I see this always as I have always seen it a simple program for complicated people. I think we have all heard that, I think that it is a lot of individuals that have a few things here and there trying to do the best that they could do. You know whatever I try to share; tomorrow I am going to try to share. I have always been a real on the table kind of a person to the extent that I became very controversial at one time. I want to tell you one of the things that Jimmy K uses to say and the fact is I do not like Jimmy K I like Jimmy Kinnon. I mean he is dead so it isn't breaking anyone's anonymity so we might as well say it like it is right. I am not Bill B. I am Bill Beck. I think that when we take a look at this in its simplest form and that we realize that the reason why we got here is because we have been in a state of controversy of which Jimmy Kinnon said is all right as long for the addict to be as long as it was within our fellowship. If we take our controversy out of the fellowship then we are breaking out traditions. The controversy in fact can help us to maintain our own personal sobriety. I mean I don' know about you man but I get a resentment I got to go work the steps on it man and grow a little bit because I have had my feelings hurt many, many times and it has become a real growing situation. You know there is sobriety amongst adversity. You cant do anything, I mean once you get into this game and you get into service and you get into having an interest about this thing called Narcotics Anonymous you know your future is much more insured than it would have been if we were all out knick-knackin, paddy-wackin on a corner somewhere. Then there are others that are out here just sort of like floating around and they are as I was, I mean it took me about twelve years before I found out that it was a program of total abstinence you know. That is I was so amazed when George told me you do not take anything, so I think we learn slowly but we learn surely. I think some things are going to be revealed this weekend. I think we are going to look at the simplicity of this situation. I think there is going to be a lot of fruit for thought and you know truth always prevails. Of course, there is o question in my mind because I know the truth. I mean Jimmy Kinnon was the founder of Narcotics Anonymous; he always will be the founder of Narcotics Anonymous. So I am really looking forward to hear the things I am going to hear. I am really looking forward to being able to share whatever it is that I can share. I will answer freely questions here r if you see me walking around to the best of my ability. Thank you. (Applause)

Hi my name is Fawn. I am an addict. Hi Fawn. I am here because I heard Betty was coming here and I wanted to come with her and my friend Bill made the trip even more worth it. I hope something will come out good out of all this. I really like your opening remarks a lot Bill and it is funny back there when you were asking questions. A lot of times one thing that I remember was the issue that came to my mind was exposure. I think a lot of the controversy or a lot of the things we have today involving some of the problems stem from way back along long time ago. Thirty-year-old resentments, twenty-year-old resentments and I think, I am here because I want to make sure that none of these resentments or problems stand in the way from acknowledging who the founder was and giving credit where credit is due. I am here to just hear some information and I hope, sometimes I think that NA just needs a healing you know. I do not that going to happen other than people just telling the truth. I do not think the truth has always been very spiritual or nice. I am just here because I am interested and I care, that is it.

I am Betty and I am an addict. Hi Betty, thank you. Well I am here because I talked to Bill and Carl and they were telling me how the fellowship can get together and how we do not have to be mad at one another anymore. My reaction was right away well I do not know if I get here, I have to tell it as it is I am just one of those people. If I come here, what will I do if I come here and see some of these people that shot at us or tried to hurt us and do all

these things and I thought I just have such a hard time talking to these people yet and I thought the fellowship really needs some mending, it needs mending badly. You know our checks and balances for me are out of whack you know and I would like to see the history written but number one I would like to see the book written about Jimmy K, Jimmy Kinnon as Bill said. You know I drive down the street just before I came out here, I am driving along the street and I see a bumper sticker and it says I am a friend of Bill W. and you know on my bumper it says I am a friend of Jimmy K. so I drove ahead of this car. (Applause) But you know there are so many people that I think in California that will loose so much, they loved NA and it should not be taken away from them. Like Bob and Bill, you know a lot of these guys you know to me it is like when it first started it was very hard I imagine. I use to listen to Jimmy talk about how these use to go in a whole bunch of groups and they use to go on a 12th step call together a whole bunch of them. They would just overtake this person, you know because they were all scared to death that they would use if they went 12th stepping so here they would clinging to one another, poor guy was scared to death. You know it must have been very hard and so a lot of people you know I do not want to see them lost along the way. Our history is what is really important and the true facts and you can write as many books as you want to. I have to tell you a lot of them get pretty pissed off at me at times but I tell them I have things that a lot of them do not have. When Jimmy passed away, there were things up in the attic that had never been seen and I have those things, I have quite a bit of things. You know it is kind of like at one time it was different things have happened, you know I am standing on my tiptoes I feel very short. No that is all right I am just verbalizing, but at one time you know I received a letter from the office and I was asked after so many years of them using a tape I was asked if I would please sign over this tape to the office and anything pertaining to this tape. It is like I am looking at this and reading and thinking what is this "anything pertaining to this tape" and I just filed it. I talked to other people in the program and we discussed that and decided that was not the proper thing for me to do. There are people have given me things and asked me to hang on to them you know and when I talk to them they say please do not let go of these things yet it is not time yet. You know our getting together, you know I have a hell of a time talking to Bob, it is like Bob and I get around together and it is like it starts almost as a conversation and then I am like turning away I have to tell it as it is, hahaha Bob is laughing. I do not know how I am going to be around some of these others you know it is going to be very strange. You know it is kind of, like I do not know how to really describe, in a lot of ways I am use to street language. So I do I clean up this, you know some times I feel like "Fuck Um".(Applause)

You know I love the addict and I love this program so much and I don't want to see it broken up, I don't want to see it broken up no way. When Jimmy was kicked out of the office and he was kicked out, you know if some of you do not know. He was, he went to the office one day and the door was locked you know he was out. He came home and he cried, we both cried because we love this fellowship so much. I am kind of jumping around a lot of people have put a lot of in this you know people even the newcomer who is coming in today has put a lot of love in this and a lot of faith. There is no reason for people going back out or going to another fellowship. Oh speaking of that I have to tell you, here we go, here we go Carl. I hear that maybe we will be writing, talking about other fellowships so as long as we are at it maybe we should put the PTA in there and some of the others. From what I understand this is the NA History and so maybe coming together will give, I hope this will all come out. I have been saying like please God, Higher Power or guide or whatever just let me say and let me do what is right and I have heard others saying and doing the same thing. I hope this does come out right I sincerely do and I would like to see that book written, oh God I would like to see that book written. Carla and Bill have listened to me over and over on this and they would like to see this book written. I am glad to be here, I really am, thank you. (Applause)

I am Grateful Dave and I am an addict. Hi Dave. Hi, family one of the things I would like to see out of this weekend is just like everybody to lay everything they feel out on the table. It was said that there is no controversy that we cannot handle as long as it is kept inside the fellowship. I know a lot about controversy that has been taken out into the public (Laughter) I probably have the dubious distinction of being the only addict that has ever been sued by Narcotics Anonymous in Federal Court. I am just here to let you know that I am going back. (Applause) Because when that book was written and this fellowship was put together it was put together for the public trust and for the public benefit and it was not suppose to be Narcotics Anonymous Inc. and that is what Narcotics Anonymous has turned in to today, it has turned into Narcotics Anonymous Inc. All of us are just being we are more or less wage slaves. We send the money out there, they pay the wages, and basically, we do not get anything for it. There has been over twenty million dollars in the past six-year's total gross income and we have nothing to show for it. You know

Jimmy wrote something one time he said" politics make strange bedfellows" and one of the reasons our history has not been told is because of politics. Here we are from probably every conceivable political spectrum and ilk and we are all here strange bedfellows. Some of us want to have the history told the way we want it told and some of us want it told the way they want it told. I think that really we are just going to have to just put it out on the table the way we see it and respect each other. I know many people do not agree with the way I see historical things, but they should agree with my absolute right to say and state what I believe and so should the other person that does not believe as I believe have the same respect to say it. If we are going lay it out lay it all out and let God sort it out. I believe we need to know the documents we need to know what it is and we need to find a way to reproduce the things where they do not get away from the rightful owners and the rightful owners are the Kinnon Family. In order to settle these issues once and for all we need to have that information. We need to have that documentation certified, notarized copies that are freely available through orders and subscriptions. Through the telling of that early history of Narcotics Anonymous, we will probably uncover some skeletons. We will probably open up a Pandora's Box of things that may even cause more questions to be asked than answers to our current situation. I do not know I cut open a golf ball one time, it is real tough on the outside, and there are a lot of stretch rubber stings until you get to the core. It is the core that we are looking for you know and we have to go through a lot of hard shit and a lot of bouncy Teflon rubber you know people with an agenda and things to hide to get to that final core of the truth you know. Perceiving the truth is difficult at times when you throw in the disease of addiction. I have learned that I can grow through any controversy as if working the steps is controversy. It causes controversy in me, I want to go and die, see, and that is controversial to work the steps to go the other way and live. So our program is about controversy, it is about growth you know because if we all sit around and there is never anything to challenge ourselves then why would the newcomer want to be apart of this? Because we will, all be spiritually dead robots walking and talking the same way. That is basically what has happened. We have taken out the , it seems to me that we have taken out the individualism and the creative spirit and that type of stuff and we are all marching to the same tune like I have seen ducks walk across the road and I mean it is like what the hell. I think we need to quit profiteering on Narcotics Anonymous you know we need to have thirty-cent Basic Texts and penny pamphlets and get about the business of returning this fellowship to the addict. We have got work to do. Thanks (Applause)

Speaker: Bill - Okay I will thank the people who came up and one thing I want as I sat there listening, I can hear real good with those headphones. Lawrence gave me something here it says Sigmund File. It is suppose to be the stuff sent to the office, I just paged through it, and it is like I heard Bob talk up here. It is not, it is a bias collection, this letter was never even filed or documented. The stuff we did in Pennsylvania and West Virginia and we sent out about the fourth Edition. There is a lot of stuff in here about the fourth Edition but never the stuff that was sent from Pennsylvania that multi regions worked on, it is not even in there. For our history to be collected, all of that type information has to be put into file and gone over not just. What we are going to do is copy this here and people will be able to get this at the cost of what it costs to operate the machines that we rented this weekend so they can see. I will also attach this letter, two letters not just one from this area that we participated in but also Philadelphia Area of NA concerning issues of Traditions 4 and 9. You know Philadelphia Area is outraged for the following reasons. I just need to, yeah

Bob: Question, are we going to get any of the information that other people have to go into because I think what you have is a worksheet and it is not complete and not something that someone could go by and give you some guides. We need a whole lot of pages in between there, we need the pages in between is what we need is to do what we are here for.

Bill: Well this is what Lawrence gave to me okay, but this stuff was also sent to the WSO

Bob: That is beside the point; we got a lot of other stuff that is not in there also

Bill: Bob, all this stuff we will get into

Bob: I am just saying we need to get the other stuff that needs to go in there also, that is all I am asking.

Bill: All the material that we collect this weekend will be available okay at the cost of the machines that is what they were rented for. Okay, all of it, if you got anything that is not in here we have two copy machines that we will be making available here. Anybody that has brought stuff or has archives. We have a room over here that will be locked up when it is not open. It is an archive room that we put together and it is very large okay there is a lot of room so if anybody brought anything to please bring it over. The machines will be there for the purpose of copying for the cost of the machines. I want to thank Lawrence for bringing this and if you have anything to say come up and say it.

I am Lawrence and I am an addict. I live in California now and just about fifteen minutes away from the WSO. I am here to tell you that I am welcome with open arms but I am not ask to stay and that is okay that is not my shit. I just stand for what I believe in and try consistent with it. You know there is a lot of stuff just like Bob was saying me and Bob happen to be roommates this weekend and he showed me some stuff very similar to this that he put in a packet that he put together and a lot of that stuff is not in here. There is also some thing that I thought was historical that dismantling of the Spanish Basic Text translation literature committee. I believe that is very significant and it a recent occurrence and that is not in there either. I have a proposal that was put together from the BOT that was given to every committee member without a BOT letterhead and that is not in there either. I am sure that if we are persistent, we use, as Malcolm X would say any means necessary we might get what we need, and we might get what we really need. It just I brought this same issue up with Bob and he could not believe that the BOT give us a blank proposal without a letterhead on it. I am here to tell you I have copies of that. I brought a duffle bag of stuff. I do not know what is in it you know I collect everything that I can get my hands on. One of the advantages of trying to be tactful and diplomatic while visiting the WSO is maybe sometimes you can attract more with honey than vinegar. There are a lot of people thinking that I am not returning to California but I am and it is not because I want to it is because I have a responsibility to. I have a wife and I have a child and we are having a lot of difficulties, my marriage is on the rocks just say it like that. But just like my relationship with Bill and my relationship with everyone in here, it means enough to me to make it work out. You know if there is some stress there I need to try to work it out I need to take a look at my stuff. In California, they call it issues, my stuff and try to work it out. Being in California has been very enlightening you know and I don't mean that in a bad sense it has just been very different for me being from the east coast it has just been very different for me. Having the opportunity to attend my first WSC was very difficult for me too. Especially when they have open forums and a member cannot actually step to the microphone but a special worker can. I have a problem with that because I am paying that special worker just like you are by what we put in the basket and what we buy in terms of literature and all of that stuff. I have a problem with that because I think that creates conflict. It creates a conflict of interest. You know it creates the influence kind of factor. I really did not get to know Jimmy on the intimate level but I did get the opportunity to hug him when I was a newcomer at the World Convention in New York. Just being able to chat a couple of words with him, I was able to feel something that was driving him. I am not saying, I think we are all apart of the history. Everyday we wake up clean and go to a Narcotics Anonymous meeting that is history. Recover is controversial as far as I am concerned, it is a radical concept you know because what I know how to do is self-destruct and try to destroy other people. So this is totally un-natural for me to go against what I am doing here. I scratched the money together to come here because I thought it was very important. Last year I had a conversation with Bo Sewell and you know he mentioned that maybe we need to do a history literature addathon or something like that. I do not know what it was I just went to the home group, this home group here that is putting on this activity and Joe has always been like a constant in my life. When I do not expect to see him, I see him. I threw up, I do not know what kind of motion I made but anyway the group took it over and this is what is happening today, this is an extension of it. I try to remember now and I try to figure where the group conscience meetings are at and I either try to call the church or the home where the group conscience is going to be held and I have caught you guys a few times like that. (Laughter) You know it is hard to talk about group conscience, as we know it here on the east coast as compared to the way it is in California. My experience has been that there is no group conscience in California, and I do not mean that in a demeaning way I just think there is no group conscience. I dint think I mean there are home meetings but just no home group. That is something I would like to see brought out in this workshop here is the history of group conscience, the history of home group, you know how we feel in home group about one other and how we learn how to serve. They actually say that groups are not responsible enough anymore to make decisions regarding group conscience I think is a lie. Because I know, I have experienced that. So yeah, this is my donation, I just want the original because I collect stuff, and I collect whatever I can find. You are more than welcome to it. Thank you. (Applause)

Speaker: Bill - I was going to say I want to apologize but I do not need to apologize it is for the Alabama person that is coming up from the Alabama history committee that is not present right now. He is on his way and hopefully for God he will make it. He left Alabama with fifty dollars in his pocket to get to Tennessee to go to work, he is waiting to be paid on Wednesday, and then he was heading up to Pittsburgh to meet somebody and head in. He was going to loan money in Pittsburgh so he could gas to go back home again and he has four files with him of what they have collected and hopefully he is going to make it here. There is a history conference next month in Alabama and hopefully some people can make it there too but Carl as some, what did you call that. I will just let you come up and explain it yourself Carl.

I am an addict named Carl just trying to get real. One of the things that got me interested in Narcotics Anonymous history is its incompleteness. Where we had come from, what developed Billy's home group in Allentown had started in December of 89 to look at a project, a short meeting took place I think just a single day in 89, and then the summer of 90 they had an addathon. So I got involved so over the last year and a half my phone bill really indicates that I had an interest in seeing something done with NA History. The addathon last year gave us a view from a number of members. Fawn contributed an overview of the office, we received a letter from one of the early chairs well actually the first chair of the first region of Narcotics Anonymous giving an overview of what he felt was the developmental period in the late 70s and early 80s. We reviewed history of the Basic Text; it was the collection of the stuff that was missing out of the formats that we are talking about. At that same period of time as we became more involved in other controversies Alabama and I am not speaking for Grover who should be here attempted to put together a weekend. At that particular weekend, it evolved into being basically a collection of more information on writing the Basic Text with four very important members of that process. The afternoon session that might have been something else ended up pretty much being a free for all. But out of that began a process, and the first process that I can find any documentation for was the literature committee of 82 pretty much putting an Ad Hoc Committee together to begin compiling the history of Narcotics Anonymous. Until earlier this year, it was believed that, all that information was lost. We have since received a packet of about twelve states or cities that in the late 82 and early 83 had sent in histories. Since that time the Ad Hoc Committee in Alabama has become a permanent committee and has continued to progress towards achieving a collection of what seems at least to me so far from what I have seen from the committee a chronological history. That is much of what was contained in the 82 and 83 material when the meeting started where they were etc. In that 82 document from the literature committee they had a questionnaire asking that sort of thing, who, what, where, why, how many. To that end on the Saturday at the conference in Alabama last year we had an open forum session for about four or five hours trying to discuss how were we going to work towards compiling the history of Narcotics Anonymous into that end and the title ended up being "Guide to collecting historical information about Narcotics Anonymous". It was an overview of how we were going to collect the material. Betty was reading it this afternoon and found some of our more humorous comments like "This effort will be attacked, use tolerance patience and know we are right". I don't know how right we will be I think one of the important things is one of the things Dave mentioned that it is very important for us to put the literature together with all of the viewpoints and for the individuals to sort. The other comment I think was "Avoid Politics" well there is no way in Narcotics Anonymous. I do not think that from my viewpoint that recovery is controversial. What happen in our meetings are miracles and that as we realize our services that are where our politics enters. That is where our controversies and that is where our difficulties have continued to come from. To that end, we have input sheets from that particular workshop. What needs to be included in collecting them, these will be available, as I have made ten or twelve copies already. For me the spirit of the history of Narcotics Anonymous the world needs to know. I think we need and deserve being very proud of what we do. We have created a situation that was unheard of in mans history and we need to respect that foundation and the individuals involved and learn from our mistakes. Much of what I have collected in history and archives in Narcotics Anonymous point to the same sort of difficulties reoccurring again and again. I believe if we collect a history that actually looks at some of the personalities and looks at some of the things that we do to each other, which are sometimes pretty shitty, that maybe we will not continue to do them. But even more so that when we get involved in service and that time comes when somebody is pointing the finger at you you'll know that you are not alone, that it is not so different for you to take the brunt of somebody else's opposition. That when you are out in front you get shot at when you take a stand somebody is there to cut you down. I know that something like that would have helped tremendously in my recovery and in my

service involvement because that would have given me the opportunity to not feel so different. If I had known that all of those things had been done to all of you that came before me maybe, it would not have had to hurt so much. Maybe that is part of the process but I think it is apart of the process that we can change. So after all of those phone calls and after all of that time trying to figure out how to progress I hope we will write a feeling document instead of a ca-chunk, a-chunk, ca-chunk. I do not think that is what we are looking for at least with the people who have been involved in this end of the process. We hope that we can come out on the other end using what Alabama has done, using what was done in 83, using the experience of our members with twenty or thirty years and ten years and five years and ten days. Therefore, that we can do something for the benefit of us all and for the benefit a world that does not know about us, that does not know our history. They do not know the miracles that happened here. Maybe we can just get on with it. We have attempted to place an agenda together that covers some of the main issues that have yet to come. We have sort of avoided the 80s because there is just so many more people that we are going to need to have show up at a place like this and so many more negotiators to manage them all in the same room on the same weekend. Hopefully we will learn some of that here, maybe some of those resentments and some of that pain, Billy mentioned that some of those people that use to work together would once more work together. That it can be over with, it is time to get on with it, and that those same mistakes do not continue. I am excited about it, I love archival material. I collect any piece of literature that I can find because we do not seem to produce any anymore. So it is time for us to look at doing that, there is quite a bit of that in the archive room and that stuff will be available. Use our resources as Billy said we want to open up and find out what you would like to know and what you think is important to be contained in this history document. What sort of information is pertinent to you today, you know what sort of focus that might have and maybe a little bit more so, what the hell you going to do to help. There have been a few of us struggling and trying to figure out what, when, where, and how, we already know why. But we need your help to be able to accomplish that. So hopefully this weekend as we get farther along into that agenda you see that Saturday Night we left most of the night open which is great for addicts and we will figure out where we are going from here. I hope you will all come and hold on and write it for all it is worth. Thanks (Applause)

My name is Frank and I am an addict. Hi Frank. I am going to try not to get emotional, it is hard not to though. I grew up in a real large family, my father was always messed up, my mother was always messed up and my sisters and brothers were always messed up but we never knew each other. I never knew where I came from. I hit my first meeting in 1973, I tried for a lot of years to get into recovery, and I bounced and bounced and bounced. I finally got into recovery a few years back and I wanted to be apart of I wanted to feel like I belonged. From the very first day I felt good but I really did not feel like I belonged you know I was always involved in controversy. No matter what I did, I was involved in controversy, the home group you know I wanted a nice tight home group and it did not come about until recently. Then I got involved in area and I wanted the area to be real close and that really did not happen. There were always many items a lot of controversy and many resentments going on and right up to region. I was always one who wanted to know where I came from. I never really believed my father was my father, I never really believed my mother was my mother and I always felt like I was the odd guy on the block. My whole life I always felt like the odd guy on the block. Now between, with shame and pride I can tell you that in my region that I have more archives and history than the region you know. I have a better history put together; my area does not even have a history. People would just throw stuff away they did not care about it; you know it did not matter to them. I go up to our RSO and I need to say my wife works there. She is not in the fellowship and I would go up there and find stuff in the wastebasket, stuff that meant a lot to stuff and me that meant a lot to the people who really cared about Narcotics Anonymous and where we came from. It uses to really tear me up to see this stuff wasted and thrown away. When I found out about this conference I was real angry because I found out there were others before this and I did not know. I know deep down in my heart that it was kept from me people would not tell me about it because they did not want me to find out. I would say to sponsor I want to know about this and he would say it is on a need to know basis and you do not need to know. I would call World Service and try to find out about history, you know where did we come from, how did we start? They would tell me we do not have a history put together and I would call another day and they would say it is not done yet, send me what you got. I would tell them what I had and they would say send me what you got. This is all truth, I am not saying it because I heard it here today but I sure as hell identify with the feelings that people were sharing here today. For me you know I feel that it is real important in the spirit of what I was taught in Narcotics Anonymous, to share and care the NA way. That this weekend we work together, not keep anything from each other, and just let things happen. If I give you, what I have and you give me what you have then

we can come up with a history. We can come up with a history; we can come up with a history. We have it, I know we do I know we have it. We have to put our prides and our egos aside and we have to do what is right. For me a lot of times like when I go to a meeting I try to share my experience, strength and hope. I try to share where I came from; I try to share what I am doing with my life today. I also share abut history, I shared about how I first meeting started and I shared about the floating type meetings we had. I have shared about standing on the corner waiting for a car to come by and pick us up to go to a meeting because there was none around. I share all that, that we are fortunate today. In my area alone we have seventy some odd meetings you know in our area. On any given day, I can go to three or four meetings, on any given day. You know when I first came around if I could get to one or two meetings a week I was lucky and there is a real need for me to know where did it all start. You know I am Italian and I know I am Italian because people tell me I am Italian. I want to know my grandfather, my grandmother, they are still alive, I want to know my cousins and I want to know my sister and brothers. I will be damned if I will allow anybody to tear Narcotics Anonymous apart. You know it saved my life and I will do everything in my power to keep it going, to keep it going. My worst nightmare is the same nightmare that most of us have, to walk into a house one day and not have a meeting there. I believe in welcoming the newcomer in, people were there for me and feel like it is my responsibility to be there for the newcomer. I cannot imagine anybody telling the newcomer to sit down and shut up, stay stupid you will learn more. My sponsor use to tell me stay stupid you will be okay you know and I use to get real angry because all my life I was stupid you know. Today like in over four years in recovery I have never missed a holiday with my wife and kids, and I didn't' have the money to come here, and it was real hard to call Bill up and talk to him about not having money. I am a Joe Macho; they use to call me the mayor of Putman Corner. I always had money and a flashy car, but today I didn't have the money to come here, I didn't have the money but it meant so much to me that I talked to my wife and I talked to my friends . I got a ride here, I talked to Bill, and I told him I want to be here. I do not know the point I am trying to make is it is just so important that we do this together, not separately. It is not for me to put my history together and for you to put your history together and then try to match them up you know. Let us put the histories together, together and I think we are going to be ok. Thanks (Applause)

Speaker: Bill - I want to thank you for sharing. What time is the meeting supposes to, we started late right. Okay, let them run, who wants to go next?

Montgomery History Conference 1991
Tape 2
Speaker: Bob B.

Lawrence. Reading: The Twelve Traditions of Narcotics Anonymous.

Speaker: Bill - This morning what we are going to do is go over the 50s, 60s, and any other information on Narcotics Anonymous. We have Bob B. Bill B. and Betty if she is up she is on her way. So what we will do is have Bob start the workshop off.

My name is Bob and I am an addict. Hi Bob. Good morning and I hope you all had a good nights rest and I know you didn't because I know most of you were up with me. Laughter) I think one of the things that we were talking about where Narcotics Anonymous came from and did not come from. I think initially we can say we came from God; it was a present from God. The need existed and somebody tried to fill that particular need. Much of what is deep into the controversy probably in terms of history is concerned is where it came from, where the name originated, who was initially involved and I think one of the things is, is that I think we have to realize there are many pioneers in terms of discovery of things happening. Just like there are many concepts or ideas that come into the religious folds, they say they come from different leanings and so forth. Trying to obtain the same goal, ours happen to be recovery from our addiction and how do you best help addicts, and you are talking about a time when we think that it is a new era when we are thinking about our recovery or the need for a place to recover. That was not so because I think the were a number of times that there were vain attempts to start something to help the addict to recover, not too much success, the nature of the disease itself and the social attitude and people acceptance as to whether addicts were

treatable or not became part of the question.

But during one of their amazing discoveries at this particular time they said what they would do was that the government decided they would isolate the addicts so they could put them under the microscope and study them very intensely so they could see what they could do about dealing with addicts at large. If we had them in one place maybe, we can tell what to do and how to do it and by deep analysis or discussion, we could come up with some idea of how we could help these poor souls. Because addiction has been around for a lot of years not just in terms of talking about 30s and 40s we are talking about going back into the 1800s they had problems with addiction. They had whole nations; China had a big drug problem. They almost lost all of China due to drug addiction. They found out it was a controlling factor in terms of dealing with addiction. Dealing with a country or dealing with people, if you kept them addicted they had lost the will to resist and that was how you control. They had a big controlling factor, opium wars that went on for years and lost whole dynasties as a result of drug addiction. So drug addiction is not new, how they dealt with it was becoming a new concept. They say what do you do about it very often the case was you hide them away, stow them away, throw them away whatever the idea was at the time as to that is how you treat drug addicts. You just isolate them, keep them in confinement wait for them to clean up and then let them go again, and to do that over and over again and so you always have a repeat performance in terms of what you were doing in terms of recovery. But all of you may think they call it recovery, they use to say getting well. They did not know that it was an ongoing process that went on rather than talk about getting well. During the early 20s they said to have come up with an idea that they needed, one place they needed to do in this isolation thing was to open up a hospital so they would have a facility to do this great study. Even after 20 years of study, they did not really come up with any real conclusions of what to do with addicts. They know that they lied and that they loved candy bars, they knew that you now. (Laughter) The rest of it they say was kind of vague, they knew some of the characteristics they knew what some of the addicts would do, they knew that it was a continuing thing, that they came back and came back and came back. During that time, they say that is when they established the United States hospital down in Lexington and one down in Fort Worth after that, but they had still been trying to understand what the addict was all about. What happened was they say that an onset say AA had started a little movement on the east coast and it seemed to take off like wild fire. Then came along some other people about the same time that said they were not dealing with that particular concept of alcohol being a drug. They thought it was something else and they thought it was different. Somebody came up with the idea they said that maybe those concepts and ideas would work and so as a result of that, this is probably where some of the issues come up in terms of saying where it started and did not start and so forth. The idea, the name was all the publications that I have seen pointed to people that participated in that exercise during that particular time. Some of them are still alive and some of them wrote their own case histories as to where they came from and what they were involved in.

I have here in, I think there is a copy in the back to be copied that will give you reference to some of these people that were around at that time. What they call at that particular time what we are talking about in the 40s, a thing called Narcotics Anonymous, but it was called a number of other things prior to that. They called them Addicts Anonymous, Narco Group and they called it a number of things until probably in 1948 or 49 when Danny Carlson got out from Lexington and kind of spearheaded an idea that under the auspices of the Salvation Army seemed to be kind of in the forefront of helping people. One of the few places that I donate to without any problems with is Salvation Army and it is because they seem to always be available when a person comes and sticks out their hand and says I need help they will usually will go out of their way to get you some help. It was usually providing facilities for people to house them or keep them or to rehabilitate or to help them in any type pf venture that they thought was worthwhile. They would give Danny a meeting, subsequent to that he started a meeting in New York, he started a meeting in Lexington, and they called it Narcotics Anonymous it was that simple in that respect. However, one of the things that happen during these periods of times they say is that there was no meeting place there was no central headquarters or no central point of functioning. No place to say who do you call, you had to get in touch with this particular person by going to the Salvation Army and saying what night is the meeting on so to speak, and they would tell you Thursday, Friday Saturday whatever the night the meeting was and that was when you got there when that meeting was. I guess whoever was there was who started the meeting and the thing of home groups and such was kind of unheard of. It kind of followed the pattern of AA or the AA concept but they still called themselves Narcotics Anonymous but they were kind of undercover. It was kind of undercover due to the laws of the land at that particular time. The laws of the

land stated that addicts did not congregate people that had been felony or on parole could not congregate, so they were almost like an undercover operation. It could not be out in the open it could let be known that they were congregating because the police had bad attitudes about drug addicts and they would maintain that attitude for a long time. They still some of them have that attitude but it has changed market ably because of our own, what we experience today we are able to do all these things that we were not able to do for many years.

During this time as I said we had many attempts at trying to start and maintain the idea of addicts helping another. I have two articles here, on the table here that were part of the conflict was they said , the question arises out of these articles out of 19, well speaks back to early 1940s or the mid 40s to Narcotics Anonymous. I mean whatever you want to think of it is okay, I mean the articles were written and people come to me and say well what about this or what about this. Or they come and bring me one of these people's articles. A fellow wrote where some of these people wrote a case history or a story about themselves which you will find in this reference here of as to that story what book it is in, go to the library, go to the store and buy the book where he references through their recovery in Narcotics Anonymous that proceeds 1953. For whatever you want to do with that is okay it has nothing to do with what we are here for, I think we are talking about information or non information or whatever you want to call it.

So but one of the problems during this time as I said where they would like to state in these particular articles which jumping up is Danny Carlson's name and there are a number of articles of the same type that are around and exist which brings up questions very often in terms of our history. Talking about our history, I think we are talking about new beginnings and I think this is where we are coming into a time to talk about new beginnings. The new beginnings are that we have a number of pioneers that become involved in that new beginning. Because I think some of these ideas have been transferred, transplanted, or transported from one place to another and they arrive at a certain destination and they say let us try it here too. Those pioneers who were open enough or far thinking enough to present the idea, as we know it today. Amongst those people at that time was Jimmy Kinnon, and probably one reason that he stands out very vividly is because of the work that he put into and the dedication that he put into maintaining, opening the doors, keeping the doors open and being the person that you could contact when you could not contact anybody else. Very simple, I would not be here today if I could not have picked up the telephone and called Jimmy Kinnon, very simple. I probably would not be here if my wife had not picked up the phone prior to me getting here and called Jimmy Kinnon. Actually, she called Jimmy Kinnon's wife, and Jimmy Kinnon's wife told her about this organization Narcotics Anonymous and did she want to talk to her husband that has this meeting going on in Studio City. So my wife took the information of where they were going to meet and how to get there and gave me instructions about let's go to this meeting or let's go check this out and I sent her to the meeting because I was not ready to clean up. The thing is the contact was made and subsequent to that, because of the pressures of family and so forth. With the case of you are going to have to do something about your that shit that stuff you are doing, because the reason I hooked up with her was because she was going to help me get my shit together. Part of the thing was we are going to have to go and get some help. Now there were not that many places to go and get help in 1959 they were far and few between. Lexington was one of them and I think I still have an application for Lexington floating around in my papers over here. But I use to carry one in my pocket at all times because when I went down to the court I was always going to lay it on them, what are you going to do about your problem Mr. Barrett. I have my application to go to Lexington, huh. Along with that application to go to Lexington I had that little yellow book down there with Narcotics Anonymous on the front of it and I am, trying to get, my shit together and they would tell him "lock him up". You know because I came with that it was a regular thing, I came with these things and I am going to get it together tomorrow. My application has not been accepted yet, and I am just waiting to go this place in the sky to get my stuff together. So you can understand that my attitude about addiction because I was one of those guys that had some preconceived ideas that I was going to be an addict forever. That is what everybody told me. I was led to believe that I was hopeless, the military had gotten rid of me and put me out on the street and told me go for it, and I was going for it the best way I knew how. You know everybody's store, every time somebody would lay, something down I would snatch it and go. So I would go to jail just to come back out and to ruin my health all over again through the same process, but I would always go back to the meetings to see who was there. I would go back and make my inspection. They use to ask me, Bob when you get out you want me to come down and, we could go to a meeting or we could talk. It was always the case of, no, I will see you later, I will get there, and I will see you at the meeting. Always had to stop in between the jailhouse and the meeting you know for old time's sake a little taste and I always

ended up with another case. But they would always come visit me when I got locked up. They would always come visit me and write me letters to me but they would never put any money on the books, never put any money on the books. That is all they would allow was three dollars anyhow on the books, but they would never put that three dollars on the books. I would look forward to a visit I would think I am going to get duckets, nope no money just a letter and a how you doing Bob, you want us to come and pick you up when you get out. No, it was a constant thing at that. I think that the vigilance that went on here at this particular time and the person that was available for this information was was Jimmy. That was a contact point. In other words, we had a telephone; we also had a post office box that we would maintain. The fact is the Post Office maintained that box even when we were not paying. They would say we know you are going to catch it up, we know you are going to pay it off later. They knew we had problems with money, called none we did not have any. It was always the case of if you needed to print you would have to start literally months ahead of time in order to raise a hundred dollars for the printing. I am talking about a hundred dollars for the printing; we are not talking about a thousand dollars for printing. However, we were lucky along this line because we had another person in the program that had a printing company but he just could not keep carrying Narcotics Anonymous forever or what we knew as Narcotics Anonymous at times forever. So it was always the case of say we always paid our bill eventually, it was always a struggle but we got a bill today and we would have to get an extra dollar here and get the dollars together and go pay this bill for our printing. But as I said, I got out of places and came back to meetings during those early years. It was always a case of, not the same people there. With all the years, you would want the same person there and that was usually Jimmy. He would be sitting by the coffee pot reading the book and saying come on in you know and it was a constant thing of come on in let's talk. I think I spent numerous hours after meeting in distant places, on the side of roads in coffee shops or wherever talking to Jimmy in his dream in his ideas as to his hopes for Narcotics Anonymous. It was a slow process because as I said the attitude, the social attitude at that particular time it was of such you did not talk of addicts to readily. You did not congregate to many addicts together at any given place without some suspicions being aroused. Therefore, we had some difficultly in terms of trying to lessen the feelings, threatened about going to meeting because there was always a fear that you were going to be picked up before you got to a meeting or be picked up after you left the meeting. They were sitting there, very often, you would come out of the meeting and look down the block and one of those cars was sitting down the block. You know because they had heard somewhere that addicts were going to congregate and they did not giving a damn about Narcotics Anonymous. Whatever it implied it did not mean nothing to them they knew they were swooping up addicts and that is what they were doing, swooping them up, locking them up. At the same time, I think what was happening here there were more people being exposed to this thing called Narcotics Anonymous by the exposure and the printing of that little yellow book was one of the things of exposure. You had something concrete, and it was only a few pages in it, there were questions on the front of it, it had what the program was and the steps, and some of that was misprinted. See we did not have a lot of proofreaders at that time like we have today. We did not give a shit about the proof reading and the, this, thus and they's were and the periods and commas were in the right lace. If it was misspelled and you understood what it was, you understood, what it was you did not have to worry about the misspelling. The steps did not change and recovery is in the steps not all this here other text and things we bring around it. Now very often even n the reading I had great difficulty with reading anyhow as far as text was concerned. My head I could read the word properly I put the comma and period in the proper place but my head would change it, it would alter the meaning the words would change and it did not mean what it said anyhow as far as my head was concerned. So I usually had to go to another individual to explain it to me and they made it very simple, they would make it very simple of how it worked. They would talk about formulas, they talked about recipes, they talked about all these things and made it very simple for me because I tend to have a problem with understanding what is being said. Because even in the first step I could not get the concept of being powerless over my addiction, because the first thing we use to talk about was I am a dope fiend. First thing, damn near everyone around the table to see how further out they can be in a meeting. They would how I am a dirty dope fiend; well I am a slimy dope fiend, well I we always tried to do one up on everybody else. So it was not understanding what the first step was even talking about cause we nothing about the nature of the disease called addiction and we had these teachers like Jimmy that would have to teach us what addiction was about. That is where we needed to have that learning taking place is in understanding what we are reading. It was always the case as I said one of the things I could always rely on is if I needed to talk to somebody I could call Jimmy, because if you were like me my phone was cut off most of the time, if I had a phone. It was a continual thing of not only being cut off.

I think one of the things that happen here is that we carry the message. We become the messenger by our contact with one another because people ask us, where you been , what you been doing and you will pass on perhaps , if they say man I need some help, and I say well have you ever tried Narcotics Anonymous? I may have not even been clean and telling them to try Narcotics Anonymous, because between 1959 and 61 I did not stay clean. I was making that revolving door, but at the same time, I kept that book and I mashed it on other people. Boy have you ever read this, hell of a concept here man, shit damn man check this out. Not that I was doing it but in them moments of clarity I seemingly had some substance to go by or some direction to follow when I choose to follow them, see because I did not choose to follow them. The idea of me cleaning up with somebody else was ridiculous. I made vain attempts to try to make it look like I was trying to clean up for another individual and that did not work. So we reach that point of crisis I think that usually occur is most of our lives that we clean up or die, very simple, clean up or die. Now some people choose to die and that is very unfortunate, but once you have come to Narcotics Anonymous you have heard the direction and know the steps the responsibility is yours, you cannot give it to nobody else, the responsibility is yours. It does not need no great amount of text to go around that because the formula is in the 12 steps but first me must understand the concepts and the ideas of what those 12 steps mean. We must understand those steps and there is always a process that goes along in understanding what it said, not what you think is going on, you must know by the process.

So it is an ongoing process what happened during this particular time we are talking about the early 60s now is I had to go do some time because I owed the state some time so I went up to Hatchbee. Once again, they sent me some books. Jimmy one more time sent me some books into Tahatchbee to start a meeting. I kept contact and I think I had some kind of desire to want to do something about what was happening because the things that they told me were happening to me. They talked about jails institutions and dieing, the only thing I had not done yet was die. I had come close to that on a number of occasions but my last occasion I had almost really died at the hand of others not my own hands. It got my attention real abruptly you know like that will get your attention, shotguns and shit will get your attention. So they had my attention you know and I kind of made that first part of that step in terms of surrender, which we talk about in the first step, is surrender, I gave up. It was not this type of giving up it because I had given a lot of them up. It was something inside that I gave up and said well I will try it. So during the early early onset of this time here there were other instrumental people that came along. There was the little Sylvia that got out of Lexington that came along and found Jimmy and she became kind of like a mainstay for a long time. She use to go out and be on the telephone and she would go out and hustle up addicts because she had a car. See that was a rare thing for addicts to have cars back then. See if you were like me that state had already taken my license so I did not have a car. No I can't say that, I had your cars, that is not true I had your cars but I did not own a car and any car that I may have owned at that time was somebody else's you know or I had one of those fifty dollar special. You could get one of those fifty dollar specials, cause you would get one of those fifty dollar specials that you put a nickels worth of gas in to try to get to the connection, on flat tires, balled tires no oil in it, all those things that we do you know.

Therefore, what occurred here was you get to the meeting and little Sylvia would, she was like a little mother hen. She use to Shepard you around make sure that you were there where you were suppose to be or meet her at work when you got off or whatever the case is. In other words, she did not soft pedal this thing called Narcotics Anonymous, you know one of these hard nosed. She was about that high and full of grit and would talk long shit, and she did not take no shit from no addict. You know she had been one for a lot of years and she had got worn out. So she had become very instrumental in terms of like being Jimmy's right hand person. Kind of stand on the right hand, do the calling and running around because during this same time here Jimmy was getting ill due to something from working on those roofs and things breathing that tar and his lungs were giving out. He was developing some tuberculosis so he was becoming somewhat sickly and was not able to get around as well as he use to or as much as he use to. Therefore, Sylvia was pretty much the Shepard of the flock for a long time. She was kind of like the one opening the doors and making sure the coffee pot was there and that the meeting got started and all these other types of things. Then there were other people that came along at this same time. We had what we called big Sylvia and little Sylvia and people would get them mixed up. I do not know how they would get them mixed up because one was about six foot tall and the other was about five foot tall. So you got two diverse people that are two different people, one was an early and one was a late. Sylvia got out of jail and she got the message brought to her in jail, Zona brought her the message in jail because she was doing a violation on a from a penitentiary and she went up to the

county jail and met Sylvia. Once again, the little book plays its part, have you ever tried Narcotics Anonymous that is it baby. So big Sylvia arrives at the meeting you know to find out what this thing is all about because she had a desire to want to be clean and she got very active. Then there was another lady that just got out, Penny just got out of the penitentiary and they seemed to be like little mother hens around there taking care of all the kids, like where are you, what you doing they were always questioning what is going on. They always seemed to have those mothers around because if you are like me you needed a mama. I needed somebody to take care of me. So I feel in that real good, when I was around mother me, because I missed it at home so I needed it somewhere. I was always hunting for a mama so it fit me real good. I had mother substitutes all over the place you know worry about Bob, shit I needed help.

So what evolved from this was periodically Jimmy would send message as to what we needed to do and one of the things we needed to do was to become more organized in terms of letting more people know what was going on at Narcotics Anonymous. We were becoming somewhat not respectable but we were becoming an organization that people were staying clean and carrying the message by whatever means and it was usually hand to hand and mouth to mouth. However, it was becoming more widespread, more people were getting the message and if they went away somewhere, they would carry it with them. They would carry a book they would carry this contact person they had the post office box, they had the telephone that they could call somebody. But part of what Jimmy comes up with was he kind of outlined a plan of a kind of a parent organization. The parent organization of Narcotics Anonymous you might see on something as the early, as a direction we chose to use. Almost like an organization or how you organized things, chain of command so to speak a direction, a formula to hold things together, for no better word, somebody in charge of or responsible for the duties that needed to be taken care of. They needed to be outlined in terms of saying directly as to what you are suppose to be doing or how you were to be doing it. So you derive this here thing called the parent organization that is pointed out a certain amount for leadership, a certain amount of people that come before you that have some sense of direction of how to do things. It functioned fairly well in terms of functioning because we only had a small core or group of meeting, which constituted about three or four meetings. Most of all those meeting were centrally located in southern California.

Now 1965, 1966 came along and the colleges were getting on the bandwagon, they were going to study addicts. They had grants, they had money to study addicts in addiction, flower time, flower children, and money people were getting hurt. Money people were out in the streets with no direction, so they decided they were going to study the phenomena of why kids run away from home, ran to the streets, and use all of these crazy drugs. So Berkeley undertook a study, they developed a thing called Ad-Center. Now what they needed were some addicts that were clean to give them some direction or some ideas of how to do this thing. Now they came, they knew where some addicts were because one of the ladies that wee involved was a lady named Vargas that had worked in the Social Service system. She said I know where there are some addicts that will staff your study. They went to Southern California and took all the people that had time and that would leave and took them to Northern California and offered them a job. You know most addicts need jobs because they are either under employed or not employed at all. So at the advent of that Sylvia was one of king of like the mainstays that went up to Northern California with Penny and Ron, Russ. It was a core group of about eight to ten people that went to Northern California and started Northern California NA. They would have an outgrowth of that of starting many meetings in that particular vicinity of Northern California. At the same time flower children traveled, they traveled all over the country and this here little book would pop up all over the country and inquiries would come from all over the country as to what is this thing called Narcotics Anonymous. They had one reference point, Jimmy was that reference for a long time but once again and what did happen here was they started contacting other people on the fellowship. As I said at this point, Jimmy was sick during this period of time right after the early 60s or the mid 60s and he was becoming more incapable of doing those particular tasks. Those tasks were left to people like Sylvia, Penny and I happened to be around, I seemed to have a permanent address, and I had a telephone because I was clean and I had been working and I started maintaining these ideas of having a telephone right, getting a car and being available. One of the differences I think that usually happens was I was becoming a useful member of society in spite of me, by doing these things that people suggested I do. It became a very slow process of growing through this method. Now what happened at the same time here in the 60s were we had a lot of changing going on in terms of who had the resources of where was the money going once again because we had very little of it so we didn't have to worry to much about it. It was usually in

somebody's dresser drawer of shoe or something or whatever the case may be. So probably what the growth that went on here we did maintain some semblance of organization, somebody being responsible for getting the message out to other addicts , what other materials we did have being in one place there was not much of that and for a lot of years I was accused of carrying around the office in my car. A lot of that is true because if you needed something you would have to call me and I would have to deliver it to you out of the back of y car. Therefore, I had this information here and I usually carried it around in a box in the back of my car. They knew to call Bob because that is where Bob would have it in the back of his car, Bob had a car, and he could get there. See so it became a thing that I might have transported what was considered the office around in the back of my car for three or four years.

Now we are up to probably the late 60s by this particular time 60s getting close to 1970. Let me backtrack just a little bit. Part of this formation in 66 was part of this development of organization was selecting a BOT, starting regional and area service committees, and having somebody to chair the parent organizations which was Southern California. So you can see we had a loose organization, very loose because we knew very little of organizing anyhow, best we were lucky to know how to stay clean. But the things out of staying clean were the thing of following the steps and working together with one another. We became very intimate in terms of our relationships because if we had fifty members we all went to the same meetings, I do not care where they were we all went to the same meetings. I remember many a night when I had to transfer addicts on a radius of twenty-five or thirty miles in a circle, because we would load up a car and I do not care if you lived in Long Beach or the valley or wherever the case is. We would just make the circle, get home whenever we got home, and get to work whenever we would get to work. It did not make any difference we became working together for a long time in that process. Therefore, we were growing because more people were staying clean and other people were getting out of these institutions called like Tahatchbee, Louie got out and he started a meeting. We were talking about last night we had all kinds of meetings that we started up just because we decided that we needed a meeting. We had what we called jazz meeting, it was at Louie's house on the blue light and music in the background and we were talking about our problem and we had to go through the den in order to get to the house that was having this meeting. It was in like a court and you had to pass all these places where they were dealing drugs out in the street. They kind of like included themselves on occasion asking like what's all this shit about baby, some would wander in and like hey what is happening. You know we had the blue lights on and they thought that we was using I guess because the blue lights and the music in the background I mean hey the atmosphere was right. But I mean as the case goes people were staying clean and I think that is one of the key because they were staying together, working together and doing things together. We use to go on Twelve Step calls together. We did not dare go on a Twelve Step call without calling someone else and saying hey man, I got a hot one. We usually very often scared people to death because you can imagine four or five dope fiends running up to the door of anybody's house and they using, that is fear. I do not know about you but anytime anything like that happened at my house "Oh no what is happening here". That is the kind of thing that was happening during those particular years, so we developed you know and kept on developing I think the BOT kind of became kind of a core of core of authority, core of responsibility, core of whatever, and core of chaos whatever the case may be. Because what we did at that time was try to run things in a since of speaking. It is not that we dictated or anything but, we set up conditions by which we operated, by which we functioned to the best of our ability. Now we called that other organizations office occasionally to ask them about certain things. The fact is we called them a lot of times to ask them certain things and they were, the letters we usually received were very non-committal not very directive. They would tell you to do it to the best of your ability or I think you are doing a good job and good luck that is about the extent of it. But we were still growing, we were still growing the message was getting out. We were becoming more responsible as far as the organization was concerned like starting a bank account, which was one of the difficulties in terms of addicts. We needed to become more business like in our doings. It became very difficult of who was going to sign the card to get the money out because if you were like most of us you had bad records in terms about signing anything. So it became difficult and you had to hunt very judiciously to find a person who did not have a dirty record perhaps to sign a check. Not that there was a lot of money involved, we were talking about a hundred or two hundred dollars at any given time, but we needed to learn how to start keeping records of these types of things. What happened here is as I say theses records very often they said if a person would change their residence and move somewhere very often they would carry those records in the back of their car, or carry part of those records somewhere else. So we had no central location for to put these here things. Jimmy was in the hospital so we could not leave them with Jimmy because we needed access to these particular things. Therefore, Sylvia had them for a while,

Ron and Cathy had them for a while, I had them for a while, you now and they kept bouncing around. Whatever records we had were bouncing around. The great idea came about that we needed to do some things more in terms of organization because we were becoming somewhat of a national organization. We had meetings going on in Pennsylvania, meetings going on in Cleveland, meetings going on, inquiries from everywhere and we were doing the best we could with a voluntary type of operation. Now we got a lot of flack from the east coast because they were not getting their materials fast enough. They wanted to know, demanded to know why they could not get their mailing

[side two of tape]

Therefore, you continually are trying to do something with a rag tail organization, which there is a certain amount of dedication involved here true enough. Apart of this dedication is they say do you have the time and the energy to give to that particular project that you are trying to get done. So we are right at the edge of 70 now and the thing we have become very aware of is that we need to carry the message at a greater, more at large. We needed an office; we needed a central place to put the records that we were accumulating. We needed to get them out of the back of people's cars and put them in one place and have a central location to respond to or go from. We had no idea how to get this money because we had been pleading with the fellowship of send us some money so we can continue printing and so we can continue this thing called getting the message out. So we came up with the bright idea of lets have a convention. And entailing this having a convention we were going to have conference and convention together where all the people from all the meetings and their committees of all the meetings like their secretary and treasurer whoever is the steering committee was going to compose this here part of this here conference. So how we got together on this here first convention was we got together in terms of we went into our pockets, those of us who was working at the time and we financed the first convention out of our pockets. On the onset of that in La Mirada we had, what we called our first World Convention and the World Convention was somewhat of a small occasion. We had approximately 200 people at that first convention and that was a smashing turnout. Jimmy was out of the hospital, he was able to get out of the hospital for the occasion and he came and spoke at our convention at that time. While he was in the hospital, he developed the logo. He was like the person who loved to do arts and crafts and leatherwork and all this type of stuff. He made the logo and he presented it and said this is what I would like the logo to be. What do you fellows think? Hey, looks good to me, group conscience, looks good to me. That was it, it was accepted, and we had no problem about the logo. We had no fights over it, looks good to me, great let us do it. That became the logo, and we did not need to go to no copyrights and all this other stuff to see if it was legalized or stamped right or whether it was authorized. We declared it; we declared it okay, end of session.

At about this same time we are talking about the conference. The first conference we had in Ventura County. The Tree was developed in terms of greater organization. We had a conference which would further this organization in terms of how we should operate and how we could or should or would operate. So we were coming along, we were growing, and in the process of doing this work we were staying clean. I think one of the things we were doing in many instances demanded upon the fellowship to follow our lead. It was not a question of asking what your conscience was, it was called a case of this is what we have decided. Very often, we may ask what do you think about it, maybe we might ask you what do you think about it. It was usually a case of this is what we decided at our gathering and we got very little response in terms of saying yeah, nay or otherwise. You have to realize it said I think very often addicts like ourselves at sometime once we get clean we have other ideas of what we approved yesterday. All of a sudden, we become clear that we want to go in a new direction or do something else different. Sometimes we will become very verbal about that response and so we start jumping on tables and pounding podiums and cursing people out and getting in fights in the parking lot. All of those because we have not learned to work together and tried to come to one understanding of a direction of what we want to do and how can we best do it. We don't have to I don't think like or love each other in that respect but we must love each other enough hopefully that when we come through the doors of Narcotics Anonymous that we are working toward one goal, collectively working toward one goal. I do not have to sleep with you but I have to work with you. It is just like if you go to the job, you might not like everybody at that job but you go to that job for a purpose. We come here to Narcotics Anonymous in the term in the theme of service and I think that sometimes we do a disservice because we go so far a field to what the objectives is.

I think one of the things that is happening here today is I think hopefully we are coming to some understanding as to

what the history is and hope we can maintain some of that idea of we all need to work towards history. The little bits and pieces that we need from you to make it all; to put it all together is necessary. We do not have no history with out these little pieces together. I do not have all the information, I do not think there is any one person here that has all the information but collectively we have all the information. Now we must come to some common ground or understanding of how to put that information together to best present it to the fellowship out there who is waiting for it. Now they are waiting for it, but you will have to do the work and look to be criticized in the process. (Laughter) It is almost a forgone conclusion that you are going to be and sometimes it becomes very frustrating and I know some of these things are labors of love, but they can become very frustrating because of our roadblocks that are thrown constantly in the way and say that is not the way I want to see it. I think we have to take into consideration because the minority opinion sometimes becomes very important, because they may have that little key that we need in order to open up that door we need to open up. So we cannot discard anyone, we must be inclusive in terms of our undertakings in order to include all of the information all of the resources. Regardless of what we believe or think they should be, because very often I have to accept what the group conscience is whether it is my conscience or not. Sometimes that is very difficult to give up my right to have my opinion. I still got my opinion but sometimes I have to accept the conscience as to what is acceptable or what thy want to have or what they think they should use. I have to be accepting of that and I found that hard to give up because I am a person who loves to bite into things and hold on. I hate giving up things, my idea and I think very often if we are addicts like myself we are very tenacious about that and we like to hold on to things and we hate to give up what we think is a good idea. There may not be anything wrong with your idea do not get me wrong, but the conscience or the group said no, just that simple, no. They may go back or change to that at another point, I have seen that happen here too. The Tree had been disassembled three or four times, it is still a piece of literature that they still refer to as the Tree. Do you know that it has been disassembled fifty times because they did not like the way it was written in the first place and do you know that it is right back almost, where it started originally. So somebody must have been thinking somewhere along the way, but once again we are talking about the conscience of the group and their understanding as they get to a certain place of understanding.

(Audience) Excuse me, I hate to interrupt but on the agenda it is allowing this time to speak about the 50s and the 60s, the 70s will be this afternoon.

Well I am sorry about that; I was just up to the 70s here.

(Audience) Well, the Tree

The Tree, when was the Tree? The Tree was in the 60s. Well I heard you mention the 70s.

Well I am just up to that cut off point. I am just about finished anyhow; I am just trying to wind this up because as I said there is a lot more history that goes on as you are saying. I would have liked to have stopped earlier anyhow, but anyway

I think one of the things as we become aware that there is information available rather than to say there is no information. Sometimes we must ask the question and there is somebody here that can reference you to some information, so I want to thank you. (Applause)

Montgomery History Conference 1991
Tape 3

Hi my name is Bill Beck, I am an addict. Hi Bill. Like we were talking last night, Bob and I have covered a lot of ground together. Part of my experience is that I was originally introduced to the program in 1956 in a penitentiary also by the little white book the little yellow book, what is it little yellow book turned white. Most of everything that I heard is about the way that I remember it. One of the things that I preface though by the Traditions is that you know prior to Alcoholics Anonymous there was a program called the Washingtonians. AA does not like claim to the fact

that the Washingtonians was the founding group of AA. Then there were some people that I ran into from Tender Loving Care and they also came out of that original Radford Street Group but they kind of went off in another direction. See I am talking about that non-information area. I love the way Bob said that, how did you say that Bob, information or non-information right. Because I mean it is like how in the hell do you talk about this thing without schlucking over a little bit you know what I mean right. So those people you know and the reason why I bring that up is because in the last few years a whole bunch of little goddamn pieces of paper like this have been filtering across my desk. From all over, the damn world and I do not know who write them or who is up to them but I have a sneaking opinion you know. Some of what I have actually investigated and found out that there was a little covert activity going on by some particular individuals, which has disturbed me through the years. Anyway, there is a set of Traditions and that set of Traditions bind me to not connect myself with any non-informational years. Now Tender Loving Care they went off to become Synanon and then there was another old guy that had a potential, had a little garage out in ( ) or San Fernando out there and they came up with this Addicts Anonymous but they did not practice any Traditions. Then again what do we do, do we go back and say that the founder of our organization is the founder of the Salvation Army whom Danny Carlson or whoever worked for? You know fuck no we are not the Salvation Army. The Salvation Army has not a damn thing to do with Narcotics Anonymous, and neither does Tender Loving Care nor neither does any attempts of somebody going out to start an Addicts Anonymous. What has happened is that in a quest for knowledge people either knowingly or unknowingly subverted our Traditions. The very thing that made our program grow, prosper, and bring us to what we are today is the fact that when Jimmy Kinnon had his inspired dream and believe me he did. He shared it with me many years ago as he told Bob about the purposes and the directions of the fellowship. But he saw a program just like people who started Overeaters Anonymous and Gamblers Anonymous. They saw that dream and it was bound out of a Twelve Step philosophy we all know that. We are not even affiliated there we just work in cooperation there of. But he knew inherently that all these other attempts were bound to failure without the Traditions and isn't it strange that here today that after the man is dead and gone after so many years that it is the Traditions that protect him today and his position of being the founder of Narcotics Anonymous. First of all, it is the unity our common welfare comes first, personal recovery depends on it. If this ain't unity, I do not know what is. Then they talk about our group purpose, but one ultimate authority a loving God. Yes, certainly, God moves in mysterious ways through the group but one man went to some people and said hey man we need to have a group. It is like a preacher that goes and gets his flock together and the God moves through the church. Therefore, this man called the fellowship together and then in his humble experience of being who he was and believe me folks anybody who ever touched this man or got around him knew that they were in the presence of a very special being, a caring and unselfish person. It is like I doubt very seriously that there was very many days that there was not a knock on the door. In addition, I think Betty can probably attest to this, she probably lost a lot of sleep with him rattling around and starting the goddamn coffee pot at two or three o'clock in the morning when that little side door would open up and you know. When the telephone calls would come in with the three hour lapse you know they thought it was one time over there you were suppose to be in the middle of your sleep time you know and they were on their way home from a meeting. Anyway, all that happened you know and so the Traditions say that we need never endorse or lend our name. So what does that mean that means no we are not connected to Tender Loving Care, we are not connected to Addicts Anonymous, and we are not connected? I do not give a shit about Life magazine we are not connected to the Salvation Army or Danny whomever. Fact is somebody I guess Bill Allen when he picked me up he asked me you ever hear of this name. I went yeah, yeah I think I heard that name somewhere but it was so insignificant that it passed in here and went out the other side and then as Bob was recalling it, I was going like oh yeah. But it did not have any business or relativity with us. So once we were called together, once this man called us together then and only then did we become a group conscience. One person is not the group but one person can call in the sheep if you understand what I am meaning and there in comes the founding. Now you have people that come to the first group, and this man being that humble individual that he was he just took an office like everybody else, and one time he was the chairman, another time he was secretary. Like Bob said he was by the door, the coffee maker, the hand shaker the hey come I will go out to the railroad tracks and look for sputnik with you (Laughter). At that point, fuck he wanted a fellowship for himself, he was a heroin addict going to AA meetings man. He probably was scared to death because those motherfuckers over there at Radford Street use to tell us to get out. I remember going there and Hey get out of our meeting. So that is how it happened and that is why I said last night that the answer was simple. We could put it to rest once and for all. Most of the history that I have heard is pretty good except I always wondered what happened to the real first convention as I watch this stuff. There was a convention prior to that that

happened on Cuanga Blvd. in ah what the hell was it a VFW or American Legion Lodge (audience speaking inaudible) Well I could stand corrected but I was pretty sure it was the first. (Audience, no it was the second) yeah okay who remembers to long ago partner. Well maybe it was the second but I was pretty sure it was the first what difference does it make. At this point what difference does it make? All the rest of it really went sort of the way that Bob explained it. I could not have explained it any better.

Then we jumped up and went through the late 60s and NA was doing resurgence finally because I am one of those people like he says he did not get the, well fuck I am a real hard. I mean it is like I was around for twelve years, I mean from 1956 to 1968 it is like in 1968. This guy told e you are not suppose to take anything, and I went nothing.(Laughter) I did not even remember riding my motorcycle into the meeting until Bob reminded me last night and I am like oh yeah right I did that. So how am I supposed to remember what year a fucking convention was a hundred years ago right? But going back and looking at that period of time, I mean it was so fantastic man the beginnings of coming together and I think the term that was used at that time all the time was "NA is coming of age, NA is coming of age". Goddamn I got off the airplane the other night and I asked somebody in the arrogant California way you know, hey how many meetings you got in this town. They told me three hundred and some odd, I went three hundred and I mean fuck I was staggered man. I said well shit that is more meetings, this is like Philadelphia man, that is more meetings than they got in LA and San Diego put together. This is just one little town, shit it came of age but it was not where I grew up it was here (Laughter) and everywhere else. Then why because our founder talked on the phone all over God's creation. I never could figure out how that one lonely guy got in Australia man. He kept calling up; in fact, he still calling probably thinks that line is just busy (Laughter) you know. So then, we got up into the 70s and Jimmy began to rally back. See for years they thought he had emphysema and man this poor guy, this is the honest to God truth, he came to my Barber Shop trying to come in to get a haircut and he got that little thing taking two steps forward and one step back and then he is like courageous. He is still there in the end when he was dieing of cancer he was still there. The people still came like the moths to the light and the man was in pain man you could see it but his eyes shown man right to the very end. He gave of himself, he was in the hospital bed man and the family, and I mean if it were not for the family shit, there would have been a throng. I was privileged by the family to be able to be allowed to be some of the last people to, we had to keep the people away. Even then, as I sat in the hospital room with him all night he would not shut up. This guy you could not shut his mouth if the I mean the pain would get him a little while and he would look up and see me sitting in the chair and goddamn he would start talking to me and I was like I don't think this guy will ever die, he is a immortal. Well as we know, he was a human being and he did have to go you know but he is here within all of us.

The 70s came and there was a birth of The Tree, a very strange thing happened then though I think this was kind of like the onset of that the fact that the program was really going to grow. The person that helped him writes this Tree, one of the major players, he did not show, and some other major players are not here. (audience. They just pulled in and are going to get some sleep)Anyway what happened at this particular time is that some people had kind of aspirations that they would grow up, get a job, take over the World Service Office and have some money come in and it did not happen and some feelings were really hurt. Then we had the calling together of a conference from the north and the south. See there was kind of a thing see around Jimmy was like Narcotics Anonymous, it was all about Narcotics Anonymous. Then there was a little click that happened over here and they sort if kind of made a separation. Like there was a little war and the reason why I share this story is that I think this is one of the things. I heard somebody say hey what are some of the same, what are some of the mistakes we do not need to make. This is one of them; the reason why I am going to tell this story is because it is what is permeating, and what has gone on. It is like the Martins and the McCoy's, the goddamn war has not ended until today, we all get our sponsors, and we all have our grandfathers. Jimmy was not my sponsor. My sponsor was a crazy guy man that went around burning down houses and hitting people in the head and I thought that was the way the program worked. I thought fuck this is what you do if the guy fucks with you, fuck him up. So we went about fucking up some people until I ran into Jimmy Kinnon and he said no, no the program is a set of principles written so simply that even I can apply in my life. You do not go around doing things like that, that is not the fellowship you know. I went oh I thought you got loaded for twelve years and then you went and kicked the shit out of the people that did not like the things you were doing. Like the cave man days, like my clan is stronger than your clan is. So if we did not do it with clubs we did it verbally, big mistake folks. So what happened then was that this thing was born, it became, and this thing became such an irritation

to me. I am so glad that this man explained to me that this was not a program of violence but love and care. Because at this juncture I surely would have killed. (Laughter)

So I got a call and by this time I was on the BOT and I hold an illustrious position because I was probably the only guy that was on the BOT kicked off and then put back on. That was not only an honor but also a double honor. So although it has of humor it also has its point of seriousness and everything to it. I was called upon to carry a message to this conference. Now the conference was not to be about this, it had a little to do with, hey man can't we do something about this fucking war. But you know what in good conscience under the name of ,"can't we do something about this war" we really came there to beat the shit out of each other. I mean everybody had their shields polished up and their swords. But this thing, we had a group conscience and we had a fellowship and the fellowship elected the trustees. The trustees were doing the best they could in a group conscience basis, but in that beginning of organization like Bob said, well like what the fuck are we suppose to do man, so we must suppose to do something. I can remember us having discussions about what are we suppose to do. Well we are suppose to be the guardians of the Traditions obviously, but then what do you do. Hell there was only fifty or a hundred people in the fellowship; I mean it was not all like he said all this stuff flying around and you know. You could take care of business adequately out of the trunk of his car. So we said okay you are going to have a literature committee and you are going to have this committee and that committee. So this thing came by in concept like he said, Jimmy drew the thing we looked at it and said Yeah, all right geez it has been happening, man I am really glad somebody could tell us what it is we have been doing. Which is a fact, see so you we said this is what it is and we approve it and then we took it to the whole BOT and the trustees approve it? Now we went to this conference with this and you have to understand the fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous had approved this. The click came, they had a lot of questions, and they did not want to approve it because there was a natural war going on. But I talked and I talked and I talked and every time it came up I said no you don't understand man, Narcotics Anonymous has voted they went to the next level they voted. This is it, this is the bonified whatever built into this structure allows us to change if we want to change it. These are the rules that we play by. At this juncture, what happened finally was that everybody went whew after these two days of hacking and hollering up there in San Luis Obispo? I am sure, were you at that thing? So then, what happened when it was all over one man decided to say, "Screw what the fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous wants, and screw what the other faction that was finally coming together wants". He says "I am taking this out to the fellowship and that is what happened" and we had two or three of the most insane years and so obviously our conferences grew out of insanity and hurt feelings. I did not even realize, you know I mean I knew that there were these things and it hit me the other night as I was talking what had happened , what was wrong with that thing that happened back then. Only now after all these years the light bulb went on, I said Oh yeah the fellowship voted for this and the fellowship was going along with that and one fucking guy got up and screwed the whole thing up.(Audience: who was that guy?) Greg Pierce.

Then what happened is that somebody moved up to Oregon and then there was phone calls, cause we were growing up there was splinter groups that were popping up all over the United States. But there were a lot of phone calls going on from Oregon all over and it was really weird. Because the next thing I am hearing about this senile old man who is running this office, that still cannot get the volunteers there to stuff envelopes and yeah there were some legitimate complaints about, hey I sent for my starter kit three months ago. Hey, you know what when there are 942 starter kits to start out and 1 guy who has to talk for six hours on the phone and six hours to somebody else. Then needs a couple hours sleep and he has got to go take a shit and he has got to drink his own cup of coffee and he is saying please, please won't somebody come over here and stuff envelopes. A few people made it over, and Fawn made it over and some other people made it over there and little by little. Then Bob would come and we would say we need the stuff in the back of the car you know. So the grew that way except these rumors started coming in from outside. There was some mis-information that was put out. It filtered into even the BOT, a couple of people had some RV's that began to go throughout the United States and so now this same kind of faction that we had been dealing with, the kind of split now began to happen over here from this area. Yet you had Narcotics Anonymous just kind of doing its thing and growing up. The thing that was sad about it is that as it went on it got really fairly nasty and then there were noises from some where in the southeast that if this person is all senile and this is why, I mean there is like a great distance. People were not really flying back and forth like, they are now and they were having this stuff. Oh well if maybe if one little old crazy old man sitting over in a closet then maybe we should get the World Service Office over here. I

started hearing those things and we are going hey wait a minute whoa, whoa, you know. I mean even the trustees were not going for that man. Therefore, what do we call that controversy, but the old man was the protector of people because he said it is okay to have controversy inside of the program that is how we grow. We grew in spite of all of that. I am thumbnail sketching through this and then maybe I can back up and answer some particular questions or I will think of something else to say.

But as it went into the 80s, you understand then came other crews out of the west that came in. I mean the structure is here and they are not coming in unity man, they are coming to do battle. That is why I finally stood up and said Jesus Christ man I refuse to business with deceit and dishonesty and covertness and I was really controversial for many years until I went and just literally hid from the insanity of it all because I will lay the shit right on the table. All the little covertness and I even taped certain people on tape. I call them on the telephone because I was privy and part of this and that. I taped them all and went to this conference and I told them and I told them, man if anybody wants to hear the truth look they are trying to run a coo on the old man and I had the old man listen to the tapes. Me and Doug F had to force him to listen to it because he did not want to hear it. He just wanted to believe in everybody. So I kind of resigned but then I watched this other thing. I watched the new breed of the 80s who had their sponsors who were out of the original click. Who said hey those guys are dirty mothers and they had all their people well trained and now you had the people over here from the south and from the east that are saying hey you know what man, we are dealing with senility, stupidity and inefficiency. I can understand people over here feeling that way because you write a letter and say hey we need a starter kit or whatever and you think what the big deal is. You know fold it, put it in an envelope, lick it put a stamp on it and it should be back in a week... But nobody had x-ray vision nobody knew, and as time grew up, but by this time you got all these camps and you got all these fucking warriors. I mean I have even had people come to me man and tell me that are going to the conference, I am a warrior. I mean they go I AM A WARRIOR; they ain't going to get me man. (Laughter) I mean shit they are plotting and hatching their thing and got their seven people and calling in their vote. I mean shit man you would think we were Democrats and Republicans. Laughter) So now you got the most in sanest of the in sanest that absolved into the 80s with their squint eyes and their shields and their double swords and whole armies with them pervading in and they are all about, Hey man we are not going to let the east get us you know what I mean. Even more than that, we are going to whip the shit out of them old guys too. I am looking at that man, that is the time, and I said I am stepping back man I am going to take a 3D view of this. Because once again I am tuned in on hey man I think this is all about peace and care and love and not slaughtering your fellow cohorts. So obviously, we went through thing and wonder why we have a mess at the level at the WSO. Well the whole is there it will work. It will work if we as individuals go with love in our hearts, and that are willing to accept the group conscience that Bob alluded to. And forget all about hey we are going to fight this battle and we are going to fight that battle and we are going super impose our idea over your idea. Because you know this thing was really set up more or less to be like the old Indian council where everybody had a voice in it, you know what I mean. If we can do that and go forth in that framework and forgive those in the past that found it necessary for what reason whatever to deal in subterfuge and covertness and deception for their own purposes or to heal their own wounds or whatever it is. But to just go forth knowing hey that this fellowship was born up out of a fellowship of sick people and we have seen some of the pitfalls and each of us on an individual level refuse to be part of that again. You know one of the things I talked about a long time ago and probably should have done it because I can hear the voice ring in my ears and Bob told me well if that is what you think should be done why the hell don't you do it? But I experienced in my own life and some other things a lot of gossip and everything like that. You know there was a time when none of this stuff, no Basic Text, no nothing just a little pamphlet, the pamphlet is what got me. I use to call it a hip pocket program but shit man there were only two or three NA meetings and if you wanted to go to a meeting everyday you had to (Tape 4)

The meat was there it was good enough, that and the pamphlet were good enough for me, but I also read that damn 12 and 12 and in there in that one place where it talks about gossip and things like that and character assassination. It refers to character assassination as a polite form of murder. Now those are heavy words folks, and you see the passing parade although there are thousands and thousands of us. We can walk into conventions and there is four or five thousand, we were at a convention a few weeks ago and there were probably four or five thousand people there you know. But you know what the rooms I have seen through the years that I have been around there are even more of us that did not make it in the passing parade. It starts with those funny little stories at Denny's where we talk about each

other. The people get their feelings hurt and then they do not come back and they go out to die, then we go to the Great War at the conference and we come back and tell these pitiful stories and the newcomer goes, shit. Then people get sued and they do whatever they want to do and law suits going on and the little lady from Florida says Jesus Christ what does the newcomer think about that. Isn't that what I heard you say last night man. It is like what the hell do we have to offer man, I mean new people coming in and all they hear all this stuff and go boy. I mean all I know man when I got clean I was not ready for that. It is like I had a hard time man when the guy is telling me, one you are powerless your life is unmanageable and I thought like yeah but I can handle this. What do you mean my life is unmanageable I can go rob a liquor store, I can go hit somebody over the head I can do a lot of things. I mean I just had a hard time understanding the basic concepts of recovery. So you see I think the big lesson that we have to realize and we do not come to go to war with anybody. It says until we give up fighting everything and everybody. I do not want to fight today. I will stand up and say the truth, as I know it. The way you observe it, you may see it different. That is fine, but truth is truth from wherever I stand and if you do the same thing maybe you will be a survivor for as long as me, or Bob. I mean he still lights my candle I still look at him and go wow man the guy has been here forever. I hope I can make it forever, you know. So that is to me the big message out of the 70s. Forget going to war, forget trying to be manipulators and con artists and just be part of the goddamn fellowship and love. Because the basic job is done, all we got to do is kick back and do what we are supposed to do. That is very hard for addicts to do what they are supposed to do. I mean I did not do it all my life and all of a sudden, I am in a fellowship and suppose to do what I am supposed to do. But it is that simple is not it. That is what I said last night; the root of the problem is in simplicity, not in complicated things. Most of you know what bullshit is when you hear bullshit. You get a feeling when something is wrong. The guy is driving me from the airport and he goes yeah everything is going, but I knew something was wrong. Some little piece, something is out of kilter man. I mean it is like trying to put a square peg in a round hole you see. You measure all the distances and say well it should fit, except it does not fit. So it is incumbent upon each of us to practice our own principles. To become human beings of love in the spirit of God because that is what this program is all about. You cannot soft petal it we did not come here to learn how to be warriors. We did not come here to be corporate executives. We did not come here to learn anything except to experience because even this program is not a program of learning it is a thing of experiencing. Then we get up to the 12th Step and the 12th Step says having had a spiritual awakening as a result of these steps. Which means it is all about between one and eleven and we try to carry the message. It does not even say we did it says we just try. So you know at the level of these conferences and the level of these personal confrontations and trying to beat the system we are in error. At the level at what is happening here today our common welfare should come first. Our personal recovery depends on NA unity. Isn't that why we are all here in this room today? That is why I came clear across the United States, because I felt that this was a message that needed to be carried. To me it is that simple, nine thousand goddamn pages of shit, you know what I did with all mines, and I threw it out because every time I read it, it made my head hurt. Now they invite me to go in, look at it again, and then send it to me from all over Gods creation. This paper, that paper, I look at it and go, oh God file X. Somebody says can I come over and talk to you about the things that came. There are some real researchers over in my area. I go sure you can come over. You want to come over and talk come on over and we will talk about it and then I start thinking where is my Tylenol, we are going to go through this shit one more time. So you know what, the man came. The man carried a dream. He born us, he brought us to maturity and he went away. From the very first day that the first meeting happened then the records came. Minutes from this meeting, minutes of that meeting, minutes of the conference and surely surely it is interesting to some people, but to most people it is dry and boring shit. I mean you can see at the convention five thousand people showed up, at the history thing, look around what representation for this mighty nation. There ain't that many people that give a shit except at the level it goes out from here and we carry the story. Hey, man we cannot go out there and kill our brothers and sisters. I am a curious one. I like to read history books, I mean I remember when someone handed me years and years ago NA Comes of Age and I read it with all undue interest. Someday surely, we will have a book and probably will not be called NA Comes of Age, but then again do not be surprised if it is. See and there comes all the history. That is what all this stuff is about, it ain't about the war, let us put it to rest man. We got a founder; we are stuck with him whether you liked him whether you did not like him. Personally, I loved the shit out of him. Somebody gave me a picture when he died, he came out here for a convention and I guess he is riding on a tugboat or ferry or something and he is leaning against the thing talking to some people and as the boat goes by somebody takes a picture of him as the thing sails by the Statue of Liberty. I went and got the son of bitches blown up this big and I hung it on my office wall. I look and talk to the old man all the time, you know well it is just a picture man but I like to think it is a spirit you know. Makes

me feel good, makes me remember because he gave me such pearls of wisdom. I can remember one night being there and I had been out screaming in the street holding my nuts for some ungodly reason. Probably another broken relationship and somebody that I was sponsoring put me in the car and took me to Jimmy Kinnon's house. He laid me up on the couch and yelled at me to shut up that there were other people living in this house. You know and I kept screaming so he, you have to know this guy man if you ever see a picture he had these ungodly hands. Probably from being, a roofer all big swollen funny fingers bony, and he starts beating on my chest and I thought God he is trying to kill me man he wants me to shut up so bad. It hurt man, oh God it hurt. Finally I shut my mouth and he looks me right in the eye and he said its all right Bill, it will be worse next time. (Laughter) With that I went (scream) and that was the last utterance for that time, and the next thing I know it was worse, but I did not have to go out in the streets and hold my nuts and scream at the moon, because I was afraid that, old man would beat the shit out of me again.

Anyway, you see there is some real seriousness about it. There is some humor about it. I am real happy to be here and share that part of the story. I hope it was meaningful to you. As far as the history and the archives, I have to hand that over with respect. He said two or three years to me it seemed like forever and I will bet you anything that if you go out and looked in his car I bet you are going to find a little box out there all stuffed with this shit. Garage full now right and Betty has a garage full. There is a whole room full over there, that book is going to come along and then the next book that is going to come along is going to be something like "The Jimmy I Knew". Then there is going to be a historical thing about the history I mean it is just bound to come out, it cannot not come out and I think that maybe this is part of what this kind of thing is leading up to be. Because my eye, who the hell am I? I am just another member of Narcotics Anonymous. If you went back and rolled it back to the early 60s or something and you would have ask me how it was going to happen, I would have told them fuck I am going to write it the book. You know what I was seriously attempting to write the book. I had a thesaurus's and the big book man and I was changing all the words. I said I am going to do it this way so they cannot call it plagiarism. But God it was a long, tedious, and gregarious job I was like already years into this and everybody grew up and beat me to it. So what did I know? Besides that when I read the shit that I wrote it did not make any since anyway because when you change those words like that and try to put it in context with other changed words it looks strange. So obviously, God was not ready for me to carry that part of the message man. So it is happening it is absolving the hurt feelings have to be let go. The attacking has to be let go. Whoever's toes were stepped on in the past; hey of you hear them talk if it is the truth the truth will prevail. If it is caca hey, man let it go in one ear and out the other. It is no different than when you are sitting in a regular meeting and you hear people come into a meeting man and you hear them talking long caca. For those of you that may not have the Spanish influence that we have from LA. I mean shit, my sponsor told me hey you interpret everything by your understanding of the steps and that is valid. So you have to go, you have to go with what is in your heart, you have to go with what you know is right. You have to go with the truth and the knowledge there of. How do I know that Jimmy Kinnon's inspired vision about maybe he read that article where the name Narcotic, but what it is man is like we is. We are an organization with a set of Traditions the other stuff was not related it is without our scope. We do not even have, at the level of our program; we do not even have any business paying attention to it at all because it diverts us from our primary purpose you see. So the old subterfuge, the covertness about it the people who have lead us to the point of having us look in the wrong direction you know what I mean. They had me going for it for a while. Then I said now wait a minute. Our program is a program, a set of principles written so simply that I can practice them in my life. That includes the Twelve Steps and the Twelve Traditions. My program doe not include anything that does not embrace the Twelve Traditions and if it gets to the point where it is happening at the WSO, fuck I will divorce them too man, you understand. The fellowship can boycott them, I am not calling for a boycott you understand, and no, I am not calling for a boycott. Right is right and I was apart of that mechanism for a lot of years. The general intent is all there in the guidelines, it is laid out to work properly, and we have to put or trust in our group conscience and let it be the way that it be. Then we also have to be smart enough to know that we can do anything we want to do, the people are trying to do except you have to do it in the right way. It is like Jimmy Kinnon told me years ago. He said, hey man you want to have a Tuesday night group you can print you own literature for the Tuesday night group if you want to do that. You can put approved Tuesday night meeting you know what I mean. Then if everybody wants to come and get some of that because they like it and it eventually finds it way to a floor. It may in fact eventually become approved NA material, but you don't go and take something that is copyrighted and change it, because you might wind up in a legal difuelty, you know what I mean. Just alter it a little bit, change it a little bit, slap a new cover on it, we need more literature I mean that is not the end of it. Jesus Christ

anybody ever pick up a Hazelden catalog lately. Christ it is a manuscript within itself. There is a need for more literature; we need our own Twelve Step Book you know. Obviously, we do not need a Bottles and Stools book but you know what is the matter with a snorting and joint book or something. You do not stick your finger up your ass with morphine suppositories or whatever it is man it is like we have a need for it you know. So if we put our attention to our needs other than trying to superimpose ourselves on each other and work in unity towards the betterment of the fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous. How can we not, not succeed? I am not saying anymore that Narcotics Anonymous is coming of age. I am saying that Narcotics Anonymous has come of age and it ain't never going to be stopped so the time of the war has to be over, it just has to. It has to carry on a loving fellowship in the hand has to be there outstretched to the new person that comes in. For God sakes folks let do not grab them by the hand and take them into battle. Thank you. (Applause)

Montgomery History Convention 1991
Tape 4
Speaker; Betty

Oh, God here we go again. **My name is Betty, I am an addict.** Hi Betty. I do not know what I am going to say. I am not a speaker you know I do not, I just tell my experience as much as I can remember. How much can you tell at once standing up here? I was just told to talk about the World Service Office. I guess that I can tell you that I came into the program in 1971. Hi, Greg it has been a long time since we have talked. It is good seeing you here. You know we have all been through al lot of stuff. I started in 71 as I said and my first meeting was a woman's NA meeting and I am very grateful for that. There were not too many meetings around and it was kind of neat last night we were sitting around talking about the different meeting and different people. It was neat to be able to laugh at some of the things that happened as before we could not laugh at some of it. I kind of feel like sometimes it is like we are walking on eggshells at times, well I can say to myself anyway.

I have to tell you my first response was that if I see some of these motherfuckers I am going to give them the knee you know. Well maybe some of you do not like it but I have to tell you and I just got through telling somebody that I am a cusser you know. I try not to and I have been in Maryland and I have been around people and when I was in Maryland I hardly cussed at all, here I go maybe it is kind of like getting it out right now. I guess it is that little voice in me saying I want things to be different you know I do not want it to be the way it has been going on.

Anyway, in 71 as if I say there were not very many meetings around and the person who 12 stepped me well he is dead now, was Jerry Kinnon and he was the father of my daughter. He made some contact with some women for me right away, which I am very grateful to him for that. I started going to meetings and getting involved and I just got through telling someone just a few minutes ago that I kind of had a hotline at the Solano Club also that all the addicts kind of hung out at. If an addict called down there, I worked there for a short time and if an addict called there, I referred them to NA. Later on, years later I found out that they use to call me NA Betty. You know I went out to some business meetings out on Crenshaw Blvd. I went to a few of them there and I tried working in the office and I think you remember Bob it was kind of hard to catch anybody; everybody was working to tell me what to do so that was very hard. What was that Bob what was that place called on Crenshaw Blvd. (it was called Crenshaw House) okay that was where a bunch of addicts were getting clean right.

Then I went to the valley and when I went to the valley, I went into the hospital there and with the understanding; I would be given no drugs. I had some things to work through in my life there. Therefore, I knew that my first I needed to make a contact with NA you know. The only one I could think of was my ex brother in law, which was Jimmy. I thought what he is going to say. I thought well I have to make my contact with NA no matter what so I called. He said I heard you were in the program and he said great what is it you need. I said I would like to talk to some women and I would like to get to some meetings. He said sure, I explained to him where I was at and he asked if I needed anything and of course, I said, cigarettes and he came out to see me and needless to say, we started talking. We never

stopped talking from then on. I would listen to him and it was just like yeah, yeah God this man. I started going to different meetings around in the valley and I wound up moving to the valley. Jimmy and I kept going to meetings together and we also went to another place where the office was at. I had given a copy machine to the office that was gone, we looked around, and a lot of things were gone.

So it was decided to move the office over to Van Nuys. So it was up over the bail bonds place. Well the landlord was the bail bondsman you know and I feel like I am jumping skipping a lot of things. It was upstairs and we had to put money in the meter, and we had to remember to put money in the meter if we did not we would get tickets. We had a desk and a filing cabinet and an old beat up couch and one or two beat up chairs. We had a few boxes of literature and in the filing cabinet; there was not very many records in there. There were very few records in there. We had the phone and we kept trying to catch the person who was supposed to be in charge of the office at the time to pay the landlord. Trying to catch him when he had the checkbook was like you know he was busy doing something else. Here I am like, oh here he comes again and he wants his money and then to pay the utilities and we share the utilities with one of the other offices there and some of the offices were empty...You know our funds were really low, how low can you go. I do not know about you but facing a landlord sometimes is really hard and Jimmy was one of the first to go to the women's meeting in that office. I would make phone calls and the girls came to the meeting and it was like we would be having a meeting there and we would be hearing people urinating underneath and they would be using and drinking and the girls would be scared because this is where they came to cop you know. This neighborhood was kind of scary, but all kinds of things happened in this office. It was decided to move the office back to Jimmy's house and so and the desk went back to the person who donated it and so here was the filing cabinet and actually it was like a little box was all that was from those records and we had some literature. So it was moved to the house and I think in that time also you know I lived in Van Nuys and I remember Greg and Jimmy working on literature and every once in a while they would say listen to this, what does this sound like, does this sound right. I would say buy God these are big words, what are you guys doing do people understand these words. You know I felt very insecure at times and they said well maybe we need to simplify this a little bit more you know. When it came to the house, I need to tell you that Jimmy and I did not realize but we were living together, I get so embarrassed over this but it is the truth and you know I had my own place and he had his own place. I always lived upstairs in the apartment but it was always like he was walking up those stairs and down those stairs. Anyway at the office we had very little. He had much of what he had you know the ditto machine you know which I donated to the WSO I do not know if they know I gave it to someone. Someone has it in the fellowship and I donated some record players. I donated several things to the WSO. Anyway, this ditto machine I will never forget that it seemed like we were always typing and typing and I would be typing away and Jimmy would say, ok I need another one. I was looking at some of that that Bob brought and I thought that it was probably some of what was on that machine. We would go to trashcans and dig some boxes out for the industries you know they would put the boxes out. Or the grocery stores we would use some of their boxes. Also like the books, we sent out, we would use the grocery bags. We would turn them inside out and we would use those grocery bags. You know it was like it really started to grow. I moved in with Jimmy and you know it was like, it is hard for me to describe because I just do not talk that much about what went on. So you are going to hear a lot of "you knows" and uh uhgs. Many things went on then; much of what went on was kept from me I did not know. I just thought that everyone that came into the program, that everybody loved everybody you know. I baked like crazy at the house. I was always handing out cookies and God help you if you said no; I was going to have to find something to get in your stomach. I went to a lot of yard sales and picked up a lot of material. Really hit the jackpot at one place it was kind of sad but a woman's husband had passed away. They had owned a stationary shop and so she donated and plus we paid her for some and gave her the receipt so she could have the write off for that. That added a lot and people donated tapes and I still have a box of tapes that has cowboy music on it. I have not figured out quite how to work that. I have been using things and trying how to copy over these cowboy music's for these tapes. These tapes are somewhat old you know this cowboy music is probably a collectors item now. It just kept growing. It started like in a little room in the front on the side and it grew n to the kitchen we would be working in the kitchen and then in the laundry room. The ditto machine was in there, we had stacks of things in there. It went into our living room. It went into one, two, three, three bedrooms. We had things in the storage shed, we had things in our front porch stored and we had things up in the addict. In fact when Jimmy passed away, there are many things that even Greg and or Bob has not seen. There are many things he had up there from years ago. He kept everything believe me, he kept everything God you know and I stood right there when we took all these things down. I went

through all these things, you know his kids and my kids were there and it was like a chain thing you know. And nothing went passed me without me looking at it to make sure that it was okay. I said this is the fellowship, or you know this is Jimmy's or I want this. You know this is how it went on.

It grew very much, there was a lot of conflict, and there was, I could not believe that people came over to our house and we were friends, I thought we were friends. All of a sudden, it was like something is wrong here it was like this. I thought what is going on here this is suppose to be a fellowship of togetherness you know why is this happening. I could not understand you know what all was happening. I neglected to say that Jimmy and I got married in 1977. We went to some conventions and we went to the conference and we had it over at the college in North Hollywood, There started to be some rumors like this old man and things like that. There were many things that went on you know, there were things that it became were people were coming to our house and they came and they started to take some things. They came and took some things, you know they were taking some things out of the files and I mean it was really getting nasty. In the meantime, there were people trying to work in the office, you know, and we had the board going. There was it was like, Jimmy, Chuck Gates, Greg, Bob and I and these people are working there and they are saying how come Bob and Greg are not showing up and not doing some of this work here that we are doing. You know they are not being involved and you know Greg I believe you had moved up north by then you were gone. We would have the meeting and I don't know if that is when you were in the hospital Bob or you I know you were not coming to all the meetings exactly. Therefore, we had this, so the three of us got together and decided that Greg and Bob were out of the office and all of a sudden we get Bob and Greg said no we are not out of the office and we demand a meeting. So we had a meeting and by that time there had people who were, giving you know so bad that it had been moved next door. So we had the meeting next door and the five of us sat there, six actually there was one other person there taking minutes down. Then we had this meeting and it kept going around and around, everybody felt that they were right, nobody changed you know it was just going on and on. In fact there is I don't think you guys know but there are a few copies going on of that meeting , so anyway this meeting was taped. Finally, I do not remember what all I said; I said Hey this has been going on for so long I am sick and tired of this. We have been sitting here for a long time and nobody is agreeing with anybody lets have this vote and get it over with, this is ridiculous. So then, they were voted whatever and it. Then the people that were working in the office they became more active in the office. They became part of the board and it was really, we were all trying so hard to do what was right you know really trying to do what was right. There was more and more conflict and you know actually I think some of it like Bill said earlier. A lot of this started way back like Southern California (flip tape)

Personality and who is going to. Na was growing so much then and it became like a power struggle. It was as if all of a sudden, I know that Jimmy told me that he and Greg had sat down and talked about the getting the literature copyrighted. The office and everything and Greg said well with everything that is going on maybe we should put it in our name and keep it so that and Jimmy said no,no,no this belongs to the fellowship. Therefore, you know we were trying out different ways and with this power thing coming in and trying to figure out what is right and Jimmy always saying the same things over and over. I watched through the years when I was living there. I watched Bob come over and say well Jimmy did not this happen, you know well was not this. Remember Bob just before a convention or a conference you use to come over and say Well Jimmy, and Gene use to come over and he would say. So a lot of things happened during this, and with this power struggle a lot people were hurt very much and we got phone calls and things like the laughter and saying ha ha old man. It was not until just recently that I found out people had shot at our home and Jimmy had kept that quiet for me, but it put some pieces together for me from something that had happened that I remembered that time. I have not really stopped for me because it is still going on with my life yet. You know people are they still in fact, when Jimmy went to the 83 convention he said I had a beautiful time there. Honey you cannot believe what a beautiful time I had there. He said I wanted to go on to Pennsylvania so badly but I felt so ill I had to come home. He said but you know the damnedest thing happened he said as I am getting off the elevator somebody said to me you know you man you stole what was it ten thousand, whatever it was whatever the amount was from the office. I swear to God after all those years still you know what happened at that period was about the book when the book was being published. There was like a paper strike, remember there was a paper strike you know that was a hassle. Then we had this printer that we had for about two years you know and the sucker went bankrupt with our money and Jimmy got blamed for that you know. The rumors it is just like, you ever play telephone you know and it goes on and by time it gets to someone it is like. However, the person who told him that he

had known him for years you know and it was like people who were around us for years it was a very hard time. Jimmy, they had I am bouncing but maybe you can figure out what I am trying to say. They had moved the office over to Vineland Blvd., Jimmy was trying his darndest, and everybody was fighting so much with one another and they making sure that there was no help in the office and all kinds of stuff. Oh God it was something by that time I had resigned you know my position and but I was still at the house I was still doing the typing. I was still answering the phone and you know it has never ended really. One day he came, you know he was excited he said there is going to be this man who is going to come in to the office, he is going to learn the ways, and maybe he can do something around here to get things together. I am to show him what is going on and maybe something will be happening. Well with this man came to the office and when Jimmy went to the office one morning and the door was locked and Jimmy was locked out. He came home, he cried, and I cried. I will try not to get into that. It really seemed like he started to go downhill then so more then you know. Jimmy had you know I think it was the later part of the 60s or the first part of the 70s. Then when they said he was not contagious, he slipped out a window and went to a meeting. You know people in the meeting were scared to go near him, they knew where he was from you know that he was in the hospital and they thought he was contagious. So he walked to a meeting, his ankles were all swollen, and he walked back to the meeting because nobody would drive him back. You know this was the fellowship and people were scared. However, you know people came to our home and I could go on and on of people turning on us, it was humongous you know. I feel that when that happened that is when he really started getting very ill that is when he really went downhill. He was like twenty years older than I you know and in his mind, he was so so young. He, this is hard, this is hard. It was as I talked earlier, Lois was my bridesmaid and Bob was Jimmy's best man at our wedding. Anyway so he went through radiation treatments, I thought dieing, I saw this man suffer a lot was but God this man did not complain. I thought what this he does not complain is and he went through so much. I saw them do so much to them. You know people said he did not take any medication; well he did take medication at the end because both of his lungs were being eaten by cancer and when he was at home, I walked through giving him morphine. That was one of my drugs of choice when I was in the hospital but I did not think about that you know I thought about helping him and I was so scared. I remember thinking I am going to kill this man I keep forgetting to pull the plunger out you now I would have never made a good needle addict, because I just always stuck my but up in the air in the hospital so they did that. But I would forget to pull the needle out sometimes to make sure there was blood in it and I was scared I was going to kill him. I was scared that area that we lived in I did not want anyone to know that those drugs were there. Mainly people came over to the house people were told to stay away at different times when they did not need to stay away and it would have been so great to have the one addict talking to another addict to walk him through that, for us both actually for us both of us. However, some did not pay attention to him you know and they came over and some called and it came to a point where he went into the hospital but I will not through all that part with you. Except that people sent cards, we put the cards all over the wall you know, people could call, and he would say, he was still directing he would say make sure that. I would be making notes, for years, I would say I want to be somebody's secretary I want to be Jimmy's secretary. He would say make sure you call such and such, this card came in, you know, and such and such, I need paper. You know this man was dieing at any time he is near as anytime he could be gone. You know people would come in and stay with him to the point he was gone. They wrote in a few papers in a few papers that Jimmy a painter, he was a roofer he did do some painting but he was a roofer. I heard Bob say he was a heroin addict, who knows what he was he just did not come across and say what he did not get in to all of that all of that part. He got into the living part. He loved addicts and he wanted addicts to enjoy life. What was that, I ran across I got all kinds of garbage, listen to me I am calling it garbage. I call it garbage sometimes when I trip over the boxes but they were different things said and there are still different things said. I went to a convention a few weeks ago and someone called his wife by a different name, his wife was Agnes she was a beautiful woman. She was not an addict so she had a hard time sometimes understanding addicts but she was a nice woman and she helped some addicts. I am thinking of Alma, I love Alma in fact, I think this is part of the history. That Jimmy and Elma are sitting at Jimmy's kitchen table and Alma saying what am I going to do about Bob, Bob cringes. Jimmy said start a program get some other women, get some other people involved and they talked about it and Alma got Naranon started, that is how Naranon got started. You know this man, it is impossible for me to stand here and tell you everything; I can tell you that I moved out of the house that we lived in. It was hard but it was a rough neighborhood and I was told that there was no place around that I could afford so I moved. I do not know if that was true or not but I moved, and then I moved again and moved out to the desert. Each time it seems like I keep finding all these changes going on and people I know what they are saying "don't pay attention to her and blah blah blah" and I get this wall like and I just

think fuck um I belong in this program. I am an addict I will talk, I go to a newcomer I get phone calls and I talk to people on the phone and I walk up to a person. I love this program, I do not want to see it fall apart, and I think we do need some more checks and balances. For a couple of weeks I was in Washington and I wore this little top with an eagle on it. Jimmy always said if he came back he would come back as an eagle you know but I think about while I was there I got to see Congress in session. That was so fascinating to me it was just like wow. The guy who was talking was from California, he was trying to pass this bill, and they were all talking about addicts. I thought my God I walk in and , then I find out later on it is going to be life for a lot of the addicts for some of the things they have happening. That is frightening, that is very frightening, the next thing I know I am going to have to walk up and register that I am an addict. I am running across some of that as it is and some of the things that is happening in my life as it is and I am labeled, I am labeled that and I resent that.

You know it is so great seeing people here, I wish there were more here. It is so great to see people from California here. They need to get their ass out of California and mingle and get some of this straightened around. (Applause) So I hope from what comes from this. I hope it comes to the good that we do not turn around and do what we did before. Thank you very much. (Applause)

Tape 4
Montgomery History Conference
Speaker: Fawn

Hi my name is Fawn and I am an addict. Hi Fawn. Thank you Betty I really like what you had to say. Do you think I can bum a couple of cigarettes from people out there? I ran out and I have not had a chance to go and buy any. I have smoked so many cigarettes since I have been here. What is this, the 70s that we are talking about? Well that is what the agenda says. Well because I got here and surrendered to Narcotics Anonymous in 1978 in July and I had come back from a relapse. I had two and a half years before that and I had come through Cry Help when Bill Beck was the director. Back then this was a treatment center that housed about 60 people and they because NA the meeting were even though there were NA Meetings in the valley they were kind of not a lot of people at them so they did not want to unload us all on one suspecting NA Group. So they would send us to a lot to various meetings to AA and NA. I think there were like I do not know how many vans there were but they would divide us up. I very quickly through Bill Beck realize that the both fellowships were distinct and apart. I mean it was not very hard as sick as I was back then for me to realize that much. Even when I had 90 days the first time around and I took a chip at Radford I went up, Radford was this AA clubhouse up in North Hollywood. I went up to the podium and I said well I took my 90-day chip in Narcotics Anonymous so I am taking my chip for AA. I mean that was just you know I never ever was a time in any of my recovery or since I stopped using thought that both fellowships were the same and I think I got that initially from Bill Beck.

When I got out, I went to those AA meetings because where I was living with my AA sponsor at the time. I went to those Radford Clubhouse meetings and I would go to some NA Meetings but mostly AA. You know something happened along the way, when I was in Cry Help I wrote inventory and I tried to listen but when I got out I just sort of never went forward with my recovery. Eventually I stopped going to meetings, I never felt real comfortable in AA. I was always afraid when those men would say gee you look so familiar. I was afraid that they had picked me up hitchhiking and I had turned a trick with them or something. I always thought they were old johns and so I was always afraid that I would be found out in those AA meetings. I was kind of hard for me to get honest. I never thought I could cuss or talk about my drug addiction or the things I had to do. I kind of felt ashamed so I very rarely did I speak at AA meetings. I quickly like a good addict I got a job and bought some clothes and you know got a normie boyfriend you know a non-addict boyfriend. I was very needy and insecure at that time, it was a disastrous relationship, and I was in a lot of pain. One day I was sitting at this bar and this bartender said you look so miserable why don't you have a drink. I said I do not drink in a really bad way but the thought popped into my mind, I am going to go home and smoke me a fucking joint you know and that is what I did. So I always had a reservation about

drinking and smoking dope. I thought my problem was just narcotics and I did not see what the harm was. Well six months later I realized what the harm of that was and it really was not working. I was deathly afraid of going back out to the streets. So when I came back I went to that AA clubhouse and this old timer that was always around for I do not know how long who was standing by the coffee pot said hey what happened and I said I relapsed. He said well what happened and I said well I smoked some pot and I drank and he goes oh man that alcohol will kill you, the pot is okay even I smoke a few joints once in a while but that alcohol will kill you. Right then and there, I turned around and drove to the Survivors Club you know and I never went back to AA if I could help it, maybe once or twice. Something really interesting happened to me, you know I realized that I had always been afraid of addicts because they were my peers and I had to expose myself in Narcotics Anonymous. I could not hide out in NA you know I could not bullshit you people and I could not manipulate you people and I started to recover pretty fast. When I had about thirty days I went up on Mulholland Drive and you know I will never forget that turning point in my recovery. I just said okay God if you are really there I am going to turn it all over. I am going to cut loose the sugar daddy, I am going to cut loose the shoplifting I am going to cut loose the old man and everything. If you are really, there I am going to be okay and what they say is really true I am going to be okay. I was really scared after I did that because I thought am I really going to survive without my sugar daddy. You know I had that guy since I was fifteen and I was making such a measly salary. You know what things happened really fast you know I got involved in a relationship when I had about thirty days I met Douglas and he started to introduce me to all his friends. People who sort of scared me when I got clean the first time you know he would take me over to Greg' house. He really loved Greg, they use to sit there and make the jewelry and they had these rocks, these rocks all kinds of rocks and crystals, those Labrador dogs and it was real comfy to go flop down on his couch. The real blessing the real healing part or the real that stuck with me for all these years was when he took me over to Jimmy Kinnon's house and Betty's house. I never really knew much about Jimmy I just sat there in the living room and I felt real safe I felt like I was at my grandparent's house, right. Betty always had cookies, there was always coffee going, and Jimmy had a way when he talked to people in fact when they both talked to people. They never like shoved the steps and traditions in your face. First, they would just talk to me like I was a human being and made me feel at ease. They made me feel welcome and apart of, I felt that warmth, and it was just a magic feeling I had in that house. I started to change, I was not doing all of that dope fiendish bullshit anymore and I started to feel some self esteem come back and I started to like myself and some self-respect came back for me. I noticed at that time that the phone was always ringing and there was, Jimmy and Betty were always busy with stuff, with letters and literature and you know the World Service.

The next thing I knew I was being told about Narcotics Anonymous and it was a fellowship that can stand on its own two feet. Back then that was sort of a pioneering notion even as, I mean it was back then even some of the trustees that we have today back then were telling me to go get your message in AA and then come back to NA and share it, that is the way it usually worked. So the idea of staying clean in one fellowship was something that was pretty revolutionary at that time. I decided if this fellowship really works, I am going to make a commitment to it, just like the God thing. Next thing I knew I was over at the office helping out typing or stapling. Everything was very; it was not automated by any means. Everything was done by hand like Betty was sharing about stapling by hand. Sometimes the only volunteers that they could get were second phase residents from Cry Help who would come over. Their sponsors would bring them over to the house to the house, we would all sit around, and maybe the project for the night was folding the IPs, putting the creases folding them in threes. The job tonight is dooping tapes; they use to have this nothing like the dooping you see at conventions. I mean this old fashioned machine that would make I don't know, I don't know one or two tapes at a time I am not sure I was never involved in the taping committee. There was like Chuck Gates and Tony D or I do not remember whom. But you know what it was really the most beautiful service in my whole life because everybody dug everybody you know. Nobody was doing anything for money or power or anything it was just gosh. Every time a letter would come in from out of state, it was like the biggest event you know it was like God a letter from wherever. I remember one time Jimmy gave me a letter from a person from North Dakota and he said why don't you answer this letter. I said oh God what am I going to say? He did that a lot because I am starting to hear stories of other people now sharing about their times working in the office, that happened to them. We were okay doing the work but we did not want to be spokes people for the WSO. So we would write a letter and send them starter kits, and the typing back then was I felt like I was the relief typist for Betty when she would get too tired. Sometimes I would be typing and it was not the Selectric typewriter, it was the kind that had to have the little white piece of paper there and backup. So when you are typing it was in such a small little office and

you had to concentrate to not make a mistake you know. So much was going on, Jimmy was always in and out of those files, and there was always a discussion going on in the living room. There was always a lot of business going on and you know I started to love going over there. It was a very special time for me I use to go over there a couple times a week, as much time as I could I would go over there.

You know one time later on in my recovery there was this girl sponsoring me and she was an addict but she got clean in AA and she worked at the same place I did. You know I really wanted to bring her over to our side and I knew if I could just get her to Jimmy's house something would happen because I knew I could not talk that way. I knew that if he could touch her the way he had touched me then maybe she would come on over. So I finally got her to agree that she would come over to his house with me and I am real excited. It was at night so she said she only had two hours and Jimmy answered the door in his t-shirt and the real big boxer shorts so right away it was ,oh dear you know I hope this is not. So we go in, he invited us in and hey, what you say, that is the way he use to always answer the door. We had some coffee and we sat around and I am waiting you know I am sitting there thinking ok Jimmy say something heavy you know, get this girl (laughter) and I am in the middle encouraging conversation you know and the next thing I know he is talking about Pennsylvania. I wish I could remember the city. It was either Philadelphia or Pittsburgh but when he emigrated over here from Scotland he his first home was somewhere in Pennsylvania and somehow he was talking about the old days of when he was living in the city. So I am thinking ok this is leading up to something you know and he started to go on about it was a story about how him and his friend were being chased by some thugs and these thugs chased them up some stairs, him and his buddy. They were at the top of the stairs and there was no place to go so I turned around and put up my fist and next thing I know is that the two hours is almost up and I am thinking Oh God he has not said anything. He has not said anything spiritual and she is never going to come back here. Finally my friend said well I have to go you know and Jimmy said well come back again. As we are walking out I am feeling soooo, you know I am just like, oh God, of shit, what a drag you know and we get into her car and I am in the passenger seat and she gets into the car and it was a full moon I will never forget it. She looked out, she put the key in, and she said, that man has such light. You know that is what Jimmy was about. He did not have to say anything you know you spent a little while with him and you were touched by him. The way that he shared, the way that he cared and his devotion to extending his hand out to everybody that came into his life. I was always very; I always admired his devotion, his never-ending energy in that office. He rarely had any time for himself. We were always trying to get him to go to a meeting with us and he was always well you know I have to get this out or get that out. He rarely had very little time, him and Betty for themselves. Their house was like a 24-hour place you know phones never stopped ringing, people never stopped knocking and I never saw them turn away anybody at that time anyway.

Anyway, you know I was not around here in the 50s and I was not around here in the 60s and for most of the 70s but it, I was not stupid and it did not take me long to realize. See I was also involved with area, San Fernando Valley area service and Southern California regional service. I could see a lot of the politicking and the division and a lot of this stemmed from things that happened a long long time ago. A lot of it stems from a man like Jimmy Kinnon telling a lot of people a long time ago what violations of the Traditions and people were got their feelings hurt. Most of us who get our feelings hurt do not like that and some of us do not know how to express ourselves and ask for clarification. So we run away like hurt animals and stew in a corner or wait to lash out like snakes or something and I think a lot of that happened. You know there was a lot of just from my personal observation there was a lot of division even between Northern and Southern California. The fellowships, it was always who is better than who are. The San Fernando Valley, it was our area. Our area was always having qualms with the Bay Area. The Bay Area being out by the beach, the Southern California region it was always the Northern California region. I mean it was always something, there were not a lot of people involved in service back then, and so a lot of people wore two, three, and four hats. You belonged to this committee, you belonged to that committee, you were on H&I, and you were a volunteer at the WSO. It was a lot of things and I think when some of these whatever position you held at the areas and regions and sub-committees and then there was the Survivors Club you know you had the people who thought it should be and you had the people who thought it should not be. I mean it was always so many you know problems like that a lot of fighting. I mean when I cleaned up it was not unusual to hear that someone had kicked the shit out of somebody else after the Monday Night Meeting. I mean that was pretty so Danny T kicked the shit out of Tony D you know so what else is new, and somebody got shot in the Survivors Club. It was kind of, like what Bill was telling you

this morning it was really insane. In San Fernando Valley, it had a couple of rehabs there, I don't know. Is Pasadena apart of the valley, no not really, so it was just Cry Help. But there were a lot of penitentiary, a lot of the people who went through Cry Help had come from penitentiary so you had a lot of that dope fiend, criminal type attitudes people talking that. It was interesting, I dug it I was never that when I was using but you know it was ok I learned some new words and some new gestures. I got a good Camel habit from it. Anyway what I started to see happen was that NA started to grow and I do not know much about the BOT. I do know that Jimmy and Bill were members of the BOT for a long time. If I am not mistaken, I think back then you were lifetime members and they would trade around to see who was chairman for that year or whatever.

I have a lot of theories of what happened but one year in the Southern California Region they shot a letter off well I wrote it a letter off to the Bay Area saying if you are using AA literature in our NA meetings is a Tradition violation. The next month at that regional convention the Magdeleno's showed up with their cronies and they were ready to kick Doug F ass because they thought that he wrote the letter. That was a lot of your bullshit right there. Unfortunately, it was very hard for people to talk civilly with one another there was always an atmosphere of like I am going to kick your ass or something. Anyway, Douglas worked at the office so I guess that was more fuel to add to the fire from the old Sylvia Magdeleno days I do not know. So now, they were going to get Jimmy K or something. Jimmy K never involved himself with the area and the region like that but he was always there to supply them literature when they could not get their shit together when they could not get their literature committee to get their literature for their own area. They would just say well let us just go to Jimmy's house and get it. He would let them use the Xerox machine to Xerox their minutes or whatever.

Therefore, there was a lot of tension building and then I do not know sometimes I feel that when I look back at all of that, I feel like I witnessed a holocaust or something because it was ugly. It is very hard for me to share that part of our history because some of the people that did us the most harm were our friends. I can remember Christmas caroling with these people, I can remember fellowshipping with these people and going to their homes you know laughing at them at the Survivors Club, inviting them to share at the Cry Help marathon on New Years Eve. I was probably the only one in the valley that thought that the BOT really meant a shit. I can remember that I went to Jack Bernstein and I said hey I got a great idea for the marathon. I am going to have every BOT speak and you know nobody really thought at that time thought so what. It was a great marathon because you had your people who were trustees who had been clean for a long time there. You know I had enough respect for the BOT in that part of my recovery.

Somewhere a long the line there was a movement of the Basic Text came to be. It was a thing that had to come, it was needed. The only problem was that somewhere a long the lines some people who were highly respected in the Narcotics Anonymous chain started planting some seeds to people out in the east out in the Midwest about what Jimmy was doing, who he was, what his problems were. This was kind of, sort of a shock to us at the office because we would get it third hand, like what the hell is going on? Jimmy was never going to suspect his closest friends having anything to do with it and who would suspect anybody with any time clean to start doing that kind of stuff. So before you knew it we were like constantly defending the office. I will tell you that for as much work as had to be done it was a real hindrance to have to do that. When Betty spoke of the WSO board at that time the decision to elect a new board was based on the fact that the board was doing. The people in the office were doing so much of the work that maybe and we had to take such a defensive stand continually about what the office was doing that we decided fuck it. Let us just vote in a board and have it be all the volunteers you know it made sense to us. Then we know where all of us stand, we are all here for the same purpose. I do not know how that came about I forgot but I could probably dig it up but that is why the decision was made. We did not know where all the dissension and bullshit was coming from. We had some ideas but that is what we decided, that is what made the most sense. That really did not change anything of how the office was run. We all still did the same shit. We still are were expected to do exactly what we were doing before.

[End of Tape 4]

I do not remember the exact; I do not know who was there. I remember Greg that you asked me, you said something

about I guess you were concerned about the office being in Jimmy's house. You said, maybe you should be the one to tell Jimmy you know. I remember thinking at that time because I was so in awe of you that you were a trustee. I thought that well maybe he has a point. I actually thought that, but then the second thought that came to my mind was why you did not do that, that was your sponsor. So, you know I did not understand what was going on at that time.

Anyway, the next thing that started to happen was that we started to receive. Like the feeling at the office was that oh okay, the fellowship wants the office out of Jimmy's house. All right let us see if we can get an office close by if that is all they want you know let's try it. We all talked about it but there were no funds for rent. Nobody ever thought out here, anywhere outside of California. Nobody stopped to think you know where is all this money coming from? Douglas at that time was the chairman of the Southern California region and there were only meetings at that time one a month or once every two months, I forget every two months right. Now what happened was we got wind of this about two months before the next coming up conference. The regional had already happened and so Douglas called up all the ASRs in the region on the phone. I was there, I heard it and there was nothing sneaky about it. It was even in the guidelines at that, time that emergency meetings, could be called for discussions could be over the phone. He called up every ASR and explained look at the World Conference we want to get the WSO into an office you know and we do not have any money to do it. It will most likely be an issue at the World Service Conference and so we need eight hundred dollars, that is what we needed for the rent the first and last or whatever, yes first and last. So ASR said yes every ASR and when the treasurer, I forget her name but she was from the Bay Area. When she was asked for the check, she said ok I will get it over to you tomorrow and she never came with the check. What she had done was gone to somebody I don't know who and next thing you know I think it was Chuck Skinner and somebody else on the BOT start shooting messages to the entire fellowships by letter, do not send any more money to the WSO, without telling the WSO their intentions. This was this created a lot of disunity first of all it usurped the trustees stepped in and were trying to essentially do the job of the chairman of the Southern California Region. At that time, my feeling was that nobody ever had the balls to confront one another. It was always done behind everybody's backs. We got into the office in the end anyway but the real intent of everything was to not get office out of Jimmy's house but to get Jimmy out of the WSO. That was the real intent and that was realized at that year's conference.

I watched you Greg. I am sorry; I watched how you used people on the east coast. You used Jim Miller, Joseph Procter and Bo Sewell to do your bidding. I do not know why you found it in your heart that, I do not know why you could not have gotten up to the podium and made those motions. But every time Chuck Gates said that motion is out of order and it will not be heard here, they would come running back to your table. You the great thinker and leader that you were would tell them how to reword that motion. I watched you, we were this far apart. You know how I know. Because at lunchtime when all those people went out to lunch Bill Beck and I went up to those tables and tore all your mother fucking notes up. You know because you came with a fucking strategy like you were out for blood, we saw these notes, and it was like a chess game. You had it all, it must have taken you months to figure how you were going to fuck this old man you know basically. So we went around very the dope fiends that we were, excuse me very much and we just took your notes and tore them up and I will admit to that and it felt good because to watch all of you to come back to your seats with your asses showing not knowing what to do. What am I going to do now we have to start all over? But you quickly reassembled and so at least we knew who the monster was by that time. I feel at that time that a lot of the RSRs coming in from the Midwest and the east coast and outside of California they were coming and they were witnessing something ugly and something untrue. You were hearing people air their dirty laundry from twenty years ago. You know I guess that is what I am doing today, I mean you guys wanted to hear that. I am glad that Bo and Greg finally showed up. Tell you the truth Bo, you know at all the conventions that I have run into you I have thought that it was very obvious that I did not want to talk to you and it has always made me uncomfortable when you keep trying to approach me. I have thought certainly by now you must know how I feel, so now that we are face to face and you know how I feel. Last night you guys missed something good because just about everybody in this room came up and talked about why they were here. You know I did not hear many people talking about you know they want to know what happened and they want to know why it should not happen again. You know these are some of the things you want to know.

Jimmy Kinnon at one point, Betty was very right on about this I remember it. Jimmy Kinnon refused to believe that certain people he grew up with in Narcotics Anonymous would do this to him, would really and truly betray him like

this. That is why Bill Beck taped that phone conversation you know and we had to take it back and let Jimmy listen to it and he was floored, he was hurt. The thing with the Basic Text you know I can kind of understand it you know, it was your baby. You know this was your baby your thing that you worked on. I know what it feels like to love something you know to hold onto it, because that is what I felt like about the office you know that was my, our baby. We thought we were doing what was best for the addict you know. We wanted to be apart of that just like you wanted to be apart of the Basic Text thing. The office never wanted to stop the Basic Text from coming around. You blindly side stepped the office; you refused to even acknowledge that the office even existed. The ways and means that you went about, the ways and means that this fellowship went about to throw this man out and lock him out of the office was disgraceful. I you know in 1982 I said fuck you California and I left. I left Douglas and that stinking state and I said I am never going to a conference again and I am never being of service in the structure until it is right. To me in my opinion it has only gotten worse because now what has happened is you are all sitting there saying what happened you know. Well you know what you assholes put those people in there you know I mean maybe not you per se but the people that represented you went out there. They were used and manipulated and what do they do now buy you a shrimp dinner, I mean you go out there now and you have the innocent RSRs that represent thousands of people, thousands of people and all they go by is the agenda. You go there and man, I know how these people are. I have worked with them and I do not have any respect for most of them. They do not intimidate me with their time you know I know what they do they lobby. They take these RSRs and they tell them how to vote, come on. You know what if we were really following what this fellowship wanted half this shit that comes on the floor would never come up our conferences would only last a day you know. Those are the issues in the fellowship they do not have anything to do with this other crap. The other thing that has been going on for years and years, why should a person who represents nobody get a vote you know that has never made since to me. What do they want to have now sixty-five trustees? You know something else that the forefathers of our constitution wrote, they realized that power corrupts well I see how power has corrupted our fellowship. I see it happening today you know when I work with sponsee's they do not know. I rarely tell them what I did, yeah I tell them that I knew Jimmy and Betty and Bill but I do not tell them about all that shit. I never tell them, you know how they hear it, when they hear me on a tape or they hear me at a convention they are floored because it is painful it is very painful. I pray man I cannot tell you how much fucking sage I lit and incense I burned and prayers I said. You know fuck it here it is. To me you know the founder of this program is Jimmy Kinnon and sometimes I think the reason, the reason it is so hard for some people in this fellowship to acknowledge that is because they do not want to be held accountable for their actions. If that means inventing up a new fucking history then that is the lengths they are willing to go to, then I say go home and clean house. That is what I did I resigned from this bullshit and if I had anything to do with it I am out of it. You know I am sorry this is not the way I planned it.

All I see now at the WSO is confusion and the thing of exclusion. I think all you know what they are collecting out there; they are not collecting the spiritual saints of our program. They are collecting the big thinkers the politicians you know. So when you go out there do not forget that you are representing your people you know your home group. Another thing that uses to be one of the sore points is a lot of addicts, I guess it is their tendency to think well if someone else will do it for us let them do it. That is why it took us so long to get a book, because shit we had an AA book, you know fuck it why fix it if something is working. One of the issues I saw becoming a problem was do not send an RSR with a vote of confidence. We are humans we are going to go there if you give us free rein to vote anyway we see fit. We are just going to be voting on everything. An RSRs purpose I believe is to represent the conscience of his people that he represents and that has been the falling away. NA worked better when we had nothing when we had no money, when we had nothing you know. I have seen how money, property, and prestige have continued to hurt people. I do not like these ideas about 12 concepts being handed down to me and taking my vote away, you know taking my voice away. It has gotten very smooth you know out there and to me what I see it is just a chipping away of taking away your voice. You can come up here with all your fine big words and stuff but to me that is all it is you just want to hold onto your power. I meant to really just get up here and talk about the Jimmy that I knew but there is so much information out there about that personally met the man and what he did for people. A lot of people got hurt, a lot of people got hurt. Back then when Southern California when all this shit was happening we could not go home after the conference and talk about all this shit because first of all who the hell would believe us you know. So we took it out on each other. We fought at home we yelled at each other in the car. I remember almost strangling Jerry Pulcarro one year you know because I was so upset. I invited my sponsor who was

not involved in service Cathy to come to the conference and I said come on you would meet all of these people from out of state. You know she sat in the back and wept, she was disgusted you know. All I can tell you is maybe there are some pioneers sitting in this room tonight that can carry on the spirit of Narcotics Anonymous in the way that it was introduced to me along time ago. About helping one another about including all of us and how we are all important and how we all have something to offer one another. I just wish that here were more people here today and you know I use to hear the old saying that resentments will kill the addicts. No, they have not killed me, rejection will kill me but I have lived with this part in my recovery this whole time. I will be clean thirteen years in a couple of weeks and all this time this is the only area in my recovery that is not resolved, the only part. You know I think this fellowship owes an apology to the Kinnon Family. I think they owe an apology to a lot of people. I think they have to stand up if the want my respect they have to stand up and say some things. You know say what, I ask God for understanding but I am not hearing any. That is why I am here; I want some light shed for me. I love Narcotics Anonymous. I would not be here today if it were not for Narcotics Anonymous. Everything that is good in my life is a result of Narcotics Anonymous, my children, my husband, my home my friends, my clean time, my health, everything. I am not the same person as I was when I got here. Once upon a time I was taught we get involved in service to stay clean we are all replaceable you know so I just want to say that. Thanks for letting me share. (Applause)

Tape 5
Montgomery History Conference 1991

Speaker: Bob B. - Thanks Fawn, I am excited let me take a deep breath here and relax for a second because I don't even know most of this stuff and I got real excited so I imagine some of you guys are jumping around. In fact maybe we can have another moment of silence, everybody. Then let us get on with it. Bob you want to come up here and talk a little bit about the office too, yeah Bob we got lots of time. (Applause)

I got so involved with what Fawn was talking about that I had almost forgot there is a lot of things that go along with what she was talking about. Some things are out of sync in terms of time frame and that is okay too because I think they can be taken care of in terms of what times they happened and what order they happened in. I think we have to be responsible for about a lot of things we had to do at any given time. Sometimes we have to make hard fast decisions, not everybody is going to like it, and somebody is going to get hurt, me, you and everyone else here. We have to resolve that within ourselves in terms of hoping that we are doing our best that we know how to do at that particular time. It is unfortunate that there were feelings hurt. I think feelings were hurt probably on both sides, the ones that were perpetrating and the ones that were perpetrated against. I don't like to make decisions, I don't even like to be apart of them most of the time if I can just let it happen by itself by some osmosis or something I would probably let that take place. However, we are living in a real world and sometimes we have to take those risks about making those decisions that are unpopular. Somebody is not going to like it and that is the way things are. I wish the world was different but it is not and human nature is different and it is what it is.

During those growing years and I think one of the things that happened during those growing years. You are talking about yes we had great labors of love that went on that we could do voluntarily. As we grew we out grew the possibility of doing those things on a voluntary level. Yes, I was in agreement with one of the decisions that were made that was kind of very difficult. It was not made in terms of whipping nobody or forcing nobody. It was kind of a decision that was made that was thought was necessary for the time. Yes I was apart of that, that agreed at the time that Jimmy needed to step aside and let somebody be another office manager. As you so stated earlier he knew about it beforehand. The way it was done I probably did not agree with the way it was done. I was not apart of how it was done, I was in agreement that it should have been done, and it was. I do not know of any soft pleasant ways to say, to do things that are difficult. I do not know if I could have carried out the act myself, personally.

Greg and I our self were dismissed from the office board because we were so much involved with the BOT directly that they had or felt they had to make some of those decisions. Once again, we are talking about the relationship

between the conference and the BOT or the people who thought they were in power or in power to do something. Sometime we felt that we were in power to do something because we had no other oppositions, nobody to tell us different. Even by the authority of Jimmy because he was apart of that same decision making policy for a lot of years himself along with us. There was nobody else to make those decisions. Sometimes we had to it upon ourselves only by the sake of what do we think is best for the fellowship as a whole. How do you think we should accomplish it? Set about the wheels in progress of doing it and taking the flack that came back from it. A part of the flack was disagreement not we took hey we remained a whipping boards for many years even we were not involved in the decision-making. They did bring the conference along and the conference that came from across the nation. Hopefully you sent you best personnel to do that job to carry your thinking and your ideas from that particular area, region to participate in what happens in Narcotics Anonymous. Hoping you are getting your personnel selves out of the way and trying to work in terms of NA as a whole. Yes, we have a lot of strong personalities in Narcotics Anonymous. I mean we will fight for our right to be wrong. I guess it is rightly so in many ways as that is the reason you are there to deal with what comes before that particular conference and what was before the World Service Office. I do not agree that the WSO is no great power personally. There may be a lot of things that are happening at the WSO that I do not agree with. I am not apart of World service myself personally and everything that I do, I do on my own and I like it that way. It gives me some other latitudes and not a matter of agreeing or disagreeing with anyone. It is called what Bob feels is purposeful for him and what I think is best for the job to be done. Hopefully the division, which we are talking about, is not irreparable. I think it is something that we have to learn how to come together even when we disagree. To find out that objective in which we are trying to achieve and find out how we can best implement whatever method in order to achieve that objective. The WSO yes if it, but hey we never had a WSO to go back to or have a history of.

We had to build from scratch and to make all the mistakes as necessary when you are trying to start a business. We have never been along this road before and I do not know nobody else that has been along this road the way that we have been along this road. This is all new it was all new territory. Jimmy in his wisdom was not an administrator in terms of running a business. He was a roofer. He had certain knowledgeable things of how to do things but that was not one of them. Business was not one of his hold cards. He even went to school to try and learn some things about some business things but he was not prepared for the momentously job that came about at the time of the publication of the Basic Text. It was almost overwhelming not only talking about dealing with the people that ran off, or went bankrupt on Narcotics Anonymous. It is part of the carry over of saying that the WSO of yesterday is the same WSO of today is not true either. It is a market ably different completely. I think that there are a whole number of things that we have to come to understand that was happening yesterday perhaps is not happening today hopefully. Hopefully, we have learned in our making of whatever mistakes we have made that there was some areas that needed to be taken care of. But it is incumbent upon you as a fellowship because they are doing the job very often, of what you tell them to do, to be involved in making those decisions. In other words you give them, the work to do hopefully you will let them do the work. Very often, I notice one thing there is a lot of interference. You give them a job and then you tell them how to do it. What is the use in giving them a job if you are going to tell them how to do it? Hopefully you will get someone in there that knows how to do it, because all those people are replaceable. We are all replaceable. Now if you think somebody in there is getting out of hand and got to much power, remove them. (Audience: How?) By whatever methods it takes to have somebody removed. Now if you are asking me how, I do not know how, right I cannot give you an answer but you have the power to do it the fellowship has the power to do that. Now you find out how. Do not leave it on me because that is what we have been doing before passing it off to somebody else. How we going to do that, you come over here and do it for me. No, you have to get involved in the process; you must get involved in the process. Sometimes we do not like to get involved in the process because we do not want to be unpopular either. We are going to get pointed at he said that. We do not like to be unpopular; we all want to be very popular. Some of us are going to have to stand our ground and be unpopular. Sorry that way it is, is the way it is, especially if you are standing in the position where I am standing in front of a podium telling you about certain things. At some point, I might be unpopular because I am going to say something perhaps that nobody do not like. Hey, it is ok, it is all right. I understand human nature and where it is coming from, but I think we have a meeting ground that we can all work together on. I have found that time and time again. If I have learned nothing more than that from Jimmy, I have learned that we could work together regardless of what this here head get off on tangents on that we can work together. We do that particular process on finding the common ground on which we can work

together.

The office, the WSO you know even in its infancy was merely, started out more of a collecting place where people could meet, where we established an address and a Post Office box. Where we gathered the material that was, suppose to be sent out, this job becomes larger and larger and larger. I do not really believe that some people can really visualize the scope of world level organization. I think it is almost incomprehensible unless you go and sit down a day and see the operation of a world level organization. To know how much work is involved in operating a world level organization. We become very centralized and think that all that needs to be taken care is our immediate meeting place or area and we forget that this is a world organization. You understand a world organization that has many complexities and many molds of understanding that are not like ours that have to be dealt with. There are many tasks to be performed in the process of bringing it all together and carrying the message.

So until we can realize or visualize that concept of a world organization and that somebody is trying to put the pieces together and hold it together I think we are kind of short changed in understanding as to the work that needs to be done. I heard it said somebody was talking about going back to the volunteer system. I hope that you form your own individual volunteer system to take care of the works that need to be done in the immediate area. See because when you get so far a field of doing everybody else's works that we do not take care of the work at home. One of my reasons for they say not being at world level in fact is at being at no level in terms of where there is any titles is the freedom which I have to do as I please in a sense of speaking. Not only that, the need for me to grow is the need for me not to have a title is to be just another member of Narcotics Anonymous. To see what job needs to be done and trying to be apart of that job that needs to be done. It simplifies it for me; it makes it very simple for me. I think one of the things about they say at the WSO you hear me talking about the early days you know that yes we had difficulties.

There was a lot of differences of opinion of who ran it or what or how. I think as I said my thinking then and had always been that Jimmy would always be a part of Narcotics Anonymous and never to not have a place at any given time. I keep hearing this thing We threw him out, yes they had changed the locks on the door, I was unaware of the changing of the lock on the door but that was done by the new manager that was not one of us in the sense of speaking that was done by the. For whatever reasons he must have thought that was the way to do things, I do not know, because I did not ask him I knew it was an event that occurred. It would not have been a way that I would have handled it but the event did occur, but he still had a place. Everybody that was on the BOT knew that he had a place in Narcotics Anonymous. The fact is they sat a place aside for him that he could put anything and do what he wants to at the office. So part of the idea that he had no place at Narcotics Anonymous, I do not know where that comes from. I know where it came from but I am not going to get into it I am not going to give no more copy on that. It occurred there were many bad feelings as were talked about earlier as a result of it. Part of the separation is still there a lot of the hurts is still there. It is unfortunate that they are, you know I wish that it could have been some very smooth way of dealing with it I do not know. That is past that is history that is history. So I think we can only go from today.

Today is a very historical moment in terms of we have been able to discuss what has been going on. Maybe to be able to come to a better understanding as to what transpired , because I think much of the attitudes and what I am hearing has been champion in this particular area, I do not know why. But we are still talking about that misinformation this morning. We have a lot of misinformation because sometimes we do not want to talk to our partner who has the information. Sometimes all it takes is the question, what happened, how did it happen, who said what. Sometimes we do not even ask the question because we want to conceive in our head that this is the way it happened, and this is the way it happened, and that is not the way it happened at all. But we get entrenched there, I do at many times and I have to get back to that place of keeping an open mind. Get back to that place of keeping your open mind, get back to that place of keeping your open mind, practicing these principles once again getting back to some basics because we are talking about recovery. I am not talking about service at all because the item I must do is recover from all these here character defects and shortcomings that I have. I am still in recovery although I might be in service I am in recovery and I hope I am always in the process of recovering. Because, I don't know what I would do if I got well, see I know to many people that got well, and we have buried a few people who have gotten well, and I don't want to

be apart of that. See I am learning how to live today and I think one of the processes here in terms of saying dealing with offices and dealing with conference I think we have to get back to the people. The people are the one that represents it if you are not being represented then you need to get you somebody that will represent you, very simple. How did they get into office in the first place, you put them there. How do you get them out of office, you take them out same way and I realize we got some strong personalities and hopefully that we will learn in the process is that we do have a voice. Sometimes you must stand up, speak, and say what you must say. Sometimes you have to be unpopular in the process. Because the one that is going to best represent you may not be, the one that is loudest and they think they got the most power. You might have to watch that person over there thinking clearly making good decisions that might be the one you want up there to represent you the way you need to be represented. So we best have some choices in that area, mostly we have to be apart of that process. There is no place in Narcotics Anonymous where you cannot be effective in some way. I am glad it is that way. We all have some idea that someone up in some hierarchy is running things. Most of the things they are doing are things that you told them or gave them permission to do. By your representation, it may not be by word, but by your representation and what you thought was implied that you thought you wanted to have done. They are doing it to the best of their ability on all cases I know of they are doing it to the best of their ability. There are some mistakes made along the way. In none of these instances do I know anybody that had not made mistakes. That is the nature of the human nature; they will make mistakes if they are human. I know damn well if a computer makes mistakes, I know damn well people can.

So the office had been kind of a thorn in many people's sides because that is where you get your information from. It is usually written so that it cannot be distorted by this is what you heard. See the rest of it you can pass off as this is what I heard, and so they are not responsible. Yes they are they are spreading bullshit, they are responsible. But you can always point at the WSO because they did not document it there and they sent you the paper. You got the paper right in front of you and they said so and so and so. It may be a response to something that you said but you got it documented so they become the target. They are very; the target is the WSO, right. Sometimes you do not want to say that the conference was involved because the conference usually tells the WSO what to do. You do not want to say that because they are your immediate peers, they surround you so you do not want to blame them. Therefore, you do not use them, because you can question them you do not want to talk to them so you focus on the WSO. The WSO is full of shit. If they are, you pumped them up.

Fawn: Just say it Betty

Betty: I would like to ask you a question. Is there trustees working in the WSO right now?

Bob: I do not think so

Room: musical chairs

Bob: No, what musical chairs, what trustee is working in office.

Betty: Are they involved in the conference, I mean are they ( ) checks and balances in there

Bob: They are part of the conference,

Betty: ( ) checks and balances in there

Bob: Yes, with the conference it is.

Room: No, not anymore

Bob: When did they change it?

Room: The bottom line is that there are more BOD represented, trustees and special workers who ( ) that counts

Bob: Well what I am saying is . . .

Room: the people sitting in the house and in the gallery that don't vote and BOD and trustees that do vote that their RSRs did not ( )

Bob: Well, if that is the case, then maybe you need to change your guidelines.

Room: They do not follow guidelines that we approve, nothing

Bob: Wait, wait, wait a minute, who said they don't?

Fawn: I have been on World Lit and I have seen

Bob: See you said World Lit; I am not on World Lit

Room: (everybody is talking at once)

(Somebody stepped to the mic) Excuse me, excuse me everybody, hang on for a second now. Now before this gets to far out of hand everybody is going to get their chance and all the sides are going to be heard. Let us not try to get to defensive here and attack here and just try to come together and put it on the table. A lot of us here do not know nothing and we want to hear all of it in due time though and we cannot all hear it at the same time. Why don't we allow the person who is sharing up here to finish sharing? We are going to have an agenda setting up kind of thing at nine o'clock and we can start maybe setting up a way that a lot of these things can be answered. We have the whole weekend we have the whole weekend. Let us let this thing take its course now and let everybody get their say.

Room: Why are we afraid of the (motion, emotion) there is nobody going to attack him, we are being spontaneous and sometimes

Podium: Unfortunately, nobody can hear everything though; we need to do it in an orderly fashion. There will be time for this. I am not the director of what is going on here (audience remarks) but I am chairing this meeting and it is in a format. If we could

Betty: Can we, I understood that when we came here we would be able to ask questions of the speaker, so if we raise our hands and ask questions is that allowed?

Podium: Is that ok

Bob: That is ok with me because I am not the authority of anything so you asking me once again as I said before you will are asking me questions that I am not an authority on. So I cannot give you a solid answer that you can bank on. I cannot give you that; I do not have that authority. Folks you are asking me questions that are not in my scope or realm of answering.

Room: Well you have been giving us a lesson on spiritual principles and what we were asking you is to tell us about what happened in the office in the 70s and you have not said a word about that.

Bob: Well that is what was happening in the office in the 70s up through the 80s.

Podium: Do you want to take questions?

Bob: Yes, I will take questions it is ok.

Podium: Ok Bob will just sort of point to people and we will ask questions in an orderly fashion. Is that ok with everybody?

Room: Do we need a microphone or

Bob: Well I will repeat your question if you will. Yes dear

Audience: When you made a statement, about we elect the RSRs ok, and we need to look at whom we are electing to send out to the conference to represent our conscience ok. When we do that and there are, motions passed and those RSRs come home and somewhere along the line in a few months, the rules get changed ok. Things start happening and the RSRs say that is not what happened that is not what got passed. I do not know where this piece of information came from but it has a WSO letterhead on it and the BOT signatures on it. How does that happen?

Bob: That is a good question that I cannot answer

Room: That is the point that I would like to bring up because I have participated and it is frustrating and spiritually corrupt you know. Let me ask you this. This is something else that comes to mind you were sharing about when the locks were changed and that the trustees is that correct voted on it

Bob: Yes, the Conference and the Trustees, both.

Audience: to ask Jimmy to resign or move aside and let some other manager gets in there and does the job done. Am I understanding you correctly? When those locks were changed and that man's life was devastated.

[Side two]

Tape 5
Montgomery History Conference 1991
Speaker; Bob B.

Room: It happened and it happened and I do not blame the man for not opening the door for one or two people that were the instruments of the coo because it was widely known who they were. Now maybe if some other people on the board had gone there but you know why that son of a bitch went there. He did not go there to carry any message. He went to that door to gloat and that is why he was not, because this is a man who opened the door for anybody at any time twenty-four hours a day and I find it most unusual. But not really when you think of the implications there of that finally there were two people that he would not open the door for man. They fucking killed him, they aggravated his cancer and killed him and put him in the fucking grave.

Bob B. Next

They are in the minutes, in the minutes of the World Service Conference there is a BOT packet and I can not call the name right off. But it was six months after the event occurred with the locked door that in a resignation letter that the chairman of the BOD or the vice chair said I could not bring myself to tell Jimmy of any this or make an apology so therefore I resign. I have got that in my archives.

Bob B. Great it was Chuck, I know who it was it was Chuck Gates.

Room: Meaning we got everybody laying low here, we can't be laying low.

Bob: Well that is what I am saying here we are talking about. Who is laying low I don't know about anyone laying

low.

Room: Did you do anything wrong then? That is what we want to hear, that is our history.

Bob S: No, I don't feel I have done anything wrong no. That is what I have said I have done the things in the best interest of Narcotics Anonymous when I made my

Room. Can I ask my question please.

Podium: If you come up and give your name it would probably help a little better with the tapes. If you don't want to, that is ok, but if you don't that is ok, just keep that in mind.

Lawrence: I am an addict named Lawrence, hi Lawrence. I have to remember that I am an addict and possibly that is what we should reflect on before we come up here. You know it seems like Jimmy was offered a kind of what ever you want to do kind of appeasement after the fact is that true

Bob: Before and after

Lawrence: it was before and after, it was before they locked him out. So he was offered after they locked he out and before (Bob:Yes, both times) okay. Now Fawn mentioned that there was a masterminding going on is this true? Is that true Greg? (various room responses) Then my other thing I am going to make this real brief. With the present composition of the World Service Conference there is no way that an RSR any RSR is in power or engenders what we send them to represent. There is no way just with the composition of the RSRs can they carry a two-thirds vote to get anything passed. Just with the nature of the way motions are inputted in to admend and they way they are sent back out a lot of the motions are substituted right there on the floor. I saw this just this year, I saw it. The conference procedure and the way just everything was violated you know and I was going to ask the RSR of Alaska you know right here how can the RSRs get anything passed with the present composition of the conference. There is no way we can be in power to get rid of Stu Tordman or to get rid of the people that are really starting all of this shit here. How could the WSO presently and the boards presently if they do not want to recognize it or deny it and then don't really know nothing about it. Then the special workers we have don't know shit about it either. So how can anything be engendered by the representative by the other fellowship with the present composition. It just cant happen, I mean yeah we might have to bear arms to get them out or something.

Podium: Excuse me, excuse me if we can do this in an orderly fashion it would be more responsible for us

Tape 5B
Montgomery History Conference 1991
Speakers; Greg P, Bill B, Bo S

My name is Greg and I am an addict. Hi Greg. The question was, was there a master plan. There was not a master plan for me. Today's workshops has dredged up a lot of pain for me too because I do not see myself as Judas. I love Jimmy more than any other human being before or since. I am sorry that we were passed the 70s because this was on the 70s and what the pain is in the '90s, the '70s were a wonderful time by and large. In '79, we began having problems. A lot of that had to do with some of the stuff that Fawn talked about. One of the things that she did not mention was the attempts to change "Another Look" and the impact that, that had and the divisiveness that had. I am going to talk about the 70s from my perspective. I came in 1970 and the people I looked up to were people like Bob and Bill and Mel and a bunch of other people. I learned from them and they taught me how to live. We ran together and we were a family. It was a wonderful time and there were a lot of wonderful firsts in the 70s. There has been a lot of the divisiveness brought up that happened in '80, '81, '82, '83, and '84, that did not happen in the '70s. The '70s were pretty much a joyous time in Narcotics Anonymous. They began with some tension between Northern and

Southern California that is true but out of that grew a lot of unity. Bill you can remember a meeting we all had in San Luis Obispo at Bib's house. When some of those hatches were set aside. Betty was there to I believe. There was a time when I think Bob, Jimmy and I rode up to Northern California in '73 to San Francisco to try to heal some of those wounds and there was some tremendous healing. The '70s were a special time, they were a time when we began to really grow, where fellowships started and stuck for the first time. I have a stack of documentation, when I do history I try not to put a lot of opinion into it I try to stick with the documentation. I did not bring any of it with me because this is about feeling now. I found something in Narcotics Anonymous that changed me. I came here and I found a new life and I found it in parking lots and I got it talking to Bob and I got it talking to Jack Whaley and I got it talking to Karen Craft and Cliff and all those folks that were so ,and Pepe, so important. Many of whom are dead today. Perhaps personally after about 1972 I learned everything or virtually everything I know about Narcotics Anonymous from Jimmy and there were some wonderful things.

One of the things that have been talked about some is the division between the BOT and the WSO. The WSO was originally formed had a BOD of six people. The BOD included Jimmy, Betty, Bob, myself, Don Keith and one other person who was it, Bill. Of those six, four were trustees. There was no separation, there was no separation at all because there were only a handful of people doing this stuff and the communication was easy. The mid '70s were a magic time. We started getting some things in I have a Twelve Steps as practiced by one member that came form Northern California which was really a peace pipe in my opinion which was an offering following all the controversy that was involved with the plagiarized. This is Narcotics Anonymous Book that was published. All that anger and all that fear and all that paranoia and all that myth information and mis-communication. The mid '70s saw a time when we really tried to heal that and the service structure that we know today grew directly out of an attempt to heal the wounds between Northern and Southern California. It was written in the later part of 1975 following that meeting between about 60 people getting together in the middle of California. The first WSC was held in 1976 part of that the BOT made all the service decisions and business decisions for Narcotics Anonymous. There was the Parent General Service Organization, which it was started, in the mid 60s. The BOT had been started before or pretty much the same time and that was the decision making process for Narcotics Anonymous. The board implemented what the Parent General Service Organization (PGSO) recommended. That changed in 1976 and as soon as the change started taking place, it started being tampered with, the relationship between the board and the office. In 1979, the relationship between the board and the office changed radically when the blue service manual was adopted. That was the same period of time that "Another Look" and some of the other IPs were attacked. We also moved out of California. We had a growing series of World Conventions that were wonderful and a lot of the growth that has come to Narcotics Anonymous can be related directly to the World Conventions that were held in Houston, Wichita and Atlanta in 78, 79 and 80. We started getting groups and fellowships going. The fellowship here in Pennsylvania started in the early 70s. The fellowships Georgia started in the 70s, Florida, Texas, Nebraska, Kansas, Ohio and on and on and on. NA really got going in the 70s and the 70s was a joyous time, but it brought our pain with them.

I was not involved in a lot of things that happened in California after 1979 when I left and moved away. I was not involved in the day had I remember that meeting that several people have referred to. All I knew is that I got a registered letter saying that you will be removed in a meeting in 48 hours. That is all I knew and I said no I would drive down 700 miles. That was the first I had heard about it. I was also told that that was because I was trying to get Jimmy out of the office. I was also told that if I were ever seen again someone would kill me. In addition, the pain, I have a lot of pain to from that time period too around 1980. We all have a lot of pain from that time and maybe this is about healing some of that pain. Some of my pain stems from the rejection of the man I love the most because of misinformation from our friends. That is where some of my pain comes from. Some of my pain comes from a dream that he and I shared. The inability we had to communicate that a simple service system. Some of that pain comes from the death of dreams. I know that is where all of our pain comes from whether that is the pain that you guys shared the pain that Bob has the pain that many people have. The death of dreams.

You know someone said about service about everybody has made mistakes; hell at worst my service has been self-serving egotistical expression of my disease. At best, it has been a form of worship, it has been both, and I do not know anybody who can say anything different about their service. I was elected my first trusted servant position at the Monday Night Moorepark Group in December 1970. I was elected GSR and I could not take the position because

I did not have 90 days clean. Service taught me about life and I got feeling good. One of the things that has carried me through some of the difficult times has been the knowledge that the people that I have disagreed with and the people that have disagreed with me all care deeply about Narcotics Anonymous. One of the people that was involved in the office in the early days there are lots of , what about Maury W, what about Bibs W, what about the folks that were really instrumental in the early 70s, 1972 when we first opened the office right after the first World Convention. The moves the office went from Crenshaw Blvd. to Highland down to MPP . Was it down to MPP or Suicide Prevention, Suicide Prevention? Then picking up the pieces and moving it to Van Nuys Blvd to the Bail Bondsman and having a third of all the files and other things disappear in the process. Nobody knew where they were and having, stepping in to that a year or two later with three months worth of unpaid bills and a nonfunctioning office. That office above the bail bondsman I think Bill helped us get that in fact he may have been paying the bills part of the time, particularly when the office did not have any money. I mean our big budget in those days was fifty dollars for the month or twenty-five dollars for the month.

I had the opportunity to begin traveling. I agree that traveling is what bridges the gaps in the 70s. I was here in Pennsylvania in 1978 and I was in Kansas in 1978. I was in Atlanta in 77 no the beginning of 1978. I was in Chicago and attended their only meeting on one trip that I went out. I do business trips for the company that I work for and every time they would buy an airplane ticket, I found out for very little money I could buy a triangle flight and I could stop and see someone who had been writing the office and give them a little personal touch. Let them know that we are real people, that were the joy, and the 70s were a joy for me. The pain everyone is talking about is 80s pain mostly maybe it has roots long before. The two greatest pains in my life in Narcotics Anonymous have been the rejection of my sponsor when Phil and I went twice to try to talk to him in 1981 long before any of this came down and the failure of the service structure. To meet the vision that we all sat in that kitchen and shared for months. Was there a conspiracy against Jimmy Kinnon? I cannot speak for anybody but me. All I ever wanted to see Jimmy do was to be free to do the things he wanted to do. To write down history, to be in touch with the armed services. I certainly did not want to see him packing the boxes and burning himself up, that is true. I get a lot of credit for masterminding a conspiracy. I would not have masterminded anything. I mean most of you at one time or another, I will get to you Bill, most of you at one time or another has called me to ask me if I could help you rite a motion or how you should deal with a problem. It was not any different in the early 80s than it is today. I still believe that being a trusted is to be of service and to help people when they ask. I never intentionally did anything to harm my sponsor. I know I hurt him but I intentionally ever did anything to harm him. That is maybe part of the air clearing. Narcotics Anonymous though is more important than any of us. We have a Tradition that says principles before personalities and that are my personality and your personality. There was a time when Jimmy single handedly kept Narcotics Anonymous together. It was a round 1960, it is well documented. It is documented in Bob's story. It is documented in tapes by Jack Whaley and Chuck Skinner. They would go out to the meeting in Moorepark, there would be Jimmy, two loaded addicts, and the next week there would be Jimmy and two other. He single handedly kept Narcotics Anonymous alive. I also know that Jimmy felt very strongly about Narcotics Anonymous should never have a founder. He felt very strongly about Narcotics Anonymous starting as a group effort as a group not as an individual. He use to say things like we should never have any big shots in NA, no big mamas or big daddy's whatever the quote is. I do not know what the resolution is. I know that there are lots and lots of documentation. God I know when I left to go to Oregon I turned over virtually all my papers to the office, all the tapes that I had made because I use to do a lot of that reel to reel taping with Jimmy. The meetings we had on Crenshaw, the step study meetings wonderful times. I think maybe what happened and if I can add, anything to the perspective just from my perspective is as the lines of communication began to dissolve in the service structure we began to distrust again. We began to fear again and we began to lash out again. As it grew and as we could not communicate, we lost the simplicity of the individual person contact. Sometimes I think Jimmy's greatest contribution was being on the end of the phone for hundreds and thousands of people.

I mean I do not know what happened in the fifties. I read the minutes and there was a committee of six when we started and by the end of the year, they had all resigned and there were other people in there. Sounds like familiar to me. I do not know about the sixties I was not there but I know some things stuck. I know the literature the way we know it pretty much and the white book that was set in the sixties. I know that we published newsletters and did a lot of things in the sixties. Bill and Bob can answer those questions. The 70s were a time of spreading of Narcotics

Anonymous. In addition, the beginning of fellowships in the United States and foreign countries. Most of them died out but some of them stuck. I know that I was privileged to be apart of that. I know that there are a lot of people here that I love that were privileged to be a part of that. Bill you had a question for me.

Bill: I mean I heard you say that you learned everything that you got from Jimmy and you were on the fucking inner circle man. You were a brother you know you were right there. During all this period of growth as things started to come alive over here in the south and on the east coast and those people were a long ways away. Somebody was telling these people out here that there was a senile old man working in the fucking office that did not have his shit together. Now I do not know who that person was but I do know that there was a hell of a lot of phone calls from Oregon to everywhere down there. It may or may not have been you, you know your right you were on the inner circle you were close. If I could pray I would pray that it was not you man but my inner feelings say that for one reason or another some misinformation some how some way got planted firmly on this coast. This information then began to become relayed to the trustees. Bob was a traveler with his RV and so was Chuck Skinner. They began to go out and the messages were coming back. I went over to that office and I did not see any senile old man or anybody that was ineffective. I saw a shit pile of work that one man could not do it by himself and a bunch of goddamned volunteers that would not come forth to do it. So I am highly offended at the ideology from anybody in this fellowship be it from the BOT to the WSO that they could have possibly drawn a conclusion that here was an ineffective person man. I mean there is a right way and a wrong way to do things. I think that they just need to own up hey man a mistake was made I am sorry, we helped drive a nail in an old man's coffin. Some fucking rumors did some irreparable harm I would like to see it stop right here and now. I love you like a brother, I have known you for years like I know Bob. It is like hey man the man is a founder.

You were not here earlier when we talked all that shit about the guys from the Salvation Army and the Addicts Anonymous and Tender Loving Care. It is all beyond us; it is all out of the realm of our Traditions. They played no part in our frickin history. There may have been some ideology out there before. There was only one founder, he called the goddamn group together, and from there on there was a Narcotics Anonymous. It is like man this whole thing blows me away. Now we can I said it earlier, we can get on with our business and capsulate our history and write a book but let us bury the shit man. The old man is dead, he ain't coming back and it hurts like a son of a bitch you know what I mean. I think there was a Judas and hope it was not you but you are the only one that can own up to that and say, yea or nay, you know. I don't know, I really don't know I got no facts or figures I got no proof I only got a feeling in my goddamn gut and I have stood corrected many times in this program. Nobody will be happier than me to say I am sorry if I am casting an expursion in a wrong direction. But I want this thing to be dead once and for all I want us to be unified once and for all. This man I have had to go to his house for help the first time I learned about meditating I seen him sit up in his bed in the morning when I was sleeping there cause it was saving my life and I seen this guy sit up in his bed and start saying prayers. I went shit them people really do that you know man I could not believe it. I mean it has got to stop now man, and everybody has done a lot of good hard work.

My name is Bo and I am an addict. Hi Bo. Yeah I checked with Bob before getting up here. Before I even say this I want to say that I as a human being I have suffered. I have been suicidal in recovery I have been like sabotaged and stabbed in the back and many other places in funny ways. Just on, the technical, cold blooded, intellectual side you know it is real interesting how the disease puts us at odds with one another and the simple solution is always so illusive. There has got to be a plot a general thing a mastermind because we cannot accept how fucked up we are when shit happens. Then we have got this awesome force out there that could not kill us one way and we imagined it has gone away just because we stopped doing chemicals. I think that the disease of addiction gets away with a hell of a lot in our recoveries. I know that the disease of addiction gets away with a hell of a lot in our service structure and in any of the efforts that we do to help one another.

In this particular case the reason I went to Bob was because I don't want share somebody's personal conference but then I have since remembered that it was shared also at the WSC but I do not think that it was understood in context or particularly believed or seen that as absolutely true or relevant. What actually happened that may shed some light and I will share this in hopes that it sheds some light that if there was any mastermind involved it was this simple.

The fact that it is already known to you maybe go away and pray that through with Gods help or something and try to reach some level of acceptance or simplicity. Of course said Bo had some other things that Bro is trying to but in and say but I am not going to let him do it.

The way I understood it from my sponsor before Bob Barrett who is now my sponsor is that Chuck Skinner went out and spent a lot of time with Jimmy one day and they had talks about many things, which was not unusual. The book came up and Jimmy said I am president of NA and the book will be done when I say it is done. I did not know about this until years and years and years later. Maybe pieces of this I knew then but so this really upset Chuck Skinner, he was not happy. In fact, he was in such a rage that he left the house and stayed away and would not call would not visit would not nothing for at least two weeks. At the end of two weeks, he went back by and hopefully removes this thorn from his side and laughs it off. As I understand it with several meals, a trip in the airplane and a lot of good fellowship all day. At the end of the day, he somehow asked a similar question and Jimmy's response was identical. The phone calls through the entire existing fellowship started that day. Now I was in Atlanta and received one of those phone calls and I think I heard that they were going out before I received one because I was walking in the Highland Club in North Atlanta that was then on the corner of North Highland and Virginia Avenue. I remember the way I remember hearing that Kennedy was shot because I was driving up Eleventh Street in Atlanta towards old Baker Audio and I can remember the time and getting some tears in the eye. I remember hearing that these calls were going out and I can remember the parking lot and what I saw the same fucking way. I got the same fucking tears in my eyes except more because I realize something really heavy perhaps unavoidable but however it may have been was going on and that our world would never again be the same. You know just for what it is worth who here bleeds alone.

Tape 6A
Montgomery History Conference 1991
Speakers; Question and Answers

I am Mickey and I am an addict. Hi Mickey. I feel like something needs to happen all the time in my addiction. I am hearing all the answers and nobody is really stating the fucking question. What was the reason in the back rooms, on the conference and the BOD office that made the decision, we are going to fire Jimmy and hire another officer. What was the problem? Obviously the office grew a lot, obviously their were problems with the book, there was problems with printing. What was the specific reason that everybody said it was time to get a new office manager? We have heard how it happened, we have heard the dirt we have heard the pain. I even heard somebody made a decision I want to hear why. Why did we change officers?

I am still Bo and still an addict. Because I mean we, no it was not that we were going to get money it is because a lot of us just completely mixed ourselves out of that category. To where a person of integrity would not be such an issue at least on scores like that at later dates because we did what we did out of love and devotion. We exploded, we went from you know like when I met Jim Miller for instance there were maybe none or perhaps four meetings in the state of Ohio a year later there were 40 a year later there were 80 and a year later 120. I mean you know rooms this size you know we are starting with five meetings in the main city in a state. Five members there and then there would be five meetings in that town and then that neighborhood. I mean it was just exploding and there was like terrific energy ok. It is like I have not heard anyone else bring it out. I think Greg touched on it but it is like it is an honor to carry a hundred pounds for NA, it is still an honor. At about four thousand pounds it is no longer funny and stuff like that was happening to people and some of the people in this room were carrying loads like that with Gods help. You know God three thousand nine hundred ninety eight pounds and I will carry two, but some how we got through there and stayed clean you know. Maybe not totally sane but fairly clean. Jimmy had, well it is not like it was unprecedented historically. Winston Churchill did a lot for England and what does the British Government do, the immediately boot him out or they can say he has done his wartime and we will give him a rest.

Room: What is the answer to the question? What is the official reason?

Bob: Let me let me state this here

Bo: The growth of the office

Bob: There were a number of comments. No, no, no wait a minute I think that the question arose that the things that were happening at the office and the speed in which they were happening it was difficult for them to be responsive. We are talking about the volunteers getting the stuff out. We are talking about the contract being made with this person that went bankrupt. There were number of those particular types of issues, management issues that came up, that brought about the question of whether we needed new management at that time. That is what brought the question up. There were a number of incidents that leaned in the direction of perhaps maybe we need some new management somebody who would have some management skills that come out of the professional management of dealing with those types of things.

Room: What incidents?

Bob: Well we are talking about the money issue that went down between the printer and that was one of the big issues because that was a holler from all over the country.

Room: What was the issue?

Bob: The money

Bill B: Listen; let me respond to something that he was laying the ground, Bo Sewell right. You said that, well unfortunately I remember you. Not with fond memories. It is because of the kind of thing that you just did about relating of a bogus message about now maybe just maybe Chuck Skinner called you up and said that. However, I know about that meeting and I do know that myself and some other people went

Bo: Hey, I did not say "maybe" motherfucker, I said that

Bill B: Ok in English, do not call me **[end of tape]** was to have the fellowship write the book. For you to stand here and cast those expursions makes you so low you could walk under a goddamned ant.

Bo S: I am under whelmed

Bill: You may be under whelmed, but like I said that has always been my opinion of you anyway because you got caught in the trap with these people feeding you bologna way down when and coming with your little trunk of information you know what I mean, which is fine, I don't deny that. I think that it is great that this cause was in on the process of writing the book. The book is beautiful man, but you stand up like if it was not you that lied then I am here to say that goddamn Chuck Skinner lied because that was not Jimmy Kinnon's style. I know about the meeting that brought him over to the house and left him. And in no way would Jimmy Kinnon ever say that he was the president of Narcotics Anonymous. Even Greg Pierce said that. I mean that is the most ludicrous fucking thing I have ever heard in my whole goddamn life. So now, these people are asking valid questions about what happened. These people are asking bonified questions about what did the man do that was so bad that they had to do this. Somebody came up here I don't know who it was and whispered in my ear and said, what do you they were saying he was so incompetent let him do what he wants to do. I mean hey man bullshit is bullshit and this is where it should end in this conference. If you have played, a part in that bullshit then let it stop here. Somebody told me which made me very skeptical and that is how come I was willing to come over here is that all this stuff was about getting information so that you make a book on the history and become a profiteer on it. Now I do not know if that is true. You understand but it is highly suspicious.

Bo: (laughing) If I died today, I would go to a paupers grave that is what an excellent profiteer I am

Bill: Ok me too, so let us hope that is wrong you understand but there are lots of things that just need to be let

Bo: The attack factor is what galls me because I have given my life to NA too.

Bill: All right and I know you have been around

Bob: To answer that man's question here. There were a number of things that opened the discussion or that were brought before the floor of the events that were taking place. One of the things was the loss of the ten thousand dollars because the fellow went bankrupt. There were a couple of other incidents that I cannot recall right off hand about trying to get the material out to the fellowship that were crying out there saying that the office was not moving fast enough and we talked about volunteers. Hey, they could not get enough volunteers and they had to take care of the business that needed to be taken care of.

Room: Hey, the ten thousand dollars that disappeared was because of Chuck Gates man. Chuck Gates and goddamn Phil Perez took the money over

Bob: I do not think that there was no argument of how it was done. It was not the case of how it was done or who done it.

Room: Then why blame it on Jimmy man?

Bob: I said it was not the case of how or who done it. It was the case that they felt at that time that they needed somebody to manage the affairs of the office, period. I had nothing to do if it was Jimmy or Fawn or you or anybody else. They felt that somebody was needed in there that had some business experience to run the office, period.

Room: ( ) Terry, Bob Stone

Bob: I said but whom they chose is whom they chose, I did not choose them

Room: Who chose them, who chose them?

Room: It was Chuck Gates buddy so that they could steal some more money

I am Jim an addict, hi Jim. This, yeah I will go up there. We have got to stop hurting each other. We got to stop hurting each other. Just a few minutes ago I heard an emotional thing happen where someone who the last time I saw them was as diametrically opposed I thought to me in service to the concepts I have learned in service about service as anyone possibly could be. Someone that I was convinced was part of a plot, part of a plot to ruin Narcotics Anonymous, as I understood it. I knew that in my heart because people I trusted told me, I think or lead me to believe or maybe it was my addiction but I heard that person just state more clearly than anyone in the last year, exactly what is wrong with NA service today and what needs to be done about it.

I do not know what happened, I do not know but I believe that the reason that Jimmy Kinnon lost the job as manager of the office was that it took him a year from the time that the book was approved to get it out. I believe that that is the real reason. I do not know the personalities and stuff. I mean I know the personalities but I do not know what happened in California at that time. Jimmy Kinnon was a human being and we must not take that away from Jimmy. I do not think we need to, I am not going to. You know I called him on the phone and was one of the many hundreds of thousands of people who learned about Narcotics Anonymous and about particularly the 12 Traditions because there was not anybody else to teach about love, and me about that care and concern. He gave me my first opportunity to do the one thing that has defined me as a human being in recovery, which is to write and be published, he gave that to me. Whenever I had a question, he was there to answer it. When I became part of what I thought what I was sure was the realization of his dreams, the writing of the Basic Text and personally asked him to send information and

participate he started to shut me off, honest he did. The last time I saw him I came to the office and he would not speak to me. He would not speak to me.

He was a human being he made errors just like we all have made errors. He hurt other people just like we all hurt him. But he was a human being an addict in recovery and I do not think, I honestly do not believe that we killed him, this fellowship or its services. We sure did him a disservice and we sure owe him amends. Honesty is part of that that he was a human being that he hurt people that loved him, looked to him for leadership, and rejected them. That he did more unselfish service by the hour maybe than anyone ever in Narcotics Anonymous. I believe that is true. I do not know I do not know what the answer to your question is but I believe it is real simple like a lot of things are real simple. I think there are two things that I got to say up here. We have got to quit hurting each other; we have to quit hurting each other quick attacking each other. I was not any part of any master plan or plot and I do not believe I was manipulated. Maybe I was I am pretty naive I am a country boy. But I do not believe that I was manipulated and I do not believe I was part of a master plan or plot.

I love Jimmy Kinnon desperately - he would not speak to me, and I do not know if you were there or not. I do not know if Betty was there or not. It does not make any difference it is my truth and he is a human being and probably that probably the reason and I am sure that there was a lot of personal stuff between him and the printer. Whatever went on there that he was trying to help another human being is probably a big part of why the book was not published for a year. Because that was the kind, he was, that was the kind of human being he was but it did not get published for the year. The fellowship and its services all of us no matter who we are let that thing happen. I believe that the pain that caused, the pain that was caused to him is not about me pointing my finger at you or you pointing your finger at me. I believe that I only have one enemy and that is the disease of addiction and I believe that I only have got one adversary and that denial of that addiction. I think that is all that there is.

Room: Thanks for sharing Jim.

My name is Betty, I am an addict. Hi Betty. I do not know he said something about the book getting out, and it took Jimmy a year you know. I remember when the book was coming out we had a hell of a time getting all the stories together and everything that was suppose to be you know. They kept saying get that book out, get that book out and we kept saying keep sending us all the material. We do not have all this material. How can we get it out if you do not send us the rest of the material and you know it takes time to do something like that? Then naturally, this seems to be a real thing that people keep talking about. Bo you have got a look on your face that I swear to God you better grow up a little bit, you really better grow up a little bit. You are like a little kid right now, unwind.

There were a lot of stuff going on you know that a lot of people did not know about, that were not there you know that were not there in the office. There is a lot of stuff that we are not talking about that has not even been brought out yet. You know Jim said don't talk fingers and etc. but when he was standing up there he was still pointing fingers as he was talking so you know I can remember some things too. You know I just got a call from my daughter and I have to call her and I have to go potty you know, so I think for me, I am going to take a break. Thank you.

Room: Thanks Betty

I am Lawrence and I am an addict. Hi Lawrence. You know I am not here to advocate for nobody I am not here to defend anybody or become anybody's lawyer, maybe I need on right now. I know that there is another, I cannot pronounce the word maybe somebody could help me, animosity with the fact that you know Bo became the first literature chair. Now I have canvassed some people, being out in California I have been able to canvas some people with double-digit recovery or whatever you call it out there. I know that there was a lot of opposition to Bo becoming literature chair. I went over to the west coast and east coast things or whatever it is. I can mention some names because they told me and I asked them if I could. That is Tony D., Chuck Gates I am not talking about Tony Daddio I am talking about. Tony D. from California and I forgot the other guys name. They were very much in support of Greg Pierce becoming literature chair. I just want to know if any of the bullshit coming out about Bo has anything to do

with that and also is this the reason why you have distanced yourself so much from Bo because of that shit. That is my question.

Bo: I am really sort of confused by that - you know Greg and I have always stayed close.

(?????) My answer to that part of the question because he directed a part of that question at me was that it was my feeling that Greg was giving up information to you and I don't even know who the hell you are but you were sticking your finger out at me ( ). I do not even recall you from jack shit man. It is like I do not even know who you are, that was my end that was my part of the thing. It did not have anything to do with who was writing the book. It had to do with they were attacking and there was rumors going on that were that they wanted to ( ) the office and take it over to some place else. So obviously, there were going to be a few feelings about that so that is what that part was.

Greg P: I will answer that with more than the No I answered it with. I do not think Bo and I are as close as we once were. I do not think that has anything to do with literature. If there is anything that separated us it was spending a year and a half as business partners, trying to make a business that was not supporting one family to support two families. Some of you have been in that experience has had similar experiences. I can remember one time and I will tell a tale that I got so pissed of at Bo I told him that if I had my gun I would put you out of your misery. That became a thing but that has nothing to do with that, it was a thing for me to remember that.

A couple things have been mentioned. Jim mentioned about the publication of the Basic Text. You know there is one thing that has not been mentioned. I started doing travel and one of the trips I made was to the 79 World Convention in Atlanta and one the year before that in Houston and the year after that the 81 convention in Wichita. To be a representative of the Office, because that is what people saw me as during those years, meant you took a lot of heat. Same as when you are involved in World Services means today. If you are out and about, you take a lot of heat, because there was a lot of frustration about it taking six to nine months to get white booklets. I am repeating things that I have heard, I have no data on this but people came to me and said, "how come I sent an order in four times and have never gotten it?" They may have moved and not sent an address I know that happened a lot. There were a lot of frustrations with services with in the fellowship and nobody has mentioned that. There is also the issue of the changes of the First Edition of the Basic Text, which Jimmy may or may not have had anything to do with. I have no idea I was not around.

But those are two issues that happened that I believe contributed as well as the length of publications and the funds. Perhaps my role, the funny part with the whole idea. I think my role was more of peacekeeper trying to cool heads than it was to instigate. I do not know I can remember calls I have had from various people. From Bo and Jim saying wait a second, wait a second, stick to the principles, stick to what the program talks about. I can remember calls I have had with several others that went the same way. I think that is what we need to remember to, this is about principles. Those are two more issues that I think people were upset about, right or wrong. I do not know what the truth behind those is. I have a white booklet there that was one of the emergency photocopy white booklets with the oversized cover. From 1978, you could not order white booklets for nine months in 1978. The only people who got white booklets because of a paper strike and because of our printer were new groups and we made them up by hand. We photo copied the inside and print the outside and the outside was not trimmed the same as the inside. For nine months you could not order literature I know that I have one of them right there. Some of those frustrations contributed.

Podium: We have a couple of choices here. This meeting can go as long as 5:30 I know everybody is starting to get tired and stuff and we can kind of pick this up later if everybody is getting to tired or we can continue on. It is up to you all.

I am glad that you decided to go a little longer because I really wanted an answer to my question not get in line again at 6:30. I . . . sorry, **I am Ray and I am an addict.** I am sorry for not saying my name is Ray I am not sorry that I am an addict. This is the first opportunity at this convention that I have had to discuss there are certain events that have been chronicled and talked about and written about but apparently some of the people that were actually there are

here now. I have a question about the removal of the four sentences from the original Basic Text. I would like to know under what principle under what guidance the BOT at that time used to in their own words on letterhead stationary from the WSO delete those four sentences because they thought they were quote "inappropriate". I would like to understand how that idea that they had the right to do that and I am not questioning that right at this time. I am only saying that I would like to know under what guidelines they conceive for themselves that they could take that action. I would also like to know at that time when there was a change from this apparently mostly volunteer service structure loosely organized apparently in combination with the Basic Text arrival new concept of WSO was formulated, was it , I guess and somehow a person named Bob Stone was hired. Was this a professional decision? Where did Bob Stone come from? What were the arrangements at that time? How did we find Bob Stone or how did Bob Stone find our WSO? How was the decision made to choose him among other professionals to work this business? I would like to know about these business items. How we, how this came about. Apparently, at these early times, these times a decision was made to begin to exact a 400% profit on the Basic Text. I have a lot of things I have been told about this profit, why that was done or how but I would like to hear how that was arranged.

I also want to say on a personal note since I want to get this. I went to my sponsors house with six months clean and he was the only who I talked to. He was the only one and I did not talk to him a lot either. I did get so I started to go by his house. I went by there one day, they were having this horrendous fight, they fell down the stairs, she started throwing oilcans at him, and he smacked the shit out of her right into the ground. The kids his two little girls were standing in the window screaming "Mommy, Daddy". It was a very ugly scene and I drove away and was like devastated because he was the only guy I talked to. He was my sponsor and I supposedly picked him because he had what I wanted and I very much did not want to have an old lady throwing oil cans at me so that I would smack her so that my kids would scream from the window. This was too ugly for me. I went to a friend of mine who went to bed to early at eight or nine o'clock to be my sponsor and he said to me "You go to a vegetable stand to get melons, and one day you go and the melons are not good. You don't give up melons, you go to another stand". (Laughter) I am very happy to be here today to understand that there are a great many vegetable stands in the room and that I am definitely going to have the opportunity to sample several of them. That people with ten years and fifteen years and twenty years sometimes wander in the same clay that my feet stomp in. Thank you very much and please answer my questions.

Podium...Hold on a minute Greg. This time is basically allotted for the 70s and we are kind of like strolling into the 80s.

Greg before you answer **my name is Frankie D I am an addict,** hi Frankie. I am from Massachusetts and I am the ASR for the Boston northwest area. When I first came in to Narcotics Anonymous, I had a sponsor and I would go to him and ask him a question and he use to give me a that kind of stuff you need to know basis, and you do not need to know at this time. I am feeling that here, I am real angry, and I am fucking pissed. A lot of questions have been asked this gentleman asked, a lot of questions have been asked. I have not heard one answer. If I were a newcomer, I would be out getting high right now. I want some answers. I came here for answers. Let us stop playing games. Everybody is so evasive. Please do me another favor, when you come to the mic identify yourself so I know who you are? Maybe even tell me what state you are from so I can maybe even guess where you are involved in this. I am real confused. I am more confused than I was before. I came here with misinformation, now I do not even have misinformation I do not have any information.

Room: Fawn: Go back to the WSC meeting minutes at that time period and it will show you. You will see the names and the motions one after the other and you will see it. Now somebody was telling me earlier that if you call the WSO today and ask for copies of those meeting minutes that you cannot get them. To is outrageous to me that you cannot get them. That is in the archives and everyone should get a copy of that here. You will see for yourself who made the motions. How bam, bam, bam if one did not get passed another one was brought up. You will see the names. It was very precise.

Greg P: I will try to answer concisely a question first of all about the changes in the language of the Basic Text. Your question was what the motivation was, what was the rational behind making those changes. I do not know what the

rational was. I did not initiate those changes. I wrote the lines the way they were initially, I do not agree with the changes. I will tell you the process that happened. Each member of the BOT received a phone call. We were given three options, print with the two changes, stop print, or print as approved. The vote I believe and someone be able to correct me, was five to print the changes, 2 stop print and 2 print with the way it was approved. It was based on that vote of the BOT plus the concurrence of the WSO that the changes were made. I do not know who initiated it. I do not know where the idea to change those two lines came from, whether it came from the BOT or the WSO I do not know.

Room: What two lines are you talking about Greg the 4th and 9th?

Greg: The Fourth and Ninth Tradition

Room: Chairman of the BOT. No, it was the president was not it. Wasn't it Chuck Gates that espoused to make the changes? I have some documentation.

Bob: Well if he has the documentation, then maybe it is.

Greg: I have no idea. I do not know. I was not in California at that time and I was not privy to those discussions. I do not know that this was ever discussed in a BOT meeting per se. I know we were asked on a call, not on a conference call, and what we felt about that, that is all I can tell you. The second question was that.

Ray: I want to know about Bob Stone and how we found him or how he found us.

Greg: Bill tells me the Bob was originally a friend of Chuck Gates. Bob had served as the parliamentarian for the WSC for three years or was it two, either two or three years prior to the conference deciding he should be the manager.

Room: Do you know what a parliamentarian is?

Greg: His role in the conference prior to him being made director of the office was to give advice on parliamentary matters, as a professional.

Ray: Can you tell us how they found him and why they decided to get a non-addict involved in the conference to discuss parliamentary procedures?

Greg: I believe the BOD of the office brought him in didn't they. Yep

Room: That is a bonified question and I know where you are coming from, but like Greg said, he was a professional just like you would go out. You would not necessarily go and hire a printer that was in the program. So he was just a professional to tell people say that they were making their motions right you know in order to keep things flowing. He was an advice person he did not have anything but when he became part of the WSO you know it blew my mind because he was kind of a shady character.

Bob: I think what we understood when you are talking about hiring professionals to do a job. He also had a background in business. He came from a business background in the first place, that is where he came from, and I think everyone was aware of where he came from not just being a parliamentarian.

Room: Did he get hired to be a parliamentarian? Was he paid for that, being a parliamentarian?

Bob: Yes he was. I think he was. No, it is not a fulltime position; it is only for the conference.

Podium: Hold on, hold on if you want to come and ask a question will you please come up to the mic. I know in your

case it is OK. We are not getting any of this and everyone is yelling it.

Ray: Did Bob Stone then from parliamentarian get a job in the office prior to becoming director.

Bob: No

Ray: So the first full time job he got with the WSO was as director. He was hired prior to Jimmy Kinnon.

Bob: true, he and Jimmy had worked very close, Jimmy knew where he worked previous to that, and he had had some interaction before.

Greg: Let me address this just a second Bob. The conference made a decision to hire Bob Stone as the director of the WSO. It was not the office hiring the conference selected Bob Stone.

Ray: It wasn't the BOD of the WSO?

Greg: No, it was the WSC.

Tom: I am a recovering addict named Tom, hi Tom. I have been standing here for a little while now so I think I will just jump in because what I have to say is pretty short and pretty sweet. It was, there is a man in this room one night told me - I was not feeling real terrific at the time. He said that if you want to do something you want to get. I had remembered I ask him, how do you remember all these things that went on all these years ago. He told me to pray to be an instrument. Since that time, I have done that. It is started me writing things. What I have come up here about was that it is almost dinnertime and I see a lot, I see. I came to the conference; I am making copies that are how I am contributing. What I came in here, I was in here for fifteen or twenty minutes and I feel it in my guts the things that are going back and forth. Granted maybe they need to be done but to remember why we are here and through going through the documents I see a lot of things that are missing. I would ask that the people who have the stuff that went back and forth between the service boards and committees that are stamped on there "not for distribution" - which too me most of the time that nobody that is not anybody gets to see. Those things should come out and some of the things but I wish and I do not like speaking when persons are not in the room. Betty, I think it was, shared that there is a whole lot of stuff that is not ready to come out or may or may not be ready to come out. How are we ever going to get anywhere? But please, and I asked this when I get up to this mic yesterday. I stood up there yesterday. I said please do not break off into factions so that we can line up against each another. Otherwise, we are wasting our time and I came here out of love and the things that I saw. I tried to ignore the shit that went on and for me that is okay and to take the recovery and the growth I can get from all these different people. Please do not forget why we are here, and try to be apart of the fucking solution. Thanks.

Lawrence: I am Lawrence and I am an addict, hi Lawrence. I do not want to forget that either. Who made the decision to first of all to fire Jimmy. Before he even went to the conference, it seems like there was a lot of underhanded stuff that went down. Who made the decision to say well Jimmy you can do whatever you want? Maybe Bob or Bo or the people that was behind the scenes.

Bob: I do believe that it was kind of more like general discussion to include Jimmy in anything that happened in Narcotics Anonymous, that would relieve him from a position of having the labor at what he was doing. I am talking about the labor in terms of having to stuff envelopes if he did not want to. If he wanted to go and write he could, he did not have to answer the phone for everybody. If there were, some business transactions to be made somebody could take care of them without him having to be involved in it. All of these particulars are a part of the factors in terms of the decision-making at that particular time. Whether it was right or wrong is not the issue, I believe you ask why was the decision made. I believe that is basically why the decision was made.

Fawn: I have an answer to that question real quick. In 1983, Rose from Florida made the motion on the conference floor that Jimmy Kinnon be fired as the manager of the WSO and the conference the motion passed.

Lawrence: So it was not even a so-called conference action to even delegate that responsibility to Jimmy as to whatever you want to do, yes or no?

Bob: I think it was drafted by the conference, yes.

Lawrence: Then my follow up stuff is there were more changes mad in the Basic Text than just the fourth and the ninth. I know Greg was privy to being exposed to that kind of stuff. I mean there has been some really radical conceptual changes made out of the Basic Text from what the Third Edition Revised was to even what the Third Edition was even to what the Second Edition was to what we have right now, which is a big intellectual piece of work as far as I am concerned. I know Greg you were exposed to that and if you can help me with that.

Bob: Yes, that was made in the 80s so we are not going to get off into it. That what he said does not get off into it because those were some other conditions and a lot of it came from somewhere else.

Podium: I think what he is trying to say is that we are going to get into a long discussion about the book and all the changes and that is coming up obviously. This is not the time with fifteen minutes left.

Lawrence: Is there documentation Bob of the conference action in reference to telling Jimmy that he could do whatever you want to do.

Bob: That was a letter drafted and the letter was suppose to be available

Lawrence: Do you have it?

Bob: What do I need it for, it was not addressed to me

Lawrence: I would like to have it

Bob: You can have it if you can find it.

Room: I got a copy Lawrence. Not with me but I got it

Bob: He got a copy, so it is available. You need to ask the question of who got it you know. I do not want one.

Judy: Hi I am Judy and I am an addict. Hi Judy. I would like to say that it is really interesting for me to be here, really fascinating and only through seeing the kind of things that go on in my own area I am from Rochester, New York. Only through seeing those things go on can I have any kind of understanding of what is going on here today as we go back and try to look at what happened in the 70s. I can understand there is a lot of emotions and a lot of hostility and part of me wants to say well let us just forget about it and try to move on. Another part of me says I really want to know and I think in terms of healing just moving on does not make sense. One thing that I have heard here but have not heard much about is exactly how was the decision made. As I understand it, Bob Stone became the director of the WSO. Jimmy was locked out and did not know about it ahead of time. How was it that that decision was made, that nobody informed Jimmy. I would like to know exactly how that came about and I would also like to say just one more thing. Being here and listening to people talk about Jimmy, and I have heard somebody else who knows Jimmy personally, who knew Jimmy personally. It is really important for me personally. To hear about what the person was like that he was not de-human of course but that he did touch many lives and he touched people when he spoke to him. I find that very important and I am glad that people are here talking about that. In terms of being a founder of NA there is certainly no doubt in my mind from the people I have talked to in NA who have been around that he was the person from which NA started. Indeed, it obviously has moved from him to a "we" thing you know and I think that is beautiful but I think it is real important that we recognize what he has done for this Fellowship. I would like that question answered in terms of how that decision was made that Jimmy would no longer be the

director of the office and that he was not told. Just how did those incidents come about?

Carl: I am an addict my name is Carl, hi Carl. The 70s, where I was at in the 70s was single substance sober. By the end of that year's I had eight years in another program

In addition, I did not see change. One of the reasons I have spent a lot of time in this effort was that I did not know if I wanted to stay here. Because I was watching what our old timers were doing to our old timers and I did not see the (spirit) that I hoped to see. I saw the camps against the camps and the bad mouths for the bad mouths. If that was, my due here as it had been somewhere else for almost fifteen years it did not make sense to continue. So a lot of what we have done and what you have seen in the last two or three hours.

[Side two of tape]

That sort of progress, that sort of growth and change is going to get us past where we have been stuck. I might be able to stay here. I have thought for a long time that maybe that effort needed to go somewhere else. Yep, I could go to the meetings and I could go to H&I and do a little service work and I will do something else and find that spiritual growth that I am not finding in Narcotics Anonymous. Because Betty cannot talk to Greg but I saw her today, turn around and say would you come up and share and I almost fall out of my chair. I watched Bill turn to Greg and I know how angry you have been here with Greg ( ). That sort of change and that sort of growth is something that I have been seeking for a couple of years here and I have not felt it. But I see it today in forum like this. We started to get all wrapped up all of this stuff into the 80s but we did not invite those people because we ain't got enough strength to handle those people. We cannot deal with those personalities yet. There is enough alienation between this group and that group that you cannot even picture. But if this group pulls together the diversity of the individual characters involved today pulls together, it will be a piece of cake. If they can draw that unity and put those differences aside. You heard about misinformation, gosh, there have been people, "Oh well, he stole fifteen thousand dollars." That has been so widespread and it was the bankruptcy of a printer. The Fellowship does not know about it so it is bullshit and somebody gets stuck in the ass for it over and over and over again for eight years. It is time to end that shit. Maybe we can stop some of that through some of our communication. We have got a chance to grow and change. I got a chance to stay here. I got a chance to be apart of something and know when my fifteen and twenty years comes in this fellowship there is still growth available for me because I saw the people before me do it. I was not seeing that happen and I will do whatever the fuck it takes to keep it growing. Keep doing that. There are still some heads-bumping fine we have got a couple more days keep doing it. Thanks.

Well as you know, I am Bill Beck and I am still an addict. I would like to respond to what this young lady said because it is a valid question. Something was going through my mind about Jimmy that I was getting the idea that maybe you people were getting the idea that this man was a controlling man. You have to understand that nobody wanted anymore than he did for the WSO to grow up and function as an entity had being approached in a proper way when the Fellowship was ready with the money. Nobody would have been happier to relinquish the job because he was not getting any pay or any big pay for this. I mean this was a humble man who had no money and did not give a shit about the money aspect of it all. The other thing that everybody is forgetting because they are trying to lay shit on him and you have to remember at this time the WSO already was formed and had a board of directors and Jimmy Kinnon only functioned as one of those BOD and as the office manager as an employee. So anybody who was responsible for the running of that office was the BOD and not Jimmy Kinnon. It pissed me off when two lame brains went with ten thousand dollars, and then the goddamn board and as a matter of fact I almost got into a fistfight with Chuck Gates over it because I was telling him you son of a bitch you got a job and Phil what is his name. You people work that is ten thousand I mean it was the first time. Bob is talking about we never had any money and suddenly there is ten thousand dollars. I am saying hey man this guy is a successful real estate man and the other guy has a job and is driving a new car why the hell could not they pay that money back? Now you want to talk about misdirection, it was not Mr. Kinnon, it was the friggin board and I was a member of that board. I was a member of that board. It irked me then and it irks me now. I still think they should have to pay that money back. Then again, they said we feel sorry for them the printer moved you know. So a lot of people have a lot of misconceptions about somebody that was supposedly right. Hey this is the guy that put the whole thing together right. This is the guy who talked to you for

hours on the phone at a time. Was he senile? Was he ineffective? Hell no man! It is like Fawn said, you got people here that are trying to cover up. They are still trying to cover up their goddamn guilt. You heard it, it was going along real smoothly earlier and then all of a sudden man people are still trying to cover it over man instead of saying hey ok the war is over the old man is absolved. We made a mistake. He is our founder. Now let us move on with the history. They want to beat a dead duck. I do not know, it blows me away this kind of mentality we have you know. For God sakes understand that the man did not run anything poorly, haphazardly or we would not be where we are today. Now some power hungry greedy people that went to war did some very uncool things. Earlier I talked about the thing of the factions coming together with their shield and their sword. That is the big mistake of NA. What the guy said that talked in front of me that is it. It is that simple that is all the healing does, you know what I mean. Bo Sewell called me a name and I called him a name and fuck it that is the end of it you know what I mean. (Applause)

Podium: I want to thank everybody for sharing and I want to close this meeting now.

Jim: Can I just have a second? **My name is Jim and I am an addict,** hi Jim. The reason that I wanted to end this session with just one more thing. I guess I am going to hammer on Jimmy being a human being. I love Jimmy and I was not nearly as close to him as the other people but I loved him. I also sat in his house and watched him because of the physical things that were happening with him change his mood just a little bit from time to time while I was sitting there in his house and he was talking to me about having people

Betty: I resent him talking about Jimmy like this when Jimmy is not here to defend himself

Jim: Well I am sorry that you resent it. I am sharing my observation when I was sitting in your house while Jimmy was talking about having connections in my state. I loved him and I cared about him but I do not think it is doing him a service or us a service to make him into a demigod. He was human being and a wonderful human being. You know what else at the '83 WSC there two things that the conference saw were. The one was, well I do not know there were probably a lot of things. The two things that come to my mind now, the one was the changes to the Basic Text from the way it was approved that was attributed to Jimmy. Perhaps it had nothing to do with Jimmy but it was attributed to him and that is how the conference felt and how people saw it. I was one of those people. The other thing was that there was a study done. It was about the blue Service Manual and part of the finding of that study was that the blue Service Manual was not published the way it was approved by the Conference. That study was distributed to everybody. I do not want to be unpopular but perhaps that is to be my role. I think it is good for us to understand what the Conference saw and what was going on at the time when the motion was made and the Conference made the decision.

A couple years later Joseph called me and he said after Stone had done one of the things Stone did in his letters you know that we went from the frying pan to the fire and we made a mistake.

Room: Can I ask you a question? It seems like you are pissed off because he rejected you right.

Jim: No

Room: I mean these were your words and because you were hurt and your were rejected you think this guy should be banished to hell.

Jim: I was hurt because of his rejection but I am not pissed off. No, I think this man should be celebrated just as the man was. To give him this status of demigod

Fawn: Who is doing that? Who said that? We just give credit where credit is due.

Jim: To say that he did not make errors.

Fawn: Give credit where credit is due.

Room: Who said that, everybody knows he made mistakes.

Jim: Ok, if you are not to call him founder.

Fawn: Because he was

Jim: I do not believe he wanted that and I do not think you guys think he wanted that. I do not think the minutes from the meeting or the experience that has been shared with me from the people that he sponsored or the experience that I had with him I do not believe we are doing the man a service by forcing that role on him.

Fawn: He is on a tape at the New York World Convention if you listen to it.

Jim: He is on the tape at the New York World Convention sharing that he is a member of another fellowship too. Is that not right?

Room: He is the person that called the first meeting together. Now if that is not what a founder is, then I will kiss your ass right here in front of everybody man. You are a stupid motherfucker.

Podium: This is a real good time to get some food and meditation possibly, close this thing, and get on with it. I would like to thank everybody who shared. Don't everybody leave we got a nice way of closing this thing.

Tape 7
Montgomery History Conference 1991
Speaker: Bob B

My name is Bob and I am an addict. We like to call people by nicknames. Sometimes I like to be called Bob, sometimes I want to be called Robert depending on what setting I am in. I do not know if that changes me, but that is just me. I want to just for the hell of it and for history sake and just because I like to do shit like this anyhow. I want to take a group conscience, okay. How many people in this room want to use Basic Text Second Edition? How many hands we got (counting). How many want to use Basic Fifth Edition? That is half-and-half divided. What about Third Edition Revised? See the thing about it we would probably have to go and vote on the Second or Third Edition Revised because those are the ones that got the most votes.

Room: What about the original, the Grey Book or the Sixth.

Bob: No, see we are only going to use two. We are not going to go through, see we can play that little game of manipulation once again. We are voting on two books. We tried three just for the hell of it. We are talking about how group conscience comes about. About the use of material in a meeting or use of material anytime. Now Third Edition Revised probably got a greater amount of votes than either of the other two. Now is that acceptable as a group conscience? If that is the decision of the group conscience then what happened to the other people that descended? They should we did not say that they would, they should that is all I want to know. You see where we get the conflict because they cannot be accepted because I did not vote the way that you voted. Isn't it ridiculous how hard we try to hold onto the something, our past or whatever and to make change. We still struggle at it. We need to learn how to be beyond dope fiending. Recovering addicts is beyond dope fiending. (Applause) It is a hell of a concept.

That was just kind of an example of my name is Bob and I am an addict and I came in with many misgivings in terms of from where I came. I came into the doors of Narcotics Anonymous for all the wrong reasons. I came to the doors

of Narcotics Anonymous because I someway got the impression that you were going to make it ok for me, you were going to fix it for me. As long as I suffered under that premise that you were going to fix it for me I stayed sick. That is all that Narcotics Anonymous would tell me was "keep coming back". I understand why they told me to keep coming back because somewhere along the way if I stay long enough and become accepting and I become willing for change something will take place. Something will happen that I like. Now most of us would like to think as I use to think that I love myself. I use to stand in the mirror and admire me constantly. I do not know about you but I had to convince me that I was ok for a lot of years. Very often how I did that was to stand in front of the mirror, you sure look cool baby, all right. I thought it was all an outside job. How well do I look to you? Perhaps I did not look as good as I thought I did when I was in the mirror, but I was presentable. I put it that way because I believe I was presentable because I fooled a lot of people that I was ok. I have a long history of drug addiction and a long history of all the madness that goes along with drug addiction. I am not even going off into it because I think all of you have arrived here with some of the same or similar stories are the only reason you are here. I cannot think of you being in Allentown this Friday night listening to me and being here all day listening to all that went on without having been some of those places, with all the madness that goes with it.

I use to think that I had been a dope fiend for twenty years and then when I got honest about it, it was about fourteen or fifteen years. I would like to tell you all the penitentiary time I did and I got out and said I oh nine or ten years that spent half my life in penitentiary. It narrowed down to about five or six years. Now these are revelations to me because I had been espousing who I was and what I had done for years. I was so convinced that it happened and that was the time frame that it happened and that is how it happened. I think we come here hopefully if you come here beaten enough ready to live and ready to survive your own insanity. Then we become teachable. That is what my experience has been. Not that we do not learn something along the way because some of the things I learned when I was coming through the doors of Narcotics Anonymous before I cleaned up. I came to Narcotics Anonymous in 1959 that did not mean I came to get clean. I came here to appease somebody else and I got tired of listening to their mouth about whatever was going on. The only way I could stay in that household was to go to those meetings that I did not believe were happening a bunch of lames were out there talking about some shit talking about recovery. I was going to give them the benefit my worldly travel and great knowledge about drug addiction and show them and tell them how it was suppose to be done. I do not know where I got all this great knowledge from, but if you had of asked me I had answers for questions never asked. That is the way I came to Narcotics Anonymous. I had running off at the mouth and I found as long as I was talking I did not have to listen. So I had done a lot of talking. Who got a question? Bob got a question. Who got a problem? Bob got a problem. I found out as long as I was talking I did not have to listen to the solution. But with some of the things that would happen, I would listen to the steps when they were read. Fact is I gave them the benefit of how my reading ability was by reading the steps for them. I did not think they could read to swell. People use to haltingly try to read the steps and I could read them with a little class a little finesse even you know, emphasize. I use to think that was a process of doing the steps was by reading the steps. So I did not have much success in doing the steps. I had none. Then I was going to do it my way. See I was going to eliminate a few steps shift a few periods and commas and make it like I wanted to hear it, like I wanted to hear it. They may have written it that way but this is the way I hear it. My head heard it differently and as long as my head heard it differently, I had difficulty in doing what they were suggesting that I do. Even from the first step, the step of surrender when they are talking about addiction. How can I talk about addiction or come to understand about addiction if I know nothing about addiction? First, I must in order to get past the first step I have to learn about the problem of addiction, as I am the addict. I understood and came to understand that it had very little to do about the chemical I used. It had something to do about my actions and the way I lived and the way I perceived things to be which were unreal.

I lived in fantasyland. I spent a lifetime of living in fantasyland. Because I thought that where you were suppose to do, they told me I was suppose to dream, and a dreamer I was. You know I had done a lot of dreaming and it this fantasy trip I always kind of perceived myself as being somewhere else, doing something else with somebody else at all times. I was never satisfied with where I was at any given time. I do not care what was happening even if I was having a good time I could have a better time over there. If I had enough substance here well I could have some more. See the name of my disease is called more. Whatever it is give me some more, now just because I removed the drugs does not mean I removed the disease. The disease is always encompassing me, involving me, the whole totality of

me. I must come to understand the problem of addiction, In order to understand the first step. Now that does not mean I have to stall and stop there and tell you what I am working on that first step, that I am trying to find out what addiction is about. I think that is something that is revealed to you over a period. Now I know some of you come in here and get it real quick. You come in here and read the steps and you got it, I got it shit. I usually find out you do not have it, sorry because this is a learning process. This is an experiencing process that goes on in recovery.

When I got back to Narcotics Anonymous when I did not want to die because the police were trying to shoot me, I made a decision not only to surrender of this way, I made an internal decision that I better try something before I die. I had been to the doors of Narcotics Anonymous and they told me what was going to happen to me. Everything they told me was going to happen was happening or had happened. So I am standing at the thresholds of dieing because that was all I had left or living and finding some method of recovery. I came to some kind of an idea as to maybe these steps would work if I worked them, because they told me that is what was suppose to happen. Now I walked back to the doors of Narcotics Anonymous hopefully that you was going to work them for me. In some ways, I kind of gave Jimmy at that time permission to work the steps for me. Fix it for me Jimmy, shit. We use to spend great hours in his car or wherever I wanted him to fix the things that were going wrong in my life. I wanted him to get the parole officer off my ass. I wanted him to get my old lady to quit fussing, fighting, and goings on, get me a car and I needed a job and la, de da de da. What do you do Jimmy? He said work the steps. First, you have to understand what the steps are all about and I did not know a whole lot of people about working the steps. They say work it as you best understand it at this particular point. You will find out time and time again you will work the steps and work the steps and it will be unending that you will be working the steps. That is part of the process.

So I started doing the things that I did not believe were going to work. I had total resistance that the steps were going to work for me. Because, you did not understand my case was different and I could enumerate the number of things that happened in my life from childhood molestation, I had been in combat and had gotten run over hills and dales and I had been kicked in the ass and kicked in the head and I had been down the road to hell. According to all case histories I was suppose to be a dope fiend anyhow. I was black, I was from a broken family, poor family, on the wrong side of the tracks and I had been kicked around the world. All cases that I had read about black and brown is suppose to be if they fit those categories they were suppose to be an addict. All the conditions were prime conditions to be an addict and I wore that like a badge of courage. If anybody would ask me I was yes, I am a dope fiend because. I used that one a long time. I carried that around for a long time you know like I had a prescription for being a dope fiend. If somebody would ask me, I would lay the prescription on them. See that is the reason I am a dope fiend, society had been fucking with me too long. This is the reason I am a dope fiend and I want you to take pity on me, and I want you to help me out. What I want you to help me out are to remain dope fiend. I had no experience of recovery and that was kind of a difficult place to envision, recovery with nothing, talking about nothing. I had found out that I could fix how I felt by wiping out the feelings. If I started feeling things I knew what to do with it, I would fix that mother. I thought that was a good position to be in, absent of feelings was a good position to be in. I thought I functioned quite well with the absence of feelings.

Probably the drug of choice at the time was heroin because I could function to some degree and knew what was going on and you could not tell me I did not have it together. I just had greater difficulty maintaining that habit because the progression of the disease is such a nature it always gets worse and I knew nothing about the progression of the disease. I was experiencing the progression of the disease but I did not know about the progression of the disease. So in doing these here steps it became very difficult because people had to explain to me that the steps would work regardless of what I thought about them. They had to make comparisons like the steps work like castor oil Bob. You do not have to believe in it. Take a dose and wait a reasonable amount of time and you get a result. Or they here is the recipe Bob, or here is the formula for recovery. The 12 Steps is an exacting formula that will work regardless of what you think about it. That is all you have to do is put the ingredients in there and it will work, and it worked. Now if you are a keen dope fiend like me you have preconceived idea that you can short cut. Have you ever been a cook, a little less sugar or little less salt of a little less flour? Nine times out of ten, you are going to get a mess. If you follow the formula or follow the recipe, you get a good result, nine times out of ten. They had to explain it to me time and time again. Bob this is how it works and I was always going to show them why it did not work that way. I was always disproving everything. I questioned everything.

I have no problem with people asking all these questions today because that was me. I questioned everything and I was going to tell you why. I am not going to run that one by you because I do not know how you will feel about that religious thing see because some people get touchy in that area. I had no religious leanings so to speak and anyhow and I use to question what you believed and I could prove what you thought you believed exist did not anyhow. I always became argumentative in terms of getting something to throw you off track. It seemed to be one of those character defects I used for a lifetime; I used it with Mom you know. I would set up a situation to make her wrong and I spent a lifetime of trying to make you wrong. Sometimes it exploded on me, so what you know. If it worked one, time good enough for me. The other fifty times it did not work, hey fuck it. I spent a lifetime disproving every thing; there was no God, what God. Shit, I seen people dead lying out in a ditches around where I came from, I mean stacks of them. One thing I can remember very vividly in combat is stacks of bodies. I do not know why the stacks of bodies stick with me all the time because that is death you know. It did not stop me from using. Maybe that is how I survived because I was using, I do not know. I carried a lot of guilt away from that because all of my partners got shot up and I did not get shot up. I do not know maybe because I was in the right place or the wrong place I do not know. But I carried a lot of guilt maybe I was hiding behind something I do not know what I was doing. I survived and I felt guilty about surviving. I carried that around a long time and these kinds of things haunt you. Even today I don't know what that represents, dead bodies stacks of dead bodies. I am not talking about one dead body I am talking stacks of dead bodies that stays with me very vividly and I do not know what it is about. That is one of the bugaboos that I would put to sleep when I started feeling or it haunted me I would fix it, shit I would fix it. It did not bother me then you know I got my head hit; nothing bothered me, earthquakes and all don't bother me. I fixed it for a lot of years.

I started working these steps in here and I got to this here step talking about God and spirituality. I knew nothing about spirituality or that which they talk about. I knew nothing about God really. I kind of had some kind of idea that there might be something out there that existed that put it all together and held it all together, nature, man on the wind. My second sponsor was agnostic. He did not believe that there was a God but did not believe there was not one. We could understand that because I did not have any experience, God experience at least I did not think I had any God experience. As I look back at it in retrospect, I had a lot of God experience. My very survival was from a God experience and I was clean three or four years and I had to go back to jail in order to have a God experience. That is how I had to have mine, very therapeutic as far as I am concerned. I had the experience of God working in my life, I understand the working of God in my life, and I came to understand how God works for me. My God of my understanding. I had been giving it lip service you know I would breeze by it and read it somewhere. I would give it lip service you know because they told me that is what you are supposed to do. But it took me three or four years of being clean and carrying the message and ranting and raving about Narcotics Anonymous. You know I would get up there and evangelize and apostlize and preach and save a few souls and bless people and sprinkle some water on them and comeback lets do it again you know. Shit but I had no God experience and I came to understand that I had many God experiences. I just did not recognize a God experience I had no recognition.

Spiritual experiences along the same line, I had many spiritual experiences. My very survival had been a spiritual experience in itself because I almost died a couple of times. I said almost right there on that edge I do not know if you know about that critical edge. See I had OD'ed a few times and I had been at that critical edge. I know about that experience of just right there on the tilt and to return from that piece of being to say" hey that was some good shit give me some more". That is insanity, that is insanity. I came to understand what they were talking about because I had some God experiences. Through circumstances that prevailed at that time it that put some people together in my life that I did not know where they came from or whence they had been. But they came in my behalf and they did some things that were not done normally. The next thing I am out walking the streets again wondering what happened and how did that happen? For it was only a God experience that could put that together. I needed that in order to have that experience of God working in my life. I came to understand about turning it over to God because God had been running it all the time. Learned about the power of prayer through part of the same process. Most of us here in this room tonight are here due to somebody else's prayer. It was not yours, somebody else prayed for you. You moms, your sisters, brother, man I was sure praying for you, their prayer was answered. Then I worry about, get to the power of prayer, and found out that I had prayers answered, I started begging for shit, (Laughter) and I started getting things.

I got very sincere, found out that God worked and that prayer worked oh yeah we had a good thing going. You give me two of these and five of the other I would be ok. Please God give it to me. I needed three old ladies so he gave me five, all right. I had to pray to God to take them away, drove me crazy on the brinks of insanity practicing my addiction one more time and it was not chemical. I got me a money jones going, I found out oh God I need to make some more money. He gave me a couple of jobs. I had an 8 to 5 I had on from five on and made meetings in between. I kept a pocket full of money. My old lady says, you got that roll n your pocket for, why you carrying that money around. I said I gave you the payroll baby, shit this is my money, wake me up at two o'clock in the morning to go make some money. It was not meeting time and I would go out and make some money between meetings. I would leave a meeting and go paint a house or something, make some money and I got to running behind money. What I am trying to convey here is one thing that I chased many things that I enjoyed chasing. I prayed for many things and very often had to pray to have them removed, because they were not for me. I could not handle them and did not know what to do with them.

When I had money, I bought toys. We all like toys, huh. All I needed was one car so I had four or five cars sitting outside, and the old lady did not even drive. (Laughter) Cars sitting outside got cars baby shit. When I bought one camera I bought five, they were all different and I can tell you justifiably why I needed them five cameras. I needed one 35 with a long range on it, one with a short range and la, de, da, de,da. I need one a give it to you now and one to give to you later. I had cameras all over the place and like to went bankrupt trying to get the film processed. (Laughter) Now I got to take care of all these toys too. Have to watch over them because somebody will walk off with them. You do not know where to lay them or whether to take them or what. You can go crazy about that. I use to arrive at a convention with three or four cameras hanging off my neck and they were like what is that. Oh, that is a long range, that is a short range, and this is for this. Sometimes I forget I have a camera today, but not then. I was caught up in a power play. I know all of you people love power. If you are an addict you do, we love power, love to be in charge, take charge Charlie. You can do it I know you can. As long as you say yes I can do it, go ahead somebody will let you do it and they will load you up. So when you get into this position of power you get to play the same game you know. The same game I played before you know you carry it to the enth degree. It was not just good that I was chairing this over here; I wanted to chair that over there and chair that over there. So when you came and ask me what are you doing well I can say I am chairing this over here and taking care of this and I am taking care of that.

When are you taking care of home, huh? That is what my old lady asked me, you are off on all these ventures doing all this good shit. When are you going to do something at home? I thought that was great. How could she be complaining, what is she complaining about. Ain't I clean? I am clean, ain't I? Shit, I am doing all this; I am saving all these addicts out here. Doing all these noble and great things but the home life is going to hell. Half the most of the time I am not even there. I don't have time to be petting Mama all the time like lay down and lets take care of it and get it over with, period. It is not time talking about playing the other little game of saying take me out, show me a good time, and take me to dinner. I was fortunate in some ways because she was involved in a thing called Nar-Anon and when she got involved in Nar-Anon very often we would go to the same place to have meetings so we would travel together. I thought that was enough togetherness. We would sleep together every night, we ride to meetings right, and we would go shopping together right. That is not togetherness folks I am sorry.

I come to find that out but it is all in the process. I did not know that going in because I had not had that experience. Very often, they would talk about rehabilitate. I do not know anything about rehabilitate. I am a never been, what am I going to rehabilitate to a never been? It is all a learning process to me I do not know anything about no rehabilitate. I do not think I want to rehabilitate back to the army or the penitentiary or none of them places. So I am having to learn. I am having to learn how to be a husband and a father and a this and that and a provider and to be a human being. How to go to a job from eight to five, stay there, and do the work. That is all a learning process for me because I have never been there.

That is why I am always amazed to see people have a job when they get here. Back when I do not know if addiction was different or something. When we came to meetings, we did not have nothing. I mean stripped of everything I mean old cheap watches we did not have them because we had conned some old lady to three dollars for them it was

gone, it was gone. Not even a decent pair of shoes because if we could pawn them we would get rid of those too. We would come to a meeting in our stocking feet if that were necessary. No such thing we say we use to arrive at meetings and talk about looking tacky. We will give us a hot second out of the pan, we started arriving at meetings in Stacy Adams and Hickey Freeman suits, and a Dobbs cocked sideways talking shit. We used to think it was necessary to dress up the outside to make us feel better to look to you like we were doing OK that is the way we use to come to meetings. We got to the place where we had a few days clean and found out how we could have enough money to go down and get a suit out of the pawn shop. Or go buy one and get you some shoes and shine them up and go to a meeting and stand back and tell them, well I am sure doing good. Life is so beautiful. That is kind of like what I had done for years. I thought if the outside looked good, I thought that the inside was ok. I come to find out that I had been doing a repetition of the same thing for a lifetime. Ever since I was a little kid, I went through school polishing an apple. I call it polishing the apple because that was always a pretense of making the outside look good. I went into the military polishing the brass because I know if the outside looked good, it was all ok. Along with that, I went to the penitentiary as long as you keep your shit out of the way and do your time, same thing you are doing good.

So I had a lot of bad habit patterns a whole lot of bad thinking and I had a whole lot of experiencing to do that I had never experienced and it was all a growing process. Now my examples became you and my questions very often became I would come to you and ask you how you did it or how to do it. I found out that question was a very good instrument. There are no foolish questions you might get a lot of crazy answers. Hopefully the reason you are asking the question is that you do not know, watch whom you are asking the question because I was a great one to give you an answer regardless of what the question was. So watch whom you go and ask a question. Hopefully that person is doing something that you need to know how they are doing it. If you would have asked me, I would have led down a primrose path to hell. If you did not see me doing it I was still trying to tell you how it was done. That is the thing that has happened here. The process of growing up in recovery is a process.

Now many of you have had the experience of being responsible and grown and taking care of thing. I am not one of those fortunate people who have had those experiences, so all my growing up has been a process of learning. I came to Narcotics Anonymous wit a few skills. Not many just a few though, because most of my skills came from the repetition of doing something over a period of time, long periods of time. In the military I did crew serve weapons instructions and all this kind of stuff so I knew how to talk amongst people you know. Hey, I could do that and I knew how to organize things so I became kind of a natural at that. I know how to repair cars and had been at a number of schools doing that, so I had some skills and in the process. I had repetitiously done some things that I could do. Although I had to learn how to work because it was not the case of me saying, fixing one object in the industry at large or the field at large. There are a lot of jobs to be done and they want you to do it in a certain way, not Bob's way. See Bob always had a way too, and once again I thought out in the industry you just polish it up and it looks good and it was ok. I come to find out that is not what they want. That was a revelation you know he said, you do good work you just do not do enough of it. I was stunned because I sat out there and polished those mothers up good, and check it out again, tighten up those nuts and check it out again and check it out again. They were like no,no,no,no all this polishing and inspecting you should have had ten units out. I just could not understand why that was not acceptable. In fact, I almost was fired in the process. I said ok how do you want things done and he said, you do good work but why do you have to stand there and admire it all day? That is the nature of the addict that is the nature of me. I spent a lot of time polishing up you know always shiny and I am still out there wiping on that mother. Habits are hard to break, see because I spent a lifetime out there polishing the apple for the teacher, polishing the brass for them other people you know, or standing tall in those other funny places because I thought if you put on a good front that was it. Very often you find it very difficult even in the hospices of being clean and in recovery doing service we do the same thing. We wanted to polish it up and make it look good. We wanted to show to our fellows that we know what it is all about, and very often, when you show them you know what it is all about they give you some more to take care of. Since you are so sharp here is, some more and we are gluttons for punishment and will take on more than we can handle. We do not know when to cut it off and say no and we use all the right reasons not to say no. Another addict may be sick and I cannot do that but your baby may be sick also and you better take care of that also. Now which are your priorities your baby or that addict that is coming to your door asking how come nothing is going on. You had better learn what the priorities are. It is the learning that is the process. We spend a lot of time running up and down the road trying to save many addicts. I guess we carry the messages during the early

days of Narcotics Anonymous. Collectively we would go together. We spent much time together and became very intimate in our relationships. One of the things that I probably miss most now is that intimacy that we had in our relationships in the early days. We went and done things together. We had meals in each other's houses at any given time, we slept over a lot of times, we went to picnics, showers and weddings and wherever and 12th step calls. Whatever we went together, we made sure that we stayed at least in telephone contact with our fellows. We were concerned that they make it and we go out of our ways in that concern to try to help them along in whatever way we could. Sometimes the overload could get off into the thing of save bodies. We want to bless people we want to become saviors and we want to evangelize and give this program away. Don't you know all these addicts out here are suffering and not realize that you are the addict that is suffering? We have deluded ourselves that somebody else is suffering and at some point in getting clean or in your clean time in your recovery, you would probably have to give up some of those loads that you have taken on and get back to the very basics of recovery.

One of the great things that has happened in Narcotics Anonymous, we have a lot of people that are capable of doing the work, a lot of people. I still have a responsibility and I cannot give that responsibility to somebody else. I must stay involved, very basically I must stay involved. If I do not my head seems to turn off and tell me a lot of crazy shit that I got it together, that I know what I am doing and I know how to do it. I stopped doing some of things that are very necessary for me to remain recovered. A couple of ago

[side two of tape]

We can be, we can get ourselves very sick in recovery. We come to find out something about some of these underlying things of our growing up because once you get to a certain amount of doing, in doing your inventory and giving it up. You have discoveries and discover your shortcomings and the discoveries of character defects that we are not able to take care of in these rooms. Does it amaze you, we come to find out we are sick cookies and very often need some additional help. On a number of occasions, I went and got some additional help. I had to be pointed in new directions that I seemed to be blinded by when I was amongst you. One of the other things that did occur at this particular time was, my recovery I think our health have to be very attentive to these things we tend to ignore. One of these things is our health and you will find out many things that come up while you are clean that you do not know what to do about. Do you take the medication the doctor gives you and give yourself the permission and say the doctor gave it to me and pat yourself on the back, or suffer it out and be the martyr. Oh I can take it, cut it open doc I can take it I am a dope fiend. I cannot take any of that medicine because I am a dope fiend. We must learn how to deal with those particular areas in our living. If I have had major surgery, I had other conditions that I had to go to the hospital and put myself under a doctor's care. I had to let you know what my condition was so that you could come and monitor me, come and check on me because I know what something induced in my body sometimes what my head will tell me. I give myself permission; the doctor said it was ok. I have seen to many people leave here because they would not tell their doctors or would not tell their fellows what was happening. These are things we have to learn here, not something that we know when we come in and you will hear many things and many ideas thrown around as you have today. You will hear many ideas being thrown around that has no value that really have no value. The reason I say has no value is because very often, we will come in here and the fight of the day was fighting the last two or three years ago battle. The battle was resolved ten years ago and they are still fighting the same battle. The yays and nays have been said already, been prayed over, blessed and everything and have been n operation and we are still fighting the same battle, is not that something. Why are we wasting all that time? It is the nature of the beast were afraid to let it go; do not want to let it go.

I am glad that I was here today. I came with somewhat of an open mind and that has not always been the case because I usually came with hidden agendas on occasion myself. But I tried to keep an open mind as to what was going to transpire and how it was going to come about and how could I be of some service, some help by being here. Hopefully I can lend some enlightenment or direction on what is going on here. That is if I have it, I do not know I do not have all the answers there. I think some people are a little uptight sometimes because somebody does not have the answer. I am sorry, I have not become a computer head yet and I do not know if I want to be. I got enough extraneous bullshit up here anyhow that I need to get rid of, but I do not need to retain it or get rid of it in that sense.

I know this can be a growing period and I hope that one of the things that will happen here that we have grown just a little bit before we leave. That we leave our misgivings and our hard feelings and all those things leave it here do not take it with you. If you have to get somebody over in a corner to exercise to throw it up to throw, it away to get rid of it don't carry it with you. Those things eat holes in us. Those things that I carried around that had no meaning and I was upset have no meaning. The only person that causes me pain is me because the other person usually does not know what is going on. I hope this is not and exercise in futility in which we are I do not believe that it is you know because the things I have heard expressed here today were real feelings. Regardless if it had nothing to do with right or wrong they were real, they were feelings, they were right. What ever they may have been but I think we must look at the things that we do and see if they are still in the vein of remaining that addict that we are, remaining that active part of our addiction still raising its head and presenting itself. We must look at ourselves, because very often when I am looking at you and blaming you or criticizing you or doing these things is only a reflection of what I do not feel good about me. Isn't that something, amazing? When you start pointing your finger and blaming and talking about a mother around here, you had better go look in the mirror, you had better go look in the mirror. You are talking about spiritual axioms. Start understanding what spiritual axioms is all about and you might be presenting what you think to someone else is presenting it right back to you. It is all a learning process. It is a very slow process also. Do not expect too much from you neither should you expect too much from me. Regardless of how long I may have been around here I still have shortcomings, I still have character defects, and I am still in the process of recovering. I am in the process of recovering I am not well. Sorry folks this is the best it gets, this is all that I am. I am what I am but I am a much better person than what I was when I got here. Today I am the best person I have ever been. I know that, I do not know if you know that. To some I just might be another asshole you know and that is ok. That is not really important as much as it is important how I feel about me today. I am feeling good about me most of the time I am feeling good about you. We are where we are. I have been around along time as I said before as fact is it been around how they say too long. I have been around here almost 30 years, as a matter of fact next month I will be celebrating 30 years. (Applause)

One thing about it like not other people in many ways, I came in to Narcotics Anonymous. I came in to Narcotics Anonymous, I did not come by way of China to get to Narcotics Anonymous and I have remained in Narcotics Anonymous. I will say that I have not been to some of those other meetings but my devotion and my work and the things that I do is in Narcotics Anonymous. This is where I work, this is where I do things and this is where I stay. I do not need to go anywhere else, the formula is here. We have the recipe we have the formula, we have the know how and all the representations of how to do it. Why do I need to go somewhere, I do not need to go nowhere. I do not care is we fight and we fuss and we go on that is what we do. We are not well we are still in recovery or in some state of recovery and hope; we remain that way for a lifetime. Thank you. (Applause)

Tape 8
Montgomery History Conference 1991
Speaker: Bo S., Grateful Dave, Grover,

As we notice this afternoon there are a lot of agendas that were brought here by a lot of people. We have a lot of material to cover, but there is a real necessity indicated by some individuals to continue on with some of the violence you saw this afternoon. To some degree we need to find out where we limit that and how much stuff we can cover and how much ability we have to cover some of the topics that many seem so interested in. Our current agenda shows a time slot this morning for book history and NA Way magazine history. Both of those have been done in the past in workshops in the literature movement, and entertaining and informative. What kind of time frame do we need to move around to cover those topics for your interest? What the hell are we going to do in this conference, we talked about is this a working conference?

We are going to write some NA history we are going to collect what we have already done. We have already started some transcribing and we are going to form a committee from the people that are here and we are going to find people that are willing to take part in that committee. What do you want to do? Do we have another bitch session with

a lot of MF-ing and SOB-ing not real productive, it got to a lot of hard feelings, and a lot of people who have not talked are talking? There is a lot of skepticism about what was said and where it goes from here. We can get stuck in that but I hope we do not. Grover has come up from Alabama and it is something we want. There was a report yesterday on Alabama's' history collection and where they are at and what their process has done. He gave me some more information and there was some talk that maybe we need to meld the variety of history collection into one. I mean what do you want to do. We can yell and scream at each other for another day but I do not think that is going to take us anywhere. I tried to say something about that this morning that if we are truly here to collect history and we attempt to enter into the age without more individuals here that have the answers that many are seeking then all we are doing is splashing and making waves creating hurt feelings one more time. Then we are not getting the truth and we are not collecting anything but the venom that is really destroying us. As we came along in this history especially here and in Allentown, I have seen the miracle of individuals coming and not realizing how honest they could be here and that is ok. I have watched them carry that miracle forward over this last year and it has been a real benefit to my recovery to watch that growth. I am tired of all the pain; I am tired of getting shot in the back and all the name throwing, all the misinformation. That was brought up quite a few times this afternoon and if we wandering into the 80's without more of the individual ( ). Then we are more than likely not going to create not a whole picture and accurate picture and we will not have anything more than some more misinformation because we will not have those individuals to deal with. What do you want to do, do you want to start up the meeting.

My name is Bo and I am an addict, hi Bo. I want to get some kind of progress report of how close we are of having some kind of a basic document for this work. So that various people who have been around and paid a price through their commitment and involvement can review the document so that if they find inaccuracies they can bring it up in a methodical open manner. In addition, that the main document is kept in the hands of the members of the NA Fellowship and it is like a Para-structural, extra-structural you know but not a structural function of World Services in other words. Maybe a function of something some of us are calling the NA Society. Just something that we do to clean our own house and wash our own laundry and get the record sort of straight and lay down some kind of track for those to come. In the direction of a document for instance at a history workshop at the east coast or at the Ocean City thing last year, not this year but last. Like Doug's letter that puts me down you know but I can live with that, but his letter could be like one chapter in that and that can be just like a sample for those that were around you know and what do they have to say about it. Then there are other people who write other things and you could get a central document together that way. Then in time you know just sort of like just have, open get together is like this and let that work eventually lead to something accurate, pretty available, pretty stable and pretty up front. You know I like a fight just as good as anyone else but there has been a lot of people die you know and we can outgrow the barriers that the disease has erected between us.

I was curious Carl and the reason I jumped for the microphone is can we have a progress report. I mean I have been on the edge of this work and I have known about this work but I do not know exactly where this work is at today. Could we get something in the form of a progress report before we start forecasting what are possible, thanks?

Carl: Thanks Bo. One of the things that are behind us obviously is to continue ( ). Last year we received letters from ( ) Alabama, maybe Grover will come up and cover that. What we have sitting back there in the archives room right now is probably outside of the additional list that ( ) provided us with and that is in collection of what is available. It is the Ivy land work in 83 had been pulled, gone, and disappeared for a long time. About three months ago I received a copy and ( ) was surprised to find it existed. It covers in 83 a subcommittee that was begun to collect state histories. There are about 14 states in that 83 history. Obviously, the 83 does not cover today. So this weekend and in our effort for this we received input from London from Johnny and Dudley on London's history and Australian history. ( ). I just went through Grover's file and I think Chattanooga, a Chattanooga history and continuing to look for those pieces that have already been done. A lot of our experiences have been difficulty-requesting things from files. (Person did not have the mic and was unable to hear the message clearly, believe it was Carl)

I am Grateful Dave and I am an addict, hi Dave. Yeah we have been trying to put together this history for a long time. I remember Grover and I in 1988 got the convention committee for the volunteer region to agree Neal Maxey and a couple other people to agree to allow us to put on a history workshop and when we got there, the plug was

pulled on us. Billy whose home group is hosting this put his name on the line for about thirteen thousand dollars here. People that we know you know sponsees of people that we know have been running around telling that the thing had been cancelled. That is right, that is right that is exactly what happened. You know there are a lot of people that have put their heart and soul into getting even this far with it. If we want to talk about what we need to do is you know to me it is like a lot of the stuff, all this pain and all this stuff is just shit you know. Yeah and it was important to every individual. Every individual felt their pain and it was important to them but in terms of what we need to do and where we need to go from here today the only purpose for shit is fertilizer. That is the only thing that you can make out of it so I was hoping that we could all take our shits here and get it on tape. See because if it is not on tapes, see we got tapes, tapes, archives, and paper but without a computer scanner and document reader to organize this stuff, we need a document reader. We need people like Fawn that can type a hundred words a minute to get and to enter the stuff into computers. We need Rachel back there transcribing the tapes that is what we need. We need to start working and start writing you know. If we are going to move on from here and start tomorrow by compiling hard copy that can be, hard copy and soft copy in terms of discs that can be taken and given to people all over the country for nothing. I mean we can set the entire written history of Narcotics Anonymous and this spoken history of Narcotics Anonymous in a 60 disc set and make it available for anyone. But it is going to take work. It is not going to take wishing, talking, and la-d-da-di-da-ing. We are all, you know we have all had problems; I have had problems with the service structure. There seems to be a universal agreement here today that you know if you do not like what they are doing remove them. Who is going to remove them? We are going to remove them. Where do we go from here? Do we go to hell in that hand basket, in that withering you know unspiritual thing we call World Service today or do we create some viable alternatives and work along a parallel track and maybe some of the good stuff that was then can be brought in with some of the new experimental stuff. You know at some point down the road we come together with that. You know I spent a lot of years running up and down the road in California talking to people and over here and over there and I just wanted to you know. I have stayed away from this microphone all weekend long you know because I do not have any creditability because I am the one that is out to destroy Narcotics Anonymous. Every one of you that has a t-shirt of NA or a piece of jewelry with NA on it or every convention that has made twenty-six thousand dollars. Nobody sued them for trademark and copyright infringements and the profiteering and shit has to stop, but they will sue somebody for carrying the message. Everything that we are doing in Narcotics Anonymous today in my opinion is upside down from what Jimmy Kinnon founded this fellowship to be. I have listened to tapes from all of the people from Frank from all the way up in Northern California and down and Jimmy you know. We have to look to something. Jimmy was the glue that held this fellowship together. None of the people that are into this thing that we have been talking about today dared to walk up to the man who wiped their nose and wipe their ass and tell him this vile shit to his face. So we are right we have got things to do, but see that is reality.

I did some fucked up things in recovery to man. I did not know that the book was going to be right, wrong or indifferent but it was better than being paralyzed. That paralyzing fear, that helpless, hopeless what am I going to do and who is going to do it. Are you going to do it, are you going to do it? I finally said I know how to wake them up, I know how to do it and all I have to do is find the personal gumption and the commitment to do something. I have a tenth step and so I have been spending my life going up in front of microphones like this and not only breaking new ground in my personal recovery but admitting I am wrong in a lot of cases. I have been wrong, I do not do everything right but I do something. If we are to sit in the chairs like bumps on a log and wish and hope and dream that, somebody else is going to come up with some magic formula to do it for us it is never going to happen. It is through our inability to accept personal responsibility we were creating our own problems. We are the architects of our own adversity. We argue for our limitations and they will be ours forever. There is no limitation to the Steps and Traditions and the spirit that Narcotics Anonymous was founded in. We can do better; you know we can do better. Of course, I do not have any creditability you know because I am out to destroy Narcotics Anonymous.

I tell you what, Jimmy and Betty and Douglas and Fawn and other people are not the only people who have been shot at and had death threats in this Fellowship. That is ugly and I have had those things happen to me too for trying to carry the message. You can complain about the way I did it, but none of you did it. None of you got off your duffs and did anything. So I mean gee I am sorry that I did not do it just perfectly but I was seeking help for years trying to get people to help. Lets do this lets talk about this, lets unify and lets ask these serious tough questions. The service structure works great if you want to have a dance at the National Guard Armory. Nobody is going to, but God forbid

that you ask for an outside audit. Oh well you are causing disunity and you know and nobody wants to deal with reality that is a fact of our disease. Euphoria clean like is the same type of euphoria we sought out there using man and it is just as dangerous in here as it was out there. Oh, everything is fine, everything is ok. When you hear that shit people saying my life is great in meetings, I guarantee you that in three months they ain't going to be there, everything is fine. It is not fine; we have a disease that is out to kill us. It is out to deny our us our history. It is out to deny us our dignity personally and in groups. If we are going to do something each and every person in this room must do physically do something. Whether it be give money so that we can hire a transcriber, give money to this committee so that Billy does not loose his house because he is sued because of shit that our World Service. I mean to me World Service has become irrelevant. The only thing left today is that World Service can tell us that will touch our gut is the international issues.

We have to take this international thing and we have to spread this message internationally. If we would just give them the literature and allow them to do their own service in their own way in their own country there would be no international issue fellows. Here you take the literature and come back when you translate it. We will check out and work out the little bugs and that is it that is it, no international issue. It is a sham it is a bright shiny thing that they use to keep you on a string. We have got to go somewhere from here because just like it says in the second tradition the self seeking soon find they are on the outside causing dissention and eventually disaster for them selves. Some will change and become role models for others to follow. We need to change. There are people in this room tonight that need to change, me included. Our attitudes about others you know the petulant childlike things that we hang on to.

You know we need to do some thing with it, maybe work the steps you know. People with all this time holding on to all this shit it is to me , you know I don't have no time and some people say I have no recovery but it is not a good example. You know I am supposed to follow this. I am supposed to accept that with 15, 20, and 30 fucking years that this is what I am going to be like, that is frightening. Therefore, you know the truth is very uncomfortable a lot of times you know. I stood up here, everybody was screaming and yelling, you know, I turn around, and I want to scream and yell a little bit too. You know I got aids and I wanted to fucking wire myself up with dynamite, walk up that World Service Office, and pull the cord man. I had that worked out in my head in a number of ways and I was so close to doing it, but I had to look at my own personal spiritual growth and see what I could live with. It does not do me any good to sidle up to you and say, "Well you know back in 32? I was wrong." because it does not do any good for anybody else. It makes me feel better you know that I worked half a program, but I do not get out in public and tell people where my shortcomings are. "Hey, you! Here is my shortcomings and I was wrong back in 32 and I owe the fellowship an amends." So if what I have done in like the Baby Blue thing, if I have hurt anybody, then I owe you an amends. I am trying to stand up here tonight and show you what it is like to work the steps. So when you get up to the microphone you can say hey you know back in 32 this is what I did and how I did it, see and this was what was wrong and I apologize and my behavior in the future will reflect that. So far today I have not heard that being done and what I was trying to say when I stood up here and hollered fuck you was that none of us have including myself have not done something that was not totally horrendous in service in Narcotics Anonymous. I heard people walk up to it, we had it right here. Yes, there was a conspiracy, yes there was. The reason that nobody wants to admit that there was is because everybody was duped and nobody likes to sit here and stand up here at the microphone and say, " I was duped." You know, "I was manipulated and was not astute enough to know it." So I mean, you know, my life depends on being able to get up here at any time in front of thousands of people at any time and work these principles in all my affairs, in all my affairs for you. That is called carrying the message. I can stand up here and tell you I was wrong and you can know that it is ok to be wrong. That it is all right, nobody wants to throw you away, nobody wants to run anyone out of here. But we do need to be honest and to heal. I do not want to have any more death threats.

You know in terms of strictly academic stuff it is going to take working your fingers to the bone. We have all the information, we have all the insinuations we have everything that we need. Betty has all kind of stuff and if she can at some point find it in her heart to trust God and allow us to have copies of these things. Then we can finally put all that academic stuff together. You know we have got it, we have everything we need in Narcotics Anonymous everything, the steps the traditions and each other. My life is here because of you, thank you Alma and I want to thank you people that did the things that you did you know. I have had a few people thank me for opening some eyes, getting people to look at things. A lot of people do not agree and that is ok.

I just want to share one little thing about personal recovery, my personal recovery. I was a chump for everyone. I was like a jailhouse punk with my ass up in the air, everybody fucked me, and that is what my life was. I thought if you would allow me to sit in a room and shoot dope with you, you could pat me on the back for thirty seconds and rip me off for the next thirty years. I was so desperate to be loved, that is I have learned in personal recovery that anybody who manipulates me into doing anything has no respect for me so I am going to loose whatever I was after to begin with. If I am seeking your approval and I need your love to validate my existence then I am doing the same shit I was doing out there on the street. So those are the things in recovery that I am not proud of. Am I proud of putting together the information in the Fourth Edition? Yes. Am I proud of working for the disapproval of It Works How and Why? Yes I am proud of that. Am I proud that my home group had enough gumption to print a book to give to addicts? Yes, I am proud of that. Those are the things that I am proud of that today. The freedom that the Steps and the Traditions have given me, because the closer I get to God the less important the mass is because they ain't going there. The mass is not going, it is like lets talk about God and we all go to sleep you know. I am tired; I mean soul sick tired I have had a formal service position since I was three days clean. You know what there is no service structure because there is no group conscience. It is an empty shell and you can doubt that but that is what has brought us to this point. That is what has brought us here tonight, is that emptiness. The death of a dream somebody said. We all got to take a look at ourselves. My archives are being donated to this group that puts this on, everything. I got shit six file cabinets full of stuff. I am doing what I can; I have been working on this for years. (Applause)

I apologize for not being here yesterday I did not think I was going to be able to be here at all. It is a truly a grace of spirit that got me here today. **I am Grover and I am an addict.** Hey Grover. Hey family! I am real grateful to be here today. Since I missed yesterday what I want to do is try to do is give you a little quick as possible summation of what is happening in Alabama. This thing started almost three years ago that Dave was talking about. A few addicts in Smyrna Georgia in a spare bedroom talking about those who worked on the history of the Basic Text. Bo was having a really hard time getting people to help him to write and get together the main energy in spiritual views that it took to get the Basic Text written. Trying to get them together to write something so that addicts out here could know their legacy because it was not being done through our present service structure. Due to the frustration of trying to get it done through that and the previous works went about trying to do this on his own and I will say with no improper intention because I know Bo. So you can have it out of love and service. Some of us got together and talked about well you know Memphis is coming up. The Tennessee State Convention and Memphis was a center of help for a lot of work, spirit, and love that went into the Basic Text. Why don't we try to do something around here? It kind of grew into more than just a book and it kind of grew way past that. You know it kind of got to, we got to talking about a meeting is no different, a group or area or region or a fellowship is no different that an individual. Groups have personalities, regions have personalities and we all have to grow. We all go through change, we all have personalities, and we all need to work the Steps and Traditions or we die. When we have to see the importance well most of us were involved in some active service and feeling like this is a bunch of shit, we keep doing the same thing over and over again expecting different results and it is not happening. So out of the frustration we said, well can we write a text and I brought the original minutes.

We started as an ADHOC Committee of the Alabama, Northwest Florida Regional Lit. Committee. Our proposal was to find out if there was enough support in this fellowship to work on a history project. After numerous phone bills and a lot of driving and talking, we found out that maybe the time was right. Maybe it is time that we took in ( ) of the fellowship and quit repeating the same insane behavior of the past.

Therefore, we made this proposal to our region and we became an ADHOC Committee of our region. That is reflected in our minutes of 88 and was approved unanimously and I think before the year was out or as the year turned, we were a standing regional committee. We started working toward putting on this celebration. Our intentions were to bring our archives and fellowship together to try to get facts based on physical evidence because we believe that is what our history is. It is not just hear say or word of mouth it is what can we substantiate with written papers. We thought the best way to do that was to celebrate our history on what we found to be Narcotics Anonymous as we saw it which is August 17 as reflected in the minutes from the first meeting where they said this is Narcotics Anonymous and this is how we are going to operate. So we said this is the day we are going to hold this celebration until we get this deal done.

We immediately started catching flack because some of us that have been out in this committee believe in service and ( ) and those that were willing to go through the flack seem fit to do what we do. We kind of tear each other apart and there has been a lot of misinformation and trying to do something productive in this fellowship you know that the disease does not want you to do anything. You know it finds the ways and means to try to stop you and have to have the energy and perseverance to see it through or else give up. We had our celebration and as you know, the Baby Blue was a hot topic. We tried to focus the energy on the literature years. You know we felt like when this fellowship started growing ( ) the Basic Text workshops started happening around the country. There was a lot of love and selfless service that went into that you know with no thought of a profit or gain by a few individuals. It was done for the good of the addict that was still suffering to keep them from dieing, to put a book in their hands. We really felt like this would be a good place to start and use it as a barometer for the fellowship, to see if the fellowship was willing to support a work. We knew that it was not going to be a one or two year deal that this was going to be a long-term commitment. However, I am not going to say all of it but a good portion of the time that was taken out of it was the needed discussion of the Baby Blue Text. We did get a lot of good arguments; I think I have three portable file folders and one cardboard box full of archives. We now have all of that sorted, collated labeled. We do not have the internet and database. I think we have one hundred eleven entries into the d-base. We have the starting of a handbook. What we have come up with over that weekend, I think our weekend was 99% successful. I only talked to three people that felt like they had been hurt or injured. Through that ( ) and two of those were not even there. However, some real neat things happened you know we saw some people that had not talked in years sit down and talk. We felt like a healing had started taking place. We started working on the handbook. I believe that in the Basic Text it talks about if the committee does not have some sort of ( ). So I feel like the first thing is planning to work and working to plan and kind of answer part of those questions. What I feel like we need to do personally is we need to plan the work and I think finishing the handbook is the place to start. We sent a revision ( ) as I understood from Scotty Allen out there because they took the handbook and in the process of forming a committee. Scotty ( ) a large package and they have lots of stuff, lots of really good stuff and I think that is a real good place to start.

The Handbook so far has the literature prayer on the first page and we start out with the lack of history is the way the disease ( ). The purpose of this is ( ). I hope that in this weekend that we could set aside some time, come together, and review this. The people in Alabama who have really put their hearts into this came up with the money to send us up here and it was a pretty good bit of money to try to lend a hand to this fellowship and say to these people we want to work with you. You know lets come together and do what we can do to get this deal done. Lets not ( ) lets not spin our wheels, let go forward. That is where we are at.

The things that happened after last years conference is misinformation, the lies. I call them lies because I ( ) the facts on paper. (Flip tape)

I do not have to fight, some of us that were to stubborn to say fuck it have persisted, and we mustarded through until region before last. We went through another vote and were voted in I mean but they tried to shut the committee down a few people and the region voted to support the committee you know to continue to support the committee. It still did not rest, I think somebody was talking about ( ) surrender to group conscience. Well the surrender did not take place and still has not taken place. The region before last I went in as a chair and usually at ( ) region we will sit there for two hours and take the shit and try to present the facts in a spiritual manner and present all the paperwork so that everybody can see what is happening and it usually takes care of itself. Well I personally am sick and tired of being sick and tired. I mean stop paying to feel bad four or five years ago. I do not feel like I have to pay to feel bad any more. I take money from my family to drive to an RSC to feel bad and there is no since in that. I called the ASR's and the supporters who is together outside during the break and I ask them I said look I am tired and I have surrendered what do you all want to do. In addition, we voted which most of the ASR's are members of the committee and had worked real hard ( ) and get this thing done said well we will just be a multi-area committee. Well I went back in and asked for the floor and we had a substantial amount of money in the account and said you have our money, we wish you good luck, adios and turned around and walked out. That is where it is at. We are supported by three areas; our region is probably in the midst of splitting. One of the areas walked in at the last RSA and said we invite all other areas that believe in service to join us we are leaving, and they left. Some other areas right now are in

the process of going back and trying to get a conscience on forming a new region. That is kind of bringing you up to date on what is happening in Alabama, it ain't been no fun and it ain't been no picnic and it has been ( ) but we have all stuck together and we have a all grown a lot a whole lot.

I made a few little notes while we were talking. I think what we have to do is one is to get the handbook, we need a handbook. We need some way to plan the work. You know we can talk about it all we want to but until we get it on paper, we have got no plan, so let us plan the work. After we get the work plan and start working and start doing the work. Let us go down a,b,c,d, and get it done. Second thing I think we need to do under that plan is to establish a database. I have one set up on my computer and if I had had more time, I would have brought it up here. There are a data base files and tapes to the archives that we house. Somehow over the next months to go through and delegate some of these responsibilities to people to sort these files out and get people to go through and label all of these files that we have and hopefully lets all come together in August in Montgomery and lets get together on the computers. If you got a computer bring it and we will transfer the d-base to your computer, get a couple people working on it, and then merge it together into one file. Let's find out what all we do have as far as archives go. Then lets be able to spread that out to everybody that is working on this ( ) and say this is what we got so far. Let us get all the pertinent material that we need ok. Let us have the facts based on physical evidence. Then we need an outline for the text. That was discussed the last working weekend we had in Montgomery. It was talked about down there and I hope we will enter into some discussion before this weekend is out. Maybe about the preface dealing with things prior to Addicts Anonymous, Synanon and NA of New York that was not part of the Traditions. I think Danny Carlson founded that ( ). A lot of other organizations that popped up and tried to help addicts died out due to no Traditions and baselines, a singular personality you know. I think that as you look through the records you will find that is what happened, a dominant personality and finally folding so there is nothing substantial there. I think that that will show us that our Traditions are vitally important to our well-being. If we are going to live and live free, we are going to have to follow our Traditions. Therefore, I think maybe if we can consider that as a preface. Then we are getting in the first half of the book as some light easy reading. Something that is light, something that catches your eye, something that keeps your attention that is not ( ) but tells a story and to go through that part from what we agreed to do is from the formation in '53 was up to 1989 ( ) and lets cut it off. Let us work on that and get that done.

Then the last half of the book, lets take all these records that we got and lets go through the chronology of areas and regions and lets start at A and go to Z from areas and regions both nationally and internationally and put down the mundane material and the statistics. This is when we started, this was the first meeting. I mean make it enjoyable to read but get the statistics down and keep it short so we don't have a book as long as this table you know. We can get this information in there and people will see how that transpired. The pains we are not have the book with out the pain this stuff is going to have to be talked about. I do not give a fuck how many people saw it, everybody saw it different. You know it is going to have to be got out and it is going to have to get out on the table. If we are going to do history, we are going to have to do it justice and we are going to have to become impartial. We are going to have to check our personalities at the door you know. This serviceites, and Jimmyites and World Serviceites and I am not saying this in disrespect but we have camps that we follow and if we are going to right a history book we are going to have be partial and be fair to all sides. This fellowship is split and I truly believe if we don't do some healing in the next ten years then we may see some ( ) in the fellowship because we just can't do it. I truly believe that if we can gather the faith and tenacity as a fellowship, look inside ourselves, and do an inventory then we can produce the fifth step and see our character defects and our shortcomings. I hope that then we can make the changes.

I really do not believe we are ever going to do a history if we focus off writing the history. If we focus on changing World Service right now today then that is what we need to go do. If that is where your heart is at and that is what you need to do then that is where you need to go. If you want to change your area or region, you need to go do that. If you want to work on history then lets work on history. We helped our committee in Alabama and took a position on the Blue Book that was an outside issue. It did not follow in the scope of what we were trying to do and we will get to it in that part of our history when we get to it. Now of course we are gathering the paperwork. All the paperwork we can gather we can stick back in boxes and when we get to that year and we will process that information, but you know, that is not where we are at. You know if we loose our focus then we are going to get lost in our dust. So let us maintain our focus and write our history. I think these things are going to have to be got out. The pain is going to

have to come out. I heard a lot of people angry today and I heard a lot of shit and again I think I saw the ( ) being broke and some of the puss coming out and maybe we can get down to the real sore you know. Maybe we can get down to some healing between the individuals and I think that is important too. I think even if we never got a history book wrote if some peoples lives get mended through the process then it has all been worthwhile. What is our focus here anyway, to carry the message to the addict that still suffers and we got a lot of suffering addicts here in this room. There is a whole lot of suffering addicts that are out there that refuse to go to these rooms and I think they are waiting for the NA Fellowship to be extended back out there. There is a lot of misinformation still going on where Dave shared that this thing was said that this thing cancelled ( ) I got a real disturbing call a few weeks ago from the admissions and service office about our history thing. I do not think our disease wants us to get this thing done.

I know there has been a lot of misinformation spread and the only way I know how to combat this information is with factual information. Show up at your meetings and if you have a committee get the minutes out and ( ) as many people as possible and make the records open, be friendly. We can take a ball bat and beat people over the heads and all we are going to do is make worse enemies of them but if we keep quit pushing against them they are going to fall flat on their ass( ) if you have to. I can say that but I cannot practice it all the time. I am trying to, to get a little better at the surrender. I do not believe we have to fight today for anything I really do not. I believe if we surrender and it is the spirits will then it will get done ( ). Getting the articles out writing articles to local newsletters or writing articles to wherever you want to write articles to about what is really going on with history and your participation and whether you are for it or against it. Getting your minutes out and getting the meeting information out, when you are having your meeting. I think one thing we need to identify is all the history committees that are going on and someway get ourselves together. You know we have this one in Pennsylvania, I know there is one in Alabama, and I heard there is one I was not able to be a part of in Ohio. I do not know if it is a standing committee or not if it is, we need to be in touch. The one that is starting in California and Scott will be in touch and he can send us a tape from the workshop. Let us share tapes from our workshops. Hopefully before this weekend is done. We have a program set and that is plan to be there in August and Bill ( ) plans on being there and Father Dan Eagan who is going to share some on pre NA History. I hope you are able to welcome Nanda today and our program chair is going to give us some pre NA History and then Father Eagan is going to give us some on New York NA. We thought that was important because it was called NA in public but yet it was never part of this fellowship and we thought it was ( ) so he is going to come share some of that. We are going to try and cover the early years from the 50's on. I hope maybe we can get Bob there and I hope all of y'all will take a flyer and fill out a registration. It is ten bucks and calls, make motel rooms, and come down there. Let us set this up. If we are going to work on the handbook there is nothing to say we cannot loose a few hours sleep and sit up and start working on the handbook. That is what we did down there in Alabama you know sat up most of the night until about 4 o'clock. We can go over the handbook and work on it or if files need to be collated you know lets collate some files, label some files. It is mundane work it is boring, as hell but it needs to be done. We need to go through and check all the records and make sure they are in the right files. You know tat is something that is going to have to be done. We got enough people that we can break of into five or six working groups. A couple people could work on the handbook and a couple people could work on files, a few people could work on the outline. You know then tomorrow night we could swap up and another group take the outline that had the files and try to get some kind of eclectic conscience. On Sunday morning or Sunday afternoon on what we got where we are going I can carry that back to Alabama and we can set our agenda to meet our needs down there and let's get together and work on it. I think what we need to do from there is start planning working weekends, and not put our expectations to high. We are not going to be able to do it every three months or every four months but let's try to set some reasonable time frame that we can financially afford to get together and get together and move it around and go in different states where it will be accessible to all.

The other thing I think that is real important is funding. I know that we are not into profiteering but the reality is we have to have money to make this thing go. I do not think we have to have a million dollars or eight-hundred something thousand that has been spent on "It Work, How and Why" today. I do not think it will take near that much to get this done. I think a lot of us that have computers and are willing to make those available to this fellowship. I have a copy machine in my living room and as long as we supply the toner and paper then we can get this shit done. You know we can make personal sacrifices that people made during the Basic Text and we can get it done. I think

that once discussion about forming and overall committee you know to organize it. If nothing else to organize our efforts and to have some sort of outreach to other committees and other countries that have, you know that are just starting their history. Some that are not very old and can tap into their history while it is fresh and into their archives. Some sort of central ( ) system. I really do not believe that all the files need to be in one place at any one time because I thought some of the anger that was going on in Alabama that people would show up at my house and try to take our archives. I kind of thought that but they never did yet. That was one of the fears of the committee. They tried to take our archives verbally, it was defeated on the floor, and the archives are in our possession and those areas that supported it. That is who you people have brought your archives to Alabama and shared them with us donated them to that committee and that committee is functioning. T-shirt and coffee mug sales you know if some of y'all feel like it you could take some back to your area a few of them and want to help funding then we can set up some kind of fund club system. Maybe with what we generate if we can pull this out this one here so that it is money making proposing hopefully we can at least break even. Maybe some of those funds can go into help other areas, groups or regions to have host a history celebration or to set up a working weekend to get the copiers, to secure the location get the pencils, paper to get it done. I know our committee is willing to do that we are not having to mess with all the bullshit anymore. We are not having to fight. Well I am sure that if we can come up with some kind of agreement here tonight or this weekend that we will carry that back and try to set up some kind of a fund club that will work for everybody. Because I believe that ( ) supportive of its members. I do not believe that we need, I do not believe that our pyramids can hurt, we ( ) working for World services. I think we are working for the members you know that is where I ( ). Our committees feel the same way. You know we are going to take care of what we need to take care of regardless. I think there is a way we can work together, get some funds together, and get you going and us members of our committee and theirs to communicate with each other. Funding is a definite issue that has to be addressed and we need some kind of proposal ( ). That is kind of I know it took a while but I appreciate your ( ) well that is kind of where we are at, well that is exactly where we are at. It is important and we are either willing to write the history or we are not. So hope we can work something out this weekend and that you all will come to Alabama. There are plenty of pre-registrations forms. I think it is ten bucks and fifteen for the banquet and I hope you will come to Montgomery. I hope we can set up some sort of additional agenda to actually start doing more work. I hope we are going to do some work here tonight which I think that is what we are doing or fixing to do and carry that on through the weekend and carry that off to Montgomery. Thank you. (Applause)

Tape 8-b
Montgomery History Conference 1991
Speaker: Bo S., Grateful Dave, Grover,

Some of the things that we have done in the past is especially in the last few months with other issues is to look at what happens when we come with so many different agendas to accomplish a task. We saw a variety of those agendas. One of the things that in these movements that have never been successful throughout history is to have a ( ) and to have a (( )). That point of having the book to start with for our compilation very important. We have something and we have something to rely on. I hope that do not have to go too far away from the agenda that we are trying to talk about. I hope that we are looking for progress and I hope that when we get to the microphone that is what we are talking about. Your enthusiasm, your hopes, your dreams of the change. It is time to stop shooting and time to patch those holes. It is time to learn from our experiences.

I am Lawrence and I am an addict. Hi, Lawrence. I have some questions and I have some comments. First of all my first question is to somebody who is experienced in committee style of you know writing a book. That is probably a lot of people here that are familiar with that kind of style. My question is to Bo having as to you know having gotten some information you asked for. I have a two-part question. My first part of the question is, in your experience how long do you think that this will take to happen to bring it to a reality. The second part was, what was the second part, the second part was what length would the book be? Will it necessitate more than one book, the size of the

book?

My name is Bo and I am an addict. Hi, Bo. I think probably something in the area of 280 to 320 pages would be enough with appendixes because you do not want to blow every body minds and put them to sleep and beat the hell out of them head wise. In the process of doing this work, you are going to be collecting material and that material which is the evidence. The back-up material for the book is called the basis and the basis may be yea long regardless of what your final book length is. I think Tom may have some ideas of some of the writing realities that are out there. I have been in the back trying to think of what useful suggestion because I am not really too Pollyanna I mean I do wear a lot of suits in service but you know I am really pretty brass tacks. I think it is if we could adapt to general policy that when it comes to problem areas we have a general tendency to say yeah blah blah happened, here is how we survived it clean, and this is what happened, this is how we survived it. How about those many many areas where nothing bad happened you know everything went off great and miracles took place. I remember the first East Coast Convention. They set up for a hundred-twenty-five people and one hundred-ninety people showed up.

How about that thing out west where that guy got to be treasurer with region and literally lifted a two thousand dollar donation from somebody's estate that had died not knowing that our Traditions do not allow us to accept donations like that. Therefore, this character gets in the middle this little dope addict right, swipes the two grand and spends it. Finally the estate contacts the region and says, well not to be pushy or anything but our donation of two thousand dollars was never acknowledged and we want to be certain you received it. Well the region had never received it but based on that they did the homework and found the guy that had stole it. He naturally had wasted it right and the region itself had paid it back to keep our honor actually. I think that is powerful, there are a lot of stories, I was listening to a couple of members share earlier, and without having a particular opinion on it yeah some people steal money from NA. Which if we are around and enjoying the common welfare that we are enjoying we must have more givers than we have takers. I do not think it is fair for all the takers to get all of the press. I think there are a lot of givers and that should be in there.

Some of our miracles and how we have survived our problems and what can we pass on to others to make their way easier. In addition, to share out some of our successes too because we have obviously had a lot of successes in the last 10 or 15 years to keep growing. I mean I am convinced that there is a section of the fellowship living the clean life tonight they are not to sure about California and this conference. They are probably to bust twelve stepping some son of a bitch you know who is probably just trying to stay clean on a daily basis. I am glad we are here but you know I am glad I know they are there too, because they are our real force. We are just praying to be instrumental in dealing with something and it would have been nice if it could have been dealt with a while ago but I will just be glad if we get to deal with it anytime including today. He says how long would it take. I do not think you want to; it is as if how long will it take you to build a house. I mean you could take centuries I understand that in Europe some of the cathedrals were built literally over one hundred year periods and greater. I think if we can get this game plan this kind of handbook kind of ironed out then we can collect basic information from say at least an invitation to each and every region. How many regions are there out there today fifty or sixty what is it seventy something. Well if we got three pages of each of the seventy regions what is your book length. Maybe it would have to be separated. Maybe it would have to be a general history and then another per region type history. See never loose that basis and when we were working on the Basic Text I know that by our open ( ) policy which I embrace in this literature work in as much as this is literature I am all for an open ( ) policy. Meaning I fully expect people to participate in this work with one day clean, with a week clean with a year, ten years and more clean. I know that we preserve the basis behind the Basic Text with the idea that later it could be gone through. Well that time has never yet come, but you are collecting your basis for this book in the room across the way there. That will always be a useful resource if you keep the files open, if you do not let someone at a future date lock them up and take them away from you. I would say no more than a year and a half or two years because what you have to do is go for the moment before the politicians show up. Right now, the stage is a little bit clear; because those people are really good at what they do they really work hard at it. Thanks

Lawrence: One last question. I would like to volunteer my computer and my other question was what kind of a there has to be more than a trivial mention. There has to be sort of a dedicated devotion to Jimmy Kinnon, you know. I do

not know if that has to be a separate book in itself I am not trying to open up any cans here I am just think we need to look at things realistically. Is the committee of 16 or of 6 how are we going to include all of that. I think Jimmy Kinnon should get his due one way or another. I am done

I am Grover and still an addict. I really feel one of the ways that can be addressed is through the outline. We set the outline of how we are going to do that and what is going to be in the preface and where we are going to start. One of these mental plaques I have in my head is Jimmy sitting in a meeting and seeing how he considered it and turned away in disgust. What I really feel like is what our committee wants to do is we want to interview Betty one on one. We want to sit down with her and talk about those early years that we shared with her and her perspective first hand and we want to get those ( ). You know if you are willing to sit down in the future ( ). That would be totally up to you. We want all the facts and part of our history will be Jimmy the single guiding force at first, but if there were two or three then those two or three that got together then it needs to be factual. Now let us interview those people and that is it. I think that can be best done one on one in an interview than it can in front of a mic because we loose the personal touch in front of the mic in front of everybody. If you are at home burning a candle you know close you can sit there, tell, and share what happened. I know I can share better with my sponsor that way than I do trying to share with a number of people. So if we can share as individuals maybe we can do some of this stuff one on one and before anything gets printed that deals with any individuals I think that those individuals need to be able to read that and say what is true. I really feel like if we are going to write about Jimmy and Betty is his wife and needs to have an input about into what is written to make sure that it is not bias or one sided. I think that she better than anybody can give that because she was the one closest to him. That is just me talking and I think through our committee that is one of the things Bill Brooks the way we remember him talked about trying to get money together to fly out to California to sit down ( )... Maybe we can do that in Montgomery, sit down one on one and talk about it. That is what I want to do. I work construction and go to different states and different towns and I carry my pen and pencil with me and try to find people that were there in the beginning of their area and try to sit down and interview those people. I try to write that stuff down and that is something you can all do to when you are in your area. I do not that is a question that we can definitively answer right now at this time I think that has to be part of the plan.

Speaker Unknown: A book about Jimmy and then there is probably that clear definition that there is probably a need for both. Our learning experiences that addicts can write once again after being told for so long that they could not will give us the skills and the talents to do justice to both projects. Probably a separation is necessary.

I am an addict named Lou, Hi Lou. I had a couple of questions or thought. Yeah what I said is I do not think we need to go out of our way in any form of looking in the outline. History is history, Jimmy Kinnon played a large part in the history, that is there, and history will fulfill itself and take up a large part of the work.

A lot of the concerns that came in my head as you were giving your report Grover and that I heard Bo speak on when he was up here were that the politicians do move in you know. It comes quick and it comes as in anywhere else in service in this Fellowship that I have ever seen you know with a lot of pride, image and ego. When you get into that power, property and prestige such as that, I think as you talked about it has happened in the NW Florida-Alabama region or Alabama-NW Florida I do not want to put Florida out front (laughter). It is something that I have had a little bit of experience with in Florida and south Florida becoming a region. Efforts that are being done in service there such as our Spring Break Convenference where the powers that be in the Florida Region, which was where it started you, know were not too pleased with the idea of open forums and all sides being presented. They went out of there way trying to kill the Convenference but when it went off and was a success were very glad to take that check and deposit it in the bank and try to kill us again the second year. You know I have not figured that one out. I think as you see you are already sinking down from a regional ADHOC into a multi- area thing. It is more than Alabama – Northwest Florida obviously.

We have this going on here and we have the history to some extent in Florida at Spring Breaks, in Ohio. We need to set up some sort of committee or conference to deal with this. I would really hate to see this be, because I know this is going to come, rallied against by the politicians and all those that hate to see all sides presented. Anything you know besides theirs is heiracy and then snaps back for the coughers. Because when you do deal, with them, you do start

dealing with closing down of committees, you do deal with closing down of information, and it is once again taking away from the fellowship, which is where it started and whose history it is. I think we need to know who is doing it. You know you are talking bout setting up fund flows and they are dearly needed to complete a project like this. I think what you are talking about setting up the guidebook for this we also need to set up , God I almost hate to say it, "Fellowship Literature Committee" but so be it. You know in some form the FLC should come about and do this in a structured manner so Alabama-Northwest Florida does not snap it back, so a multi area thing does not snap it back. So that you are not at the whims of whomever who ever can jump up and down the loudest at a few area services where it stays open to the fellowship the way we know literature can be written and has proven to be before. I think these things need to be definitely and delineated. That you speak to your ideas as to how that will happen.

Well I am Grover and still an addict and I feel like with working on the handbook and the discussion here earlier about forming a committee. I think those things can be and would be discussed and worked out. You know I think that is what we are doing. I do not think we have shrunk as a committee. I think if anything if walking out of the RSC has enlarged the committee. At out last meeting we had grown substantially basically because of people that had been involved before that quit coming were tired of the fighting and bickering. When we surrendered the committee grew you know and those areas that are supporting the committee are the areas that have supported the committee from the beginning. I believe as long as we stay in the framework of the Traditions then the rest will take care of itself. Some politicians and hecklers may come for awhile but if we stay focused and we have a plan and stay on track then it is not going to be any different than what the people went through writing the Basic Text, "you can't fucking write, you will use, you know". "You can't do that you are going to die", you know I do not know how many times those people heard that, addicts cannot write, especially southern addicts you know. (Laughter) Addicts have tenacity about them that we are not going to let go. I do not know about this literature process you know I really do not. I have a lot of mixed feelings. I feel like we need to remain within the service structure but yet I do not want to be apart of. I do not believe that World Services dictates to me what to write and when to write it. I am not working for World Services. I believe the way I understood our literature process is that it came from groups, areas, and members and regions and then it went out, you know after we had some sort of manuscript then we moved it on. I do not see why they are even, for me it is an outside issue. You know because this is some thing our areas are doing and if it is some thing that we do collectively as committees and we form a committee to oversee this then it is some thing we are doing as a multi-group, area regional whatever you want to call it.

We are doing it as members of Narcotics Anonymous and we have no opinion on what they say or do. I am not working for them and I do not think you all are working for them. Maybe by the time this thing is published we will have a new literature process and you know in operation, and maybe we will not. I am not going to expound on where it might go because just as soon as I do they will take that for fact and run with it. You know "well he said this and this is what they are going to do". Well fuck I do not know what we are going to do you know. We are going to live just for today that is what we are going to do. We are going to write and we are going to try not to keep all our files in one location. We are going to have some sort of means set up so that if some thing folds somewhere it is going to go to the remaining committee. I believe that Larry has told me in the past that there was work that was done and the committees folded up. I believe last year when we talked on the phone that there were some and they do not know where the records went. What I see here and what I have seen in Alabama you know this is Pennsylvania second and this will be our second and Ohio's first and California out there where Scott and them are getting fired up. You know we are growing. This started three years ago in a back room, it has already grown into two years of active committees putting on celebrations or trying to do something positive towards history, and we are growing. Therefore, I think a lot of the frustrated people are going to come forward and addicts are willing and able to write. I do not believe my literature has to be written by a professional that is going to tell me what addiction is about. Our book touches us because addicts wrote it. That is why each one of us can pick it up and feel some thing when we read it. Therefore, I do not know where we are going to go and I am not going to worry about it what the process is and where we are going to go with it

Chapter Nine

Baby Blue

South Florida Literature Committee Chair account – page 215

Bob Stone – page 220

An Open letter to the trustees concerning the printing of the
3rd Edition, revised Basic Text – page 221

Intent was to get attention on negative factions within world services by agitating
At Fellowship conventions and passing our copies of home made Basic Text

Cease and desist letters from WSO to members – page 223

Commentary on history leading up to Baby Blue Case – page 225

Florida member response to C&D letter – page 227
Tremendous Amount of Pain

Grover N. shares receiving a Cease and Desist letter – page 228

Grateful Dave's Fight – page 229

Grateful Dave's Home Group – page 229

WSO takes bait and goes to court in Philadelphia to sue Grateful Dave
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South Florida
Blue Story

I had the unfortunate luck of being the area literature chair [of and area in South Florida] when the 4th Edition fiasco occurred in '88. It seems that the World Lit Committee (WLC), at either the 85 or 86 WSC (can't remember for sure), put in a motion asking for permission to perform a "LIGHT EDIT" (their words, my emphasis) of the Basic Text, to correct problems of inconsistency of grammar, tense, gender, number, etc. (e.g., sentences that began in the past tense and ended in the present tense.) Obviously, nobody had a problem with that. Unfortunately, they couldn't leave it at that.

When the 4th Edition came out, there were people actually in tears, saying, "They've gutted our book!" In a classic example of "exceeding one's mandate," the WLC had changed a lot more than grammar and tense. They had rewritten

whole passages, altered the meaning of many phrases, and worst of all, totally deleted many phrases, sentences and even paragraphs.

My friends were adamant that, as lit chair, I hold a workshop. So, I sat down with both books for a couple of days and detailed the alterations. Indeed, I found out that my friends had not exaggerated; there was no rational way that a literate person could describe the changes as merely "grammatical." I typed up my findings into a report.

At the workshop, members of the "royal family" (addicts who belonged to the sponsorship tree that has often exerted a dominant role at the WSC) came to try to shout us down and call us trouble-makers. When that didn't work, they pretty much said we were lying. Their position was that there had been no substantive changes of the Basic Text, and that we were just spreading division and distrust in the fellowship. (This was not the first or last time that the "NA Gurus" stuck their feet in their mouths, embarrassed themselves, and ended up being mad at me for bringing the meeting back to order and standing on principle.)

We carefully laid out the history of the 4th edition, the details of the changes, and the furor that was already taking place across the fellowship by mail and phone. (One of the least pleasant stories circulating was that the changes were made to appease Comp-Care and Hazelden, who were then distributing more Basic Texts than the Fellowship itself; they wanted the changes to make the book less "raw & street-wise," and more literary. Many addicts said that less rawness reduced its realness.)

Once we held up the books and showed the changes, they could no longer claim that there were no substantive changes. So instead they admitted, yes there were changes, but they were GOOD changes! We said, one's opinion about the changes is not the point; the point is that the fellowship was lied to and the WLC exceeded its mandate in a spectacular example of self-will run riot.

The 4th edition split the fellowship that year; the 5th edition came out as a compromise which satisfied nobody, because while it restored the out-and-out deletions, it did not change back the alterations of text.

Some addicts continued to object, and tried to bring motions through their groups, areas and regions that would stop publication of the 5th Edition, would restore the publication of the 3rd Ed. revised (which was, after all, the last edition that had actually gone out to the groups in a group-conscience process), and would put in place a standing rule that changes in the NA literature would not be possible in the future without strict adherence to consulting the group conscience. These motions were defeated, not by a strict democratic process, but by parliamentary maneuvers and being declared out of order.

So as you can see, many members -- including many of the most idealistic members, and including many of the people who had helped write the book felt disaffected, felt that their input was not merely not being considered but rather was being actively discouraged. Naturally, they objected. Ironically, those who spoke out to this steam rolling full-speed-ahead rejection of the voices of caution, were suddenly being called "rebels," "trouble-makers," and "self-willed addicts in denial."

Again proving that the disease has been to so many meetings with us that it can use the language of recovery against us. (In another age, a teacher pointed out that "The devil can quote scripture, and twist it to his purpose." Similar concept.)

Despite being a voice of moderation, caution and co-operation, I was painted with this same broad brush locally by those with strong loyalties to the WLC. I was being called a "dangerous addict!" Me, a chubby, non-violent, vegetarian, gentle jokester! I had never said a word publicly against any person, I had just called for the WLC and WSC to listen to the objections of the members and find a path of mutual understanding consistent with our principles and the group conscience. But that fell short of total loyalty and acquiescence, so now I was being attacked and even slandered. Fortunately it didn't work. The newcomers and GSR's already knew me to be a helpful and honest person, and calling me names just bounced egg back on the faces of the NA gurus. Which of course only made them madder.

It was during this time that I made the acquaintance of a member known as "Grateful Dave." He was sick with HIV and felt he had little to lose by being brave. He was one of the members who began printing the Baby Blues, and he was pretty up-front about it; but when he explained his purpose he was not alone for long. A number of areas, and even a region or two, bought the books and supported Dave's efforts. I neither jumped on Dave's bandwagon nor opposed him, but I did admire his guts, and understood that he was not merely motivated by self-will.

Dave said that proceeds from the sales of the BT were being used to build a bureaucracy at the WSO; that because of the high cost of that office they needed more saleable "product," but that the old group-conscience process that had created the BT was "too slow;" that those members who had been the creative forces that made the Text possible, were now consistently pushed aside -- no longer welcome in world lit. because they had the annoying habit of standing on principle and demanding accountability; and because NA's best writers were discouraged and shunted aside in this manner, all the writing projects being developed by WLC were mediocre at best, and would continue to be rejected by the fellowship.

One had only to look at the utter failure of the "professional writer" project on It Works, which wasted over $80,000 of the fellowship's money, to see that Dave was not far off the mark. Dave believed that what the WSC and WLC needed was a wake-up call. They had gotten too caught up in money, and too out of touch with grass-roots addicts who raised the money and wrote the literature. While the BT was written by any addicts who wanted to participate, without regard to "official position" or even clean-time, the WLC was now becoming so restrictive in who could participate that even bona-fide regional lit committees were being told, "Don't call us, we won't call you."

They couldn't see that encouraging the creative urges of the fellowship would create MORE literature; they could only see that literature not created by the WLC would become harder and harder to control. Legalities had superceded principles. His sources on the WLC and WSB (trustees) told him he was right on.

Dave said that the whole problem with the set-up was that we had failed to follow AA's model. (Dave, by the way, was no ‘anda'; but he would not argue with a successful model.) In AA, literature did not fund world services. Donations by the groups (and incidentally legacies and bestowals left by richer members before AA had the Traditions) were the primary source of revenue for AA's services and offices. AA's literature prices had consistently and deliberately stayed low; furthermore, AA was not terrified by the prospect of electronic distribution of the Big Book and other AA lit., because the wider the distribution the greater chance that would bring in new members -- hence guaranteeing a continued fund flow through the best source, Self-Support! (7th Tradition)

In NA, the WSO had grown explosively BECAUSE of the Basic Text! When revenues began to falter, officials began to react with fear because it might mean the loss of some jobs. The 4th-edition effort to "tone down" the book to "sell more product" to treatment centers and distributors had backfired, which now had the prospect of wrecking WSO and WLC's long-range funding plans -- a major new writing project every 5 years. It was essential that the credibility and loyalty of the objectors be called into question, and the attention of the fellowship drawn away from the major blunder that had been caused by ignoring group conscience.

Dave was determined to prove that the emperor had no clothes. The Baby Blue was designed to prove that the BT could be published dirt cheap, and given free to any newcomer who needed it. Dozens of groups around the fellowship (but especially in the eastern US) bought thousands of copies, and gave them away free -- asking only for a "donation suggested" if possible. It said on the cover, "Fellowship Approved" -- which was not untrue per se, because in fact the 3rd Edition revised was the last version of the book that HAD been approved by the fellowship at large! (Though, certainly, the Baby Blue was never CONFERENCE approved. Nor did it say it was.) While previous versions of the BT, from gray review & input to the 3rd revised, had gone out to the groups, the 4th and 5th had never gone out to the groups. Dave had convinced quite a few thousand addicts that the Baby Blues were more authentic expressions of the group-conscience process than the official version was!

Of course, this was a challenge to be sued. Dave was awaiting the prospect with relish; he had done his homework.

Grateful Dave wanted a test case, to challenge the WSO's claim to owning the copyrights to NA literature. He did not hide his role in the Baby Blue affair, he flaunted it. And in short order, he was awarded: with a lawsuit. He was ordered to appear in Federal Court in Philadelphia to defend his actions, and he was ready. WSO sent its assistant director and an expensive lawyer. Dave sent Dave. He represented himself. WSO told the judge that the Basic Text had been a work-for-hire, and that Dave had infringed on the copyright.

Dave disagreed. And he had a witness, a man who could rightfully be called "Mr. Basic Text" himself. Bo S. of PA came to testify on Dave's behalf. Bo had been the first world lit. chair. He had started the process that led to the Basic Text. He had shepherded the whole process through to its conclusion, even though many had told him it couldn't (and even shouldn't) be done. Bo was a recovery hero to many addicts. Bo told the judge that the BT had never been a work-for-hire; that in fact the then-officers of the WSO had strongly objected to a book not produced within the WSO.

Bo told the judge in detail the story that is briefly outlined in the Basic Text. (In the 3rd edition it is called the foreword; in the 5th addition it's called the preface.) He described how hundreds of people contributed thousands of man-hours to create a "synthesis of the collective group conscience of the Fellowship as a whole...". A few other members who had also "been there" to witness the creation and birth of the Basic Text, also spoke to corroborate Bo's description.

Dave and his witnesses also described how the rights to the book had been given to the fellowship in trust, and that the WSO could be described as the trustee but in no way the "owner" of the book; and that in any case it was never foreseen that the WSO would protect the book from use by its members, just against copyright infringement from outsiders. From all descriptions, the judge seemed unusually hip to the unique concept of a "Spiritual Fellowship" as opposed to a corporate business. For once the meek did inherit; he dropped a bombshell on the court by announcing to the representative of the WSO that he was ready to find against WSO and in favor of Dave. However, he was offering him a chance to come to some mutually agreeable compromise with Dave, if Dave was willing to be magnanimous -- and that he STRONGLY suggested that WSO get humble and ask!

It seems that in a flash, the tables were turned. Dave had every right to gloat, but he didn't. In fact, he was actually invited out to Van Nuys and spent some time at the Office with that official, hammering out the agreements. It appeared in the CAR.

Dave agreed to stop publishing the BBs, and WSO agreed to hold a fellowship-wide referendum on the BT. Both sides were duty-bound to stop all finger-pointing and name-calling. The judge was satisfied. And most of this story was never broadcast to the fellowship, "in the interests of unity."

Unfortunately, the referendum was kicked out at the next WSC. Too expensive, too time-consuming, too blah-blah-blah. Dave grew much sicker, and died before he could pursue the matter further. Most of the impetus for exposing the naked emperor died with him. And the name-calling crept back.

You may have heard of the much-vaunted "4th Step" of WSC and WSO in the past three years. This largely grew out of the above problems. Yet the results of that inventory are still much in doubt. Corporate mentality still seems to rule at the world level. The only reason It Works came out at all is because the window was reopened for a short while on group-conscienced literature to let it happen.

But people like Bo are not being asked to come back and restore the process. Rather, an atmosphere of distrust and polarization has still remained regarding all this stuff; I see no immediate solution, as both sides are absolutely convinced that they are right.

A few years ago, Bo S. and a few trusted friends decided that it was time for a new group-conscience process, to be called "the NA Way of Life." It was meant to be a broad view of the culture of recovery that develops in the lives of

members as they spend many years living clean. He composed an outline, and did some writing himself; but then he turned to the workshop process. Getting "just folks," regular members, to participate in the work, he held various workshops around the country to encourage the same spark of contribution and collective creation that had led to the BT.

People who have participated in these workshops describe it as a wonderful opportunity to share the miracle that has transformed their lives. They also are amazed to see the group-conscience process in action; it works.

In the mood of distrust that has gone on ever since Jimmy K was locked out of the WSO, it is hard for some members to believe that some people serve in an independent role, not because that would be their first preference but because that is the only way they can serve. Bo S. is not trying to lead a coup, and I am confident that neither was Dave. They were trying to light a spark, and Frankenstein's monster could only respond, "Fire bad."

Despite the fact that my moderateness has been a matter of impatience to those more partisan than I, the very fact that I can view the contributions of people like Dave and Bo, not with anger and outrage but with appreciation and understanding, makes me "unreliable" and "potentially disloyal" in the view of those who support the party line. Despite good shares at good conventions, (again one of those "independent roles" I was mentioning,) and 10 years of writing pretty good recovery articles and ideas, I consider the chance of my being considered as a WCNA speaker or WLC member as so close to nil, it would stun me for a week if I got an offer.

The party line, that all the above were merely stunts pulled by malcontents, thrives when people only know one side of the story. I do not liken the division, as one member did, to the political division between conservatives and liberals; there are lots of liberals who are very grass-roots, and lots of conservatives who can't wait for government to get into your bedroom and tell you what to do. I think the problem is the "heady rush of power." Those at the center can be intoxicated by their position, and many say that's why they sought it. Just like "it takes one to know one," so those in power are apt to believe the motives of those who oppose them are all about power. It's hard for them to believe that it's about principle. And when it gets polarized enough, each side demonizes the other, and it's hard for both the ins and the outs to even believe that their opponents HAVE any principles.

I am sure that all members want the best for NA, and that no-one wants to "tear NA apart." I fear that addicts on all sides of disputes fail to thoroughly consider the thoughts and the legitimate grievances of those who disagree, and in the process create enmity and division needlessly.

But our problems are not going to go away until we really LISTEN to each other, instead of jumping to conclusions and calling each other names. The fact that even highly informed and experienced members can view some of our most valuable and creative members as distant stick figures wearing "kick-me" signs, shows that we still are quick to believe the worst about each other, rather than seeking to know the facts. I don't believe that this is really the Evil Empire vs. the Rebel Alliance, or its reverse. But if we don't back up and show love & respect, it could get a lot worse.

Love and Blessings,
DH in South Fla.

“Dave was invited out to Van Nuys and spent some time at the Office with that official, hammering out the agreements. It appeared in the CAR.” We need to find any documents or CAR reports relating to these agreements. Did the WSO carry out court order, or not? Is WSO in default, yes/no? Something happened at WSC that next year where WSO was not going to do something called for by court order, and got 11th hour call from Judge Pollack and WSO backed off. Can’t recall details. - Ed

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Bob Stone

by Bo S.

Bob Stone was offered the job at the WSO on 6/11/1983, a Saturday. So, Jimmy was the office manager until that day. Bob Stone went to work on Sunday, 6/12/1983.

This kind of makes the point moot that Stone was around for the various office moves from 1976-1983. Stone was the Parliamentarian of the WSC prior to becoming office manager. He was only present during the World Service Conference held in late April/early May period. There was no hovering about the Office by Bob Stone looking to take over. As perceived successor to Jimmy Kinnon, whatever went wrong at WSO was hung around Bob's neck. Surely the staff played a significant role in this. I can see Bob taking a fall for a staff action or decision. He was that kind of man. Also, just as surely, Bob was mislead by addicts near him to believe the unlikely or the implausible. Remember this if you plan to read his book. It is interesting how the ‘good guys' and ‘bad guys' changed from time to time.

Bob Stone was also an ardent believer in our NA philosophy of inclusion. Allowing members from far away to have a hand in NA issues and decision making is a rare and special quality. I believe for someone to be trustworthy, it helps if they feel trusted. It is harder for an individual to be trustworthy if they know they are going to be treated as badly as someone who is known to be untrustworthy. Perhaps this is simple reciprocity - expect me to steal and I might, treat me with dignity and respect and I'll go hungry before I steal. People in NA long for dignity and respect but can shift gears quickly if they feel betrayed. Therefore, in both WSC Administration and the WSC Sub-Committee for Literature (WLC), we made a point of trusting people and expecting the best. We were careful to arrange backup plans if things were to go badly, but we never advanced these plans as an insult or a threat. Plan A was if everybody did what they said, when they said they'd do it. Plan B was what we would do if Plan A failed. A good Plan B seems to have helped Plan A go well. It was also our announced policy to give applause for doing a good job. If you did a poor job, you were simply passed over. In other words, we gave attention to good performance and ignored non-attendance or incomplete work assignments where the person did not ask for help. If they asked for help, we would get them as much as needed. The WSO had different policies: they had payrolls, job titles and responsibilities and everyday management problems. The slight clash between our volunteer system and the WSO management system made for problems. When staff developed tendencies to treat elected WSC officers and chairpersons like employees, there was an air of superiority among Office workers. Like they were for real and the elected volunteers couldn't be expected to do much. While this may have only shown itself as mild competitiveness, it may be the real source of antagonism and friction.

If Bob Stone's book, *My Years with Narcotics Anonymous* is accurate, then Bob was not expected to be a big supporter of the policy changes planned by the WSO Board of Directors, the Board of Trustees and the WSC Administration in the late 1980's. You don't subject an executive director to non-renewal if his is in on the planned changes.

Tradition Wars: a pathway to peace
Fellowship Work in Progress - Not for Use in Meetings

I am posting this Open Letter that I was given years ago. It was written after Baby Blues were distributed but before Grateful Dave fought the court case for us. I don't know the author or exact date but it is a great example of the sentiments for that period. It also refers to letters written by the BOT during this same time period attempting to label those involved with the effort as hurting the Fellowship. If anyone has a copy of the BOT letter perhaps we could post both letters to TWPP Baby Blue Chapter.

Love and Respect
Ed M

An Open letter to the trustees
concerning the printing of the
3rd Edition, revised Basic Text

After seeing a copy of the letter put out by the trustees stating violations of Narcotics Anonymous Traditions as a s result of the printing of an altered version of the Basic Text, 3rd Edition, revised, I found it necessary to voice another opinion so that the fellowship as a whole is not misguided by the trustees simply because of the "WSO says so, so it must be true" attitude.

The first thing I felt it was necessary to do was go through some basic facts from the Basic Text, any edition, in this case the WSO's very own 5th edition. On page 59, we read in the 1st Tradition, about unity, halfway down, "No one can revoke our membership or make us do anything we do not choose to do." and "…we found that what is best for the group is usually good for us" and on page 60, "This is not to say that we do not have our disagreements and conflicts; we do. Whenever people get together there are differences of opinions. However, we can disagree without being disagreeable. Time and time again, in crisis we have set aside our differences and worked for the common good." The 2nd tradition talks about the only ultimate authority we have, on page 61. "…we rely on a loving God as He expresses Himself in our group conscience, rather than on personal opinion or ego." "We must be constantly on guard that our decisions are truly an expression of God's will" and that "Direction and manipulation fail.

We choose not to have presidents, master or directors. Instead we have secretaries, treasurers and representatives. These titles imply service rather than control." 3rd tradition states that "Desire is our only requirement. Addiction does not discriminate. This tradition is to endure that any addict, regardless of drugs used, race, religious beliefs, sex, sexual preference, or financial condition is free to practice the N.A. way of life." Tradition 4 asks, "Are we truly autonomous? Don't we have service committees, offices, activites, hot lines, and other activities in N.A.?" The answer is that these things are not N.A. "They are services we use to help us in our recovery and to further the primary purpose of our groups". The 5th Tradition then tells us about or primary purpose, but not before adding that "…if we do not dictate to other groups or force anything upon them… then all will be well." "I thought our primary purpose was to recover from drug addiction? For the individual this is certainly true; our members are here to find freedom from addiction and a new way of life. However, groups aren't addicted and don't recover. All our groups can do is plant the seed of recovery and bring addicts together so that the magic of empathy, honesty, caring, sharing, and service can do their work." "What would happen if our groups had another primary purpose? We feel that our message would be diluted and then lost. If we concentrate on making money, many might get rich… If our group purpose was anything other than to carry the message, many would die…" And Tradition six talks about the money, property and prestige issue by saying on page 66, that this traditions "is extremely important to the continuation and growth of Narcotics Anonymous." It "goes on to warn us what may happen: 'lest problems of money property and prestige divert us from our primary purpose'.

The problems often become obsessions and cut us off from our spiritual aim. For the individual, this type of abuse can be devastating; for the group it can be disastrous. When we as a group waver from our primary purpose, addicts who might have found recover die." The 7th Tradition tells us how we get our money and why, on page 68. "…members who can afford it give a little extra to help. N.A. services remain in need of money, and even though it is sometimes frustrating, we really would not have it any other way; we know the price would be too high." Tradition 8

warns us about professionals on page 69 of the 5th Edition Basic Text. " If we employed professionals in NA groups, we would destroy our unity" and on page 70 as hypocritical as it is, "our special workers on the other hand , work within our traditions and are always responsible to those they serve, to the Fellowship." The 9th says,"…that we may create service boards or committees to serve the Fellowship. This is the nature of our service structure as it has evolved and been defined on the N.A. Service Manual." Tradition 10 says that "One of the most important things we can do to further our primary purpose is to let people know who, what and where we are." Tradition 11 says, "…it is important to reach as many people as possible…" and on page 72, the 12th Tradition says that, "The spiritual foundation becomes more important than any one group or individual."

I first quote these traditions to show that the Board of Trustees is totally and completely hypocritical solely to their own means. As long as the end result suits their personal desires the BOT will say anything they want to and because the letterhead reads "World Service" most people think that it must then be so. The true hypocrisy comes through in the latest letter from the trustees. At the top of the page, by using the copyrighted symbol of NA they have violated their own definition of the fourth tradition which says that if it is not a meeting than it is not NA. The letter goes on that, "This action contradicts, our 12 Traditions "Not the 12 Traditions that I just read. Whose traditions is it violating? Maybe the boards tradition of using the NA funds to travel around the country, depleting the cash flow from the services we really need. The letter goes on about how the book is not conference approved. I remember having bought a 3rd edition revised text straight from WSO in 1986, and the other parts in approved literature before that. So what, the stories were left out in this version. The "Fat Addict" didn't do a thing for me anyway. I'm trying, also to figure out how the Trustees had the audacity to write "as a result of broad consideration within the NA Fellowship" when the 5th Edition was a quick cover up for the riff-raff 4th Edition that was spit out.

This was WSC approved, but not "Fellowship as a whole" approved as is our structure as it has evolved and been defined in the service manual. "Without consulting any of N.A.'s worldwide decision making bodies" is a scary thought and an insult since reading the Traditions which say that the Fellowship is the decision making body not the other way around. The services are set up to serve the Fellowship, not to "rule, censor, decide or dictate" as it reads in previous editions of the Basic Text.

Yes, there is truth in the Trustees letter. The Text is sold by the WSO for $8. $8 that newcomers and prisoners don't have, and it comes in a hard-cover which prisoners aren't allowed to have and even the limited soft-cover copies is dtill large enough that most prisons won't allow them anyway, because they "can be used as weapons". Do we keep what we have only by selling it, or by giving it away? Would we have it any other way? I make a donation to the basket weather I buy a 5th Edition, a 4th Edition or any other Edition. I can give this light blue soft cover book to prisoners and newcomers who otherwise may be unable to get this message in print. I can reach as many people as possible by spending $2 instead of $8. Four times as many prisoners and newcomers. Four times as many suffering addicts. Our primary purpose. Four times as many, minimum.

The only "support of worldwide services" that sales of "the unauthorized text" will take away is that of the free travel by King George and the boys in the future. As long as I continue to give books away, whatever Edition, no sales are made by those people anyway. According to the 7th tradition support comes from donations and fundraisers, not sales. "The price would be too high". By telling members, groups and committees to, "just say no "the BOT is in violation of the 4th Tradition of not dictating.

Our Fellowship hasn't been spending that much time over the last fifteen years making the WSC what it is today; they've been doing that themselves by consistently allowing people who don't represent groups to vote. A full 1/3 of the decision making practice is voted by the people representing their own opinion. The Fellowship still believes that the decisions should be made by the Fellowship. That is why every year they ask that RSR's only vote. This could never happen though, because then those who represent themselves alone and no region would lose their "importance" and there's too many of them to allow that.

Furthermore, for the BOT to say that the WSO, which holds the copyright intrust for the Fellowship, is going to sue a member of the Fellowship is appalling. That would be like the trustee of a will suing one of the heirs for spending his

inheritance! Boys, I think there is a slight control issue problem here based on a false pride and image thing. If N.A. world services were deprived of income from basic text sales only the “travelers” would suffer. Not the Fellowship. They might have to miss a convention or two.

Likewise, to say that the people who are publishing this book are running on self-will is like the pot calling the kettle black for the BOT. That is what World Service has been doing with our literature for years. The only misinformation and misguiding is being done by the BOT. To say “we have allowed a vocal few to divert us from our primary purpose far too long” is interesting. “Its time to say, ‘enough’” is true. Let’s dissolve this world structure and start again. It seems to be a shame to have to right this letter but the “World” has brought it upon themselves. When I was approached by someone who had two boxes of the light blue books, I asked him what he used them for since I knew they were not sold in meetings. He said,” I give them away to prisoners, newcomers, and people that I sponsor.” I said, “Give me a box!” My donation still goes in the basket. Now I have a few more dollars with which to do it. These books go where they are needed. To people who otherwise may never get a chance to read the book. What is best for the whole is good for the individual. Let’s set aside our differences and work for the common good. Now addicts are assured, too, that financial condition won’t hinder their chance at a new way to live. Let’s not dilute our message by letting money interfere with our primary purpose. My conscience tells me that the God of my understanding wants me to reach out to as many people as possible and give away what was so freely given to me Recovery and Recovery Texts regardless of what Edition, stories or not. The Who, What, How, and Why remain the basis of my recovery and remain unchanged.

To: [Trusted Servant's Name]
From: Wagner & Middlebrook, Attorneys
Date: July 10,1990
Re: FELLOWSHIP OF NARCOTICS ANONYMOUS
Worid Service Office
Our Docket No.: 03-9545-15.XX

This office represents WORLD SERVICE OFFICE, INC., the service office for the Fellowship of Narcotics.Anonymous. My client is the owner of United States Trademark and Service Mark Registration Nos. 1,450,681, and 1,476,774, for the marks NARCOTICS ANONYMOUS and NA logo. My client is also the owner of United States copyright Registration Nos. TX 2 112 598, TX 2 250 589, TX 2 342 402, TX 2 250 588 and TX 2 254 607, covering the First through Fourth editions of the NARCOTICS ANONYMOUS Basic Text. The registration for the Fifth Edition is now pending.

It has come to our attention that you may have been printing and/or distributing a version of the copyrighted Basic Text, including unauthorized duplications of the NA Fellowship's trademark to include the totally false legend that the version being distributed is "Fellowship" approved. These actions violate the NA Fellowship's rights under both Title 35 and Titie 17 of the United States Code, as well as constitutes consumer fraud on the members of the Fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous, and unfair and diluting use of the registered marks.

IF YOU ARE OR HAVE AT ANY TIME ENGAGED IN THESE ACTIVITIES, YOU ARE HEREBY DIRECTED TO IMMEDIATELY CEASE AND DESIST IN ALL SUCH ACTIVITIES, as well as any other infringements that may have not yet been discovered. Please confirm by return letter that each and every infringement has ceased, and surrender the remaining infringements to this office.

Simply being a member of the Fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous does not give you, or any other member, the right to engage in unauthorized use of the marks or copyrights of the Fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous, or to falsely represent that approval has been granted to these materials.

We ask that you accurately complete, sign, date and return the enclosed response in the postage paid envelope provided. If we are in receipt of your immediate agreement in wnting that all further infringement and distribution of infringing items has ceased, we will consider this matter closed. If we do not receive your immediate and full cooperation, my client is prepared to institute litigation against you and your company to protect these properties from your misuse, as well as costs and attorneys lees. May I have your response within ten days of the date of this letter.

Very truly yours,
Theresa Wagner Middlebrook, for
WAGNER & MIDDLEBROOK

Response to cease and desist letter

This response is made by the following person or company:

Name _____

Address _____

_____

Please check the correct response:

_____ We have never printed any copies of the Basic Text.

_____ We have never distributed any copies of the Basic Text that consist of the following: a light-blue paperback cover containing the first ten chapters of the Third Edition of N.A.'s Basic Text, replacing the material on Traditions Four and Nine with material from the Second Edition text

_____ We have printed copies of the Basic Text consisting of a light-blue paperback cover containing the first ten chapters of the Third Edition of N.A.'s Basic Text, replacing the material on Traditions Four and Nine with material from the Second Edition text, and agree to print or distribute this NO LONGER. Our inventory is _____ books at this time.

_____ We have sold, given away, or otherwise distributed printed copies of the Basic Text consisting of a light-blue paperback cover containing the first ten chapters of the Third Edition of N.A.'s Basic Text, replacing the material on Traditions Four and Nine with material from the Second Edition text, and agree to print or distribute this NO LONGER. Our inventory is _____ books at this time.

_____ Other response: _____

I declare under penalty of perjury that the foregoing is true and correct.

Signature and date

Printed name

Commentary on history leading up to Baby Blue Case
by Bo S.

In the early 1970's, Greg Pierce continued a process begun in the late 1960's and leading to the popular movement in Narcotics Anonymous. He began recovery in 1970 and from the beginning was in meetings with all the California old timers. To our knowledge, there were twenty meetings in the world at that time and all of them were in Southern California. He went to them all in time. It bothered him to find that there was no real organization in NA, spiritual or otherwise. A viewpoint that NA ought to have a central office was unified and an Office was begun. It was located downstairs in the home of Bob B. It was later moved to rented space with CEDA workers. Some files were lost and the Office was moved to Jimmy K's home in Sun Valley, across from a public airport. The Office - and telephone - was located in Jimmy's home all through the seventies. As the Fellowship grew, the organization and files at the Office expanded. Jimmy was spectacular about supporting the addicts calling in for help. Unfortunately, he was older and had suffered from illness (cancer, how about tuberculosis?).

With a Scotch background, he affected extreme control over the office, he had never read the Peter Principle by Dr. Lawrence Peter. For instance requiring a volunteer executive secretary to use a key to unlock a cabinet to get a single first class stamp. This made him seem like a cranky gentleman doing a tough job and being responsible. What also resulted is blind spots like getting a Federal non-profit tax number and giving it out to members over the telephone all around the country. When Bob Stone was installed as WSO Manager in 1982, the found stacks of correspondence topped off with undeposited checks. He listed them and put them in the WSO account the next day. Nevertheless, Jimmy K is recognized as our founder. Through study, it is possible to go back further than 1953 and consider Daniel Carlson, Houston Sewell and others like Bgr. General Dorothy Berry and Father Dan Egan. What is important about Jimmy was his helping us get our White Booklet in the 1950's and manning WSO during the 1970's. He was the one to answer the phone and spend countless hours 12 Stepping the young Fellowship. From the mid-1970's onward, WSO sent out starter packs to all new groups on request. These contained a copy of the NA Tree, the White Booklet and groups supplies including a Treasurer's Handbook and a registration form. A growing World Directory of Meetings was available for a low cost. No one ever helped so many people over the telephone as did Jimmy K in the 1970's. He also played a unifying role because of the centrality of his position at WSO and possibly out of the education and viewpoint developed over the years with all those late nights with members in his kitchen and all those phone calls.

Back East from 1975 onward, many of us would follow up on this friendly, caring approach and announce new meetings and groups to their nearest fellow members who would go out of their way to visit. We distributed literature, mailed out the original chip system based on the colors of the rainbow: red, orange, yellow, green, blue and day glow for a year. When the World Convention moved out of California to Houston, Texas, Atlanta, Georgia and Wichita, Kansas, NA began to grow terrifically. One example was the Ohio Fellowship. The first year there were four meetings in Ohio. The second year, the number of groups rose to forty. Then eighty groups in the third year. In the fourth year, there were over a hundred and sixty meetings. The Fellowship was very open and caring. Recovery and Fellowship were the order of the day and policy was adjusted to support our service efforts. The Service Manual,

renamed in 1979 from the NA Tree, became the subject of close scrutiny and endless study. While short and simple to begin with, amendments and motions at the WSC began to change the structure, enlarging and extending the duties and functions of WSO while diminishing and reducing the say of the Fellowship from binding WSC motions made and voted on by Regional Representatives who were expected to vote the conscience of their home Region to Delegates who vote their own conscience and report to their home Regions once they returned home.

As Jimmy grew older and the young Fellowship developed its lines of communication, there was an unspoken shift. Many groups had problems with getting their literature orders filled. Groups who resorted to printing their own were considered disloyal. Questions about how NA functioned in its service structure politely avoiding characterizing the service functions in terms of the personality of the current chairperson. While this may have helped stress principles over personalities, it did little to deal with the reality of different levels and patterns of understanding relating to our principles. The service structure contained qualifications including increasing experience with the NA 12 Steps and 12 Traditions. There is, of course, no way to track someone's spiritual progress but this can be said. Without the capacity to surrender, a person is incapable of really listening to another. Without a belief in a Higher Power and turning our will over to the care of that Power, a person is bound to go it alone, on their own power - and think all others are doing the same. Letting our God help us with a moral inventory, sharing it, becoming willing and asking our Loving God to remove our defects, we carry those defects with us always. Our selfishness and basic fear my be arrested to some extent but when it really comes down to it, we have all our defects intact, ready to go. Continuing this line of thinking, making a list and becoming willing to make amends to all those we have harmed, proves our sincerity and our freedom from fear. It actualizes much of what has been happening inside as we worked the first six Steps. Making the amends punches a hole in the fear that has ruled us ever since active addiction began taking us down. Steps Eight and Nine allow us to step free of the personal fears and restrictions we have developed as addicts in a way that also makes it good for us as trusted servants. When we are wrong, we can promptly admit it. We can seek through prayer and meditation that which is hidden from those who cannot yet live a life based in spiritual principle. The spiritual awakening we experience and the ability to live by spiritual principles makes us extraordinarily able to serve and do the Will of a Loving God in this life.

Consider, if you will, how these very factors might play out over the lives of a hundred thousand people. Now, double it. The effect of all these people who have entered recovery but not yet progressed to the point where they could honestly say they had a good working knowledge of the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions explains what happened to our service structure. Unable to fully implement the approved, written structure, service, especially service at the world level, became a zoo full of people who occupied themselves trying to re-write their guidelines because they had no basis for surrender and building on the accomplishments of those who had gone before. They had no traditions of respecting the abilities of others and in the end fell back on the growing lattice work of corporate structure making itself appear as the 'real deal' in NA. Of course, the entirety of NA world services has never gotten a single addict clean. They, like all of us, can only assist with group needs and do things under the direction of the Fellowship. The Fellowship mans the meetings. The Fellowship lives the program and greets the newcomer. The Fellowship has been growing. Any other viewpoint is like saying the dance got us clean or we got clean as a result of a convention or a PI committee. No, it is that fact that we encountered someone who cared and that early hope grew into our recovery. This is not to belittle the remarkable and important job done for us by our world service contingent. It is just to set the record straight. We, as a Fellowship, need to always be clear about our dependence on a Loving God to care for us and do those things that are beyond our strength or ability.

Into this tableau, bring a few bright new comers who have past experience with money, power and prestige. As surrendered members of NA, they feel compassion for the confusion and difficulties of self-government experienced by the mixed bag of recovering addicts. Instead of letting it play out, and let some of our unseen talent and God'grace keep the miracles coming, they do the human thing: they take charge. Gently without making waves, they begin to communicate and agree among themselves the insanity of the group conscience process. Being mentally based - and that is all a person without a secure Higher Power can be - they rationalize things around until they are the hope of NA. Over a few years, they and their friends are in place and the Grateful Dave, Baby Blue Case takes over front stage center. The lawsuit in 1990-1992 quickly lets world service understand that it is not in charge and in fact of a court of law, they are admonished to make concessions to the forces that oppose them and their corporate solutions to

all our problems. This is in 1990! The Baby Blue is demonized into a metaphor for all that World Service fears. Cease and Desist orders are sent out to a long list of members, many of whom have no idea what is happening. When you hear about people leaving the Fellowship because of service disorders, imagine getting the following notice in the mail seemingly from your beloved Fellowship.

Tremendous Amount of Pain

I rely enjoyed this piece which was written by a member in 1990 after receiving cease and desist order from WSO and their "agent." I believe it is from Florida. I have omitted last name of person who wrote this.
God loves us all.
EdM.

Baron and Cliff
ATTORNEYS AT LAW

July 13, 1990

Mr. Stu Tooredman
World Service Office, Inc
PO Box 9999
Van Nuys, Cal 91409-9999

Re: Alleged Copyright/Trademark Infringement

Dear Stuart:

This is in response to your letter of July 19, 1990, as well as to the certified letter of July 2, 1990 from Wagner & Middlebrook regarding duplication of the revised 3rd edition of the basic text of Narcotics Anonymous.

When I received the Wagner & Middlebrook letter, I was extremely troubled by three points. First, the fact that I had never even heard about, let alone seen, the subject text meant that the letter was being sent in a shotgun approach to every conceivable trusted servant in N.A.; this was confirmed the following day at the North Dade A.S.C. when it was determined that not only I as chair, but also the Vice Chair and A.S.R. had received certified letters. The use of this procedure, at a hard cost of $2.75 together with whatever legal fees were incurred, supports the perception held by many of the Fellowship that the W.S.O. has no concept of fiscal responsibility whatsoever. This perception was supported by the receipt several days later, by DHL overnight mail, of your letter apologizing for the first letter. In my experience, overnight delivery costs a minimum of $7.00, meaning that this whole exercise cost the Fellowship thousands of dollars which could clearly have been better spent.

The second point that troubled me even more is the fact that at least in this instance, little if any consideration was given by the W.S.O. to the Traditions. Clearly, if some law firm in Glendale is writing me as a member of Narcotics Anonymous, my anonymity doesn't count for much. The 12th Tradition does not state that anonymity can be broken to the W.S.O.'s "agents". The fact that the W.S.O. apparently gave no thought to the principle that anonymity is the spiritual principle of all our Traditions likewise supports the perception at the group level that service at the world level operates more on the basis of money, property, and prestige than on the primary purpose of carrying the

message.

This brings me to the final point, the document which is the basis of the controversy. Without knowing exactly the manner in which the various trademarks and copyrights mentioned in the Wagner & Middlebrook letter are held, I am not able to determine if their statement of the law and facts is correct. It was always my impression that the W.S.O. held these rights in trust for the entire Fellowship. While I am not an intellectual property attorney, if this is the case, it would seem that duplication of materials by a member of the Fellowship for free distribution within the Fellowship would not be illegal. While I have not personally been engaged in such duplication of materials, it again seems to me that questions of money, property, and prestige may be playing a more important role in this dispute than the primary purpose of the Fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous.

I find the tone of Atty. Middlebrook's letter to be threatening and insulting. I do not intend to respond to the questionnaire accompanying the letter, nor does the prospect of litigation cause me any great fear. However, the fact that member of the world service committees are threatening with the institution of legal action against other members of Narcotics Anonymous to restrain them from distributing free literature which, contrary to Mrs. Middlebrooks statement, was in fact the last edition of the basic text to be "Fellowship Approved", causes me a tremendous amount of pain. Had this matter been allowed to resolve itself according to the principles and traditions of this Fellowship, my guess is that it would have shortly died of its own weight. By your actions, overkill, and threats, it appears you have now converted the relatively minor matter of an unorthodox group or area into a controversy which may in fact create permanent schisms in Narcotics Anonymous.

It may be that such is God's will in this situation. It has been my experience that controversy, while painful, is often healthy. At the very least, the argument has caused a great many addicts to go back to their literature and review it for the first time in a long time. It is my hope that the Fellowship will grow from all of this. In any event, you have certainly given us much to discuss around our homes, business meetings, and service conferences.

With thanks for that, I remain,

Very truly yours,
Michael C.

Grover N. shares receiving a Cease and Desist letter:

To my knowledge there was no other letters prior that, that were sent out to members or regions. As stated on nawol site, we had a group of subversive members going from area to area spreading untruths, bringing the same harsh tone to the region. Some of these were from outside of our state. I am sure that a list of names was sent in to the principle with more harsh untruths, in a hope to have us expelled.

We saw the writing on the wall, the service structure was being manipulated, the fellowship was being told horse shit and ate every bite. So for some of us we did not wait to be expelled we quit. We had been part of a world full of lies and mistrust during our using, it is one of the things we rebelled against. Our sanctuary of hope, truth and service was being ripped apart by a few, and an apathetic whole. Hell. Logan said "there is no sanctuary" (See Logan's Run - The movie). To some of us he was right, prophetic even.

Now I know the sanctuary we sought was internal. I had not been clean long enough to mature enough in this understanding. For all those that tore down the churches, they forgot the church is in the person not the building.

So here we are. For those that survived and made it back, my hope is to honor the time and those that did not, with this work. We can not change the nature of man or disease. There is always going to be the apathetic majority, along for the party and dates. There will be those seduced by the illusion of power, and corrupted by the dollar. "We have no opinion on outside issues" These our outside issues, our focus should be on our recovery and our work. When we

stop trying to change what we can not and work on what we can our lives and work will become much more pleasant. Our road smother. God will be in control and we will be of service to our fellow man, member and most of all a loving God, without which it is all insane anyway.
ILS
Grover

Grateful Dave's Fight

When the power politics started up in Narcotics Anonymous, there were men and women who were not at all afraid or disoriented. The Viet Nam War was fresh in people's minds and experience. Activists or all sorts wound up in NA seeking recovery. To watch a few players try to wrest power and control from the Fellowship was absurd. But when they changed the Basic Text, they went too far. One member who got clean in Charleston, West Virginia was David Moorhead. He had some rock and roll business in his background. Since most of the serious service workers had families and jobs to tend, Dave elected himself to take on the Office. Greg Pierce said it infuriated him that Dave lured them into the court battle so easily - after announcing that was his main plan and intent. He wanted to draw out what he saw as negative elements within the world service system who were anything but surrendered and loving. One member of World Services said it all with the line, "Dave deserves what he gets." as they prepared to launch the law suit.

Tapes exist of these sad periods. The violence and degradation shared on these tapes is terrible.

Dave created a persona for himself, wrote himself lines designed to infuriate the Office and traveled to major conventions and spent so many hours on the phone I found bloody scabs on his ear during a visit. He could be found spreading concern for the breech of trust and existing NA policy as exemplified in changes to Narcotics Anonymous, our Basic Text. He had taken the 3rd Edition Revised and inserted material deleted from Traditions Four and Nine in confused WSC action a few years before. In short, the lines referred to ‘all else is not NA' and service boards and committees do not have the power to ‘rule, censor, dictate or decide.' Grateful Dave produced and distributed about 17,000 copies of this book but there are more being produced even to this day.

The WSO was hard pressed to locate the RSC vote that warranted the deletion based on a vote after Conference a few years earlier. And yes, people did not put it beyond the WSO to falsify the voting tally to have their way. Trust in WSO had been shattered by their actions during this period. When WSO committed an incredible $100,000 dollars to sue Grateful Dave to stop his Baby Blue campaign, Dave finally got Fellowship attention.
Walking through a park in Allentown behind Billy A's home, I had a long talk with Dave. He had been diagnosed with AIDS and said that he wanted to be remembered this way: "Dave? Dave was a son-of-a-bitch - but he was right!" The results of his efforts are found in the Fellowship Intellectual Properties Trust. Many of the members who worked at WSO or took sides with the Office were amazed to find that the Fellowship really did write the book and did in fact own the book! There is a blindness that comes from being at or near the center: presumption and lack of perspective make it hard to see the real proportions of things. – Personal Recollections by Bo S.

Grateful Dave’s Home Group

The issues previously described concerning the BabyBlues had already hit the fan when I was invited by Grateful

Dave to attend a meeting in one crazy neighborhood in the Philadelphia area 1989-1990. The neighborhood was just outside what is now called the "Badlands". I parked a block away with much trepidation. As I walked to the meeting there was a potential shootout at the cross street. Each of the two corners on one side had men from a local gang the other corners were manned by a vigilanty goup who wanted to clean up the neighborhood and they were also armed. I no sooner navigated that when an arson fire broke out two blocks away with the noise of fire engine sirens all over the place. Next to our meeting was a Korean convenience store who's front security gate looked like a truck hit it. The burglar alarm was going off because the front window had been rifled. And now for the meeting place...
There was a door next to the meeting place leading up to an apartment which had turned into a shooting gallery. I noticed the bright orange cap to a set of gizzmoes lying on the sidewalk as I entered the meeting. The abandoned storefront was just that, abandoned. There was a single light bulb that hung from the ceiling at the far end of the store. It looked like someone was pirating the electricity. The attendance that night was about 20-25 and I was asked by the chair if I would share with everyone on the first three steps because most everyone there was on one of those three. I was glad to share especially when I found out the speaker got to use one of only three chairs. That's right eveyone was sitting on the floor of this abandoned store with dirt and cockroaches galore! So there I am in total awe about to share to a group with about 50% of em totally high when I noticed that many of these addicts were holding "BabyBlues". Because they were so cheap they were being given away freely to anyone who wanted them. I know that many of those present would never have spent the $10 price tag. I also believe that most homegroups could not provide them to the extent that this group was doing it. I have to this day not experienced anything so moving as the fifty-five year old who came to the front for a 90 day key tag amidst all this craziness. He had tears in his eyes when he shared that it had been the longest he had been clean since he was 16 years old. He shared that "it's cause this meeting an things in my book" (he was holding a BabyBlue)!

This story does not have the happy ending you might be hoping for. When the local "Area Service" (I don't know if this group was a member) discovered this renegade meeting house with the BabyBlues they decided it needed there help! The atmosphere was ruined by addicts political arguing (not a good thing to do near the badlands). Some of those attending were from a 1/2 way or 3/4 way house so the area deemed that it couldn't be any bodies home group it had to be an H&I thing (you guessed it no BabyBlues). The presentation fell apart shortly after the start of H&I presentations. I like to think it may have been a result of circumstances beyond the comittees control but something tells me that the NA sheriffs needed something more than a presentation to stifle there libido. I would only add a personal observation to this. What I witnessed was recovery at its finest . The nice spic and span back rooms of church's that are so typicle of our meetings are sometimes filled with members just as green. Autonomy sometimes gets crushed under the swordsman who shouts "Except when affecting NA as a whole." My question here is,"did that group in any way affect you in Florida, New Jersey, California or for that matter 5 blocks away in Philadelphia?

Baby Blue Court Case

This important and telling set of exerpts from the Baby Blue Court Case resulted in many members understanding for the first time that the "Fellowship" was the entity responsible for the writing of the Basic Text. The tone of David Morehead, Judge Pollack and the others in these transcripte should remind us all of how important we are to one another.

90/91 CAR WSOBOD Report to the Fellowship from Stuart Tooredman, Chairperson
Report pp 27-34
Excerpt pp 29 - 34

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<top half of page: 90/91 CAR Motion #11 & 12 with intents>

The following section of the WSO report is provided as our commitment to the recent settlement concerning the production and distribution of the Basic

Text. The motions from the agreement, as presented in this section, are the culmination of a joint effort by all concerned to obtain a clear understanding and determination from the fellowship. We encourage all regions, areas, and groups to read the introductory remarks thoroughly, and to consider each motion conscientiously during their subsequent deliberations. The motions are not accompanied with intent statements, and are presented without any further comment other than the following introductory remarks.

These are the comments of the Honorable Louis H. Pollack, J., United States District Court of the Eastern District of Pennsylvania.

THE COURT: We have spent the day hearing testimony in this matter. It is not the kind of a controversy that a court welcomes. It is, quite evidently, a controversy which is essentially internal to a group with many, many members, many dispersed sub-entities, a common purpose, a common purpose of great social consequence.

It is evident that the fellowship has engaged, over the years, the devoted participation of tens of thousands, now maybe hundreds of thousands, of people, people who have in their own lives been deeply troubled, and who have striven very hard to liberate themselves in the course of time, to help liberate others to brave this sort of peril.

For a controversy to arise in an enterprise of that kind is regrettable; certainly one that is controversy that seems to be deeply schismatic. It is more regrettable, and it appears to be beyond the capacity of the participants to resolve their differences internally, recognizing the larger importance of common purposes than the areas of disagreement. That is to say, the more regrettable one. An appeal is made to the secular authority of the courts to make dispositions.

I asked the parties to try their best to reach some resolution, at least on an interim basis; not on a final basis, and the efforts on the 27th and 28th of December evidently were not fruitful. Today's testimony only underscores for me the importance of some serious

attention being given to reconciliatory activity rather than activity of a divisive kind. I rather appreciate that with people feeling deeply, as evidently people do on each side of this issue, it is the tendency of each side to think, well, I am the reconciler, and it's the people over there who are being divisive.

I suppose in this courtroom right now, Mr. Wolfe and I are the only people who are in a position to say -- maybe both sides suffer a little from the sins of inflexibility and certainly that virtue is mine and vice is thine.

I would ask you all to give some close attention to the possibility that there is more that you have in common than that divides you; and to carry on controversies of this kind is only destructive of, and diversionary from, your common purposes.

One point that I find particularly disturbing is to be told, as, in effect, Ms. Moore was telling me, that we have poor people who are greatly in need of guidance. They can't afford $8 a book, and therefore, we want to make texts available to them for little or nothing; or at least we want to make access to such texts available.

I hear from Mr. Hollahan that, in principle, the WSO has no difficulties with furthering what would seem to be such a clearly laudable goal, assuming one believe in the purposes of Narcotics Anonymous. But, of course, the resolution which would flow from an assent by the directors of the WSO to making texts available, free, to Ms. Moore's home group, and possibly to other groups which have constituencies which really can't pay, afraid of $8 a volume, that resolution begins to seem remote when one is told, yes, but the text that WSO has in stock, its Fifth Edition, is not a text that we in conscience could accept. It's a little curious to be told by Ms. Moore that maybe the Third Revised Edition might be acceptable. They would have to talk to the group about that. But it's certainly not the Fifth Edition.

That was apparently beyond the pale in discussion with the group. I have not inquired into, and I do not intend to inquire into, what the debates are with respect to what texts are appropriately within the compass of the revered Twelve Traditions, and what are not. Debates of that sort have a habit of being unproductive. Yet, I can't believe that if you people on both sides of the aisle, both sides of the litigation, really have a shared earnest commitment to people gripped by addiction, that you cannot find a way of reconciling your differences; recognizing that shadings of verbal meaning may, usefully, be the subjects of honest debate rather than insuperable obstacles to getting on with your real business of saving people who are desperately ill.

I guess I'm saying to you that, after listening all day, I think there's an awful lot of self-righteousness on both sides of this case. And for people who are trying to save others, that sort of self-righteousness is not entirely attractive.

So now you have my preachment. I'm going to leave you for some hours with that preachment to chew over. I'm going to challenge you, both sides, to have the courage of your convictions; to talk with one another, not against one another, but with one another, with a view, at least for the moment, of reaching accommodations -- maybe small accommodations arrived at now -- to obviate the need for going forward one way or another with an application for a Temporary Restraining Order, and beyond that a Preliminary Injunction. Maybe accommodations arrived at right now could pave the way for larger accommodations, so that you could then use more fruitfully the machinery of the World Conference and get back to reasoned collective debate rather than imposing solutions on one another.

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I don't know whether you really have the courage of your conviction. I wonder whether each side isn't simply taking a refuge in its self-described

virtue. Maybe if I talk long enough in this vein, you can recognize me as a common enemy, and that will give you something to unite about.

You're not the only people who recognize the evils of narcotics addiction. A person in my line of work sees it every day in this courtroom, and these courtrooms are replicated by the tens of thousands throughout this country. For every one of your home groups, there are scores and scores and scores of courtrooms. So if you want to work at these problems, work at them.

Work at them for the balance of this evening and tomorrow morning. You can come back here tomorrow at 11:30, and you can tell me whether you've been able to manage to talk constructively together.

As I understand it, the conversations up to now, on the 27th and 28th, were between Mr. Moorhead, on the one hand, and Mr. Synnestvedt and Mr. Fields, on the other. Mr. Synnestvedt and Mr. Fields are lawyers. I was about to say only lawyers. I don't mean that in a disparaging sense, or I would disparage myself. I'm only a lawyer, too. But we're instrumentalists in this business. It's Mr. Hollahan and his colleagues on the one, and Mr. Moorhead and his colleagues on the other hand, who are going to have to decide whether they can do something constructive.

I think the next set of conversations -- and I'm going to leave you here in this courtroom. This a good venue to start. Its neutral ground has a certain severity that may remind you of your common obligations. I think it should be the attorneys and the litigants, Mr. Hollahan, as well as his attorneys, Mr. Moorhead -- and I hope, Mr. Moorhead, your colleagues with you -- talk here in the courtroom; go out and have supper, talk more there. If you can't work something out this evening, then you'll have a few hours in the morning. But take your responsibilities seriously.

Forget the posturings of this courtroom. If you come up empty-handed by tomorrow morning at 11:30, then I will go forward to consider the motion for a Temporary Restraining Order. Good night.

(Whereupon, the Court began the proceedings at 9:45 a.m.) Friday, January 4, 1991.

MR. SYNNESTVEDT: The parties have carefully followed Your Honor's instructions, and have worked together long and diligently, and have reached an agreement.
THE COURT: That's very gratifying.
MR. SYNNESTVEDT: It's one that finally disposes of this matter, subject to Your Honor's entry of an order, that we worked out the language of, and I'd like at this time to hand up a copy of the agreement that the parties entered into. Attached as Exhibit A is a copy of the proposed form of order.
THE COURT: Let me take a moment to look at this.
MR. SYNNESTVEDT: I'm sorry, I didn't have an opportunity to get it down to Your Honor earlier this morning. We made that last revisions after 9 o'clock.
THE COURT: Obviously, you have been working very intensively.
(Pause)

Well, that sounds like a very constructive agreement, indeed, that you've arrived at, and I congratulate you. I call your attention to a couple of very minor typographical matters that I think you might want to amend.

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On page two, fifth line from the bottom -- well, I think the last word of that line should be "either the" or "a" but not both of them. That is, "either entered the preliminary hearing," or "entered a preliminary hearing."
MR. SYNNESTVEDT: I think the word "the" should be stricken, Your Honor.
THE COURT: All right. Suppose we make the changes and have the parties who are here with us in the court today initial the changes. I would think that would make good sense.
I the same line, my first name is L-O-U-I-S.
MR. SYNNESTVEDT: Sorry about that, Your Honor.
THE COURT: No apologies are necessary. I routinely have my name misspelled, but it's usually my last name.
On page three, in the fourth line of motion two, I think you mean "its" without an apostrophe; do you not?
MR. SYNNESTVEDT: Yes, Your Honor.
THE COURT: And I would, in the same vein, I would suggest that on page four, the various times where you refer to RSRs, that you probably don't want an apostrophe there, either. It's just an ordinary plural, isn't it?
MR. SYNNESTVEDT: Yes, I think that's correct, Your Honor.
THE COURT: The second line of the first full paragraph where it says, "four RSRs," and then down on the seventh line, the last work of the line is --
MR. SYNNESTVEDT: On the third line, too, Your Honor.
THE COURT: On the third line, correct, and the third line. And, finally, I guess it's the twelfth line, the third word, "by the RSRs," again you probably would not want the apostrophe. I'm sure you really didn't want me to be your proofreader, but it's very hard for me to read without a pen in my hand.
I'm certainly entirely satisfied to enter the Order which you are requesting me to enter by consent.
MR. SYNNESTVEDT: Thank you, Your Honor. I have the original typed version here.
THE COURT: You and Mr. Moorhead want to agree on, and initial, the changes in the agreement.
MR. SYNNESTVEDT: Mr. Moorhead has requested an opportunity to address the Court.
THE COURT: I'd be delighted to hear from Mr. Moorhead before I sign this Order.
MR. MOORHEAD: Your Honor, our Society of Narcotics Anonymous is only a microcosm of society at large, and we are thankful for the insight and the direction that you have offered us. We may have many things to learn as individuals and human beings, and we must remain open to instructive, sound, wise admonishments that help redirect us in our endeavors.
Your patience and your tolerance for the proceedings that we in front of you the other day, and your admonishments to us at the end, were the catalyst that brings us to the point where we are today, putting seven years of divisiveness and hurt feelings and diversion from our societal purposes behind us. This is truly, in my mind, and in minds of all who have attended and participated thus far, a truly momentous day in the history of not only Narcotics Anonymous, but

perhaps it may have further far-reaching implications for society as a whole.

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I would beg Your Honor, if there is ever a time that someone comes before your court that is in need of an organization such as ours, that you not hesitate to call upon me personally, or any one of the people who were here in this courtroom, because, quite frankly, sir, we will go to the mat for them, and we're going to the mat for you, too. Thank you.
THE COURT: Well, I thank you, Mr. Moorhead, for what you have said. And I thank all of you for the very constructive spirit in which you have approached this matter.
There are lots of lawsuits that come to a federal court ranging all over the canvass, civil and criminal alike, and most people don't come to court unless there's a considerable trouble. There are occasional times when one feels that a judicial intervention serves some constructive purpose. There are many times when one feels that all a court can do is contribute an orderly framework for the disposition of a problem and determine what the society's response must e where people are unable to resolve disagreements for themselves. But, not infrequently, one feels not a great sense of accomplishment besides registering society's verdict and establishing the discipline framework.

One doesn't feel a great sense of accomplishment in the sense that, too often, one is not very sanguine that constructive things will follow. This litigation is an exception, and an enormously gratifying exception to that generalization.

On the basis of what you, Mr. Synnestvedt, and you, Mr. Moorhead, have said, and on the basis of the text of the agreement you've arrived at, and the Order of which you are asking me to sign, and which I very happily do sign, I feel that the auspices are very good for moving forward in a constructive way, with efforts which obviously are of enormous consequence to the society. And I'm most gratified to the extent that our efforts here, the day before yesterday and this morning, have led in this proper direction.

I certainly will bear in mind, Mr. Moorhead, as I continue to do my work here, that we are in some significant sense institutionally working in parallel ways for these very important common purposes. And I will look forward to hearing, I hope -- perhaps the parties will favor me with letting me know what happens to accomplish the ends which are identified in your agreement, most particularly what provisions are ultimately determined by the processes which are contemplated for further consideration by the Conference.
I should add that I am gratified at the thought that the parties have felt that something useful might be accomplished by publishing what I had to say in court on January 2. I will have to tell you that after that hearing, I was a little concerned, perhaps more exigent in my censure, and less appreciative of your various efforts than I should have been. But I am glad that some positive message came through, and that in response to it, you were able to work so successfully together.

So I have signed this Order, and I will ask if you, that you -- will you

undertake to file this, Mr. Synnestvedt?
MR. SYNNESTVEDT: Yes, Your Honor.
THE COURT: Perhaps if you would kindly return a copy of the agreement to my chambers.
MR. SYNNESTVEDT: Yes, Your Honor. The agreement is to be modified slightly by those typographical corrections. Thank you, Your Honor.
THE COURT: Thank you all. Unless there's anything further, we are in recess.
(Whereupon, the Court adjourned the proceedings at 10:00 a.m.)

WSC Agenda Report -- WSO Board of Directors Page 34

<in bold print>

#13. That the fellowship reconsider its decision on which edition, or parts thereof (First, Second, Third, Third Revised, Fourth, or Fifth), of the Basic Text shall be produced and distributed by the WSO as the official and accepted text of Narcotics Anonymous.

In order for this motion to be considered, a description of the differences between the respective editions will be sent to each registered area and region, along with a copy of the complete Basic Text Third Edition, Revised. It is expected that the WSC will rescind the motions adopted in 1988, which adopted the Fifth Edition as the Basic Text, as well as the motion restricting any change to the text for five years.

#14. That the WSO produce, at a reduced price, the edition of the text ratified by the WSC. The actual price of this text should be determined in view of the following factors: its affordability to the membership at large; a change in the cost and quality of the materials used in producing the book; the responsibility of the WSO to provide services from the income generated by sales of the Basic Text; and whether it includes personal stories or only the first ten chapters.

#15. That the WSC be directed to obtain a group-by-group tally of all the groups registered with the WSO, on Motions 13 and 14 above. This procedure will begin on July 1, 1991 and continue through December 31, 1991. All the registered groups shall receive a copy of a paper detailing the differences between the editions of the Basic Text, and a complete copy of the Basic Text Third Edition, Revised. In addition, each group shall receive complete information concerning the issues relevant to a reduction in the price of the ratified text.

The committee appointed to supervise this tally shall consist of the following: four RSRs, to be nominated by members of the World Service Board of Trustees; two WSO directors, to be nominated by the directors of the WSO; and the WSC Chairperson. Those nominated RSRs, trustees, and directors, respectively, are to be submitted to the World Service Conference in 1991 for confirmation by two-thirds published roll-call vote, failing which, those not confirmed shall be replaced by others nominated by the RSRs, the trustees, or the directors, respectively. Two members of the WSO staff shall also be assigned as nonvoting advisory members. The results of the group-by-group

tally shall be published in the Fellowship Report, and confirmed as official at World Service Conference in 1992.

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Grateful Dave's input
to "Trust Document"

(Excerpts from transcription of conference calls of 'original working group.' Dave's comments preceeded by ...GD: all other
member's comments, which are included only as needed for context,
preceeded by ...X,Y,or Z: Jim M, Ohio is X)

GD: You're not going to like it, but I don't have anything positive to say about this (Trust Doc.) or the WSO report or the state of affairs in Narcotics Anonymous today, so prefaced with that, that's my opening comment.

X: I feel betrayed. I think that what we talked about in Harrisburg was trying to heal something in the fellowship that's become a rift. This document, particularly the operational rules part of it widens the rift. It doesn't do any healing that I see.

GD: Absolutely. It's completely one-sided.

X: Essentially, the trustor is in the place where the beneficiary should be consistently.

GD: Absolutely.

X: I see that if this, from the nature of things that I understand in my region and people that I've visited with, this comes on the floor of the conference, it's going to solidify some people that already want to create an alternative structure. That's what I'd really hoped to avoid with this, is getting everybody pulling together instead of pulling separately, and I really feel this shows that somebody who was responsible for the writing this doesn't understand the traditions of Narcotics Anonymous.

Let me look first specifically to one thing that I think is the most indicative of that, and that's page 19 of the operational rules, under **** of inspection. Item #1, referring to this region that might want to inspect the records of the trust. The region's motion to conduct an inspection of the trust must be approved by two thirds or more of regional service committee's voting participants. In this way, the literature trust which is supposed to be part of that scheme of things, which is a service board or committee directly responsible to those it serves, has dictated to those they serve. That's number one. Number two, which is referent to the ability of this region. Let's refer back to the beginning on page 18, Section 3, "Inspection of Trustee Activities conceptual notes," it says that all records will be available to the inspecting region, except personnel records, and then parenthetically, U.S. federal employment codes require that employers keep these records completely confidential. Somebody doesn't understand that the fellowship is the employer of the employees at the World Service Office.

Y: That's correct. But the fellowship elected a board that deals with the personnel aspect. So, in essence, they have a body that inspects personnel records.

GD: I got a comment here at this time. "Responsible framework" is that since the fellowship is the employer of all at

the office, really, that the fellowship has been in this inspection procedure, and I'm with Jim all the way on it. It places an unfair burden financially and otherwise on the region itself. This stuff should be a matter of accounting records that, if proper accounting procedures are used, that should be able to be printed out on a monthly basis, and presented to anyone who asks.

Y: Print out what?

GD: Print out the financial status of all the accounts and the other things. If you're using a proper accounting program, which may be a little expensive to institute in the beginning...

Y: We do that right now.

GD: Okay, then why are you setting up barriers for the fellowship?

Y: We're talking about an inspection that's beyond that particular scope. That's something that we would freely distribute. We're talking about physical inspection.

X: I apologize for trying to use this as an illustration, but not one of the major things that I have contention with the document. The major thing I have a contention with the document is that I believe in order for this rift to be healed, the fellowship needs to be specified, the fellowship of N.A. as owner or if legally it can only be co-owner, that would be okay, too. There needs to be some direct chain between the fellowship and the administrator of this trust, WSO, and it needs to be somehow defined in here that WSC is going to be included in discussion, but the WSC is the definition of collective conscience of the fellowship. What I have the biggest trouble with is that the WSC is indicated as the approver of literature, primarily, the rift has started because the fellowship to a great extent considers themselves as the approver of literature, and the WSC as an entity that has approved literature (or disapproved literature), changed literature without the consent of the fellowship.

Z: That's the problem.

GD: I'd like to interject here and drop a bomb. The bomb is, that all throughout this document and the WSO Report, and several of the public situations that we've all been involved in, you've talked about the mistakes made or the convenience factor of a work made for hire. I will tell you that work made for hire is all through here, and it's prettied up. It's like, "Okay, don't look too close at it, because if you look too close, you're gonna know." Some of the, in fact early, and even a lot of the later stuff shifts some of the criteria for work made for hire. However, upon closer scrutiny and challenge, maybe first time out, but certainly upon appeal, that would never stand up. So your fundamental premise for development of this document as it stands with the work made for hire as its basis, renders this document useless for your purposes. I'm just telling you this for your purposes. The other thing is that you've got, and I shared this with George the other day, you may have 18 months from now and after this conference and people get as disgusted as they are, because I don't see any thing. I looked at the end game three years ago and here we are. It's all unified board, unified this, unified, bring in all the power, bring in all the finance, just reel it all in and put it down. You have 300 people in the fellowship that are manipulating 750,000 that don't have a clue to what's going on.

So you're going to have a few people that have clues that say, "Hey, man, to hell with this." It's going to take them a little while. But what we're going to be, is doing an alternate thing, maybe four regions, maybe five, maybe ten. In 18 months from now, you're going to get a wise idea to take us to court and try to do whatever for work made for hire, and you'll lose. So, Jim is absolutely right in the healing.

I feel really chumped out. I feel that I've been put on a spit and turned over a fire and laughed at, and "Gosh, we got Dave, didn't we? Well, nobody's going to give him a ticket to the conference so he won't be a threat to us." You know what I mean? I told George this. We had an agreement, it was witnessed in front of officers of the court, and others, and that agreement was that these intellectual properties would be taken care of, and he's nodding his head yes, I'm

sure. I don't perceive him to have any reason not to stretch it, and I'm quoting exactly, that "If you don't get these things registered properly and factually, I will be back on you like stink on chit."

I will crawl up 95 and put myself in a rescue mission, and we will be right back to square one, and let me tell you again if you have not figured it out, that if I was doing something that was so radically against the law that a 40-year federal court veteran thought that I was out of line, you would have walked into court, and thirty minutes later you would have had your restraining order, and that would have been that. You had better take a big, hard, long look at what it is that this is all about. As far as I'm concerned, it's the same chit, different day. I have absolutely no hope in this document. There was nothing positive that was said about a reduced price Basic Text, $3.00 is no bargain. You've failed, in my mind, completely failed.

Z: What is the origin of this document? It's like a first draft or something?

Y: It's going to go out for review, and it can be changed dramatically, it can be altered dramatically. But, it is an attempt.

GD: It's origin is just like when you to a law firm, Bo.

Z: I want to hear that from them, though, Dave, not from you. I want to hear that from them.

Y: The origin of the document is to articulate in writing the nature of the fiduciary trust between the World Service Office and the World Service Conference and the membership. The purpose of it is to define these things so that the membership and the trustors/ trustees, everything, know exactly what the operating rules are and what the parameters of the trust is.

If it's not in the best interest and it lies in these areas, or it needs to change, or the rules need to change, then we need to articulate the way it should be so we don't sit on the phone and argue back and forth and end up in court while wasting our fellowship's money about who has rights and who doesn't have rights.

GD: Let's go for it. This is a very poor starting point.

Y: That's fine, Dave. You're not really lending a whole lot to this whole God damn thing anyway. Except saying everything sucks. Come on, man.

GD: If you want my whole point by point feedback, I can go point by point. I thought we were just having a general chat to begin with. This is the chat. Yeah, I think it sucks, Stu, I think you're absolutely correct.
Z: The fellowship owns the literature, and this document would reduce them to the status of beneficiary. I know that they have to work through organizational approaches to have effective ownership and control of their property, but we did it for them. We didn't do it for a current crop of hirelings at the office. You'll only be at the office for a few years.

Y: The office only serves the people that it serves.

Z: I just heard that the office serves basically those who it is responsible to, I have a real conflict with that as everyone knows. I believe they're supposed to serve my home group, and every other home group in the world. The home groups are basically not given the opportunity to participate in the communication network.If the conference is not responsible, there's no way the World Service Office going to be.

GD: Correct.

Z: So we do have some structural matters that have to be worked toward change for that to happen.

X: Except, perhaps, if regions could elect a portion of the directors, perhaps a majority, directly.

GD: Directors of what, Jim?

JM: Of the office. Of the Board of Directors of the Office. Directly.

GD: I've got some specific stuff, but there are problems with that specifically. I would like to see the recognized RSC's themselves be the trustors. If that is a compromise situation. However, what we are going to see with the subdivision of the fellowship in the national and international conferences and licensing and printing and all of that different stuff that's going to go on, is we're going to have probably five years from now, ten years from now, when we get some of the literature translated, if that ever happens, we'll have other structural issues pertaining to this trust that we'll have to deal with that haven't been recognized.

Stu, I want to just say right now. I'm interested in seeing that the fellowship's property is enured, and the benefit enured to the benefit of the fellowship. Maybe philosophically, knowing where I'm at with this may help you see into my head a little bit. If you take 330,000 Basic Texts and multiply that by whatever cost you do, and then you subdivide that by 30 cents that you could pay to get them, you're talking about over a million books that could be used to carry the message to addicts who still suffer.
Now, you take the money out of it, you take the personality out of it, you take the control out of it, you take the plane flights away, you take all those things away from it. You have to understand that a person like me, and maybe other addicts are not like me, but I walked in here dead. If something stands in the way of our ability to carry the message to the addict who still suffers, then my whole philosophy is that that's got to go. Whatever barriers there are to saving lives, like mine, has to go. That's why our home group did what we did.

We are basically here today, over the question of the ethic of what it is we are doing to carry the message to the addict that still suffers and the proper use of the money. One faction says we need a dollar Basic Text, it's peppered all over the CAR. Another faction says we need a 30 cent Basic Text that costs $3.00, which is even more profit that you guys are making now. Are you the same kind of addicts that perhaps the people that worked on the text believing, trying like Joshua in the battle of Jericho, march around and blow the horns. One day it will all fall down.

Y: It's been a lot of years since then. I have a question. I understand where you come from, Dave. I don't not believe in a lot of the things that you're talking about. That remains to be seen. I have some questions about something that you said. You mentioned that the RSC's could be the trustor.

GD: Right.

X: The trustor, instead of specifying the conference, we're saying the RSC's, the fellowship.

Y: Then, if that's the case, are you saying that the RSC's as a whole? Specifically not the conference, which would then exclude all the non-RSC participants, correct? Is that what you're saying?

GD: I got this just so recently that I haven't really had a chance to fine tooth comb it and then turn around and write what it would be that I would like to see in place. First of all, the definition of a trustor, I don't see it. Then, the trustee, I don't see that. But hypothetically, I would see the RSC's acting as the agent of the beneficiary. So, addicts in whatever region that they are in, would have that kind of access to the system. I see a two-fold set up here.

I talked to George about this the other day. The conference is incredibly influenced by the office, and we have got plenty of evidence that for instance, in Florida and the published report from Northern California, it doesn't matter what the areas vote, because their RSR's have stood up and said that they're going to vote exactly what they want to vote and if you don't like it, tough chit.

We have problems with spiritual principles in our fellowship. I see the office and the conference as a symbiosis that needs to be corrected in some fashion. I never supported giving the Trustees the copyrights, because of the move toward the single board concept. But I would see a two-tiered system here where the office would be the office, and the trust would be administered by the RSC's. The beneficiaries would be, this is regardless of the office, the Board of Directors, the WSC, the committee chairs, the trustees, everybody. As far as I can tell, I don't feel...

Z: The beneficiary, properly, would be the newcomer.

GD: Absolutely. And, if we ever get around to writing a step guide, people who have been here a little while. I'd like to see us do something. In 1982, we started writing a step book.

Y: Let me ask a question.

GD: Let me tie this up if I can. In 1986, Bob Stone proposed that we license RSO's to print literature. Oops. He went home to California. I was on the committee, me and Charlie Coocher and a bunch of other people. We went home and the committee was canceled. Why? Because if the RSC's or the RSO's could produce their own literature, there would be no need or income for the World Service Office.

That is something that we may need to look at, is that the trust sets up a way for the necessary functions of the office to be continued, which would have to be done in a fellowship wide referendum. It would be a rather complex and protracted process. It says here on the front of this thing that the fellowship will be given a year to review, and we're not going to approve the final version until before the '92 conference. Even for something as simple as, for some people, as simple as this, it's going to take a lot longer to even approve something like this, or even to get input in a way that's going to satisfy all those philosophical concerns that we've discussed previously here and in other places. I appreciate the work that has gone in on this. But in being less than hostile and a little bit more fair, it seems to be particularly one sided. Even quoting from the WSO annual report, there's a line in here. It's neat, it's slick, but it definitely favors the status quo. No one that I know that's awake yet, is going to be taken in by it.

Y: There's two things that I think are important to note at this point. Number one, I believe a lot of discussion that we've heard from you guys is really something that really needs to take place in a document, that for lack of a better explanation, would be a conference charter. That would display the relationship of this thing called the WSC to the regions, to the areas, to the groups, and to the members. We felt as we were writing this, that we were somehow constrained by what currently exists in our fellowship today, what we know as the service structure, right or wrong.

GD: I'm going to interject one small, quick thing. Here is the fundamental thing that maybe it makes it difficult, but I will label the "traditionalists" in this fellowship, assume that all creative and spiritual, quasi legal spiritual documents in Narcotics Anonymous are an expression of the fellowship and group conscience. And that as employees in the office, staff team writers, special workers, lawyers, and that type, that there's a rub in there. We are forever non-professional, aren't we? Doesn't the fellowship do the work and the service bodies assist? I think we've approached this process backwards.

Y: We could probably spend a few weeks discussing those things to find some commonalities between us. The current way that the service structure makes decisions, right or wrong, and I think that we all agree that we all have problems with it, that we were somehow confined by that. The issues that you bring up, are the issues that need to be brought to the fellowship. Not necessarily in this type of document, because we are somewhat constrained about what exists today.

The other thing is, one of the difficult things in trying to put this thing together, is really defining the beneficiary of the fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous. A fellowship whose only requirement for membership is the desire to stop using. That is not stated in any other way than by the individuals themselves. That presents us with a major difficulty legally. For the fact that by identifying those beneficiaries in a way that they can benefit from the trust, there's also

the principle of anonymity. To name all of our members in this type of document may cause us some conflict with that tradition as well. Those are the types of things that as we developed this document, we felt somewhat constrained by. The law does require us to name in a way that can be identified as a beneficiary and a trustor. Unfortunately, the RSC's coming together as a group is not something that we've done in the fellowship. We've basically articulated a document reflective of the current service structure. We tried to articulate something that say a home group or area somewhere has a problem with the way the trust is administered, and they need some way of approaching a question they have to get some reasonable answers. If their questions are answered and it becomes an issue that needs to be addressed. Currently, nothing exists. Currently, you have the World Service Office who has the trust in a fiduciary capacity, and they're connected to the conference somehow. It's not in any writing, or not in anything, but they're connected because we are who we are.

The ideal was to make a formal connection and allow sufficient concern for a problem or issue to surface that could be addressed. This may need to be widened and expanded, but it's going to take **** outside of us. We could only reflect the current system. Maybe the current system needs to change. I kind of think it does, but...

GD: The beneficiaries of the trust ultimately are the addicts that aren't even born yet. Yes, it's a very weighty issue, and I understand anybody's difficulty wrestling with it. But to some degree, we're going to have to find some way to trust somebody, trust the RSC's to be together and administer this properly, and not...

Y: You know what, Dave? My tying into the WSC is what my way of tying into the region. That's what my conception is. The interpretation of tying into the fellowship through the WSC, because I believe that's the collective conscience of the region, the region are the conscience of the areas, and etc.

GD: I don't think you'll find any agreement on that amongst any of us.
Z: That's the agreed intent, Stu, but we all know that that's now how the conference operates. We know that. If it worked that way it would be great. We know that what happens there is when the issue of the 3rd Edition Revised and 4th Edition came up, and the RSR only voting participants, we had RSR's marching to the floor and rejecting their regional conferences that they had to carry there. We know that the conference had a world literature conference right in a forum violated our literature guidelines and we know that trustees get to the conference mikes and use their position to manipulate, and others. We know how that operates. We know that it's a political forum there. It is not speaking of the fellowship coming through, and that's where our philosophical differences come in.

Philosophy is one thing, but when the guy from Philadelphia called me and told me about the six guys marching into the home group that used to be Grateful Dave's home group and taking over the group conscience setting, pushing through some votes of their choosing, never having been to the group before, except one of them once. They just walked in like gangsters and pulled this off and called that group conscience. Well, that's not group conscience.

Y: I agree.

X: I guess where I come from in looking at all this, is that I think if we, together, want to do something to help solve the problems, that we need to do more homework before we present something to any other group of people than ourselves. It would be really unfortunate if this document were to leave our nurturing until it was a whole lot more acceptable to a wider group of the fellow-ship. I understand what you, Stu and George, about feeling the need to work within the existing structural situation, but I really kind of trusted that you would look back to when it was working, to find some leadership there. I'd like to share with you just a bit on page 9, section 5, regarding where I'm coming from. One thing I do want to commend you on, is that somebody talked to the lawyers and toned down the "legalese" in the first part.

"Operational rules, page 9. Nature of ownership of the trust copyrighted literature. Creation of all new or revised trust literary properties will be initiated by the beneficiary, either directly or subordinate board or committee. The process used to create these properties from commencement to conclusion will be under constant control of the beneficiary, exercised directly, or by a subordinate board or committee, e.g., the trustor. Individuals who take part in the creation

of these properties will do so as giftors, and as such, may be called employees of either the trustor or the trustee, whether or not they receive compensation, with full knowledge..."

You see my thrust? Everybody knows that what we're calling beneficiary and trustor, etc., language like that, an alteration philosophically, would make this document more nearly acceptable and more nearly distributable. If we're interested in having a healing, causative impact on the fellowship and the conference. Without that kind of a thrust, we don't even have a place to start.

GD: Absolutely.

Y: You want to...What I'd like to do...Do you want to take 30 days to put your stuff in writing? And then, what we'll do is try to include conceptual differences in here so we can have a more thorough review. So you have a variety of sides reflected in the document. We're in a position where we've put it out and started a dialogue on it. I'm trying to get to that point. I had a feeling that because we were rushed getting into this thing, that you guys really haven't had the time to really work on this, and I really want to give you the time before this goes out to the fellow... for review.

GD: How about giving us a budget for telephone calls to each other? All of us are busted flat in Baton Rouge.

Y: You guys want to start with $500?
Take the next 30 days, get your bills together, and we'll take it from there. On the next conference call. Then we'll talk about where we stand.

GD: We haven't all been part of the world service structure.

Here I go again. I look at having attended a few conferences, I know the possibility for anything to happen.
I feel that based on all of us will probably want to review the tapes of the conference, review the actions of the conference, we'll want to see the roll calls, we'll want to have an opportunity to talk to other people about this. I don't understand what this March 28 for distribution thing is, a report on the 3rd Edition Basic Text changes, I thought we were not commenting on anything. I gotta tell you. I really don't want to be a thorn in your side, or somebody that has look at two years ago to see what was happening today. I don't like it.

To me, it's all bullshit. If we can get back to the traditions and do what the f**k we're supposed to do, then we won't have these problems. I can only share with you that we had this guy come back from the Florida Region, who has been one of the most staunch supporters of everything that world services has done, and another person same way. They came back going, "This is completely bullshit. The people that I loved and trusted and emulated and desired to be just finished giving me the fast shuffle." This is not an uncommon experience. When people start to come back from the conferences and from the regions and tell the story. They are well known, well liked, well respected people who have not been labeled and branded radicals and ostracized like the four of us. You're going to see a snowball effect.

I'm telling you that these people are coming back now. Gosh, things are like Dave and Bill and others have said. That's where you're going to get your problems. And they're going come soon.

Z: They're already enormous. They're so bad that I don't even want to bring them into this discussion.

GD: If we don't get it right soon...

Y: I'll tell you something, guys. Maybe I don't understand what you said. I might be really...I understand a lot of your philosophy and I understand where you're coming from. There's also responsibilities, and responsible ways to approach that. You're trying to get the best of both worlds. I currently don't genuinely know what you expect. Maybe we'll find the time in the months to come, and maybe we can sit down and I can hear what you've guys have said. I don't really know.

Z: When the Basic Text was done, Stu, we envisioned it going to an office that would hold it in trust, print and distribute the literature, and perform other services under the direction of the conference. We didn't expect it to the perfect, but we didn't expect professional writers to be put under contract for $100,000 two weeks before the conference, when that was an item listed on the agenda to be discussed at the conference.

I did not expect when I served my five-year term on the Board of Trustees to have thousands of tiny changes made to the Basic Text down the hall, and find out only by getting a copy driven in by car several hundred miles that was bought from an institution who bought it from Hazelden, who bought it from the WSO before a member of the Board of Trustees even got to study or look at it. If you follow what I'm saying. Those things really happened. We really don't want those things happening again. That's what makes this serious. That's what we want to get a solution about, and that's the importance of this document, and possibly the conference charter like George was saying. Make the rules of the game clear and posted so everybody can subscribe to them. They confine their actions to a coherent structure.

The structure, as it stands, if the new executive director turns out to be a good and honorable man, then hopefully bring some useful experience to serve our needs, then great. Or he could be out in six months. We really tired of upset. It hurts our people. People come in waves and they leave in waves. Service disorders is our primary problem as a fellowship. We really seriously want a remedy.

GD: We are coming up on 1992, and if you look back ten years ago, there are a lot of ten year cycles in this fellowship. Ten years ago they completely, the fellowship rose up and cleaned house.
...with integrity, resolve these issues, which created a very strange alliance, one that at this point is the only positive thing I've seen come out of it, is the restoration of George's and my friendship. I would say that it appears that there is something afoot, that it's the same stuff...

Z: Why don't you be a little clearer about that, Dave. In other words, you're saying we're having one reality when we're on the conference call like this, and we have a separate reality going on that's supposed to be out of sight from us.

GD: I'm not going to characterize it as a conspiracy, I'm just going to say I think it was a very poor judgment to have ordered the lawyer to amplify something that is already in such questionable state. That's probably a bad business decision on the part of the office to have done so. The reason I say that is because if it ever comes up and becomes a question, it will look strange.

Y: Wait a minute. The amplification simply explains a work for hire as being the world lit committee is the writer or the author. So I don't know what you mean like this is some big conspiracy...

GD: We don't know what the amplification is or says, or what its legal implications are either, Stu. I'm just bringing this up.

Z: The point is, we're finding out about it now.

Y: Then you want me to mail them to you?

GD: Yeah.

Z: I think that should have happened back when it occurred. We don't know about these things, and I think we're doing pretty good to stay cool in the situation where there's a change. We're supposed to be informed.

GD: Yeah, you guys spent $96,000 in legal fees this year. I feel very offended that, maybe unrightfully, that the most important thing in the discussions, the agreements, the arrangements, all the conversations that we had was this: I

think that this is probably was qualified to be either number 1 or number 2 most serious problem in the fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous today, is getting this stuff straight.

Z: And the basic problem is non-communication.

GD: ...five days before the conference, and all the trustees and everybody, I begged you to tell the truth. Hey, we have problems with the registering. If you trust the world service community and you ask us to trust the world service community to resolve problems and act in the behalf of the fellowship and the beneficiary, and you as a business entity does not have enough trust in that same world service community to accurately reflect the problems that we have in the document that has been put out to the people that are going to make the decisions prior to the time that they come together to make the decisions, I see that as really irresponsible. I see that as very poor judgment. You're going to have people coming to the conference with absolutely no more understanding or information with which to make a decision than they did before. It'll be raw emotion. It'll be committee as a whole. It'll be arguing. It'll be another 5th Edition quick fix.

You may come out of there with the conference going, "Yeah, you guys have it all. By God, you do anything you have to do to whatever." That's what you were initially asking for in your first Board of Directors report. It's hard for me, from afar, being fair, it's very hard for me to see any change or philosophical shift or understanding of the delicacies of the positions of the various factions.

ST: Wait a minute, wait a minute. First of all, Dave, I'm not sure what all particular things that you're talking about. If you don't understand something, the registration is a simple responsibility and basically was in response to you guys. Because it's a responsible way when you deal with something as a work for hire, it needed to be depicted, the truth needed to be depicted. Second of all, I don't know that what was written that you feel so ripped off about that's so irresponsible.

GD: Nothing was written, that's what I feel ripped off about. You spent nearly $70,000 taking me to federal court. Is that not a high priority for you to resolve and make me feel good, considering the fact.

Y: I'd like to take 30 days and have you guys go through it line by line, come up with your ideas and your conceptions, and see if we can articulate different processes in a document to where people can look at the different issues and sides, so we can get it out for review. That way I'll tell the conference that this document is coming, okay? And then, once it's out there, we'll come together in a place like you're talking about and discuss it, thoroughly.

X: And sit on the conference, Stu. Sit on the conference, because the book is probably better in its current state of "we don't know where the hell it is" than it is in the public domain.

Y: Well, we'll...we'll...we'll just * the book, we'll...we'll... we'll keep things status quo until we get finished, you know what I mean?

GD: I have to look at the Board of Directors report. I have to shake my head. There isn't a single positive statement about a reduced price Basic Text. It's just not there.

Z: In other words, it's left out. A sizeable group conscience factor is left out. So it's an incomplete document, so the live steam continues to build.

Y: You're talking about the report on a low cost text that's in the report, right?

GD: Right. All it is I've seen is a synthesis of Stone's report in 1987 with a few little...

Y: You are way off, Dave. I'm sorry, I gotta tell you that. I ain't even going to fucking go for that. It's not even close, man.

GD: All right, don't.

Y: That report has more in it and more information than this fellowship has seen in the last ten God damn years.

GD: I'm talking about that section specifically. You are pushing in that report, a compilation. You have steered everybody in that report, that particular section of the report, you have steered everyone away from a reduced price Basic Text and onto this compilation deal.

Y: I don't think so.

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GD: And then go back to it. Maybe we can hammer out something between now and 90 days.

Y: Why don't we set up a conference call for three weeks. We'll talk about our status at that point, talk about some of the outcomes of the conference. In the meantime, I suggest you put together the thing that Bo talked about, so you can all see what everybody else feels. ... we'll be looking for the input

GD: I would make a suggestion that you say there is a document, we're trying to work it up, and we're probably 90 days off from having a draft to go out to people.

Z: I would at least like to hear the Executive Director's comments on some of this, or questions.

JG: Hi, I'm Joe Gossett, I'm the new executive director. I've been here two weeks. I want to make an observation on what I've just heard. I think there are about half a dozen men here that are all very committed to the same goals. We've got some administrative details to work out. We're going to work on them, we're committed to do that. But I think we're all headed in the same direction, and that encourages me.

GD: Sounds good so far.

X: If you could be encouraged after what you just heard, I guess you're our man.

GD: Wait a minute. Are we done? Because we were face to face in all of the things going on surrounding the courtroom and by all these other things that were going on, brought us together in a way that I don't feel we're as together as we were in Harrisburg in our discussion. It seemed to me in Harrisburg that there was...
Well, chit. It is kind of like taking a bath in chit for eight days. All I go is on feelings, folks, most of the time. My feeling is here that Jim, Bo, Bill and I. George has been stoic. Danette's been silent, and Becky's a sweetheart. We're not together with what the ultimate thing is here. As ridiculous as the whole thing may sound, the only thing I know about is the twelve traditions.

I know that our primary purpose is to carry the message to addicts who still suffer. As I shared with George before, we used to do that by any means possible. If it causes some belt tightening or some minor adjustments, or even major adjustments, I believe that we are missing the boat when we consider these things that we do in any other context.I know that areas that raise money and raise money and raise money and never have enough money to pay their bills. But areas that rely on carrying the message and going out and doing it and volunteering, they seem to have all the money they need to take care of the responsibilities that they have.

There's something fundamental that is being missed. It's very difficult for me to be tactful and diplomatic and articulate. I'm trying to communicate to you that it's kind of a spirit thing that all of us are trying to communicate, and we're trying to interface that with your world, which is a structural world, in dealing with dollars and cents. Joe's comment made me think of this, made me think that perhaps we're headed in the same direction. Our intractability on

both sides of our approaches and the unwilling- ness to interface our philosophies and come up with a compromise which I have really haven't seen the compromise, maybe I'm missing it. I think we all need to take a look at that, all of us.

Z: I'd like to hear something from some of the other persons on this call.

B: This is Becky. The reason I was asking Billy those questions earlier only because I'm trying to understand what it is you're looking for in this document, and I don't know that I'm still clear on this. I have a little bit better idea after this phone call, but I guess I still need to see what you guys are going to come up with in 30 days, because I'm not clear. That's why I've been sitting on this phone call and listening.

X: I'd like to quickly share with you with what I'm thrusting for. What I think a whole lot of people out here in the world of N.A. are interested in seeing. Number 1, some specification somewhere that the fellowship, who in reality is owner of our intellectual properties, is defined somewhere as owner. The structure, which stands in the stead of or acts as fiduciary for that fellowship is subordinated to its role in reality. That's number 1. Number two, that the fellowship has, as a fellowship, direct controlling powers over these intellectual properties, and that process, exclusive of the process that's now in place, is specified in this document. Number three, referring again to the word "process," that the process that created the usable intellectual properties that we have, which is basically the 2nd Edition Basic Text, is in place for now and ever more. That's my thrust.

Additionally, of course, as an overview to that, that it fits whatever necessary legal things that are required. However, what we need to recognize is that the legal world is there to define itself according to our needs. We're not here to fit our reality to some sort of legal definition, but rather the legal definition needs to be modified, if that is the necessity, to our needs.

U: I can certainly understand that. I don't think that our thrust in being involved here is any different. However, I think, Jim, that we don't have an ideal situation in which to deal with. As a fellowship, we cannot even recognize our own groups as exerting their beneficiary rights. These are some real fundamental problems that we've had for a long time. How do you identify a group who's to exhibit direct control over a trust that it has? You don't know that they're even there.

GD: Well, I think we made great strides in resolving that thing in our discussions about how we would conduct a group tally. If there are questions of autonomy and the additional question of an invisibility, I think we resolved that.

Z: You send out a piece of paper to every group in the world, and ask them to please respond by a certain date, and you read it, tally it.

GD: I don't see what the resistance is across the board about this. There's a strong personality in every group. Yeah, but with 20,000 strong personalities, you're gonna get a conscience out of it.

Y: It has nothing to do with resistance. It has everything to do with the reality of Narcotics Anonymous as exists today, as un-wholly and as wrong as that can be at times. That's how we are trying to approach this. If I was going to draw up an ideal situation, it would not be within this document. Do you understand?

X: No. I guess that's something that I don't understand, George.

Y: Well, to me, the first thing is a member of Narcotics Anonymous is a beneficiary, how are you going to identify him?

X: Why need you?

Y: Along with being a beneficiary, there is a responsibility you have as a beneficiary, and also certain rights that you

can exhibit.

X: I don't see the necessity of identification, other than through labeling.

Part Two of New Material:

GD: What you're saying, basically is the same thing I've heard lots of other people say, is that our groups, a) don't give a chit; b) they're not responsible; c) they can't make a decision.
I don't think you will find some agreement, but with qualifications from us, that I don't know any addict that don't have an opinion on something if they've been given some information. If they were given correct, broad-based information, I would say that a lot of them would welcome the opportunity to participate in that way. We have created an atmosphere, maybe unintentionally, where "let's let the service junkies do it." I think it's more of a matter of education, where we encourage participation, where we coax people along, where we tell them the things that we were told when we got here, like "You matter."

GD: We need a media that is responsive to all points of view.

Z: And not biased. It doesn't take sides. They're just so tired of all this game playing and what they perceive is just disorder. It's like noise. The only way they can do it is shut it out and tend to their newcomers, and take care of their home group.

GD: When asked, they say that's all political bullshit and I don't want to get involved. I think that attitude has been cultivated. I think that attitude is very well understood.
You tell somebody that their behavior is unspiritual and they're going to relapse, they're going to stop. They're going to stop quick and look because they don't want to die. We've been playing on fundamental insecurities here.

We've been saying that this one is going to destroy Narcotics Anonymous, that one, and we've been saying a lot of these things. I was in the media business for years, so I understand a little bit about mass psychological things.

X: And respect a good one when you see it.

GD: Yeah, absolutely. What's gone, in my opinion, forth from world services in the past five years has been a masterful job. I will say that these addicts, because they're insecure, and we all want to know it all, would just say "That don't mean anything. I'll do my H&I."

When really what they're saying is, "I don't have enough information, I feel inadequate, I feel stupid. Every time I go to a service forum and because of my personal recovery, my understanding of the traditions, and I stand up and say, "Well, it seems to me, that because of our 5th, 9th, and 12th traditions, that this is so..." And some service structure sharpie jumps up and goes, "Well, you don't understand. We have this policy and that policy..." and cuts him into fishbait. Everybody goes, "Oh chit, well I'm never going to ask another question."

Z: Well, their feelings get hurt.

GD: Of dealing from a moral or sensitivity position, there's very few people that can stand that kind of chit like I can.

GD: We have an educational process to embark upon, if we are really serious about healing the spiritual sickness in our fellowship. we're now moving onto concepts.

Another thing I guess I've got to comment on. I support movement or alternatives, viable alternatives, be they within the context of the current service structure or without. I see these various approaches and attempts as more of an act

of desperation by a whole bunch of people that don't really know what to do. They've been shut out. I would say that if we trust a loving God and if we allow parallel tracks to exist, that maybe we'll all be better off, because we can all learn from these different tracks. We have enforced an approval-seeking. We've indoctrinated our members, "You do this, you talk this way, this is how you do meetings, and this is how you do service. If you don't follow guidelines to the letter, then we have your head."

Z: Or a goon squad walks into your home group.

GD: Absolutely. Our little statement of unity seems to have been lost on those who were most in need. Here you sit here talking to the radicals of the fellowship, and we're really not radicals. We haven't done anything wrong. But your rampant world supporters are still running around ripping books out of people's hands.

GD: Is there anyone here besides me that knows exactly what the last sentence in the 12th tradition says? "Anonymity in action renders personalities and their differences powerless." If that is true, then we all have a ways to go. I'm hopeful, yes there's a dialogue. Yes, this conversation could have, but wouldn't have taken place five months, six months ago.

Z: The point is, we were willing a year ago.

GD: Years ago. ... I struggle to get eight hours a day awake anymore. I have a sense of urgency that may not be falling on anyone else. I would like to go to my rest with a good feeling that there has actually been an observable change, observable by anyone who chose to look. I've dedicated my entire life since walking in the door here to serving and bettering this fellowship. Some of you may not believe that. I sat and read literature to coffee pots. I don't know how long I'll be alive. That's a fact, that's just reality. My disease is running me down quick.

AIDS dementia, I guess. No, it's just that it's the same thing. I would like to get a little personal peace and feel good in my gut about what's going on. I had a glimmer of hope a few months ago. I want to continue to have that, even if it's small. It's very, very depressing for me. Whatever my motives may have been, I know there's been a lot of discussion of what they were. It had nothing to do with world service or a vendetta or anything. It was we've got to carry the message to the addict who still suffers. George was in my home group, and he can tell you. He can communicate to you, seeing all those detoxing and toothless wonders on welfare with $3.00 in the basket, but they all had a blue book and their eyes were bright. That's what counts to me.

Philosophically, I applaud the ideals of the WSO, and I applaud the ideals of the WSC, and I think it's a wonderful experiment that we've become far too rigid about. I think that we have worked to the point where a lot of the things that we do are kind of unnecessary. We need to be able to trust developing fellowships with the literature that we currently have. Let them translate it and then come back to us and work out the little bugs. We'd be saving a hell of a lot of money, and we'd be getting a lot more literature translated.

X: A hell of a lot more recovery there.

GD: Absolutely. This gift of recovery and our literature, it was given to all of us, and to those to come, freely by a loving God. We are standing in the way of God's gift to humanity. Some people accept barriers and limitations. Jim Miller wrote in my book when I had 45 days clean, "Argue for your limitations and they will be yours forever." I have refused, because there is the power of a loving God, I have refused to accept those limitations in my own personal life, which has set me outside the norm or status quo. What my home group did in group conscience, I am completely okay with on the level of spiritual and what was the right thing to do. It may have interfered with somebody's plans. It may have rocked somebody's boat. It may have pissed somebody off. If there wasn't a WSO or WSC, that's what would be happening today. It's not unrealistic to imagine that those people who might perceive our world structure as being a barrier to carrying the message, might arrive at basically the same moral conclusion.

That's a very powerful motivation to walk into a prison and have a hard back book or two stuck in a counselor's office because they've caused fistfights, or because somebody ripped the pages out. I have watched those blue books going into prison, and they're having step and book study meetings now. They weren't having them before. Yeah, there was a certain amount of it going on, but I've watched this whole thing very carefully. The people who are not involved in the politics of it, love it. The people that we're trying to reach, ostensibly, are benefiting from it.

Maybe we have to look at the whole enchilada. There will be people who will refuse to allow any barriers between them and the thing that keeps them alive. That's what keeps me alive. I have a sponsee with four days clean. That's what keeps me alive. That's what keeps our fellowship alive. God, let's hope that we stop turning them off. Service, yeah, come on, let's go. "f**k that, I went there once."

BS: You kind of lost me on that last one.

GD: I'm going to take my new sponsee to the area service. Tell him that he counts, that he matters. Service is where we need to be. I'd be talking out the side of my neck, and it didn't used to be that way. It really didn't.

GD: They let me write do's and don't's with 40 days clean, man. It's approved. There's newcomers all in that Basic Text. I think Bo was right earlier in saying that we had a process. Nobody could understand it, but damn it worked, and we tried to f**k around with it and we've got paid people and this and that. That's a brand new idea. It didn't work before, and I don't think anybody can say that it's working now. Maybe we have to back up a little bit. Maybe all this progress is not what we need to be in. Maybe we need to back up a little. Emotional sap and drivel. That's where I'm at. I have to bare my soul. I guess I have been for a long time. I don't know how long I've got, and I want to see it right. If it comes to me that there's something I have to do, then I have to do it. I don't mean to really leave it dangling there, but...

Z: Don't leave it dangling. You've done your part. You haven't put out anymore Baby Blues, right?

GD: I have honored my agreement to the letter.

GD: I am a man of honor, whether anybody believes it or not. All I have is my word. That's all I can take to my maker. I've given my word, and I've kept my word.

GD: One last closing comment to you guys. I'm not going to be there. I tried every way I could to be there, but I want to ask you Stu, remember when I said please don't send any letters out until we get a chance to talk? I want to ask you to please try to, all of you who have the ability to address the conference, try to prevent the conference from reeling off. We have a problem. That problem cannot be resolved by a vote of the conference. If you can get the conference maybe to even hold off. I think George knows what I'm talking about. I think Stu knows what I'm talking about. Let's downplay all this stuff, in terms of exclusive property and all that stuff, cause I know it's going to be very...I'm almost sorry I'm not going to be there.

Y: I'm going to do everything I can to have the issue addressed, guarantee that. I'm usually pretty good at that.

Z : To have the issues addressed like...

Y: Well, I'm not...We're going to talk about everything that's in the agenda. We're going to discuss some of the difficulties in the fellowship with the intellectual properties. It's not going to be washed under the rug.

GD: Well, if you create a separate account for Blue Book sales at $1.50, and limit the distribution, like we talked about before, and dedicate all that money to assisting other fellowships in other parts of the world to translate their literature.

Y: There are a lot of things that will be discussed about that, Dave. I really think you're jumping to a conclusion, and really should be patient. Let's see what the conference does.

GD: The conference will do what it's told.

GD: Also, I'm still waiting on the communications registered on the Basic Text and the other things that were supposed to be forth-coming. I know you guys are busy out there, but if you have it, send it. And the amplifications.

LIT TRUST TALKS
MAY, 1991

X: This background statement, very simply needs to be focused on the fellowship rather than services, and most particularly, that portion of the fellowship exemplified by the 1981, before the literature conferences. The composition of the literature committee, the process that was happening then, and the four conferences that occurred then. I believe that it needs a simple description of the bond of trust that does exist between the spiritual fellowship of N.A., and its services, including ASCs, RSCs, WSC, WSB and their agents, primary service center, WSO. To the statement, "our leaders are but trusted servants, they do not govern." That's kind of what the background statement needs to be focused on in my opinion.

The '81 literature committee and those four conferences were something that happened in the fellowship, was a phenomenon that didn't have a precedent and hasn't happened since. The members that worked there, and the fellowship that they were representative of developed a trust bond with the service structure that the results of their work would be used in the same spirit and manner that the work was developed. This must be, in my opinion, the foundation and the basis of this literature trust document.

GD: I agree. The fellowship and the people who wrote and participated are actually the authors and the owners. I think you've got it switched around. I didn't send any input because I've got some minutes of the conference here, it says to me that the things that we had discussed in Harrisburg and other times, and the promises that were made to Jim and Kathleen and Bo and myself and others that were present at the time, were ignored. It's like you've got the exclusive rights to do whatever you want to do as far as I'm concerned, it seems like that is "your" trust. The trust that I had that you wouldn't ask for these things and you wouldn't do the things that you have done, you violated that trust.

Y: I never said that we wouldn't ask for it. I put it in the Conference Agenda Report. That's not true, Dave. I told you I was going to ask for it.

X: What I understand, Stu, what I remember was that in those documents that you gave us your assurance that you would share that something was in process, and that after the process was completed, that you would ask for this, and mention that in any requests for it. I felt you made yourself very clear and agree substantially with Dave.

Y: No. What I agreed to was the fact that I would ask for this in lieu of producing any other document. I agreed that this document was premature to distribute at the conference at that time. It needed some work. I instructed the conference that we would be working on this document and would send it out.***

GD: Did anybody get the amplifications and the other materials that were supposed to be send, because I received nothing.

Y: They were just done. They'll be coming in the next package.

GD: I feel like it's kind of a waste of time. I do so because of my own personal intimate knowledge and understanding of the promises that were made. The last conference call, I said that I had fulfilled my end of the bargain 100%, Stu, you said yes, and everyone was amazed that you had said yes. The fact of the matter is, from what I understood in the court, you were supposed to go from the court to the vote, without any comment.

Y: No, no, no, no, no. The only comment that wasn't supposed to be taken, was I wasn't supposed to put a prelude to the motions that went out to the fellowship. That's what was indicated by the court.

REFERENCE PAGE #19 FROM APRIL LIT TALK TAPE

GD: Was there not a three-hour discussion before the votes were taken at the conference? Was there not papers sent out four or five days before the conference to RSRs about...I have it, it's dated March 28 "For distribution. An essay on the fourth and ninth tradition changes."

Y: The only thing that was sent out that had anything to do with those three motions was the issue of the low cost text, and that was ordered by the court that it was done. That was it. We said nothing, we publicized nothing, we did nothing.

GD: Was there not a three-hour discussion before the votes were taken at the conference? Was there not papers sent out four or five days before the conference to RSRs about...I have it, it's dated March 28 "For distribution. An essay on the fourth and ninth tradition changes."

Y: The only thing that was sent out that had anything to do with those three motions was the issue of the low cost text, and that was ordered by the court that it was done. That was it. We said nothing, we publicized nothing, we did nothing.

GD: There wasn't three hours were of discussion before the votes were taken at the conference?

Y: At the conference, I gave my report.

GD: And then Terry Middlebrook gave her report, and all that information in which I saw nothing positive, not even in the WSO Report, nothing positive at all...

Y: Dave, those RSRs came there with the vote. There's no votes after the discussion. Those votes were taken by their respective fellowships. Those votes were taken back in their fellowships. They went out in the agenda report. They all came with a vote from their fellowship.

GD: Then why was there a need for three hours of discussion?

Y: Because I give a report every year. There was no cross discussion. There were questions and answers after the report, which they cut short and forced the end of discussion. We went into session, I asked for a committee of the whole, and they refused it and wanted to vote. They voted and then they went into a committee of the whole after the vote. That's what came then.

X: I'm sorry to interrupt you, Stu, but I believe we need to move on from here. A lot of us weren't there, and we're just really not positive what happened. The reports that we get indicate that you betrayed the trust that we felt we had established. I think that that's something we must deal with. However, for us to deal with it, when I don't have all the

details and facts, and Dave seems to have a whole lot of it, but all of us aren't on the same page. I don't think that we're going to make any progress toward dealing with it. Dave and I, and perhaps to a lesser degree, Bo think that this process that we're participating in right now may be of some value. I'm questioning the value from what I've heard of the conference. However, I'd like to go through the motions of it, and see if we can set some positive change. I think if we discuss this any further on this particular conference call, until I have minutes of the conference and Bo has too, and Dave and Bo and I and perhaps others, Billy, have had a chance to visit, we're going to be spinning our wheels. There isn't any sense doing that.

Let's go on to your agenda and deal with it, and any other input that might come up. Deal with these things that come up point by point and see where we're going to go as a working group from here. If you guys, in fact, have snared us into something, deluded us, and Bo can trust, I guess I'm not going to have to make amends for that. If I do this work and it's all for naught, at least it's built character some. Dave doesn't have a lot of time to build character, but I'm going to go ahead and do that.

GD: I'm sitting here with the minutes of the conference, and I see all the motions. You tell me one thing, and 20 people that were there tell me another. The only way we're ever going to know what's right is if you were to send the tapes of that day to all of us, so we could determine what, in fact, did actually occur at the conference. If you want me to trust you...

GD: There's a lot of stuff here, I'm sure, that spanned over four or five hours. I'm looking at the minutes, making that determination.

Literature, the WSO presentation, the motions, the votes, the committee of the whole.

If you could get those copies and send them out, then we would have a better idea of what the conference felt like, and what they wanted. If you want me to at least modify my feelings at this trust, then that would go a long way. I don't like to operate from a position where I've got no information. I don't like to make a mistake or get something wrong. From what I'm looking at here, and from what people have told me, and from the publications and things that people have sent me, and looking at the WSO Report, I didn't have much faith to start with, and I put all whatever remaining faith that I had in Narcotics Anonymous and the principles, and the trusting when we went to court, I put whatever I had left there. I don't have any left.

Y: Let me try to put it into perspective for you, Dave, at least what I believe. This trust document will supersede all previous decisions. The decisions that were made by this year's conference were temporary if we find that those decisions are no longer usable in the trust document. That's how I tend to look at that and what we discussed at the conference. I understood Stu to make a commitment that he would not present the trust document, which will the be the policy that is established when we get through the review period, hopefully, and the fellowship approves it. The decisions made by the conference are temporary in that light, because the trust document will supersede all of that.

GD: It seems that the perception that the members that were together in Harrisburg and various other communication that you and I have had personally, that you see things one way, and I know I see things another way, and I'm taking a straw poll down the ranks of the people we have on the phone here. You've got people on the phone here who have not been intimate to this stuff, but Oma and myself, Jim and Kathleen, and Bo and his girlfriend that were in Harrisburg, in that room with you, we made, all of us, made agreements together. It sounded like there was something that could come out of all of it that we would all be happy and satisfied with, and there were things discussed at that time. One of those things was that three months after the conference, when we should take and put out the trust document. That was one item. The second item was the idea of exclusivity and ownership of the properties. You would have the exclusive rights to ownership, that was going to be held in abeyance. You promised that you would not ask for those things and/or the right to sue any group, area, or region, or member, until such time as we had developed the document.

Y: I didn't promise that. Anybody else who was on the phone that was there, did I promise that?

X: Yes, I do believe that approximately what he's saying is what we agreed to as a group. However, I really don't think that we need to spend a lot of time right now going over that and salving up those wounds. If in fact, our impression of what you said was made in good faith by you, George's word that this trust document will supersede all previous decision, including temporary decisions made at WSC '91, is enough for me to go ahead and not waste the fellowship's money and time, and my time, any further trying to do this, trying to salve this up. It's a waste of time, but I may be wrong. I just need to feel that everyone involved here agrees with George's perception that what we're working on shall supersede anything that's been done previously.

Y: Now, that's what I promised.

X: Does everyone agree that what we're working on is something that can transcend all previous policy in this area and the areas attached to it?

GD: It seems to me that if it's a legal instrument that's executed, then that will, in fact, supersede even the decisions of the conference. The conference will have to ratify whatever it is that we end up coming up with, because we'll not have any rights to put something like that out, without the fellowship. I may be going even further to say that the fellowship, as a whole, has an opportunity to look at it. The other thing is, that we talked about having a little budget last time so we could communicate with one another. I can't afford to communicate with anybody. If we're going to proceed, I'm willing to proceed. I've given most of my input to Jim, because Jim and I have a relationship where we understand each other, so I gave him most of the input that I had, and he factored most of that into his input.

We've already done some initial work. I just think that our ideas, and I would like to hear from the other people on this particular question, Roy and Billy, and others. Does corporate N.A. own our property, or does the "creator," being the fellowship, own the property? We're looking at the question here of whether...The first literature document that you sent us made the owners the beneficiaries. That's kind of screwy. You guys get the budgets and the travel and the office, you guys are the beneficiary of our work. It's really the other way around. I think we have a chasm between corporate N.A. and spiritual N.A. We have to decide as a fellowship, whether we are a corporate entity, and go on with that, or whether we are a spiritual entity.

Y: We have a corporate entity, because a corporate entity does certain things on behalf of the fellowship. Service. It only exists for the fellowship. They benefit its worth. It has no other purpose.

GD: I'm looking at it, and we may argue over two million dollars, but I'm looking at twenty million dollars over the past five years, and I'm wondering what we got for it.

Y: That's quality judgment. It doesn't exist for anything else other than services to the fellowship. That's what it was intended to do. Now whether the services were good, bad, indifferent, that's something that has to be dealt with from a quality control situation, not from...

GD: Stu, I know what you believe. I think that we're just talking and we could not be further apart, I don't think.

Z: What do you think Stu believes?

GD: I think he believes that it's a business, an agency, this, that, and the other thing. If that's the case, efficient business and successful businesses run on spiritual principles, on good sound principle and practice. It's like it says in the 11th step, "results count in recovery." I haven't seen the results that one would expect for the amount of income that's passed through that office over the years. The controversies and controversial issues that have come perhaps as a result of perhaps me, or the tension created in different philosophies. Do we want to carry the message to the addict

who still suffers? Well yeah, we do, but we only want to do that when we can do it with computers and...

Z: Dave, let Stu way what he believes. In view of what you've said, what do you believe, Stu?

Y: I believe that there's a business aspect to Narcotics Anonymous, and that's why you have a corporate arm. I believe that corporate arm operates in that capacity. I don't believe the corporate arm is a beneficiary of the fellowship. I believe actually the reverse. I believe that the corporate arm solely services the spiritual arm. It has no other function other than to protect, and pursue the aims of the fellowship of NA. It has no other...

Z: Don't you understand, though, the reason we're on the phone? There have been some serious breaches of fellowship trust? And like I said on the last phone call, that these are not mysterious, will of the whist, variations on how people who live in different parts of the United States express themselves in English? The severe disorders...

R: Hey everybody, this is Roy. I think what I'm hearing, and I realize that I'm just being brought in on this whole process here, is that we really do have sort of a difference of opinion. I have to tend to agree with Jim at this point, though. We do have five things that were written down here. If we're going to progress at all, and maybe some day we'll reach perfection, but let's go with progress for now, maybe we ought to try to do what we can with these five issues here for today.

I have one question regarding number one off the bat: What background statement? Either I didn't get that, or it's part of this document, and I just haven't been able to pick it up.

Y: Your copy doesn't have it, Roy, and I apologize. Neither you nor Billy received the background statement.

Z: The thing that seems to be evolving in some of my talks with Jim and Dave, and just in general as a result of working on that input, was that there was a verbal trust statement that we told people so commonly that we didn't realize what it was. But it went like, "there will be no by-lines, no royalties paid to us for doing this work, and the proceeds will go to the fellowship" That was basically our operating, verbal trust document agreement. That was delivered to lit workers by the hundreds. Since they liked that, they came and did the work.

GD: That is a quasi contract.

Y: The problem that we have with it is there's a three-tier situation where you have the world service office, and then you have the collection of people of the conference, and then you have the members at large. We're trying to write to capture the whole thing. In some cases, the office is not the voice of the fellowship, it's not an attempt. It's hard. You have the collection of all the regions everywhere that give the direction to the office. The office does work for the whole.

Z: Let me hone in on that, with the support of this working group on the phone. Because I think that's a very primary, that's a really big question. We've always thought of the office as being the primary service center, and every time it's broken out of that role of service center, and became publisher, became governor, minutes or motions or elections or reports seemed to be waived for or again the question in preparation, anytime any of that came up, it's been the office's disservice, and really injurious to the common welfare and body of Narcotics Anonymous. I sort of feel like you agree with that, that the office is the primary service center, not a publishing agency. If the office is a publishing agent, then it could go into the movie business.

Y: Right, but it's a publishing agency as the fellowship says to publish its work, ITS work, total work. It doesn't do anything without...

GD: I think that's skirting the issue that Bo writes.

Z: I hope we can clear up that. I've listed four things here, there's another agenda, but I really think that the four points that stand out at this point, and maybe if nothing else, it'll clarify something for others: The fellowship owns the Basic Text. And all the names and properties, and all our literature and all our stuff that's going to come. And that needs to be held in trust, however it's held. It can be held by an agent in trust, but it's not done for hire, it's not the kind of product that's subject to the bump and grind of the market place. Our stuff has to be the kind to reach into our people in the middle of the night when they want to use, and the book's there and their sponsor just died. As opposed to the kind of literature that the local hospital may like. We have a different image.

GD: I've spent a lot of time in the music business, and I understand publishing, and I understand royalties and all this stuff. We're still...

Z: Dave, the reason I take time to bring up this, is the key word is "publishing." Publishing has come up a lot in these trust documents in the first few pages, and I hit them with a highlighter everywhere I see the word "publish, publisher, publishing agency." Even line 23 on page one, it says, "The World Lit Committee specifically conveyed the copyright." All I remember is that the office was going to copyright the Basic Text so that they could protect the copyright and distribute it to the fellowship.

Y: Anytime you print, that's publishing.

Z: I know, but the "specifically conveyed" and all that stuff. If that happened, they sure kept it quiet. All we know is we did the work on faith, we turned it in, kept the faith, and there's been some problems, and we want an end to the problems. Those other items, I'm going to recommend that maybe we could just take a quick statement from everybody on questions numbered 1,2,3,4,5. Try to make that our primary focus of what we're trying to do on the phone here. I think the verbal trust statement needs to be emphasized in question number one. What needs to be stated in this section, is that I think this is a long overdue formalization of a verbal literature trust. That's what I think. What do the other guys think?

GD: I'm flying blind, but I kind of figure the same way. I understand that a company needs to make money. They need to have help, bottom line, they need to have all these things. I'm not so sure what we do about that. I'm not suggesting that we do away with the WSO, I'm suggesting that we do some radical reorganization of it. How many people do you need to do the job? Do you need 42 or do you need 1500?

BA: I agree with Bo's statement, basically. I have real problems with the whole trust, where I believe in the basic of literature statements made between '79 to '81 when I was involved with the fellowship early in my recovery. I believe that the WSO, what it was supposed to be doing, and what transpired afterwards are two different things. It was just supposed to be a basic statement of our eighth tradition, that it was a primary service center. It was not supposed to end up with ownership, but was supposed to have a trust to protect our literature from being printed by outside agencies like Hazelden, Compcare, or any other hospital or institution. Our literature was not supposed to be a profit making venture. Those are the sort of things I'd like to see in our opening statement.

GD: The judge in court steered us away from five counts. He kind of looked at that stuff, and said that yeah, probably a real good case could be made that all of this stuff is public domain. The literature itself could be taken into the public domain. I think that was the intention of the authors. Somehow, we've got to split the difference between if we choose to continue to have the corporate arm being supported from the literature, the creative output of anonymous members throughout the fellowship, then we need to split that difference?

You've got $25.00 sweats, and jewelry and all this stuff going on, and people making money left and right on Narcotics Anonymous, printing the stuff on you-name-it. Nobody with the exception of "Creative Arts," which was a corporate entity that could be sued by another corporate entity, nobody has bothered to do convention corporations and what have you. So here we go with somebody who wants to produce a Basic Text, at cost, and deliver that to the addict who still suffers, and this is the one who gets sued. To me, that is kind of indefensible. Again, I'm probably off

on a tangent again, but I'm not hearing in this conversation, to the degree that would make me comfortable, is this wide gap between the corporate and the creative.

Z: I'm Billy Eason, and I wasn't privilege to the original statement, but I really liked the paragraph that Jim read. We need to decide whether we are a corporate entity or a spiritual entity. That's my opinion, and I am familiar with the literature process from '79 to '82. Things were a lot different then than they are now. I'm confused about what George said earlier about motions. When I look at motions #112 and #113, he said that they would be null and void if this were adopted, is that correct?

Y: What I was saying, Billy, is that eventually the trust document becomes our permanent document, so if there are differences that exist between past positions, including the most recent, and what the fellowship adopts in the trust document, it will supersede the previous decisions.

X: Let's go on to two. I'll read it, that'll give me something to do. I get bored when I can't talk all the time and monopolize the conversation. Don't understand? I'm an addict. "How does the fellowship direct the service office as it administers the trust?" "Does the World Service Conference act as that voice? If not, how, who, or what does?"

My first brief note was new direct method. I'll go into that if anybody would like to hear it. There's been a lot of talk lately about an alternative service structure. It bothers me and it bothers a lot of people. It bothers me positive and negative. We need an alternative channel within the existing service structure so that the responsibility becomes more direct. The very indirect route that's now available should be changed. Much good should not be changed, much good can happen as the fellowship passes direction from member to group to area to region to WSC. However, a more responsive, more specialized, and more direct channel should be opened. Every issue regarding the fellowship's property, every issue, should be finally decided by a group poll, directly between the N.A. groups and the WSO Board of Directors.

GD: Absolutely.

X: Very general policy decisions should be made through the existing structure, and then parameters for daily operations between the WSC should be made by a) WSO Board of Directors. I think the WSO Board of Directors needs to be established with direct yearly elections and reconfirmations of half that WSO Board by an act of the World Service Conference, the other half of WSO Board elected directly from regions. The election procedure of WSC, supposing 12 Board of Directors, four of them would be elected each year to serve only one three-year term. There would also need to be a provision that the conference to remove any of the remaining nine.

Then the election procedure by regions, supposing 12 Board of Directors, elected directly by 60 regions in a service area, each region would elect a director for a five-year term every five years, four years of that term as an advisory director welcome to attend Board of Director meetings at the expense of the region, able to participate in motions and discussion, but not vote, and one year of active directorship. So of the 60, only 12 would be voting and equal the WSC directors. Active directorship, attending Board of Directors meetings at the expense of WSO, to wit, participate as a voting director. Some lottery situation could be developed so that when the active role came to each region, could be a term. It could be cumbersome to develop that. However, if the WSC, as just a side note, were an effective voice for the fellowship, we wouldn't have the current problems that we've got fellowship-wide. The statement that WSC anywhere near mirrors group conscience of Narcotics Anonymous, has been an absurdity for some time. Maybe it always was. Maybe it always will be, I don't know. I know that it distresses me and others greatly now.

Additionally, I think that this particular thing like was originally planned, needs a literature trust fellowship panel, which should be formed to consist initially of five folks who were among those who helped to write the book. This panel would be charged with three responsibilities: A) to solicit and act upon mature fellowship input regarding the conservation, maintenance, and development of our literature and property; B) to be a non-voting participant at WSO

Board of Director meetings, with veto power on actions affecting the fellowship's literature property. Essentially, let me clarify what I mean by veto power: to postpone changes until a poll of the groups could occur, that's all I mean; and C) to foster open fellowship-wide communication and continuation of the process that effectively developed our literature.

How would this panel be selected? One suggestion is willing nominees could be volunteers from those registered at world literature conferences. All the members that were registered at world literature conferences could be contacted and elect the panel by a mail ballot. I would suggest a 12-year term rather than life, as was previously mentioned. Replacements to this panel could possibly be selected by the panel so that there would be a continuity of service.

GD: We're looking at an administering structure that is equally representative of the varying...Each element of our service structure, including the fellowship has parochial concerns. The trustees have their concerns, the admin has their concerns, the Board of Directors has their concerns, and the fellowship has its concerns. Then you throw the conference in there, and when we're discussing the conference, I tend to echo everything Jim says. I think everything needs to be direct when we're talking about significant decisions that will affect our literature or our properties. It has to be direct.

I'm not upset with the idea of an alternate service structure. I'm not upset with it, because I see the possibility of working along a parallel track and being able to learn from the mistakes that our current structure has made, and to not have the constrictions that have been placed on the current structure. Maybe in developing an alternate structure we learn something. Maybe it will all merge somewhere down the road, that we'll finally get enough information and share enough experience, strength and hope within the context of the two structures.

We're looking at international issues, service structures in different parts of the world, this and that. I noticed something in the minutes: Are we a North American fellowship with worldwide outreach? If that's the case, then we make the rules and that's the way it is. It doesn't matter what anybody else, anywhere else, wants to do. That will cause even more divisiveness that we currently have. We have to become okay.

So if we must get this multiple-tiered trust organization together that will provide the checks and balances that will create policy, create a structure and will eliminate the necessity for all these parochial concerns and bickering back and forth...

GD: ... because we have control issues, or we think that our way is best, that keeps that tension going. You have that tension between the service arms of Narcotics Anonymous. You have all this infighting in the service structure, and when you take somebody from the fellowship who maybe wants to be involved in area service or something like that, and they look up the tree and they go, "Oh chit, this is nuts" Everything they try to make an entrance into it, the energy that's going on in all of this other stuff, it's like a forcefield on Star Trek. They bump up against it and are repelled.

If we use that kind of a single board made up of representatives to represent all these interests, then I say let's do that. Five years from now, or ten years from now, we could modify that too. It may become unnecessary. There are contractors out there for everything. They say this is the cheapest bid, we can get it to the people for the cheapest bid, and that's what they do. I don't say adopt what they do, but I say that there are lessons they have learned. When bootleg literature was coming up, they sent a letter out that was very nice. If you find that the literature suits your needs, fine. We're looking at a tone and a way of handling. That's got to change too. It's the kind of heavy handed ways that the difference in N.A. today are...

Z: Well, world level positions feel powerful. It takes a trusted servant mentality to not buy into that feeling of power and remain a servant worthy of trust. Can we hear from some of the other people? My answer to #2 is group conscience is the answer to all that. It's strange but group conscience might be at the world service conference on some items or some issues, and if it's not, then those items and issues continue to be a problem. Like the target area we're dealing with. We're functioning as a group conscience right here and now.

GD: Well, I've got one comment. Looking at the minutes, you've got votes that are 23 to 51, 21 to 55.

GD: Yeah, this year's minutes, and I'm sorry that you don't have them. The point I'm making with this is that there are four ways to rule on a vote: Is it a 2/3, or is a majority? I guess that this was considered to be 2/3, but you're looking at 23 to 20 regions that thought that in their conscience, we're talking about a third of the fellowship taking out the trustee and others votes. What I'm trying to say is, you're looking at maybe 40% of the fellowship that thought that this stuff was a good idea, motions 113 - 115. That to me is indicative that maybe on issues such as this, the fellowship needs to be a voice. Group conscience needs to be the voice.

Z: I'll just make the statement that I'm sort of ignorant, and I'm being a little boggled by what's going on here. If it was kept a little more simple, I might be able to follow in a little better. I'm just going to kind of sit back and listen to what a lot of the other folks have to say.

GD: Well, thank you for sharing that. When somebody reads something like that by us, and we don't have it in front of us to study, all that input is overwhelming. I would like to see as a document, so you could input, I could input. Basically I'm a policy kind of nut. There's a lot of things in there that sounded good, but it was a little too complex, too fast for me to absorb. I'm not scared of complexity so much, as long as what seems to be complex sometimes is really simplicity being manifested. It seemed to me that there was a lot of real good basic ideas in what he was reading. In all fairness to you and to Jim and to myself and all the other people that are on the line, that don't absorb things that fast, we probably need to take a look at those suggestions.

I'm for something like 12, 12, and 12, since 12 seems to be a pretty cool number. Like we have 12 people directly elected from the fellowship, in maybe a zone way, and then 12 people elected from the conference, and then we have the Board of Directors. The trustees, I don't know where they would fit into this, maybe a six director committee, and six trustees.

GD: We need video conferencing.

Y: The thing that everyone seems to be pointing out. I still have a concern that I voiced on the last conference call. A good deal of what we're talking about needs to show the trust of the fellowship with its service boards. This document was never meant to show that in any way. This document would simply show the service structure relationship with its service center, and how the administration of the trust would take place. All the different things that we have brought up are things that to different degrees, I'm sure we all have agreement about that things need to be changed. However, this document, in my belief anyway, is not the appropriate place to bring those changes about.

GD: Why not?

Y: You have a great deal of problem with the service structure, and we need to take care of that. But again, that's the limitations I think we feel in drawing up this document. Those decisions are going to have to be made by the fellowship. I don't know many times in our history in Narcotics Anonymous has made a group by group decision. That is a whole different concept altogether. We thought maybe that point this year that they had adopted motion #15, but it's a completely different concept from what we currently have. There should be two documents. One is something, for lack of a better name, a conference charter that shows the relationship and the trust that the fellowship conveys in the service structure. Then there's a literature trust with service structure in understanding the trust from the fellowship through ways to the appropriate body to take care of it.

GD: Hold on a sec, let me change the tape. I want to get all this wisdom down.

Y: I don't think that we're going to be able to proceed with the idea that we can take care of all of Narcotics Anonymous ills in this document.

GD: Again, I have to go back to something Jim told me a lot of years ago, argue for your limitations and they'll be yours forever. It seems like all of this stuff is either we're developing two documents concurrently, or what we are actually attempting to do here and nobody's comfortable enough to say so, is we're trying to develop a new structure as we speak.

Y: If that is true, we need to admit that and get that on the table.

Z: Well, I know that in my report on the structure that really got into a couple of other things, but an interesting thing came out that a social movement like ours goes through four separate distinct phases. One, sell it. One is popular. One is formalization. One is institutional. The book was written by a bunch of zealots and in the hurry, the lit trust was not properly written down and defined carefully. Now, there's admission of a popular agreement that there's a need to be addressed here, and now we're formalizing that trust document. That is very central to our entire structure and our philosophy and how Narcotics Anonymous really exists in application instead of theory.

Jim reminded me over this past weekend we went to Cleveland about just how many oldtimers in the late 70s and early 80s were confirmed members of other fellowships and were very surprised to see dedication among the N.A. people. The reason I bring that up is it reminds me of just how deeply I had to walk a razor's edge to stay in service and stay effective while I was upsetting these oldtimers by doing what they regarded as impossible, and possibly improper. In Narcotics Anonymous, where we're enormously much more free today.

X: Relating back to the question, "How does the fellowship direct the office as it administers the trust?" and following that up with the question, "Does the World Service Conference act as that voice?" My response to that would be, in an ideal world and an ideal situation, yes. In the practicality and reality of today, no one would be on the phone together. "If not, how, who, or what does?" I don't know that I've made a viable proposition, but I really think that this is a significant area we need to work on. However, I think it will clear it up a whole lot, unless someone's got a burning desire, if we just leave this hanging in the air with the discussion that we've had now, and move onto #3. I think #3 might give us some illustration of our real differences and where we need to come together on this document and whether or not we need to use this document to institute a new method of fellowship direction of the World Service Office or not.

GD: Well, would somebody be kind to read it?

Y: Let's go on and talk a little bit about #3, and I'll read it for you. There is a question as to the assignment of the parties of the trust: "Who is the beneficiary, trustor, and trustee? Who are these specifically?" One of the reasons why I picked this out of Jim's input: He offered two levels, one being the beneficiary being the membership...The beneficiary being the trustor. Do that at two specific levels, one being the addict who still suffers, and one being the member. That's why I basically picked up that difference. The question that I asked at that particular time was the trustor had to be some entity that could in some fashion, direct the trustee, or being that the member at large and the addict that still suffers, don't have any real parameters around, a real entity. It would be hard to identify them as a specific trustor to direction. The original document was organized as the beneficiary being the members.

X: Let me clarify where I come from in this input: I think what we're talking about here, when we talk about, and I like to call it the tangible property of the fellowship. What we're talking about here, everything that is our tangible property are symbols, indications, the written word, vehicles that we as members of Narcotics Anonymous use to fulfill our individual 12th Step. We carry the message to the addict that still suffers. If these are the vehicles that we use to carry the message to the addict who still suffers, in that, they are so extremely precious to us. There are definitions on property, of what we are and who we are and how we function, and how we function as a group in our 5th Tradition. There are the vehicles of the primary purpose, and therefore the definition. I just see the reality of the situation is that the trustor is the owner, that spiritual fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous who is and can be the only owner, the only entity, however definable or discernable, that has and holds this property, and therefore the trustor.

I see the trustee as the entire service structure culminating with the agent's service center, WSO, Inc. The beginning

of that trustee is the GSR, the ASC, etc., on down through the service structure through the World Service Conference, which makes specific guideline instructions to the agent (the publisher), the legal entity, the copyright defender, etc., WSO, Inc., the corporate arm. That is how we function, that the trustee of our property, of that thing the defines us tangibly in society, culminates, ends with an agent, a corporate arm designed solely to serve us. In that, I see I concur with those who say we need spiritual and corporate.

The beneficiary is obvious. The beneficiary is that "addict who still suffers" in the 12th step and the "addict who still suffers" in the 5th Tradition. Maybe that's you and I, maybe that's somebody out on the street, we can't be specific in definition of that beneficiary. It certainly isn't the trustor. It certainly isn't the owner, because we need to give it away in order to keep it. Except in that, this vehicle is necessary, the integrity of this vehicle needs to be maintained because our recovery depends upon it, (giving it away in order to keep it). I believe that we need to mirror reality in this document and define clearly "trustor" as the spiritual fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous.

Y: The way that I approach it is that every member, whether it be the addict who still suffers, is of benefit as a result of whatever the properties or whatever the trusts are. So in my viewpoint in looking at it, they're the ones that gain the benefit of the service structure that they created. The "trustor" is the entity that they place their trust in. The administrator of that trust, the person who carries out the wishes of the trustor. That's the way that I structurally see it.

GD: This is David. I see a two-tiered definition of beneficiary. The varying elements that we've talked about here, there may be overlapping or interconnecting definitions that apply. It may take some creativity to allow our minds to expand a little bit and tell the lawyers that "this isn't a boilerplate kind of arrangement that we're making here, it is a little eclectic," but once we all agree to it and sign it is, it is in fact binding. I see the beneficiary and the owner as the same. In other words, addicts that come in perpetuity and addicts that were here. We own the property. We are also beneficiaries. We benefit in a number of ways.

Z: Because you own your car, you drive your car.

GD: Right. Spiritual ways that as Jim was sharing about with the 12th Step and the 5th Tradition, which to me should be the overriding guiding principle in everything we do. Reality is reality and we have to have some kind of a corporate entity. How we develop that and administer those things, the trustor and the trustee may have some overlapping areas of responsibility. But we need to be a little bit looser and freer in our thinking if we're going to have a document that will stand the legal test of time and the spiritual test of time. I frankly, with my illness, I don't know if I'm going to live to see these things rectified. I know I've mentioned that before, but I'm listening to a number of people here today saying...to the limits of our ability accommodate and know all these potentialities. I am firmly in the camp of that the fellowship owns it, and any document that we were to come up with, if that wasn't the basis of the document, then I don't see how. Maybe you could show me how I could get behind it. I don't see how.

Z: Well, the real rub here seems to be not who owns it so very much per se, because I believe a lot of people agree philosophically, but that ownership not be seen as the same as it has been so that the feeling out in the fellowship is that the office owns it, it belongs to WSO. It's a feeling of loss, whereas the fellowship...

GD: One thing I know for sure is that I don't want the Office to own it, and I don't want the conference to own it.

Y: Isn't that the nature of the fiduciary relationship? What you articulate is the fellowship's ability to revoke it.

Z: What I'm trying to do is direct the topic out in the open and put it on the table.

Y: If the fellowship has the ability to revoke the trust...

Z: Yeah, through a complicated action. We've had some really rough things happen the last five or six years.

Z: Hold it. Let's get for real here, okay? I get real frustrated when I'm listening. You're all being soft and nice to each

other now, okay? But if we were in a conference setting, it would be devastating. People would be having their hearts ripped out like I did before, and the bottom line is real specific. Jim talked about it as the trustee and the trustor, it's real simple. The fellowship itself owns its own literature. That's always been what we've been brought up to believe. I was brought up to believe that World Service Office was only going to be a fiduciary rights corporation to hold our property for us. That's what we were brought up to believe. This conference...I'm real fucking pissed off because I know there's dishonesty, because World Service Office's Conference lead the fellowship to believe that they are the owners, and reaffirmed that damn thing at the conference. So who the hell are we bullshitting here? You proved that there. This section violated quasi contractual relationships. Always violated those relationships with the fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous.

Y: No, it didn't.

Z: It always has.

Y: Look in it, it says the owner...of the fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous. That's all it says. That's what it says. And when you do that...

Z: Sure. In the "parties of a traditional trust document are trustor, trustee, and beneficiary. We don't have any problem with that. In which case, it indicates here that Narcotics Anonymous owns the property and is the trustor." Being part of the literature committee and part of the effort in creating the book, that's kind of the way that I understood it to be at that given time, was that none of us were to benefit anything other than in continued recovery and spiritual good things, and that really the only people that were going to be beneficiaries of this whole things were us and the new people, which is any member when they say they're a member, etc. There's also another sort of unwritten trustor here who as I recall, Bo, in a lot of the conferences when we talked highly of the Higher Power, and that we were trusted servants of that power. Therefore, we should all be included as trustors and beneficiaries. To kind of close that loop, to be at the beginning and the end, is just that little analogy of owning the car and driving it. It just makes too much sense to say that that's now valid. As Jim's indication of who the trustee is, if the trustee is in fact the WSO, and the WSO is created from the boards and committees directly responsible to the trustor and the beneficiary, then that just completes the whole circle.

Y: Looking at it, I'm trying to think of a way to reorganize it, but it just seems kind of weird to have the service structure serve membership benefitting in being a benefactor. It kind of feels wrong.

Z: As far as being the beneficiary, Stu?

Y: Yeah, being a benefit. You're usually doing something to benefit someone else. It just kind of has a weird feeling.

GD: It's certainly a different way of looking at it than we are used to. When we're speaking of the World Service Office and its employees and directors, who are in some way, shape, or form... To me there's kind of like a dichotomy here. I don't mean to put anything more on this than what it is, but it's kind of like an honor and a privilege and what have you to be able to fly out a couple times, three or four times, and eat and things be taken care of as a Director of the Board. The employees certainly are, if we take into literalism the 8th and 9th tradition, and we understand the 12 steps work, and if not, something that we pay for, it would appear to me that each and every employee of the office is directly benefitting through medical, dental, insurance, job security, feeding their families and that kind of stuff from the creative efforts of members of the Fellowship that are not.

GD: We're prodding around with some sensitive personal areas. I, for one, was a member of World PI in 1984 and 1985. I came into the service structure in the heyday and the melee, and it was different. Something changed around '86. I began to reevaluate did I want to do this. Today, I wouldn't want to be an RSR. I wouldn't want to be a trustee. I wouldn't want to be an employee of the office. None of those positions are taking away the fact that my region might think that I was a wonderful guy and wanted to send me out there because they trusted me. Taking that and bringing that into the equation, I don't know why we need all the traffic. In my own personal recovery, I had to evaluate what

was it about me that made me want to be this or want to be that

Part Three

The reality is that everybody who makes a salary in Narcotics Anonymous as a result of the creative spirit, is benefitting in their own personal lives in their own personal way. That's just real.

Y: There's no doubt about that, Dave, I agree wholeheartedly that an employee benefits from...But the problem I have is the trusted servants. To me, service is giving, and I never look at service as a form of getting something.

GD: Stu, I agree with that. But we're looking now at travel policies and plane tickets are paid for and this and that. Initially, my experience has been in the early days of service, my own personal experience was that you called somebody that lived 100 miles away and they picked you up, or you hitchhiked and you got there. I know that was hard and cumbersome at times, and it cost a great degree of personal resources, and I know why we set up that policy. That policy was so that we could have the people most qualified to serve serving and not have to be financially over-burdened. There has been a subtle shift in, I'd say across the board, but in my perception, there's been a subtle shift across the board in our service structure that has made it one of now it's convenient and attractive and comfortable to serve, for all servants from the RSR, and even some areas, ASRs get overnight expenses. I know they do in Florida. They stay in fine hotels. There's an element that is there that we have to deal with, we have to look at. I'm sure that that's A) a personal recovery issue for the servants, and B) also a recovery and responsibility issue for the electing body.

X: On that note, it's kind of unique how each next item seems to lead us out of the tangle of the previous item.

Z: Let me throw in my term from the last tape to this one. The problem there being conflict of interest. That people would want those jobs, want those positions, want those plane tickets, want those hotels, want those dinners and adulation, money, property, and prestige, and that would in some way compromise their service and create conflict against the 5th Tradition, against our primary purpose, against N.A. message in N.A. literature. Against "let's change the book to where we can sell more copies to the hospitals. Then that extra income will justify making the changes regardless of what the fellowship wants or even if they know about it. We can always confuse them at the conference."

GD: 950 changes between the 3rd Edition Revised and the 4th and 5th Editions.

Z: Nobody quite knows how all this happened, but we know it happened.

Y: Come on, guys. They view to travel is self-centered? That's hard for me to believe.

X: I really think if we move onto the next one, that we can see some of the real problems that we have here. I guess my main concern wasn't with that, but rather with the fact that we decided years ago that we should have an $8.00 book to get an office started and we never changed the price back, never rolled the price back when it was appropriate. The real beneficiary, I believe, has been what I'll call "pet projects" of world services that have been on consensus thrust upon the fellowship and funded by these profits. Not that they might not have been advantageous to the fellowship, they might be. It was a misrouting of request and information response, requested services responses. This was funded through these profits. I think if we deal with what ability the office has to effect trust property without prior permission, we'll come up with some input on pricing.

Z: You're talking about like "The Guide to Service" project, $50,000 for five years, right? That's a quarter of a million dollars.

X: Yeah, etc., etc.

Z: Who asked for it?

GD: It's a joke.

X: Etcetera, etcetera, etcetera.

Z: Well, I just thought I'd throw in a couple of specifics.

GD: We've squandered millions of dollars and we're no closer to anything.

Y: Some people would say, "Hey, this project sucks," or "This project is okay." Somebody's got to make that determination. I'm in line with you on "The Guide to Service," but the idea is that we're going to have projects, they're either going to be successful or not. Somebody has to determine what these projects are. Hopefully, we get the right people proposing the projects, and the right people carrying them out.

GD: Kevin Fahey said that in his report, when in 1984 in March when they sent out "please don't copy, please don't copy. We're going to do this, we're going to do that." The planned price reduction that he talked about...We have been broken faith with year after year after year, and I told you that I was a GSR who'd just gotten clean when that report came out. I made a motion not to copy literature and to quit buying keytags from the Atlanta Lit Committee. But things have changed. We've got just a trail of broken promises. From ideas and things that have been squandered.

Y: You took on a different approach.

GD: You know how many IP's five cents will produce in America?

Y: Yes.

GD: Do you know how many IP's might produce in India? Our priorities...to me it's mismanagement across the board and bush league bullshit.

Z: Let's not get into name-calling here.

GD: I read a letter once from an AA member that was sent to the trustees that said, "I feel like my 50-year old mother is being raped." That was all the addicts running into the AA meetings. My sentiment and my feelings about what has occurred in the course of services, at least in my short time being clean, I have sentiments that run to that degree. I'm looking at a grand lady, a wonderful and beautiful shining light in the darkness that can go out worldwide. Why is our growth diminishing? What's going on here? There are reasons. There are billions of addicts, and we are not doing the job. We're just not doing the job that we should and could be doing. If we didn't have an office to support and 42 employees to support, if we didn't have a conference that spends a half a million dollars a year for nothing. Would we load up 30 cent books and translate the chit and send it to these places around the world? That's what I'm trying to say.

Y: Well, we do that to a degree. We do send books places.

Z: Hey, that's terrific.

GD: But at $2.07, or do you charge it off to the office for $8.00. When you send literature, do you send a pamphlet and charge 1.2 cents, or do you charge it at the retail price?

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X: There's abject misunderstanding of the 9th tradition among RSRs. I believe that's an issue that we need to attend to, just like George specified earlier. The structure needs a revamp. Perhaps my discussion of revamping the structure in this vehicle is inappropriate. Perhaps it is appropriate. I think that first we need to have some kind of consensus of who the parties of this trust are. When we have some kind of consensus who it is, owns the literature, who it is, we owners trust to administer the literature, both primarily and then finally, where we intend the benefit of the literature and all other property to go. Then we'll have an inkling of how we should arrive at decision. If we say the fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous that organized spiritual entity is the owner of this property, if we specify that every place that it needs to be specified, that the owner of the property is and only can be the spiritual fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous, then obviously we need a vehicle that's satisfactory for the fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous to make decisions regarding this property.

What I hear Billy saying is the vehicle we now have isn't satisfactory. I concur with that. It's not satisfactory because of a rampant misunderstanding of the 9th and 2nd Traditions across the fellowship. Just to illustrate that, a friend of mine just became a member of the H&I committee, spoke to the chairperson who talked about the interpretation of traditions. I think if we as a fellowship are so devoid of quality trusted servants that we must elect someone to the chair of a world service subcommittee who considers interpreting traditions, then we're in sorry shape. That's enough of that tone.

GD: What the group conscience put down in that Basic Text in the original traditions is what we are, at least I feel, morally and spiritually bound to operate under. Even if it's not right, if it's not right, then show us through documentation and an education process, that it's not right. The way to keep the trust is to follow those guidelines, but we throw them away.

Y: "What ability does the World Service Office have to affect the trust property without provision of the trustor?"

GD: Oh, yeah. Zero.

Y: I felt zero. Jim picked out a few points in there. It appeared that the document gave it some authority. For my sake, I don't believe we have use with that principle.

Z: I made a written comment. I said "None, but may express opinions, etc." I don't think we should have any special workers or trusted servants who can't speak. That would be horrible, but they shouldn't govern or control or manipulate. We can tell when documents are weighted or biased.

GD: But a lot of people can't. Most people can't because they're operating from another place, perhaps spiritually than we do. This man is neither a pessimist nor an optimist. He sees things as they are. Most of us on this telephone call have enough experience to know that basically if it comes out laser printed and well written, even if it's bullshit, most everyone in the fellowship who reads it is going to take it as the gospel. There is a responsibility for accurate communication. All the way around, don't break the circle anywhere. You take the most inflammatory chit and put it in there, and you take the most... it's like mind control. Mass psychology. We can't afford to play those games anymore, because what happens is we find ourselves in a situation such as where we are now, where you have a limited amount of players who have any ability to dissect the results of things.

X: I feel real strongly about #4, that any and all actions affecting the fellowship's property must first be considered by the fellow-ship. The fellowship should decide what products and services should be available from WSO, and the fellowship should decide the price for these. The fellowship should at least provide general parameters. The office from time to time may need to take temporary, specific action until the fellowship has had time to act.

Z: I think the office has to have all of the ability to communicate the effect that the trust property may have on the office itself, but none of the affect.

X: Definitely. In pricing, I think this is maybe one of the real critical things we need to tend to quickly. In pricing, it's contingent upon the office to offer the fellowship now and in its time of question, some sort of analysis. Let's say if the book were to cost $2.00, what services would be funded, or what services would have to fund...

GD: You mean how many employees would have to be let go for the good of Narcotics Anonymous?

X: Etcetera, etcetera. What the real effects are. If it cost $3.00, $4.00, and $5.00, in increments. I think dollar increments are not too much of a chore, even though I know the magnitude of the chore I'm asking for.

Y: Well, I hope that things run smoothly again. They have before. That's all everybody knows about. Make a decision one way or another and what the effects would be and what it would take. When we make a clear decision...

Z: On #4, did I hear you say that the office should have no affect at all with no prior permission of the fellowship?

Y: The World Service Office really shouldn't have anything to do with the trust property, other than to produce and distribute it, or any of that.

Z: Exactly. That's what we've all been trying to say, Stu.

GD: Absolutely.

Y: Such as changes, revisions, new development, all should be directed to the office. The office should have nothing to do with any of that.

Z: And I heard that at this year's conference. I heard George make that statement too, "Hey, just tell us what you want us to do." It was pretty simple. In this #4 then, all we're really doing is defining who the trustor is.

GD: Yeah, and the methodology by which it's administered. How about #5, folks?

Y: See, we all did agree on something.

Y: #5 "Does a member have immunity of prosecution for infringing on the trust property?"

X: Here's something I'd really like to say, that I've really thought about for a long time. I think this matter just requires a little common sense. Members and groups are part owners of the property, so no infringement has occurred. However, if, after a study of all the facts and the impacts concerned by the fellowship, which isn't the current situation, the fellowship then decides the nature of products to be sold and their price. Then, if an individual or group should be approached, they should be approached by the Board of Trustees if they choose to print or distribute on their own. Such action would be approached in the same method that trustees visit gently and kindly with other people who are violating or compromising our traditions.

GD: Trustee Guidelines, Section 8B, clearly delineates how they're supposed to handle it. If the Trustees are the guardians who protect our traditions, then no other service body, element, or arm has the right to initiate any type of action, legal or otherwise, until our policy that the trustees will place that issue, inform the fellowship and place the issue on the agenda has occurred.

X: All I'm saying is "infringement" happens outside the fellowship.

GD: That's correct. I'll prove that legally if I need to.

X: I firmly support the protection of our property from anyone who is infringing on it's being held by the fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous through whatever agent.

GD: I agree, Jim, I agree. If we had a true group conscience on it, set a price, all those elements that you articulated were present and in place and done, then I agree that we may have a problem. But as I said at the beginning of our conversation today, when that happened with Alcoholics Anonymous, they treated it with more in line with what you're talking about than before. They didn't do anybody, they announced it to the groups and said "If you find that it better suits your needs, fine. We just wanted to inform you that this is not official GSO stuff."

Y: Well, there's two points I'm going to make. Because of the fact that Narcotics Anonymous has only one requirement, the desire to stop using, which is a self-admittance, anyone can make that statement and not be prosecuted because they say they are an N.A. member. Such is the case, and I'm sure Stu would have pointed this out, as the person who had Creative Art, brought to the forefront, and he told Stu he was a member. The same situation would have happened. It's a real difficult situation when you only have one requirement for proof of membership that is so unrecognizable to say whether or not that person is a part of the fellowship.

GD: There's nowhere, any place in our literature, a statement that says "You are a member when you say you are." It says membership in Narcotics Anonymous is not automatic when someone walks in through the door, or when the newcomer decides to stop using. Now?

Y: The point is, Dave, that if I say that I am a member, you have no way of saying that I am not. Alcoholics Anonymous has changed their point of view in how they are handling this situation.

GD: If you have some communication from them on this, or a file that you've gotten, I would appreciate getting it. I want to say that it was the World Service Office that singled Billy and Lou and myself out acting as individuals which could have put us outside and into that definition that you have just articulated. The fact of the matter was that none of us were operating outside the group principle, the group concept. If we're looking at members, suing individuals, you've got permission to sue, individuals, groups, areas, and regions, what's going to happen? There are areas, groups and regions that are going to do what they're going to do no matter what kind of legal threat you put out there. We've got to look at it. What's infringement? The fact of the matter is, what Bo, in Bo's signed deposition in court and what I'm sure, Roy articulated earlier, that the legal definition that would be applied surrounding these statements that have been made as to the intent of the authors, their financial arrangements and agreements. A case can be made through the fair use doctrine and other points of law having to do with copyright, ownership, and authorship to take this into public domain where anybody can. I'm trying to point up these things, bring them to the forefront. Is Joe Blow's group in San Diego that prints up meeting schedules with "Just For Today" on it? All the underground step guides. Suppose another book is written that uses any of the steps in it or refers to N.A.?

Y: We're talking about exact replication, for sale for profit. Simple.

Y: The proper way to handle it is to apply for permission. You've got situation where you have some delineation for flexibility. Therein lies the point: What actually constitutes infringement? If we set up a trust, and no matter whether or not you are a beneficiary, you have the potential for violating that trust. Just because you are an owner or a beneficiary of that trust, does not remove you, or place you in a position of immunity from infringing that trust.

GD: I think as long as the two legal viewpoints that you're putting out, and the legal point I'm putting out, which are on opposite ends, basically of the spectrum, are unresolved, then we're going to find ourselves in the continuing tenuous situation.

X: I think what we need to realize here is that we have two potential situations. One as illustrated by the current thing in a state of flux, where a member or a group, because of difference of opinion, what it's given to be, or appears to be, or is used as the group conscience takes action on its own, or his or her own, strictly for the benefit of their personal

program or their personal approach to service. Another where an entity removed from the fellowship, whether they claim membership or not, takes action motivated by profit. I think it's two pretty distinct situations that most mature groups of folks could establish the distinction. I'm not saying that there's not going to be difficulty. But I think we need to take an appropriate stance on those two different situations. I don't think that the stance is to treat everything and everyone the same. That needs to be part of this. This is a valid question. I don't want to be a member of a group even if they take AA's 12 and 12 and put the N.A. logo on it and change a few words and start to publish it, I don't want to see them treated as Dave was treated. Because of our failure to learn from our mistakes. I think that what was done was a mistake, and I think everybody will agree that the expenditure was not using money effectively to carry the message to the addict who still suffers. The only good that can come out of it is for us to come up with something that's going to work effectively in the future. The critical point is, how do we treat somebody who's rooted in N.A. and may technically infringe on the trust properties...

GD: It's easy to determine who is a member and who isn't. It's not that difficult of a process.

GD: Stu, I remember our conversation of July 5. I begged you not to send out those letters. It probably would have died a death. It probably would have gone to about ten groups and nobody would have given a chit about it. It was like you guys handled it all wrong.

Z: Stu, you have an indemnification clause in the section under "Trustee." Would it be conceivable to create an indemnification clause under each of the other two sections? In regard to the trustor and the beneficiary?

Y: Yeah, and also articulate in the operational instrument how you handle an individual who's termed "a member" in relation to an infringement. To something like Jim's talking about, instead of a defined process, less rigid is kind of what I had in mind.

Z: I think that terminology of indemnification, if we just come together on what that definition is, we can take care of that.

GD: My definition of indemnification, as far as I know legally, if there is no malice aforethought, carelessness, or harm intended by an action, then the insurance carrier, or the corporation in separate cases will take care of the cost. If however, that carelessness, waste, fraud, mismanagement, those types of things are shown, then the corporation is liable and directors and employees are personally liable as well.

Y: Right. If the of offer of indemnification in those areas are violated...I've been looking at how to re-work, how to word that section. I remember working on that part of the indemnification. I'll try to reword that.

Y: Well, the problem is that you have to have the ability to sue an infringer. So to make a determination to degree of infringement and that somebody is exclusively void of any kind of prosecution for wrongdoing, what is considered wrongdoing or violating trust, violating Narcotics Anonymous. For people to take advantage of it, it leaves us wide open. I believe that N.A. needs the ability to protect itself, but then also take in the concerns that Jim and Dave talked about.

GD: If a service board, committee or group were to print literature that a definition of what constitutes "for profit" needs to be included. Such as 20% over and above for shipping and handling, and administering that. Whereas, somebody that was on the outside that fits the definition of what an infringer would be, would be selling at 100% or 200% or 900% markup. We need to look at what constitutes a "for profit" infringement.

Y: Right. You've have to orchestrate that in the organizational instrument, but the actual trust has to say you'll pursue infringement.

Y: What that allows you to do if you use that as the sole motive for indemnification, Compcare, Hazelden, all those

guys can qualify.

GD: I didn't mean them, because they are outside the fellowship.

Y: But if you can prove in the eyes of the law, that they are existing of the same conditions, irregardless of the fact that they are outside of the fellowship, then in the eyes of the law, they will be looked at equally.

GD: I don't know if I support that. What I'm trying to say is that if copious records and notes are kept by the "member infringer..." I mean yeah, we've talked about it here. It's just input, it's feedback. It looks like this may be an alternative, or a way to determine what in fact institutes within the fellowship.

GD: What are the reasons, spiritual or otherwise, where a group, area or region would do that? On the other hand, we must frown very hard against anyone outside profiteering on N.A. Clear up our own internal profiteering on N.A.

Y: Let me give you a scenario, Dave. If I understand what you're saying, you're creating a system by where an identifiable part of the fellowship can, in fact, infringe through revision and infringe through changing Basic Narcotics Anonymous philosophy, and the fellowship itself has no way to straighten out the situation. You're giving them permission to do so.

GD: No, I'm talking about exactly duplication of conference-approved literature.

Y: I think we had better take time to work on it a little bit. I think if we expanded our thinking a little bit, we could come up with some viable options.

GD: When you take a look at the gross revenues of all the conventions put together, I wouldn't be opposed to say a 5%, or 10% net as an automatic donation for the use of logos on articles. It has nothing to do with recovery. It has to do with money. We need to stop the profiteering within the fellowship, or at least license these conventions to give us money that would go directly to support our volunteer service structure. The World Convention Corporation, when the change was made back in '85, used to have a percentage that went automatically to the WSC, a percentage that went here and there. When the office took it over, that stopped. We need to look at the resources that we have both internal and these conventions, extra-curricular. Convention committees would probably get smart and not put the logo or the trade name on it, and we would kill two birds with one stone. We'd end the profiteering with the logo and the trademark internally, would create an additional profit center for our service structure.

If you're going to apply some kind of policy that has to do with property, trademarks and logos, and all this other stuff, it's got to be fair. It's got to be equitable. It's got to be across the board and address all these areas.

GD: I don't mean conference approved, I mean fellowship approved. And I mean it in context with what Billy said. We need a direct vote on what is and what isn't, then we need to follow that. Same thing as Jim articulated earlier. We get into this term of convenience that's more laziness than anything else. I meant Fellowship approved.

THIS IS THE TRUTH, THE WHOLE TRUTH AND NOTHING BUT THE TRUTH SO HELP ME THE W.S.O., INC. (AND THEIR FINE ATTORNEYS) ABOUT THE BIRTH OF THE FREE BASIC TEXT BETTER KNOWN AS

THE 'BABY BLUE'

I know, I know, some of you have probably heard and innocently believed one of the different rumors and lies that have been floating around for years about who was responsible for first printing the Free Basic Text, better known in some circles as the dastardly 'Baby Blue.' But, where did it really happen? Why was it really done? Who did it? What are the REAL facts?

Most of those who think they know, think that is was all done by Grateful Dave, may he rest in peace. After all, wasn't it Grateful Dave who was actually sued in Federal Court by our own World Service Office, Inc and their fine attorneys? WSO Inc. actually misspent thousands upon unknown thousands of our 'dollars in the basket', without even attempting to obtain the Fellowships' conscience, in order to try to prove in court (how spiritual!) that our Basic Text and indeed all of our
Literature and intellectual property really belonged to them, the World Service Office, Inc., by virtue of copyright. Those who continue to try to govern us arbitrarily instead of serving us keep insisting that it does not belong to us, the N.A. Fellowship at large. However, the members who wrote our literature always intended that it would always be freely ours, we know because they told us.

Those same 'dollars in the basket' which you and I donated to help carry the message to the suffering addict, were also misused by the WSO, Inc. in a Fellowship wide, slanderous propaganda campaign against Grateful Dave and his 'gang of evil cohorts' accusing all those involved in printing and giving away free N.A. Literature of high treason against N.A. and of attempting to destroy our beloved World Service Office, Inc. by taking away their well earned profits! But that is another story. Maybe someday, someone will write a detailed account of that exercise in fear, manipulation and control (WSO, Inc. at its best!).

We also remember with great sadness the time when the main speaker at our World Convention in Portland stood right on that podium and spewing arrogance and hatred slandered and berated Big Lou P., God rest his soul, intimating that it was Big Lou who was the evil force behind the Free Basic Text and the attempted destruction of WSO, Inc. And so it goes on and on, many other dedicated members all over the country received threatening letters from the WSO, Inc. and their lawyers warning them to cease and desist or they would all face litigation.

Well, as one who was there and involved at the time I can tell you that the way this whole thing really began was as follows. There were some totally committed and very well informed members in the South Dade Area of the then Florida Region (soon to become the liberated South Florida Region) who were fervently looking for some kind of Spiritual solution to the problems that had surfaced at the time with relation to the purity of message content, quality and most of all, the cost of our literature.

On the one hand the Fourth and Fifth Edition fiasco was still very fresh in our minds. Just in case you have never heard about this important part in our history, about nine years ago the WSO, Inc. had printed and distributed to the unsuspecting Fellowship, the 'gutted' Fourth Edition of the Basic Text. Then, even after they got caught red handed and forced to stop by the Fellowship at large, and exhibiting a large measure of their customary arrogance, they still refused to follow the Fellowship's desire to return to the last approved edition, the Third Revised.

Instead, they went ahead and rammed the Fifth Edition through the WSC without sending it back to the Fellowship for the input and review process which would have been the only sane course of action to follow under those questionable circumstances. They then slapped a five year moratorium on the Basic Text so that the Fellowship could not force them to also throw out the Fifth Edition like they had the Fourth.

At the same time, more and more of the home groups in our Area and as it became apparent afterwards, many other areas and regions were suffering financially due to the exorbitantly inflated prices that were being charged for all our literature by the Florida Regional Service Office Incorporated and the World Service Office, Incorporated. The only way our areas and regions could pay for the services that helped carry our message was to generate funds artificially through merchandise sales and fund-raising dances, picnics, conventions, etc. The Spiritual Principle of the Seventh Tradition was being strangulated by the ignorance and greed that the corporations we had formed were exhibiting. The over ruling priority was the survival of the corporations, Spiritual Principles be damned. The welfare of the suffering addict and the N.A. Groups be damned! The Corporation MUST survive at all costs. We had created a monster and the disease was using that monster to destroy us! The tail was wagging the dog! We had enough of money, property and prestige! It was time to take action!

It is a well known fact that for services to be most effective they must be provided as close to the need as possible. If a group can provide a particular service, then as area has no business being involved. If an area can better provide a service, then a region should not be involved, etc., etc. And yet, here was the least important service body, the WSO, Inc. which sits at the very bottom of our inverted pyramid structure draining every last resource from the groups, areas and regions, and therefore the World Service Conference. In this very scenario, the proper and logical fund flow of the Seventh Tradition, from member to group, group to area, area to region and only then, from the region on to the WSC, gets totally distorted. What to do? How to make sure that anyone who could not afford to pay the 4 or 5 hundred percent profit (and even more in some cases) for OUR OWN literature could still be able to have access to it.

As one possible solution to our problem and armed with the sincere knowledge that our N.A. literature (up to that point) had been written freely by addicts for addicts and that it belongs and will always belong freely to any N.A. member and to no-one else, and that no corporation, especially one we had created ourselves had the right to rape us at will, a couple of members of that group (I was one of them, so you are getting this story first hand, this is not hearsay or propaganda) decided to take the bull by the horns and try to reduce our costs as much as possible so that we could continue to support our services based on the Spiritual foundation of generosity and self-support.

Because our God always gives us what we need, it just so happened that another home group members was working at a print shop at the time, so we took a Basic Text, tore off page by page, pasted it back up and made a master (without the stories) so that we could print is as inexpensively as possible. We used the Third Edition Revised because that we the last Edition that had actually been circulated throughout the whole Fellowship for approval. The Fourth and Fifth Editions were never even seen or approved by the Fellowship. And so we did it, printed it, the first 'Baby Blue' ever to see the light of day - did so about nine years ago right here in Miami, Florida.

We experimented widely, tried different methods of binding, varied designs and wordings on the cover itself: "FREE BASIC TEXT", "SUPPORT YOUR HOME GROUP", "FELLOWSHIP APPROVED", etc. We also tried different colors on the cover: white, light brown, and various shades of blue until we settled on "Baby Blue".

Once we had a book we were happy with, we started printing as many Free Basic Texts as we could with our very limited resources and giving them away for FREE. We gave them to the prison system and to state and county run treatment centers, detoxes, etc. One area gave some to each of their groups at area service and we started giving them away individually, one on one to all newcomers or to anyone who wanted and needed one.

The idea started to catch fire and very soon other individual members, groups and even areas started printing their own Free Basic Texts and other N.A. literature too: information pamphlets, white books, Grey Forms, etc., etc.

To date, many other variations of the "Baby Blue" Free Basic Text have been and some are still being produced: "The Colorado Resentment Baby Red", "London Lime Baby Green", "Georgia Baby Peach." I have seen and have in my archives right now Free Basic Texts with Yellow covers, Purple covers, Brown covers, White covers, and I am sure there are some others around that I have never seen. There was even a home group called O.D.O.P. in the South Broward Area, South Florida Region, that produced a Fifth Edition of the Free Basic Text with a white cover. They also printed their own Information Pamphlets. There is also a "Baby Grey" available to all.

Well, there you have it, there is a lot more to this story but here at least, for the first time in print, are the real circumstances that necessitated the creation of the Free Basic Text "Baby Blue."

Please always remember that WE are N.A. and that WE own the literature. It is our legacy from the addicts who wrote it for us. Any one of us can, at any time, reproduce it for our own use and no corporation can stop us!

- from a member in South Florida

Transcript of the court case - Summary Ruling by Judge Pollack

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EXHIBIT A

IN THE UNITED STATES DISTRICT COURT FOR
THE EASTERN DISTRICT OF PENNSYLVANIA

WORLD SERVICE OFFICE, INC., a:
Charitable Corporation and
Trustee of the Copyrights,
Trademarks and Service Marks
for the Fellowship of
Narcotics Anonymous

Plaintiff

Civil Action No. 90-7631

v.

DAVID MOORHEAD

Defendant.

ORDER

Having come before me this 4th day of January, 1991, upon the joint Application of the parties, it is hereby finally ordered as follows:

Defendant, David Moorhead is hereby permanently enjoined, subject to the terms and conditions of the Agreement appended hereto and incorporated by reference as if set forth in full, from:

1. Using, selling, or trading in any manner utilizing the federally registered and common law trademark and service mark "NARCOTICS ANONYMOUS";

2. Reproducing, copying, distributing, or selling works identified in the following subsisting copyright registrations, or portions thereof:

(a) United States Copyright Registration TX2 837 638,
entitled "Narcotics Anonymous" (5th Edition);

(b) United States Copyright Registration TX2 254 607,
entitled "Narcotics Anonymous" (4th Edition);

(c) United States Copyright Registration TX2 250 588,
entitled "Narcotics Anonymous" (3rd Edition Revised);

(d) United States Copyright Registration TX2 342 402,
entitled "Narcotics Anonymous" (3rd Edition);

(e) United States Copyright Registration TX2 250 589,
entitled "Narcotics Anonymous" (2nd Edition);

(f) United States Copyright Registration TX2 112 598,
entitled "Narcotics Anonymous" (1st Edition);

3. Using, authorizing, or causing the use of "Narcotics Anonymous" or any colorable imitation thereof, in or on any books, pamphlets, letterhead, business cards, signs, brochures, directories, advertisements, promotional items, or otherwise, as a name of mark purportedly identifying the Defendant Moorhead or any services or good offered or proposed to be offered by Defendant Moorhead;

4. Directly aiding, abetting or encouraging others to engage in any of the proscribed activities set forth in paragraphs 1 to 3.

The Court hereby retains continuing jurisdiction over the enforcement of this Order and the Agreement appended hereto.

SO ORDERED:

Date: _____ _____

Pollack, J.

AGREEMENT

This is an Agreement entered into this 4th day of January, 1991 between World Service Office, Inc., (hereinafter "WSO") a charitable corporation with a principle place of business at 16155 Wyandotte Street, Van Nuys, California, 90025, and David Moorhead an individual residing at 1110 Pamler Street, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania, 19120 (hereinafter "Moorhead").

Whereas WSO and Moorhead have been engaged in litigation in Civil Action No. 90-7631, in the United States District Court for the Eastern District of Pennsylvania, concerning certain copyrights, trademarks and service marks held in trust by WSO;

Whereas the parties are desirous of amicably resolving the above noted litigation;

1. Civil Action 90-7631 shall be terminated subject to the entry by the Court of the ORDER, attached hereto as Exhibit A.

2. Moorhead hereby covenants and warrants: that he produced approximately 9,000 copies of a book incorporating portions of the Basic Text of Narcotics Anonymous, which was identified as an infringement in the Complaint in Civil Action No. 90-7631; that he is no longer in possession of any of said approximate 9,000 copies; and that he has destroyed any and all printing plates or other apparatus associated with the manufacture or production of said approximate 9,000 copies.

3. Moorhead and WSO hereby agree, that is an effort to heal any wounds caused by the controversy which led to the above referenced litigation, a Statement shall be published in the January 1991 Fellowship Report and the next editions of the "Newsline" and the "NA Way" containing in the signatures of Messrs. George Hallohan, Stuart Tooredman and David Moorhead. The contents shall be agreed to by all three individuals and be published to the Fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous. This Statement shall: (a) reference the controversy which led to the above litigation, and include a call for peace within the Fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous; (b) include a call for a full and adequate discussion of the issues which led to the above litigation; and (c) include an admonishment against any

recrimination with the Fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous as a result of the controversy which led to the above litigation.

4. WSO agrees to place, without comment, but with an introduction, the following Motions in the 1991 Conference Agenda Report of the World Service Conference ("WSC"), which shall immediately follow the publication, in their entirety, of the closing remarks of the Honorable Louis H. Pollack entered at a Preliminary Hearing held on Wednesday, January 2, 1991, and in the United States District Court in Philadelphia, PA., prior to the announcement of any judgment.

Motion 1

That the Fellowship reconsider its decision on which Edition, or parts thereof, (1st, 2nd, 3rd, 3rd Revised, 4th, or 5th) of the Basic Text shall be produced and distributed by the WSO as the official and accepted text of Narcotics Anonymous.

In order for this Motion to be considered, a description of the differences between the respective Editions will be sent to each registered area and region, along with a copy of the complete Basic Text Third Edition, Revised. It is expected that the WSC will rescind the motions adopted in 1988, which adopted the Fifth Edition as the Basic Text, as well as the motion restricting any change to the Text for five years.

Motion 2

That the WSO produce, at a reduced price, the Edition of the Text ratified by the WSC. The actual price of this text should be determined in view of the following factors: its afford ability to the membership at large; a change in the cost and quality of materials used in producing the book; the responsibility of the WSO to provide services from the income generated by sales of the Basic Text; and whether it includes personal stories or only the first ten chapters.

Motion 3

That the WSC be directed to obtain a group by group tally of all the groups registered with the WSO, on Motions 1 and 2 above. This procedure will begin on July 1, 1991 and continue through December 31, 1991. All registered groups shall receive a copy of a paper detailing the differences between the Editions of the Basic Text, and a complete copy of the Basic Text Third Edition Revised. In addition, each group shall receive complete information concerning the issues relevant to a reduction in the price of the ratified Text.

The committee appointed to supervise this tally shall consist of the following: four RSR's in attendance at the 1991 WSC; two Trustees to be nominated by the members of the World Service Board of Trustees; two WSO Directors, to be nominated by the Directors of WSO; and the WSC Chairperson. Those nominated by the RSR's, Trustees and Directors, respectively , are to be submitted to the World Service Conference in 1991 for confirmation by two-thirds published roll-call vote, failing which, those not confirmed shall be replaced by others nominated by the RSRs the Trustees, or the Directors, respectively. Two members of the WSO staff shall also be assigned as non-voting advisory members. The results of the group by group tally shall be published in the Fellowship Report and confirmed as official at World Service Conference in 1992.

5. This agreement represents the complete agreement of the parties and is to be construed and enforced pursuant to the laws of the Commonwealth of Pennsylvania.

6. WSO and Moorhead hereby unconditionally grant mutual releases to each other, their successors, predecessors, officers, employees and directors for all causes, claims or demands, both in law and equity, arising from the beginning of the world until the execution date of this agreement.

Date: 1/ 4/ 91 _____ (Seal)

Tradition Wars: a pathway to peace
Fellowship Work in Progress - Not for Use in Meetings

David Moorhead

World Service Office, Inc.

Date: 1/4/91 by _____(Seal)
George Hallohan
Assistant Executive Director

WS Inventory

Court action did not go as planned. When this court case turned up support for Grateful Dave's position from the bench, WS immediately threw its policies out the window and instigated the 10 year inventory process which effectively tied the Fellowships hands and led to changes in our service structure that would have been deemed incredible ten years earlier. It took me a while to realize that while portions of world services, the WSC and its sub-committees did not function, WSO continued doing business as usual. You know, you just don't like to think stuff like this can happen.

First the 12 Concepts were pushed through the WSC. The Fellowship had many groups who did a through discussion of the proposed material. I attended three, one in Aliquippa, one in Ohio and one in Michigan. Each one started with two side representing opposing views. Some for and some against with the numbers and force evenly divided. After about an hour, the supporters began verbalizing exceptions and issues within the material they could no longer support. All ended rejecting the proposed Concepts. The 12 Concepts were voted in by members who did not do the workshops but simply trusted world services. The NA scholars of the times were shocked at their approval.

This is important to note because the 'group conscience process' used to run from group to world services in an unbroken chain. Now the 'delegates' at world level can vote as they please, the Super Board is in place and no one seems to really know or care what is going on. This is breeding out the vigorous, informed type of NA membership that was so attractive in the 1970's and 1980's. NA groups in Charleston, West Virginia are down from fifteen to one. Charleston is Dave Moorhead's hometown.

Chapter Ten

The History Committee Folds

Alabama/NW Florida Region Splits

Terrific confusion and divisiveness spoils the loving, creative atmosphere that had prevailed in the history movement in Alabama up to this point. Some members, began going from ASC to ASC raising questions and creating suspicions and negativity that effectively shut down the history movement in Alabama and without interest or support elsewhere, the movement went to sleep for almost a decade. But it did not die, we are a continuation of that movement in working on this book. It just takes some time and technology to collect and present the relevant material in a single form.

Chapter Eleven

THE WORLD SERVICE INVENTORY

When Judge Pollack failed to admonish Grateful Dave over the Baby Blue court case and opted instead to admonish both Dave and WSO to make concessions to one another, WSO realized their grip on the literature copyrights was not secure. It is possible that the 'Inventory' was designed to shut down the only service body that could give WSO serious problems if it wanted to do so. It proved to be a successful 'non-move' meaning it appeared benign and sincere but was actually adroit in that it achieved one goal while appearing to reach for another. The Fellowship was very clear about what it expected World Services to do and the policies and procedures for doing it. No region requested the 'inventory' and yet WSO controlled the instruments of communication from WSC, WSB, WSO, the NA Way Magazine and the Fellowship Reports. So?

To change the service structure, especially in regard to the Second Tradition, required pressure on the Twelve Traditions. The Twelve Concepts, while well intended, contain language that is the gravest assault on the Twelve Traditions since they were approved by AA in 1955. Along with the Steps, we were encouraged to adopt the Twelve Traditions of AA as a 12 Step fellowship. As a member of the NA World Service Conference, I was asked to do a report on the AA service structure and found the 12 Concepts of Service to AA to have real teeth and certain provisions to protect the rights of the AA Fellowship. Any serious reader should compare the two documents side-by-side. We have to do a partial comparison here to make it clear that the NA Concepts are not related beyond being numbered twelve.

Once the Concepts were in place, the Guide to Local Services could be approved. This was such a damaging and exhausting process, that it just plain wore out members to oppose it. The breach of trust was so enormous that NA members could either disbelieve what they were being told by a few members or they would have to get up in arms and challenge the whole organization of world services. Few members were willing to do this, so they took the choice of disbelieving what they were told or they ignored it. Right or wrong, we only have so much time apart from work and our families. And no one was expecting an attack from such a source, a source that was supposed to be serving. And, after all, God would not let such an awful thing happen, right?

Chapter Twelve

THE SUPERBOARD

Voted down again and again in the 1980's the idea of having a single superboard over all of world services was finally accomplished by creating a Fellowship that did not know what was happening. In the ten years of the WSO inventory plus a few years for its implementation, members who would have opposed the changes fell away. These were not complainers or members who did not work their Steps. They were the most devoted and brave members in our history. They helped form all the new regions, areas and groups. Some few were able to stay clean through it all, but many will have nothing to do with service beyond group level. Others who got clean after our group conscience process was shut down for the inventory never knew what they were missing. By the late 1990's, the opposition had moved on with their lives, members had adapted by beginning to ignore the going's and coming's of world service and concentrate more on their personal recovery and carrying the message. Somehow, NA survived all this and alternative service efforts began to bubble up like water springs in a parking lot. You can cover it up, but water will find a way. You can block the Spirit but the Spirit will find a way. Using manipulation and control to take advantage of people who have surrendered to a terrible disease and trust you with their lives is not only un-thinkable, it is illegal. But you will never hear an outcry because our internal struggles are just that – we keep them within NA. It is not our way to appeal to the law of the land. We are in touch with a much higher power.

Distanced from World Services by what began as part of the California legal code - that a corporation could not be under the direct control of another, unincorporated, group or undefined body of people, the World Board now controls effectively everything that happens in the rooms of Narcotics Anonymous. While the shadows of our former organization are still in place, they only have a say if the Board wants to listen. Some members will attack you if you point this out as if you had done it to them, since you are aware of it.

Board Authority Motion to be inserted here - Ed

The path to self determination is still open to us, although in the past several years there may be things established as a matter of law that we have no knowledge of or fail to understand. Many still believe that something voted in can later be voted out but this might not be the case. We don't need a lawyer to stay clean or work our NA program. We can even write books if we want to and no one can stop us. We live in a free country. The attractiveness of being a part of a spiritual Fellowship bonded together by gratitude, concern for others and a sense of wonder is great. Joining a corporation might be a fine thing also but it is a different thing.

[I have asked for some current information on the Super Board and what it is doing right now. Hearing nothing is not the same as imagining nothing is going on. I believe there are people who are so fear based, they would cheerfully throw out the 'baby with the bath water', forgetting what is important here to the members. We'll see what comes in. NOTE:Ron - do what you can to check for recent minutes, reports, anything you can dig up. – Ed]

The blindness of the 'un-spiritual' is incredible and they will inevitably come up with statements like one heard several years ago. One of the NA members working with the group master minding the super board repeated what he had heard in a session: "This new structure is just setting in place what we have been doing for years." By announcing this, he was in effect describing the actions of people who circumvented our structure by power of association and with full view and knowledge of participants in their closed circle. So, by not playing 'above board', they have cancelled out the service structure written and supported by the Fellowship in the seventies and eighties and substituted a new structure that no one understands. Well, there might be a few hundred who understand but that is not enough to bind the Fellowship to their agreements. And certainly we cannot approve that which we don't understand. NA members have never thought putting the entire control in the hands of a few people was a bright idea. It was opposed in year after Conference year through the 1980's until the inventory suspended the WSC for a decade and a new Fellowship was allowed to grow up without fully understanding the issues. That is why there is a disparity of feeling and experience between members who got clean before 1988 or after 1990.

Chapter Thirteen

THE INTERNET

For the first time in our history, NA members from all over the world could access, read, download inexpensively and discuss documents, records and other materials from the world wide web. This network is science fiction come true and it helps us unify our information base and get answers we would never be able to do without this blessing. The study, communication, email groups and ease of contact with members overseas makes it possible to learn and study on a level that would have been out of the question a few years back.

This low-cost method of expression, presentation and rebuttal has largely replaced what used to happen in our service structure. Clogged up with rules that make free expression impossible, we have to meet our needs any way we can. The NA-net is a real God send. Without the ability to see and hear, an individual is trapped in their own mind. Only extraordinary means allow them contact with the outside world. Without the method of open sharing, written reports and the opportunity to respond and be heard, our Fellowship is not able to know what changes have occurred and has just evolved into a form that doesn't concern itself with the goings and comings of world service. Surely this is a blessing of sorts but we still need up to date recovery materials, information on how to better carry our message and what is happening in other areas and parts of the world. It must be understood that NA is not "up for grabs." We are defined as an open, loving, and caring Fellowship by our lives and by our literature. This is not subject to change. When we talk about input and feedback, we really mean new stuff, new in the positive useful sense. Members that amazingly fail to grasp this simple principle, often go off as if instructed to re-invent the whole program. Rest assured, that is not what we mean. Early recovery concerned itself with just getting past withdrawal and into working the 12 Steps, with some mention of the 12 Traditions. Now, we are able to write about and share our experience in a hundred areas of everyday life. Parents can share how they apply NA principles to their home life and rearing children who reflect the love and joy of a spiritual life. We can extend the light of recovery into all parts of our lives. The communications among addicts world wide has never been greater.

As the cost goes down and the availability and resources go up, we will increasingly be able to communicate with written posts, audio and video media. We may have a group of members, visible on a large screen meet with another group of members on the other side of the world for an hour for twenty dollars. Certainly, we can make and mail CD and DVD videos that allow us to speak directly to members no matter where they live. Feelings and concerns will be expressed and coherence of focus and activity will emerge, in whatever form it may take. So, there is no question that the NA Fellowship will become informed enough to resume it's dominance of what happens at the world level and any other item or issue affecting it's spiritual integrity. Surely there will arise leaders who are able to transform the current structure into something more friendly and workable - or else it will be replaced. How else could it be? Abraham Lincoln said, "You can fool some of the people all the time, all the people some of the time but you can't fool all the people all the time." Getting our message into jails will always be a challenging and tough job for members who are able to step up to the plate. Some members will always want to work to get the word out so that addicts in pain and desperation will be able to reach us. And members like us will want to explore the possibilities of written recovery materials. And, you know, we like to get caught up in things that feel good. Real service gives an individual a feeling of worthiness and energy that allows us the step into a new life clean, willing to make amends and able to live without causing harm to others. The Twelve Steps allow us to go as far as we want into the spiritual life.

Chapter Fourteen

THE DISENFRANCHISED

There is a viewpoint that leaders do the dirty but necessary work of running an organization. In the case of Narcotics Anonymous, there must somehow be enough of the Spirit to move and impress our membership more than disappoint and depress them. Addicts are not your ordinary people to begin with so extraordinary leadership and showmanship are appreciated more than diligence and severity. By taking members out of the loop of leadership and reducing their say to a minimum, a Fellowship that is not informed and unaccustomed to reaching workable solutions is brought into existence. The Basic Text was a great effort and it welded the membership into a coherent whole. The waves of inaccurate or incomplete information have assaulted the Fellowship mind and one of the ways many members cope is to simply stop paying attention. The yearly Fellowship Report which had been used to share information with the fellowship was abused and then abandoned. The NA Way Magazine was turned into a propaganda machine and absorbed into the 'corporation' along with all the functions and offices of the World Service Conference and World Service Board. Now, it is all one thing with ten or twelve members at the top. The notion that the Group and member represented the highest level of service has been completely replaced at the official level so that the Fellowship has become distanced from what happens at the decision making level. Many members try to believe that no harm has been done. But a severe lethargy and a widespread belief that there is nothing we can do about it has had a dampening effect on the Membership. Many members do not believe the World Service estimates of how many groups and members exist in NA today. While NA is large and healthy in many areas and regions, this has more to do with the Twelve Steps and Traditions than anything positive or encouraging coming from World Services. The stream lining of World Services has had the collective affect of silencing the fellowship voice and led to the disenfranchisement of the general Fellowship.

In NA we have the right to a vote, we distribute our literature and group supplies, and we control what happens within our Fellowship by our support or non_support. We have been disenfranchised by changes that break the ties between what members vote at the group level and what votes are made at our World Service Conference. By changing our 'representatives' to 'delegates' we change the nature of our structural organization from one that is rooted in group conscience to one that is rooted in 'those who know best.'

Example of disenfranchisement: Fifty people are in a bus going along a road. The management company plans several stops for necessary items but has an onboard facility for using the restrooms and even a cold sandwich and chips luncheon service. This keeps the bus rolling and gets everybody to their destination most efficiently. If you want to stretch your legs, you can do so like the other passengers _ up and down the aisle. The catch is you don't know where you are going. You go ask the driver and he/she explains there is a problem with the radio and the destination is not really clear right now. Well, let me off the bus, you say. He/she explains that there is nothing but jungle out there and passengers who get off delay the bus and are never heard from again. You begin to question other passengers about how they got on the bus and where are they going? With pleasant comments you figure out that they don't know any more than you do. You press them with stronger questions and they begin to snap back at you, some may call you a trouble maker. After the first few months, you begin to wonder just where the bus is taking you. You have no 'franchise' or right to know where the bus is going or a say in setting its course.

Many modern corporations are waking up to the principle that involving people in the business and including their ideas makes good sense. Also, when the company makes extra profits, they let some of the profits go to those who made it happen. In NA, the good feeling of worthiness is the coin of the realm. When WSO officials started the business of trying to maneuver themselves into the leadership roles, they undid something they did not understand. They took something from the membership that rightfully belonged to the membership. The Fellowship had written a book and founded a whole new Program based on principles of inclusion and routine information channels to inform and encourage each and every member. This resulted in an explosion of new members and meetings. NA went from a few thousand members in widely separated little communities in LA, San Francisco and Philadelphia to hundreds of

thousands of members and ten of thousands of meetings everywhere. No corporation can account for this explosive growth. Friendliness and counting people in on things developed a network of members world wide that is still in place. Damage has resulted in the relapse and death of many originating members from the seventies and eighties. Some members who saw unethical happenings and observed the staging of corporate games were dismayed to the point of dying. Members who recognized the negative changes of policy were terrifically let down. Their hope smashed, many quickly fell prey to their addiction. Many others just will not have anything to do with structured service. Keeping the Faith and Hope alive is our main goal here.

How it got this way can be reviewed in this chapter. The biggest growth in NA history occurs in the 1980's with the writing and publication of the Basic Text, *Narcotics Anonymous*. We grew to fifty thousand members, then one hundred, then two hundred and fifty thousand. This rapid growth added so many addicts to our Fellowship during a short time that the numbers were overwhelming. Our capacity to meet the communication and service needs of the Fellowship fell short and created confusion that complicated matters.

Group conscience was never just 'how members felt.' Group conscience has to do with how NA members, who are working their 12 Steps, and have some history of involvement with NA, feel on matters of policy and procedure in NA. Our policies are our planned reactions as members of NA to routine concerns and problems that arise with some regularity. Our procedures have to do with the way we do things in NA. For instance, we advise openness and fair play in all matters having to do with service efforts and maintaining our system of service committees so that they stand as a whole structure. Allowing members who are inexperienced with the NA way of doing things to change the structure invited disaster. It is a sign of weakness and insincerity to allow our Traditions and Service Structure to be altered or revised by people whose only qualification for voting on issues is that they used drugs to the point where they surrendered to the NA First Step. Other qualifications like a working knowledge of our 12 Steps and 12 Traditions should not be taken lightly. Going from a few hundred meetings to ten thousand meetings definitely put a strain on things.

Along with this surge in NA membership came a sea of new trusted servants who had experience in politics, industry, treatment and other organizational efforts. The members who were already here had participated in the writing of the Basic Text and had an understanding of the spiritual process of group conscience. They were not threatened by these new trusted servants and felt no need to control NA. Much administration had been done by agreements on what the 12 Traditions said and the protocols of courtesy mixed with a strong follow through. When a question arose that involved major issues members were asked for answers repeatedly until they responded. A tug of war developed between the new world level trusted servants who wanted to streamline the NA service structure and make service more business like and trusted servants who wanted to continue our application of spiritual principles and group conscience. During this struggle a few of the new trusted servants, saw the opportunity to enforce their beliefs on the Fellowship of NA. They were unaware that this struggle was a part of the learning curve for many members learning how to do service in NA. We take time and trouble to explain things to our new members in service and it is often difficult and confusing.

As soon as the book came out in 1983, changes were introduced at the World Service Conference. The structure up to that time had separate boards with the idea of 'balance of power' and 'double_checking' so that no one service board or committee would 'take over' NA. Each had its own Chairperson, Secretary and Treasurer as outlined in the NA Tree. First to go was the position of WSC Secretary. Then the WSC Finance Committee was discontinued. Once the Fellowship had real financial concerns, it lost its sub_committee for finance! Then the Board of Trustees surrendered its Secretary and Treasurer later in the 1980's.

In every case, WSO assumed responsibility for those duties. The Office typed and mailed reports and correspondence to the Fellowship for the Board of Trustees (WSB). The Office handled hotel accommodations and air travel arrangements for WSC Officers and members of the Board of Trustees. After a few years, the discussions among Trustees as well as attempts to conduct business in the World Service Conference seemed increasingly irrelevant and philosophical. The issues were philosophical in the sense that they didn't really seem to make any difference and were more a matter of petty personal preferences rather than real spiritual issues. The word philosophical became a

way to dismiss a concern or issue as rhetorical or academic. Running the business of NA at WSO became the important thing and getting more literature to sell as WSO product was quietly accelerated to become the main mission of WSO. As the terminology of the business office began to sound more and more corporate, spiritual issues and concerns which reflected years of Fellowship debate and discussion began to seem very blurred and were being presented more as a matter of form than experience, strength and hope. Those who agreed with the business office came to be seen as intelligent and agreeable. Those who took exception or lodged complaints were portrayed more like sick addicts who just needed to work their Steps and get with the Program!

In an effort to get more marketable literature, the Office hired a professional author to write and finish a book on the 12 Steps and 12 Traditions. This was quite a shock to the general membership. After years of involvement in the writing of the Basic Text and working on other recovery materials and newsletters, the Fellowship expected direct involvement in the Literature process. The business office seemed shocked by the vigorous and general disapproval of the move to hire out the writing. While this was very much NA private business, many people in the outside world knew about it. NA members were appalled.

Back in the Fellowship, members in Miami and Washington, DC were getting busy making low-cost copies of the recovery text from Book One of Narcotics Anonymous. Many of these low cost books were given to newcomers instead of a key tag or poker chip at their first NA meeting. Grateful Dave, a member from West Virginia, developed a plan to force perceived negative forces at WSO out into the open. He printed a booklet form of the 3rd Edition Revised with the 4th and 9th Traditions restored as approved by the Fellowship in the White Approval form. It worked. Even though Grateful Dave told Greg Pierce - who told others what he was doing - WSO still sued Grateful Dave to stop his activity. At the end of the 1st day in court on January 2, 1990, the Federal Court Judge Pollack took a position that NA had lost sight of its primary purpose and admonished both Grateful Dave and WSO. Judge Pollack then ordered Dave and WSO to work out over the next few days specific accommodations to one another with the idea that the initial accommodations would lead to further accommodations. He further stated that both parties could regard him as the enemy if necessary. The ‘accommodations’ were agreed to and approved by the court over the next few days. This was quite a shock to the business office on the West Coast! Grateful Dave never printed another book but WSO did not complete their part. Possibly as a result of the lawsuit, the WSO launched a diversion that curtailed the WSC as a functioning service body and resulted in an eight year inventory. This inventory diverted the Fellowship attention from fulfilling the obligations of the lawsuit as well as allowing serious changes to be made in our service structure. Once it was disclosed that Dave had AIDS, the wheels stopped turning. The case died with Dave but the issues live on.

The a new crowd of people came in to replace the members who had experience with group conscience in the world service structure prior to 1990. Many of these NA pioneers left either NA or the service structure or both as a result of the court case and being made to feel generally unwelcome. The WSO Executive Director was not renewed with the possible idea that he would not have gone along with the super board. Bob Stone for all his shortcomings believed in the WSC group conscience system. The members coming into service in the 1990s had never seen the WSC as a potent service body. The members orchestrating the so_called inventory were in place long before the super board was approved as NA policy. By the end of the 1990's, the new system allowed for a super board to administrate everything. The new structure did away with the Fellowship representative system, replacing it with a system of delegates who were free to vote as they pleased at the WSC. Naturally, the Fellowship was largely unaware of the depth of change. While some may have voted the ‘conscience’ of the members in their home regions and areas, the letter of the service documents no longer required them to do so. The paperwork relating to the WSC and world service in general became so convoluted and difficult to follow that most members gave up in disgust. This was seen as one more example of Fellowship incompetence, rather than poorly prepared Conference material. The voices that were raised against the needlessly complex paperwork and the moves by the business office to streamline our service along corporate lines were ignored as out of date and unworkable fundamentalism. Any potential conflict of interest was overlooked and somehow never came up.

One of the attractive parts of the Program of NA as described in the NA Tree from the 1970's is the incorporation of democratic principles into our service structure. This original service structure was approved by the Board of Trustees

(WSB) in 1975. From that time forward, members worked to implement the service structure as described in the NA Tree. The conscience of individual members was passed on by voting at the group level. This was carried forward by a system of representatives voting at the area, regional and world level on issues facing the Fellowship. By carrying the important feelings of the membership, the representatives were almost a priest class in NA service. God as expressed in Group Conscience. The young Fellowship very quickly learned the structure and implemented the service boards and committees directly responsible to those they serve. Egotism and interpersonal maneuvers to get friends elected or push motions through may have happened but it was frowned on and generally did not happen. Many members worked quietly and unofficially to make the system work. Egos were stroked, feelings mended and information given before conflicts where ever possible. As members, everyone felt they had a stake in NA and took their responsibility seriously. The study of bureaucracy and government can be helpful for those seeking to understand. We can say here, that there is an underlying pattern of human involvement and personal reaction that insures that we will always have a degree of democracy in NA. It is simply that people, expected open and fair dealing and have an innate way of effecting their will. For instance, if a motion is carried by some manipulation or hidden agenda, and members don't really understand it, they act is if they are unaware of the motion _ as indeed they are. If a fraudulent election takes place, the membership works out some other way to cover the job going undone by an incompetent appointee, or they do without. If a piece of literature is forced past normal procedures of review and input prior to approval, the Fellowship just doesn't like the work and will not buy it or recommend it to their newcomers.

Many members felt that at last they were a part of a group of people who gave them the recognition and a chance to make a positive contribution that they needed to help learn to live life new and clean. Working the 12 Steps of recovery gave them ways to change past habits of lying, cheating and stealing. They were able to make a living and honesty was becoming a friend. Democratic principles seemed to fit in with the spiritual nature of NA. Every member should be heard and policies and procedures should be tailored to the needs and wants of the membership. No other consideration should be allowed to enter into a service structure based in group conscience. The Fellowship totally underestimated the power of corporate zeal and a wave of persons with other ideas flooded into the structure through the 1990's. Eventually, these people took over and began to change the way things were done in NA. Compared with the multi_million dollar cash flow at the business office, the feelings and methods of gathering group conscience were viewed as cumbersome and backwards. Though the Fellowship outcry was great at junctures, the changes were so demoralizing that many just left NA for more spiritual surroundings. Many of the changes voted in during the 1990's were so out of keeping with our approved structure that members still do not know what happened. With each change, the Fellowship distanced itself and many members stopped reading the Conference Agenda Report and participating in discussions about the annual Conference. Today, many members cannot tell you how our world service structure is organized and have adjusted to not knowing what is happening in NA.

As sad as this may seem, there is a bright side. As the business Office under the name of NAWS (NA World Services, Inc.) has distanced itself, it has also taken itself 'outside the loop,' which means the membership has no knowledge of wrongdoing or lessened democratic principles in NA. By a simple shift of emphasis, NA members readily undertake projects and as ever rise to the level of expectation when asked to do something. Many of the principles that guided our service efforts in the late seventies and early eighties are as potent today as ever. When a person cares about you and how you feel, you feel an uplift. When a group gives you this lift, it is affirming, strengthening, and encouraging. It feels great. It takes away some of what was lost in active addiction. Our addiction made us run from people and people run from us. The new people in our lives, the clean addicts, are not running or making us run. They are sitting with us, hearing us out. This rejoining with humanity, makes us whole again over time. While working the 12 Steps we often discover ourselves sharing the answers we were looking for when sharing our experience with others. Extending the validation to the larger body of the Fellowship, we find ourselves feeling good about a much larger number of people. When we travel, attend conventions and participate in conferences, we get additional assurance that our surrender is well founded and we feel good about being able to do our part to help things along.

If this feeling is taken away from us, a real part of our common welfare is lost. Our recovery is damaged creating a serious condition for the Fellowship and member alike. This is not 'just a notion.' Think of a motion picture: if the

audience likes the film, identifies with the story and becomes involved with the action, they stay seated, often putting off a trip to the refreshment stand or bathroom so they will not miss important parts of the movie. If the movie gets stale, or violates certain paradigms, they just get up and leave the theater. We do not want our members leaving NA, for any reason. Especially over service disorders. And the sad, enormous fact is that when all else won their hearts, service disorders alone had the power to stop recovery and give otherwise good committed members of Narcotics Anonymous a reason to identify out - and they left the program. You can say it was just their disease but many of us feel like we could have done better.

Because of our low self esteem we are attracted to service for our self worth. In a sense, all service is based on ego. Being of service we are given the opportunity to grow. Power is a drug. Powerless addicts seek power. Along with whatever services actually get provided, our service structure also allows us the opportunity to work through problems in group settings. It is part of our socialization process. Real example: a Corporal (recovering addict serving as ASC Chairperson) in the Army was promoted to Sergeant because or his 'leadership abilities.' We learn simple techniques of communicating and we learn to handle the emotions that come to us. We can feel great _ or we can feel left out.

It is known through out the world that knowledge is power. In these times, with all the benefits of modern communication and resources that let us see into time and what people are thinking, it is easy to see that a community in crisis contracts, with the many following the few. In peace times, the many have a chance to look around, ask questions and have a general knowledge to go along with the particular role each person plays in a neighborhood, a city, or the general population. The TV, Internet, interpersonal talks all go into forming this picture. Our spiritual Fellowship has a similar way of informing itself, examining a subject or expressing important ideas. This information helps us form a general picture of NA that may vary in details but becomes increasingly stable in overall terms. This is what we base our recovery on and forms the basis of our new understanding of life. This new understanding helps us fit in with all the other people in the world as well as get along with one another. Ego trips and power plays should have no place in all this. Holding key information to disadvantage others exhibits fear of losing control and a lack of basic surrender. While most will back off and avoid unpleasantness, it is obvious that we have to occasionally 'get back to basics.' And the basics of NA have to do with simplifying our lives, getting honest about our goals and amending our relationships with others, whether the harm done was intended or not.

At any given point in our recovery or in our growth as a Fellowship it is important to realize we are not powerless to express ourselves. Democratic principles may be essential to our NA way of life. The moves to streamline our world service system have removed the dynamics of many happenings from our Fellowship view. The idea of a few people at the top and everyone else in the dark is not a workable proposition. The great panoramic play of an enfeebled World Service Conference with confusing reports and a motion system that makes most members feel stupid and actually tells them how to vote is ridiculous. I doubt it would be allowed in what is called 'corporate America.' Talking down to people and doing as you please is not a good solution. It would not work to run any organization. It is not like having the fox guard the henhouse or the goose guard the corn, it is a few people attempting to control all our resources with little accountability and the large Fellowship having no real say. You can see how the 'few' might think this is a good idea, but the Fellowship feels left out. The purpose of world services is to give each and every member a window into what is going on and a say in those happenings by their vote at their home group. Without beating around the bush, this gives the Fellowship not only the final say on things but also plenty of comments along the way. Tailoring our Program to the actual members who constitute the NA world is not only a good idea, it is our heritage. The Basic Text, *Narcotics Anonymous*, was tailored to the Fellowship by a lengthy process that makes it one of the greatest books in the world. Group conscience is a two way street: it informs members as well as gathers individual opinion into a useful format. Reflecting actual practice in preparing our H&I, PI, Policy and Literature policies makes as much sense today as it did when the Basic Text was being written. The more people who know what is going on, the better. The more our written recovery materials conform to the actual practices in meetings and Fellowship, the better. We foster comradery, unity and cooperative effort when we are sensible and caring in our Fellowship communications. Leaving people out is no solution. It is organizational death in slow motion.

When we see others in trouble, we pray for strength and guidance to help them. An NA old timer shares, "I know that there have been times when things went wrong and there was nothing I could do about it but regret that it happened. There have been members who have come to me and extended themselves to assure me that I was ok with them and that whatever happened, there was someone who understood and cared about me. Giving this to others is an ultimate act of love. It is divine and can only come from a power greater than ourselves."

Chapter Fifteen

JODY R. - CHANGES

Note: this long article was written some time ago by an eyewitness. We will never have an alternative viewpoint on some of events and people as good as this one. While the trail may be cold on many of the issues portrayed, it is a real 'heads up' article and too good to leave out. This was all written in the early 1990's, long before many of the changes that came in the late 1990's. - Bo S.

Here is a reprint of Jody R's article about what's happening within our World Service Organization. It's divided into five sections for readability. Click on the underlined topics at the top of this page to access the sections. What you read here may shock you. Remember to stay close to your home group and to your sponsor. NA is a grassroots organization. There is no higher authority than GROUP CONSCIENCE!
– Introduction from the URL from which the article was taken. - Ed

Our NA Fellowship

By Jody R.

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Beginnings

(Why I'm Writing This)

If you saw your best friend's lover actually in the act of cheating on them, would you feel you had to tell them? Maybe you'd say "it's none of my business", but what if you lived in the same house and they announced they were going to marry this cheater? What if out of hundreds of friends who didn't know about the affair, only a handful also knew, but none of them were speaking up for a variety of reasons. Maybe they liked the other partner, maybe they didn't want to "get involved", maybe they just didn't want to be accused of "breaking up the relationship" or maybe they just didn't care. Some even had the nerve of saying they weren't going to tell your best friend because "it's best left up to God to decide these things."

But you know the truth, and the wedding day is approaching. You know if you're ever going to look your friend in the eye again you'd better speak up _ even if it means them becoming angry and saying "they never want to speak to you again", especially since all their other friends who didn't see the affair jump in with "oh, they'd never do that" once you told.

After doing a "searching and fearless moral inventory", you discover that you feel God's will can only be discovered after all the truth is laid out on the table. After all, aren't we all taught that "we're as sick as our secrets"? Even in the criminal law system, if I see a murder and don't report it, I can be charged as an accessory, so even in the law's eyes "knowing but not telling" isn't right. I feel I need to tell what I saw, even if it costs me the friendship of many people that I love (we must all risk losing prestige at some point in order to maintain principle) So here goes . . . please forgive the history lesson _ I just want to make sure we're all on the same page.

History of Narcotics Anonymous

As many of you know, Jimmy K. founded Narcotics Anonymous after finding A.A. "insufficient" for addicts who needed "identification deeper level of emotions or feelings", rather than "identification at the level of apparent symptoms" common in the A.A. fellowship and philosophy (quotes from Basic Text "We Do Recover" written by Jimmy).

But this was more than a feeling, and more like a "near death experience" that prompted Jimmy to this realization. In a tape of his talk at our 20th year convention, Jimmy spoke freely of the night when he had over 15 years "sober" and decided to wait until his wife and children went to sleep in order that he could shoot them and himself in the head and end all his misery. It was a vision of 12 Golden Steps that awoke him to the "different" process necessary for addicts to recover that became the basis for Narcotics Anonymous forming. (For a copy of the tape of this talk, mail a blank cassette to NA Foundation Group, 483 Moreland Avenue NE #6, Atlanta, GA 30307. Be sure to include your return address and postage.)

Jimmy soon found he was not alone. Many of the former A.A. members who joined him in founding Narcotics Anonymous also found their way to this realization through "near death experiences". Vito is a popular speaker back east who talks freely of the night he strung himself up with a rope at 18 years sober, only to be rescued at the last minute. When I first met him, the rope burns on his neck were still visible. Vito became a driving force in the early beginnings of east coast Narcotics Anonymous in the 1960's after hearing that "something different" was being formed.

Believe it or not, even Bill Wilson agreed with our early founders that "something different" was needed in order to recover from the spiritual aspects of the disease of addiction. In the history of A.A. "Not God", along with various other history documents available through A.A.'s General Office, it's common knowledge that Bill Wilson not only started experimenting with LSD, Niacin Therapy, and speed in his sobriety, but experienced deep, profound depression into years of sobriety, (see the story of how Bill Wilson met Father Martin).

It was after 20 years of sobriety in the fellowship that he created, that he too realized "something different was needed". Bill dubbed this the "ism" of alcoholism, and started speaking out in the fellowship about this problem. However, his own fellowship dubbed this an "outside issue", and soon many members of his own service structure started phasing him out of world level service because of what they felt was his "confusion of the issue". (Bill Wilson made a videotape available through the General Office that speaks about how the fellowship and him parted philosophical ways about 20 years into the formation of A.A. You can also email me for a dub if you wish).

Jimmy wrote a pamphlet called "Problems Other Than Alcohol" about just this issue that was available for a while (before A.A. rewrote it and changed his concepts) in A.A. meetings. Greg P. used to have a copy of this version of the pamphlet, you might want to check it out to see why it stirred up such controversy, that Jimmy speaks on some of his tapes about how he became quite an "unwelcome troublemaker" at some of the A.A. meetings he regularly attended at that time because of what it said. When he defended the pamphlet, many oldtimers told him "why don't you start your own fellowship", to which one day he replied "I think I will".

I'm not an expert in history, so please forgive me if I get a few things messed up here, but it was then that he started looking for a meeting. A probation officer at the prison suggested they come there. I think about ten members joined him for the first meeting of Narcotics Anonymous (not to be confused with the Narcotics Anonymous originally formed on the east coast by someone else that folded two years later prior to this event) at the prison. It was such a success, they were asked to return.

Soon came time for an outside meeting. But this posed problems. A group of individuals sharing recovery at a prison is considered an "H&I presentation", and not a group which has to be part of a fellowship. What fellowship? Jimmy realized that one had to be formed. Because of the 12 Steps of A.A. are copyrighted, and cannot be adapted without an acknowledgment of the author without risk of copyright lawsuit, Jimmy received copyright permission and along with these other addicts, formed Narcotics Anonymous.

Groups also had another problem _ where to meet? Back in the '50's (N.A. was formed approximately in July of 1953 "We Do Recover", cons were not allowed to meet together while on parole. Many churches would also not allow drug addicts to meet in their facilities. The first meeting of N.A. as a fellowship was in North Hollywood, California (I think in a Salvation Army). As meetings grew, some cops started waiting outside them for everyone to go in, and then they would jump in and arrest everyone for parole violations. Some cops camped out at meetings in order to catch those who had warrants out.

Soon "rabbit meetings" were started in response to the police threat. Private, secret meetings that would be moved every night, that you could only find when the secretary had your number and called with directions. But these kinds of meetings posed a big problem _ how would a newcomer find the meeting? Especially a newcomer without a phone or answering service, or one that didn't want the ones they lived with to know about their attendance (remember this was the '50's and answering machines for addicts were very uncommon).

A debate grew. The members insisted that more secrecy was what was needed. Jimmy resisted profusely, insisting that all meetings be held just like A.A. meetings with respect to consistency. "Even addicts said it could not be done the way we had it planned. We believed in openly scheduled meetings _ no more hiding as other groups had tried. We believed this differed from all other methods tried before by those who advocated long withdrawal from society (treatment centers). We felt that the sooner the addict could face his problem in everyday living, just that much faster would he become a real, productive citizen". "We Do Recover", Basic Text.

Because literature was needed, Jimmy wrote our little white book, along with some IP's like "Self_Acceptance", etc. He formed CARENA, a corporation to hold his copyrights for him in a way that did not put his own personal name out there as author like Bill Wilson did with the Big Book, but also allowed him to retain control of the copyrights.

Why? According to sponsees of his, he believed that part of what was needed to combat the disease, rather than the symptom, was total "anonymity". That no addict be considered better, higher, smarter, or even more "prestigious" than another. He saw this too clearly with how Bill Wilson was treated at A.A. meetings and what it did to him. He wanted addicts to feel this was their fellowship, not his. He believed that only by downplaying his role, and keeping his name off documents, would he be allowed to work a program just like any addict. A program that for him, meant avoiding any chance of "star" position if he was to stay in a humble, servant attitude. It was also because of this belief, that he felt the Basic Text should be written by the fellowship, and not him.

History of the Service Structure

He was not alone in the realization that if you want different results, you've got to do something different. That if Narcotics Anonymous was going to provide a different avenue for those who needed something different, then everything _ from the literature to the service structure, would then have to be different. Greg P. was one of those addicts of "like minds" to Jimmy who came in and wrote our original service structure "The Tree". Greg told me it was called the Tree because the roots were the home group, and everything else branched off from there. If you don't have a copy of the original Tree, and you'd like to see it, also put that down on your request to Greg for copies of documents. This structure was not randomly put together in some kind of hurry, but carefully designed not only to service our fellowship, but also to help provide recovery for the individual addict.

Unlike the structure of A.A. where members are voted in to be representatives who make decisions for who they represent, it was felt that if you boiled all the drugs down to one common denominator for an addict, that what we all shared was the need for "control". How were we supposed to learn to "surrender the need to control", if we were put on service floors and given a license to run with control like they do in A.A. Service meetings. Besides, if our fellowship was originally designed for those who needed "something different", then giving them the same service structure as the other fellowship would not be honoring our basic differences and providing for that.

One other basic difference was that our originators felt that addiction had a component of a force, an "internal and external force which could destroy us" acknowledged in the introduction to the Twelve Traditions of our Basic Text. This force could only be kept at bay, by setting up a service structure that would not allow it to pop up it's ugly head to grab for money, property and prestige (what truly every addict sought in their disease).

It was felt that you might be able to sway individual addicts, but that God's will would always express itself through a "group conscience", and that as long as ALL decisions were put to the groups, that the disease would not take over the helm of our ship. Also, that non_addicts left in a position to make decisions for our fellowship based on laws or balance sheets who had nothing to lose when making unspiritual decisions were not the best gatekeepers for us _ but instead that an addict, who held our fellowship dear because his very life depended on it's survival was truly the best gatekeeper for us. This is why all committees or boards formed of non_addicts would never be placed in a position to make decisions that affect Narcotics Anonymous as a fellowship, or that could alter their message in any way.

Our Traditions
And The World Organization

A service committee, an area meeting, a regional general assembly, even a meeting of the Board of Directors at the WSO, is not a group. A "group" is a meeting of two or more addicts who get together to carry the message to the addict who still suffers. Members of a home group who get together with each other, to vote on decisions for our fellowship, have the ability to express God's will in their conscience because their decision is based in the very roots of the group, not out on an open service committee floor. How can a God's will, who expresses himself through a GROUP conscience, express himself in a non_group arena?

Under our original service structure, all decisions are taken from the area floor BACK to the groups for a decision and vote. That vote is then carried by the GSR to the area floor for tallying. Then the area counts it's votes from the home group votes, and so on, until a vote count is sent on to WSC for a count of "group conscience" votes.

Under the concepts, we will now have "delegates" who make decisions for us on these area and regional floors. I

would trust just about any moron in an environment where I knew God's will would prevail, as would happen in a home group. But to cut someone lose on our behalf, who doesn't even know our history, our service structure, or that even has that much clean time in some cases, onto a floor where people are grappling for power and control, under the rule of what could be a clever, manipulator with hidden agendas, and then tell me I call them a "trusted servant" _ I DON'T THINK SO.

There's also many other problems with this setup.

1. The flow of information _ you can't fool every home group. Nor could someone with a hidden agenda, reach each and every home group. No one could be in that many places at one time. There's a certain safety in numbers. But put each and every person's name and face on a floor, and on a phone list, and suddenly, you have people who can be "lobbied" just like in the government. I'm not paranoid _ I've watched this happen. You also have now a target of people with which WSO can target propaganda to, whereas the groups can't so easily be put onto a mailing list. Again, I'm not paranoid _ I've seen these propaganda mailing lists put out by WSO like the once attached to this letter that just went out recently that conveniently didn't reach the groups _ just key, target people.

2. The loss of anonymity _ if I'm carrying a vote back from my home group, this is not my vote _ but theirs. I don't enter into the picture. Not my background, opinions, viewpoints, religious beliefs, childhood issues with authority, nor my fear of bucking the group or of needing approval from others enter onto that floor. It's not me up there _ but my home group's vote.

3. The loss of no "hidden agendas" _ if GSR's are voted in by their home groups, then other positions can be had by votes of certain other people who are not tied to our home group. This allows a risk of "selling out our home group" in order to lobby for another service position. I might make a more popular decision that even hurts my home group if it strengthens my position to be nominated for a world position by the area or regional floor members.

4. The loss of time to consider important issues _ In a home group environment, an issue can be picked apart and debated for weeks before ASC. A careful consideration of each issue can be made. On ASC or RSC's floor, there always seems to be this "hurry" to get things over with, so some issues receive 15 minutes or less of consideration. When individuals don't properly understand issues, the proceedings are not stopped until everyone understands, but instead they are just glossed over without so much as the batting of one eye of conscience that sometimes more people who don't understand the issue properly are voting than those who do.

5. The potential for misunderstanding an important issue _ I can't tell you how many times I thought I really understood a motion until I had to explain it to my home group. Some of them had questions I never would have thought of, concerns I never considered, or knew more about the issue than I did. We're addicts, and our perceptions are not always accurate, but through the question and answering of a home group situation, the bottom line can be found. I would have made serious mistakes on votes, despite knowing our service structure, and our traditions inside and out, and having a lot of clean time, if I had been allowed to vote on issues on the floor.

6. The loss of the newcomer input _ when our home group used to meet and discuss motions, newcomers were always invited. I was always surprised at the clarity at which sometimes they saw issues. A clarity that was not seen by regular members who may have been too caught up in social issues like not wanting to rebel against their sponsor, or not wanting to go against their husband on a vote, or wanting to make the guy next to them like them by not getting controversial about an issue in front of them so he wouldn't think they were a bi**h, and so on. It was usually at these home group meetings, that newcomers felt empowered to go on to service on higher levels. Rarely is the impact of a newcomer's clear vision felt on an area or regional floor where a vote is being made without their input (rarely have I seen someone with two weeks clean at ASC).

But you say that the fellowship wanted the adoption of the concepts, and it's a little late to change course now. You might change your feelings on this after I recount some personal eyewitness experiences to you.

Inside The WSO

Some years into recovery, I'd been working as a paralegal for quite some time, consisting of doing legal research, and legal writing for various lawyers. My sponsees also seemed to experience a very high recovery rate after release from treatment. One treatment center in the San Fernando Valley called me up one day and asked me why all my sponsees seemed to be the only ones who stayed clean after release. I told them I worked an N.A. program with them uncluttered with A.A. concepts that would confuse them. They asked me to come down and meet with them.

This began a process for me whereby I was asked to start training their drug and alcohol counselors in some of the concepts I used on my sponsees that had been handed down to me by oldtimers in N.A. They also asked me to help them write their grant proposals to keep in business because of my paralegal experience.

In order to give their counselors training, I had to get some specialized education myself. I met with the head of the Addictions Studies Program at Mission College, who told me I could take a fast track to getting my degree by putting together a thesis on the development of the addiction and recovery movement.

I also met with the head of the Foundation Library in Los Angeles, who told me the best way to learn how to write grant proposals, was to look at some successful ones. Since the successful ones I looked at, cited history's of various organizations to support their belief that their program would work, I felt that putting the two projects together would be a great idea.

My first stop was at the World Service Office. I thought at the time that they were the head of our fellowship. I don't look like an addict, but instead more like a college student or housewife, so when I arrived, no one at the office knew I was an addict. I explained that I needed to do some research on N.A.'s history for my thesis, and for some grants I was working on, and they set up an appointment for me to meet Bob Stone, our then Executive Director (who was not an addict).

When I was introduced to Bob as a grant writer, having no idea I was an addict, Bob felt very open to answering my questions and requests for certain documents. He freely gave me copies of the Articles, the By_Laws, the copyrights for various works, financial reports, etc. After all, I had been referred to him by the Head of Addiction Studies, the Chair of the National Council of Drug and Alcoholism, the California Women's Commission on Drug and Alcohol Abuse, and the Program Director of a very large, local treatment center who was applying for their yearly grant. During this meeting, he also relayed freely his disdain and hostility towards our fellowship to the point where I knew he couldn't have possibly known I was a member or he wouldn't talk this way.

As we got into the financial structure, I was more shocked than you could imagine at what he revealed to me what an common workday was like for him. I sat there in his office, while the Editor of the N.A. Way came and got his approval for what would appear in the next issue. Bob then took an article out of his typewriter (this was a while ago folks), and told Ron (the editor at that time), to put this article in that he'd written himself. After Ron left, I asked Bob what he was doing _ to which he replied that he had certain programs he wanted the fellowship to go along with, so he would write letters supposedly from our fellowship and have Ron print them as propaganda tools.

Obviously, this man felt no shame around me, so I asked if we could meet again, only the next time I planned on coming in hooked up to a tape recorder. He freely agreed, and in fact told me how "refreshing it was to talk to someone with a brain, unlike the addicts he was surrounded by every day".

During subsequent meetings, Bob laughed at how he was already pulling the wool over the members' eyes. Things like when some staff members he wanted to ensure their loyalty asked him to help them purchase housing, he put out a phony plea to the fellowship about how broke WSO was, and to please send donations, raising over $83,000 that he

then loaned them under the phony guise of a project.

I asked Bob how he could get away with this, to which he replied "They never read their own treasury reports. If they did, they'd know we were far from broke, plus they wouldn't dream of asking enough questions to uncover what we really did with the money. Besides, they're so dumb, they don't even know that we're not allowed under their own service structure to solicit money directly in the groups as we do or they'd call us on it."

I knew these tapes were hot, so I contacted various addicts I knew with a lot of clean time and asked them what I should do with this information. I was outraged. The group consensus was that I needed to take full advantage of my position of trust at WSO at that time, to find out as much as possible about what was going on, otherwise asking for his resignation would fall on deaf ears, and that I needed to go on taping.

Bob told me I could come and go at any time, and observe any meetings that I wished to for my "research purposes". Besides, he felt that addicts were so dumb that he was immune from any consequences, so why would he suspect me of anything? I asked some addicts who knew me in the Valley to act like they didn't know me if they saw me at the office, to which they agreed. My relationship with Bob and the office went on for months.

Then one day, I walked into a meeting I'll never forget. Bob and other addicts I can't mention without breaking their anonymity because they are still in WSO and WSC service today, were discussing how to take control of the money generated from the WSC, from the World Convention, and how to generate more income from literature. They wanted to do both, but couldn't so long as our current service structure was in place, because they would always be outvoted. I mean, these were only three members and one executive director planning these things behind closed doors. I walked in on their plan to take control.

I made a point of playing dumb, and batting my then 20 blond something eyelashes at them, asking them to explain why they couldn't get what they wanted under the current structure, why it was kept from their control, and why they wanted these things so bad. While they were showing off to what they thought was a dumb blond, they told me all about their plan. All of it was taped.

Service Structure Overview

Since my job was to understand their financial as well as service structure, soon their plan became clear. The Convention Committee's bank account usually brought in a great deal of money, money that is meant to further the fellowship's main purpose "to carry the message". The Convention Committee is also made up of all addicts, who again are bound by our traditions or die. The funds for the convention money are subject not only to our service structure, but also our traditions. By being part of the fellowship, they are not subject to outside donations, treasury reports are to be released to the fellowship, etc.

These funds can only be used for convention purposes also, not easily funneled into other projects where accounts could be padded or lost in the confusion. The primary goal of the convention is also recovery _ not profit, as is the WSO. This is why there are different bank accounts for the World Convention Corporation and the World Service Office. They are subject to different rules under our service structure, have different purposes, go to different people, and are decided upon by a different set of people.

Yes, the incorporation papers and the bylaws of the World Service Office clearly (until the last few years), state that while they are a nonprofit organization, that does not mean they are not a business. Their function according to these papers was PURELY to print and distribute literature to our fellowship, serving as no more than a glorified shipping office. Want proof? Call Carl D. at (616) 544_5165 for a copy of these papers. *(Note: After long years in service, Carl D. died in 2003 - phone number out of date. Copies of various incorporation papers exist. - Ed)*

The office, unlike the convention, can be staffed by non-addicts, and business/financial decisions for the funds generated by this office can also be decided by non-addicts just as non-cancer sufferers can man the office at the National Cancer Society. Granted, the check and balance system of the Board of Trustees is there, but they are strictly an advisory board, and cannot restrict the Board of Directors who make up the WSO decision makers.

In 1989, I sat in the World Service Office, and heard every step of four men's plan to take over control of our copyrights so they could print literature as they saw fit, take over control of our trademarks so we could not use them ourselves without paying them a licensing fee, take over our Convention money so they could use it the same way they used the WSO money - without the restrictions applied it as with the Convention money, and set themselves up as a business entity completely unhindered by the fellowship or the service structure with high profits as their goal.

Surprised? Actually, you shouldn't be. Bob Stone was a non-addict who was hired to run a nonprofit corporation just like any other who makes money in the real world. Plans, schemes, money laundering, bank account juggling, public relations, propaganda, are all common business tactics. He wasn't doing anything he wasn't hired to do. He wasn't hired to serve our fellowship, the World Service Office isn't even Narcotics Anonymous, despite so many people's confusion on this issue. It's a business.

He used every tactic he could, with the help of these three other men who are addicts. Who are these men? The very men who illegally got Jimmy out of the World Service Office's Executive Director position because he was standing in their way by refusing to make decisions that they wanted him to make. Why do I say illegal? I have a copy of the bylaws that state that 2/3 of both the Board of Directors and the Board of Trustees have to be present at the voting out of the Executive Director from office, and that the Executive Director has to also be advised of the meeting to take such a vote. However, the minutes from this fateful meeting reveal that less than 1/2 of each board was present, and that Jimmy was not advised of the meeting until the next morning when he was locked out of the office when he came to work. I saw both these documents personally.

But why would they want Jimmy out? This ties into my perspective as a grant writer for a few years for the drug treatment centers in Los Angeles. Each of these men started a treatment center for addicts in Los Angeles, in fact, I think the first that ever existed. The Federal Government however, would not give grants at that time to centers that did not host A.A. meetings, used A.A. literature, and had A.A. counselors. Also, these centers advocated as long as nine months in their facilities, something I pointed out earlier that Jimmy strongly disapproved of. Plus, unless their program showed an addict's "progress", i.e., that he had completed a certain number of steps at the end of his treatment, they would also not continue funding.

Here's where the head_butting came in, and why Jimmy was replaced:

(1) the fellowship owned the copyrights to the Basic Text. It could not be altered in any way, or it's sale price changed, etc., without the fellowship all voting on it. Again, under the old service structure, you can't fool the groups, and they would not consent to some of the things these men wanted to do to serve their financial interests. The Basic Text was not carried for many years, and even now not in great numbers, because the fellowship would not authorize a discount to the distributor that would make their purchase price any lower than the addict's purchase price on the retail end. Without the discount profit margin, the distributors have no reason to heavily market our book to prisons, shelters and treatment centers. A.A. offers a 60% discount to Hazelden, and you'll find an A.A. book in every prison and treatment centers' library.

(2) These men could not take over the copyrights from Jimmy and alter the White Book, in any way to suit their needs without Jimmy's consent, which he wouldn't give, or without taking over Carina, the corporation that held the copyrights.

(3) The fellowship would not vote in a step workbook so desperately needed in order to maintain funding of drug programs on it's own without leadership in that direction, which again Jimmy said he wouldn't ever agree to because

it was wrong. He believed addicts should only work their steps provided to them by their sponsors, and that these workbooks would actually block many from seeking out that vital relationship.

(4) Jimmy also refused to lend the same support that A.A. did to the treatment centers so they could receive their money. Let me give you an idea what I mean _ Marty Mann was the first woman to recover in A.A. She wanted to set up an organization to lobby for funding for research and treatment, and to make political changes. This obviously could not be done under the A.A. heading, so she formed the National Council on Alcohol Abuse. This organization receives more money then you can imagine each year that it funnels into research, grants to treatment facilities, the training of counselors, and puts considerable effort into things like making sure alcoholism is covered by health insurance providers. Her name carried a lot of clout because of her sobriety in A.A., so this also won her a lot of grants. Marty's relationship with A.A. was one of "wash my hands and I'll wash yours". But Jimmy wanted no part of any such relationships, thus interfering with these men running these programs, while being BOT's.
So now you know why Jimmy was taken out, and a man who would "play ball" was put in. So I heard the master plan being laid out, and did get all of it on tape. I called up some of the oldest timers I could find, and told them maybe we needed to do something with these tapes. An emergency meeting was called in Rutherford, New Jersey in August of 1989. We did it there, because we didn't want to risk my "cover blown" yet, no one on the east coast knew my face, and only selected people from the west coast were invited. Approximately 300 addicts showed up to this emergency meeting.

The tapes were played, and I confirmed to all these people that these discussions had indeed took place. I told them of the plan to force the concepts on us so they could gain control of the voting power of this fellowship, in order to wrestle away what they wanted. We made plans on how to counter_attack. We decided not to release the tapes to the general members then because it would "blow my cover". They decided I needed to continue on with the office thinking I was one of them.

There were also some very deeply entrenched WSO staffers there, and some BOT'S, who agreed to stay in position so they could help when the time came. I say that because if they had shown any signs of rebellion against the force of these men's plan at that time, they would have been immediately removed. I saw this happen to anyone who stood up to them. If this person was a nonaddict, they were fired immediately. If they were in an elected position, the smear campaign would commence until they were ridden out of the office on a rail.

I continued on organizing my "paper trail" for the rebellion as we were called then. They would tell me what papers we were missing in order to prove what was happening was not an illusion, and I would seek it out. If the files were locked to me, I'd get someone else on the inside to get them. We consulted lawyers who informed us of what facts, dates, and papers we needed to put a stop to this hostile takeover of our fellowship, which we consistently worked on to compile. We knew that a feeble and unprepared attack would have met with nothing but a discrediting of us, and for them to go on unchallenged.

Soon we had just about everything we needed to move forward. Some of the rebellion acted as smoke screens. They became vocal, and rebellious to distract attention from us on the inside, so we could continue to sneak out the documents we needed from locked files and closed doors. When we had everything together, the lawyer advised us what to do.

We had to engage them into suing us or it would never work for a variety of legal reasons. We'd already learned their word about making changes never happened as evidenced by what they did to our Basic Text (more on the history of that further down).

One being that if we sued, the WSO could then claim that we were attacking the fellowship, creating disharmony, and have plenty of ammo for the smear campaign they'd become so good at by now. Another was how the rights of discovery would be on our side by having them sue us. They couldn't claim priviledged files as plaintiffs, thus allowing us to subpena in court any document or person we wished. Plus, as plaintiff's, they would be forced to prove their case against us, instead of merely putting the burden on us if we were plaintiffs. All in all, if this whole plan was

to work, we had to get them to sue us. But how?

We knew the only thing they cared about was money _ their weakness. So we decided if they felt their money was threatened, they'd become so rash and impulsive, that they'd then sue us, exposing their flank just as we wanted them to. So the decision to print and distribute the "baby blue" was born.

Grateful Dave's dad was a printer, and a few other addicts had some homemade presses. So we started printing up thousands of free copies of the "group conscienced" approved literature that the office kept refusing to print because it didn't serve their masterplan. Tens of thousands of copies were given out at meetings all over the U.S. All of us refused to purchase any WSO printed literature, using only our own presses for what we needed. We formed groups that did not donate money to World Service Office, and advised our sponsees and friends to do the same. We walked out of Areas and regions, announcing loudly that we would no longer buy literature from the World Service Office, and that we were printing our own.

We had everything to prove our position at hand. We had the copyrights to the Basic Text that clearly stated the copyrights were owned by the "fellowship", and that the World Service Office only held them in trust for us, giving them no rights at all other than to print and distribute at our instruction. Even the N.A. symbol belonged to us. Nowhere in any of the papers, service structure or otherwise, were we as members and groups REQUIRED to purchase our literature, keytags or anything else from them. We had the right to do with them as we wished, from a completely legal viewpoint. Their brainwashing of the fellowship that they controlled us had to be stopped.

But still we couldn't quite get them to sue. They knew they were screwed in a court of law if they did, and didn't want to take the chance of losing. They kept hoping the rebellion would die down once the smear campaign started. And boy did they start the campaign. Letters started appearing in the N.A. Way about the ones who were "trying to destroy N.A." (again, there seems to be this idea that the World Service Office is N.A. _ it isn't). Rumors starting flying about the baby blue distributors trying to "get rich under the guise of helping the fellowship" so that many members would turn on the distributors. Newcomers who didn't have a clue what was going on, were told to "stay away from the trouble makers", and other similar attacks were mounted.

Then the real attack began. Theresa Middlebrook, the very lawyer who wrote the letter you see enclosed, sent a letter Federal Express to each and every group's secretary in the U.S. that she knew of. Over $50,000 was spent on these letters, and a tremendous violation of anonymity was incurred. Who gave this woman, a non-addict by her own admission (I asked her once during a confrontation), the list of names and addresses of N.A. member's home and work addresses to which to send these letters? Who consented to spend $50,000 of the fellowship's money on the FedEx charges? The letter stated that any literature other than "approved" literature that was given away, sold, displayed, or in any way distributed by them personally or at a meeting, would be subject to legal action. (Carl D. has a copy of this FedEx letter if you wish to see it and weren't around in 1990 when it was sent out).

Here's the Letter:

> To: [Trusted Servant's Name]
> From: Wagner & Middlebrook, Attorneys
> Date: July 10,1990
> Re: FELLOWSHIP OF NARCOTICS ANONYMOUS
> Worid Service Office
> Our Docket No.: 03-9545-15.XX
>
> This office represents WORLD SERVICE OFFICE, INC., the service office for the Fellowship of Narcotics.Anonymous. My client is the owner of United States Trademark and Service Mark Registration Nos. 1,450,681, and 1,476,774, for the marks NARCOTICS ANONYMOUS and NA logo. My client is also the owner of United States copyright Registration Nos. TX 2 112 598, TX 2

250 589, TX 2 342 402, TX 2 250 588 and TX 2 254 607, covering the First through Fourth editions of the NARCOTICS ANONYMOUS Basic Text. The registration for the Fifth Edition is now pending.

It has come to our attention that you may have been printing and/or distributing a version of the copyrighted Basic Text, including unauthorized duplications of the NA Fellowship's trademark to include the totally false legend that the version being distributed is "Fellowship" approved. These actions violate the NA Fellowship's rights under both Title 35 and Titie 17 of the United States Code, as well as constitutes consumer fraud on the members of the Fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous, and unfair and diluting use of the registered marks.

IF YOU ARE OR HAVE AT ANY TIME ENGAGED IN THESE ACTIVITIES, YOU ARE HEREBY DIRECTED TO IMMEDIATELY CEASE AND DESIST IN ALL SUCH ACTIVITIES, as well as any other infringements that may have not yet been discovered. Please confirm by return letter that each and every infringement has ceased, and surrender the remaining infringements to this office.

Simply being a member of the Fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous does not give you, or any other member, the right to engage in unauthorized use of the marks or copyrights of the Fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous, or to falsely represent that approval has been granted to these materials.

We ask that you accurately complete, sign, date and return the enclosed response in the postage paid envelope provided. If we are in receipt of your immediate agreement in wnting that all further infringement and distribution of infringing items has ceased, we will consider this matter closed. If we do not receive your immediate and full cooperation, my client is prepared to institute litigation against you and your company to protect these properties from your misuse, as well as costs and attorneys lees. May I have your response within ten days of the date of this letter.

Very truly yours,
Theresa Wagner Middlebrook, for
WAGNER & MIDDLEBROOK

Response to cease and desist letter

This response is made by the following person or company:

Name _____

Address _____

_____

Please check the correct response:

_____ We have never printed any copies of the Basic Text.

_____ We have never distributed any copies of the Basic Text that consist

of the following: a light-blue paperback cover containing the first ten chapters of the Third Edition of N.A.'s Basic Text, replacing the material on Traditions Four and Nine with material from the Second Edition text

_____ We have printed copies of the Basic Text consisting of a light-blue paperback cover containing the first ten chapters of the Third Edition of N.A.'s Basic Text, replacing the material on Traditions Four and Nine with material from the Second Edition text, and agree to print or distribute this NO LONGER. Our inventory is _____ books at this time.

_____ We have sold, given away, or otherwise distributed printed copies of the Basic Text consisting of a light-blue paperback cover containing the first ten chapters of the Third Edition of N.A.'s Basic Text, replacing the material on Traditions Four and Nine with material from the Second Edition text, and agree to print or distribute this NO LONGER. Our inventory is _____ books at this time.

_____ Other response: _____

I declare under penalty of perjury that the foregoing is true and correct.

Signature and date

Printed name

This gross breach of trust on the part of the office backfired. The office was flooded with calls from addicts who felt violated, who demanded to know how this happened, some bomb threats even came in from people who's trust had been completely violated. Addresses of secretaries are only given to the WSO for fellowship communications, not to be threatened by a lawyers. Many good addicts felt so violated that they completely dropped out of service, some completely out of N.A because their trust could never be restored.

The outcry from addicts was so loud, that an emergency meeting had to be called on what to do. Knowing that they would host this meeting without the presence of Billy A., Carl Deal and Grateful Dave, the marked (we wanted the office to go after these men so we made it appear they were the only ones so they would be targeted), men were rushed to get on planes to appear at this meeting. (What the office did was notify them of this meeting, and that they could appear if they wanted to, but only gave 24 hours notice. Thinking they couldn't get flights and didn't have the money for a flight with no advance purchase, they felt safe they wouldn't show, but they could say they invited them. However, we had money waiting, but could only get a flight in time out for Dave.)

I was pregnant at this time and still "under cover". I asked if I could sit in on this meeting for "historical" purposes, to which the emergency meeting of the Board of Directors, the Board of Trustees, the Executive Director and Theresa Middlebrook had called. Dave got there five minutes into the meeting and shocked the hell out of everyone. I was sitting there about six months pregnant, so I think this meeting was in November or December of 1990 (my daughter was born March of 1991).

The office demanded that he cease from the printing of the baby blue, and the advocating of not sending money to the office, and threatened to sue if he continued. We couldn't make it look too easy, and I must admit Dave was a

wonderful actor that day. He started to appear scared and acted like he wanted to comply, but then at the last minute (they literally had the contract in front of him and handed him a pen) he got up and said "I'll never give up".

At this time, as far as I know anyway, the WSO people I spoke of at this meeting, except for one man, a supposed trusted friend of Dave's whom we had thought was part of the rebellion up until this point and on our side, who was a Board of Trustee, and at this meeting, all did not know Dave had AIDS and was dying. He still looked well, and we went to great trouble to conceal that fact. We felt if they knew, they would concentrate on suing only him, jerking the lawsuit around until he died, and then claim victory. We had only found out about Dave's disease a few months prior, well after our plans had been mapped out. We were rushing for time now.

After Dave left and was being taken back to the airport, it was announced that Dave had AIDS to the group by this person. Then the sharks smelled blood. A horrible fight broke out in this room whereby I blew my cover. They decided to sue Dave right then and there. I was recording the whole meeting, so I asked them if they had to get the fellowship's permission to hire the lawyers and pursue this action. They said "what they don't know won't hurt them" basically, that they were not going to continue to lose money behind this rebellion and that they were going to make an example out of Dave.

I pulled out the tape and told them what I'd been doing. I also told them that I would let the fellowship know how lightly they spent their money, especially when it came to suing sick fellow members who were trying to stop this hostile takeover of our copyrights, literature and money.

One BOD, got up in my face and said that "Fine, if I can't use the fellowships money without a conscience to pursue this case, I'll put up the money out of my own pocket". I checked our treasury report, and again, another promise was not kept as the WSO did pay for this lawsuit. But I bet you don't remember voting on this, do you?

A case for copyright infringement was filed in Federal Court naming Dave Morehead as the defendant, with the World Service Office as plaintiff. The case was filed in Philadelphia, Pennsylvania in 1991, I'm not sure what month. The other printers of the baby blue were conspiciously not named as defendants, probably because they were strong, and had money and personal lawyers to back them. We tried to add the other men's names to the lawsuits as defendants, but this motion was denied.

At the last minute, the lawyer who was a part of the fellowship who had agreed to "take Dave all the way in court" as his lawyer over this matter, chickened out at becoming the named lawyer for a defendant in a case like this. I talked to him myself for over two hours trying to convince him he couldn't back out at the last minute like this, but he wouldn't stop crying. Of course, he had to back out two days before the court hearing, and no one had the money to hire another lawyer on a federal case like this at the last minute.

So I got busy in the law library, and we tracked down every lawyer in the fellowship we could. I got together all the legal research I could for Dave, and despite the fact I was in California and he was in Philly, I, and other addicts, managed to get him as prepared as any "in pro per" defendant could be. N.A. had a tough lawyer (when I called him to discuss the case, he just said "See you in court" and hung up on me!), but Dave insisted that with God and spiritual principles behind us, it didn't matter.

We all felt this sinking feeling like we were all screwed. Here's this sick and broke lonely addict going into a federal court to fight slick, high-powered attorneys, on behalf of all of us of which most of us don't even know he's on our side (but that's okay, he knew that, but loved N.A. so much he was willing to put everything he had into this fight). I had just had a baby and was in and out of the hospital, certainly in no position to fly out even for moral support, so all most of us could do was wait by the phone.

To put the lawsuit into a nutshell, without going into all the ins and outs, (you can order copies of the court records if you want to see the blow by blow for yourself), the judge ruled in Dave/our favor. It was a slam dunk. The judge didn't even have a question.

Bo Sewell was the first World Literature Chairperson, i.e., the man who coordinated our first Basic Text. He made it clear that when the book was written, the copyrights were put in the name of the members/fellowship, NOT THE OFFICE so that no one person or company would own this book. The copyrights the office held were merely trusts so that they had the legal right to print and distribute the book ONLY. Bo also made it clear that the copyrights were only released by them to the fellowship under the assurance that no one would own the copyrights at any time. (For more on this, check out the History of the Basic Text by Bo at http://www.bosewell.com.)

Since we produced the copyright papers that backed this up in court, the judge saw it clearly that no copyright infringement could be performed by a man who technically had the right to them (the copyrights were in the members' names, and Dave as a member had the right to reprint literature without restriction, and that WSO had no right to restrict his use of the literature).

A settlement hearing was held. Dave told WSO what he wanted in order to settle the lawsuit, and to stop printing baby blues, and promoting non_donations to the WSO. What he wanted is (1) to resubmit the Basic Text back to the group conscience process where control of it could not be wrestled away by these men, and (2) that the copyrights remain in the name of the fellowship where they could also not control our literature, (3) we wanted Bob Stone out of office.

An order was issued to resubmit the Basic Text for a fellowship group conscience process at the WSC floor I think in 1991 or 1992, I'm not sure what year because by this time we had other fires to put out and were scrambling to keep up. The order clearly stated that the book was to be given back to the group conscience process at WSC that year _ WITHOUT COMMENT OR VOTE.

Three of us were able to be there at WSC with a copy of the order in our hands to ensure that the order was complied with. I won't say who and break his anonymity, but the man ordered to submit this order without comment, broke out at the microphone with a whole line of BS about this issue at WSC. He started whipping up the crowd saying "it'll cost $52,000 to resubmit this book, and you don't want to spend this kind of money simply on one kooky addict's fanatism now do you?" While the others there who knew about the order, and all of the facts, including myself, struggled to protest, the microphones were all being controlled by office members. Then when they had what they wanted _ they adjourned.

We were left running around waving papers in our hands at passerby addicts like we were lunatics. Talk about feeling like you've been run over by a train. We decided to retreat, and sue for contempt of court on the order. Granted, we didn't do the most perfect job on this fight because (1) some of us were sick, (2) some of us were broke, (3) some of us were going through a divorce, and/or raising young children, working, etc., and (4) we were scattered all over the U.S. On top of all of these handicaps, we had other fires raging that we were trying to put out also:

1. They took over the copyrights while we were in court: All the time we were in court over the baby blue, the WSO had rewritten the bylaws of WSO, and reapplied for trademarks and copyrights in their name and under their control. Our lawsuit pointed out their vulerability which they were going to make sure they cinched up as fast as possible.

We didn't have the ability to put a restriction on them while they were doing this because we were not only fighting the lawsuit, but fighting the concepts that suddenly were thrown out at us.
Our "moles" still on the inside were smuggling the new documents taking control of our literature's copyrights out to us as they came, and they were coming in a hurry. Why smuggle? Do you know of any area, region or group, who received copies of these applications as they were flying out to change the copyright status? No one outside the office saw these things until AFTER they had been filed. We couldn't contest the copyrights being changed, because we honestly felt that once the order was issued on WSO, that everything would be put back in order. We were wrong.

2. The Concept Push: They knew that the fellowship would rebel once they knew the office had lost the lawsuit. In early 1991, I remembered them talking about trying to get these concepts approved and out in a hurry before the

lawsuit came back. This way they could have the people in voting position that were stacked in their favor.

They decided to have the meeting whereby the decision to submit the concepts to the groups would be held at the Bonadventure Hotel in Downtown L.A. on a Friday afternoon. If you ever lived in L.A., you'd know this was a setup so that only their cronies would show up and vote. Ten of us who had voting rights (my cover was blown so I piled in the car too), took off work to make sure we were there. As they continued not to address us regarding discussion of the concepts, we became angry and demanded to be heard. Security was called and ten of us were escorted out of the hall. I was eight months pregnant at the time.

The vote was held while we were out of the room. Then we were allowed back in. We demanded to see if the minutes showed we had been thrown out during the vote, and for a recount. They said the meeting was over and adjourned. One poor woman felt sorry for me and told me there was one more meeting before it would become final to submit the concepts to the groups over in Santa Monica. All of us attended that meeting, but were told we could not address the floor, discuss the issue, or vote in any way because we were not servants in their area (since when is an addict not allowed to vote his concerns over something as important as this?).

Too Tired To Fight

Finally, I have to admit that all the stress got to me. The fact that Dave died, and the judge would not allow us to substitute defendants for him, and his informing us we would have to sue them (which I already said above would not put us in a position to win), that they seemed to be pushing the concepts so well onto unsuspecting newcomers or those with a need for power who knew better, and that the WSO's propaganda machine seemed to be well tuned by now, was more than I could bear. Books started churning out of the office, step workbooks (just like the ones they needed for the treatment center funding) were announced, and I admit totally that I just gave up. While Bob Stone did leave office, the other three men who were behind him are still in our service structure pulling strings.

I decided to remarry, and move out of state, completely dropping out of N.A. service forever. How can you fight Big Brother part time on a single mom's salary when everyone who won't take the time to look at the evidence thinks you're crazy? Why bother anymore with N.A. I wondered? I'm clean, so screw you all right?

I didn't go to meetings for three years. I stayed in contact with my sponsor and other addicts with double digit time who understood how I felt, because many of them too had thrown in the towel and gone into almost isolation so the pain wouldn't be felt.

Finally my sponsor lowered the boom. He told me to get more involved, or find another sponsor. I was living in a very rural area at the time with no N.A. meetings for at least a hundred miles, so I decided it was easier to move.

I moved to an area where no one knew my background, nor anything about the controversy over the last ten years. I was asked to GSR a meeting, and did so like I thought was always done. I hadn't realized that the fellowship I once knew like the back of my hand, had changed so drastically in the last three years. I attended the General Assembly last week, on April 19th, and haven't been able to sleep since.

I'm not shouting "fire" in a theatre _ the theatre is on fire. Let me take just a few points addressed in Theresa Middlebrook's letter that went out to the Transition Group for the World Service Conference Group just recently:

1. Please note her letter only addresses the legal aspects of this merger, not our traditions, or our fellowship's best interests. I must add it's also slanted. She's been in on the plan to merge this fellowship since 1990. She's been at the same meetings I have and I can guarantee you on my recovery that there's more to what she's saying here than what

she's saying. This letter is pure propaganda to make you think this merger is harmless _ when it isn't.

TRADITIONS VIOLATION _ An N.A. Group ought never endorse, finance, or lend the N.A. name to any RELATED FACILITY OR OUTSIDE ENTERPRISE , lest problems of money, property and prestige divert us from our primary purpose.

The World Service Office is not a group, nor is it Narcotics Anonymous. It is truly an outside enterprise. Their primary purpose is not ours, and money, property and prestige does divert them from OUR primary purpose. Any organization that feels $50,000 for Fed Ex letters to private members addresses threatening them with a lawsuit for not complying with a copyright they didn't even legally have is not someone we should lend OUR name to. The WSO bylaws state that they are purely a business office, and not us. How can we put our name on them?

If it's not a traditions violation, then why does A.A. not call their General Service Office the Alcoholics Anonymous General Service Office in the phone book and in their incorporation papers? Call information in New York and you'll find that even the great A.A., whom we are supposed to be modeling our concepts after, does not list the General Office as the A.A. General Office. I have copies of their incorporation papers, which do not have the A.A. name on them.

2. She talks about the "impact of not spending $21,000 to update the trademark registrations" should this name change be approved. Who is the heck is going to use our name, initials, etc., but us? This is not to protect us, but to give them power to go after others who don't go along with their wishes.
3. It's said that Charles Ross of Thomas Harvey researched how we did business, and "concluded that only one entity was needed" for both corporations. Is Mr. Ross an addict? When he made this decision, did he consider our traditions? Who makes up the boards on these corporations? While the Convention is part of our fellowship, the office isn't. A fact I don't believe was an accident that it wasn't addressed. Who decides how the money is spent on both boards? Where does the money go?

This is the plan I heard being made to have the WSO take over the convention money over nine years ago come to life. DON'T FALL FOR IT!

4. Catch this "avoided would be the need for new bank accounts, an extra set of returns, new permits, new contracts", etc. The convention is set up as a "for profit" so that an itemized tax return is filed so all can see what was raised and spent, and because items are sold retail, thus meaning sales tax has to be accounted for and paid out. The separate bank account is because different people are supposed to be signing on the accounts, and different people in control of them. WSO is a nonprofit organization, supposedly only selling literature to areas and regions for resale to groups. They ARE completely different organizations. DON'T LET THEM FOOL YOU INTO LETTING THE WOLF SIGN ON THE CHICKEN'S BANK ACCOUNT BY TELLING YOU IT'S SIMPLY TO "SAVE MONEY". This lawyer and this accountant are supposed to be on our side BUT THEY ARE NOT. What would you think of a man going through a divorce who used his wife's divorce lawyer to save money?

5. She says she doesn't want to address "language and procedural questions that were discussed and addressed in the past", and prefers to work with "people who were already familiar with the old WSO and bylaws". In other words, she wants to draw the wagons around and not let the outsiders peek in. There's some tough questions she doesn't want to answer here. There are language and procedural questions she simply doesn't want you to know about folks!

6. "A general provision is included requiring Board members to abide by the Twelve Traditions and the Twelve Concepts" which contradict each other. So if one says "do it" and the other says "don't do it", I guess this just gives them their pick doesn't it? Who calls it on opposite concepts?

7. "Great care was taken NOT to give the WSC the LEGAL power to direct the affairs of the corporation . . . ". This reminds me of a car I once bought. The salesman told me I had three days to bring the car back for a full refund if I was unhappy when I got it home. On the way home, the car blew up on the freeway. I towed the car back that day,

only to be told by the manager that I signed a contract stating that "all oral assurances were made void upon execution of the written contract if they were not included in the written contract". I contacted a lawyer who said basically that gives them the license to tell me anything they want to get me to sign, but gets them off the hook once I sign.
Here this woman is saying that we're supposed to combine the two boards where the fellowship is supposed to rule over "special employees", and give the "special employees" the right to tell the fellowship to go screw themselves if they don't want to follow their wishes or honor their judgement. Who's in charge then? How can it be us?

8. Don't miss this one folks _ "if giving the WSC the power to go to court to compel certain action was desired . . . " Okay _ let's take away all possible rights of remedy for an out of control board. They don't have to listen to us on a polite level, and if we feel they're too out of hand and feel forced to take them to court, they want to make sure we have no legally enforceable power.

HOW CAN THEY BE DIRECTLY RESPONSIBLE TO US, WHO THEY SERVE, IF WE CAN'T CONTROL, DIRECT OR STOP THEM EXCEPT WHEN THEY "FEEL LIKE" IT IS IN THEIR BEST INTEREST"?

9. Don't be scared by her threat of "economic disaster" that could put their corporate assets at risk. The office and the N.A. literature are two separate items. It's the office that can make bad financial decisions, and that could be sued, not the fellowship. Therefore, the only one liable for a bad business decision, "as is" is the office, not our literature, trademarks, etc. By entwining us with them, that makes us responsible for their debts. In other words, they're trying to say they want to protect us, but what they're doing is putting our literature, properties and copyrights up as their collateral. GUYS, WE'VE GOT TO BRING IN AN INDEPENDENT LAWYER OF OUR OWN BEFORE THIS GETS OUT OF HAND ANY FURTHER!

There is doubt as to who Narcotics Anonymous is in a court's mind. Certainly enough that Dave won his lawsuit hands down against the office, the propaganda machine, and high powered attorneys. They've scrambled to try to make themselves N.A. ever since, so that there is no more doubt in a judge's mind should this ever go to trial again, and it might. They're telling you this is to protect you, but it's really to protect them and leave us vulnerable.

The copyrights to our Basic Text were given to a trust to our fellowship, and only given away from their authors under those assurances. While Dave was fighting it out in court, they scrambled and changed all the paperwork around to protect their position, and assume control of the copyrights WITHOUT TAKING A FELLOWSHIP CONSCIENCE ON THIS ISSUE. If I'm wrong, did you personally ever vote on whether or not to take the copyrights out of the fellowship's name, and put them into the World Service Office's name? I didn't think so.

These copyrights are no longer in the fellowship's name, and the literature is being altered without the author's consent, nor with the fellowship's group conscience consent. This means that as it stands, the copyrights to the Basic Text are in the office's name under false pretenses, and were taken away from their rightful owners by fraud.

They are the ones vulnerable to a lawsuit, and they are still scrambling to protect themselves as we speak. This push to change their name to "Narcotics Anonymous" might be viewed as a judge as them being Narcotics Anonymous, and having a right to the copyrights.

THE WORLD SERVICE OFFICE IS NOT NARCOTICS ANONYMOUS. They are not a fellowship of men and women, and are not under our direct control. They do not follow our orders, and as expressed in this letter addressed to the conference attendees, they don&#0

Chapter Sixteen

The Vocal Minority

During the 1980's a term was developed to describe, altogether, the people who read all the minutes, reports and were often participants in events that involved the founding of the NA Fellowship - expanded from an idea into a reality based in freshly written literature. They were totally unafraid and would speak up loudly if there were breaches of policy at WSO or anywhere in our service structure. In the beauty of hindsight, it appears that these fine members who stayed up on the mail, made copies of key documents and reports, drove thousands of miles a year to attend service workshops and conferences as well as the usual conventions of NA - these members we considered out of line and simply negative. Since they spoke up when things were done in violation of our written, approved, service structure and our 12 Traditions, those uninformed members who were committing the violations felt less than generous towards their concerns. The fact that the WSO manager and later executive director, Bob Stone, was not an addict made it easy for him to see these members simply as malcontents who jumped at an opportunity to attack someone for a real or imaginary violation. It was one of those strange times in history where a smaller group builds on the basic ideas and principles of a program and thereby moves in advance of the main body to conclusions that would only appear to the greater body in hindsight.

You have to wonder if they had numbered tens of thousands instead of only thousands, what would they have been called? The "Vocal Members?" Of course they were vocal! They represented the part of our Fellowship who cared enough to deal with the mounting paperwork and very often were key figures in the growth and development of NA in the hundreds of new communities emerging in the 1980's. Many of these treasured members are still in recovery and can be approached in one on one settings.

To do them justice, we need to consider:

1) what they were concerned about from WSC minutes and other sources,

2) how their concerns were brushed aside, often as a result of deliberately inaccurate or misleading information from World Services and

3) where they are today.

Of course, many are dead from addiction. They lost hope and fell by the wayside. Many just drew back from the source of their pain. When an organization breaks its own rules, members of good character and honorable disposition simply withdraw. We lost many of the finest members in our history to disorders that even now have not been factually resolved. Many of us did not fall by the wayside and found ways to stay active in NA with or without the structural involvement that characterized our early years. We are honored to witness their courage and dedication.

One of the most obvious instances of breaches of protocol is voting irregularities. These are most simply examined by considering the status of abstentions. In some voting bodies, there is a quorum of a set number based on participating groups or areas. Let's say this number is twenty-seven. If simply motions are based on passing by simple majority, the vote would have to be fourteen to carry. If several participants were unable to attend or had to leave the assembly early, the number could drop to say, twenty-five. Then a majority would be thirteen. But if several members were unclear on the motion the might choose to abstain from voting while still willing to abide by the vote pro or con. Let's say four of our participating group of twenty-five abstain. Now, passage would require eleven votes. The problem comes when some policies count abstentions as 'no' votes. Out of a number of twenty-five, they insist that it takes thirteen for a motion to carry, eleven is too few for the motion to carry where twenty-five members are present. So, in effect the abstentions are given the value of a no vote because the required number of votes to pass a motion is based on members present instead of members voting for or against the motion. This seems simple enough until a situation occurs where the policy is set one way and the chairperson rules that passage requires a majority of members present, not members voting.

Now, some members feel that the right to abstain includes that their vote is not counted either way, as a yes or a no. When this item comes up, there is a strong push to carry the motion on the part of members supporting the motion. Pushing past the rules by which the body ordinarily governs itself is a breach of policy and indicates disunity among voting members.

In general, a chairperson in a spiritual fellowship would either carry forward voting to the next session or at least extend discussion prior to calling for a vote. This allows members to think the item through more carefully. Opposition can state their concerns in more details. Supporters can explain their position more clearly. By the time the voting takes place, there should be a degree of certainty that not only the members voting are satisfied, they are prepared to explain their position to the members to whom they are directly responsible.

[July 29, 2004]

Chapter Seventeen

Twelve Concepts

"The Twelve Concepts are the greatest threat to the NA Twelve Traditions ever."

Con-Saps

It requires a period of study to comprehend what happened and comparison with the AA 12 Concepts gives the reader a quick basis for comparison. The Concepts should be clear and useful, not lending themselves, as they do, to intrigue and advantage over members not familiar with them. The Right to Redress for instance, implies that redress will somehow open up the minds and hearts of a group of members who has just taken a negative position towards an individual or their actions. Actually, this should rarely, if ever happen in a spiritual setting. If it does happen, by definition, the setting is not spiritual. So, it has the effect of approving bad behavior by the group. Most frequenly, what I hear and agree with is that a group that has just stomped on somebody, is usually ready to do it again and doesn't particularly care to re-examine the case.

[The following article was originally drawn from a member who was concerned and creatively thoughtful. - Ed]

CON - SAPS

con (kon), adv. [contr. <L. contra, against], against; in opposition: as, they argued the matter pro and con. n. an argument, reason, vote, person, etc. in opposition.
con (kon), v.t. [conned (kond), conning], [earlier cond <me. conduen, to conduct; OFr. conduire; L. conducere; see conduct], to direct the course of (a vessel).
con (kon), adi. [Slang], confidence: as, a con man. Vt. [conned (kond), conning], [Slang] to swindle (a victim) by first gaining his confidence.

sap (sap), n. 1. the juice which circulates through a plant, especially a woody plant, bearing water, food, etc. to the tissues. 2. Any fluid considered vital to the life or health of an organism. 3. vigor; energy; vitality. 4. sapwood. 5. [< dial. sapskull & saphead], [Slang], a stupid person; fool. vt. [sapped (sapt), sapping], to drain of sap.
sap (sap), n. [OFr. sappe < the v.], an extended, narrow trench for approaching or undermining an enemy position or besieged place. v.t. [sapped (sapt), sapping], 1. to undermine by digging away foundations; dig beneath. 2. to undermine in any

> way; weaken; exhaust; devitalize. v.i. 1. to dig saps. 2. to approach an enemy's position by saps.--SYN. see weaken.

Concerning the "Twelve Concepts for Service" no real study has yet been made either by we Traditionalists or (we would say) by the current structure. Some of us would say this alone is a good argument against them. This is one addict's perspective. You will no doubt see more from others in the coming months and there are doubtless others with greater knowledge than I. During most of NA's history I was not here; I was busy (down at the dope house). I am an inheritor of the present situation.

Going all the way back there have always been two schools of thought, if you will - one that believed in greater administrative control or a more business oriented approach to the development of our Fellowship, and the other which opposed this, basing themselves (we believe) more strictly (or literally) on our Traditions. Viewed in this way the last 10 years can be seen as a protracted trouncing of one school of thought over the other, culminating, it seems today, in the adoption of the Concepts.
Once upon a time "NA as such" was the Groups and the Traditions were their non-negotiable and only guidelines. The service structure was built to serve only and was defined outside of NA. Groups (NA as such) and service boards or committees were understood to be distinctly different entities. All we knew about authority was contained in the 2nd Tradition: defined on the Group. All we knew about service boards or committees was contained in the 9th Tradition: we (the Group[s]) may create them and they must be directly responsible to those they serve (again, the Groups).

It is interesting to reflect upon the phrase "directly responsible". This section of our non-negotiable guidelines might just have easily read, "in some manner responsible to" or "through a representative system, indirectly responsible to" or "directly" could have been left out altogether to leave more room for "trust". It was not, of course.
Viewed in this manner the Traditions "add up" and hang together as a cohesive set. Viewed otherwise they give rise to more ambiguity than answers. Questions raised over the years have included: If our Traditions are only about Groups, does this mean service boards or committees may go ahead and freely violate Traditions? If the service structure has a Fifth Tradition (the current supreme raison d'etat) why does it not also have a Seventh Tradition? Can our services function without their own set of guidelines? How can our services function in an effective and timely manner if every decision must go back to the Groups?

As you no doubt know, the lines in our Text which defined the service structure outside of NA, forbidding them to rule, censor, decide, or dictate, and guaranteeing to the Groups the right to use or not use such services were deleted under scandalous circumstances. It has been said that "they deleted the lines that prevented them from deleting the lines."

Efforts to come to terms with some of the above questions, and perhaps ultimately, "If the service structure is not NA then what is it?" gave rise a few years ago to a proposed Twelve Precepts for Service. This was written by a Trustee and circulated on a small scale for feedback. A later

version seems much more sympathetic to the "authority" of the structure. We can guess where most of his feedback came from.
With the printing of the Baby Blue in 1990 by autonomous NA Groups and the willingness of one member to become a spokesperson and focal point, these issues were rescued from oblivion and the syndrome of "a lie repeated often enough will become accepted". There came a frantic effort to hush up, cover up, clean up, approve retroactively and anticipate the next moves of this insignificant "handful" of trouble-making members (often called non-members). When I look back at the World Service Conference Reports for 1990-93 it looks like 3/4 of it is thus motivated. It was in this context and atmosphere that the Concepts were hastily approved at the World Service Conference. The first Concept seems to imply that our right to create a service structure began and ended with the one, now only “Approved" one. Given that service boards or committees continue to be created by service boards or committees constantly, (isn't the solution found by bureaucracy to bureaucratic problems always to create more bureaucracy?) it would appear that possession of this right has "changed hands". Another Concept says that grievances should be heard. It offers no further recourse or guarantee. Thus "let's just take him out in the parking lot and kick his ass" (an infamous WSO quote from 1991) might have to be, "let's give him 1 minute to talk then take him out in the parking lot and kick his ass" - a far cry from ideals such as freedom, autonomy and a Loving God.

Another Concept seems to define Group Conscience as decision-making without votes. Its always seemed to me that a better word for this is consensus. Many of us feel that this is the preferred way of deciding things as a Group. The problem is that the Concepts do not define Group Conscience on the Group(!), thus retroactively approving what has always been the practice in many places - the practice of decision-making by service boards or committees: Hence, 'The RSO BOD took a Group Conscience and decided that...". We have seen this kind of confusing use of our language more and more lately (This is in fact, along with the name "Concepts", A.A. language). And a Fellowship filling up with addicts who weren't here a year ago would seem now to find an against-all-odds chance for clarity...

Another Concept gives servants charged with carrying out decisions a right to "full participation" in those decisions. In practice, this is the legitimization of "administrative" or "add-in" votes. The original structure where only GSR's voted in ASC's, only ASR's voted in RSC's, and only RSR's voted at the WSC kept Group Conscience and thus decision-making defined on the Group. "Carrying conscience" is probably another bit of our terminology that will soon cease to have meaning. At each level approximately one-third of votes are cast by committee vice-chairs, offices, treasurers, subcommittee chairs, etc., who are carrying no conscience from any Group or Groups and naturally tend to have an administrative perspective or a vested interest, if you will. We say that in this manner the Ultimate Authority is diluted or corrupted along the way. The fact that this was the practice at the WSC as well as many RSC's and ASC's prior to the approval of the Concepts means that this historic transferal of decision-making power from the Groups to the service structure was legitimized without the approval of the Groups (do you remember your Home Group's decision on this one?). Or we could say that they delegated themselves the

authority to delegate themselves the authority.

[end of article]

[July 29, 2004]

Chapter Eighteen

Political Correctness

"Political Correctness. What is it and how does it affect Narcotics Anonymous? Should it be a part of the discussion? Is it a myth or reality?"

"All liars believe everyone lies,
All thieves believe everyone steals."

Those in power can not believe we work without desire for political power,
Those with money can not believe we work without thought of gain,
Those who stand on others can not believe we seek to elevate the member and not ourselves.
Those who believe in no Higher Power cannot comprehend
we trust Spirit to guide and build as needed.

The real NA is the caring and the sharing. All else is stage setting. Were we to grow large in worldly terms and lose our simple message of hope, we would have to make another program.

from New Webster's Dictionary 1997 Edition: 1) political---adj---of or pertaining to politics 2) politic---adj---shrewdly judicious in support of an aim 3) correct---v.t.---to put right//to remove faults from//to admonish, reprove//to adjust ---adj--- true//accurate//conventional	*from Marriam-Webster Dictionary 1990 Edition* 1) political correctness ---n--- conformity to a belief that language and practices which could offend political sensibilities should be eliminated.

The case for breaking the bounds of political correctness has its roots in the study of the above definitions. We as a fellowship have fallen into the trap of allowing a select few in power to dictate how the vast majority are to conduct themselves. This began as an effort to expand and improve our World Service Office. It is just human nature that people who feel they are at the center will try to dominate and control. It is part of our spiritual nature to resist control. Surrender is a different matter. The part of the definition that most applies to our case in recent NA history is from the practices that have been eliminated. The political sensibilities of the power structure are always offended when strong members voice their opinions and demand full participation rights for the Fellowship.

The power structure that has evolved in NA has a strong incentive to push political correctness for they know that the less there is of a free and open exchange of ideas the more chances they have to remain in power. This may be due to poor hiring practices or the general influx of people drawn from a business community that thrives on such practices. Our 'special relationship' as addicts seeking recovery is likely seen as a tactic or control ploy to outsiders. The power structure is able to manipulate the Fellowship by keeping it uninformed of its true desires. They will put out bulletins that are self-serving. They will control the agenda at the WSC. They will allow their CAR motions to have a full intent attached to it but not a motion from a region. They will have literature published that the entire fellowship has not seen much less heard about. They will conduct secret meetings that affect the Fellowship as a whole. They would deem those who will not stoop to such tactics as idealistic and inexperienced. They expect no one to question anything they do. To do so would be wrong since they know what is best. And of course, no one brings up a conflict of interests between "us and them" – it would be politically incorrect!

List of assertions

- Whatever happens, our common welfare comes first. The comings and goings of world service

is small compared to the multitude of NA members staying clean, helping others and opening the meetings all over the world every night.

- Twelve Traditions make it clear that leaders should do so by power of example, not position of perceived power or unwarranted authority.
- The Will of a Loving God is expressed through group conscience, not a service board or committee.
- The NA name is never given to an outside organization. This is to make clear the special position of NA in the hearts of its members and to prevent certain disorders including attempts to 'control' what members say and think.

One member shares:

I remember the the 1st stirrings of hope coming from the experience strength and hope of addicts shared without regard to the judgments of others. To hear an addict speak passionately about the degradations of their disease, the miracle of recovery, and the day to day footwork of honesty, open-mindedness and the willingness to try that reached the last part of me that almost dared to believe in something again. Some of those addicts were colorful, or difficult, or just plain strange, but their heartfelt, genuine sharing led me to believe that if I just didn't use and kept it real, things might change. I was desperate enough to keep coming to meetings regardless of how i felt about myself or what i imagined people might think of me.

I remember hearing "your a member when you say you are" and thinking...the bastards cant throw me out, doesn't matter if no one approves of me, I'm staying. I was allowed to recover by addicts who valued honesty over conformity. As I gained some clean time, the temptation to compromise that primitive honesty by imitating what I thought others would approve of became an issue. I told my sponsor that I wanted to get involved with regional service, we talked a bit about my motivations for wanting to go from no service to regional service. Ego, prestige and artificial belonging were the motivating factors.

Never one to mince words, he told me, "Son, if you think your a big shot in NA, you've missed the whole point." He suggested I reach out to the folks at my home group that looked the most desperate, the newcomer that made folks feel uncomfortable (people like me!!!) Later he suggested I make coffee so I would be in place for those newcomers before and after the meetings. I have that as my foundation for service, so when I've served as a GSR, or meeting secretary or subcommittee chair its still about honesty and the newcomer. Political correctness is about not believing in the personal truth of recovery, it's a conformist action to protect oneself from the journey of self-discovery. It's a 'monkey see, monkey do' charade of the true process of recovery where difficult truths are arrived at and shared with each other. That's very uncomfortable stuff for corporate NA, it's messy, and impossible to control, but its real, and the sterile group-speak message of the 'me too' crowd will never be sufficient to invite an addict to live. Political correctness is a hollow hope. It's a message without spirit.

The question then is, "how do we take the political correctness out of the fellowship?" We do this, by this work and the voice of its collective writers, being broadcast over as wide an area as possible. We shed light on the power structure by getting the word out that there is another view. We stress that there are loyal NA members who have a different opinion. These members must be heard. We continue to publish new and exciting literature for the newcomer. We continue to make the literature accessible to the fellowship at cost or only slightly above cost.

We never let someone's political sensibilities be what defines how we share, what we share, where we share. As we grow to health through 12 Step recovery, we become free of defects that used to cloud our thinking and become capable of making good decisions. The true history of NA, which means all of the history of NA, good and bad, must be known throughout the Fellowship. This doesn't mean we are insensitive to our members or try to use high impact language at every chance, we just don't let business concerns enter into recovery concerns. This is most important in our written material.

For the Fellowship to grow and prosper, all members are entitled to a Fellowship where all ideas are heard. All members must have a voice that is strong in the selection of our leaders. These leaders must allow all opinions to be heard and to matter. Political correctness and the damage it has done must be eliminated or the Fellowship will continue to suffer the consequences and addicts will continue to die needlessly.

Central Office vs. World Wide Fellowship

It is perhaps helpful to demonstrate our understanding and appreciation of other viewpoints than our own. It might strengthen our concern for it to be clear that we have investigated what we consider shortsighted methods that leave most members out in the cold. The other side of the picture goes like this:

> The NA Fellowship has grown too large for group conscience to be an effective guide to action. Efficiency is best achieved by a small board with links to all parts of the Fellowship. Administrating the World Office, the NAWS, Inc. Board of Directors brings together the most experienced and able of the membership to take care of the business of NA. Members are not evenly informed and there is no practical way of doing this. Some members are getting clean and others are relapsing, making the idea of voting on real issues a dangerous undertaking. Instead of letting things rock along to inevitable disaster, a few brave members made solid plans to restructure world services. This would enable the Office to do its job without the endless parade of critical members and the necessity of presenting everything to an uninformed and loosely organized Fellowship. If we took on the job of providing informational material

to all the members who need it, we would never get any work done.

This view would be acceptable only if NA was going to abandon the Twelve Traditions and become a business. It may appear, "more book sales, more recovery" overlooking the effects of betraying the fellowship giving them despair instead of hope, robbing them of their allegiance and identification. It is like building the front of a house while burning the back. Helping people grow in knowledge of the spirit and the incredible beauty and power of a loving God is what NA is all about. And this is what takes NA way beyond to scope of a business operation. Good service should be seen and felt. WSO was planned to be our primary service center. It is hoped that the fascination with bigness will give way to something more wondrous as time goes by.

Another member shares:

> Many have often thought and shared with others the idea that "political correctness" is killing the fellowship of NA. Many members who have been around for over ten years have agreed with me. I have given it much thought and I am starting to think that when the WSO made its move to control the Fellowship, the idea of "politically correct thinking" invaded the fellowship. By this I mean that in today's Fellowship, where I live, we do not question anyone's motives. We go along to get along. We do not make waves. Anything goes in NA because of the 3rd Tradition. It is ok to use because relapse is ok; you can always come back. Not to sound like a conspiracy theorist but things are different today than 13 years ago.
>
> When I got clean, I was told to sit down and shut up as I had nothing to share about recovery and the men I was going to meetings with already knew how to get loaded. I was instructed on clarity of the message of NA. I was given stern warnings about 13th Stepping, both as predator and prey. I was made to do service as a greeter and butt can monitor. I was told to work the steps as my life depended on it. I was called on my foul language and on my foul behavior. It was pointed out to me that with membership in NA comes responsibility. All of this was just what was needed.
>
> Today, I do not see this happening. Maybe it is just out West here and this kind of Fellowship exists somewhere else. I get flack from those who would allow anything to happen in the rooms when I talk about leaving the newcomers alone to heal. I have been told all must share whatever as we can not dictate to others what recovery means, all the while as we hear about the hardship of someone's day in their warm treatment center. Do not get me wrong, treatment is tough but to hear about issues for six meetings running is a bit much. We dare not question what was handed down from ASC as it was voted on, even though no such vote was allowed to happen at group level. Service Wonders of six months ramming the down 12 Concepts down our throats because it has the NAWS logo on it can get to be heartbreaking when they will not listen to older members talking about the 12 Traditions being our only guide to service.

It is better to be informed than right. An informed person can listen, discuss, assimilate new information and can put to work what they have learned and studied to better deal with things that come up in life. A person who is merely right must assert themselves, appeal to authority figures,

evade specific questions and regard those who have a different viewpoint as the enemy and restrict their associations for fear of changing their minds. Political correctness is a substitute for morality.

Over the course of time, the Fellowship of NA has seen many changes. We started out as a small but committed group of addicts who could not find freedom in other places. We were told by other 12 Step programs we could not share about our drug use. We were thought of as unsavory characters who would always end up in prison. We had to deal with laws that in some states made coming together openly in a recovery meeting a crime. We were looked down upon. Out of this adversity arose the idea that there could be a place for addicts to come together to help one another. That idea was Narcotics Anonymous. In 1953 our Fellowship as we do not know it today was born. There were even earlier meetings of Narcotics Anonymous though opinions vary as to how much they might be like recovery today.

In the early years of NA we had very little to work with, other than bits and pieces of literature cobbled together from various parts of the country. We relied upon literature from another fellowship. It was of a specific nature that catered to a symptom of addiction. It did not deal directly with the nature of addiction. As such, it was inadequate for our needs as addicts. On the other hand our early members were real adamant about living a certain way. Recovery meant abstinence from all drugs. One drug was no different from another. We suffered from the disease of addiction and we could not expect to recover if we did not give up all drugs. Not only was this expected of members, it was driven home time and time again by the desire of our founders for NA to be a refuge where safety was paramount. Once you got to NA it was made clear that using was frowned upon. No drugs or paraphernalia was to be brought to meetings. We were to start to live as productive members of society, even if that just meant we would not be a risk to others at a meeting.

Our 8th Tradition warns us against submitting our recovery program to professionals.

> *8. Narcotics Anonymous should remain forever nonprofessional, but our Service Centers may employ special workers.*

Coupled with the 9th, we are further warned against 'organization,' and allowing our service boards to become autonomous. Bureaucracy has long been cited as the enemy of self-help organizations like ours.

> *9. NA, as such, ought never be organized; but we may create service boards or committees directly responsible to those they serve.*

When a few are given power over the many, tyranny is the natural result. Usually the tyrants don't think themselves so terrible, just the people who take issue with them and find fault with their failing to follow the process. The few seek to hold their power by listing those who agree as supporters and those who disagree as detractors. In the twist from spirituality to oligarchy, detractors become enemies. This is the part we cannot tolerate in NA. We are all in a state of progress recovery and if 'incorrect' people are not allowed to participate, they are not free to grow to a better understanding. In no case should sanctions be made against those who disagree – as it is their right, even duty, to disagree where occasion warrants. It is what makes our freedom reality. It is freedom that makes us responsible because clean we can see the results of our actions in time to head off trouble. NA is the self-correcting program. Without freedom and choice there is no real morality.

Tradition Wars: a pathway to peace

Fellowship Work in Progress - Not for Use in Meetings

"If you don't know history, you don't know anything."

- Edward Johnson, 1990

"I'm not interested in the future.

I'm interested in the future of the future." - Robert Doniger, 1996

The *Traditions War: a pathway to peace* is a history book and roadmap to the future. "Those who forget the past are doomed to repeat it." This is so true in our personal recovery and in the history of NA. We see this happening regularly in the Fellowship. Worse yet is that so few know our fellowship's history. The future is also given short shrift by our inability to see the big picture, as a Fellowship, in the decisions we make in the present.

Working the steps was a matter of life or death. Work the steps or die was to be heard many a time. 12 Step calls were done on a regular basis, even with the risk of being arrested for possession for entering a place where drugs could be found. Two or more addicts carrying the message to our most needy members was a staple of the Fellowship. This still happens today but not with much emphasis. We have ceded this function to Detox and Treatment Centers. It just is not convenient for most members to take time out of their day to carry the message outside the rooms or put someone on their couch to help them get started. Or so say.

A friend of Jimmy K shares:

> "The Traditions were what kept the Fellowship alive in our founder's mind. He knew that NA would not survive without a strict adherence to the Traditions. If Jimmy K. were alive today, would he recognize his Fellowship? I think not. He may see glimpses in places that adhere to the old ways, and he might recognize some familiar faces, grown older and more weathered. But the Fellowship he helped start would not be what he saw in the majority of the world today. The opposite of evolution is devolution. Devolution in the case of a spiritual fellowship might be called 'falling apart.' You can only depart from a winning formula so far without getting off track entirely."

Non-violent intimidation was valued because it got out attention. Many members first received their 12th Step with the words, "Sit down and shut up!" And they were right. We knew jack about staying clean. They knew how to stay clean, so we trusted them to show us how. If some of us that do remember what it was like don't keep those old school values alive they will surely DIE!!!

A member recalls what happened this way:

I guess the problems started around the same time as the Basic Text was being high jacked by bureaucrats who saw it as only a sales item and wished to control it. The Basic Text was called a 'cash cow' because it was the money that seemed important to them, not the loving, caring message. At that time several members were putting the finishing touches on our text by way of the World Service Conference Literature Committee. We all know the story of what happened next. It has been covered quite well in several places. What also happened to Narcotic Anonymous that does not get enough publicity is that Political Correctness entered into the Fellowship. This conclusion is reached by examining the after affects of the rise to power of the WSO.

Prior to the Basic Text controversy, the Fellowship was run through the Groups and committed members who had a desire to carry the message, our primary group purpose. After the Basic Text and Literature Review process was taken away from us in the latter half of the 1980's, several assumptions were formed by those in positions of power. One assumption was that no member could speak out against the power structure formulating within the WSO, let alone a large vocal protesting body of addicts. The ability and right to question decisions we had always made ourselves but had no voice in now was taken away from us and became the standard from which the power structure grew. This became the new corporate policy: "You will not question us and if you do we will brand you with a label to make you stand out as what is wrong with the Fellowship. Trouble makers, whiners, purists, and The Vocal Minority." All terms used to stop the questioning and scare those who would not stand up. Scare tactics, innuendo, lies, manipulation, fear, and illegal business practices became the coin of the realm for the power structure to control the Fellowship. This started the Fellowship down the path to Political Correctness that is helping to keep the addict who still suffers out there.

How many times have we seen members who had an idea to help the Fellowship progress beaten down by other members who did not want to see waves made? How long has it been since Groups banded together to fight for the right to self govern? How many times has an addict been told it is ok to keep on using after picking up yet another Welcome Chip? When was the last time someone shared in a meeting that newcomers needed to sit down and shut up and listen? When was the last time a speaker got fired up at a convention about how the 13th step kills? Can you remember the last time you heard "Work the Steps or die, M*****F****R!" in a meeting? When did nicety become an important issue as opposed to breaking through to people who needed to rethink their whole lives? These things do not seem to happen anymore for the most part. There was a good reason for putting people in their place, and there still is: ego deflation. I actually help someone by confronting their bullshit. Sometimes the only way to get through to some of the ignorant and dense slobs who walk through the doors and think they have a game or can run a game in the rooms ... is to give it to them raw. Ego deflation.

One "free thinking" NA member shares:

In my many years of experience the only ego God has directed me to deflate has been my own. I am grateful to Him for that. The members in this Fellowship I have accepted guidance from in that area have first displayed humility and understanding in their own lives. One of my friends I accept direction from tells me his idea of heaven is to perpetually be able to sit and visit with his friends. You might easily understand why he is a good friend. He enjoys my company and I enjoy his. When he gives me guidance he walks beside me. He does not stand behind me and shove or stand in front and pull. He treats me as an equal. I treat him and all my friends the same way. I regard everyone here I share with as my equal. When I forget that there are spiritual and emotional consequences I must pay.

Some folks on the other hand seem to thrive on being intimidated and shouted at by strangers. Millions flock every Sunday to be edified, chastised and fortified by a single man in a pulpit. This seems to have worked for the multitudes for ages. Personally, I don't want anyone telling me their foregone conclusions are the one and only truth. Admonishing me not to bother thinking for myself they have done that for me. Many of these shouters of the gospel try to push, pull and cajole the masses up the spiritual road of selflessness and ego-deflation without realizing they themselves are caught in the addiction of fundamentalism.

The paradox of this situation is that no man can teach the selflessness of ego deflation while practicing the very essence of egocentricity. My own ever growing understanding of ego deflation is this. I must allow another person their own joy of self discovery. The way and means I choose to pass on information or experience is
crucial if I am to remain as selfless as I possibly can be.

For instance if a first grade teacher were to walk into a room and say two plus two is four and will always be four you bunch of little uneducated twerps, that teacher would have failed her task miserably. The joy is in the journey of learning the process and realizing you have the talent to learn the process. As a personal choice if I am not willing to be a part of the entire process then I just don't say anything at all.

As for violating our Twelfth Tradition and expecting deferential treatment for any reason whatsoever, count me out. If I ever had reason to correct someone in a meeting for their form of sharing and another member corrected me for doing so I would defend my position with integrity or defer to their point of view. My length of time in the program has nothing to do with my spiritual condition for any particular twenty-four hour period. I have seen men with 25 years on the brink of suicide. I have seen men and women with many years relapse and die. H-O-W means the same thing today as it did the first day I walked in the door.

Being politically correct implies transience. I go to bed one night and the members of a certain race want to be called one thing. When I wake up they prefer to be called another. I blink my eyes and the members of the same sex are allowed to be legally married. Personally I could care less about that stuff. These are the whims of society. We are a Society or Fellowship of a spiritual nature. Our Steps are based on spiritual principles that are the same now as they were when man took his first breath and will remain the same until he takes his last.

I however, am not twenty-three anymore I am fifty. I do not run around shouting profanities in reference to The Steps and Traditions I have come to love and revere.
Here in Knoxville we still make sure our troublemakers get a sponsor and we allow the sponsor time to work with the new member. We call our members down only on the rarest of occasions. For the most part we once again rely on the member's sponsor that needs correcting to do the correcting.

I do know my sponsor and I have started a new FG meeting, hosted workshops together, co-hosted a literature conference, attended an out of state service workshop, hit a couple hundred meetings and are planning another conference. This is just in the last year. He has been asked to speak at a history conference in Texas and I have been asked to expound upon our Ninth Tradition here at the largest group in our area. I am the GSR of my group and am active with my H&I committee. I am the co- panel leader of a recently started jail meeting in a county adjacent to mine.

I'm not saying all this to brag on myself. I say this to make a point. I am the best member of NA that I know how to be. I am a serious and informed member of this Fellowship. I want to do my best to lead by example. I can not browbeat or guilt trip another person into loving this Fellowship the way I do. I cannot encourage another suffering addict to share the joy of a

relationship with a loving God and be of service to his fellow by behaving in an immature and arrogant fashion. I must behave in a confident but humble way. I must be a man of conviction with a sense of direction.

I have that conviction. I have that direction. Let the mendacity of the past speak for itself. Let the current errors be as they may. Each of us as convicted members has the opportunity to practice to our best ability the timeless spiritual principles that made our recovery possible. We can choose to pass it along or not pass it along to another suffering addict. The closer my walk with the God of my understanding the better job I will do in sharing the message. A simple attitude of equality and humility is of the utmost importance in doing this. This is the heart and the spirit of our Twelfth Tradition.

Another area where Political Correctness has hurt the Fellowship is around a lack of knowledge of the true meaning of the 7th Tradition. We use dances, picnics, and Unity Days to support our areas. We do this because we do not hold Groups accountable financially for the Service bodies they have formed in their name. We have become complacent in demanding that we support ourselves and let events do the work the Groups should be doing themselves. Anyone who questions this is out of touch with the reality of the world we live in. This is thought control in action. That reality was brought on by an attitude of laziness which gets it's most glaring example from the bottom of the pyramid that is the NA Service structure. When the WSO sells our Literature for their support, anyone paying attention realizes that they do not or will not live by the 7th Tradition and so the example is set. Yet to question this is just not done and has somehow been manifested as wrong because the Super Board and the Office must know what they are doing and we should be grateful they are doing it for us. All of those people have time in recovery and would never hurt the Fellowship or act in an unspiritual way.

To give a viewpoint that may be shared by many, we include this addict's statement without editing:

"I appreciate the enthusiasm and insights of all the post's on this subject. I was under the impression that the phrase "work the Steps or die mother fucker" was a statement used to voice ones own personal convictions. I always thought that when people said that they meant that's what they personally had to do. I understood that conviction, for that was the attitude I adopted in order to begin recovery.---Contrary to the basic text, I did come here to change my life.-------The first couple times I said it was to stop using, because I didn't trust any of you enough to tell you the truth, that I was scared and didn't know how to live hell I didn't even know I was scared an old timer had to point it out

"The last time I came to the rooms it was to change my life, stop using was a given. See it's not politically correct to say that. I almost always get chastised if I say that in a meeting, bet a few of you if you read that cringed.----Oh yes and it's politically correct in NA to say that the AA book catered to a symptom of addiction, and not the exact nature of when in all actuality the AA book is what NA had to begin with if it was good enough for JIMMY K. and I had an NA sponsor in 94"who had 30 something years who taught steps out of the AA book. We both used the clear cut directions.

"The statement that the AA book does not deal with the exact nature of addiction is foolish, misinformed and usually made by people who by there own prejudice are unwilling to really investigate what they are talking about and I guess it must give some small feeling of smug superiority - I don't remember ever hearing or reading about prejudice, close mindedness, or self-rightiousness being a spiritual principle. I did read a quote by Herbert Spencer that said --- "there is a principle which is bar against all information, which is proof against all arguments and which cannot fail to keep a man in everlasting ignorance--that principle is ---- contempt prior to investigation "----Just so you know I don't talk about AA in NA ---- Yes, we speak of spiritual principles.---I get a lot of people that come to me, that have been in and out some for years. They have all the answers, know everything about recovery and cant stay clean!

"Why is that? They have been told by well-intentioned members: "stay on the first step for a year." What the heck is that???? Whole group aplaudes for the relapser [God Bless them] picking up there 40th white key tag; pat'em on the ass and say oh it's all right. When did it become "all right" to get high in NA ???? OK keep coming back OK how about keep coming back and don't frickin' use in between call me here's my number. Get their number, I call a lot of new comers if they have a phone. Most aren't going to call you, they're too scared. Yes "empathy becomes a healing therapy for all addicted people." we do recover. It is politically correct in NA to say "well I was clean for 8 yrs relapsed and used for 5 yrs and now I've been clean for 3 yrs so I really have 16 yrs of recovery"---I don't know who taught them to add!

"Yes, clean time doesn't equal recovery but it's kind of part of the deal don't ya think?-----and on and on it goes----So when do we stop turning our back to the truth in the guise of love, compassion and tolerance.-----When does empathy become apathy !!???.--------As said earlier I don't need to be screaming at people, and everything is a fine line when working with addicts, -----but come on if all I do is go to meetings and nuthin' else the only thing I get is bad breath from to much coffee and a flat ass from hard chairs!!!!--------So how about the old Alanon saying 'if it is to be; let it begin with me" Yes they got it from somewhere but we got "just for today" from Alanon. How about sponsorship instead of lordship like one of our members wrote, "it takes time to explain to the newcomer." But people don't want to take the time; just tell them to go to 90 in 90 and stay on the first step bla bla bla and then you dont have to explain any thing I thought sponsorship was an obligation. ----- Since words carry the power to kill I must be always checking my motives with God and with sponsor. -------- At the same time I will call people on it and I will call bullshit, bullshit and I do speak about and directly address 13 step and other issues, it doesn't make me popular but at least I don't walkaway ashamed of myself for participation and approval by default, because I was to fucking spiritual and had to much "humility" to say anything about at the risk of, prestige. I don't remember a spiritual principle of being afraid of the simple truth. Walking the spirit path is not about being afraid to speak up for the truth. ----------and how do I put paragraphs on this thing.

Spiritual Unity

NA is a spiritual program of recovery from the disease of addiction following the 12 Steps from absolute

defeat to the ability to live spiritual principles. Political Correctness in nothing more than refusing to take a stand. We have to have a bias favoring spirituality. Trying not to offend or fear of being alienated for ones beliefs can work against us if we allow loud, self-seeking people to take charge of the meetings. Conflicts of interest can seriously disrupt the patterns of caring and sharing found in NA groups. Conflicts of interest push spirituality aside; there is always a conflict between the worldly and the spiritual. Sincerity and facing up to the truth are at the root of this thing called recovery. Acceptance without willingness to try something new is useless.

The Unity called for in the 1st Tradition has been another casualty of Political Correctness. It used to be the responsibility of each addict to take under his or her wing newcomers and start the education process of NA. The do's and don'ts of the Fellowship were explained. Clarity of the message of NA recovery was taught. Behavior that was deemed inappropriate by the groups was pointed out. Service work at its most basic levels, such as meeting greeter or butt-can monitor was usually not up for debate. You just were told to do it as service helps keep you clean. The women were told to stay with the women and the men were told to stay with the men. Members with time were severely admonished about leaving the cute newcomers alone so they could recover in peace. How we dressed, drove our cars, conducted ourselves in the parking lot, and what was expected of us when we went out for food after a meeting was part of the education process. Step work was encouraged as soon as we were able to focus enough to put pen to paper. In short we were all in this together.

Somewhere along the way all of this stopped being important to most. An 'anything goes' mentality arose. The 3rd Tradition became fragmented to only read from the first line. There is more to membership than just a desire to stop using. With membership comes responsibility. But it has become the norm to leave that out. We are told not to offend anyone by calling them on anything. The unity called for in the 1st Tradition is lost, they say, when we point out anything to anyone that used to be considered bad for the addict and bad for the Fellowship.

Sharing pain and concern, one member shares:

> "The subject of spiritual or moral values is in conflict with PC. What will we have if we say it is all ok. I am seeing the effect of this attitude reflected in the news and in some family members. It causes me reflect on what kind of society we will have in twenty years. When a child of four can calls their dad a punk and beats on everyone around with out fear of reprisal. Because it is not PC to spank or correct the child in the parents eyes. When people in the line at the store attack, kick, curse or take from another because it is not PC to be kind and have manners. It is the culmination of the me society. All about me. For me. About me. No morals, no spiritual center, no respect.
>
> "15 years ago I watched Bill B. leave a meeting in tears because of the disrespect of a newcomer. This guy said fuck the old-timers we don't need them. It is the essence of this attitude that is the problem. because it was not PC to stomp the shit out of the boy, Bill was harmed, and the newcomer tore our area apart and later used."

The whole question of what is morality for the fellowship is also something to be explored. We do not seek to impart a strict view that does not take into account a members personal opinion. None want a forced morality. Being a world wide fellowship, we as members come from a diverse set of societies, with member views shaped by the political, social, religious and/or secular climate we live in. To a

narrow perspective before such a multitude would be a potential devisive wedge.

We have an opportunity to once again allow the members to shape the future of the fellowship. It is our hope that a combination of spiritual principals with a morality component based on belief in the power of the NA message and the primary purpose of NA versus the whole political correctness attitude can bring a much deeper commitment to the fellowship and the addict who still suffers for all of us.

The attitude of 'everyone for themselves' has taken deep root in the Fellowship due to the example set, which became the way we do things, by the WSO all those years ago. There is an old spiritual saying, "As above, so below." that may apply here. It may not be intended yet it has built over the years. It happened so slowly that most did not notice. But examine these examples and others you can think of and draw your own conclusions.

This is not meant to be another conspiracy theory but a view of how things that do not seem to be related when taken together add up to another reason to take back the Fellowship to the Groups and members. A large percentage of our Fellowship has never known what this Fellowship was like before the taking of the Basic Text by the WSO. The old ways live in memory by a dwindling few. The Fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous is at stake and must be returned to it's rightful owners, us.

One member's experience:

> "Who's going be the ones to set the standard? What am I considering to be moral that you wouldn't. Who are you to tell me what my morals should be? Where would it become self-righteous? Didn't the WSO think they knew best for us.??? They might well have thought they were teaching us morals..??
>
> "Maybe we already have the way. The path has already been laid out. Could it be that we all as members need to be about the path and the application of these principles through the 12 Steps and the adherence to the 12 Traditions by each group and on up through the service structure.
>
> "Now I see newcomers get encouraged to chair meetings and become leaders and trusted servants before they could possibly have proven they have earned our trust and respect. I see newcomers get long-winded in meetings and too few seem to understand why this can actually harm the newcomer.
>
> "Some bleeding deacons as the old AAers called them might come in behind me and undermine and contradict something I said in order to help a new person get humble. A few years back at a Saturday noon JFT (Just For Today) meditation meeting a couple of men with seven or so years went to whining about their problems right after we read a meditation that had nothing to do with dumping. I stepped in and basically told them to grow up, and that what they were talking about had nothing to do with the topic of the meditation, or recovery for that matter.

The balance of the meeting consisted of big mouthed, big bottomed, big egoed women sharing that I was wrong because they could share about anything affecting their recovery.

”That meeting wasn't my home group and maybe it was merely a drama and trauma dump session, maybe it still is. Point is a couple of the women who came in behind me and controverted what I shared to the men had substantial clean time, and in the old days, out of respect for my time, they would have reinforced what I said, or said nothing. Hell, even 2 and 3 year wonders have the gall to come in behind old timers and tell the old timer he or she is wrong these days.

”Lack of ego deflation, obedience, discipline, and respect is hurting the fellowship. Course I'm way way past having any of the nonsense affect what I do or say. I figure if my motives are right, any barriers will be removed by who's in charge.”

The important thing for those who are not familiar with the term 'political correctness' is that it is not only deceptive and not true, it is something fabricated by a controlling group of a few administrators who take it on themselves to make rules - and reality - for others. It is deadening the the spirit. Spirited members come to be seen as threats to the status quo, as indeed they are, and should be!

A member of the former World Service Board of Trustees recalls:

“We have come a long ways in NA and I vividly recall saying, "You can't do that, it violates the trust bond with the people who built the Fellowship." The reaction was anything but spiritual. Because they were not there and knew nothing of the trust bonds I spoke of, they reacted as if I were making it up.

“Members used to strut around WSO in 1982 when they found a found a typo in the original Basic Text, unaware that any typos were generated by WSO typesetting the manuscript. Since the Lit Committee did not proof the type setting process, all that could be said was there were some original typos in the manuscript. Who would expect WSO to print typos.

“I remember in 1985 or so every year we had a new buzz word. The first year it was ‘inappropriate.’ Anything wrong or unsuitable to the WSO was deemed ‘inappropriate.’ It was hard for people to react to this word because they were not used to political correctness. You could say a phrase was ‘inappropriate’ and never hear of see it again – that year! Then legalistic terms like ‘dissembling’ to describe the lawyers habit of presenting a set of information as if it were complete, only leaving out certain key items to lend a false air of certainty to a proposition or declaration. As long as no one challenges, the argument is strengthened. Lawyers go to school to learn how to do this – and how to deal with it when it comes up. Addicts seeking to serve their Fellowship didn’t see this coming and it certainly wasn’t seen in any of the Conference materials at the time. Then came graduated information: dis-information, mis-information, misleading-information, inaccurate information. After this were some instances of black listing where WSO personnel allowed their personal presumptions to contribute to a list of members who were supposedly involved with the Baby Blue. Legalistic

> threatening documents were sent out to a large number of NA trusted servants instructing them to 'cease and desist' from distributing the Baby Blue versions of our Basic Text, *Narcotics Anonymous.* Curiously, many members receiving these documents knew nothing of the Baby Blue and reacted in horror. "NA goes to court" was a matter of some discussion among the many non-addicts who followed our progress from afar."

It is the blindness that comes at the center – an almost total lack of perspective. When you go from a volunteer system to a paid staff, you get some 'funny' shifts of emphasis. What is regarded as important changes. No longer is it important that the writing reflect the true experience of recovery of actual NA members. It becomes, "Who gets the credit? How will this affect my standing or that of my department." The basics of bureaucracy are in books at your public library, look under 'b.' It will shock you how ordinary and predictable our problems are.

Political correctness is a term made up to describe the 'official position' of bureaucrats trying the manage the thinking of a population. It is right up there with ethnic cleansing for murder of an ethnic population. Cleansing sounds better than stabbing, shooting, blowing up and genocide. Correctness sounds better than lying, cheating or massaging the truth advantageous to the managers. This is an outright violation of the letter and spirit of our Twelve Traditions – and a good example why we ought never lend the NA name to outside enterprises. Many addicts who experienced this crass intrusion to our spiritual Fellowship were so shocked and dismayed, they were unable to continue in recovery. There may be some hard-hearted people who thought these people just lacked strong programs of recovery. There are may witnesses who experienced these things alive today and through the writings in this book, their pain will not go unnoticed. It is our sincere hope that this book signals the end of such disorders.

Morality

Discussing matters of right and wrong could easily be misconstrued as a move to enforce morality on our Fellowship. Anyone who knows NA well will see that this is not likely to happen. We are a tribe of gypsies bound together by common cause and our need for recovery. If preachy, moralizing material is written, there is not much chance of it attaining a significant readership. The language in the Fellowship has always been spiritual principles.

Most of us understand that:

1. Morality has to do with right and wrong. I NA we utilize spiritual principles to guide us in situations where we don't otherwise know what to do.

2. Belief in a loving God in some form is required for recovery.

3. NA is not aligned with any formal religious organization.

4. Our morality is based on an inner feeling of correctness spread over a large and unregulated group of sincere people who have been clean and worked towards Step 12 for a number of years. Finding out what they think or feel on an issue or question of policy is called group

conscience. Policy is defined as 'plan of action:' what to do when a certain thing happens. Good policy insures that we apply the lessons we have learned.

5. Spiritual principles starting with honesty, open-mindedness and the willingness to try are our guides in dealing with life on life's terms.

Personal responsibility, applies to morality as well as spirituality, "In a justly ordered world were loss of equipoise would mean complete destruction; personal responsibility must be absolute," writes James Allen in his book "As a Man Thinketh" Morality for the fellowship would definitely be something each individual would find their own sense of. They would have a sponsor that would lovingly yet sternly and effectivly encourage them to travel that path. When fear of possible criticism or exclusion freezes recoverying addicts into silence, you can almost watch disorder proliferate from the fear. We who have long occupied the lowest rung on the social ladder should realize how quickly these problems fade when we face them squarely.

Thoughts create actions. We have to be careful about out words in recovery. Political correctness follows the herding instinct and without spiritual direction, we go where the cows want us to go – into the ditch and field. This is fine if you are a cow. Falling back on business issues is fine if you are primarily a business. At some point, a person must be willing to think for themselves and reach their own conclusions. That is why NA is not aligned with formal religions, to allow members to develop their own lives and recovery.

We cannot assume that every member has the moral fiber to think for themselves. It is obvious from the state of affairs many are quite comfortable having someone else think for them. Perhaps many are not aware of the need to think for themselves. They are quite comfortable to let politicians do for the most part as they please and remain blissfully unaware of what is going on. And for most, no matter how informed they become, frustration seems to be the main result. On the other hand when it comes to recovery and this Fellowship, the situation is entirely different.

Here's how one member sees it:

> "My rewards are spiritual in nature and no matter what the result of the things that seem political in nature in our Fellowship my rewards are still the same. They are rewards of the inside. Rewards of having known I took a moral stand and I am trying my best to carry the message to the addict who still suffers. If I am working with men and women who I hope are also surrendered to the God of their understanding and doing their best to follow direction of their God to fulfill our Fifth Tradition then that is much different to me than trying to work side by side with others who may have all kinds of mixed messages. While political correctness has inserted itself into our Fellowship, I still assert we are a Fellowship built on spiritual principles and morality.
>
> "The rewards of understanding the difference are very important. Some may be grateful for someone taking the time to point that out. Others may get angry at those who do. Still others may keep on baaing, grazing and going off the cliff without bothering to look. "

If a person is working steps it would be thought or hoped that they would grow towards and start developing some morals and ethics. From surrender to belief to relinguishing control of our lives to our Higher Power, we are asked in Step 4 to list and to share in Step 5 what we think we do right and what wrong. Having God remove defects that have grown up in our active addiction, we become new people, spiritually. Living up to the responsibilities contained in Steps 6, 7, and 8 we are allowed to correct the mistakes made along the way through the amends in Step 9. When we do this all the time in Step 10, growth and maintenance of our spirituality through prayer and meditaion of Step 11 becomes possible. The Spiritual Awakening of Step 12 comes to us when we can surrender, grow in faith and make our peace with our fellow man so we can go deeply into Step 11.

An Addict shares:

> ok, here we go, a differing opinion, lets see if open mindedness is a concept or a reality. up front, let me state clearly that ego deflation is absolutely necessary to the creating the environment that the seed of recovery can be planted in. untill and unless that catastrophic rejection of self will occurs, recovery will be a battle, not a surrender. Here is where my perspective begins to divert.... when i came to na in 87, i heard 2 distinct messages in the rooms, one was a belligerent work the steps or die motherfucker* ...the other was work the steps and live, you don't have to die.
>
> my life up till na was based on a concept of power. i was stronger than some folks, weaker than a few. My interactions with others depended on where i decided they were on the food chain. when i saw addicts acting like feudal lords over "their meetings", "their sponsees"... i recognized the dynamics of that same food chain. the disease of addiction is sufficient to the task of destroying the ego, when i limped into na, i was near dead, spiritually, emotionally and physically. i didn't need to have my ass kicked, I needed to be healed. truth be told, my time in na has revealed to me that kicking ass for their own good is usually justified bullying, originating from fear, based on a belief that the higher power doesn't know what its doing. any other addict that i meet on my path of recovery is invited to be there by a higher power. no matter what na credentials they have, length of time, circle of friends etc., can elevate them from the position of fellow traveler.
>
> all addicts are of equal status, from newcomer to gods most holy dinosaurs. now sharing experience strength and hope with newcomers is much different than shoving an ego laden message down the throat of a critically ill newcomer. responsible, caring, spiritually awakened addicts do in fact wrestle with the denial and self centerdness of newcomers, but we are only assisting the work of a higher power, its not an invitation to lord our recovery over anyone. na is an emergency room, not a locker room. the message that saved my life(both physical and spiritual)was that none of the steps were designed to hurt me, i had already done that to myself. the country club mentality of some members of na is harmful to the message of this healing program. some sponsorship families have a self appointed vip status, but to me it looks like some combination of ancestor worship and elitism. recovery has been a personal journey with hp guiding, it is a journey shared with many, but controlled by none but hp. looking forward to any views on this subject, i am open to more being revealed.
>
> *Motherfucker has nothing directly to do with sex. It has to do with someone claiming authority over a child under the guise of having a special relationship with their mom in a single parent household, hence "You can't tell me what to do! You're just my mothers lover."

Allowing market conditions, personal power plays and 'political correctness' to enter this delicate and wondrous process cannot really happen because these things stop the process from happening. Self-discipline is creative and helps us change into better people. Control is deadening. It works not in recovery or in any other part of life except the barbarism of war, where people do not really matter. People on our side are expendable to wipe out people on the other side who are even more expendable. In recovery, our people are not expendable. Self imposed discipline is creative because it is directed by a person's spirit.

Sometimes a little assault and battery is needed:

> When I had about six weeks and was all knowing in my views of recovery an addict named Dewitt picked me up by the neck and slammed me up against a wall and told me to shut the f**k up, as i was not adding to the recovery of the group, just carrying the mess. Now I go at 6'4" and 300 lbs and Dewitt made me look small. And before anyone says how dare he do that to a newcomer, it was the best thing to happen to me. I was intimidated into opening my ears to true recovery. If I tried to do that today to some of our six week recovery wonders, I shudder to think what would happen. As I once heard in a movie, "Sometimes a little assault and battery is needed." (LOL) but in my own way i carry on for dewitt with a strong message of recovery and what is appropriate based on what I was taught by the strong men of NA I was exposed to early on.

If an individual is sincere they will surely grow towards the ideals they develop about morality. They develop morals and ethics and have a path to walk that lets one apply spiritual principles to their life and the way they live it. Kinda sounds like "a spiritual awakening as the result of these steps." This is the kind of thing recovering addicts try to get new people to see. If we as a Fellowship start trying to teach morality, we would be violating several of the 12 Traditions of NA. Particularly, we would become teachers instead of leading by example. We would develop other requirements for membership and our group purpose would exclude those who could not agree with us.

From the US West Coast:

> You are spot on, man. I was brought up with the same guidance. Sit your ass down, you have not been at a meeting unless you are there when it opens, and closes, and you better take a piss before and grab your coffee, your ass goes in the seat and stays there. Keep your mouth closed, and your ears open. Pray you get recovery before the disease of addiction gets you...

> I have not been paying attention to the big picture these days. I visited our area this month for the first time that I have been home since August. There seemed to be an air or attitude that I just did not get! I was so jumpy, that after open forum, I left as fast as my little legs could carry me. I was only there to give a point of information as to how and why there was such a large credit carrying for the New Lit. sales person... I served this position in 95 & 96.....At that time we were hoping to accomplish purchasing Literature in advance by the case so that we could get the bulk discount...Well come to find out (after area) that offer of discount purchase is no longer available. Only under contract direct with the WSO. The Northern California Region no longer sells in Bulk at discount...Yet as I sat and listened to everyone's reports waiting for the open forum..(I knew most folks in the room..) something was very different...

See when I got home and was looking through my mail,,,(3 months worth) I was reading one of the NA WAYS...After the conference...Where the fellowship was being asked to discuss 2 issues.. one being our "Public Image" and one being once again "what is the proper NA message" of course tied in with the Issue of Public Image...Concern being that "Some" professional would not refer any young women, due to NA being full of predators...

My eyebrows twisted and my mouth dropped...I felt that tug of fear... When the light came on with the 10th tradition....."Narcotics Anonymous has no opinion on outside issues; hence the N.A. name ought never be drawn into public controversy". Shook my head again...and wondered what it was the WSO was diverting the fellowships focus away from. Hence I was relieved of that part of my disease that wanted to jump in.

For any of us to DISCUSS these issues… is a violation of the 10th tradition.
What folks think of us is an outside issue… EVEN if they are in a "PUBLIC MEETING"...now I am paying attention to other members whom are suffering over discussing these issues and watching their fear of NAs' survival...One member whom I love dearly is expressing it through Their service work with our Outreach committee.... I stay silent and pray.... for the moment that I can be of service to that person, and or any member suffering...

So what is going on that we really need to be focusing on? Have a conscious on? It Certainly is not something that is a clear violation of the traditions, once again.....

So as I am pondering this and asking for this to be revealed:

I am starting to see that our disease has Spiritual Principals ..like DIVERSION... FALSE FEAR....and...OVERPOWERING ourselves and others.
Like Lower Power verses Higher Power.....

So as I was briefly reading this to make sure I could understand my own writing...I realized that I only checked with one region... I remembered, we can buy from any region we want... maybe there are other regions that still offer bulk discounts to Area's

This seems to be my most pressing issue seeing that I have spent over 60.00 buying books for new sponsees... I am starting to tell folks to steal them.. (It gets a good Laugh)...10.42 cents apiece....

Some things just have not changed yet....

From the East Coast:

They're $ 12.50 in Pittsburgh. When me and a member brought up, why? At the region, last week we were given all kinds of insane reasons but none of them congruent. They're cheaper at the recovery book store than at the regional office?????

One reason that was given was, we needed more money to send World-- (WHY?) - explain that - I stepped out and prayed, to avoid getting upset enough to fight.

So now the research begins, for that is just one of many problems being avoided here--those skimming off the top are good at deflecting the truth and trying to spin it around on their

"accusers" '---that's ok-- at least today. My battles are fought with facts and intelligence, and good motive, with the Traditions to back it up. Years ago would have been a different story. They don't like it here when you bring literature to the service meetings, some thing to do with--- being accountable ---that seems to be a problem with the powers that be.

And I thought they were supposed to be accountable to and serve the fellowship, silly me.

For the NA program to work we have to reach the deeper levels. That is what the 12 steps are all about. Corporate management and political correctness do not reach these levels. This deep inner core, in every person, comes together in NA and forms what we call group conscience. lt may be that there are two NA programs at any given time, each unaware of the other. There is the corporate management power structure on one side. The loving caring spiritual side on the other. If this be the case we can live with it. But it is something that needs to be known so we can keep first things first.

Breach of social contract can be devastating to the individual and the NA Society as a whole. Our society has been built on the idea that together we can do what is impossible alone. As we become part of NA and develop some way of helping as part of our program, we each become an important part of a modern day miracle. Our trust bonds become the source of a life giving energy and we dare not break them.

When we are allowed through the barriers, we communicate with the inner being of a person. This can be done in a group setting. In rare cases, many more people can be involved. Our group conscience process is something like this. It involves trust, non-injury, loving care and concern, a leap of faith and an ability to follow through. This human interaction goes way beyond corporate goals and office talk. It involves parts of a person that cannot be bought or sold. This is not the way wars are begun, it is the way wars are ended.

12.28.04

Chapter Nineteen

Traditions War Memorial

Our Memorial is for those who have crossed over
or who have suffered greatly due to violations of our Twelve Traditions
and the principles behind them that protect us from useless conflicts.

Origins of the Memorial

On Saturday night, I had a discussion with another member working on this book. We discussed the Traditions and the fall out behind the change of structure and the book. We remembered fallen members that were gone. Good spirited people with no other intent or motive than that of helping the addict that still suffered.. Vietnam has a wall for

fallen soldiers that died in a war that should not have been, why don't we. So, the idea was made to have a thread on our na-history.org website with just that, a memorial to fallen members, giving facts of their person, spirit and service, as well as what happened to them..

By Sunday morning I thought, "I don't know if I dreamed this or not " But some time after our talk Sat evening, I had a flash! A book titled "Victors Of The Traditions War" With a memorial chapter to fallen members. I talked it over with other members interested in the work on history. A good discussion followed. The chapters can be defined but the intro needs the to state what this war has been about.. That is the difference between a corporate mentality of nA service vs a spiritual mentality of service. That is it in a nut-shell. I will take a page to define. There is a quote from an underground newspaper in Atlanta, the "Great Speckled Bird" in its first issue: "These are our opinions and we are entitled to them, they are not written anywhere else. So, don't expect us to tell both sides of the story. The big newspapers, magazines, TV and radio do that all day long. Here you will hear our side of things." We attempt to give both sides in this book but we admit to a bias.

If you have friends that have fallen in this conflict then write it down.. Don't juice it up, just tell the truth.. Who were they, what did they do to help you and NA as a whole, what happened.

You know there are some 12 step calls that need to be made.. There are some fallen members that are still suffering.. I suggest we all PRAY for these NOW and keep it up. A hand of fellowship needs to be reached out to them... Love conquers disease. When is the last time we had a jonesing addict on our couch? Treatment centers and good times have made a lot of us soft..

The time in now, the work is ours, if it is to be it is up to me, and you and you and you and you and you..... Now the question is do we have the courage to open the door and let some light in?

ILS
Grover

Jimmy Kinnon - spent good part of his life devoted to NA. He was not treated with the respect he deserved. Unfortunately, some of his friends don't appear to be representative of his good spirits and humor. He always helped us when we called. He manned the telephone through the 1970's and answered night or day. One time I called and told him an institution - jail - in Texas was critical of our rough language in the NA meeting there and he said, "It's none of their business what we say in our meetings." It was a comfort to have such quick and positive support. The politics surrounding the expansion of the WSO were high-pressured and that may explain if not excuse some of the rough interaction. He was a speaker at the NA World Convention at New York and sat next to Father Egan who mentioned the pre-1953 NA in New York. Jimmy was smiling through this.

Jack Whaley – Jack was the first outspoken Board of Trustee Chair to take up for NA and seriously agitate for more solidarity among its members in early 1970's. (check date – Ed)

Gina Helguerra - wrote some of the Basic Text, wonderful story in Book 2. From Nashville, ran in music circles. Very educated and good with people. Singer. When NA lit movement caved in she lost her focus and wandered into obsession. Moved to Miami and got involved with a doctor. Lived with AIDS for a time. Moved home to Nashville where she died.

Greg Pierce - wrote our original service structure ***NA Tree*** and served on Board of Trustees during most of 1970's and 1980's. Grandfather of our Basic Text. He had the original idea to expand the Little White Book into a topic outline for the book. He worked hard at the World Literature Conference II at Lincoln, Nebraska - NA's first week long service conference. 800 pages were factored into Greg's outline. Also, formulated the plan to fund the

expansion of WSO by selling new books for $25 numbered with a special red cover. Spoke at countless NA conventions and service conferences, chairman of the NA World Service Board and mentor to many, many NA members wanting to be effective and correct in their service to NA.

Tom the Red - Hitchhiked across America, got stranded in desert and got hell of a sunburn - hence his nickname. He also had red hair. Tall and skinny, he was a warm personality and contributed much of his time towards the book effort, attending conferences in Memphis and Santa Monica. Story told of his getting involved with women on a live in basis and someone shot him at the door one day.

Billy Russell - Extremely active service worker in Northern Alabama. Absolutely wonderful NA member. Relapsed and never was able to accumulate clean time again. Active in H&I service work.

Grover N. - First major effort to write out NA history. Members from all over East Coast came to Conference in Madison, Alabama, Allentown, Pennsylvania and Montgomery, Alabama. These were all large, well planned Conferences with impressive list of notable NA members from all over. Video tapes lost to one member who was supposed to send them into to Alabama, headquarters for the history conferences. Members moved in from out of state and were so disruptive to the history effort that dissension took over and the effort died out. Grover so demoralized, he moved to Oklahoma, leaving behind all his life in Alabama.

Joe P. - One of the greatest service workers in the history of NA. One of the individuals responsible for the Basic Text. First attended the Lincoln Lit Conference in 1980. Rallied together hosting for the Memphis Literature Conference where our Basic Text first saw the light of day. As Joe used to say, "If we don't stand for something, we'll fall for anything."

Perry L. - My Name is Lester and I am an Addict in Recovery. I am sending this reply in hope that it my somehow find its way into the Chapter on fallen members, in the Traditions War Book. I got clean in Portland, OR in 1986 and at that time we had a member here whose name was Perry L. Perry had over 2 yrs in Recovery and was very outspoken about his Recovery and very visible in our fellowship. Even though he was not my sponsor. Perry kind of took me under his wing, which was his way with newcomers in particular if they showed any amount of Sincerity in wanting to stay clean. Perry was very active in H&I and became my mentor so to speak. I chose to go to my 1st Jail meeting with him because I wanted what he had. I wanted to learn from the best. Perry had also been instrumental in getting H&I into our jail system here in Portland. So I followed Perry into the Jails and later into Area and eventually Regional Service and H&I Rep. which became a strong part of Recovery.

Unfortunately, the pull of our addiction took Perry back out following his 9th Anniversary and he was never able to return to these rooms. During one of his several attempts to regain some recovery, a member is said to have asked him what took him back out and his reply was something that I believe can benefit us all.

He replied that there were some things listed in his 4th step that he had failed to deal with in the remaining steps. And because of this Narcotics Anonymous lost a great person who had touched the lives of hundreds possibly thousands and had given them hope and recognition that laid the groundwork for their recovery.

Ten years have passed since Perry's departure, and I am still in Recovery, and still working the steps and still attempting to practice these principals in all of my affairs. One of the things that Perry use to say was that if we don't get Humble we will get Humiliated. Many of my friends that I have today are also still in Recovery in part because of the knowledge that was so freely given to them by a fellow addict in Recovery whose name was Perry L.

Thank you for allowing me to share. – Lester

Big Lou – Denounced from the podium at Upper West Coast WCNA in for his participation in the Baby Blue movement, Lou relapsed and was never able to get clean again. He died of overdose.

Bill Brooks – One of the founders of NA in Alabama, Bill devoted his life to recovery and did all in his power to help others, the NA way. I spoke to him at the "Out of the Darkness, Into the Light" convention the year before he died and he made a bitter statement about nobody owing him a thing. I was right on it and said without pause, "No, Bill. Lots of people owe you their lives. We are just going though our adolesence as a Fellowship and the membership hasn't learned how to regard members who devote their lives to their well-being. It is part of the disease." He seemed stunned by this and I was glad he said nothing and thought about it. He was able to rally a bit from his prolonged bout with cancer and was a speaker at the WCNA Atlanta.

Larry North – One of the pioneering members of the NA Fellowship in the early days of the Mid-Atlantic RSC, Larry was an ardent member who drove countless newcomers to conventions and was one of the founding members of the Virginia RSC. He was denied recognition at the first WSC because some thought the region was contrived by Larry just to give himself a vote on the Conference floor. This was very selective because many other regions had been formed with much less basis for recognition during the same time period. Larry was WSC Policy Chair one year and even when his health began to fail due to emphezema, he continued to be as active as possible in NA.

Lynn Watkins

Eyewitness account of politics in early days of World Service Conference and the Transition from the original WSO

Hi,

I was there also listening to many crazy things concerning the WSO. Jimmy was really up into having a basic text published for sure. The literature committee had no thoughts of trying to run NA back then and Jimmy was just doing his best he could. So much happened so inadvertently and in a manner of him just to me it seems he was just replaced instead of actually rousted out. And with that he just went home from all appearances - from what he told me. He was fearful that people would take over outside of framework of what he was doing (to perpetuate NA) under auspices of becoming a great entity set on making money behind the book, and he was afraid how this would go about . . . I remember talking to him and he did not appear to have animosity toward Bob, but unfortunately he did have some toward Bo, fearing Bo may have had something to do with him being removed from office. I know and knew Bo then and there was no such behind the scenes on Bo's part to any such thing for sure. In talking to Jimmy, I tried to allay his fears that anyone in Atlanta was out to get him and I tried desperately to get him to come to Atlanta and just talk. I do remember a spectre of someone calling him and supposedly threatening him if he did not leave, and my understanding is that this was a person on their on and had nothing to do with a group or group conscience for sure. It was very trying time for Bob too for sure as he tried to collaborate and get printing out for the book.

The excitement was unbelievable though with the blue and red books that was just to raise money you know just to get the initial set of books published. Even Bo feared for his life because of very deep underlying animosity of people resenting him for pushing and getting the book going in spite of the office.

In talking to Bob on several occasions with his small staff at the time, especially after the big theft fiasco and put book publishing behind he really was so sorry things were not going as they should it seemed. There were strong factions in Atlanta on three sides, the AA/NA people saying we did not need book and Bo and his people were not qualified and should be written by professions etc. besides they had their aa big book, and so there were some very animosity undercurrents between these people at times.

Me, like the dumb ass I was, was trying to allay everyone on all sides and really did not know lot of the behind the scenes scheming on all sides, as the time when I went to WSC in Santa Monica to visit as a spectator only, but also in

my hands were many documents to undercut Bo and take any credibility from him and make him look bad so as to keep him from becoming Chairman, and this I gave to each RSR to add gasoline to the flame and without Bo being there to defend himself, even as I had talked to him on nice terms and agreeable to him but wearing double face of trying to please everyone. I did this thing not knowing the consequences of my actions and there were newcomers there too that took this information and ran with it so to speak to strengthen their position in the WSO with there handpicked ones behind the scenes, as like I was at someone house once in Beverly Hills hearing in next room three people one relative new comer soon to be running office hard time for use to even get Bob Stone more business like to run business as such and would soon be taking over himself with much push from friend old timer at that time anyway to do this. So I went to conference confused and feeling too many closed doors and secrets going behind the scenes as to what would actually happen at the conference. I talked to Jimmy about this and tried my very level best to assure him that I knew Bo and Bo would never ever do anything to harm him for sure and Gregg had nothing but good things to say about Jimmy, and seemed even that he wished he had stayed sometimes to keep controversy down.

At that time though after some of us did foolish things to sabotage the book and the WSO at the same time, things went along anyway. For changes, and even hearing of behind scenes of changing the basic structure of NA which I did not understand at the time, but certainly do today, which I wish I had listened to. By this time I was no longer a fence rider and felt pretty true to NA and it purposes, but wish it had not taken so long though, cause even though I was asked to input to the book and worked on it sometimes myself also at the Highland Club and the Rising Sun Club House and meeting others writing so very hard and inputting I still had my stupid little issues of keeping people going different paths to stay together, and all it did was hurt sometimes in NA's eventual growth. After undermining Bo by that stupid letter from some people that wished to humiliate and disgrace him, I had a very hard road to climb especially after I gave up on fence riders and skeptics of other fellowships trying to dictate and used their popularity to perpetuate their own agendas in all their fellowships. It was at this time I dedicate myself to NA in spite of my foolishness of trying to be with people not truly dedicated to one purpose of NA only . . . This was a very lonely place and isolation was part of the consequences of my actions on all sides at times it seemed, until we had first world convention of NA in Atlanta, and even in its mess still being run by others, our next home regional had a much different perspective when we really finally got off the ground and used money to open up a little office, and I remember at that time Jimmy K was so excited about it and the influence the book was having in the community and much reorganization going, but at that time could not have but reservations of what Jimmy K. warned me about and motives being questioned as I soon found out. The true hard NA's supported me in getting office going and there was a permissiveness there thru region committees to let me do my thing, and found out die hard nA members really behind it. Remember going to California again and getting first set of 100 books direct from conference and going to Panama City Fun in the Sun (oldest convention east of Mississippi you know} and selling them right off. Will never forget it, and even guy who wrote a story in it had to stand in line to get one and he got mad at me cause I would not reserve him some for his friends and all (I think he still resents me for that though). .But was able to pay office back from sell off books though and gave credibility for us anyway and Bob Stone was very permissive in letting me have more books on credit...

I did many things to try to redo and make amends to the fellowship and particularly Bo for my underhandedness at WSC while I was being controlled by others. I hope he forgives me today for my stupidity and not listening very well to those closed cliche rumors and get togethers in California. Even Jimmy informed me he was excluded much and it did hurt him very bad, and much of this resentment was take to his grave with him, but he had a resignation about him that he did the best he could and did not hate anyone He would always tell me not to let the small things get me down and keep doing what I was doing and ignore controversy or it would also run me off from NA, and I did not have to leave or run anymore. Those were bout last words of sharing he gave me before he got sick and I moved to Texas, where NA really was barren and addiction was truly not understood with mixed up programs, treatment centers, confusing issues, and hats passed around with no traditions!!! So what I had learned was really awesome taking into unknown territory ignorant of ongoing history of NA as a whole and even trying to get meetings going there was awesome, so am still very grateful for what Bo basically taught me about singleness of purpose, broad of vision and Jimmy K. insisting I did not have to run any more but could make a difference in my life and others.

Even years later I regret much of the things I could have done more constructively, even going through first heart attach, surgery, recovery and isolating I could have done more, and especially regret hurting Bo inadvertently. Kermit talks about telling truth and I am not very politically correct for proper sharing so to speak with many powers that be I suppose. But still feel very hurt from that original cliche that found one anther that used book for own purposes to just perpetuate big business so to speak and how so many feel today they have no say so or affect at times, cause all has been done already.

This is farthest from the truth, much still needs to be done in all phases. I just wish I had strength resources etc, but I do not any longer for sure and so have nothing any longer to loose like I once did telling the truth....

I just wish Anonymi would get strong again so that I did not feel so isolated any longer and people look at me like I was crazy like when I tell them I even got a TV show once going called NA!!!! instigated much back then we did, and am afraid too much apathy is around corner now and need to help build some fires again. I could at least try to write something a bout sponsorship I suppose, but my spirit is still low sometimes and says what difference will it make anyway? Stinking thinking for sure. I am hoping a praying God will help me get out of my funk and do some hiking and not feel like such a useless has been...

PS: I remember that crazy Kermit coming to Atlanta to his first convention. I believe and their total fascination with such growth, I think about 82 not even sure any more and watched him grow through years and not losing his enthusiasm, so will pray for more as I go. But God knows I still sure miss Jimmy K. and Gregg P. now for sure, but still hear them swing their NA two by four. May the great power of love and honor through your Higher Power always be with you. and lots of NA hugs and love. (hope nobody pissed about me posting this long note so to speak.)

Lynn Watkins
November 8, 2000

Chapter Twenty

Pathway to Peace

The truth of our daily recovery is miraculous in nature. It far outweighs our concerns about NA service politics and the learning curves others may have before them. We've already been through hell, what's a little purgatory? There would be no point in writing this material were it not for our hope that a way be presented that allows NA members and our friends to discern exactly how we have grown and how we have dealt successfully with all the real-life problems we have encountered along the way. While nature allows us to heal, we have the disease of addiction which does not go away entirely, even in the best recovery. It sleeps, and perhaps while it sleeps, it dreams. It may dream pleasant scenes or it may make nightmares. Maintaining our spiritual condition is one way to describe what we do to keep our sanity and optimistic attitude in mind amid all the concerns of daily life, including what is being done in our NA name. Surrender, faith, self-examination lead us into the new life. While we can hope to understand and even sympathize with the concerns that have led our world service contingents to shut down to a great degree the open communications we once had between world and our general membership, it is no great matter to be set straight or restored to some former condition. No, we have to go on with our lives, our recovery and our service. We can wish others well we have to keep acting on the impulse to care for others and help in any way we can.

This writing can catalogue, sequence and in some cases explain what has happened - it cannot change it. We are being as through and careful as possible to restrict our statements and positions to the evidence of minutes, official reports and personal correspondence but this will surely be a lost effort to some. Negativity cannot generate stuff of its own, so it always has to find some positive effort to condemn or destroy. We, on the other hand, are as free to create and explore as anyone could want. We neither hate nor despise the poor people who have fallen to the traps of egotism and control. We accept them and their behavior and exult in our escape from pettiness and fear. What does concern us is that others not be led into dissolution and despair by poor leadership and unavailability of study materials. People cannot be blamed for not knowing that which they cannot read and study.

We know that we have to each of us find a way into our own hearts and hold on to that peace and certainty there, born of our own true experience. While there is great beauty and joy in sharing recovery, we must each make this very private and personal journey within ourselves. All that God can give us is there awaiting our desire to know and be a part of life in all its forms. It is waiting for you and you have only to calm yourself and look within to know what we are talking about. The noisy cannot hear it, the busy cannot see it but it the reality of higher power is there always, just beyond our field of perception. We can only acquire it with our surrender.

When we can do this, we will not go crazy over what world service is doing or not doing. If other members go temporarily insane, we can stand by looking for ways to help but we will not be drawn into their illusions. God will grant us a way to help and our path will widen and deepen as time goes by. Gratitude and sincerity are the building blocks of the new life. All that we need will be brought to us as we become ready for it, with more on the way. All we have to do is calm down and accept the miracle. Going sour, complaining about our imperfect perceptions, blaming life for being real, forgetting that whatever pain our moments bring, we are alive and can often do something to better our situations. We will finally realize we are drawn back again and again to lessons we have to learn so that we can go on. The lessons are blessings in packages and we forget or don't know to look inside for the meaning. When we remind each other of the reality of the Spirit, our own spirit grows.

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Excerpt from Bob Stone's Book:

The following extract is placed here not to embarrass anyone but simply because most members of our Fellowship don't know this happened. Since they cannot find a specific time and place where 'everything' changed, they believe the fun loving, caring Fellowship we had in the late seventies and early nineties is still in existence somewhere. Adjustments that have been made by people like me have been a positive reaction to these changes. But if the Fellowship has no way of knowing, they will think some of what we do is unnecessary. The NA Way of Life project for instance is far too loving and caring to survive in this kind of power politics atmosphere. It would be like choosing to go to a dumpster to have a baby.

Still, I respect the friends I have who have stood the strain of all the years in world service. We need a strong structure and a stable World Service Office. It is up to us to provide the spirit, the fun and the good humor that brings life to our Program and Fellowship. They take care of their stuff: the corporate work, the reports, the printing, distribution and all the other work they do for the Fellowship in trust. Like us, if they fail they can pay a high penalty. None of this recovery stuff is anything but a God given miracle! If we are grateful, we can wish them well and get back to what we do the best: stay clean and carry the message.

Bob Stone was a great man in our history and we will be fortunate to attract others of his caliber. I have long suspected that while he was not an addict, he held back more insanity within our world service system then we will ever know. If we don't show gratitude and respect to our trusted servants and special workers, who will?

- Bo S.

Bob Stone
and the NA fellowship

Bob Stone was the manager of the NA World Service office from 1983 to 1990. He was not an addict which made for peculiar problems in his management of the Office. Our approved and carefully considered service structure of the time did not make provision to prohibit the WSO from making NA policy or manipulating information in Fellowship publications entrusted to their care. The expansion of WSO from less than $10,000 in the 1978-1979 fiscal year to a million dollars in the 1984-1985 fiscal year (figures approximate) increased the staff of the Office from none to over forty. The dynamics of this change included a range of new strains and pressures. It was hard for the workers at WSO to know exactly what pains had been taken by the Fellowship leadership. They had to answer to their boss on a daily basis and that which their boss did not know, did not reach the light of day. Heavy on the business side and hazy on the spiritual Fellowship side, it is not surprising that many mishaps miscommunications happened. Add to this all the personal interpretations that Bob was given by addicts who surrounded him at the WSO in Southern California or else on the road traveling 'for the Fellowship.' It has to have been confusing.

Several years before the end of his managing the WSO, I advised him to write a book about his experience. Our members need to know what you are learning and it may help others understand what goes on at WSO and thereby make improvements that would be impossible if they were kept in the dark. At the time, I thought no more about it. Then I heard his contract was not renewed. Greg P. who I trusted in these things told me that there were many little things towards the end of Bob's work for us that would be unimportant but taken as a whole, they were enough to get him 'non-renewed.' I now think there are other explanations. I have just finished reading his book, "My Years with Narcotics Anonymous" and may have stumbled on an unexpected explanation.

Before going into that, I want to point out that during my assignment to the WSC Literature Committee in the 1986-1987 Conference year, we were going through a document that contained a large excerpt from a letter Bob Stone

wrote to the Chairperson of the Literature Committee. He advised that the work of the Committee be suspended for a few years during which time the Chairpersons should go around a talk with members about what they would like to see written about recovery. In the course of reviewing the material, the excerpt proved to be problematic. It made good points but just didn't fit in with the piece we were working on. Sorry, I can't recall which piece. It may been concerning the Committees guidelines. Someone finally snapped to the fact that Bob's letter was not meant to be input but only contained some thoughtful and relevant observations. Bob's comments left no doubt that he believed as we did that the writing should be tuned to the reality of NA recovery and not the member coerced into doing it the way a writer thought they should. This experience based approach is what saved us with the Basic Text. State someone's experience and no one in the world can deny it. Present the same information as a suggestion or opinion, anyone can argue with you. There were other things but after that, I began to suspect that Bob was holding back plenty of insanity instead of making problems.

Reading Bob Stone's book, he refers to a 'vocal minority.' This would be funny if it were not so sad. The members who had studied and been apart of World Services the longest, whether as a Fellowship supporter or as an active participant became outraged when certain breeches of trust and written policy were violated. Hell, no one knew it all and it took a sizable group of well informed members to keep up with events and the written material in Quarterly Reports, the Annual Conference Agenda Report and any other documents to come out of the WSO, WSC (World Service Conference) or WSB (World Service Board). These few members who cared and dared enough to complain or express concern were dubbed as a group: the vocal minority. So, if something upset the 'vocal minority', he would wave it off as if the concern came from people who just liked to find fault or complain. This is what proved to be his undoing. While there may be no direct relationship between to two events, it is not lost on me that the non-renewal came after the 4th Edition debacle.

By not listening to the informed, studied and experienced members, he was left to listen to whom? His employees? Currently elected WSC Officers and Chairpersons? So, would you expect he got a well rounded viewpoint or might his view point be restricted by the limited group of persons he let advise him. After all, he wasn't going to listen to a bunch of sick addicts who were vocal and lacking in numbers, was he? Only the 'vocal minority' could have or would have helped him, if he had asked. But a manger runs on information and any corporation places a high value on information. Once you think you have enough, you just go for it and hope for the best. Corporation go out of business because they can't read the writing on the wall. They become insensitive to customer complaints and they go out of business. If instead of fearing, dismissing or ignoring the vocal minority - who is still around, let me tell ya! - he could have brought them into the picture and heard them out. Their feelings were probably on track and it would have been easy enough for him in particular to please them. To me, this is, or should be the difference between a spiritual fellowship and a corporation. A corporation has no soul. It responds to lobbying. A spiritual fellowship takes the long view and looks out for all its members, not just a few who seem to be in power. God's really in power in NA.

As his story moves towards the last two chapters, Bob is literally globe trotting at Fellowship expense. He goes everywhere from Tokyo for two weeks to South America and Europe. Of course he travels extensively around the United States. He was paid a good salary as WSO manager and worked very hard to achieve the directives of the Fellowship. After around ten years of involvement with us, he did know a few things about what we wanted and how we worked towards our goals within the Twelve Traditions. He describes a group of people who decide not to renew his contract. He says he was told that they wanted to change Executive Directors because they were planning some changes in the Service Structure that he might not be able to go along with because of his well known basic beliefs. Apparently, these members succeeded because right after he was kicked out, there were some dramatic changes in our Structure. Representatives at the WSC no longer represented, now they are delegates. This means that while the tokens of representation are still there at the Regional level, they can vote their own conscience at the WSC. They don't have to vote the way their regions tell them to on issues announced in the Conference Agenda Report (CAR). Since they no longer have to follow the specific directions of their members in the region that has delegated them to vote at the WSC, the Fellowship no longer has a real vote. The linkage that used to exist between Group Member whose vote at the Group level was tallied with other groups at their area, then the area votes tallied at the region, and finally the regional votes tallied at the annual WSC. Without specific language, this linkage is destroyed. There were other sweeping changes. A big move to efficiency resulted in drying up the Board of Trustees (WSB) and the WSC

sub-committee system. During the years I attended the WSC there was only one thing the Fellowship did not want: the super board composed of a few people who run everything. Today, we have a super board. No doubt, Bob Stone would not have gone along with that plan.

To pull off this exhausting and radical change, a decade long charade called 'The Inventory' was utilized. It had the effect of freezing most WSC activity while WSO continued to function 'business as usual.' The most striking thing about the implementation of the super board is that they had two years to write their own guidelines. So, they had all the money under their control, all publications under their control, and all world service functions under their control. The only way for a member to get in is called the 'pool.' So members who want to serve at the World Level, have to sign up for a pool, fill out forms - the first in our history, and wait to be called. Presumably, if they do a good job, they are retained and even giving other assignments. A perfect management system.

I am grateful to Mr. Stone for all his work on our behalf. The man was not perfect but his position as Executive Director would have driven anyone insane. It is a wonder he did as well as he did and to credit the 1983 WSC voting group conscience, no one could have done as well. You and surely couldn't unless you're one hell of a manager! When he got sick with inoperable cancer, he wrote his truth probably as much to help him process what had happened as anything.

So that you members reading this will have some idea of what is contained in Bob's book, I am going to present the last chapter or two of the book. The early chapters have some excellent detailed writings on the history of NA. There is also an amazing blow by blow description of some of the service politics from the 1980's. This is the stuff we will have to master if we are to do better service in the future. To spare anyone at all the feeling that I am up to something, let me say that I am telling anyone I can reach that they should pray and step out on faith to meet any perceived need the NA Fellowship may have at present or in the future. Since these people in World Services wanted the super board, let them have it. If they get in trouble, we may have to save them. After all, it is our service work they are selling.

It is the love and understanding along with useful survival information in the Basic Text that called most of them to recovery in the first place. The Basic Text was written by over a thousand members in the late 1970's and early 1980's. It is the combined experience, strength and hope of addicts in recovery from all over the Fellowship with members from one day clean to over thirty years. Their input was put in a big pot and set to boil until it became condensed into writing and met the approval of members and groups all over the world who voted through a group conscience system in days when we had representative voting. My role in all this has always been basically the same: I hate to see big guys beating the shit out of little guys. I enjoy supplying the little guys so they at least have a chance. It gives me a thrill and makes my Higher Power happy. And that is just fine with me.

Since so much of this is coming to light for many members today, my suggestion is to leave the structure alone, especially at the world level. Just surrender. They will ask for help from the only people who can give it to them, or they will drain away power hungry members from the more important tasks at the group and area level. For instance, we need to get Basic Texts into every library in our state - how about yours? We need to routinely visit young doctors just when they are graduating from medical school and do this on a regular basis to get help for addicts and help doctors better understand addiction and recovery when they are young and growing. How about visiting local police departments and letting the new policemen and women know about recovery from addiction.

Maybe then they can jump out of the Hollywood stereotyping and into reality. We can do these things through existing H&I and P.I. committees. Did you know some large groups used to sponsor a hospital meeting so when the person got out of treatment, they had existing friends in a regular NA recovery meeting? Dreaming works - when you are clean!

In Loving Service,
Bo S.

My Years with Narcotics Anonymous

by Bob Stone

Chapter Twenty
I Was Stunned

The Board of Trustees had been in their closed meeting for over four hours when they sent for me.

Upon entering the room, I noticed that the smiling faces and jovial attitude normally present at breaks in their meetings were totally absent, and concluded this was indeed not going to be a pleasant discussion. This was the first time the trustees had excluded me from any discussion in the entire time I served with NA, so my heart was pounding quite fast.

Jack was at the head of the table, and the only empty seat was at the opposite end. As I sat down, the door was closed, and after a moment Jack began.

"There is no way to make this easy or pleasant, Bob, but the board has been discussing your tenure as Executive Director. No one has ignored the invaluable contribution you have made to Narcotics Anonymous and all the things you have done for the fellowship. No one can take those things away from your service to NA.

"But the board is of the opinion that NA is going in new directions, and that you would probably not be able to adjust to the kinds of changes that are necessary. It is not that you have done something wrong. The board just feels that you will be unable to cope with the changes that will come about. Because of this, we feel that a change in management of the office is in the best interests of the fellowship. The trustees are therefore recommending to the Board of Directors that your contract not be renewed.

"Is there anything you would like to say about this?"

I was stunned! Waves of heat flushed through me as I tried to comprehend and organize my thoughts. Dozens of ideas whizzed by, but I was too numb to catch them or even make sense of the images they carried. I was fighting against this electrical storm in my mind as I tried to fathom why they had decided this --- what should I say, what words could I use? In just a few seconds my world had been turned upside down. Without hint or warning, the Board of Trustees had decided to boot me out. Through the shock, I began to feel like I was inside a roaring fire, racing in circles. I needed to say something but what, and will the words come out?

What could I say? Having had no warning that day or any day previously that the trustees felt a change was necessary, or that I could not adapt to the changes taking place, my mind could not come up with a rational defense.

The World Service Conference had ended only thirty day before, during which I had been lauded by the trustees and the conference for another year of excellent performance. In the weeks leading up to this meeting, not one member of the board had suggested to me or to the office directors that I should not be retained another year.

Yes, there were three trustees who considered me their enemy because I frequently opposed their power grabs, needless junkets at NA expense, and self-promotion, but I never suspected they would convince the others that I should be disposed of. Nor would I have suspected that those among the trustees who had been my close friends for many years would have, in four hours, turned against me in such a callous manner. Frankly I was unable to

comprehend what Jack meant, or really why they had reached the conclusion that a new Executive Director was essential immediately.

Throwing out an Executive Director with no notice is simply a stupid idea unless the individual is guilty of some negligence of misconduct. And if those were the issues, every such charge requires an open and fair hearing. But I was not being charged with negligence, incompetence, dereliction or commission of some crime, or even of some mistake! I was not being given an opportunity to rebut their contention. They had already made up their minds. I was guilty of some supposed vague inability to adjust, and the trial was over. End of discussion.

Suggesting I was unable to adjust to changes in the fellowship seemed then, and seems now, simply ludicrous. No one had been closer than I, or involved so directly with the tumultuous changes in NA for the previous fifteen years. Not only was I at the center of those changes, but many of them rested on my ability to foresee their need, convince others of their value, and then later implement them. Many important changes were simply put in my hands by the conference, the trustees of the directors, and I was charged with the duty of getting them done. If there was any quality or characteristic I possessed, it was the ability to adjust.

Despite my disagreement with the trustees' assessment, and my demonstrated ability to adjust to changes, I didn't have many options for a response. From the very beginning of my tenure as an employee of NA, I had warned against allowing the Executive Director to become entrenched. I had even forced the issue by writing in my contract in 1983, that to remove the Office Manager (later changed to Executive Director) required only a phone call or letter of notice from the Board of Directors. I had even set up that my contract was for a year only and renewal was at the pleasure of the board.

In some ways I was guilty of having prepared the hemlock the trustees were now serving me. The black humor of having built my foundation as Executive Director on such thin ice escaped me then, but later I would shake my head in disbelief. Equally unfortunate for me at that moment was the fact that I had trained nearly all the trustees over the years and made sure they knew how easy it was to remove me.

Perhaps I had done it all wrong, and should have taken the more traditional approach. The more traditional approach used by Executive Directors was to write multi-year contracts that are hard or expensive for boards to break.

Most of the trustees knew about that tactic. Jack, for example, had become Executive Director of his treatment center twelve years earlier, in part, because of my efforts to remove his predecessor. He and Chuck L. were subordinate staff members when their Executive Director grossly violated good management and even misappropriated resources of the treatment center for his own benefit. But the guy was smart, and had a lifetime contract as Executive Director. I had helped their Board of Directors remove him, despite that contract. Jack became his replacement, and Chuck had later become his assistant. Greg P. had been a trustee at that time and was a friend of the Executive Director who was removed.

More recently, all but a few of the trustees had been active in the fellowship when Jimmy K. had fought to the very last to remain as office manager, and they knew how that conflict had rocked the fellowship to its foundation. Having gone through that had surely imbued the trustees with determination to act swiftly to remove me.

All of the trustees knew the language in my contract that allowed for non-renewal. that factor had been openly announced at the conference several years running, and I had discussed it with each trustee personally over the years. Two were even more directly familiar with my contract as they had served as chairperson of the Board of Directors while I was Executive Director. Additionally, Stu, then the chairperson of the directors, had participated in the four hours of their discussion. I certainly had the deck stacked against me.

But all was not lost. Trustee recommendation, even if strongly argued, might not be sufficient to sway the Board of Directors when they had to decide the issue. I had worked with most of the office directors for years, and

most professed strong friendship and support for continuing my management. Most also felt the trustees were more than a little out in the ozone when it came to practical decisions about fellowship matters. It was still possible, I knew, that the directors might reject the Trustee recommendation and renew my contract for another year or more. And I knew that many Executive Directors would have argued for a delay, and then used the time to marshal member support in opposition to such a removal.

Unfortunately, these were not options for me.

In the education I had given to this room full of trustees about organizational management, I had stressed that internal fights over the Executive Director had to be avoided at all costs. I had lectured them at business meetings that a board that engaged in a bloody fight with its Executive Director over tenure is dumb, and that such battles are dangerous to the interests of the organization. And the way to do that was to have the Executive Director on one-year contracts.

Furthermore I had educated them on the notion that such easily -ended agreements served to protect the interests of the organization, and the interests of the organization were paramount. Employees could come and go, but the volunteer management had to always have the upper hand and be in control. Yes, I had indeed planted and cultivated the seeds of my own removal.

Several trustees who participated in the discussion guessed correctly that I would not fight against their decision. I had shared openly over the years with all of them that I loved Narcotics Anonymous too much to cause a fight over my tenure. I was never told what was discussed at the meeting, so I don't know how much of my vulnerability was disclosed, but if some were as smart as they pretended to be, they should have made sure everyone knew.

But this complex analysis really came later. At the moment I sat there with Jack's words still ringing in my ears, I was trying to formulate some kind of response. I had a decision to make and no time in which to make it. They were waiting for me to respond, and my response would set the stage for a destructive fight or my capitulation.

Still in the trustee meeting, my head felt like it would explode and my heart was now racing so fast I could feel the blood rushing through by body. I was still trying to come up with some response. I had a faint sensation that I could see myself from outside my body and I was looking at me from the right side of the room and everything seemed to be moving in slow motion. the few second of Jack's statement and the moments before I responded seemed like a long, long time. I knew I had to say something, and I wanted the words to be right and clear. I was afraid, however, that my voice would be so quiet and low that no one would hear me. My vision had so constricted that I could not see anyone except Jack. I don't even remember who was sitting where.

Finally, I was able to muster a response. I don't remember precisely what I said, but this was my message.

"I don't agree with your recommendation. I think it is wrong. But I will not fight your recommendation. I believe NA should not have to fight between the Executive Director and other service boards. To do so would be harmful to the fellowship. As you know my contract is at the pleasure of the directors so there should not be a bloody fight over my removal.

"It is a matter of confidence. If the service boards cannot have the confidence of working well with the Executive Director, the Executive Director must go. As it is obvious that your confidence in my has gone, then I must go."

I may have said more, but I don't remember. The trustees did not record their meeting, nor did they have minuets or a written report made of their discussion of my few minutes with them.

Jack must have said something, because the meeting then broke up and I rose to leave. My head was spinning so much that I don't recall if anyone said anything to me in any way. My first recollection was that outside the meeting room Stu T., office chairperson, suggested we have dinner together and figure out what to say to the Board of Directors when their meeting started in slightly less than an hour. So off he and I went to discuss a quick termination from what had been the center of my life for seven years.

Some trustees, whom I had considered friends, even close friends, had evidently not stood in the way or fought to retain my services. Heavens! They didn't even fight to have the removal handled with grace and loving care. As I walked away from that meeting, and later that weekend from the joint meeting of the two boards, these "old friends" avoided me, wanting, I believe, to hide their guilt and shame at have been so callous and insensitive. In the years since that night, only two of the trustees have made any effort to communicate. With those trustees I had felt were my friends, I was disappointed that I have never initiated further contact either. The rest still avoid me, although I have been easy for them to call or visit. It is almost like I had died, and they did not have any further need to recognize their insensitivity or that I had ever existed. Yes, I was hurt by this experience, and it took a long time for me to recover from such a heartless removal. But time had washed away most of the sting of that hurt.

For those who truly considered me their enemy, I am sure there was jubilation. Their victory was easy for me to reconcile. They knew that I believed their motives and actions were based on their own pride, ambition, and quest for power, and that their actions were harmful to the fellowship.

For the few with whom I had a more neutral relationship, I was quite disappointed that they failed to consider the damage such a sudden and ill-conceived change would have upon the office and the fellowship at large. Their willingness to approve the removal of an Executive Director so suddenly and without cause is testament to their lack of qualification for service on such an important board.

The disappointment of that day and the sadness of the last month at the office were not representative of my experience with Narcotics Anonymous. There was a time, even when controversy swirled around me or the office, that the support and affection from the boards, committees, and the fellowship at large, was strong and sustaining.

Even in departing, I knew the vast majority of the members who were aware of world service matters would be stunned and saddened by my leaving. They would not understand my removal any more than I did. Unfortunately it was my task to permit the last month to proceed with as little notice as possible and allow no further controversy. A wave of opposition to my removal now would not have served the interests of the office or NA, and had to be avoided. My career at the World Service Office had to be sort of like the adage about the month of March: "In like a lion and out like a lamb."

And I truly had come into the position of office executive with the force of a lion. But is was not I that was the lion: it was the conference and the group conscience driving it. On that day in 1983 when the conference voted to suggest I become the office manager, there were whoops, hollers and a standing ovation. Practically everyone in the room was showing their favor and support for the decision. By that vote, the conference had, for the first time, demonstrated its authority and control over its service boards.

At each conference since then, I had received standing ovations for the year's work and overwhelming support for continuing as the Executive Director. At the conference just a month before, the participants had again loudly demonstrated their support.

But now the conference was over, and there was no one to effectively combat the closed-door kangaroo court session that had engineered my removal. Only if I fought against their decision and remained as Executive Director until the next conference was there a possibility I could win against such odds. That would likely paralyze the office and the relationships among the world service boards. The only choice was to pack my bags and leave. I went without a fight. "Out like a lamb:" As the full time paid Executive Director that tens of thousands of members knew about, I had an obligation to set a proper pattern for my successors.

As I left with Stu, I pulled Anthony and George aside to tell them the trustees had voted to recommend that my contract not be renewed. They were stunned, and in total disbelief. I asked that they not tell the others, as I felt I should do that when I returned from dinner with Stu.

At dinner I didn't ask what had been said in the meeting of how he had argued against the idea. Deep inside I felt he had probably been mostly silent or provided encouragement for my removal. We talked about practical matters.

I proposed a separation payment equal to seven months salary. As I mentioned in previous chapters, in the previous three contract renewals, at my suggestion, the board had not given me a raise. Instead the board had agreed to provide an additional month to my severance payment. In this way I had earned three months severance, which was in fact earned compensation, but the payment was deferred until I ceased being an employee. The contract renewal Stu and I had discussed only days before, was to extend my earned severance to four months. I had five weeks unused vacation time and was due more than twenty working days in compensatory time for working extra days and overtime without pay.

By suggesting seven months, I was including the already-earned compensation, including vacation, and comp-time and that the board pay me two months salary, unearned, for the sudden and unwarranted termination. I also suggested I was not willing to leave immediately, but would expect and require to remain on my job for an additional thirty days. Stu agreed to these, and promised to get the directors to agree when their meeting convened.

I don't know what was going through his mind about how the office was going to be run or get through a period without an Executive Director, but we did talk about it. He was aware of my opinion, but I restated it during dinner.

We had on staff two capable and skilled assistant administrators in George and Anthony. Both were fully able to run their departments without supervision. This had been proven over and again because of the long trips I was often forced to take. If the Board of Directors could provide the buffer between them and the power grab that would take place in my absence, the office would continue to run efficiently. the most critical matters would be to keep the trustees from taking direct control of office staff or their work assignments, and from getting control of office spending decisions that I customarily made in conjunction with the WSO board chairperson and the conference chairperson.

We finished dinner quickly and returned to the office. The trustees had ended their business for the night and departed while the directors were just getting there. I had George assemble all office staff members who were still at work. I told them what the trustees had decided, and that I was not going to fight to stay on. Everyone was shocked; several were soon in tears.

Stu called the board meeting to order shortly after six, and although we were still missing a few members, we proceeded with the agenda. There were about three hours of work to be done before we got to the item marked as Personnel. Stu and I moved forward on all of these matters without having first informed the board of what the trustees had decided.

About nine o'clock we finally got to personnel matters. At that time Stu explained what had taken place, and about our dinner conversation. The board was totally shocked. Martin C. quickly said that he didn't care what they wanted. "We need Bob." he argued. "He is an excellent Executive Director and there would be chaos without him. their idea is just nuts!" He was in truth voicing the feelings of nearly all the directors. Martin and several others were willing to go against the trustee recommendations, even though it would cause considerable controversy. Randy J., at his first meeting since becoming a director was incensed. Always quick to raise his temper, this afforded him a new opportunity. Others were just as heated, and had some of the directors from the early eighties been on the board -- such as Kevin F. or Mac M. -- they would have simply told the trustees to shove their idea where the sun don't shine.

After the shock had set in for a few minutes, I quietly explained, that I was hurt by the trustee action, but that NA could not afford to have a fight over the Executive Director. We had been through that once, and by having a one-year contract for me, we had set it up to avoid fights like that again. "Essentially," I told the board, "the Executive Director is an expendable person. The volunteer leadership needs to have someone they can work with, and Trustee confidence in my ability to work with them has vanished. I believe it is best for the fellowship that the directors follow the trustee recommendation." After a little more discussion, I left the room so the board could discuss the matter in private and make decisions on the conditions of my termination. After about forty minutes, I was called back to the meeting, told of the board concurrence to the trustee recommendation, and we proceeded to finish the evening's agenda.

I don't remember sleeping that night, but periodically took aspirin to relieve the pain and swirling in my head. The following morning the board continued with its agenda matters until just before lunch when we finished. the directors each spent some time with me sharing their dismay and disbelief. They also expressed their appreciation and that of a grateful fellowship for my years of service. Each expressed their continuing affection and concern for my well-being. On Sunday afternoon I returned to the office and, as usual, took two separate carloads of departing directors to the airport. I didn't cry until the last had left.

There were four visiting members to the weekend's events that had a ring-side seat. Present this weekend were representatives from Hawaii and Ohio. They were also shocked when told of what had happened. I remember telling them that I was stunned by the decision but the system in place protected the fellowship against a fight over tenure of the Executive Director. I have often wondered what they thought and what they told the folks back home.

On Monday morning Stu and Jack came to the office to preside over a staff meeting at which they explained what had taken place. It was an undignified way to treat a delicate situation. The impression given was that I was being removed for some unspeakable and unannounced cause and that Stu was going to take immediate control of the office. "Yes, Bob was going to remain on the payroll, the staff were told, but without any authority. Supervisory staff members were to meet with Stu at the end of each day and he would make all necessary decisions." From the way Stu and Jack presented the matter, they conveyed to the staff that all trust in my decision-making ability had been withdrawn.

The staff were in complete shock. For most it was hard to comprehend. I had hired most of them, trained them, organized them and made the whole team work. Many felt a loyalty to me that was stronger than their loyalty to the impersonal office that was to emerge from the weekend meeting. there was disbelief, and this time, lots of tears.

It was a tough day. One after another the staff visited my office for moments of personal grief and expressions of affection. Several cried nearly all day. Around five o'clock that afternoon, Stu arrived and commandeered George's office. He proceeded to take full and direct control of the office. I wasn't even invited into the meetings he had with the staff.

I spend the next few days comforting the staff and taking phone calls from people who were just beginning to get calls about what had happened. I tried to work as much as I could, as there were a lot of projects on my desk that had to be finished or ready to turn over to someone else.

Stu came each evening after working at his own job to meet with George, Anthony and other staff members. This caused a lot of friction within the staff and some lasting resentments. I took Friday off and drove to southern Utah, where I owned some property, and escaped thinking about anything but the beauty of the red hills and blue sky.

I was sad that my service to NA was having a sudden and unhappy end. But I was also confident that the office was being left in good hands, if they would let George and Anthony do their jobs. George, Anthony and the staff were well-organized, knowledgeable and capable of doing their jobs regardless of who was Executive Director

(or even without one). We had assembled a talented team of members and local non-members who worked hard for NA. There was very little friction at the time, and the level of commitment to the fellowship was extremely high. The office had been organized into a fellowship services department and a support services department, responsible for internal operations. George ran fellowship services and Anthony managed support services.

George had been the RSR from Florida in the 1981 conference. He served as vice-chairperson for two years under Bob R., and then served two years as chairperson. Shortly after his second term expired, we hired him as my assistant in the overall management of the office. We needed his vast fellowship knowledge and experience. NA had invested thousands of dollars in him when he was an officer of the conference, by sending him to many places around the fellowship to gather information and serve the fellowship. No one at that time was as well prepared to do the job he was given. George is a quiet person with tremendous restraint and tact. Yes, he does have opinions -- strong ones at times -- but he is a professional, dedicated to the service of NA.

Anthony had been a member of the host committee of the 1986 World Convention in Washington, DC. Later, when the Convention Corporation was formed, he became a member of that board and served with considerable distinction. His knowledge of conventions was unparalleled and he was organized, assertive and straightforward. He was just the man you would want as the captain of your team, for any venture. In 1988 the position of H&I coordinator became vacant, and I called Anthony about the job. I wanted Anthony because I knew he had the skills, temperament, background and recovery that we needed in management employees. He was surprised at the call, and more surprised at the job offer. It took some time and persuasion, but he accepted, and brought his family to Los Angeles.

Later, when the support services division was to be created along with the administrator positions to manage it, Anthony was chosen for the job from among eleven qualified candidates. He organized the department, trained and supervised the staff, and managed it with excellence. Anthony demonstrated that same ability when he managed the World Conventions from 1988 to 1990. Without his knowledge, experience and hard work they would not have been nearly as successful.

George and Anthony made a good team for NA, and since I left the office they proved that confidence in them was well placed. The rest of the staff were also steady and dependable. Several, like Bob S., Lois G. and Vida M., had been with the office for many years, and remained the rock upon which the office rested.

These and others were very close friends, and the sudden decision was as tough on them as it was on me. But their dedication to the office was strong enough that they continued to work just as hard during that last month and after I left as they had when I was there. Throughout the staff there existed a spirited sense of purpose that was not dependent on who the Executive Director was. Even so, there were strong bonds of affection, and over the last weeks, I spent time privately with each member to talk about their beginning with the office, our special relationships and our hopes for the future.

The fellowship at large didn't learn of the removal for a week or more. A joint letter from Stu, Jack and Ed D., conference chairperson, was sent to the fellowship announcing the decision. I felt sorry for Ed at having to apply his name to such a muddled and ambiguous communication on such an important decision. The closest they came to announcing a reason for the change was "it became clear to those present that there needed to be a change in the way the office functioned within world services." The unwillingness of the trustees to tell bluntly that I stood in the way of their power grab was a measure of their duplicity.

After fifteen years of adjusting to the changing factors and forces within the fellowship, it was strange to be told I was unable to adjust to the changes that loomed on the indefinite horizon. Looking back after these years, the only functional or organizational change that followed my termination was the attempt by the trustees to take complete control of world services. And yes, I would have continued to oppose that centralization of power.

Reaction from the fellowship was mostly shock and disbelief. Members, groups and committees discussed what little they were told. Many wrote letters to the board, and many wrote directly to me. I received letters and messages of affection and support from places as distant as Australia, Canada and Germany along with many from within the US.

In the final weeks I wrote a closing report for the board, about a hundred and fifty pages including attachments, in which I outlined many of the concerns I felt they could not afford to neglect. I gave considerable emphasis to international fellowship needs, resisting the power grab taking place, and expressing my appreciation to the fellowship at large for their affection and support.

I also wrote a farewell letter to the fellowship at large, hoping the board would permit it to be published in the Newsline. I was pleased that it was. I reminded the fellowship of the disastrous fight over my predecessor, and implied my unwillingness to engage in that kind of battle. I expressed my regret at leaving , and my appreciation for the support and affection that had been shown me during my service with NA. I was not terribly vague in offering several warnings about personality cults and power grabs.

During my last days with the office, we had two going-away parties. The first was the official departure party, but the second was the personal farewell to friends. Both were filled with tears and sadness. But I was leaving a strong World Service Office. It was far different from the one I started working for in June of 1983. I was proud of the changes and the success we had achieved.

The gross income of the office for the year that ended a few months before I became an employee had been $87,000. There was one full-time employee, a part-time employee and a typewriter that didn't work. In seven years, NA and I had built a service office with forty-three employees, a five-million dollar budget, and branch offices in Canada and England.

When I began my first day on the job, there were probably two thousand meetings worldwide and perhaps six thousand members of NA. On the day I left, there were over fifteen thousand meetings and more than a quarter million active members. It was both pleasure and privilege to have been part of that growth and to have had a significant role in its success. There had been some problems along the way, but the fellowship got from me the ultimate in hard work, dedication and fidelity to the interests of the fellowship.

Narcotics Anonymous had become a strong, viable solution in the worldwide war against addiction. Although our Public Information philosophy kept NA out of the headlines, NA is the only entity that is truly solving the problem. Others may fight the war on drugs, but only NA is fighting the war on addiction -- and winning.

It was impossible in 1976, when I first served NA, to have guessed that it would grow to the magnitude it had. but looking back, there was a steady course of expansion. But looking back even further to the very beginning, it seemed even less probable that NA would have become the dynamic, worldwide lifesaver it is.

There is no doubt that I was terribly angry and resentful over my removal. For seven years I had given the fellowship my unreserved effort and determination. I had been faithful to my responsibilities and had been summarily removed without an adequate explanation. My leaving was poorly explained to the fellowship, and they were left with the impression that I had been removed for some hidden and nefarious reason.

Frankly I'm over that now, and writing this chapter was the start of getting over it. I spent nearly a month writing the previous pages of this chapter. As I wrote, I got through some of the anger and I rewrote it and felt better. And I rewrote it again, and again until it finally reads the way it does. The rest of this book was written two years later.

Epilogue

People have often asked me why I was fired. And until I was halfway through writing the previous chapter, I really didn't know. I was never to learn what was said at the trustee meeting about why it was necessary to terminate me so immediately -- a decision I still feel was a poor and ill-considered one. While researching and writing this book, though, and in particular the final chapter, I began to gain some insight into how this happened. I seems during my last year of service, I was oblivious to the signs I now see in the record. And it seems Jack was right to tell me the trustees didn't feel I could adjust to the changes that were going to take place in NA. I didn't understand it that day, but I was the obstacle in the way of the trustees taking control of the fellowship by implementing the one board concept in practice, without actually changing the service structure. Had I understood that, as I do now, yes, I would have fought against it until I was removed.

The problem the trustees had with me was that I had not changed. I was still doing the job the way I had started out: listening to what I heard from the fellowship at large, listening to what the trusted servants were saying, and examining my own heart to determine what was right and wrong. When my heart said something was wrong, I didn't rush forward and support it. When my heart said something was right, it got my full support. But in all cases, since I worked for the fellowship through the authority of the directors, I did whatever the directors wanted.

From my first day the directors were the boss. Between meetings, I consulted with them and went by what the chairperson of the board said. And there were times when I disagreed with what they said. The removal of Ginni is undoubtedly the most notable example. The directors were steady and didn't change. Even when board members left and others took their places over the years, they were basically the same. They examined everything I or the staff gave them, and asked questions about everything -- and then asked questions about things we might not have remembered.

There was a kind of unofficial division of labor within the board. Each member concentrated on one or two areas and became a specialist. Martin C. and Kevin F. were always particular about the budget, finance reports and accounting. And when Robert McD. came along he took that role too. Stu, Bill W. and Martin knew personnel practices, policy and management, so every time something came up on these subjects, others listened and often used their judgment as the basis for decisions. Bob R. from Missouri and Bob K. from Tennessee became the resource on legal matters, contracts and precise wording of letters, motions and reports. Chuck G., Steve B., Jim W., and Donna M. were always on top of productions matters, whether it was the Basic Text or pamphlets. Jamie S-H and Oliver S. were both very determined that non-US matters were clearly thought out and dealt with fairly. Sally E., Randy J., Bob R. from California, Mark D. from North Dakota and Mark D. from Maryland were always watching our relationship with the fellowship to be sure we were open and responsible without being in the way or controlling. Chuck G., Don D., Kevin F., Gerrie D., George K. and Mac M. were very basic in their analysis of what was right and wrong -- everything was measured against basic principles. In their eyes, we did things because it was right and not simply because we could do it, and if something was wrong in principle, then we couldn't do it.

The board evolved a collective vision of what the office should be doing in a growing fellowship. They wanted us to be responsive to the conference, since they were the body that represented the fellowship and were truly the boss of the office. They wanted the office to be efficient and responsible for keeping the fellowship supplied with literature and information. They demanded, and got, open and complete reports on finances, inventory, and whatever else they wanted. They felt the office should be, "out there" with the fellowship, searching for solutions to fellowship problems or concerns within the scope of the duties we were assigned. Additionally, the board knew the office was the central point in the fellowship for the exchange of information and problem-solving. They wanted the staff to be helpful to all groups, committees and boards, without being commanding of domineering.

At the same time, the board gave me and the office a lot of freedom and latitude. They didn't demand to read every letter or get a report on every phone call. They took their job to be a board rather than quasi-staff who wanted to be in the chair of Executive Director. They didn't take opportunities to exercise more and more power or authority. And they remained consistent in their interpretation of what the office staff was supposed to do.

But what did happen was a major power shift outside the office. While Bob R., George, Leah, Chuck and Bob H. were successively chairperson of the conference, the office took them to be the representative of the fellowship at large. And I believe each exercised that duty with determination, objectivity and devotion. They each looked at the WSO board and the trustees as companion agencies of the fellowship, but that each was subordinate to the will of the conference. Yet each of them felt they did not, as chairperson of the conference, have authority to dictate to the trustees of WSO. Each, I believe, felt their duty was to find consensus with the trustees and WSO on matters that came up between the annual meetings of the conference. And the trustees under Sally E., Jack B. (during his 1985-87 terms), and Bob R. acted in the same manner.

But as the record shows, a change started at the beginning of Bob R's second term as trustee chairperson. But his plans suffered a major blow when three experienced trustees (Sydney R., Dutch H., and Bo S.) were not re-elected and Mike B., the only non-addict trustee, decided not to run for re-election. These were replaced by three others, most with less maturity and wisdom. But Bob moved forward to take an ineffective group of trustees and attempt to make them a productive working unit. And he was successful in starting the board on that track.

At the end of his second year as trustee chairperson, he was not re-elected nor was John F., his vice-chairperson. And equally important, Sally E., and Bob B. left the board without seeking re-election. So from April 1988 to April of 1989, eight of eleven trustees were replaced – a seventy-five percent turnover in membership. The board lost members who had each served five or more years and got as replacements people much younger in recovery and maturity.

They new crop of trustees, on average, were ambitious, assertive, and interested in changing the trustees into the power-house that some imagined the fellowship considered them to be. The change was dramatic. Gone were the days when consensus was a watchword of trustee leadership. Gone were the days when the office board and conference chairperson were equal partners in service. Gone was the balance of power that had existed and was built into the Service Manual. It was their determination that the trustees were to supervise the staff, have first priority over spending, establish the agenda for world services and have authority over nearly everything.

While gathering information from the written record to write Chapter Nineteen, I was struck by realizing that the conference leadership, the office board, the staff, and myself were each working under the old assumptions and trying to adjust to the change going on, but not understanding it. As the year progressed, the record shows the trustees became more aggressive and expansionist, and this put me out of step with the new order.

In 1994, I was told through a second party that some of the trustees didn't understand why I hadn't understood why they had removed me, "as I surely had seen the signs along the way in my last six months there!" No, I didn't see the signs, nor would I have wanted to change to serve this new type of master, when I believed the group conscience of the fellowship was already in place. I opposed the one board concept when it was being drafted into the Guide to Local Service and had I realized that it was being put into place, in practice, through changes by the trustees, I would have opposed it. Apparently some of the trustees had better vision than I had and were surprised I couldn't see.

If NA abides by the spiritual foundation embodied within the Steps and Traditions, such ruthless actions should be unthinkable, much less actually take place. But over the years I say this same sudden termination of relationship among many world-level trusted servants over and over again. And frankly I should not have been surprised by it.

Looking back, there were obvious examples to have been guided by. The rift between Jimmy and Greg was almost unfathomable based on their close and lengthy personal relationship. Yet it happened and had not been healed when Jimmy died. And Jimmy had been close to many others who turned their backs on him during those tumultuous years before the conference in 1983. Chuck S. had even been friends with Jimmy but in the end had very little good to say about him except for his determination.

Many times sponsors would cut loose their favorite sponsees (and vice versa) and become implacable adversaries. I remember sitting for hours with friends like Chuck S., Hank M., Kevin F., Bob R., and Steve B., and pondering this, never finding an answer. Greg P. came as close as any, I guess, to understanding why this happens. In 1994 he told me that there is likely a recess in the personality of most addicts where they quickly jump to when they are faced with having to terminate a long-standing, close personal relationship. And rather than ending the relationship with a show of affection, esteem or honor, this recess takes them back to their using personality, and it's like "kissing off a using buddy who took your dope and turned you in." This recess seems to require an immediate suspension of feeling and an almost complete repudiation that there ever was a close relationship. This, he said, appears to happen regardless of how close they were or how long they have worked a program or how spiritual they are in other matters. I tend to think he is pretty near right.

An interesting yet unfortunate truth is that nearly all world-level trusted servants are cast aside when their last day in office ends. Trustees, office directors and conference leadership have all had their day in service and then seemingly fell off the face of the earth. There is no provision in the system to acknowledge their participation and sacrifices. Truly I understand the application of the Twelfth Tradition in such matters -- that spiritual anonymity is the basis upon which we work – yet there is a difference between spiritual anonymity and "kissing off" the departed.

There is much to learn from all of this. The important lessons are that we do need to treat people with loving respect, even when we have to part company. And the principles of the program should be lived in such a way that people who have given faithful and dedicated service to the fellowship are awarded comfort and affection when they leave service.

I believe it is appropriate for the fellowship to acknowledge, in an appropriate manner, the service that others have provided. Without those who came along before us and had the strength and wisdom to keep NA on the right track, NA would have died. It is important to keep the welcome mat at the door of every meeting for those who carried the burden, in their early days of recovery, the duty of making NA successful. I would like to express my admiration for a number of people who, I believe, made it possible for those just coming through the doors today, to find recovery in NA. But truly there are not enough pages to list even their names, much less write about what they did.

I have attempted on these pages to give a factually-based account of what I have discovered about NA and the people who were part of it along the way. Although this book seems long, it would be twice its volume if every person and fact were fully reported. By necessity I have had to be selective, but tried to be fair and representative in covering events and the people involved in them.

I have tried to restrain my prejudices, such as they are, and present the facts as I see them. Some events were omitted and some names were not included when to do so would have caused embarrassment or possible harm. Even when writing the history of NA, it is critical to be concerned about the ongoing recovery of people who may have been part of those events. And there are a few individuals whose efforts were, in my opinion, counterproductive to the health and well-being of the fellowship. Rather than blame such individuals, such activities were portrayed without giving their names.

There are a number of people whose service to the fellowship deserve special recognition. These are people whose contribution were critical to the very existence of Narcotics Anonymous. I have selected six such individuals as heroes of the fellowship, as I believe their contributions were particularly valuable. These are people who have made it possible for NA to have existed, grown, or moved in a positive direction. Without the efforts of these heroes, NA could have died or been much less than it is.

The first hero is Houston S., who got the doctors at the US Public Hospital at Lexington to try the AA concept with their patients. Houston came to the meeting every week until 1963, when he turned his duties over to another AA member. Many addicts, having found

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the message in this meeting, returned to their homes and joined AA. Many of them would eventually help NA when it started in their towns from coast to coast. From this came the New York fellowship and also the foundation for NA in California.

The second hero, of course, is Jimmy. He was part of the birth of NA as we know it today. He was its first "Traditions" conscience and chose to insist that "addiction" was the disease and not a specific substance. Without his determination, vision and hard work, NA would not have survived the 1959 lapse. His strength carried NA along until others were there long enough to help with the burden. And it was his service in the late 1970's when the truly established the office, that made it possible for addicts around the world to have a place to call when they knew they needed recovery from addiction. And while it may not be proper to call any member a hero for simply sharing their personal recovery, it cannot go unmentioned that Jimmy did this by phone and in person, any time of the day or night, for struggling addicts and struggling new NA communities all around the world.

Bob B. whose awakening in Tehachapi led him to become the quiet, reliable, consistent force behind NA, is a true hero. While Jimmy was ill, it was Bob who stepped in and carried the burden of leadership and responsibility for the office. His soft but nurturing personality brought comfort and resolve to others. And his long service as a trustee -- nearly twenty-five years -- was the basis for mature decisions and sound spiritual guidance.

Greg P. is another hero. His vision, his skill with words, and his persuasiveness were to set the framework upon which NA came of age. His early writing of the service structure, though it never materialized in quite that way, made it possible for NA to organize itself and express a true fellowship-wide group conscience. The sacrifice he endured to help fellowships across the country is legendary. His support for the development of the Basic Text, although at personal cost, was key to preserving a unified fellowship and keeping the book project alive.

Bo S. is an important hero of the fellowship. Despite the calamity that his service made of his personal life, his determination made it possible for NA to have a book on recovery. Without the book, the message of NA would have become fragmented, and the fellowship would have been eclipsed by other recovery movements. And without the book, NA would not have had the financial resources to meet the challenges that growth in the eighties afforded.

Bob R. from Los Angeles is also a hero. His vision of what NA could and should be was the driving force behind the way the office grew and responded to expansion in the 1980's. Under his leadership, the conference came into its own and began to produce the tools a dynamic fellowship needed. His selfless devotion drove him to spend countless hours offering guidance and inspiration when NA needed it most. Much of what happened in world services, especially at the office between 1983 and 1990, came as a result of his vision and character.

The seventh hero is actually a body of people rather than one person. These heroes are the trusted servants and special workers who have carried on with the daily tasks of NA service. Without each office worker or manager, without each committee member or leader, and without every group representative and secretary, NA could have dwindled and faded into oblivion.

There are many whose combined efforts, ideas, leadership and recovery provided the spiritual guidance which has enabled NA to truly carry the message of recovery throughout the world. Those of us whose lives have been touched by NA, and all those suffering addicts yet to discover NA and find freedom, owe a deep debt of gratitude to these pioneering members, and to the Higher Power of our individual understanding.

[exerted from My Years with Narcotics Anonymous by Bob Stone]

TIMELINE

The following is archives borrowed from India web page..
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Following WSC '79
Work on "Our Book" begins as a project of the Fellowship...by the World Literature Committee (members were members just by being willing to help). This was not the WSC Literature Subcommittee, that we know today but something called the World Literature Committee. Any NA member could be a part-of.

First World Literature Conference; World lit. held first conference, wrote first literature handbook.

Following WSC '80
Work on Basic Text continues...WLC-2 decides to frame chapters from little White Book...

Memphis Feb.'81
WLC-3 THE CONCEPT: POWERLESS OVER THE DISEASE - IDENTITY-very simply AN ADDICT...AND...THE 1ST DRAFT OF OUR Basic Text - THE GREY BOOK ...are developed by World Literature Committee

Memphis Mar.'81
Grey Book distributed to every known NA Group (free) for review and input.

Santa Monica April '81
WLC-4 Fellowship responds with lots of input. Edit by committee, factoring-in all input begins. WLC membership swells into the hundreds - no NA member is ever denied membership. Book is becoming outgrowth of fellowship.

WSC '81
Obvious battle between WSO & WSB. 1st real WSC - most of the fellowship is represented.

Warren June '81, Miami Sept. '81
Basic Text finalized by committee despite irresponsible, political new chairperson who eventually resigns. Strong, directly- responsible, open committee survives to serve in spite of inadequate trusted servant.

Memphis Nov.'81
WLC elects its own new chairperson, distributes Approval Form of Basic Text to the Fellowship. Every known NA group receives a copy. Policy committee (WSC) enlists help of World Lit members to help draft a new service manual reflective of current fellowship practices- including reformation of WSO, Inc.

WSC '82
Book is approved by the fellowship through the WSC. WSO instructed to produce hardcover by September. Price of book established at $8.00 until office "gets on its feet," then will be lowered - perhaps to $4.50 or less...

Mid-winter '82/'83
No book published by WSO. Most of fellowship copies approval form for use by members till hardcover is out.

WSC '83
"1st Edition" is altered from form approved by fellowship.

Justification used was that some few members feel changes are appropriate. Fellowship demands book returned to approved state by a reformed WSO, Inc.- 2nd Edition

Motion passed WSC by 2/3 of voting participants that RSR'S ONLY VOTE AT WSC. CHAIRPERSON CALLED MOTION DEFEATED BECAUSE NOT 2/3 OF TOTAL REGISTERED VOTING PARTICIPANTS.

WSB MAKES EMOTIONAL APPEAL BASED ON (PROBABLY SOLICITED OR FRAUDULENT) LETTER FROM GROUP IN NEVADA TO 'POLL' FELLOWSHIP DURING A 90 DAY-PERIOD REGARDING CHANGES TO THE CONCEPTS OF 4TH, AND 9TH TRADITIONS REPRESENTED BY DELETIONS IN 1ST EDITION. FELLOWSHIP REPORTEDLY RESPONDS IN AFFIRMATIVE, THOUGH DOCUMENTATION NOT AVAILIBLE TILL 1991. - 3rd Edition

"Original 13" pamphlets approved.

'83-'84
Fellowship Report, originated as open fellowship-wide communication, becomes increasingly (and unnecessarily) detailed and exclusive in tone. WSO, Inc. initiates "Newsline," presenting Office's views to every NA group world-wide, free.

Price of Basic Text is still $8.00 (printing cost reported to be $1.45).

WSC '84
NA WAY magazine taken from the fellowship and given to WSO, Inc.

World convention incorporated as a profit making venture administered by WSO, Inc.

WSC Finance committee disbanded.

World service communication persuades fellowship to accept concept of "vote of confidence" for RSR's.

WSC committee membership begins to close, eventually becomes small controllable groups of like-thinking members.

WSC '85
Little White Book revisions passed... Lit. sub-com. will factor into basic text - 3rd Edition Revised Motion passed to allow WLC to do "minor editing of Basic Text for tense, verb agreement, etc." Office hires professional editor to do lit committee's work resulting in many changed concepts - 4th edition.

WSC '86
Fellowship tells world services "no more professional writers." However, WSC takes it upon themselves without fellowship direction to re-edit Basic Text as committee of the whole - 5th edition [allowing no fellowship review/input and ignoring established fellowship Approval process]

BEGINNINGS OF VTW BOOK

Ah, ha! Great~! Terrific!

Just got off phone with Grover and he has come up with wonderful new idea. Make a book called the Victors of the Traditions Wars. That way we will cover in some detail our memories and just what happened in the eighties and ninties will be more available to those who want to know. I have said often lately that people can't be blamed for not knowing that which they cannot read and study. This is a good case. Further, the general histories may not cover this or cover it in sufficient detail to do it justice. We need to understand just what is in the minds of people who perpetrate their ideas on the rest of us without realizing we have done our homework. If we are unfair or leave some important thing out, it would be nice to hear a response. So far as I know there is no response to the statement that in the eighties and ninties world services succeeded in running off most of the brightest spirits and most dedicated members by exclusionist policies. The members who wrote the Basic Text sold the Basic Text. Without them WS is hard pressed to keep book sales up. How is it good business to savage your free distribution system?

Anyway, no hard feelings, right? But we do this to honor those who died along the way. We know it is the disease and not any one individuals fault. But we need to study and discuss these things openly so that our ranks of newcomers will not subject us to yesterday's horror show. Also, we want our service structure, as well as our meetings, to be safe places for addicts seeking recovery. To the Victorious Members _ YOU!

In Loving Service,

Bo S.

ALL ELSE IS NOT N.A
March 06, 2003

Long ago, there was a saying that helped members of Narcotics Anonymous deal with the various elements that try to intrude on our way of life. When the business concerns of N.A., or the committees that we form to serve us began to get caught up in themselves, we would say, "All else is not N.A."

This handy phrase helped us keep things straight. It didn't mean we weren't grateful to those who served us. It didn't mean we have an attitude towards anyone or anything not N.A. It did mean we don't like bosses. It meant N.A. members set up and were responsible for the meetings of Narcotics Anonymous in the various places where our meetings are held. It strengthened us and made us aware of our spiritual responsibilities. It kept us from feeling betrayed so badly when some of our servants get out of hand. Our trusted servants were responsible to serve us, not to control our actions or manipulate the information we were allowed to receive through service publications.

The phrase "All else is not N.A." helped us focus on the spiritual facts of the program instead of the arrangements and activities of those who act on our behalf sometimes. It is easy for us to get things like this turned around.

When our Basic Text was written, this line was included under the Traditions. It was later the subject of some discussion as a result of a few members in world services who didn't agree with the line and were in a position to exclude it from the material.

That was OK for then but now ten long hard years have passed and many members still see N.A. as a spiritual, not religious program of recovery from addiction. Not just from drug addiction or addiction to narcotics as our name would imply. We have grown. Many, if not all members, have realized for some time that once the chemicals are taken out of the picture, our addiction stands intact and ready to deal with us if we do not find a way to deal with

successfully. Our need for spiritual integrity will always be great. Emptiness seems to result whenever we try to place something other than our spiritual yearnings and experiences in the center of our programs.

N.A. is not a business. We have some needs and functions that may involve collecting and disbursing sums of money to get literature printed or to put on a convention. This is a scaled up model of what we experience in our groups. Never should our coffee chair feel more important than our members who come to care and share the N.A. way of life with one another. Trusted servants serve our group and fellowship needs at many levels. They are enjoined to avoid the error of thinking themselves governors, rulers or directors. This would be untrue and create problems. Our trusted servants have to keep faith with the members they serve. Other goals must never come ahead of carrying our message to those who come to N.A. seeking recovery. There can be no more important persons than these for us.

Those of us who are clean and reached a level of gratitude serve only to balance the scales with those who helped us. We help others in our turn and do for others what was done for us. Further, many of us believe that helping others is the key to our ongoing recovery and part of the reason we were able to escape the clutches of active addiction.

It is easy to slip back into spiritual laziness and let others deal with the things we cannot. "Can not" may be "will not." "Will not" can lead to big trouble if we expect spiritual growth. One of the greatest verities for us is that abstinence alone is not enough to keep us clean. Spiritual growth, a sense of emotional health, the ability to tolerate increases in our honesty and the alleviation of our obsessions and compulsions is fundamental to recovery. The hole in the gut must be filled.

Confusing spirituality with morality would put us in the category of churches and other institutions that seek to promote goodwill, health and well being among people in a variety of ways. There is nothing wrong with these efforts. It is just that we are not a business and we are not a church. Worldly concerns are not the source of our disease.

For our spiritual fellowship to survive, we need to look long and hard at our goals and our resources. If we promise to share freely that which we were freely given, we can hope to live up to it. If we promise to provide recovery and various levels of assistance to addicts seeking recovery, we have crossed a line and risk spiritual bankruptcy. You can't bankrupt God. Spirituality is shared human experience of what goes beyond the world and fills the needs we have for a sense of comfort and well being. Once we learn to apply spiritual principles in a practical way, our lives improve dramatically.

It is true that not everyone can do this with equal results. What is right for one may be wrong for another. We can't predict outcomes. We can say that for those of us who have given this program our best, we have been surprised and amazed. Our actions and commitment to recovery reflect our gratitude.

Correctness Cults

In the absence of real historical materials, beliefs held in common by differing groups of members within NA are free to roam at large, do battle, recruit and participate in seemingly endless war with opposing viewpoints. They function like local war lords and rule by force of verbal arms. They conduct kangaroo courts and frequently exclude NA members from participation in their groups or meetings and sometimes run people out of NA. A growing number of witnesses attest to this. Also, a growing number of survivors are coming back to NA and tell of having been run off because they wouldn't go out with someone or sought answers with unpopular questions. This is not recovery in action. It is simply fear and social ineptitude acting in an information vacuum where no one is really sure what to do because they are or have been faced with problems they never experienced.

IF WE LOOK FAR ENOUGH INTO OUR PAST - WE WILL SEE OUR FUTURE

The N.A. TREE

The Service Structure of Narcotics Anonymous
(11/ 7/ 75)

Serenity Prayer : GOD . . . Grant me the Serenity to accept the things I cannot change. The Courage to change the things I can . . . And the Wisdom to know the difference

. We cannot change the nature of the Addict or Addiction . . . We can help to change the old lie "Once an addict, always an addict" by striving to make recovery more available. God help us to remember this difference

An open letter to the members of Narcotics Anonymous

November 17, 1975

Dear Fellow Members:

Again, the groups in our area are being asked questions like, "Hey, what's this GSR we're supposed to be electing next week, what does he do?"; "Where does the money go, what's it used for?"; " Now that I've been elected Secretary, what do I do?"; "What's the WSO?" Most of the answers we've heard to these questions and others like them have been based on good guesses, opinion, or misinformation. There doesn't seem to be anywhere in N.A. where this kind of information is set down in plain terms.

Gathering together what we could find in old ditto sheets, letters, tapes, from the literature of other fellowships such as ours, and from our own experience, we have tried to find answers to some of our own questions and to clarify some of our misconceptions. The following is a pamphlet about the service structure of N.A. as we understand it. Its purpose is to express, in simple terms, basic ideas about how we as members and servants of N.A. relate to each other and to N.A. as a whole. It is our hope that this pamphlet will become part of our literature, available to all members; and that, in some small way, it will help ensure the continuation and growth of our fellowship.

Yours in Fellowship,
A Group of Concerned Members

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Narcotics Anonymous

World Service Office
P.O. Box 622
Sun Valley, CA 91352

DEDICATION

This presentation of the Service Structure of Narcotics Anonymous is dedicated to the following proposition:

To assure that no addict seeking recovery need die without having had a chance to find a better way of life, from this day forward may we better provide the necessary services.

Our N.A. Symbol

Simplicity is the keynote of our symbol; it follows the simplicity of our fellowship. We could find all sorts of occult and esoteric connotations in the simple outlines, but foremost in our minds were easily understood meanings and relationships.

The outer circle denotes a universal and total program that has room within for all manifestations of the recovering and wholly recovered person.

The square, whose lines are defined, is easily seen and understood; but there are other unseen parts of the symbol. The square base denotes Goodwill, the ground of both the fellowship and the member of our society. Actually, it is the four pyramid sides which rise from this base in a three dimensional figure that are the Self, Society, Service and God. All rise to the point of Freedom.

All parts thus far are closely related to the needs and aims of the addict seeking recovery and the purpose of the fellowship seeking to make recovery available to all. The greater the base, as we grow in unity in numbers and in fellowship, the broader the sides and the higher the point of freedom. Probably the last to be lost to freedom will be the stigma of being an addict. Goodwill is best exemplified in service and proper service is "Doing the right thing for the right reason." When this supports and motivates both the individual and the fellowship, we are fully whole and wholly free.

INTRODUCTION

The purpose of this pamphlet is to express, in simple terms how we, as members and servants of Narcotics Anonymous, relate to one another and to N.A. as a whole; and to present an ideal Service Structure for N.A. in such a way that we can strive to improve our fellowship, and better fulfill our primary purpose of carrying the message of recovery to the addict who still suffers.

N.A. is a Twelve and Twelve program borrowed from the A.A. fellowship. In fact, three of the first committee of five were also members of A.A., who wanted to make this proven program of recovery available to addicts. So why, you may ask, don't we just use A.A.'s structure and be done with it? This would probably be a good idea except that we are not A.A.; our needs, despite the similarities, are to a certain extent different. (As addicts, the progression of our illness is normally much more rapid that alcoholism. How many alcoholics have you heard who have at some time in their lives been reasonably successful in business or family relationships? On the other hand, how many addicts have ever had anything even resembling a successful business or family relationship? This is just an example of how our basic patterns are subtly different.) We are precluded from directly using any part of the A.A. program other than the 12 Steps and 12 Traditions; and finally in order for N.A. to survive we must be autonomous, we must have a fellowship and program of our own.

In the early days of N.A. we had what have been called "rabbit" meetings; held sporadically in different places at different times. At this time with only one or two N.A. meetings in existence, a specific structure for N.A. wasn't needed and really wasn't wanted. Soon N.A. grew, and permanent meetings were established, but because these were few in number and all were located in the Los Angeles area, there was still no real need for any established service structure. However, N.A. has continued to grow. As groups began opening up in population centers other than Los Angeles, we began to feel the need for some kind of structure. Intergroup or General Service Committees came into

being in various locations, each trying to take care of business on a local level, without too much regard for N.A. as a whole.

In the last 5 years, this approach has sort of backfired. The unity necessary for personal recovery has been in short supply. Each group or area moved in its own direction -- usually apart. The very existence of N.A. was again seriously threatened as it was in the 1950's when the traditions were ignored. Some positive action has been taken to try to solve this problem, conventions were held, a World Service Office opened, and lines of communication shakily established. We can see that these attempts have paid off to a certain extent. Groups in various areas are starting to work together, much of the petty bickering seems to have disappeared and it seems that many members, in all areas, are trying to establish a better environment for sobriety [in AA this word means a balanced state of mind in abstinence from the drug alcohol - this term was dropped as N.A. developed in lieu of "recovery"] in N.A. The strength and unity of purpose evident at the last N.A. Convention shows we are making progress. Maybe this is because for the first time, we now find many members with long-term sobriety [recovery] active in the meetings and in the fellowship. It's no longer a rarity to find members with years clean rather than only weeks or months. Perhaps some of the personal maturity gained in living drug-free has started to have an effect on N.A. as a whole.

Despite this progress, we are still at a very critical stage of the "coming of age" process. Today large, active fellowships are developing in several population centers and new groups are starting up in many areas throughout the United States and in foreign countries. N.A. is growing, and with this growth the need for unity and communication increases. The old adage that a house divided cannot stand applies to N.A. as well as any other group. Right now we don't seem to have any unifying structure or clear-cut lines of communication for N.A. as a whole. What structure there is, only functions on a local level and our vital lines of communication have often been both hard to locate and as changeable as the weather. It is our sincere hope that this presentation of the service structure of our fellowship, as we understand it, will help to fill in some of the gaps that separate us; and that in some small way we can contribute to the growth and future of N.A.

THE TWELVE TRADITIONS OF N.A.

We keep what we have only with vigilance and just as freedom for the individual comes from the Twelve Steps, so freedom for the groups springs from our traditions. As long as the ties that bind us together are stronger that those that would tear us apart, all will be well.

1. Our common welfare should come first; personal recovery depends on N.A. unity.
2. For our Group purpose there is but one ultimate authority -- a loving God as He may express Himself in our Group conscience; our leaders are but trusted servants, they do not govern.
3. The only requirement for membership is a desire to stop using.
4. Each Group should be autonomous, except in matters affecting other Groups, or N.A. as a whole.
5. Each Group has but one primary purpose -- to carry the message to the addict who still suffers.
6. An N.A. Group ought never endorse, finance, or lend the N.A. name to any related facility or outside enterprise, lest problems of money, property or prestige divert us from our primary purpose.
7. Every N.A. Group ought to be fully self supporting, declining outside contributions.
8. Narcotics Anonymous should remain forever non-professional, but our Service Centers may employ special workers.
9. N.A., as such, ought never be organized; but we may create service boards or committees directly responsible to those they serve.
10. N.A. has no opinion on outside issues, hence the N.A. name ought never be drawn into public controversy.
11. Out public relations policy is based on attraction rather than promotion; we need always maintain personal anonymity at the level of press, radio and films.
12. Anonymity is the spiritual foundation of all our Traditions, ever reminding us to place principles before personalities.

It is necessary that we be aware of these principles in all our N.A. work and especially whenever our actions could in any way affect N.A. as a whole. Any undertaking such as this pamphlet must, if it is to be valid, have as its foundation all of these traditions. The N.A. pamphlet says: "There is one thing more than anything else that will defeat us in our recovery, this is an attitude of indifference or intolerance toward spiritual principles." The Traditions are spiritual principles and we have tried in writing this pamphlet to keep these principles in mind.

The First Tradition, of course, is the purpose of this pamphlet. A service structure for N.A. is necessary for our common welfare and to promote personal recovery. Unity within our fellowship is the goal we hope can be achieved by the implementation of this structure.

Much thought has gone into the structure to be described in this pamphlet. One of our primary aims has been to lay out the structure in such a way that the integrity of the conscience of each group is maintained throughout the service arm of N.A. The Second Tradition also describes the nature of those members active in N.A. Service as trusted servants and only by emphasizing this relationship between the group and its representatives can the principle of democracy and group conscience, which we have tried to build into this structure, work. We find it necessary to stress that adherence to the Second Tradition is of the utmost importance, without it no effort to strengthen N.A. as a whole can be successful.

The guarantee that our society will remain an open fellowship in which recovery is available to all and not limited to a select group is one of the principles (Third Tradition) which the implementation of a formal structure can help to ensure. We hope that N.A. will never become weighted down with rules, regulations, requirements, initiation fees, selective membership, and discrimination which prevent recovery and which have, in time, destroyed most programs designed to help addicts.

Tradition Four talks about the autonomy of each group, except as it affects other groups and members. Again this Tradition can be strengthened by lines of communication and unity, freeing the individual group from the arbitrary actions of another group.

Our primary purpose, as expressed in the Fifth Tradition is, along with some of the other Traditions, the reason we are writing this pamphlet. The hope that we can, in some way, carry the message of recovery more successfully and on a broader scale has been our motivation.

The Sixth Tradition concerns the use of the name Narcotics Anonymous. Formal service structure with active member participation can help prevent the misuse of our name and guard against the problems of money, property and prestige and their ultimate weakening of the fellowship.

Undoubtedly one of the most widely used terms in N.A. is the "7th Tradition." Most groups, in fact, even call the collection which is taken during most meetings the Seventh Tradition. This is unfortunate, the Seventh Tradition is not a basket with money being put into it; it is a principle -- probably the most widely confused and abused principle within all the 12-step fellowships. Few of us, it seems, have given much thought to this principle and its far-reaching consequences. The 12 Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous were not adopted by the fellowship until 1950 and during the 15 or so years prior to this adoption A.A. was not fully self-supporting. Numerous cash gifts from non- members and organizations were accepted, loans were taken, a cash advance on Big Book sales was accepted, stock was issued, and money came from many sources outside the fellowship. Because of the "strings" so often attached to free or easy money, A.A. had to pay its dues for this outside support. All the Traditions are there for good reasons and the reason we must be fully self- supporting is obvious in the history of A.A. It is, in more than any other way, through the practice of this principle that our fellowship maintains its freedom. The acceptance of a service structure for N.A. will give us a guide to what needs to be supported, a context in which one can see where the money goes, a chance for the group to use its funds to benefit N.A. as a whole, and some checks to help prevent our contributions from supporting someone's habit or paying someone's rent.

Tradition Eight describes the nature of people who will make up this service structure. That they should be non-professional just as we are individually non-professionals in our 12 Step work is obvious, and for the same reasons. The nature of professionalism contradicts the principle of giving freely of one's self for the common good. This principle of giving and sharing is, of course, one of the cornerstones of our program of recovery.

The Ninth Tradition has been the topic of considerable deliberation in the preparation of this pamphlet. How can we propose a structure without proposing organization? The Tradition states that we ought never be organized, but that we may create service boards and committees. This seems to be, at first glance, almost a contradiction in terms, but somehow we must untangle this mess. We ought never be organized and disorganization is killing us. What can we do without violating this Tradition? We feel that the key to this problem lies in understanding the purpose and nature of the structure we propose. First of all the purpose of this structure is service. Most of us realize that in order to keep our meetings going there are some necessary functions which must be performed, this is service. The development of lines of communication within our fellowship is service. Providing for 12 Step work is service. This Ninth Tradition says that we may create service boards or committees directly responsible to those they serve. Most of this pamphlet deals with just that. But what about mapping it all out with charts and descriptions, and everything, isn't that organization? The purpose of laying out these boards and committees in an orderly form, showing what they do, and how they relate to each other is not organizational in nature, but informational. What we are presenting is not an organization, but a method; a method by which the services necessary to N.A. can be performed with a minimum of confusion. In this sense, this service structure is fully in keeping with our Ninth Tradition.

As with other Traditions the Tenth Tradition is supported by the service structure. With such a structure functioning within our fellowship we are assured that no one person can express his personal opinions in the name of N.A. as a whole.

With a service structure, public relations as discussed in Tradition Eleven become a group matter rather than a personal one. With the group conscience working as the basis for decisions concerning public relations the chances of inadvertent anonymity breaks are greatly reduced. The individual who is going to publicly break his anonymity at the level of press, radio, films, or TV because of self-obsession, in one form or another, is going to do so despite traditions, service structure, group conscience or the advice of his friends. In establishing this service structure we do not vainly hope to prevent this type of anonymity break, we do, however, hope to minimize the occurrence of the accidental anonymity breaks which result form lack of information and guidance.

That leaves us with the Twelfth Tradition. We, as a group, feel that this tradition, as it relates to this topic and to N.A. as a whole, is self-explanatory. We pray that in implementing this service structure, principles may always be placed before personalities.

THE SERVICE STRUCTURE OF NARCOTICS ANONYMOUS
[organizational chart below]

MEMBER

GROUP

AREA SERVICE COMMITTEE

REGIONAL SERVICE COMMITTEE

WORLD SERVICE BOARD -- WORLD SERVICE OFFICE

WORLD SERVICE CONFERENCE

A NOTE ON TERMINOLOGY

Considerable thought and discussion took place concerning which words should be used to describe our structure. It seems ironic that, while we were in agreement about the structure itself, we went "round and round" about the words. The irony, of course, is that it's the structure which is important, not the words. Some felt that we should use the same terms that other fellowships have used, other felt that we should use government terminology. Both of these suggestions, as well as others which came up in the course of our discussions, have merit, but neither fully serves the purpose. First of all, this structure of ours isn't exactly like any other and it can't just be plugged into an existing framework. Secondly, the use of someone else's terms would not be in N.A.'s best interest. N.A. is a fellowship unto itself; and it is of the utmost importance that we maintain our own identity.

For the purpose of this work, we decided to use the simplest possible terms which were meaningful to us all. Geographically we chose to use the words Area, Region, and World. These designations can be thought of as roughly equivalent to the telephone company divisions in the sense that they are meant to represent population rather than location. this is important because we are, and deal with, people not places. Furthermore, we tried to avoid using terms such as "organization," which might imply a lack of adherence to our Traditions. Instead, we used words like Service Board and Service Committee which could not be construed as a violation of the Traditions.

Another important thing to keep in mind is that some of the service arms which we describe in this structure are not a part of the N.A. program. They exist separately and are designed to provide services to the program. The Narcotics Anonymous program consists only of 12 Steps, 12 Traditions and addicts helping each other. We have described three types of service in this overview; these are Personal Service, General Service, and World Service. In general, the Personal Service one or more members can offer directly to the addict who still suffers is a part of the program. It is in the nature of our 12th Step work. General Service and World Service, however, are not primarily involved in this type of direct service. Rather, they are designed to support our program of recovery by providing the services necessary for our members and groups to survive and grow.

If you as a member or as a representative of your group need more information or clarification on any part of this pamphlet your World Service Office will be more than happy to help. Get in touch with them by writing: WORLD SERVICE OFFICE, P.O. BOX 622, Sun Valley, CA 91352.

The Member

The front-line, so to speak, of N.A. Service is the individual N.A. member. A member is a self-proclaimed addict who is living a drug-free life by practicing the principles of Narcotics Anonymous. Anyone can be a member, the only requirement is the desire to stop using. One qualifies by taking the First Step and remains a member as long as he or she is clean and desires membership. The services that each of us provide are the most important in N.A. It is the member who carries the message of recovery and works with others. It may sound silly but without an active membership there would be no need for a service structure, there would be no N.A.

The benefits of membership are clear cut to us all: a drug- free life, the chance to grow, friendship, and freedom. However, membership is not without its responsibilities. It is the responsibility of each member to maintain his or her personal sobriety [recovery], to share freely his experience, strength and hope with the addict who still suffers; and to work to ensure that, that which was freely given to him remains available to the newcomer.

Before coming to N.A. most of us realized that we could not stay clean alone. The gathering together of two or more member addicts for the purpose of learning how to live a drug-free life by practicing the principles of N.A. constitutes an N.A. Meeting. When these meetings are held regularly, they can become a Group.

The Group

An N.A. Group is any meeting which meets regularly at a specified place and time, provided that it follows the 12 Steps and 12 Traditions (having no outside affiliations and receiving no outside financial support) and is duly registered with the World Service Office of Narcotics Anonymous. The Group is the second level of the service structure of N.A.

The primary purpose of an N.A. Group is, of course, to carry the message of recovery to the addict who still suffers. However, it also provides to each member the chance to express himself and to hear the experiences of other members who are learning how to live a better life. There are two basic types of groups: those which are open to the public, and those closed to the public and for addicts only. Meetings vary widely in format from group to group. Some are participation meetings, some speaker, some question and answer, some special problem discussion, some topic discussion, and some have a combination of these formats. Despite the type of format a group uses for its meetings the function of a group is always the same, to provide a suitable and reliable environment for personal recovery, and to promote such recovery. The Group has proven to be the most successful vehicle for 12 Step Work. After sharing one's personal experience, strength and hope, the most valuable thing a member can do is usually to being the suffering addict to a group meeting. In this way the group meeting becomes a place where the newcomer knows he can come for help. Often the first thing that can open the doors of recovery for the addict is the recognition of himself in others. The Group provided a setting in which the newcomer can find this identification by hearing a number of recovering addicts instead of just one or two.

The Group is the level at which we first find some of the mundane business of N.A. being taken care of. There is rent to pay, literature to buy and distribute, refreshments to be provided, a meeting hall to be kept clean, a time schedule to follow, announcements to be made, and many other things to be done for the maintenance of the Group. The Group must stay in contact with other Groups in their local area and with the rest of N.A. so they can find out about activities, learn of new groups opening up, get new literature, and find out what's happening in N.A. This is also the first level or which fellowship funds are handled, and the correct use of this money is essential for the preservation of the Group. In general, there are many uninteresting things that a Group must do, in addition to its meeting, which are necessary for survival.

We have found that most members who attend group meetings just aren't interested in the "business" of N.A. As a result, a few dedicated members who are willing to do something for the group, usually have to do most of the work. It is at this point that the principle of trusted servant comes into being. Although most addicts don't want to help out with the work, they are at least willing to delegate this responsibility to someone else. This seems to be part of the nature of the addict. These members who have been drafted to do the work make up an informal Steering Committee out of which come the group officers. For the purpose of most groups these officers usually consist of a Secretary, a Treasurer, and a General Service Representative (GSR). Some groups, however, have additional officers, such as a Program Chairman to arrange for speakers of decide topics to be discussed, depending on their specific needs. Group officers other than the GSR normally serve for a period of one year and are elected by the group as a whole. One of the pitfalls which has caused many N.A. groups to suffer or even fold has been the election of officers who were unqualified to serve or did not have a history of sobriety [recovery]. Often N.A. elections have seemed to be popularity contests rather than the selection of trusted servants. The officers of a group must be chosen with great care because of the responsibilities that their offices carry and the potential effect bad officers can have on their group.

The Group Secretary is responsible for the day-to-day functions of the group. It is his primary responsibility to assure that the group meeting takes place when and where it is supposed to. He selects a leader for each meeting, makes sure the coffee gets made, keeps the meeting records, arranges for group business meetings, arranges for the celebration of "birthdays," makes sure that the meeting hall is left in proper order, and answers correspondence. This job is important because without a good Secretary a group had little chance of attracting new members.

The Treasurer of an N.A. group is responsible for the funds which come into the group from the collection and for the distribution of these funds. The money collected in our meetings must be carefully budgeted. There are numerous expenses necessary for running a group.

The Treasurer keeps an accurate record of all the group's financial transactions, he or she maintains the group bank account, and distributes monies to pay the rent, purchase literature, provide refreshments, buy supplies, and cover the costs of any miscellaneous expenses the group incurs. In order to maintain our fellowship and freedom, the monies which come from group collections and members contributions must always be used to further our primary purpose. A group must first support itself. After paying its bills, any remaining funds should be placed in a group bank account and a reserve adequate to run the group for 2 or 3 months built up. After this "prudent reserve" has been established, excess funds should be diverted to help N.A. as a whole. A group can do this by contributing to the area or regional committee which serve the group or through contributions directly to the World Service Office of Narcotics Anonymous. One of the biggest problems we have faced has been the misuse of group money. Thousands of dollars in needed funds has just sort of disappeared. This abuse limits what N.A. can do and for the individual the dues have usually been very heavy; obviously, the Treasurer has a grave responsibility and much thought should be taken in selecting a member to perform this function.

The General Service Representative is the vital link between his group and the rest of N.A. He is the formal line of communication whose purpose it is to represent his group's conscience in matters affecting other groups of N.A. as a whole. Because the role of the GSR is so important to the success of N.A., this servant will be discussed in some detail in the next section of this pamphlet.

As a general guide, we have found that the group Secretary and Treasurer are most successful if they have certain assets necessary for the performance of their responsibilities. These qualifications include:

1. The willingness or desire to serve.
2. A history of sobriety [recovery] (we suggest a minimum of 6 months continuous freedom from drugs -- including alcohol).
3. A good working knowledge of 12 Steps of recovery.
4. An understanding of the 12 Traditions.
5. Active participation in the groups they are to serve; preferably some experience with the group's Steering Committee.

These assets do not guarantee a good servant, however, they do help to ensure that those we choose will be capable of doing the job. Normally, group Secretaries and Treasurers serve for a period of one year at which time they are succeeded by other members who have been elected by the group. Of course, the use of drugs while serving as a group servant constitutes an automatic resignation for that officer. One of the responsibilities of group officers not often talked about, is to train group members to replace them. A group can be strengthened by new officers who are prepared to take over the responsibilities of those they replace. Another valuable lesson we have learned is that the continuity of service can be aided by staggering the election of servants, and overlapping terms of service. (Example: A Group Secretary might be elected in November to begin serving in January and the Treasurer elected in March to begin in May.) Remember, choose your trusted officers well, it is you who they will be serving.

PERSONAL SERVICE

The Members, the Meeting, and the Group provide what has been called Personal Service. This type of service is in the nature of the one-to-one, addict-to-addict relationships so important for our initial sobriety [recovery] and recovery. It is at this level that we find personal identification, the hope necessary to continue, and the first introduction to the program of recovery.

The General Service Representative

As we have said, the General Service Representative (GSR) is the line of communication between the group and N.A. as a whole. He or she is the link that binds the groups together in their performance of our primary purpose. It is his responsibility to keep the group informed and to express the group conscience. In all matters affecting N.A. as a

whole or other groups he is, in fact, the voice of his group. Finding good GSR's who will take an active part in the business of N.A. is probably the most important thing we can do to improve the fellowship. Active representation, more than any other thing, can strengthen the ties that bind us together, and promote our common welfare.

The GSR speaks for his group at Area and Regional Service Committee meetings. He takes part in the planning and implementation of the N.A. functions which affect the members of his group. As a result of this participation he can keep his group informed about what is happening in N.A. A group member should always be able to go to his representative and find out about activities, other groups, and about N.A. as a whole. Although the GSR is no expert on N.A., a member should be able to come to him and get guidance or information concerning how N.A. works, the Traditions, and how he can get more involved. The GSR is an active group member. He serves on the Steering Committee, helps train new officers, and is normally the mail contact for the World Service Office and other groups. He is responsible for maintaining the group's 12 Step list. Often the GSR's phone is busier than that of any other member; he is the contact for his group. AS if this weren't enough, the GSR, in most groups, is also responsible for the literature. He makes sure books and pamphlets are available, and that new publications are presented to his group. He also encourages members to submit their stories and thoughts to the WSO for incorporation (anonymously, of course) in the N.A. Newsletter or pamphlets in production.

A group's General Service Representative normally serves for a period of two years. The first year he or she is an alternate who can take over in case the voting representative is ill or cannot, for any reason, continue to serve. The second year, he becomes the voting representative, taking over the full responsibilities and functions of the office, and in turn is helped by a newly elected alternate. This "apprentice" system serves two purposes: First of all, it helps to provide a continuity of service which never leaves a group unrepresented; and secondly, the year spent as an alternate provides the training necessary to a good GSR.

As you can see, the role of the GSR in N.A. service is not a simple one, or one to be taken lightly. The election of good GSR's and alternates is probably the most important thing that you, as an individual, can do for N.A. as a whole. In choosing your representative, remember that he or she is your voice and your ears in N.A. If you wish to be well represented and well informed, it is your responsibility to elect the best possible nominee. For this reason we suggest that candidates for GSR should have:

1. A commitment to the principle of creative action through service.
2. A minimum of one year of continuous cleanliness.
3. Experience as a group officer.
4. A good working knowledge of the 12 Steps and 12 Traditions of our fellowship.
5. An understanding of the service structure of N.A. and the nature of the GSR.

These qualifications are not, of course, hard, fast rules. They are however, some of the things you should consider in the selection of your representative. The General Service Representative, as we have described him, is your link to the rest of N.A. He is also the tie that binds the personal service you and your group perform to the next type of service which is offered by N.A. -- General Service.

GENERAL SERVICE

Thus far we have been dealing with the personal services that one member or a few members can offer the newcomer in his search for recovery. The next type of service found in N.A. is General Service. General Service provides the support necessary for groups of N.A. members so that they can act together for the common good. A new idea in service also begins at this level, this is the concept of community service. This kind of service not only helps the addict who still suffers but also makes available, to the society it serves, a workable program of recovery for the drug addict for who other types of help have seemed to be just so much wasted effort. Narcotics Anonymous exists in many areas as an obscure unrecognized drug program, about which little is known. It is a fact that most communities in which active groups exist, acknowledge the often surprising, success of our fellowship and are grateful to have our groups around.

General Service is divided into sections, the area and the region. These are both geographic and functional designations. The area is designed to provide service to individual groups with specific needs and the region is established to serve many groups with common needs. This difference in function is important to keep in mind as we discuss these two levels of service because in many ways they provide very similar services. The group's General Service Representative is active at both these levels and must be aware of the nature and purpose of each, lest we fall back into many of the problems we are trying to overcome.

In 1969, N.A.'s first committee, specifically designed to fill our General Service needs, was established. This group and others like it have contributed greatly to the growth of N.A. However, today it is no longer enough to have a few members getting together to keep their groups going. N.A. has grown and is continuing to grow. The absence of effort towards some necessary functions, and the duplication of efforts towards others seems like an old friend to many of us; a cure causing worse problems than the illness.

A "Designated Area" within N.A. is any local area, community, or town with a significant number of N.A. meetings. We have found it convenient to think of an area as any community or communities which comprise a single telephone directory. This concept seems adequate for our needs today, however, any set of groups within definable geographic boundaries who need to function together as an area can be a designated area.

The "Designated Region" is a broader geographic unit made up of one or more areas. Normally we consider a region to be any state within the United States or any foreign country. Again, the definition of a region is ultimately one of need, any N.A. areas which can show this need can be considered a designated region. A good example of this, as it exists today, are the Northern and Southern regions of N.A. in California. In the future, it may be necessary to break this down even further. A definition of a region might then be any geographic unit comprising a single telephone area code. We feel it necessary to stress that for the purpose of N.A. the designations of area and region should always be based on specific need rather than resentments, insanity, or personalities.

AREA SERVICE COMMITTEE

An Area Service Committee (ASC) is a committee made up of representatives (GSR's) from all Groups within a designated Area (provided that it is duly listed with N.A.'s World Service Office) which meets monthly for the purpose of serving the specific needs of its member groups.

Our experience has shown that from time to time our groups have problems which they can't handle on their own. In the spirit of our fellowship, we, as individuals seek help from one another to deal with our living problems; just so, groups can find help from other groups. For this reason General Service Committees have been established. However, most of the problems a group faces are of such a nature that another group located many miles away can be of little assistance. Only a nearby group can help and for this reason our General Service structure is made up of both Regional and Area Committees. The Area Service Committees are made up of representatives from all the groups in an area and are designed to support their members groups.

Isolated groups often have a hard time of it because there is no one nearby to whom they can turn. For this reason it is to the groups' benefit to put forth as much effort as possible towards starting other groups in their Area; and, once this is accomplished, establishing a new ASC as soon as possible. Often isolated groups have had to temporarily sit in with another Area's Committee of even act on its own in order to provide the necessary services. Experience has shown us hat this can sometimes be a very rough road. If your group is of this isolated type, it is of the utmost importance that you keep in especially close contact with your World Service Office and other groups even though they are located elsewhere.

Because groups, just like individuals, find it hard to survive alone, one of the most important functions of the ASC is to encourage new membership. This can, of course, be most successfully accomplished by active 12 Step work. For this reason, each ASC should maintain an accurate 12 Step and Sponsor list, put together a notice of its meetings and

post this notice in places where people can see it, provide for periodic public service announcements, keep in contact with local authorities and referral agencies, and perhaps arrange for an answering service to take calls which can then be referred to members on the 12th Step list. In our Areas this type of service is provided on a personal basis and our primary aim is to being the newcomer into our fellowship in the hope that he too can benefit from our program.

Another major function of our ASC's is in providing activities which may make cleanliness more attractive to the newcomer, give the member an opportunity to learn how to function drug-free on a social level, and which gives us a chance to gather together to celebrate living. These local activities could include dances, picnics, parties, dinners, breakfasts, round robin meetings, and any other functions which the committee feel would benefit its groups.

The third and most important service which the ASC provided is that of Group support. Whenever a group has specific problem or need which it has not been able to handle on its own, it can come to its Area Committee for help. These problems are almost limitless in scope. However, we have learned that we can get much accomplished when we work together.

The ASC often performs other functions which are of help to the groups. This committee helps new groups get started or gives aid to floundering groups. It might scout as area for potential meeting places; might help a group which is short of funds set up a "work party" system in lieu of rent; might encourage members of other groups to attend meetings which need support; our might keep a stock of literature which the groups can purchase without waiting for mail to get to and from the WSO. The point is that the ASC handles whatever functions are necessary or helpful to its groups.

In order to provide these services the ASC needs the support of its groups, the active participation of its GSR's, certain facilities, and qualified leaders. The group supports its Area Service Committee both financially and emotionally. It takes money to provide the services we have described. It is the groups responsibility to offer this support. When as ASC is formed this need for funds may be minimal. Just enough to pay for a post office box, the rent of a hall once-a-month, and to serve coffee. However, as an Area grows so the financial needs of the committee also grow. In order to provide a full line of services it requires a steady, reliable input of money. Some Areas have tried to provide these funds through their activities or by holding "round-robin" types of special meetings, or by any number of fund raising methods. All these alternate courses of financial support are helpful, however, the bulk of the responsibility still falls on each group.

The active participation of each group representative is essential for a successful ASC. Each GSR must keep his group informed and must represent his group's spiritual conscience in all committee decisions. In addition to this a GSR participates in helping to carry out the ASC's other specific functions. The planning and implementation of activities, the attracting of new members, and the aid given to groups with special problems are services which require much more effort than a monthly meeting. Most Area Service Committees have found that a subcommittee system is necessary to provide these services. A subcommittee service, such as 12 Step work, and may meet or do work as needed during the month between regular ASC meetings. It is the GSR's who make up these subcommittees and do the work.

There are certain facilities which are necessary to the services provided by the ASC. In the beginning the may simply be a permanent mailing address (usually a post office box), a bank account, and a place to hold meetings (often a private house). As the membership and number of groups within an Area increases, or when the groups decide that they need a broader spectrum of services, more facilities are needed. These might include a telephone answering/referral service, a ditto machine, a typewriter and adding machine, and a place to store literature, among others. As an Area grows still more the members may decide to consolidate and improve these facilities by opening and staffing a local office. At all times, however, these facilities must reflect the needs of the Area if they are to be an asset to the groups rather than a burden.

In order to coordinate these services, each ASC elects officers. These officers include a Chairman, Vice-Chairman, Secretary, and Treasurer. The Chairman conducts the monthly meetings and is responsible for correspondence; the

Vice-Chairman coordinates subcommittee functions; the Secretary keeps an accurate record of what occurs at each meeting; and the Treasurer keeps track of the finances. Their functions and responsibilities are very similar to those of the group officers. These officers are elected yearly from among the active General Service Representatives. They do not normally represent any group and have no vote in the committee.

REGIONAL SERVICE COMMITTEE

The General Service Representative also attends the quarterly meetings of the Regional Service Committee. The Regional Service Committee (RSC) is made up of the GSR's from all the groups within a designated Region. This service committee is also designed to provide service to its member groups; and must be duly registered with the World Service Office. The ASC and RSC are similar in nature and purpose, however, their functions are slightly different. While the ASC serves the specific needs of the individual groups; the RSC serves the common needs of many groups. One of the primary aims of the RSC is to unify the groups within its jurisdiction. Another aim is to carry our message to addicts who cannot attend our meetings. A third basic function of this committee is to contribute to the growth of N.A. as a whole; both by helping to support our World Services and by initiating much of the work to be finalized at our World Service Conference. Ingrained in these basic functions is, of course, our primary purpose of carrying the message of recovery to the addict who still suffers. The desire to more effectively achieve this purpose is the reason that our Service System, including the RSC, exists.

Just as the ASC often deals with problems that the groups cannot resolve on their own; so the RSC tries to solve problems which the groups and their area cannot deal with. This is especially true when these problems involve several groups or an entire area. This is one way in which the RSC strives for unity. Another unifying function of the RSC is that of communication. The RSC provides a meeting place for groups and areas and a stepping stone to other Regions and N.A. as a whole. Most RSC meetings are held on a Saturday or a Sunday and either in a location central to the region or rotationally in the areas within the region. Sometimes the meeting will be scheduled for an afternoon preceded by a luncheon get-together. This provides an ideal setting for the representatives of various groups who might not normally get to know one another, to meet and develop valuable lines of communications.

The RSC is also responsible for major activities such as conventions, retreats, and round-ups. These also can be considered functions to stimulate N.A. unity. Most of us have, at some time, attended an activity of this type; and we are aware of the unity, creative action, and fellowship they can create. We encourage each region to hold at least one major activity each year. These can be as simple as a camping trip or an involved as a convention; it doesn't really matter, they all provide the same stimulus. Usually the planning and implementation of an event such as these is left to a Regional subcommittee specifically established for this purpose. We have found that a subcommittee system is even more important at the Regional level than it is in our Areas. This is because the region covers a greater number of meetings and only meets every few months. By necessity most of the work (excluding major decisions and matters of conscience) must be done by subcommittees. Only the initiation and finalization of a project actually takes place in the general RSC meeting.

Our traditions say that our primary purpose is to carry the message to the addict who still suffers. This is just as true for the RSC as it is for any group. All RSC functions have this purpose as a goal, however, some functions relate directly to carrying the message. As we have noted, the Areas basically work to being the addict to the fellowship, through public relations, public service announcements and advertising. The RSC's basic means of attracting addicts is to take the program to the addict. Institutional work is the responsibility of the RSC. This work is usually handled by one or more subcommittees. This type of "out of the fellowship" work is very important, but often very touchy. Most of the violations of our Sixth Tradition inadvertently occur during this type of work. Drug Programs, Mental Health Groups, hospitals, criminal diversion courses, drug and alcoholism schools, and other organizations who have requested N.A. speakers or panels for the benefit of their patients, residents, or members have at times used the N.A. name as part of their publicity. This type of misuse should, at all times, be avoided. It doesn't do their program any good and can easily become a threat to N.A.

Another important part of the RSC's function is to contribute to our World Services. Regional support in the nature of funds, ideas, and confidence is essential to the work of our World Services. Any excess funds which accumulate at the Regional Level should be contributed directly to our World Service Office. The RSC, itself has little need of monies; since it does not have any stationary facilities. Areas normally sponsor RSC meetings and arrange for securing a hall, preparing a luncheon, and providing coffee. Even when our RSC chooses to arrange these things themselves there should be no great expense since each GSR pays his own way, and these meetings only occur quarterly. Monies are needed for major activities, however these are ideally self-sustaining; with enough left over from one activity to secure the next. The RSC does, however, need money to operate; there are expenses. Large quantities of literature are often supplied to institutions and hospitals; most RSC's normally publish quarterly meeting directories; most Regions sponsor their delegates to the World Service Conference; and groups of any kind require miscellaneous funds for postage, stationary, supplies, and the like . Your RSC needs your support and the support of your group.

Most of the suggestions, ideas, and literature presented at the World Service Conference are initiated at the regional level. These are submitted in writing prior to the conference in order to be placed on the agenda.

Like the ASC, the RSC elects officers each year. They include a Chairman, Vice-Chairman, Secretary and Treasurer. Their functions and responsibilities are identical with those of Area officers. The RSC also elects a Regional Service Delegate who speaks for his region at the World Service Conference. He is the counterpart of the GSR, and will be discussed more fully in the next section of this pamphlet.

Both the Area and Regional Service Committees are autonomous just as the groups they serve. The first thing a group of any kind must have, if it is to establish its identity, is a mailing address. Once they have this, the next thing to be done is the register with our World Service Office. A group or committee must be registered in order to be listed in our World Directory and in order to receive the information and support available from the WSO. The final thing that must be done when forming a group or committee is to set down some kind of framework within which to function. For our groups, this is usually a simple format which describes the type of meeting to be held and how to proceed in holding it. Our committees also need a format in order to keep their meetings orderly, however, in addition they need some kind of guidelines in order to maintain their service functions.

Meeting formats vary widely from group to group however, meetings usually consist of a statement defining the group, readings from our pamphlet, the body of the meeting, announcements, a collection to support the meeting, and a closing prayer. As ASC meeting might consist of a definitive statement; the reading of our Traditions, old business (including work in progress and subcommittee reports), new business (including a report from each group), announcements, a collection, and a closing prayer. ASC meetings are generally fairly flexible in their formats in order to deal with the wide variety of problems which might come up. RSC meetings, on the other hand are usually pretty well structured. The format of an RSC meeting is virtually identical to that of an Area committee meeting. However, because the RSC deals primarily with common problems, individual groups do not usually report their specific needs. Some Regions have found it valuable to conduct their meetings by a prearranged agenda. During the time since their last meeting, the officers of these meetings have been in touch with Area Officer and collected topics for discussion and problems to be considered at upcoming meetings. In this way group and Area problems can be dealt with on a priority basis, and similar problems can be combined to prevent duplication of effort.

As we have said, each service committee should have some king of guidelines to ensure that its services continue to be provided regardless of changes of officers or representatives. Some committees have by-laws to fulfill this purpose. We feel, however, that the locked-in rigidity implied by the term "by- laws" doesn't represent the function of these committees accurately. We must always remain flexible enough to handle whatever comes up. For this reason, we suggest that the term "guidelines" be used instead. These guidelines should include a description of the committee, its purpose, the scope of its service, and should define the functions and responsibilities of its members, officers, and subcommittees.

The General Service Committees are the real working body of N.A. It is these committees which can contribute more to the growth of N.A. than any other parts of our service structure. However, in order to function they need active support; your support. Choose your representatives carefully; participate in group functions; get involved in N.A.; seek to serve where and when you can. The work's hard and often there seems to be little getting accomplished. However, you personal return will be a thousand-fold.

THE GENERAL SERVICE DELEGATE

The General Service Delegate (GSD) is to the Region what the GSR is to the group. The GSD, as a representative of his Region, speaks for the members and groups within his region. The primary responsibility of the GSD is work for the good of N.A. as a whole by providing two-way communication between his Region and the rest of N.A. The GSD attends the annual World Service Conference and takes part in any decisions which affect N.A. as a whole. The responsibilities of this servant don't begin or end with the conference, being a GSD is a year 'round job. He attends all RSC meetings and as many ASC meetings as possible; serves on one or more conference committees; receives conference information and requests from the WSO; works closely with Regional Officers and subcommittees; and is a source of information or guidance in matters concerning the Traditions or N.A. as a whole.

The GSD is elected at the group level. The representatives of each group, gathered together in committee, nominate potential delegates from among their number. Each GSR then takes these names to his group for a group conscience vote. The results of this vote are reported back to the RSC and the nominee who receives support from the most groups becomes a Delegate for the following year. A GSD normally serves for a period of two years; the first as Alternate Delegate, and the second as a voting Delegate.

We feel that in order for GSD's to do a good job, each nominee should have the following qualifications:

1. A commitment to service.
2. Service experience.
3. The willingness to give the time and resources necessary for his job.
4. A minimum of five years of continuous abstinence from drugs.
5. A good working knowledge of the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions of our fellowship.

Our General Service Delegate should be selected from among our best informed, most trusted, and most active members in order that they may best serve our needs and the needs of N.A. as a whole.

WORLD SERVICE

The final type of service which N.A. offers is World Service. These are the services which deal with the problems and needs of N.A. as a whole and which N.A. as a whole offers to its members, its groups, and to society. The basic purposes of our World Services are communication, coordination, information, and guidance. We provide these services so that our groups and members can more successfully carry the message of recovery, and so that our program of recovery can be made more available to addicts everywhere.

Our World Services include three specific service bodies: the World Service Office, the World Service Board and the World Service Conference. These three branches of service are interrelated and work together to benefit N.A. as a whole. The World Service Office is the "heart" of our World Services; the World Service Board, the "soul," and the World Service Conference, the "mind."

Within our World Services we again find new service concepts developing. First, our World Services work for the good of N.A. as a whole, only at this level do we find service bodies designed to deal with problems which involve our entire fellowship. A second new concept found at this level is that of the non-addict servant. These individuals have valuable skills from which our fellowship can benefit; and they can often give us viewpoints which are not clouded by the disease of drug addiction.

Our descriptions of the arms of N.A. World Service will be necessarily brief. At this date our World Service System is in a developmental stage, and we feel that any attempt at a full description of these services could, perhaps, limit their potential effectiveness. Each branch of World Service functions within its own framework; and these guidelines, as they develop, will specifically define the nature of our services. For the purpose of this pamphlet we are presenting a brief overview of the major functions and inter-relationships of our branches of World Service.

WORLD SERVICE OFFICE

Probably the single busiest part of our service tree is the World Service Office (WSO). WSO functions as the "heart" of N.A., circulating our lifeblood to and from all groups and members within our fellowship. WSO is the contact point and the distribution point.

One of the most important functions of the WSO is to link our wide spread groups and members into a single cohesive fellowship. The WSO stays in close contact with our Groups, Areas, and Regions. This contact is maintained through correspondence, our quarterly newsletter, and through the delegates and representatives of our service structure. WSO offers considerable aid to new groups, existing groups with special problems, institutional groups, groups outside the United States, members who travel extensively, and loners. This aid is in the nature of sharing the experience which other groups and members have reported to the WSO and by putting those who seek aid in touch with other groups or members within our fellowship.

Another major function of WSO is the publication and distribution of literature. This office publishes yearly a World Directory, quarterly Newsletters, all World Service Conference material, and new literature in both English and other languages. In order to provide these publications, WSO needs both financial support and the input of literature drafts from our members, groups and committees. WSO is also responsible for the printing, warehousing, and distribution of all existing literature. Additionally, a number of information kits such as our starter kit are available. As a sideline to its literature, the WSO also offers reel-to-reel and cassette tape recordings of important N.A. functions, personal "pitches," typical meetings, and discussions on various topics.

Another very important function of our World Service Office is to coordinate our World Service Conference. WSO is responsible for the planning of the Conference itself, selecting a suitable site, locating lodging, arranging for meals, establishing the agenda, notifying the delegates, and administrating all the details necessary for the Conference to take place. If and when N.A. has a truly international convention, the administration and coordination of this event will also be the responsibility of the World Service Office.

In order to provide communication, coordination, information, and guidance services, the WSO must keep extensive files of correspondence and other records. These files include letters to and from those who have contacted WSO; a file of all correspondence with each N.A. group; a record of all starter kits sent out; the name, address, and telephone number of all GSR's and GSD's; and the address of all General Service Committees and their officers. Along with these files and records, WSO keeps the archives of N.A.'s history. These archives contain relevant documents, newspaper articles, photos of original meeting places, etc. Records such as these are necessary so that we may learn from our past mistakes, stay in contact with all of N.A., and serve our fellowship.

One of the most difficult jobs of the World Service Office is dealing with public anonymity breaks. Due to the nature of our fellowship no part of our service structure should ever function as a disciplinarian. This would not be in keeping with our basic principles. When public anonymity breaks do occur, the WSO does function in an educational role. We try to explain to the individual or group and the media involved that actions of this type are in violation of our Traditions; and that this type of publicity can potentially cause grave problems which could threaten the survival of our fellowship. It is never our place to attempt to punish, we can only try to prevent the reoccurrence of this type of problem.

The final WSO function we shall discuss is that of public relations. Much of our mail consists of requests for information from individuals, agencies, and other drug programs. It is our policy to answer each inquiry; however, we stress that our function is not informational or referral. Our program is principles and people. Our relationship with those outside our fellowship is cooperative and our Traditions make it clear that we must stay unattached if we are to survive.

All these functions make it necessary for our World Service Office to be more of a "business" than a part of the fellowship. WSO is separate from N.A. but works with N.A. WSO functions as a non-profit corporation; with managers, departments, administrators, paid employees, subsidiaries, and the like. Our office is administered by our World Service Board and acts upon the directives of our World Service Conference. WSO is truly a business; its raw material is the program; its product is sobriety [recovery]; and its function is service.

THE WORLD SERVICE BOARD

The World Service Board (WSB) of Narcotics Anonymous has the broadest scope of any branch of our service structure. The responsibility of this board is to help deal with anything that affects N.A. as a whole; both internally and externally. All things which may endanger the existence of our fellowship or limit our growth are of concern to the WSB. This board does not, however, govern. Its nature is that of a custodian; providing guidance. The members of the World Service Board are known as Trustees and consist of both addicts and non-addicts. Their only purpose is to serve the best interests of our fellowship; and through the World Service Conference we give them the authority to do this.

Like the World Service Office, our World Service Board functions as a corporation apart from our program per se. All the actions of the Board are guided by our Traditions. Although the primary aim of the Board is to ensure the maintenance of the Twelve Traditions, they also serve in many other capacities and have other responsibilities.

The WSB is responsible for the administration of our World Service Office. In this capacity they strive to increase the effectiveness of its many functions and coordinate its activities. In order to perform this function and others the WSB utilized a subcommittee system similar to that used by our ASC and RSC; the main difference is that the Trustee committees are permanent while the General Service subcommittees are usually set up to deal with specific needs and disbanded when their job is done. The standing committees of the World Service Board indicate the major functions of the Board and include: public relations, finance, literature, institutions, policy, planning and nominations.

These committees meet throughout the year and are composed of Trustees, members and an occasional non-addict. Committee members are selected on a "What they have to offer" basis, and each brings special skills or experience relevant to the committee function.

The internal structure of the World Service Board is different from the rest of our service branches. The Trustees do not represent; they serve. This service is for an indefinite term; however, each trusteeship is reaffirmed yearly to ensure the continuation and quality of service. The WSB works closely with the World Service Conference and conference committees, but functions within its own guidelines. Its day to day activities are its own province. We, as members, have given the Board the right to act on our behalf, so long as its actions are within the framework of our Traditions. The Trustees do not, however, have the authority to control N.A. or change the nature of our fellowship. Our Second Tradition ensures that major policy decisions can only be made according to the spiritual conscience of our entire fellowship. This means that each of us, through our service structure, maintains the right to have a say in what happens in N.A.

THE WORLD SERVICE CONFERENCE

The final part of our service structure is the World Service Conference (WSC). It is the nerve center, the brain, of our fellowship. Our conference is the one time each year, when all our service branches come together forming the complete N.A. tree. Unlike all other branches of N.A. service, the Conference is not an entity; it is an event, the

coming together. In the spring of each year the Regional Service Delegates, the Trustees of the World Service Board and the manager and directors of the World Service Office meet to discuss questions of significance to the fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous as a whole.

The conference itself can last up to a week; however, the planning and implementation associated with the conference is a year-round proposition. The WSO is responsible for the administration associated with the conference itself. The Trustees and directors who attend the WSC must spend time in preparation studying problems to be discussed and gathering information upon which decisions can be based. Each delegate must be knowledgeable about the needs and feelings of his region, and be prepared to contribute to the conference.

The conference usually begins with an opening meeting which includes opening ceremonies, an overview of topics to be presented, and a review of the meaning and effect of the Twelve Traditions.

From this general meeting the conference splits up into eight committees at which all suggestions, questions, and problems which have been submitted are discussed. These topics can include anything of major importance to N.A. as a whole.

These committees include: the literature committee, finance committee, World Service Office Committee, World Service Board Committee, public relations committee, institutions committee, conference report committee, and the Conference Planning Committee. Each delegate serves on one committee; each committee contains at least one trustee; and those committees which have equivalents in the WSO or WSB meet in conjunction with them. the purposes of the committees are to discuss all input within their scope; resolve items which do not require major policy decisions, and prepare resolutions for policy items. These resolutions are designed to occupy as little general meeting time as possible and include a simple statement of the resolution, arguments for and against, and the facts which support these arguments.

After the agenda for the general meeting has been prepared from resolutions gathered from the committees, all conference members get together as a body once again. At this general meeting each resolution is presented and considered. Some resolutions can be acted upon by the conference and some must be taken back to each Region, Area, and Group for group conscience decisions.

The World Service Conference does not speak for N.A. as a whole. The voice of N.A. as a whole can only come from fellowship-wide group conscience. However, the conference can, because of our service structure, initiate action which will benefit all members.

Once the conference has considered all resolutions and decided which required group conscience votes and which were within the realm of conference action, the committees meet once again to plan for the implementation of the conference resolutions. The committees decide which branch, the WSO, the WSB or the RSC's can take the most effective action. Based on these decisions, directives are drafted and submitted for final approval.

Then, finally, all conference members meet together once again for the closing meeting. At this time the directives are approved and the closing ceremonies take place.

It sounds like the World Service Conference has a lot of power...this isn't true. All conference matters are dealt with in strict accordance with our Traditions and the Traditions clearly define the powers of the Conference; each Conference member is a trusted servant and has shown an understanding of our traditions; and all items discussed in conference originate within the fellowship. Due to its very nature, the Conference is the servant of the fellowship.

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Everything that occurs in the course of N.A. service must be motivated by the desire to more successfully carry the message of recovery to the addict who still suffers. It was for this reason that we began this work. We must always

remember that as individual members, groups and service committees we are not, and should never be, in competition with each other. We work separately and together to help the newcomer and for our common good. We have learned, painfully, that internal strife cripples our fellowship; it prevents us from providing the services necessary for growth.

It is probably obvious to you that many of the responsibilities and functions, which we have mentioned, just aren't getting done today. It has not been our intent to condemn the good work which has been done and is being done. Rather, we hope to clarify what needs to be done as that we can provide better service. The service structure of Narcotics Anonymous, as we have described it, does not exist in N.A. today. It is an ideal towards which we can strive, and in so doing, make recovery available to a greater number of addicts.

[Editor's Note: the paragraphs above state clearly that this structure did not exist except in outline form. Greg Pierce felt till the day he died that the service structure described in the NA Tree had never been fully implemented.]